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Acts

Acts - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of Acts

1. The apostles spread the good news about Jesus in Jerusalem (1:1–6:7)
2. The church expands into Judea and Samaria (6:8–9:31)
3. The church expands to include Gentiles (9:32–12:24)
4. Paul goes to Asia Minor as an apostle to the Gentiles (12:25–16:5)
5. The church expands into the middle Mediterranean area (16:6–19:20)
6. Paul reaches Rome, but as a prisoner and after several trials (19:21–28:31)

Luke makes transitional statements at 6:7, 9:31, 12:24, 16:5, and 19:20 to mark the movement from each major part of the book to the next part.

What is the book of Acts about?
The book of Acts tells the story of the early church. It relates how more and more people, from different backgrounds and in different parts of the Roman Empire, became believers in Jesus. It shows the power of the Holy Spirit helping the early Christians. The events in this book begin with the return of Jesus to heaven and they end about 30 years later.

How should the title of this book be translated?
Translators may choose to call this book by its traditional title, "The Acts of the Apostles." Or translators may choose a different title, for example, "The Acts of the Holy Spirit through the Apostles."

Who wrote the book of Acts?
The author of this book does not give his own name. However, the book is dedicated to Theophilus, the same person to whom Luke dedicated his story of the life of Jesus, the Gospel of Luke. Also, in parts of this book, the author uses the word "we." This indicates that the author traveled with Paul. Most scholars think that Luke was this person who traveled with Paul. Therefore, since early Christian times, most Christians have thought that Luke was the author of the book of Acts as well as the Gospel of Luke.

Luke was a medical doctor. His way of writing shows that he was an educated man. He was probably a Gentile. He personally witnessed many of the events that he describes in the book of Acts.

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

What is the church?
The church is the community of people who believe in Jesus as their Lord and Savior. The church includes both Jewish and Gentile believers. The book of Acts shows God helping the church. It shows God doing signs and wonders to confirm the church's testimony to Jesus, leading many people to have faith in Jesus, guiding the church about where and how to share the good news, and enabling believers to resolve conflicts and endure persecution.

The kingdom of God
The "kingdom of God" is a major concept in the book of Acts, as it is in the Gospel of Luke. This concept is very rich in meaning. It includes the idea of eternal life in the presence of God, but it also includes the idea of what the earth will be like in the future when God rules everything, and the idea of life on earth right now, when and where God's wishes are carried out fully. The unifying concept behind all of these ideas is that of God ruling and of people embracing God's rule over their lives. Wherever the expression "the kingdom of God" occurs, translation notes will suggest communicating the idea behind the abstract noun "kingdom" with some phrase that uses the verb "rule." UST models this approach consistently. (See: Abstract Nouns)

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

Figurative usages in the book of Acts
"arise/arising"

Luke often says "arise" or "arising" to mean taking action to get an enterprise under way, rather than to mean getting up from a sitting or lying position. Notes will indicate where this figurative usage occurs.

"brothers"

Luke often uses the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. Although this term is masculine, Luke uses the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If you decide to retain this figurative usage in your translation, you could state "brothers and sisters" to indicate that the word has this generic sense. (See: When Masculine Words Include Women)### Possible translation difficulties in the book of Acts

"to the same"

Acts - Chapter 1 Introduction

The phrase “to the same” occurs five times in this book (1:15, 2:1, 2:44, 2:47, 4:26). It is not entirely clear what this phrase means. In the first three instances it could mean “in the same place,” but it could also mean “in one accord,” that is, “in full agreement.” In 2:47 it seems to mean “to their group.” Paul uses the same phrase in 1 Corinthians 11:20 and 14:23, where it could mean “in the same place” or it could have the sense of full agreement and mean something like “in Christian fellowship.” That sense would fit Acts 2:47, where the phrase could be translated as “to their Christian fellowship.” In 4:26 it could mean “to the same place,” but it could also mean “by agreement.” Notes will discuss the different possibilities in each case where the phrase could mean more than one thing.

“in/to/into the temple”

Luke uses this phrase many times in this book, but it does not refer to the temple building itself. Only priests were allowed to enter that building, so the phrase refers to the courtyard or area around the temple. The phrase “in the porch that is called Solomon’s” in 3:11 makes it clear that Peter and John and the crowd that gathered on the occasion that chapter describes were not inside the temple building. Notes will address this phrase to explain its meaning each time it occurs in the book.

What are the major issues in the text of the book of Acts?

The following are the most significant textual issues in Acts. Notes will address them where they occur in the book.

First, there are some verses that are found in traditional versions of the Bible, but they are not found in the most accurate ancient manuscripts of the Bible. Some modern versions put these verses in square brackets ([ ]). The ULT and UST also put them in brackets. If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider including these verses if that translation does. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, we recommend that you indicate in some way that these verses may not be original. You could put them in brackets, for example, or in footnotes. These verses are:

- Acts 8:37, “Philip said, ‘If you believe with all your heart, you may be baptized.’ The Ethiopian answered, ‘I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God.’”
- Acts 15:34, “But it seemed good to Silas to remain there.”
- Acts 24:6–8, “And we wanted to judge him according to our law. But Lysias, the officer, came and forcibly took him out of our hands, sending him to you.”
- Acts 28:29, “When he had said these things, the Jews departed, having a great dispute among themselves.”

Second, in some verses, it is uncertain what the original text said. The ULT uses the first readings listed below, but it includes the second readings in footnotes. If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider following the same reading that it does. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, we recommend that you follow the same reading that ULT does. These verses are:

- Acts 3:22, “the Lord our God.” Some versions read “the Lord your God,” and other versions read “the Lord God.”
- Acts 7:46, “a dwelling for the house of Jacob.” Some versions read “for the God of Jacob.”
- Acts 10:19, “three men.” Some versions read “two men” or “some men.”
- Acts 10:30, “Four days ago, at this hour, I was praying at the ninth {hour} in my house.” Some versions read, “From the fourth day until this hour, I was fasting, and at the ninth hour I was praying in my house.”
- Acts 12:25, “They returned from Jerusalem.” Some versions read, “They returned to Jerusalem” (or “to there”).
- Acts 13:18, “he put up with them.” Some versions read, “he cared for them.”
- Acts 15:17–18, “This is what the Lord says, who has done these things that have been known from ancient times.” Some older versions read, “This is what the Lord says, to whom are known all his deeds from ancient times.”

(See: Textual Variants)

Acts - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

The UST has set the words “Dear Theophilus” apart from the other words. This is because English speakers often start letters this way. You may want to start this book in the way that people start letters in your culture.

Some translations set quotations from the Old Testament farther to the right on the page than the rest

Acts 1:1 (#1)

of the text. The ULT does this with the two quotations from the book of Psalms in 1:20.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The Ascension
This chapter records an event that is commonly known as the "Ascension." That word describes how Jesus returned to heaven after he became alive again. In the future he will come back to earth again, and his return to earth is known as his "Second Coming." (See: heaven, sky, heavens, heavenly; and resurrection)

Baptism
Luke uses the word "baptize" with two different meanings in 1:5. In the first instance, it refers literally to the water baptism of John. In the second instance, it refers to people being filled with the Holy Spirit. Luke uses the term "filled" to mean this same thing in 2:4. (See: baptize, baptized, baptism)

"He spoke things concerning the kingdom of God"
Some scholars believe that when Jesus spoke "things concerning the kingdom of God," as Luke describes in 1:3, he explained to the disciples why the kingdom of God had not come while he was on earth the first time. Other scholars believe that the kingdom of God did begin while Jesus was on earth and that Jesus explained that it had come in a form different from the one the disciples had expected. Since Christians hold different views about the kingdom of God coming, translators should be careful to avoid letting how they understand that issue affect how they translate this verse.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Long sentence
As was common in compositions of this time, for stylistic purposes Luke begins this book with a very long sentence. It goes from the beginning of 1:1 to the end of 1:3. ULT represents all of this as a single sentence. It may be helpful to your readers to divide it into several sentences, as UST does.

The details of the death of Judas
There are some differences in detail between the way Luke describes the death of Judas in the book of Acts and the way Matthew describes it in his gospel. Luke says that Judas used the money he got for betraying Jesus to buy a field; Matthew says that Judas returned the money to the Jewish leaders and that they bought the field with it. Luke says that Judas killed himself by falling onto the field from a height; Matthew says that Judas hanged himself. Luke says that the field was named the "Field of Blood" because Judas died a bloody death there; Matthew says the field was given that name because it was purchased with "blood money," that is, money paid to ensure someone's death.

It is possible to reconcile many of these details. For example, the body of Judas may have fallen and split open on the field if he fell when he tried to hang himself. Luke may say that Judas bought the field because the Jewish leaders would not take back the money that they had paid him, and so in a sense it was still his money when the field was purchased with it.

But it would probably be best to avoid trying to reconcile these details within your translation. For example, when Luke says in 1:18 that Judas fell onto the field, instead of saying that he fell when he was trying to hang himself, you could let Luke and Matthew each tell the story the way they do. Then you can leave it up to preachers and teachers of the Bible to explain how their accounts are compatible.

The 12 disciples
There is one small difference between the list of the 12 disciples that Matthew and Mark provide in their gospels and the list that Luke provides in his gospel and in the book of Acts.

All three writers list Simon Peter and his brother Andrew; James and John, the two sons of Zebedee; Philip, Bartholomew, Thomas, Matthew, James the son of Alphaeus, Simon the Zealot, and Judas Iscariot. But Matthew and Mark say that the twelfth disciple was Thaddeus, while Luke says he was Judas the son of James. However, it is quite likely that Thaddeus was another name by which this other Judas was known.

Once again it is not necessary to try to reconcile these details within your translation. Specifically, in 1:13 instead of saying, "Judas the son of James, who was also known as Thaddeus," you can let each of the biblical writers tell the story in the way that they do. Then you can leave it up to preachers and teachers of the Bible to explain how their accounts are compatible.

Acts 1:1 (#1)

τὸν & πρῶτον λόγον ἐποιησάμην

"I made the first account"

Luke assumes that Theophilus will know that by **the first account** he means the book that has become known as the Gospel of Luke. Since that book was not known by that title at this time, it would not be accurate to put the title in your translation as a name that Luke would have used to describe the book to Theophilus. However, you could explain this in a

footnote and use another expression here. Alternate translation: [I wrote in my first volume]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:1 (#2)

ὦ Θεόφιλε

"O Theophilus"

Here Luke is identifying and addressing the man for whom he complied this account of the early church. Since this is like the salutation of a letter, in your translation you may wish to follow your culture's way of identifying and greeting the addressee of a letter. UST models this by saying "Dear Theophilus" and putting the phrase at the beginning of the sentence.

Acts 1:1 (#5)

περὶ πάντων & ὧν ἤρξατο ὁ Ἰησοῦς ποιεῖν τε καὶ διδάσκειν

"about all that Jesus began both to do and to teach"

This is a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [about some of the most important things that Jesus did and taught]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 1:1 (#4)

περὶ πάντων & ὧν ἤρξατο ὁ Ἰησοῦς ποιεῖν τε καὶ διδάσκειν

"about all that Jesus began both to do and to teach"

Luke is using the word **began** to indicate that Jesus had been doing something else (working as a carpenter) but then began to do something new when he started his ministry. In your language, it might not be necessary to translate the word **began**, since it might seem to convey redundant information that would be not be natural to express. Alternate translation: [all that Jesus both did and taught]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 1:1 (#3)

Θεόφιλε

"Theophilus"

Theophilus is the name of a man. It means "friend of God." It may be his actual name, or it may describe what this man was like. Most translations treat it as his name.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 1:2 (#1)

ἄχρι ἧς ἡμέρας

"until that day"

While this did happen on a specific day, Luke is likely using the word **day** to mean a specific time. Alternate translation: [up to the time when]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:2 (#3)

ἀνελήμφθη

"he was taken up"

Luke is referring to Jesus being **taken up** into heaven. See the discussion of "Ascension" in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [he was taken up into heaven] or [God took him up into heaven]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:2 (#2)

ἀνελήμφθη

"he was taken up"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [God took him up]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:3 (#2)

μετὰ τὸ παθεῖν αὐτὸν

"after he had suffered"

This refers to how Jesus suffered and died on the cross. Alternate translation: [after he had suffered and died on the cross]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:3 (#4)

δι' ἡμερῶν τεσσεράκοντα, ὀπτανόμενος αὐτοῖς, καὶ λέγων

"appearing to them for 40 days and speaking"

While the antecedent of **whom** is "the apostles whom he had chosen" in the previous verse, Jesus actually appeared to many other disciples besides his apostles. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that explicitly. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [For 40 days he appeared to his apostles and many of his other disciples, and he spoke]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:3 (#3)

ἐν πολλοῖς τεκμηρίοις

"with many proofs"

The word translated as **proofs** describes items of evidence that are decisive and convincing. Alternate translation: [with many definitive proofs]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:3 (#1)

οἷς καὶ παρέστησεν ἑαυτὸν ζῶντα, μετὰ τὸ παθεῖν αὐτὸν, ἐν πολλοῖς τεκμηρίοις

"to whom also, after he had suffered, he presented himself living with many proofs"

As the introduction to this chapter suggest, it be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Jesus also presented himself alive with many proofs to his apostles after he had suffered]

Acts 1:3 (#5)

τὰ περὶ τῆς Βασιλείας τοῦ Θεοῦ

"things concerning the kingdom of God"

See the discussion of the concept of the **kingdom of God** in Part 2 of the General Introduction to Acts. If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **kingdom**, you could express this with a verb such as "rule," as UST does.

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 1:4 (#1)

ἀπὸ Ἰεροσολύμων, μὴ χωρίζεσθαι, ἀλλὰ

"not to depart from Jerusalem, but"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative verb **depart**. Alternate translation: [to remain in Jerusalem and]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 1:4 (#2)

ἀπὸ Ἰεροσολύμων, μὴ χωρίζεσθαι

"not to depart from Jerusalem"

The content of Jesus' instructions to the apostles on this occasion begins here. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could translate and punctuate the material from here to the end of the verse as a direct quotation, as UST does.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 1:4 (#6)

ἠκούσατέ

"you heard"

Here, **you** is plural because Jesus is speaking to the apostles, so use the plural form of "you" in your translation if your language marks that distinction. In 1:6, "you" is singular because Jesus alone is being addressed, so the singular form would be accurate there. In general these notes will not discuss whether **you** is singular or plural when this should be clear from the context, but they will address ambiguous cases where this may not be clear.

See: Forms of You

Acts 1:4 (#5)

ἣν ἠκούσατέ μου

"which you heard from me"

In keeping with his engaging storytelling style, Luke begins a quotation from Jesus here without introducing it with a formula such as "he said." If it would be helpful to your readers, you could include an introductory formula in your translation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [He said, "You heard about this from me] or [He said, "I told you about this]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 1:4 (#3)

τὴν ἐπαγγελίαν τοῦ Πατρὸς

"the promise of the Father"

Jesus is referring to the Holy Spirit by association with the way God made a **promise** to send the Holy Spirit. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit, whom the Father promised]

See: Metonymy

Acts 1:4 (#4)

τοῦ Πατρὸς

"of the Father"

Father is an important title for God. Alternate translation: [of God the Father]

See: Translating Son and Father

Acts 1:5 (#2)

ὑμεῖς & ἐν Πνεύματι βαπτισθήσεσθε Ἁγίῳ

“you will be baptized in the Holy Spirit”

After describing earlier in the verse how John baptized people literally, Jesus is using baptism in this second instance as a metaphor. See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit will come and empower you]

See: Metaphor

Acts 1:5 (#4)

οὐ μετὰ πολλὰς ταύτας ἡμέρας

“after these not many days”

Jesus is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. Alternate translation: [just a few days from now]

See: Litotes

Acts 1:5 (#3)

ὑμεῖς & βαπτισθήσεσθε

“you will be baptized”

You may wish to retain the metaphor of baptism in your translation. If you do, and If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you can say who will do the action. Alternate translation: [God will baptize]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:5 (#1)

Ἰωάννης

“John”

Jesus is referring to the man who was known as John the Baptist because he baptized people. It may help to identify him if you use that title after his name in your translation. However, because the word “Baptist” is associated with a group of churches in many parts of the world, it may be helpful to your readers to use a different form of the word as a title, as UST does by saying “Baptizer.” Alternate translation: [John the Baptist] or [John the Baptizer]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:6 (#1)

οἱ & οὖν συνελθόντες, ἠρώτων αὐτὸν

“They therefore having assembled, they were asking him”

In the first instance, **they** describes Jesus and the apostles, while in the second instance, **they** refers to the apostles. (Other disciples could have been present on this occasion, but the instructions that Jesus gives about being “witnesses” in 1:8 apply specifically to the apostles, so it would be good to name them directly.) Alternate translation: [When the apostles were together with Jesus, the apostles were asking him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 1:6 (#3)

εἰ & ἀποκαθιστάνεις τὴν βασιλείαν τῷ Ἰσραήλ

“if you are restoring the kingdom to Israel”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **kingdom**, you could express the same idea with a noun such as “king.” Alternate translation: [are you going to give Israel its own king again] or [are you going to become the restored king of Israel]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 1:6 (#2)

εἰ ἐν τῷ χρόνῳ τούτῳ, ἀποκαθιστάνεις τὴν βασιλείαν τῷ Ἰσραήλ

“if you are restoring the kingdom to Israel at this time”

This is an idiomatic way of asking a question. Alternate translation: [are you restoring the kingdom to Israel at this time] or [will you now restore the kingdom to Israel]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:7 (#2)

χρόνους ἢ καιροὺς

“the times or the seasons”

The words **times** and **seasons** could: (1) refer to different kinds of time. Alternate translation: [the general period of time or the specific date]; (2) have similar meanings, being used together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [the exact time]

See: Doublet

Acts 1:7 (#3)

ὁ Πατὴρ

“the Father”

Father is an important title for God. Alternate translation: [God the Father]

See: Translating Son and Father

Acts 1:7 (#1)

οὐχ ὑμῶν ἐστιν γνῶναι

"It is not for you to know"

Jesus is saying implicitly by this response that he is not going to tell the apostles when the thing they are asking about will happen. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that explicitly in your translation. Alternate translation: [I am not going to tell you when that will happen, because it is not for you to know]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:7 (#4)

ἐν τῇ ἰδίᾳ ἐξουσίᾳ

"by his own authority"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **authority**, you could express the same idea with a verb such as "control." Alternate translation: [as the one who controls all things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 1:8 (#2)

δύναμιν

"power"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **power**, you could express the same idea with an adjective such as "powerful." Alternate translation: [powerful ability]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 1:8 (#3)

ἕως ἐσχάτου τῆς γῆς

"to the end of the earth"

This is a reference to place, not to time. Jesus does not mean "until the world ends." Alternate translation: [all over the world] or [to the places on the earth that are farthest away from here]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:8 (#1)

λήμψεσθε δύναμιν, ἐπελθόντος τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος ἐφ' ὑμᾶς, καὶ ἔσεσθέ μου μάρτυρες

"you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you, and you will be my witnesses"

Jesus is using the word translated as **and** to describe a result. Alternate translation: [when the Holy Spirit comes upon you, then you will receive power to be my witnesses]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 1:9 (#3)

ἀπὸ τῶν ὀφθαλμῶν αὐτῶν

"from their eyes"

Luke is using the **eyes** of the apostles to mean their capacity to see. Alternate translation: [from their sight]

See: Metonymy

Acts 1:9 (#2)

ἐπήρθη

"he was raised up"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who did the action. (See the discussion of "Ascension" in the introduction to this chapter.) Alternate translation: [he rose up] or [God raised him up]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:9 (#1)

βλεπόντων αὐτῶν

"as they were looking"

Your language may require you to specify the object of **looking**. Alternate translation: [as they were looking at him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:10 (#2)

καὶ ἰδοὺ ἄνδρες δύο

"and behold, two men"

Luke is using the term **behold** to focus readers' attention on how suddenly these **two men** appeared. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [just then two men]

See: Metaphor

Acts 1:10 (#1)

ἀτενίζοντες ἦσαν εἰς τὸν οὐρανὸν

“they were looking intently into heaven”

Since a cloud was able to block the apostles’ view, it is clear that Luke is using the word translated as **heaven** here in one of its specific senses to mean “sky.” It would be good to make clear that the apostles were not seeing into heaven itself. Alternate translation: [gazing at the sky]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:10 (#4)

ἄνδρες δύο

“two men”

These were actually angels. Luke calls them **men** because they appeared in human form. Alternate translation: [two angels]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:10 (#3)

καὶ

“And”

Luke uses the word translated as **And** to indicate that the event of the men appearing happened after the event of Jesus going up. Alternate translation: [Then]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Acts 1:10 (#5)

ἐσθήσεσι λευκαῖς

“white clothes”

In this context, the word **white** likely has the specific sense of “bright” or “shining.” Alternate translation: [bright clothes] or [shining clothes]

Acts 1:11 (#2)

οἳ & εἶπαν

“they said”

If you retain the word **they** in your translation and if your language uses dual forms for verbs, it would be accurate to use the dual form here, since two men are speaking.

See: Verbs

Acts 1:11 (#6)

ὁ ἀναλημφθεὶς ἀφ’ ὑμῶν εἰς τὸν οὐρανὸν & ἐθεάσασθε αὐτὸν πορευόμενον εἰς τὸν οὐρανόν

“the one having been taken up from you into heaven & you saw him going into heaven”

In its second occurrence in this sentence, the term translated as **heaven** likely means “the sky,” as in the previous sentence and in the previous verse. However, in its first occurrence in this sentence, the term likely means “heaven” itself. It would not be accurate to say that Jesus was just “taken up from you into the sky.” Alternate translation: [who has been taken up from you into heaven … you saw him going into the sky]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:11 (#1)

οἳ & εἶπαν

“they said”

This could mean: (1) one of the angels had spoken on behalf of both of them. Alternate translation: [one of them said]; (2) the two angels had each said different parts of the quotation.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:11 (#7)

ὁ ἀναλημφθεὶς

“the one having been taken up”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who has done the action. Alternate translation: [whom God has taken up]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:11 (#5)

τί ἑστήκατε βλέποντες

“why do you stand looking”

The expression **stand** means to continue doing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [why do you keep looking] or [there is no reason for you to keep looking]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:11 (#4)

τί ἑστήκατε βλέποντες εἰς τὸν οὐρανόν

“why do you stand looking into heaven”

The angels are not looking for information. They are using the question form for emphasis. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate their words as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [there is no reason for you to stand looking into heaven!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 1:11 (#3)

ἄνδρες, Γαλιλαῖοι

"Men, Galileans"

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [You Galileans]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:11 (#8)

ὃν τρόπον

"the way"

Alternate translation: [in the same way in which]

Acts 1:12 (#2)

ὄρους τοῦ καλουμένου Ἐλαιῶνος

"the hill that is called Olivet"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the hill that people call Olivet] or [the hill whose name is Olivet]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:12 (#1)

ὑπέστρεψαν

"they returned"

The word **they** refers to the apostles. Alternate translation: [the apostles returned]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 1:12 (#3)

ὄρους τοῦ καλουμένου Ἐλαιῶνος

"the hill that is called Olivet"

Olivet is the name of a hill. If your readers might recognize it better if you called it the Mount of Olives, you could use that name in your translation, as UST does.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 1:12 (#5)

Σαββάτου ἔχον ὁδόν

"having a journey of a Sabbath"

The **journey of a Sabbath** was the distance that interpreters of the law of Moses had determined people could walk on the Sabbath without that being "work." If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express the distance in the measurement that your culture uses. Alternate translation: [about a kilometer away] or [about half a mile away]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 1:12 (#4)

Σαββάτου ἔχον ὁδόν

"having a journey of a Sabbath"

The expression **having a journey** refers to a distance. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a Sabbath-day's journey away]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:13 (#1)

ὅτε εἰσῆλθον

"when they arrived"

The previous verse explains that the apostles returned to Jerusalem. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that again explicitly here. Alternate translation: [when they arrived back in Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:13 (#5)

Σίμων ὁ Ζηλωτὴς

"Simon the Zealot"

Simon is the name of a man, and **Zealot** is another name by which he was known. (1) **Zealot** could be a title that indicates that this man was part of the group of people who wanted to free the Jewish people from Roman rule. Alternate translation: [Simon the Patriot]; (2) **Zealot** could also be a description that indicates that this man was zealous for God to be honored. Alternate translation: [Simon the Passionate One]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 1:13 (#3)

Ἰάκωβος Ἁλφαίου & Ἰούδας Ἰακώβου

"James of Alphaeus & Judas of James"

These are two occurrences of an idiom. Alternate translation: [James the son of Alphaeus ... Judas the son of James]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:13 (#4)

Ἰάκωβος Ἁλφαίου & Ἰούδας Ἰακώβου

"James of Alphaeus & Judas of James"

These are the names of four men. As the UST indicates, the man named **James** who was the father of **Judas** is not the same man as the James who is mentioned first in this verse, and he is also not the same man as James the son of Alphaeus.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 1:13 (#2)

εἰς τὸ ὑπερῷον, ἀνέβησαν οὗ ἦσαν καταμένοντες

"they went up into the upper chamber where they were staying"

In this culture, in some houses, rooms were built on top of other rooms. The expression **upper chamber** describes such a room, which was reached by stairs. If your culture does not have houses like that, it may be helpful to explain the meaning of the expression in your translation. Alternate translation: [they climbed the stairs to the room where they were staying, which had been built on top of other rooms in the house]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 1:14 (#2)

γυναιξὶν

"the women"

Luke assumes that his readers will know he is referring to the women who accompanied Jesus and his disciples during his ministry. These women provided for them out of their own means, and they had traveled with them to Jerusalem. These women are described in Luke 8:2–3 and 23:49. Alternate translation: [the women who had helped Jesus and his disciples during his ministry]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:14 (#1)

ὁμοθυμαδὸν

"unanimously"

The word **unanimously** indicates that the apostles and other believers shared a common commitment and purpose and that there was no strife among them. Alternate translation: [with one accord] or [harmoniously]

Acts 1:14 (#3)

τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς αὐτοῦ

"his brothers"

These were Jesus' younger brothers. They were the sons of Mary and Joseph. Since the Father of Jesus was God, and their father was Joseph, they were actually his half-brothers. That detail is not normally translated, but if your language has a specific word for "younger brother," you may wish to use it here.

See: Kinship

Acts 1:15 (#1)

καὶ ἐν ταῖς ἡμέραις ταύταις

"And in those days"

Luke uses this phrase to introduce a new event in the story. The phrase refers to the period of time after Jesus ascended, when the disciples were meeting in the upper chamber. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 1:15 (#7)

ὄχλος ὀνομάτων

"the multitude of names"

Luke is using the term **names** to mean "people," by association with the way that people have names. Alternate translation: [the number of people]

See: Metonymy

Acts 1:15 (#6)

ἦν τε ὄχλος ὀνομάτων ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτὸ ὡς ἑκατὸν εἴκοσι

"and the multitude of names to the same was about 120"

Luke provides this background information to help readers appreciate what happens shortly afterwards in the story, when the church grows in one day to many times this size. It may be helpful to put this background information first in the verse as a separate sentence, in which case it would not have to be in parentheses. Alternate translation: [Now the number of people in that one place was about 120.]

See: Background Information

Acts 1:15 (#5)

τῶν ἀδελφῶν

“of the brothers”

Although the term **brothers** is masculine, Luke is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. As the General Introduction to Acts suggests, here and throughout the book, if you retain this figurative usage in your translation, you could state “brothers and sisters” to indicate that it has this generic sense.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 1:15 (#4)

τῶν ἀδελφῶν

“of the brothers”

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. Alternate translation: [his fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 1:15 (#2)

ἐν ταῖς ἡμέραις ταύταις

“in those days”

Luke is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time. Alternate translation: [during that time]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:15 (#3)

ἀναστὰς

“having stood up”

Peter **stood up** to indicate that he had something important to say. Alternate translation: [having stood up to show that he had something important to say]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 1:15 (#8)

ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτὸ

“to the same”

See the discussion of this phrase in Part 3 of the Introduction to Acts. Alternate translation: [in that one place] or [in their Christian fellowship]

Acts 1:16 (#3)

ἔδει πληρωθῆναι τὴν Γραφὴν, ἣν προεῖπε τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον διὰ στόματος Δαυεὶδ περὶ Ἰούδα, τοῦ γενομένου ὁδηγοῦ τοῖς συλλαβοῦσιν Ἰησοῦν

“it was necessary for the scripture to be fulfilled that the Holy Spirit spoke before by the mouth of David concerning Judas, the one having become a guide to the ones arresting Jesus”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could put the information that Peter provides to identify this **scripture** before his statement that it had to be **fulfilled**. It may be helpful to make that statement a separate sentence. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit spoke before by the mouth of David concerning Judas, who became a guide to the ones who arrested Jesus. It was necessary for that scripture to be fulfilled]

See: Information Structure

Acts 1:16 (#5)

προεῖπε

“spoke before”

Alternate translation: [spoke beforehand] or [spoke in advance]

Acts 1:16 (#7)

τοῦ γενομένου ὁδηγοῦ τοῖς συλλαβοῦσιν Ἰησοῦν

“the one having become a guide to the ones arresting Jesus”

Peter is using the act of guiding **the ones arresting Jesus** to represent all of the things that Judas did to betray Jesus. This also included meeting beforehand with his enemies, receiving payment for the betrayal, and looking for the best opportunity to catch Jesus away from the crowds. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in more general terms. Alternate translation: [who betrayed Jesus to his enemies]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 1:16 (#2)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

“Men, brothers”

See how you translated the term **brothers** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [My fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 1:16 (#6)

διὰ στόματος Δαυεὶδ

“by the mouth of David”

Peter is using the word **mouth** to refer to words that David spoke or sang using his mouth and that he recorded in the book of Psalms, as Peter indicates in 1:20. Alternate translation: [through the words of David]

See: Metonymy

Acts 1:16 (#4)

ἔδει πληρωθῆναι τὴν Γραφὴν

“it was necessary for the scripture to be fulfilled”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the things needed to take place that the scripture described] or, if you put the background information first as a separate sentence, [What that scripture described needed to take place]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:16 (#1)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

“Men, brothers”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [My brothers]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:17 (#6)

τὸν κλῆρον τῆς διακονίας ταύτης

“a share of this ministry”

Luke temporarily ends his quotation from Peter after this phrase so that he can provide further background information about Judas in 1:18–19. The quotation resumes in 1:20. If you are identifying quotations in your translation by putting them within quotation marks or by using some other punctuation or convention that your language uses, there should be an ending quotation mark or the equivalent after this phrase.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 1:17 (#5)

ἐν ἡμῖν

“with us”

Although Peter is addressing a larger group of people, he is using the word **us** to refer only to himself and the other apostles. So if your language distinguishes between exclusive and inclusive “us,” it would be accurate to use the exclusive form here. Other languages may have other ways of indicating that **us** is exclusive here. Alternate translation: [with us apostles]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 1:17 (#3)

κατηριθμημένος ἦν ἐν ἡμῖν

“he was numbered with us”

Peter is using the term **numbered** in one of its specific senses. Alternate translation: [he was considered to be one of us apostles]

Acts 1:17 (#1)

ὅτι

“For”

Peter uses the word **For** to introduce the reason for a result that is described in 1:21–22, after Luke provides further background information and Peter quotes the scripture he referred to in 1:16. The overall meaning is, “Since Judas was one of us apostles, we need to replace him with another witness of the ministry of Jesus.” But since so much material comes between the reason and the result, it may be helpful to give an indication here that Peter has a response in mind. Alternate translation: [There is something important we need to do in response to this scripture being fulfilled, since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 1:17 (#2)

κατηριθμημένος ἦν ἐν ἡμῖν, καὶ ἔλαχεν τὸν κλῆρον τῆς διακονίας ταύτης

“he was numbered with us and received a share of this ministry”

These two phrases mean similar things. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [Jesus chose him to be an apostle along with us]

See: Parallelism

Acts 1:17 (#4)

κατηριθμημένος ἦν ἐν ἡμῖν

“he was numbered with us”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [he belonged to our group of apostles]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:18 (#6)

πρηνὴς γενόμενος

“having become prostrate”

The word **headfirst** describes someone falling forward, as opposed to falling backwards. Alternate translation: [having fallen forward]

Acts 1:18 (#1)

μὲν οὖν

“Now indeed”

Luke is using this expression to introduce further background information that he provides in this verse and the next one about how Judas died and about what people called the field where he died. This is not part of Peter’s speech. You may want to indicate that by putting these verses in parentheses or by using the equivalent convention in your language.

See: Background Information

Acts 1:18 (#2)

οὗτος

“this one”

Luke is using the demonstrative adjective **this** as a noun to refer to a specific person, Judas. (ULT shows that by adding **one**.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could state “he” or use the name “Judas.”

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 1:18 (#5)

πρηνὴς γενόμενος

“having become prostrate”

Luke does not say how Judas became prostrate, that is, how his body landed face-down on the field. It is clear, however, that Judas did not just trip and fall accidentally. Rather, it seems that his body forcefully hit the field as he was killing himself. Alternate translation: [in his attempt to kill himself his body struck that field]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 1:18 (#4)

ἐκ μισθοῦ τῆς ἀδικίας

“from the wage of unrighteousness”

Luke is using the term **unrighteousness** to describe Judas betraying Jesus, by association with the way that was an unrighteous thing to do. Alternate translation: [with the money that he received for betraying Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 1:18 (#3)

ἐκ μισθοῦ τῆς ἀδικίας

“from the wage of unrighteousness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **unrighteousness**, you could express the same idea with an adjective such as “unrighteous.” Alternate translation: [with the money that he received for doing an unrighteous deed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 1:18 (#7)

ἐξεχύθη πάντα τὰ σπλάγχνα αὐτοῦ

“all his entrails were poured out”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [all his inward parts poured out]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:19 (#2)

γνωστὸν ἐγένετο πᾶσι τοῖς κατοικοῦσιν Ἰερουσαλήμ

“it became known to all those living in Jerusalem”

Luke says **all** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [it became well known to those living in Jerusalem]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 1:19 (#4)

Ἀκελδαμάχ

“Akeldama”

Akeldama is an Aramaic word. Luke spells it out using Greek letters so his readers will know how it sounds, and then he says what it means, **Field of Blood**. In your translation you can spell it the way it sounds in your language and then explain its meaning.

See: Copy or Borrow Words

Acts 1:19 (#3)

ὥστε κληθῆναι τὸ χωρίον ἐκεῖνο

“Therefore that field was called”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [So they called that field]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:19 (#1)

γνωστὸν ἐγένετο πᾶσι τοῖς κατοικοῦσιν Ἰερουσαλήμ

“it became known to all those living in Jerusalem”

The verb form is not passive here, since **known** is an adjective rather than a participle. Even so, it may be helpful to your readers to make **it** the object rather than the subject. Alternate translation: [all those living in Jerusalem heard about it]

Acts 1:20 (#7)

γενηθήτω ἡ ἔπαυλις αὐτοῦ ἔρημος, καὶ μὴ ἔστω ὁ κατοικῶν ἐν αὐτῇ

“Let his habitation become desolate, and let not one dwelling be in it”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if the repetition might be confusing, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Or you could combine the phrases if you think that would be the clearest thing to do. Alternate translation: [Let his habitation be made desolate, yes, let no one dwell in it] or [Let his habitation be made completely desolate]

See: Parallelism

Acts 1:20 (#9)

τὴν ἐπισκοπὴν αὐτοῦ, λαβέτω ἕτερος

“Let another take his overseership”

The word **overseership** refers to a position of leadership and supervision. It is the same term that Paul uses for a spiritual leader in 1 Timothy 3:1. Alternate translation: [Let someone else take his leadership position]

Acts 1:20 (#10)

τὴν ἐπισκοπὴν αὐτοῦ, λαβέτω ἕτερος

“Let another take his overseership”

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [May another take his overseership] or [Another should take his overseership]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 1:20 (#12)

τὴν ἐπισκοπὴν αὐτοῦ, λαβέτω ἕτερος

“Let another take his overseership”

It may be more natural in your language to use the second person for this imperative. Alternate translation: [God, make another take his overseership] or [God, please give his overseership to another]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 1:20 (#1)

γέγραπται γὰρ

“For it is written”

Luke now resumes his quotation of what Peter said on this occasion. If you are identifying quotations in your translation by putting them within quotation marks or by using some other punctuation or convention that your language uses, there should be an opening quotation mark or the equivalent before this phrase. It may also be helpful to indicate explicitly that the quotation resumes here. Alternate translation: [Peter went on to say, “For it is written]

See: Quote Markings

Acts 1:20 (#11)

τὴν ἐπισκοπὴν αὐτοῦ, λαβέτω ἕτερος

“Let another take his overseership”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a request rather than a command. The psalmist is continuing God to judge and punish the wicked. Use a form in your language that communicates a request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please let another take his overseership] or [Please may another take his overseership]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 1:20 (#8)

γενηθήτω ἡ ἔπαυλις αὐτοῦ ἔρημος, καὶ μὴ ἔστω ὁ κατοικῶν ἐν αὐτῇ

"Let his habitation become desolate, and let not one dwelling be in it"

The word **habitation** likely refers to Judas' home and is a metaphor for his family line. Alternate translation: [May he leave no descendants, none to continue his family line]

See: Metaphor

Acts 1:20 (#3)

γέγραπται & ἐν βίβλῳ Ψαλμῶν

"it is written in the book of Psalms"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who did the action. Alternate translation: [David wrote in the book of Psalms]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:20 (#2)

γέγραπται & ἐν βίβλῳ Ψαλμῶν, γενηθήτω ἡ ἔπαυλις αὐτοῦ ἔρημος, καὶ μὴ ἔστω ὁ κατοικῶν ἐν αὐτῇ; καί, τὴν ἐπισκοπὴν αὐτοῦ, λαβέτω ἕτερος

"it is written in the book of Psalms, 'Let his habitation become desolate, and let not one dwelling be in it,' and 'Let another take his overseership"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [it is written in the book of Psalms that his habitation should be made desolate, with no one dwelling in it, and that another should take his overseership]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 1:20 (#5)

γενηθήτω ἡ ἔπαυλις αὐτοῦ ἔρημος, καὶ μὴ ἔστω ὁ κατοικῶν ἐν αὐτῇ

"Let his habitation become desolate, and let not one dwelling be in it"

This is an imperative, but it communicates a request rather than a command. The psalmist is asking God to judge and punish the wicked. Use a form in your language that communicates a request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please let his habitation become desolate, and please let no one be dwelling in it] or [Please may his habitation become desolate, and please may no one be dwelling in it]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 1:20 (#6)

γενηθήτω ἡ ἔπαυλις αὐτοῦ ἔρημος, καὶ μὴ ἔστω ὁ κατοικῶν ἐν αὐτῇ

"Let his habitation become desolate, and let not one dwelling be in it"

It may be more natural in your language to use the second person for this imperative. Alternate translation: [God, please make his habitation desolate, and please make no one dwell in it]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 1:20 (#4)

γενηθήτω ἡ ἔπαυλις αὐτοῦ ἔρημος, καὶ μὴ ἔστω ὁ κατοικῶν ἐν αὐτῇ

"Let his habitation become desolate, and let not one dwelling be in it"

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [May his habitation become desolate, and may no one be dwelling in it] or [His habitation should become desolate, and no one should be dwelling be in it]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 1:21 (#1)

To help your readers understand Peter's main point in this verse and the next one, you could combine both verses into a verse bridge. You could put his main point in a first sentence and his further explanation in a second sentence. Alternate translation: [Therefore it is necessary for someone else to become a witness with us of Jesus' resurrection. It should be one of the men who accompanied us during all the time that the Lord Jesus came in and went out among us, beginning from the baptism of John until the day that he was taken up from us.]

See: Verse Bridges

Acts 1:21 (#3)

εἰσῆλθεν καὶ ἐξῆλθεν ἐφ' ἡμᾶς ὁ Κύριος Ἰησοῦς

"the Lord Jesus came in and went out among us"

Peter is speaking in an idiomatic way. Alternate translation: [the Lord Jesus lived among us]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:21 (#2)

ἡμῖν & ἡμᾶς

“us & us”

In the first instance of **us**, Peter means himself and his fellow apostles, not everyone to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of the word if your language marks that distinction. However, in the second instance of **us**, Peter could well mean himself and his entire audience, so use the inclusive form in that instance.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 1:22 (#7)

τῆς ἀναστάσεως αὐτοῦ

“of his resurrection”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **resurrection**, you could express the same idea with an adjective such as “alive.” Alternate translation: [that God made him alive again after he died]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 1:22 (#4)

ἀνελήμφθη ἀφ’ ἡμῶν

“he was taken up from us”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [God took him up from us]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:22 (#5)

ἀφ’ ἡμῶν & σὺν ἡμῖν

“from us & with us”

When Peter says **from us**, he is referring to God taking Jesus from everyone to whom he is speaking. But when Peter says **with us**, he means only himself and the other apostles. So the word “us” would be inclusive in the first instance and exclusive in the second instance, if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 1:22 (#3)

ἀνελήμφθη & τῆς ἀναστάσεως αὐτοῦ

“he was taken up & of his resurrection”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jesus, not to John the Baptist. The pronoun **his** also refers to Jesus. For clarity, you may want to use the name Jesus instead of one or both of these pronouns. Alternate translation: [Jesus was taken up ... the resurrection of Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 1:22 (#1)

ἀρξάμενος ἀπὸ τοῦ βαπτίσματος Ἰωάννου

“beginning from the baptism of John”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **baptism**, you could express the same idea with a verb such as “baptize.” Alternate translation: [beginning from when John started baptizing people]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 1:22 (#2)

τῆς ἡμέρας ἧς

“the day on which”

While Jesus was taken up to heaven on a specific **day**, Peter may be using the word **day** to mean a specific time. Alternate translation: [the time when]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:22 (#6)

ἕνα τούτων

“one of these”

Peter is using the demonstrative adjective **these** as a noun to refer to specific people, the men whose qualifications he has just described. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could add the term “men” to clarify the meaning. Alternate translation: [one of these men is]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 1:23 (#3)

ἔστησαν δύο

“they stood up two”

When the believers **stood up** these two men, that is, when they had them stand up within the group, this was a symbolic way of proposing them as candidates to replace Judas. Alternate translation: [the believers proposed two men who met the qualifications that Peter described]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 1:23 (#4)

Ἰωσὴφ & Βαρσαββᾶν & Ἰοῦστος

“Joseph & Barsabbas & Justus”

Joseph is the name of a man, and **Barsabbas** and **Justus** are two other names by which he was known. **Barsabbas** is probably a patronymic, that is, an indication of who his father was. If your language and culture identify people by patronymics, it may be helpful to translate this name as “the son of Sabbas,” as UST does. **Justus** is a Roman name, and it may be a name that this man used for official purposes and in interactions with people who spoke Latin. (It would be like the name Paul, by which Saul of Tarsus was also known in the Roman Empire.)

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 1:23 (#6)

Μαθθίαν

“Matthias”

Matthias is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 1:23 (#5)

τὸν καλούμενον Βαρσαββᾶν, ὃς ἐπεκλήθη Ἰοῦστος

“called Barsabbas, who was named Justus”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state both of these things with active forms. Alternate translation: [whom people called Barsabbas and whose other name was Justus]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 1:23 (#2)

ἔστησαν δύο

“they stood up two”

Luke is using the adjective **two** as a noun to refer to specific people, two men who met the qualifications Peter described. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could add the term “men” to clarify the meaning, and you could also describe these men more specifically. Alternate translation: [the believers stood up two men] or [the believers stood up two men who met the qualifications that Peter described]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 1:23 (#1)

ἔστησαν δύο

“they stood up two”

The pronoun **they** refers to all of the believers who were present on this occasion. This is the group that Luke describes as “the brothers” in 1:15. Alternate translation: [the believers stood up two]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 1:24 (#1)

Judas betrayed Jesus and abandoned his position as an apostle. The person who is praying says that in the next verse. As a result, the believers are asking God to show them whom he has chosen to replace Judas, as the person praying says in this verse. You could put the reason before the result by creating a verse bridge. UST provides a model for doing that.

See: Verse Bridges

Acts 1:24 (#6)

σὺ Κύριε

“You, Lord”

The word **you** is singular because the person who is praying is addressing God. If your language has a formal form of “you” that it uses to address a superior respectfully, you may wish to use that form in your translation. However, it might be more natural in your language for someone who has a good, close relationship with God to address God using the informal form of “you.” Use your best judgment about what form to use here.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Formal or Informal

Acts 1:24 (#7)

ὃν ἐξελέξω ἐκ τούτων τῶν δύο ἕνα

“which one from these two you have chosen”

The person who is praying is using the adjective **two** as a noun to refer to specific people, the two men whom the believers have proposed. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could add the term “men” to clarify the meaning. Alternate translation: [which one of these two men]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 1:24 (#4)

σὺ Κύριε, καρδιογνῶστα πάντων

“You, Lord, heart-knower of all”

Alternate translation: [You, Lord, who know the hearts of all people]

Acts 1:24 (#5)

σὺ Κύριε, καρδιογνῶστα πάντων

"You, Lord, heart-knower of all"

Here, the **heart** represents the thoughts and motives. Alternate translation: [You, Lord, who know the thoughts and motives of all people]

See: Metaphor

Acts 1:24 (#3)

προσευξάμενοι, εἶπαν

"praying, they said"

The pronoun **they** refers to all of the believers, but one of the apostles alone probably spoke these words on behalf of everyone. Alternate translation: [as the believers were all praying together, one of the apostles said]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 1:24 (#2)

προσευξάμενοι, εἶπαν

"praying, they said"

Together the words **praying** and **said** indicate that the believers said what they did while praying. Alternate translation: [they said in prayer] or [they prayed]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 1:25 (#3)

πορευθῆναι εἰς τὸν τόπον τὸν ἴδιον

"to go to his own place"

This phrase uses a mild expression to describe Judas' death and likely also his judgment after death. Alternate translation: [and died under God's judgment as a result]

See: Euphemism

Acts 1:25 (#1)

λαβεῖν τὸν τόπον τῆς διακονίας ταύτης καὶ ἀποστολῆς

"to take this place of ministry and apostleship"

The person who is praying is expressing a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **apostleship** identifies what kind of **ministry** this is. Alternate translation: [to take this place of apostolic ministry]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 1:25 (#2)

ἀφ' ἧς παρέβη Ἰούδας

"from which Judas turned aside"

The expression **turned aside** means that Judas stopped performing this ministry. Alternate translation: [which Judas stopped fulfilling]

See: Metaphor

Acts 1:26 (#3)

ἔδωκαν κλήρους αὐτοῖς

"they cast lots for them"

The term **lots** describes objects with various markings on different sides that were used, most likely by dropping them on the ground, to select between possibilities. The belief was that God would control which way these objects fell and so guide the selection process. Alternate translation: [they threw marked objects on the ground, trusting that God would use these to guide them whether to choose Joseph or Matthias]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 1:26 (#2)

ἔδωκαν κλήρους αὐτοῖς

"they cast lots for them"

The pronoun **they** refers to the believers and the pronoun **them** refers to Joseph and Matthias. You may want to specify that for clarity. (But if you decide to retain the pronoun **them** and if your language marks the dual form, **them** would be dual because it refers to those two men.) Alternate translation: [the believers cast lots to decide between Joseph and Matthias]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 1:26 (#4)

ἔπεσεν ὁ κλῆρος ἐπὶ Μαθθίαν

"the lot fell to Matthias"

The word **fell** means "selected." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the lot selected Matthias]

See: Idiom

Acts 1:26 (#1)

καὶ

"And"

Luke uses the word translated as **And** to introduce what the believers did as a result of Peter's speech. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 1:26 (#5)

συνκατεψηφίσθη

"he was chosen together"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [the believers chose him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Some translations set lines of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry that is quoted from the Old Testament in 2:17–21, 2:25–28, and 2:34–35.

Some translations set quotations from the Old Testament farther to the right on the page than the rest of the text. The ULT does this with the material that is quoted in 2:31.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Pentecost

The events described in this chapter took place on the day of Pentecost. That was a festival that the Jews observed each year 50 days after Passover. It was a harvest festival that celebrated the first produce from the fields. That produce was known as "firstfruits." Many people believe that the church began to exist when the Holy Spirit came to live inside believers on this particular day of Pentecost. Those believers were the "firstfruits" of all those who would become part of the church down through the years.

Tongues

Luke uses the Greek word "tongues" to mean two different things in this chapter. In 2:3, Luke describes what came down from heaven as "tongues as if of fire." A "tongue of fire" means a "flame of fire" (as in Isaiah 5:24, for example), so this means "something like flames of fire." In 2:4, Luke uses the word "tongues" in the different sense of "languages" to describe the languages that the people spoke after the Holy Spirit filled them. For clarity, ULT translates the use in 2:3 as "tongues" and the use in 2:4 as "languages."

Last days

In 2:17–21, Peter quotes a prophecy from Joel that describes something that will happen in the "last days." Some scholars understand the "last days" to mean a time in the future just before Jesus returns. Other scholars understand the "last days" to mean the entire time from when Jesus first came to when he will return. Translators should be careful not to let how they understand this issue affect how they translate this expression where it occurs in 2:17. It may be best not to say more about this than ULT does. (See: last day, last days, latter days)

The prophecy of Joel

In 2:17–21, Peter quotes a prophecy of Joel about what would happen in the "last days." Some of the things that prophecy describes did happen on the day of Pentecost, for example, the pouring out of the Spirit (2:17–18). Some other things did not happen, at least not literally, for example, the sun turning to darkness (2:20). Depending on how scholars understand the "last days," they may say either that these other things await a literal future fulfillment or that they were fulfilled in some spiritual sense on the day of Pentecost. Once again it may be best not to say any more than ULT does and to allow preachers and teachers of the Bible to interpret and explain the meaning of Peter's statement in 2:16, "this is what was spoken through the prophet Joel." (See: prophet, prophecy, prophesy, seer, prophetess)

Baptize

In this chapter, the word "baptize" refers to water baptism as an expression of faith in Jesus for the forgiveness of sins. That is how Luke uses the term in 2:38 and 2:41. Jesus did promise the disciples in 1:5 that they would be baptized in the Holy Spirit, and the events that Luke describes in 2:1–11 are the fulfillment of that promise. But Luke does not use the word "baptize" to describe those events in this chapter. (See: baptize, baptized, baptism)

Wonders and signs

These words refer to things that only God could do that showed that Jesus was who the disciples said he was. See the notes to this expression in 2:43.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"You killed" (2:23)

The Romans were the ones who killed Jesus, but they killed him because the Jews captured him, brought him to the Romans, and urged the Romans to kill him.

For this reason Peter tells the people in the crowd on the day of Pentecost that they were guilty of killing Jesus. See the note to this phrase in 2:23 for suggestions about how to make clear in your translation what Peter means when he says this.

Long sentences
There is a long sentence that goes from the beginning of 2:9 to the end of 2:11. ULT represents all of it as a single sentence. It may be helpful to your readers to divide it into several sentences, as UST does.

There is also a long sentence that goes from the beginning of 2:44 to the end of 2:47. Once again it may be helpful to your readers to divide it into several sentences, as UST does.

Poetry
The quotations from the Old Testament in 2:17–21, 2:25–28, and 2:34–35 are poetry. For advice about how to represent this literary form in your translation, see: Poetry.

Acts 2:1 (#1)

καὶ ἐν τῷ συνπληροῦσθαι τὴν ἡμέραν τῆς Πεντηκοστῆς

"And when the day of Pentecost was completely filled"

Luke uses this time reference to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 2:1 (#3)

ἐν τῷ συνπληροῦσθαι τὴν ἡμέραν τῆς Πεντηκοστῆς

"when the day of Pentecost was completely filled"

Since this is an idiom, it would probably not be meaningful in most languages to use an active form of the verb "fill" in place of the passive form of that verb here. However, if your language does speak of someone or something "filling" days or times so that they arrive, but your language does not use passive verbal forms, you could use an active form of "fill" here.

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:1 (#5)

ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτό

"to the same"

See the discussion of this phrase in Part 3 of the Introduction to Acts. Alternate translation: [in the same place] or [in united Christian fellowship]

Acts 2:1 (#2)

ἐν τῷ συνπληροῦσθαι τὴν ἡμέραν τῆς Πεντηκοστῆς

"when the day of Pentecost was completely filled"

This is an idiomatic way of speaking about time. Alternate translation: [when the day of Pentecost had come] or, if your language does not speak of days "coming", [on the day of Pentecost]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:1 (#4)

ἦσαν πάντες ὁμοῦ

"they were all together"

Here the word **they** refers to the apostles and the other 120 believers whom Luke mentions in 1:15. Alternate translation: [the apostles and all the other believers were together]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 2:2 (#1)

ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ

"from heaven"

The word translated as **heaven** could mean: (1) "the sky." Alternate translation: [from the sky]; (2) the sound came from **heaven** itself.

Acts 2:2 (#6)

οὗ ἦσαν καθήμενοι

"where they were sitting"

Luke may be using the term **sitting** to mean "meeting." Alternate translation: [in which they were meeting]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:2 (#4)

ἐπλήρωσεν ὅλον τὸν οἶκον

"it filled the whole house"

Luke speaks of this sound as if it **filled** the **house**. Alternate translation: [it could be heard throughout the house]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:2 (#2)

ὥσπερ φερομένης πνοῆς βιαίας

“as of a strong wind being borne along”

Luke is using a simile to describe what this wind was like. You could use the same simile in your translation, or you could use a different comparison, to a similar loud sound that your readers would recognize. It may be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [It sounded like a strong wind being borne along]

See: Simile

Acts 2:2 (#3)

φερομένης πνοῆς βιαίας

“a strong wind being borne along”

Luke speaks of the wind as if it were being carried through the air. Alternate translation: [a mighty, rushing wind]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:2 (#5)

ὅλον τὸν οἶκον

“the whole house”

Luke may be using the word translated as **house** in one of its specific senses to mean a building. So this could have been either a private home or a larger building. Alternate translation: [the entire building]

Acts 2:3 (#1)

γλῶσσαι ὡσεὶ πυρός

“tongues as if of fire”

This phrase means “something like tongues of fire,” and a “tongue of fire” means a “flame of fire.” (The expression is used with that meaning in Isaiah 5:24, for example.) This is not a simile. Luke is describing what these objects looked like. Alternate translation: [objects that looked like flames of fire]

Acts 2:3 (#4)

ἐκάθισεν ἐφ’ ἕνα ἕκαστον αὐτῶν

“they sat upon each one of them”

Luke is using the word **sat** to indicate that the objects remained in one place once they had spread around. Alternate translation: [one of the objects remained on each one of the disciples]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:3 (#2)

διαμεριζόμεναι

“distributing themselves”

This means that the objects that looked like flames of fire spread out so that there was one on each person. Alternate translation: [spreading around]

Acts 2:3 (#3)

ἐκάθισεν ἐφ’ ἕνα ἕκαστον αὐτῶν

“they sat upon each one of them”

The pronoun **they** refers to the objects, and the pronoun **them** refers to the disciples. Alternate translation: [one of the objects sat upon each one of the disciples]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 2:4 (#3)

ἤρξαντο λαλεῖν ἑτέραις γλώσσαις

“they began to speak in other languages”

Luke is using the word **began** to indicate that the disciples had been doing something else (speaking in their own languages) but then began to do something new when the Holy Spirit filled them. It might not be necessary to translate the word **began**, since it may seem to convey redundant information that would be not be natural to express in your language. Alternate translation: [they spoke in other languages]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 2:4 (#4)

ἤρξαντο λαλεῖν ἑτέραις γλώσσαις

“they began to speak in other languages”

The implication, as 2:6–11 makes clear, is that the disciples were speaking languages that they did not know. Alternate translation: [they began to speak in languages that they did not know]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:4 (#2)

ἐπλήσθησαν πάντες Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

“they were all filled with the Holy Spirit”

Luke is speaking as if the believers were containers that the Holy Spirit **filled**. Alternate translation: [they were all inspired by the Holy Spirit] or [the Holy Spirit inspired them all]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:4 (#1)

ἐπλήσθησαν πάντες Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

“they were all filled with the Holy Spirit”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit filled them all]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:4 (#6)

καθὼς τὸ Πνεῦμα ἐδίδου ἀποφθέγγεσθαι αὐτοῖς

“as the Spirit was giving them to speak out”

The word translated as **to speak out** means to speak clearly and articulately. To express this meaning, it may be helpful to make this a separate sentence. Alternate translation: [The Spirit was enabling them to speak these languages clearly and articulately]

Acts 2:4 (#5)

καθὼς τὸ Πνεῦμα ἐδίδου ἀποφθέγγεσθαι αὐτοῖς

“as the Spirit was giving them to speak out”

Here, **giving** has the sense of enabling. Alternate translation: [as the Spirit was enabling them to speak out]

Acts 2:5 (#3)

παντὸς ἔθνους

“every nation”

The word **every** is a generalization that emphasizes that the people came from many different nations. Alternate translation: [many different nations]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 2:5 (#4)

ὑπὸ τὸν οὐρανόν

“under heaven”

The expression **under heaven** is a way of referring to being on earth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on earth]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:5 (#2)

ἄνδρες εὐλαβεῖς

“godly men”

Luke is using the term **men** in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [godly people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 2:5 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Luke uses the word **Now** to introduce background information that will help readers understand what happens next. You can translate it with a word or phrase that serves the same purpose in your language.

See: Connect — Background Information

Acts 2:6 (#1)

συνεχύθη

“was confused”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state what did the action. Alternate translation: [what they heard confused them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:6 (#2)

ἤκουον εἷς ἕκαστος τῇ ἰδίᾳ διαλέκτῳ λαλούντων αὐτῶν

“each one was hearing them speaking in his own language”

The pronoun **them** refers to the believers and the pronoun **his** refers to each person in the multitude. Alternate translation: [each person in the multitude could hear one of the disciples speaking in that person’s own language]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 2:7 (#2)

ἐξίσταντο & πάντες καὶ ἐθαύμαζον

“they were all amazed and were marveling”

The expression **were ... amazed** is not a passive verbal form. However, if your language does not use passive forms, it might be helpful to your readers to use an expression that does not seem to be a passive verbal form. Alternate translation: [this amazed all of them and they were marveling]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:7 (#3)

ἰδοὺ

“Behold”

Behold is an expression that speakers use to focus the attention of their listeners on what they are about to say. Though it literally means “look” or “see,” the term can be used to get people to pay attention. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use here in your translation. Alternate translation: [In fact]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:7 (#1)

ἐξίσταντο & καὶ ἐθαύμαζον

“they were & amazed and were marveling”

The terms **amazed** and **marveling** mean similar things. Luke may be using the two terms together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [they were ... greatly amazed]

See: Doublet

Acts 2:7 (#4)

οὐχ & ἅπαντες οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ λαλοῦντες Γαλιλαῖοι

“are not all these who are speaking Galileans”

The speakers are not looking for information. They are using the question form to express their amazement. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate their words as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [all of these people who are speaking are Galileans!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 2:8 (#6)

ἐν ᾗ ἐγεννήθημεν

“in which we were born”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. However, since this is a metaphor, it would be preferable to use another expression to explain its meaning, rather than to say something like “in which our mothers gave birth to us.” Alternate translation: [that we learned from birth]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:8 (#5)

ἐν ᾗ ἐγεννήθημεν

“in which we were born”

The speakers say that they **were born** in these languages to mean that they learned them from birth. Alternate translation: [that we learned from birth]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:8 (#3)

πῶς ἡμεῖς ἀκούομεν ἕκαστος

“how are we hearing, each”

Your language may require you to specify the object of **hearing**. Alternate translation: [how are we each hearing them speak]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:8 (#2)

καὶ

“And”

The speakers are using the word translated as **And** to introduce the results of what the previous sentence described. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 2:8 (#4)

ἡμεῖς & ἡμῶν

“we & our”

The speakers are using the words **we** and **our** to refer to themselves and to their listeners, so use the inclusive forms of those words if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 2:8 (#1)

καὶ πῶς ἡμεῖς ἀκούομεν ἕκαστος τῇ ἰδίᾳ διαλέκτῳ ἡμῶν, ἐν ᾗ ἐγεννήθημεν

“And how are we hearing, each in our own language in which we were born”

The speakers do not expect someone to be able to answer this question for them. Rather, they are using the question form to express their amazement. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate their words as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So we should not each be hearing them speak in our own languages in which we were born!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 2:9 (#1)

Πάρθοι & Μῆδοι & Ἐλαμεῖται

“Parthians & Medes & Elamites”

These are names of three people groups.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 2:9 (#2)

τὴν Μεσοποταμίαν, Ἰουδαίαν & Καππαδοκίαν, Πόντον & τὴν Ἀσίαν

“Mesopotamia, Judea & Cappadocia, Pontus & Asia”

These are names of five areas.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 2:10 (#1)

Φρυγίαν & Παμφυλίαν, Αἴγυπτον & τῆς Λιβύης

“Phrygia & Pamphylia, Egypt & of Libya”

These are names of four areas.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 2:11 (#2)

Κρῆτες & Ἄραβες

“Cretans & Arabians”

These are names of two people groups.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 2:11 (#1)

Ἰουδαῖοί τε καὶ προσήλυτοι

“both Jews and proselytes”

The term **proselytes** describes converts to the Jewish religion. The phrase **both Jews and proselytes** could apply specifically to the visitors from Rome mentioned at the end of the previous verse, or it could apply to the whole list of people in 2:9–11. Alternate translation: [both Jews and converts to the Jewish religion]

Acts 2:11 (#3)

τὰ μεγαλεῖα τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the great things of God”

The speakers are using the adjective **great** as a noun. (The term is plural; ULT adds **things** to show this.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the great things that God has done]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 2:12 (#2)

ἐξίσταντο & πάντες καὶ διηποροῦντο & λέγοντες

“they were all amazed and were perplexed, saying”

These are not passive verbal forms. However, if your language does not use passive forms, it might be helpful to your readers to use an expression that does not seem to be a passive verbal form. Alternate translation: [this amazed and perplexed all of them, and they said]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:12 (#1)

ἐξίσταντο & πάντες καὶ διηποροῦντο

“they were all amazed and were perplexed”

The words **amazed** and **perplexed** mean similar things. Luke is using them together to emphasize that the people could not understand what was happening. Alternate translation: [they were very perplexed]

See: Doublet

Acts 2:12 (#3)

τί θέλει τοῦτο εἶναι

“What does this want to be”

The expression **want to be** is a way of referring to what something means. Your language may have a similar expression that you could use in your translation. Or, if it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What does this mean?] or [What is the explanation for this]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:13 (#1)

γλεύκους μεμεστωμένοι εἰσίν

“They are filled with sweet wine”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. However, it would be preferable to use an equivalent expression that conveys the meaning rather than to say something like “sweet wine has filled them.” Alternate translation: [They have drunk their fill of sweet wine]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:13 (#3)

γλεύκους

"with sweet wine"

This refers to wine that is thicker and more intoxicating than ordinary wine. If your readers would not be familiar with this drink, you could use the name of another strong drink that they would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [with strong liquor]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 2:13 (#2)

γλεύκους μεμεστωμένοι εἰσίν

"They are filled with sweet wine"

The implications of this statement are that the disciples have gotten drunk and are babbling and that this is the explanation for the languages the people think they are hearing. Alternate translation: [They have gotten drunk on sweet wine, and so what we are hearing is just drunken babbling]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:14 (#6)

οἱ κατοικοῦντες Ἰερουσαλὴμ πάντες

"all the ones inhabiting Jerusalem"

This seems to mean implicitly people who are not Jews but who live in Jerusalem. Alternate translation: [all of you non-Jews who are residents of Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:14 (#2)

τοῖς ἕνδεκα

"the eleven"

Luke is using the adjective **eleven** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the other 11 apostles]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 2:14 (#7)

τοῦτο ὑμῖν γνωστὸν ἔστω

"let this be known to you"

This expression means that Peter wants to explain the meaning of what the people are seeing and hearing. Alternate translation: [let me explain this to you] or [I am going to explain this to you]

Acts 2:14 (#4)

ἄνδρες, Ἰουδαῖοι

"Men, Jews"

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [My fellow Jews]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:14 (#5)

ἄνδρες, Ἰουδαῖοι

"Men, Jews"

Peter is using the term **men** in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If you retain the idiomatic form of address in your translation, follow the convention in your language that indicates a mixed group of people.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 2:14 (#9)

τοῦτο ὑμῖν γνωστὸν ἔστω

"let this be known to you"

The word translated as **known** is an adjective, so this is not a passive verbal form. However, if your language does not use passive forms, it might be clearer for your readers if you use an expression that does not seem to be a passive verbal form. The adjective **known** expresses the result of action by a different agent (**you**), so you can use an active form with that agent as the implied subject. Alternate translation: [know this]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:14 (#3)

ἐπῆρεν τὴν φωνὴν αὐτοῦ καὶ ἀπεφθέγξατο αὐτοῖς

"raised up his voice and spoke out to them"

The idiom **raised up his voice** means that Peter spoke loudly. Alternate translation: [spoke out to them in a loud voice]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:14 (#11)

ἐνωτίσασθε τὰ ῥήματά μου

"take my words into your ears"

Peter is using the term **words** to mean what he is about to say by using words, and he is using the term **ears** to mean the capacity for listening. Alternate translation: [listen carefully to what I am about to say]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:14 (#8)

τοῦτο ὑμῖν γνωστὸν ἔστω

"let this be known to you"

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may this be known to you] or [this should be known to you]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 2:14 (#10)

καὶ

"and"

Peter uses the word translated as **and** to indicate what his listeners should do as a result of what he has just told them. Alternate translation: [so]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 2:14 (#1)

σταθεὶς δὲ ὁ Πέτρος σὺν τοῖς ἕνδεκα, ἐπῆρεν τὴν φωνὴν αὐτοῦ

"But Peter, having stood with the eleven, raised up his voice"

Peter **stood** to show that he had something important to say, and the other apostles **stood** with him to show their support for him as he spoke. You could indicate that in your translation, perhaps as a separate sentence, if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [But Peter stood up to show that he had something important to say, and the other apostles stood with him to show their support for him as he spoke. Peter raised up his voice]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 2:15 (#4)

ἔστιν & ὥρα τρίτη τῆς ἡμέρας

"it is the third hour of the day"

In this culture, people began counting the hours each day beginning around daybreak at six o'clock in the morning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this in the way the people of your culture reckon time. Alternate translation: [it is nine o'clock in the morning]

Acts 2:15 (#3)

γὰρ

"for"

Peter says **for** in this second instance to introduce the reason why the people speaking different languages are not drunk. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [They are not drunk, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 2:15 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Peter says **for** in this first instance to introduce the reason why the crowd should listen to him. Alternate translation: [You should listen to me because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 2:15 (#5)

ἔστιν & ὥρα τρίτη τῆς ἡμέρας

"it is the third hour of the day"

Peter assumes that his listeners will know that people do not get drunk that early in the day. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [it is only nine o'clock in the morning, and people do not get drunk that early]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:15 (#6)

ὥρα τρίτη τῆς ἡμέρας

"the third hour of the day"

If you decide to translate this in the way that the biblical culture reckoned time, but your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here. Alternate translation: [hour three of the day]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Acts 2:15 (#2)

οὗτοι

"these"

The demonstrative pronoun **these** refers to the disciples who are speaking different languages. If it would

be helpful to your readers, you could add more information to clarify the meaning. Alternate translation: [these people who are speaking different languages]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 2:16 (#1)

τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ εἰρημένον διὰ τοῦ προφήτου Ἰωήλ

"this is what was spoken through the prophet Joel"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who did the action. Alternate translation: [this is what God said through the prophet Joel]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:16 (#2)

τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ εἰρημένον διὰ τοῦ προφήτου Ἰωήλ

"this is what was spoken through the prophet Joel"

The implication is that God is now making happen what he said through Joel. Alternate translation: [you are seeing God make happen what he announced earlier through the prophet Joel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:17 (#8)

ὑμῶν

"your"

If you turn the direct quotation into an indirect quotation and translate these instances of **your** as "our," use the inclusive form of the word "our" in each instance if your language marks that distinction, since Joel would be referring to himself and his listeners.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 2:17 (#1)

καὶ ἔσται ἐν ταῖς ἐσχάταις ἡμέραις, λέγει ὁ Θεός, ἐκχεῶ ἀπὸ τοῦ Πνεύματός μου ἐπὶ πᾶσαν σάρκα

"And it will be in the last days," God says, "I will pour out from my Spirit on all flesh"

The material in 2:17–21 contains a quotation within a quotation within a quotation. Luke is quoting Peter, Peter is quoting Joel, and Joel is quoting God. You could avoid having a third-level quotation by moving the phrase **God says** to before the quotation from Joel. (The phrase itself does not occur in the passage from Joel that Peter quotes. It appears to be something that Peter supplies within the quotation to show that God is the speaker. Since that is the case, putting it before the quotation would not change the actual biblical text.) Alternate translation: [God said, "And it will be in the last days, I will pour out from my Spirit on all flesh]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:17 (#9)

οἱ νεανίσκοι & οἱ πρεσβύτεροι

"young men & old men"

God speaks separately of **sons** and **daughters** in this verse and of "male servants" and "female servants" in the next verse. But here the contrast is between **young** and **old**. So the word **men** could have a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [young people ... old people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 2:17 (#5)

ἐκχεῶ ἀπὸ τοῦ Πνεύματός μου

"I will pour out from my Spirit"

God says that he will **pour out** his Spirit, as if the Spirit were a liquid, to mean that he will give the Spirit generously and abundantly. Alternate translation: [I will lavish my Spirit]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:17 (#7)

καὶ προφητεύσουσιν οἱ υἱοὶ ὑμῶν, καὶ αἱ θυγατέρες ὑμῶν; καὶ οἱ νεανίσκοι ὑμῶν ὁράσεις ὄψονται, καὶ οἱ πρεσβύτεροι ὑμῶν ἐνυπνίοις ἐνυπνιασθήσονται

"and your sons and your daughters will prophesy and your young men will see visions and your old men will dream dreams"

If you have decided to turn Peter's quotation from Joel into an indirect quotation in order to avoid having a second-level quotation, also do that here in the rest of the verse. It may be helpful to make this a new sentence. Alternate translation: [God said that our sons and our daughters would prophesy and our young men would see visions and our old men would dream dreams]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:17 (#6)

ἐπὶ πᾶσαν σάρκα

"on all flesh"

God refers to **flesh** to mean people by association with the way that people are made of flesh. Alternate translation: [to all people]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:17 (#2)

καὶ ἔσται ἐν ταῖς ἐσχάταις ἡμέραις, λέγει ὁ Θεός, ἐκχεῶ ἀπὸ τοῦ Πνεύματός μου ἐπὶ πᾶσαν σάρκα

“And it will be in the last days,” God says, “I will pour out from my Spirit on all flesh”

You could also avoid having a second-level quotation by turning the direct quotation into an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [God said that in the last days he would pour out his Spirit on all flesh]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:17 (#3)

καὶ ἔσται

“And it will be”

Alternate translation: [This is what will happen] or [This is what I will do]

Acts 2:17 (#4)

ταῖς ἐσχάταις ἡμέραις

“the last days”

See the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to this chapter, which recommends not interpreting or explaining it, but representing it simply as ULT does.

Acts 2:18 (#2)

ἐπὶ τοὺς δούλους μου, καὶ ἐπὶ τὰς δούλας μου

“on my male servants and on my female servants”

If your language has masculine and feminine forms of the word “servant,” it would be accurate to use those forms here. Other languages can indicate this distinction in other ways, as ULT does with the adjectives “male” and “female.”

Acts 2:18 (#1)

καί γε ἐπὶ τοὺς δούλους μου, καὶ ἐπὶ τὰς δούλας μου, ἐν ταῖς ἡμέραις ἐκείναις ἐκχεῶ ἀπὸ τοῦ Πνεύματός μου, καὶ προφητεύσουσιν

“And even on my male servants and on my female servants in those days I will pour out from my Spirit, and they will prophesy”

You may have decided to turn Peter’s quotation from Joel into an indirect quotation in order to avoid having a second-level quotation. Alternate translation: [God said that even on his male servants and on his female servants in those days he would pour out from his Spirit, and they would prophesy]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 2:18 (#4)

ἐπὶ & ἐπὶ & ἐκχεῶ ἀπὸ τοῦ Πνεύματός μου

“on & on & I will pour out from my Spirit”

See how you translated this in 2:17. Alternate translation: [to ... to ... I will give my Spirit abundantly]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:18 (#3)

ἐν ταῖς ἡμέραις ἐκείναις

“in those days”

Here, **days** means a specific time. Alternate translation: [at that time]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:19 (#3)

ἐν τῷ οὐρανῷ ἄνω

“in the heaven above”

Since God specifies in the next verse that these **wonders** will affect the sun and the moon, the word translated as **heaven** likely has the specific sense of “sky.” Alternate translation: [in the sky above]

Acts 2:19 (#4)

ἀτμίδα καπνοῦ

“vapor of smoke”

Here the possessive form describes **vapor** that looks smoky or that has **smoke** in it. Alternate translation: [smoky vapor]

See: Possession

Acts 2:19 (#2)

δώσω τέρατα & καὶ σημεῖα

“I will give wonders & and signs”

Alternate translation: [I will show wonders ... and signs]

Acts 2:19 (#1)

καὶ δώσω

“And I will give”

You may have decided to turn Peter’s quotation from Joel into an indirect quotation in order to avoid having a second-level quotation. Alternate translation: [God said that he would give]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:20 (#9)

ἐλθεῖν ἡμέραν Κυρίου

“day of the Lord comes”

This is an expression that many of the prophets use. It refers to the time when God will judge and punish people for their sins. Alternate translation: [the time when the Lord judges and punishes people for their sins]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:20 (#4)

ὁ ἥλιος μεταστραφήσεται εἰς σκότος

“The sun will be turned to darkness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **darkness**, you could express the same idea with an adjective such as “dark.” Alternate translation: [The sun will become dark]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 2:20 (#10)

ἐλθεῖν ἡμέραν Κυρίου

“day of the Lord comes”

In this expression, God is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the first person in your translation. Alternate translation: [time arrives when I judge and punish people for their sins]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 2:20 (#5)

καὶ ἡ σελήνη εἰς αἷμα

“and the moon to blood”

Here some words have been left out that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [and the moon will be turned to blood]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 2:20 (#1)

ὁ ἥλιος μεταστραφήσεται εἰς σκότος καὶ ἡ σελήνη εἰς αἷμα, πρὶν ἢ ἐλθεῖν ἡμέραν Κυρίου τὴν μεγάλην καὶ ἐπιφανῆ

“The sun will be turned to darkness, and the moon to blood before the great and remarkable day of the Lord comes”

You may have decided to turn Peter’s quotation from Joel into an indirect quotation in order to avoid having a second-level quotation. Alternate translation: [God said that sun would be turned to darkness, and the moon to blood before the great and remarkable day of the Lord came]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:20 (#6)

καὶ ἡ σελήνη εἰς αἷμα

“and the moon to blood”

If you decide to supply words as the previous note suggests, but your language does not use passive verbal forms, you could use an active form. Alternate translation: [and I will turn the moon to blood] or, if you are making this an indirect quotation, [and that he would turn the moon to blood]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:20 (#8)

ἡμέραν & τὴν μεγάλην καὶ ἐπιφανῆ

“great and remarkable day”

The words **great** and **remarkable** mean similar things. They are being used together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [the very great day] or [the truly remarkable day]

See: Doublet

Acts 2:20 (#7)

καὶ ἡ σελήνη εἰς αἷμα

“and the moon to blood”

God is speaking as if he would change the **moon** into something else. Alternate translation: [and the moon will look like blood] or [and the moon will appear to be red]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:20 (#2)

ὁ ἥλιος μεταστραφήσεται εἰς σκότος

“The sun will be turned to darkness”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [I will turn the sun to darkness] or, if you are making this an indirect quotation, [God said that he would turn the sun to darkness]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:20 (#3)

ὁ ἥλιος μεταστραφήσεται εἰς σκότος

“The sun will be turned to darkness”

God is speaking as if he would change the **sun** into something else. Alternate translation: [The sun will become dark] or [The sun will no longer shine brightly]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:21 (#4)

πᾶς ὃς ἂν ἐπικαλέσηται

“everyone who may call on”

The expression **call on** means to make an appeal. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everyone who may appeal to]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:21 (#7)

τὸ ὄνομα Κυρίου

“the name of the Lord”

The implication is that people would appeal to God to show them mercy and save them. Alternate translation: [the Lord for mercy and salvation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:21 (#1)

καὶ ἔσται, πᾶς ὃς ἂν ἐπικαλέσηται τὸ ὄνομα Κυρίου σωθήσεται

“And it will be, everyone who may call on the name of the Lord will be saved”

You may have decided to turn Peter’s quotation from Joel into an indirect quotation in order to avoid having a second-level quotation. Alternate translation: [And God said it would happen that everyone who called on the name of the Lord would be saved]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:21 (#6)

τὸ ὄνομα Κυρίου

“the name of the Lord”

Here, **name** represents a person by association with the way that each person has a name. Alternate translation: [the Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:21 (#3)

πᾶς ὃς ἂν ἐπικαλέσηται τὸ ὄνομα Κυρίου σωθήσεται

“everyone who may call on the name of the Lord will be saved”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the Lord will save everyone who calls on his name]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:21 (#2)

καὶ ἔσται, πᾶς

“And it will be, everyone”

Alternate translation: [And this is what will happen: Everyone]

Acts 2:21 (#8)

σωθήσεται

“will be saved”

This is the end of Joel’s quotation of the Lord. If you chose to mark the Lord’s words as a third-level quotation, indicate that ending here with a closing third-level quotation mark or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate the end of a quotation within a quotation within a quotation. It is also the end of Peter’s quotation of Joel. If you chose to mark Joel’s words as a second-level quotation, similarly indicate the ending of that quotation within a quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 2:21 (#5)

τὸ ὄνομα Κυρίου

“the name of the Lord”

God is speaking of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the first person in your translation. Alternate translation: [my name] or [me by name]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 2:22 (#4)

δυνάμεσι, καὶ τέρασι, καὶ σημείοις

“with mighty works and wonders and signs”

The terms **mighty works**, **wonders**, and **signs** mean similar things. Peter is using them together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [by means of many great miracles]

See: Doublet

Acts 2:22 (#3)

ἀποδεδειγμένον ἀπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“attested & by God”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [whom God proved he had sent]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:22 (#2)

ἀκούσατε τοὺς λόγους τούτους

“hear these words”

Peter is using the term **words** to mean what he is about to say. Alternate translation: [listen to what I am about to say]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:22 (#1)

ἄνδρες, Ἰσραηλεῖται

“Men, Israelites”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [My fellow Israelites]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:23 (#3)

τῇ, ὡρισμένῃ βουλῇ καὶ προγνώσει τοῦ Θεοῦ

“by the determined counsel and foreknowledge of God”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the ideas behind the words **counsel** and **foreknowledge**, you could express the same ideas with verbs. Alternate translation: [as God had planned in a determined way for things he knew about ahead of time]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 2:23 (#8)

ἀνόμων

“of the lawless”

By **lawless**, Peter does not mean people who disregard the law and break the law. He is describing Gentiles (that is, people who are not Jews) by association with the fact that they do not have the Jewish law. Alternate translation: [of the Gentiles]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:23 (#7)

ἀνόμων

“of the lawless”

Peter is using the adjective **lawless** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could supply the word “people” to show this. Alternate translation: [lawless people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 2:23 (#1)

τοῦτον

“This one”

Peter is using the demonstrative adjective **this** as a noun to refer to a specific person, Jesus. (ULT shows that by adding **one**.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could specify whom Peter means. Alternate translation: [This Jesus]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 2:23 (#6)

διὰ χειρὸς ἀνόμων

“by the hand of the lawless”

Here, **hand** refers to actions. Alternate translation: [through the actions of the lawless] or [by what the lawless did]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:23 (#5)

ἀνείλατε

“you killed”

It was the Romans who literally killed Jesus, but Peter says that the Jewish people in the crowd killed him because their demands led to his death. Alternate translation: [you demanded to be killed]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 2:23 (#4)

τῇ, ὡρισμένῃ βουλῇ καὶ προγνώσει τοῦ Θεοῦ

"by the determined counsel and foreknowledge of God"

The word **determined** is a passive verbal form that you could express with an active form. Alternate translation: [in a way that God had determined as he planned for things he knew about ahead of time]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:23 (#9)

προσπήξαντες

"having fastened"

This is a reference to the crucifixion of Jesus. Alternate translation: [having nailed him to a cross] or [by crucifying him]

Acts 2:23 (#2)

τῇ, ὡρισμένῃ βουλῇ καὶ προγνώσει τοῦ Θεοῦ, ἔκδοτον

"given up by the determined counsel and foreknowledge of God"

The term translated as **given up** is an adjective, not a passive verbal form, but even so you may wish to translate it with an active verbal form. Alternate translation: [whom God gave up by his determined counsel and foreknowledge]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:24 (#4)

τὰς ὠδῖνας τοῦ θανάτου

"the agonies of death"

Peter uses the possessive form to describe **death** as something that is characterized by **agonies**. Alternate translation: [agonizing death]

See: Possession

Acts 2:24 (#2)

ὃν ὁ Θεὸς ἀνέστησεν

"whom God raised up"

The idiom **raised up** means that God made Jesus alive again after he died. Alternate translation: [whom God brought back to life] or, as a new sentence, [But God brought him back to life]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:24 (#5)

καθότι οὐκ ἦν δυνατὸν κρατεῖσθαι αὐτὸν ὑπ' αὐτοῦ

"because it was not possible for him to be held by it"

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state explicitly why this was **not possible**. Alternate translation: [because God is so much stronger than death that it was not possible for him to be held by it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:24 (#6)

κρατεῖσθαι αὐτὸν ὑπ' αὐτοῦ

"for him to be held by it"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [for death to hold him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:24 (#1)

ὃν ὁ Θεὸς ἀνέστησεν

"whom God raised up"

It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [But God raised him up]

Acts 2:24 (#3)

λύσας τὰς ὠδῖνας τοῦ θανάτου

"having loosed the agonies of death"

Peter speaks of the **agonies of death** as if they were ropes with which Jesus had been tied, and of God bringing Jesus back to life as if God had untied those ropes and set him free. Alternate translation: [delivering him from the agonies of death]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:24 (#7)

κρατεῖσθαι αὐτὸν ὑπ' αὐτοῦ

"for him to be held by it"

Peter speaks of death as if it were a living thing that held Jesus captive. Alternate translation: [for him to remain dead]

See: Personification

Acts 2:25 (#2)

Δαυεὶδ γὰρ λέγει εἰς αὐτόν, προορώμην τὸν Κύριον ἐνώπιόν μου διὰ παντός, ὅτι ἐκ δεξιῶν μού ἐστιν, ἵνα μὴ σαλευθῶ

"For David says about him, 'I saw the Lord before me through all, for he is at my right so that I should not be moved"

The pronoun **him** refers to the Messiah, about whom David is prophesying. This means that within the quotation, the pronouns **I** and **my** are spoken by the Messiah. If you turn the direct quotation into an indirect quotation and change these pronouns to "he," "him," and "his," it may be helpful to indicate the references in some cases so that your readers will recognize this. Alternate translation: [For David said about the Messiah that he saw the Lord before him through all, for the Lord was at the Messiah's right so that he should not be moved]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 2:25 (#6)

διὰ παντός

"through all"

The phrase **through all** is an ellipsis for "through all times." It means "always." Alternate translation: [at all times] or [always]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 2:25 (#4)

Δαυεὶδ & λέγει εἰς αὐτόν

"David says about him"

Peter assumes that the crowd will know that he is referring to what **David says** in one of the psalms that he wrote, and that David is prophesying what the Messiah would say. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [David says in one of his psalms that the Messiah will say] or [David wrote in one of his psalms that the Messiah would say]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:25 (#5)

ἐνώπιόν μου

"before me"

The phrase **before me**, which means "in front of me," is a spatial metaphor. Alternate translation: [present with me]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:25 (#7)

ἐκ δεξιῶν μού

"at my right"

Here the adjective **right** is being used as a noun to indicate the right side. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could state that specifically. Alternate translation: [at my right side]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 2:25 (#9)

μὴ σαλευθῶ

"I should not be moved"

Here, **moved** means to be taken out of a safe and secure position, and so it means to be harmed. Alternate translation: [I will not be harmed]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:25 (#10)

μὴ σαλευθῶ

"I should not be moved"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [no one will harm me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:25 (#3)

γὰρ

"For"

Peter uses the word **For** to introduce a reason why the crowd should believe him when he says that God brought Jesus back to life. The reason is that the Scriptures predicted this. As a result, the crowd should be confident that it did happen. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [You can be confident that God did bring Jesus back to life, because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 2:25 (#8)

ἐκ δεξιῶν μού

“at my right”

In this context, to be at someone’s right side means to be in a position to help and sustain that person. Alternate translation: [there to help me]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:25 (#1)

Δαυεὶδ γὰρ λέγει εἰς αὐτόν, προορώμην τὸν Κύριον ἐνώπιόν μου διὰ παντός, ὅτι ἐκ δεξιῶν μού ἐστιν, ἵνα μὴ σαλευθῶ

“For David says about him, ‘I saw the Lord before me through all, for he is at my right so that I should not be moved”

In order to avoid having a second-level quotation, you could turn Peter’s quotation from David into an indirect quotation. (Peter is quoting from Psalm 16:8–11.) Alternate translation: [For David said about him that he saw the Lord before him through all, for he was at his right so that he should not be moved]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:26 (#5)

καὶ ἡ σάρξ μου κατασκηνώσει ἐπ’ ἐλπίδι

“my flesh will also dwell in hope”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **hope**, you could express the same idea with an adverb such as “hopefully.” Alternate translation: [my body will also live hopefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 2:26 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτο ηὐφράνθη ἡ καρδία μου, καὶ ἠγαλλιάσατο ἡ γλῶσσά μου; ἔτι δὲ καὶ ἡ σάρξ μου κατασκηνώσει ἐπ’ ἐλπίδι

“Because of this, my heart was glad and my tongue exulted. And indeed, my flesh will also dwell in hope”

You may have decided to turn Peter’s quotation of David into an indirect quotation in order to avoid having a second-level quotation. Alternate translation: [Because of this, his heart was glad and his tongue exulted, and indeed his flesh would also dwell in hope]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:26 (#2)

ηὐφράνθη ἡ καρδία μου

“my heart was glad”

Here, the **heart** represents the emotions. Alternate translation: [I felt glad]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:26 (#6)

καὶ ἡ σάρξ μου κατασκηνώσει ἐπ’ ἐλπίδι

“my flesh will also dwell in hope”

The Messiah is speaking as if his body itself would live hopefully. Alternate translation: [I will also have hope for my body]

See: Personification

Acts 2:26 (#4)

καὶ ἡ σάρξ μου κατασκηνώσει ἐπ’ ἐλπίδι

“my flesh will also dwell in hope”

Here, **flesh** means the human body by association with the way that is made of flesh. Alternate translation: [my body will also dwell in hope]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:26 (#7)

καὶ ἡ σάρξ μου κατασκηνώσει ἐπ’ ἐλπίδι

“my flesh will also dwell in hope”

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state explicitly what **hope** the Messiah had for his body. Alternate translation: [I will also have hope that God will bring my body back to life after I die]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:26 (#3)

ἠγαλλιάσατο ἡ γλῶσσά μου

“my tongue exulted”

Here, the **tongue** represents the capacity for speech. Alternate translation: [I said joyful things]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:27 (#8)

ἰδεῖν διαφθοράν

“to see decay”

The term **decay** refers in this context to the decomposition of the body after death. If it would be helpful to

your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [to experience the decomposition of his body]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:27 (#5)

τὸν Ὅσιόν σου

"your Holy One"

The expression **Holy One** is a title for the Messiah. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that explicitly. Alternate translation: [your Messiah] or [your holy Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:27 (#4)

οὐκ ἐνκαταλείψεις τὴν ψυχήν μου εἰς Ἅιδην

"you will not abandon my soul to Hades"

The Messiah says **my soul** to mean himself, using one part of his being to represent his whole being. Alternate translation: [you will not abandon me to Hades]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 2:27 (#2)

οὐκ ἐνκαταλείψεις τὴν ψυχήν μου εἰς Ἅιδην, οὐδὲ δώσεις τὸν Ὅσιόν σου ἰδεῖν διαφθοράν

"you will not abandon my soul to Hades, nor will you allow your Holy One to see decay"

These two statements mean similar things. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it may be helpful to show that to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if the repetition might be confusing, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **nor** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [you will not abandon my soul to Hades, no, you will not allow your Holy One to see decay]

See: Parallelism

Acts 2:27 (#1)

ὅτι οὐκ ἐνκαταλείψεις τὴν ψυχήν μου εἰς Ἅιδην, οὐδὲ δώσεις τὸν Ὅσιόν σου ἰδεῖν διαφθοράν

"For you will not abandon my soul to Hades, nor will you allow your Holy One to see decay"

You may have decided to turn Peter's quotation from David into an indirect quotation in order to avoid having a second-level quotation. If so, it may be necessary to add some introductory material here. Alternate translation: [The Messiah knew that God would not abandon his soul to Hades and that God would not allow his Holy One to see decay]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:27 (#7)

ἰδεῖν διαφθοράν

"to see decay"

Here the word **see** is being used to mean "experience." Alternate translation: [to experience decay]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:27 (#3)

οὐκ ἐνκαταλείψεις & οὐδὲ δώσεις & σου

"you will not abandon & nor will you allow your"

The words **you** and **your** are singular, and they refer to God. See what you decided to do in your translation in 1:24 in a similar case where God is addressed as "you." You may have decided in such cases to use a formal form of "you" that your language may have, or you may have decided to use an informal form of "you."

See: Forms of 'You' — Formal or Informal

Acts 2:27 (#6)

τὸν Ὅσιόν σου

"your Holy One"

The Messiah is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the first person in your translation. Alternate translation: [me, your Holy One] or [me, the Messiah]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 2:28 (#3)

ἐγνώρισάς μοι ὁδοὺς ζωῆς

"You made known to me the paths of life"

The Messiah speaks of **life** as if it consisted of **paths** that a person walked along. Those represent the various pursuits and adventures that people have in life. The word **known** refers to experiential knowledge. Alternate translation: [You enabled me to experience the adventures of life once again]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:28 (#1)

ἐγνώρισάς μοι ὁδοὺς ζωῆς; πληρώσεις με εὐφροσύνης μετὰ τοῦ προσώπου σου

"You made known to me the paths of life; you will fill me with gladness with your face"

You may have decided to turn Peter's quotation of David into an indirect quotation in order to avoid having a second-level quotation. If so, it may be helpful to add some introductory material here. Alternate translation: [The Messiah said that God had made known to him the paths of life and that God would fill him with gladness with his face]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:28 (#5)

μετὰ τοῦ προσώπου σου

"with your face"

Here, the word **face** represents the presence of a person. Alternate translation: [by your presence]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:28 (#6)

μετὰ τοῦ προσώπου σου

"with your face"

This is the end of Peter's quotation of David. If you chose to mark David's words as a second-level quotation, in your translation you can indicate this ending with a closing second-level quotation mark or whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 2:28 (#4)

πληρώσεις με εὐφροσύνης

"you will fill me with gladness"

The Messiah speaks as if he were a container that God could **fill** with **gladness**. Alternate translation: [you will give me great gladness]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:28 (#2)

ἐγνώρισάς & πληρώσεις & σου

"You made known & you will fill & your"

The words **you** and **your** are singular and they refer to God. See what you decided to do in the similar case in 1:24.

See: Forms of 'You' — Formal or Informal

Acts 2:29 (#3)

τοῦ πατριάρχου Δαυεὶδ

"the patriarch David"

A **patriarch** is literally the ancestor of a group of people. David was not the ancestor of all the Jews to whom Peter is speaking. So he is likely using the term to identify David as the king who established the Israelite kingdom as a lasting dynasty. Alternate translation: [David, the founder of our kingdom]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:29 (#4)

ἐτάφη

"was buried"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [people buried him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:29 (#5)

ἄχρι τῆς ἡμέρας ταύτης

"to this day"

Peter is using the word **day** to mean a specific time. Alternate translation: [at this time]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:29 (#2)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

"Men, brothers"

Often in the New Testament, the term **brothers** refers to fellow believers in Jesus, as it does in 1:15. But here, Peter is addressing fellow Jews who are not yet believers in Jesus, but they do believe in the God of Israel. Alternate translation: [My fellow believers in God] or [My brothers and sisters]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:29 (#1)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

"Men, brothers"

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [My brothers]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:30 (#3)

ἐκ καρποῦ τῆς ὀσφύος αὐτοῦ, καθίσαι ἐπὶ τὸν θρόνον αὐτοῦ

"to set from the fruit of his loins upon his throne"

Peter is using the word **loins** to represent David himself by association with the way the reproductive organs are in the loins. He is using the word **fruit** in a broad sense to mean what someone or something produces, in this case a descendant. Alternate translation: [to set one of his descendants upon his throne]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:30 (#4)

ἐκ καρποῦ τῆς ὀσφύος αὐτοῦ, καθίσαι ἐπὶ τὸν θρόνον αὐτοῦ

"to set from the fruit of his loins upon his throne"

When Peter says that God promised to **set** one of David's descendants **upon his throne**, he is using that one action to represent God's promise to David that this descendant would succeed him as king. Alternate translation: [to make one of his descendants succeed him as king]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 2:30 (#1)

οὖν

"Therefore"

Peter uses the word **Therefore** to introduce the logical result of what he has just said. Alternate translation: [We can therefore conclude that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 2:30 (#2)

προφήτης & ὑπάρχων, καὶ εἰδὼς

"being a prophet and having known"

Peter is still speaking about David. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [because David was a prophet and he knew]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:31 (#4)

τοῦ Χριστοῦ

"of the Christ"

Christ is the Greek word for "Messiah." If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use the term "Messiah" in your translation, as UST does.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:31 (#7)

οὔτε ἡ σὰρξ αὐτοῦ εἶδεν διαφθοράν

"nor did his flesh see decay"

The term **decay** refers in this context to the decomposition of the body after death. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [nor did his body experience decomposition]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:31 (#2)

ἐλάλησεν περὶ τῆς ἀναστάσεως τοῦ Χριστοῦ

"he spoke about the resurrection of the Christ"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **resurrection**, you could express the same idea with an adjective such as "alive." Alternate translation: [he described how God would make Christ alive again after he died]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 2:31 (#1)

ἐλάλησεν & ἐνκατελείφθη & αὐτοῦ

"he spoke & was he abandoned & his"

The first instance of **he** refers to David, and the second instance of **he** and the pronoun **his** refer to Christ. Alternate translation: [David spoke ... was Christ abandoned ... Christ's]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 2:31 (#6)

οὔτε ἡ σὰρξ αὐτοῦ εἶδεν διαφθοράν

"nor did his flesh see decay"

Peter is using the word **flesh** to mean the body of Jesus by association with the way the body is made of flesh. Alternate translation: [nor did his body experience decay]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:31 (#5)

οὔτε ἡ σὰρξ αὐτοῦ εἶδεν διαφθοράν

“nor did his flesh see decay”

Here the word **see** is being used to mean “experience.” Alternate translation: [nor did his flesh experience decay]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:31 (#3)

οὔτε ἐνκατελείφθη εἰς Ἅιδην

“neither was he abandoned to Hades”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who did the action. Alternate translation: [neither did God abandon him to Hades]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:32 (#2)

ἡμεῖς

“we”

By **we**, Peter means himself and the other apostles, so use the exclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 2:32 (#1)

ἀνέστησεν ὁ Θεός

“God has raised up”

As in 2:24, the idiom **raised up** means that God made Jesus alive again after he died. Alternate translation: [God has brought back to life]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:33 (#5)

τήν τε ἐπαγγελίαν τοῦ Πνεύματος τοῦ Ἁγίου

“and & the promise of the Holy Spirit”

Peter is using the possessive form to describe the Holy Spirit as someone whom God the Father promised to send. Alternate translation: [the promised Holy Spirit from the Father] or [the Holy Spirit whom the Father promised to send]

See: Possession

Acts 2:33 (#2)

τῇ δεξιᾷ οὖν τοῦ Θεοῦ ὑψωθεὶς

“Therefore, having been exalted to the right of God”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [now that God has exalted Jesus to his right]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:33 (#6)

τοῦ Πατρὸς

“the Father”

Father is an important title for God. Alternate translation: [God the Father]

See: Translating Son and Father

Acts 2:33 (#3)

τῇ δεξιᾷ & τοῦ Θεοῦ

“to the right of God”

Peter is using the adjective **right** as a noun in order to indicate the right side. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:25. Alternate translation: [to the right side of God]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 2:33 (#4)

τῇ δεξιᾷ & τοῦ Θεοῦ

“to the right of God”

In this culture, the place at the right side of a ruler was a position of honor. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that explicitly. Alternate translation: [to a place of honor next to God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:33 (#7)

ἐξέχεεν

“he has poured out”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jesus. Alternate translation: [Jesus has poured out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 2:33 (#1)

οὖν

“Therefore”

Peter is using the word **Therefore** to introduce a result. But it is not the immediate result of what he has just said. He is not saying that Jesus has done

what the people see and hear because God raised him from the dead. Instead, this is an overall conclusion. Peter is saying that Jesus sending the Holy Spirit is the reason why the disciples are able to speak in other languages. The crowd should not conclude that they are babbling drunkenly, as some of them have suggested. UST models a way of expressing this sense of the word **Therefore**.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 2:33 (#8)

ἐξέχεεν

"he has poured out"

Peter says that Jesus has **poured out** the things that the people are seeing and hearing as if those things were a liquid. Peter means that Jesus has given these things generously and abundantly. See how you translated the similar statement in 2:17, to which Peter is likely alluding here. Alternate translation: [he has generously given] or [he has abundantly given]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:34 (#4)

ἐκ δεξιῶν μου

"at my right"

In this culture, the place at the right side of a ruler was a position of honor. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in a place of honor next to me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:34 (#2)

εἶπεν Κύριος τῷ Κυρίῳ μου

"The Lord said to my Lord"

The Lord means God here, and **my Lord** means the Messiah. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [God said to the Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:34 (#1)

λέγει & αὐτός, εἶπεν Κύριος τῷ Κυρίῳ μου, κάθου ἐκ δεξιῶν μου

"he himself says, 'The Lord said to my Lord, "Sit at my right"

The material in 2:34–35 contains a quotation within a quotation within a quotation. Luke is quoting Peter, Peter is quoting another psalm by David (Psalm 110:1), and David is quoting God. You could avoid having second-level and third-level quotations by translating this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [he himself says that the Lord told his Lord to sit at his right]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 2:34 (#3)

ἐκ δεξιῶν μου

"at my right"

Here the adjective **right** is used as a noun in order to indicate the right side. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:25. Alternate translation: [at my right side]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 2:35 (#1)

ἕως ἂν θῶ τοὺς ἐχθρούς σου ὑποπόδιον τῶν ποδῶν σου

"until I make your enemies a stool for your feet"

The psalm says that God would make the Messiah's **enemies** a **stool** for his **feet** to mean that God would conquer those enemies and make them submit to the Messiah. Alternate translation: [until I conquer your enemies for you]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:35 (#2)

τῶν ποδῶν σου

"for your feet"

This is the end of David's quotation of the Lord and of Peter's quotation of David. If you chose to mark these in your translation as a third-level and a second-level quotation, indicate that ending here with the appropriate closing quotation marks or the comparable punctuation or convention in your language.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 2:36 (#4)

πᾶς οἶκος Ἰσραὴλ

"all the house of Israel"

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Israel** means all the people descended from the patriarch

Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [the entire nation of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:36 (#3)

γινωσκέτω πᾶς οἶκος Ἰσραὴλ

"let all the house of Israel know"

It may be more natural in your language to use the second person for this imperative, since to this point in his speech Peter has been addressing his audience in the second person. Alternate translation: [all you in the house of Israel, know]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 2:36 (#1)

οὖν

"Therefore"

Peter is using the word **Therefore** to introduce the result of what he has just said. Alternate translation: [Since David was not talking about himself, but about the Messiah]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 2:36 (#2)

γινωσκέτω πᾶς οἶκος Ἰσραὴλ

"let all the house of Israel know"

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may all the house of Israel know] or [all the house of Israel should know]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 2:37 (#6)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

"Men, brothers"

Often in the New Testament, the term **brothers** refers to fellow believers in Jesus, as it does in 1:15. But here, the crowd who does not yet believe in Jesus is addressing Peter and the other apostles with the same affectionate term that Peter used to address them in 2:29. So it seems that what they mean by it is, "fellow believers in the God of Israel." Alternate translation: [fellow believers in our God]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:37 (#1)

ἀκούσαντες & κατενύγησαν τὴν καρδίαν

"hearing this they were pierced in the heart"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [what they heard Peter say pierced their heart]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:37 (#2)

κατενύγησαν τὴν καρδίαν

"they were pierced in the heart"

Here the word **they** refers to the people in the crowd to whom Peter spoke. Alternate translation: [the people in the crowd were pierced in the heart]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 2:37 (#7)

τί ποιήσωμεν

"what should we do"

The people in the crowd are asking about themselves but not the apostles, so use the exclusive form of **we** in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 2:37 (#4)

κατενύγησαν τὴν καρδίαν

"they were pierced in the heart"

Luke is speaking. The people were not literally **pierced in the heart** by anything. He means that the people felt guilty and became very sad. Alternate translation: [they felt guilty and became very sad]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:37 (#3)

κατενύγησαν τὴν καρδίαν

"they were pierced in the heart"

Since Luke is referring to a group of people, it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **heart**. Alternate translation: [the people in the crowd were pierced in their hearts]

See: Collective Nouns

Acts 2:37 (#5)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

“Men, brothers”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [Our brothers]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:38 (#4)

εἰς ἄφεσιν τῶν ἁμαρτιῶν ὑμῶν

“for the forgiveness of your sins”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **forgiveness**, you could express the same idea with a verb such as “forgive.” Alternate translation: [to show that you want God to forgive your sins]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 2:38 (#2)

βαπτισθήτω

“be baptized”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [allow us to baptize you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:38 (#1)

μετανοήσατε & βαπτισθήτω ἕκαστος ὑμῶν & τῶν ἁμαρτιῶν ὑμῶν & λήμψεσθε

“Repent & each of you be baptized & of your sins & you will receive”

The words **you** and **your** are plural, **you will receive** is a plural verb form, and the implied “you” in the imperative **Repent** is also plural. But the implied “you” in the imperative **be baptized** is singular, since the subject is **each**.

See: Forms of You

Acts 2:38 (#3)

ἐπὶ τῷ ὀνόματι Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

“in the name of Jesus Christ”

Here the **name** of Jesus represents his authority. By being baptized, these believers were acknowledging Jesus’ authority over their lives as their Lord and Savior. Alternate translation: [to express your allegiance to Jesus Christ as your Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:39 (#1)

ἐστιν ἡ ἐπαγγελία

“the promise is”

Peter is speaking of the Holy Spirit by association with the way God promised to send the Holy Spirit, as Peter says specifically in 2:33. Alternate translation: [God has promised the Holy Spirit]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:39 (#5)

Κύριος, ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν

“the Lord our God”

By **the Lord our God**, Peter means the God of the Jews. He is speaking of himself and his fellow apostles and of the people in the crowd, so use the inclusive form of the word **our** in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 2:39 (#4)

πᾶσι τοῖς εἰς μακρὰν

“to all those {being} at a distance”

Since Peter is speaking to Jews as a fellow Jew, this is likely an implicit reference to the Jews who were living in other parts of the Roman Empire. However, this statement took on greater meaning when the church realized that “God has also given repentance unto life to the Gentiles,” as its leaders say in 11:18. So you could either express the likely initial meaning here in your translation, or you could leave the statement more general. Alternate translation: [to the Jews living in faraway parts of the empire]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:39 (#2)

ὑμῖν & καὶ τοῖς τέκνοις ὑμῶν

“to you and to your children”

Peter showed the people in 2:17 that God’s promise through Joel to pour out his Spirit included their “sons” and “daughters.” So the implication could be that the people in the crowd should not think that any of them have to reach a certain age before professing faith in Jesus and being baptized. Alternate translation: [to all of you, no matter what your age,] or see the next note for a further possibility.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:39 (#3)

ὑμῖν & καὶ τοῖς τέκνοις ὑμῶν

“to you and to your children”

Peter could also be using the word **children** in a figurative sense to mean “descendants.” In that case, he would be saying that faith in Jesus as the Messiah was not something just for the people living at this time, but also for people living at all times in the future. That would parallel what he says next about faith in Jesus not being just for those who are present in this place, but for people living in all places. Alternate translation: [to you and your descendants] or [to you and everyone who will live after you]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:39 (#6)

ἂν προσκαλέσηται

“may call”

Peter is using the word **call** in an idiomatic sense here. Alternate translation: [may bring to salvation]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:40 (#3)

σώθητε

“Be saved”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who would do the action. Alternate translation: [Let God save you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:40 (#4)

ἀπὸ τῆς γενεᾶς τῆς σκολιᾶς ταύτης

“from this perverse generation”

The implication is that God is going to punish **this perverse generation**. Alternate translation: [from the punishment that this perverse generation will suffer if it does not repent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:40 (#2)

διεμαρτύρατο, καὶ παρεκάλει αὐτοὺς

“he testified and urged them”

Here Luke is expressing a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **urged** tells in what way Peter **testified** further about faith in Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this same idea with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [he testified urgently to them]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 2:40 (#5)

τῆς γενεᾶς τῆς σκολιᾶς ταύτης

“this perverse generation”

The word **perverse** describes things or actions that do not conform to what is right and expected. Peter may be referring implicitly to how the people of this **generation** rejected and killed Jesus. Alternate translation: [this wicked generation that rejected and killed Jesus] or [the wicked people of this time who rejected and killed Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:40 (#1)

ἑτέροις & λόγοις πλείοσιν

“with many other words”

Luke is using the term **words** to mean things that Peter said by using words. Alternate translation: [by saying many other things]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:41 (#2)

ἀποδεξάμενοι τὸν λόγον αὐτοῦ

“having received his word”

Here, **received** means that the people in the crowd accepted that what Peter said was true. Alternate translation: [because they believed his word]

See: Idiom

Acts 2:41 (#1)

οὖν

“Therefore”

Luke uses the word **Therefore** to introduce information about what happened after the story of Pentecost as a result of the events within the story itself. Your language may have its own way of indicating how such information relates to a story.

See: End of Story

Acts 2:41 (#4)

οἱ & ἐβαπτίσθησαν

“they were baptized”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who did the action. The apostles themselves may have baptized all these people, but because so many people repented and wanted to be baptized, it is possible that some of the other believers may have baptized some of them. Alternate translation: [the apostles baptized them] or [the believers baptized them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:41 (#3)

τὸν λόγον αὐτοῦ

“his word”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean what Peter said by using words. Alternate translation: [what Peter said]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:41 (#6)

προσετέθησαν

“were added”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [became part of the church]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 2:41 (#5)

ψυχαὶ

“souls”

Luke is using one part of these people, their **souls**, to mean the people themselves. Alternate translation: [people]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 2:42 (#2)

τῇ κλάσει τοῦ ἄρτου

“in the breaking of bread”

Luke could be using the word **breaking** to mean “eating,” and he could be using the word **bread** to mean “food.” In each case he would be using one part of something to mean the whole thing. Breaking bread is one thing people do when they eat it, and bread is one kind of food. So this could be a reference to the believers sharing meals together. Alternate translation: [in sharing meals] or see the next note for a further possibility.

See: Synecdoche

Acts 2:42 (#1)

ἦσαν & προσκαρτεροῦντες τῇ διδαχῇ τῶν ἀποστόλων, καὶ τῇ κοινωνίᾳ, τῇ κλάσει τοῦ ἄρτου, καὶ ταῖς προσευχαῖς

“they were continuing in the teaching of the apostles and in fellowship, in the breaking of bread and in prayers”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the ideas behind the words **teaching** and **fellowship**, you could express the same ideas with equivalent expressions. Alternate translation: [they continued to learn from what the apostles taught and to share life with one another, and to break bread together and to pray together]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 2:42 (#3)

τῇ κλάσει τοῦ ἄρτου

“in the breaking of bread”

By **the breaking of bread**, Luke could also mean remembering the death of Jesus in the way that Jesus commanded, by literally breaking a loaf of bread and sharing it and also sharing a cup of wine. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in observing the Lord’s Supper]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:43 (#5)

πολλά & τέρατα καὶ σημεῖα

“many wonders and signs”

The terms **wonders** and **signs** mean similar things. Luke is using them together for emphasis. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:22. Alternate translation: [many great miracles]

See: Doublet

Acts 2:43 (#2)

ἐγίνετο & πάσῃ ψυχῇ φόβος

“fear was coming on every soul”

Luke is using one part of a person, the **soul**, to mean the entire person. Alternate translation: [every person began to feel a deep respect for God]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 2:43 (#3)

ἐγίνετο & πάσῃ ψυχῇ φόβος

“fear was coming on every soul”

Luke says **every** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [very many people began to feel a deep respect for God]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 2:43 (#1)

ἐγίνετο & πάσῃ ψυχῇ φόβος

“fear was coming on every soul”

Here the word **fear** describes a deep respect for God. Luke describes this **fear** as if it were a living thing that could come onto people. Alternate translation: [every soul began to feel a deep respect for God]

See: Personification

Acts 2:43 (#4)

πολλά & τέρατα καὶ σημεῖα διὰ τῶν ἀποστόλων ἐγίνετο

“many wonders and signs were happening through the apostles”

Since Luke says that these things happened **through the apostles**, the implication is that God was doing them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make God the subject of this sentence and **wonders and signs** the object. Alternate translation: [God performed many wonders and signs through the apostles]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 2:44 (#2)

εἶχον ἅπαντα κοινά

“had all things in common”

Luke may be saying **all** as a generalization to emphasize the powerful spirit of generosity among the believers. The next verse explains more specifically how the believers showed this generosity, and you could give some indication of that here. Alternate translation: [shared their belongings with one another]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 2:44 (#1)

ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτὸ

“to the same”

See the discussion of this phrase in Part 3 of the Introduction to Acts. Alternate translation: [in the same place] or [united in Christian fellowship]

Acts 2:45 (#1)

τὰ κτήματα καὶ τὰς ὑπάρξεις ἐπίπρασκον

“they were selling properties and possessions”

The words **properties** and **possessions** mean similar things. Luke may be using these words together for emphasis. As the introduction to this chapter suggests, it may be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [They were selling many valuable things that they owned]

See: Doublet

Acts 2:45 (#3)

πᾶσιν, καθότι ἄν τις χρείαν εἶχεν

“to all, as anyone might have need”

Alternate translation: [to everyone who needed help]

Acts 2:45 (#2)

καὶ διεμέριζον αὐτὰ

“and they were distributing them”

Here the pronoun **they** refers to believers who sold things they owned, and the pronoun **them** refers to the money they received from these sales. Alternate translation: [the believers who sold these things were distributing the money that they received]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 2:46 (#2)

ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ

“in the temple”

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when Luke says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [in the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 2:46 (#1)

καθ’ ἡμέραν τε προσκαρτεροῦντες ὁμοθυμαδὸν

“and, continuing unanimously every day”

The word **unanimously** indicates that the apostles and other believers shared a common commitment and purpose and that there was no strife among them. See how you translated the same expression in 1:14.

As the introductions to this chapter suggests, it may be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Continuing to meet with one accord] or [Continuing to meet harmoniously]

Acts 2:46 (#4)

ἐν ἀγαλλιάσει καὶ ἀφελότητι καρδίας

"with exultation and sincerity of heart"

Here, the **heart** represents the emotions. Alternate translation: [with feelings of exultation and sincerity]

See: Metaphor

Acts 2:46 (#3)

κλῶντές & κατ' οἶκον ἄρτον

"breaking bread in each house"

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:42. There were two possible meanings there, but here **breaking bread** seems to mean specifically sharing meals. Alternate translation: [having meals together in their homes]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 2:46 (#5)

ἐν ἀγαλλιάσει καὶ ἀφελότητι καρδίας

"with exultation and sincerity of heart"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the ideas behind the words **exultation** and **sincerity**, you could express the same ideas with adverbs that would indicate feelings. Alternate translation: [joyfully and sincerely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 2:47 (#1)

αἰνοῦντες τὸν Θεὸν καὶ ἔχοντες χάριν πρὸς ὅλον τὸν λαόν

"praising God and having favor with the whole people"

Luke says **the whole people** as a generalization to emphasize how widely the people favored the believers. As the introduction to this chapter suggests, it may be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [They praised God and enjoyed wide favor with the people]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 2:47 (#3)

ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτό

"to the same"

See the discussion of this phrase in Part 3 of the Introduction to Acts. Alternate translation: [to their Christian fellowship]

Acts 2:47 (#2)

τοὺς σῳζομένους

"the ones being saved"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [those whom he was saving]

See: Active or Passive

Acts - Chapter 3 Introduction

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The covenant God made with Abraham
This chapter explains that Jesus came to the Jews in fulfillment of the covenant that God made with Abraham.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"Servant"
Twice in this chapter Peter uses the word "Servant" as a title to mean "Messiah" (3:13, 3:26). He and other believers use the word in the same sense twice in Chapter 4 as well (4:27, 4:30). The word takes on this meaning by allusion to the book of Isaiah, where Isaiah uses it to mean the person whom God has chosen for the special purpose of bringing salvation. In your translation, indicate in some way that "Servant" is a Messianic title. Jesus was not a servant of God in the more ordinary sense, in which the believers apply it to themselves in 4:29, for example. Jesus was fully the Son of God, sent to earth on a special mission. If you would not be able to make this clear by using the word "Servant," you may wish to use the word "Messiah" instead.

"You killed" (3:15)
For the same reasons as when he was speaking on the day of Pentecost (2:23), Peter tells people in this chapter that they were guilty of killing Jesus. But he also tells them that they are the first ones to whom God has sent Jesus' followers to invite them to repent (3:26). For further information and suggestions for how to make clear in your translation what Peter means, see the discussion of this phrase in the introduction

to Chapter 2 and the notes to this phrase in 2:23 and 3:15. (See: repent, repentance)

Acts 3:1 (#3)

τὴν ἐνάτην

"the ninth hour"

In this culture, people began counting the hours each day beginning around daybreak at six o'clock in the morning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this time in the way the people of your culture reckon time. Alternate translation: [three o'clock in the afternoon]

Acts 3:1 (#4)

τὴν ἐνάτην

"the ninth hour"

If you decide to translate this in the way that the biblical culture reckoned time but your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here. Alternate translation: [hour nine]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Acts 3:1 (#2)

εἰς τὸ ἱερὸν

"to the temple"

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when Luke says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [to the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:1 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke uses the word **Now** to introduce background information that will help readers understand what happens next. You can translate it with a word or phrase that serves the same purpose in your language.

See: Connect — Background Information

Acts 3:2 (#2)

καί τις ἀνὴρ

"And a certain man"

In this verse, Luke provides background information about this man to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 3:2 (#5)

Ὡραίαν

"Beautiful"

Beautiful is the name of one of the gates of the Jerusalem temple.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 3:2 (#1)

καί τις ἀνὴρ, χωλὸς ἐκ κοιλίας μητρὸς αὐτοῦ ὑπάρχων, ἐβαστάζετο, ὃν ἐτίθουν καθ' ἡμέραν πρὸς τὴν θύραν τοῦ ἱεροῦ

"And a certain man, being lame from the womb of his mother, was being carried, whom each day they placed at the gate of the temple"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an active verbal form instead of the passive form **was being carried**. Alternate translation: [And there was a certain man who had been lame since birth whom people would carry to the temple every day and place at the gate]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 3:2 (#4)

τὴν λεγομένην

"that is called"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [that people call] or [whose name is]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 3:2 (#6)

εἰς τὸ ἱερόν

"into the temple"

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when Luke says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [into the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:2 (#3)

ἐκ κοιλίας μητρὸς αὐτοῦ

“from the womb of his mother”

Luke is describing the time of the lame man’s birth by association with the way he came from the **womb** of his **mother** when he was born. Alternate translation: [since birth] or [since he was born]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:3 (#1)

ἠρώτα ἐλεημοσύνην λαβεῖν

“asked to receive alms”

The man specifically asked Peter and John to give him **alms** (that is, a charitable gift). Alternate translation: [asked to receive alms from them] or [asked them to give him alms]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 3:4 (#2)

βλέψον εἰς ἡμᾶς

“Look at us”

Peter is asking the man to look at him and John, not to look at himself as well, so use the exclusive form of **us** in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 3:4 (#1)

ἀτενίσας & Πέτρος εἰς αὐτὸν σὺν τῷ Ἰωάννῃ εἶπεν

“Peter, looking intently at him with John, said”

This means that both Peter and John looked at the man. It does not mean that Peter looked at the man and at John, and it does not mean that both Peter and John spoke to the man. Alternate translation: [Peter and John looked intently at him, and Peter said]

Acts 3:6 (#1)

ἀργύριον καὶ χρυσίον

“Silver and gold”

Peter is referring to money by association with the way that **silver** and **gold** were used for money at this time. Alternate translation: [money]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:6 (#4)

περιπάτει

“walk”

This was not a command that the man was capable of obeying. Instead, it was a command that directly caused the man to be healed. Alternate translation: [I give you the ability to walk]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 3:6 (#3)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ Ναζωραίου

“In the name of Jesus Christ the Nazarene”

Here the **name** of Jesus represents his authority. Alternate translation: [By the authority of Jesus Christ the Nazarene, I command you]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:6 (#2)

ὃ δὲ ἔχω, τοῦτό σοι δίδωμι

“but what I have, this I give to you”

What happens next in the story shows that by **what I have**, Peter implicitly means the authority that Jesus has given him to heal. Alternate translation: [but Jesus has given me the authority to heal, and I will use it on your behalf]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 3:7 (#1)

πιάσας αὐτὸν τῆς δεξιᾶς χειρὸς, ἤγειρεν αὐτόν; παραχρῆμα δὲ ἐστερεώθησαν αἱ βάσεις αὐτοῦ καὶ τὰ σφυδρά

“seizing him by the right hand, he raised him up, and immediately his feet and ankles were made strong”

In this verse, the pronoun **he** refers to Peter, while the pronouns **him** and **his** refer to the lame man. You could indicate that specifically in at least some of the cases if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [seizing the man by the right hand, Peter raised him up, and immediately the man’s feet and ankles were made strong]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 3:7 (#2)

ἐστερεώθησαν αἱ βάσεις αὐτοῦ καὶ τὰ σφυδρά

“his feet and ankles were made strong”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [his feet and ankles became strong]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 3:8 (#2)

ἔστη καὶ περιεπάτει, καὶ εἰσῆλθεν σὺν αὐτοῖς

“he stood and began to walk, and he entered with them”

The pronoun **he** refers to the man who had been lame, and the pronoun **them** refers to Peter and John. You could indicate that specifically if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the man stood and began to walk, and the man entered with Peter and John]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 3:8 (#3)

εἰς τὸ ἱερὸν

“into the temple”

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when Luke says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [into the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:8 (#1)

καὶ

“And”

Luke is using the word translated as **And** to indicate that the events in this verse happened as a result of the events in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 3:9 (#1)

πᾶς ὁ λαὸς

“all the people”

The word **all** is a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [the crowd that was in the courtyard]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 3:10 (#2)

τῇ Ὡραίᾳ Πύλῃ

“the Beautiful Gate”

This was the name of one of the entrances to the temple area. See how you translated the similar expression in 3:2.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 3:10 (#1)

ἐπεγίνωσκον & αὐτὸν, ὅτι αὐτὸς ἦν ὁ & καθήμενος

“they recognized him, that he was the one sitting”

Alternate translation: [they realized that he was the man who had been sitting]

Acts 3:10 (#5)

ἐπλήσθησαν θάμβους καὶ ἐκστάσεως ἐπὶ τῷ συμβεβηκότι αὐτῷ

“they were filled with wonder and amazement at what had happened to him”

Luke is speaking as if the people were containers that these responses could fill. Alternate translation: [what had happened to him made them completely amazed]

See: Metaphor

Acts 3:10 (#3)

ἐπλήσθησαν θάμβους καὶ ἐκστάσεως ἐπὶ τῷ συμβεβηκότι αὐτῷ

“they were filled with wonder and amazement at what had happened to him”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [what had happened to him filled them with wonder and amazement]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 3:10 (#6)

ἐπλήσθησαν θάμβους καὶ ἐκστάσεως ἐπὶ τῷ συμβεβηκότι αὐτῷ

“they were filled with wonder and amazement at what had happened to him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **wonder** and **amazement**, you could express the same idea with verbs. Alternate translation: [they wondered and marveled greatly at what had happened to him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 3:10 (#4)

ἐπλήσθησαν θάμβους καὶ ἐκστάσεως ἐπὶ τῷ συμβεβηκότι αὐτῷ

“they were filled with wonder and amazement at what had happened to him”

The words **wonder** and **amazement** mean similar things. Luke is using them together for emphasis. You can combine the words in your translation if that might be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [what had happened to him filled them with complete amazement]

See: Doublet

Acts 3:11 (#2)

τῇ στοᾷ τῇ καλουμένῃ Σολομῶντος

"the porch that is called Solomon's"

This is the name of a covered walkway in the Jerusalem temple courtyard. It consisted of rows of pillars that supported a roof. People had named this porch after King Solomon. Alternate translation: [Solomon's Porch]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 3:11 (#1)

πᾶς ὁ λαὸς

"all the people"

The word **all** is a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [the crowd that was there]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 3:11 (#3)

τῇ καλουμένῃ

"that is called"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [that people call] or [whose name is]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 3:12 (#2)

τί θαυμάζετε ἐπὶ τούτῳ

"why do you marvel at this"

Peter does not expect the crowd to tell him why they are marveling. He is using the question form for emphasis. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [you should not marvel at this!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 3:12 (#4)

ἡμῖν & ἰδίᾳ

"at us & our own"

By **us** and **our own**, Peter means himself and John but not also the people in the crowd. So use the exclusive forms of **us** and **our** in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 3:12 (#5)

ἰδίᾳ δυνάμει ἢ εὐσεβείᾳ

"by our own power or godliness"

Peter may be expressing a single idea by using two words connected with **or**. The term **godliness** describes what the crowd may consider the source or nature of the **power** that he and John have. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [by our own godly power]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 3:12 (#3)

ἢ ἡμῖν τί ἀτενίζετε, ὡς ἰδίᾳ δυνάμει ἢ εὐσεβείᾳ πεποιηκόσιν τοῦ περιπατεῖν αὐτόν

"Or why do you look intently at us, as if we have made him to walk by our own power or godliness"

Peter is using the question form for emphasis. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Do not stare at us. We did not make him walk by our own power or godliness!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 3:12 (#1)

ἄνδρες, Ἰσραηλεῖται

"Men, Israelites"

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [My fellow Israelites]

See: Idiom

Acts 3:13 (#2)

τῶν πατέρων ἡμῶν

"of our fathers"

Peter is using the term **fathers** to mean "ancestors." Alternate translation: [of our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 3:13 (#6)

κατὰ πρόσωπον Πειλάτου

“before the face of Pilate”

Here the phrase **before the face of** means “in the presence of.” Alternate translation: [in the presence of Pilate]

See: Idiom

Acts 3:13 (#3)

τῶν πατέρων ἡμῶν

“of our fathers”

The term **fathers** could mean: (1) in a generic sense that includes both men and women, the ancestors of the Israelites. If you decide to retain this metaphor in your translation, you could state “fathers and mothers” to indicate this. (2) Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. In that case, Peter would be repeating the meaning of the previous phrase, and the term would have a masculine meaning. Alternate translation: [of the patriarchs]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 3:13 (#4)

τὸν παῖδα αὐτοῦ, Ἰησοῦν

“his Servant Jesus”

See the discussion of the term **Servant** in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [Jesus his Messiah]

Acts 3:13 (#5)

παρεδώκατε

“delivered up”

Alternate translation: [handed over for trial]

Acts 3:13 (#1)

Ἀβραὰμ & Ἰσαὰκ & Ἰακώβ

“of Abraham & of Isaac & of Jacob”

These are the names of three men.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 3:13 (#7)

κρίναντος ἐκείνου ἀπολύειν

“when that one had decided to release him”

Peter is using the demonstrative adjective **that** as a noun to refer to a certain person, Pilate. (ULT adds **one** to indicate that.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could indicate specifically whom Peter means. Alternate translation: [when Pilate had decided to release him]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 3:14 (#3)

τὸν Ἅγιον καὶ Δίκαιον

“the Holy and Righteous One”

The terms **Holy** and **Righteous** mean similar things. Peter is using the two terms together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [the Supremely Holy One] or [Jesus, who was supremely holy]

See: Doublet

Acts 3:14 (#2)

τὸν Ἅγιον καὶ Δίκαιον

“the Holy and Righteous One”

Peter is using both the adjective **Holy** and the adjective **Righteous** to indicate a certain person, Jesus. (ULT adds **One** to indicate that.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could indicate specifically whom Peter means. Alternate translation: [Jesus, who was holy and righteous]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 3:14 (#1)

δὲ

“But”

Peter uses this word to introduce a contrast between what Pilate wanted to do and what these people demanded he do instead. Alternate translation: [Even though Pilate wanted to release Jesus,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Acts 3:14 (#4)

τὸν Ἅγιον καὶ Δίκαιον

“the Holy and Righteous One”

This description of Jesus is an implicit assertion that he is the Messiah. Alternate translation: [Jesus, the Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 3:14 (#5)

ᾐτήσασθε ἄνδρα, φονέα χαρισθῆναι ὑμῖν

“asked for a man, a murderer, to be granted to you”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [asked Pilate to release to you a man who was a murderer]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 3:15 (#3)

ἐκ νεκρῶν

“from the dead”

Peter is using the adjective **dead** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [from among those who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 3:15 (#5)

ἡμεῖς

“we”

If you conclude that Peter is referring only to himself and John, and if your language uses dual forms, use the dual form of the pronoun **we** here, since it would apply to two people.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 3:15 (#2)

τὸν & Ἀρχηγὸν τῆς ζωῆς

“the Originator of Life”

Peter is using the expression **the Originator of Life** as another title for Jesus. This expression could be a reference to the way Jesus, as the Son of God, took part in the original creation of all life. It could also be a reference to the way Jesus gives spiritual life to all who believe in him. Or it could mean both things. In any event, Peter is drawing a contrast between the life-giving Jesus whom the people rejected and the life-taking murderer whom they asked Pilate to release. It may be best in your translation to bring out this contrast while leaving the specific meaning open. Alternate translation: [Jesus, who gives life rather than taking it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 3:15 (#4)

ἡμεῖς

“we”

Peter is speaking at least of himself and John, and perhaps also of the other apostles, but not of the people he is addressing. So use the exclusive form of **we** in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Other languages may have other ways of indicating that **we** is exclusive here. Alternate translation: [we and the other apostles whom Jesus chose]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 3:15 (#1)

ἀπεκτείνατε

“you killed”

It was the Romans who literally killed Jesus, but Peter says that the Jewish people in the crowd killed him because their demands led to his death. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:23. Alternate translation: [you demanded the death of]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 3:16 (#4)

ἡ πίστις ἡ δι’ αὐτοῦ, ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ

“the faith that {is} through him has given to him”

The first instance of the pronoun **him** refers to Jesus, and the second instance refers to the man who had been lame. Alternate translation: [the faith that is through Jesus has given to this man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 3:16 (#2)

τοῦ ὀνόματος αὐτοῦ & τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ

“in his name & his name”

The pronoun **his** refers to Jesus in both of these instances. Alternate translation: [in the name of Jesus ... that name]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 3:16 (#5)

ἡ πίστις ἡ δι’ αὐτοῦ, ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ τὴν ὁλοκληρίαν ταύτην

“the faith that {is} through him has given to him this complete health”

Peter is speaking of **faith** as if it were a living thing that could have given **complete health** to the man. Alternate translation: [because this man had faith in Jesus, Jesus has given him this complete health]

See: Personification

Acts 3:16 (#1)

ἐπὶ τῇ πίστει τοῦ ὀνόματος αὐτοῦ, τοῦτον ὃν θεωρεῖτε καὶ οἴδατε, ἐστερέωσεν τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ

“by faith in his name, this one whom you see and know, his name has made strong”

Your language might naturally present the phrases in this sentence in a different order. Alternate translation: [this man whom you see and know had faith in his name, and his name has made him strong]

See: Information Structure

Acts 3:16 (#3)

τοῦ ὀνόματος αὐτοῦ & τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ

“in his name & his name”

Peter is using the **name** of Jesus to mean his authority or power. Alternate translation: [in the authority of Jesus ... the authority of Jesus] or [in the power of Jesus ... the power of Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:17 (#1)

καὶ νῦν

“And now”

Peter uses the expression **And now** to shift the people’s attention away from the lame man so that he can speak to them directly. In your translation, use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that would be natural for this same purpose.

Acts 3:17 (#3)

κατὰ ἄγνοιαν ἐπράξατε

“you acted in ignorance”

Peter likely means that the people **acted in ignorance** of the fact that Jesus was the Messiah. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [you acted in ignorance of the fact that Jesus was the Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 3:17 (#2)

ἀδελφοί

“brothers”

Peter addresses the people as his **brothers** because they are related to him as fellow descendants of the founders of the Jewish nation. Alternate translation: [my kinsmen]

See: Metaphor

Acts 3:17 (#4)

ὥσπερ καὶ οἱ ἄρχοντες ὑμῶν

“as also your rulers”

Peter is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [and that your rulers also acted in ignorance]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 3:18 (#1)

ὁ δὲ Θεὸς ἃ προκατήγγειλεν διὰ στόματος πάντων τῶν προφητῶν, παθεῖν τὸν Χριστὸν αὐτοῦ, ἐπλήρωσεν οὕτως

“But what God foretold through the mouth of all the prophets, that his Christ would suffer, he has fulfilled thus”

Your language might naturally put first in this sentence the information that God **fulfilled** prophecies when Christ suffered. Alternate translation: [But in this way God has fulfilled what he foretold through the mouth of all the prophets, that his Christ would suffer]

See: Information Structure

Acts 3:18 (#4)

πάντων τῶν προφητῶν

“of all the prophets”

Peter is using the word **all** as a generalization. It is true that the overall witness of Old Testament prophecy is that the Messiah would come first in humility and suffering, but not every prophet spoke specifically of the sufferings of Christ. Alternate translation: [of many prophets]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 3:18 (#2)

διὰ στόματος πάντων τῶν προφητῶν

“through the mouth of all the prophets”

Since Peter is speaking of a group of people, **the prophets**, it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **mouth**. Alternate translation: [through the mouths of all the prophets]

See: Collective Nouns

Acts 3:18 (#3)

διὰ στόματος πάντων τῶν προφητῶν

“through the mouth of all the prophets”

Peter is using the **mouth** of the prophets to represent what they said by using their mouths. Alternate translation: [through what all the prophets said]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:19 (#2)

πρὸς τὸ ἐξαλειφθῆναι ὑμῶν τὰς ἁμαρτίας

“for your sins to be wiped away”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who will do the action. Alternate translation: [so that God will wipe away your sins]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 3:19 (#1)

ἐπιστρέψατε

“turn back”

Peter is speaking of his listeners as if they were traveling somewhere and had taken the wrong way and needed to **turn back** onto the right way. Alternate translation: [start obeying the Lord again]

See: Metaphor

Acts 3:19 (#3)

πρὸς τὸ ἐξαλειφθῆναι ὑμῶν τὰς ἁμαρτίας

“for your sins to be wiped away”

Peter is speaking of sins as if they would be physically **wiped away** when God forgave them. Alternate translation: [so that God will forgive your sins]

See: Metaphor

Acts 3:20 (#2)

καιροὶ ἀναψύξεως

“times of refreshment”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **refreshment**, you could express the same idea with an adjective such as “refreshing” or “restful.” Alternate translation: [refreshing times] or [restful times]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 3:20 (#3)

ἀπὸ προσώπου τοῦ Κυρίου

“from the face of the Lord”

Peter is using the term **face** to represent the presence of the Lord. Alternate translation: [from the presence of the Lord]

See: Metaphor

Acts 3:20 (#1)

ὅπως ἂν ἔλθωσιν καιροὶ ἀναψύξεως ἀπὸ προσώπου τοῦ Κυρίου

“so that times of refreshment may come from the face of the Lord”

Peter is speaking of these **times** as if they could actively **come** to his listeners on their own. Alternate translation: [so that the Lord may send you times of refreshing from his face]

See: Personification

Acts 3:20 (#4)

ἀποστείλῃ

“he may send”

Peter is referring implicitly to Christ’s coming again. Alternate translation: [he may again send]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 3:20 (#5)

τὸν προκεχειρισμένον ὑμῖν

“the one appointed for you”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the one whom he has appointed for you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 3:21 (#2)

ἄχρι χρόνων ἀποκαταστάσεως πάντων

“until the times of the restoration of all things”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **restoration**, you could express the same idea with a verb such as “restore.” Alternate translation: [until the times when God will restore all things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 3:21 (#1)

ὃν δεῖ οὐρανὸν & δέξασθαι

“whom it is necessary for heaven to receive”

Peter is speaking of **heaven** as if it were a person who has welcomed Jesus into his home. Alternate translation: [who must remain in heaven]

See: Personification

Acts 3:21 (#3)

ἀπ’ αἰῶνος

“from the age”

The expression **from the age** means that something happened a long time ago. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [long ago]

See: Idiom

Acts 3:21 (#4)

διὰ στόματος τῶν ἁγίων & αὐτοῦ προφητῶν

“through the mouth of his holy prophets”

Peter is using the **mouth** of the prophets to represent what they said by using their mouths. Alternate translation: [through what his holy prophets said]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:22 (#7)

αὐτοῦ ἀκούσεσθε κατὰ πάντα

“You will listen to him according to everything”

Here, **listen** is an idiom that means “obey.” Alternate translation: [You must obey every command that he gives you]

See: Idiom

Acts 3:22 (#2)

Κύριος, ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν

“The Lord our God”

Some ancient manuscripts read “the Lord our God.” Peter would be quoting Deuteronomy 18:15 somewhat loosely but with the same basic meaning. ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “the Lord your God.” Peter would be quoting Deuteronomy 18:15 exactly. Still other ancient manuscripts read simply “the Lord God.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it has. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 3:22 (#1)

Μωϋσῆς μὲν εἶπεν & προφήτην ὑμῖν ἀναστήσει Κύριος, ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν ἐκ τῶν ἀδελφῶν ὑμῶν, ὡς ἐμέ αὐτοῦ ἀκούσεσθε κατὰ πάντα, ὅσα ἂν λαλήσῃ πρὸς ὑμᾶς

“Moses indeed said, ‘The Lord our God will raise up for you a prophet like me from your brothers. You will listen to him according to everything—whatever he may speak to you”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Moses indeed said that the Lord our God would raise up a prophet like himself for us Israelites from among our brothers. Moses said that we were to listen to him according to everything—whatever he might speak to us]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 3:22 (#4)

ὑμῖν ἀναστήσει

“will raise up for you”

Here the expression **raise up** does not mean “bring back to life,” as it did in 2:24 and 2:32. In this context, it refers instead to God giving someone the mission to go as a prophet to certain people with a message for them. Alternate translation: [will send to you]

See: Idiom

Acts 3:22 (#5)

τῶν ἀδελφῶν ὑμῶν

“your brothers”

Moses is using the term **brothers** to mean people who are fellow descendants with his listeners of the founders of the Jewish nation. Alternate translation: [your kinsmen]

See: Metaphor

Acts 3:22 (#6)

αὐτοῦ ἀκούσεσθε κατὰ πάντα

“You will listen to him according to everything”

Moses is using a future statement to give a command. Alternate translation: [You must listen to everything he tells you]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Acts 3:22 (#3)

Κύριος, ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν

“The Lord our God”

Moses is speaking of himself and his fellow Israelites, whom he is addressing, so use the inclusive form of the word **our** in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 3:23 (#2)

πᾶσα ψυχὴ, ἥτις ἐὰν μὴ ἀκούσῃ τοῦ προφήτου ἐκείνου, ἐξολεθρευθήσεται ἐκ τοῦ λαοῦ

“every soul that does not listen to that prophet will be destroyed from the people”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who will do the action. Alternate translation: [God will destroy from the people every soul that does not listen to that prophet] or see the next note for a further possibility.

See: Active or Passive

Acts 3:23 (#1)

ἔσται δὲ πᾶσα ψυχὴ, ἥτις ἐὰν μὴ ἀκούσῃ τοῦ προφήτου ἐκείνου, ἐξολεθρευθήσεται ἐκ τοῦ λαοῦ

“But it will be that every soul that does not listen to that prophet will be destroyed from the people”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Moses also said that every soul that did not listen to that prophet would be destroyed from the people]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 3:23 (#3)

πᾶσα ψυχὴ, ἥτις ἐὰν μὴ ἀκούσῃ τοῦ προφήτου ἐκείνου, ἐξολεθρευθήσεται ἐκ τοῦ λαοῦ

“every soul that does not listen to that prophet will be destroyed from the people”

Moses could be using a future statement to give a command, in which case he would be telling the people to take this action. Alternate translation: [you must destroy from the people every soul that does not listen to that prophet]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Acts 3:23 (#5)

ἥτις ἐὰν μὴ ἀκούσῃ τοῦ προφήτου ἐκείνου

“that does not listen to that prophet”

Here, **listen** is an idiom that means “obey.” Alternate translation: [does not obey that prophet]

See: Idiom

Acts 3:23 (#4)

πᾶσα ψυχὴ, ἥτις

“every soul that”

Moses is using one part of a person, the **soul**, to mean the entire person. Alternate translation: [every person who]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 3:24 (#1)

πάντες & οἱ προφῆται

“all the prophets”

Here the phrase **all the prophets** is probably not the same kind of generalization that it seems to be in 3:18. It is true in a more literal sense that all the prophets **announced these days**. There was something in the messages of each one of them that pointed to the culmination of God’s work in the coming of Jesus. So even if your language does not use generalizations for emphasis, you could translate these words just as Peter says them.

See: Hyperbole

Acts 3:24 (#3)

τὰς ἡμέρας ταύτας

“these days”

Peter is using the word **days** to mean a specific time. Alternate translation: [this time] or [these times]

See: Idiom

Acts 3:24 (#4)

τὰς ἡμέρας ταύτας

“these days”

Peter is referring to a specific time to mean implicitly what is happening at that time. Alternate translation: [the things that are happening now]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 3:24 (#2)

ἀπὸ Σαμουὴλ καὶ τῶν καθεξῆς

“from Samuel and those after him”

Alternate translation: [beginning with Samuel and continuing with those who lived after he did]

Acts 3:25 (#8)

ἐν τῷ σπέρματί σου

“in your seed”

As the apostle Paul notes in Galatians 3:16, God used the singular form of the word **seed** when he said this to Abraham, and so the ultimate fulfillment of this promise came when God sent Jesus as the Savior for everyone in the world who would believe in him. That may also be what Peter has in view here, since he refers in the next verse to God’s “Servant,” meaning the Messiah. Alternate translation: [through the Messiah, who will be your descendant]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 3:25 (#10)

πᾶσαι αἱ πατριαὶ τῆς γῆς

“all the families of the earth”

Here, **families** refers to people groups or nations by association with the way that many of them consist of people who have a common ancestry. Alternate translation: [all the nations of the world]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:25 (#1)

ὑμεῖς ἐστε οἱ υἱοὶ τῶν προφητῶν

“You are the sons of the prophets”

Peter is using the word **sons** in the sense of “heirs,” by association with the way that children inherit from their parents. He means that the Israelites living at this time are going to receive something as a legacy from those who lived before them. Alternate translation: [You are the ones who are going to receive what the prophets promised] or [You are the ones who are going to experience what the prophets foretold]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:25 (#7)

ἐν τῷ σπέρματί σου

“in your seed”

The term **seed** means “offspring.” It is a word picture. Just as plants produce seeds that grow into many more plants, so people can have many offspring. Alternate translation: [through your descendants] or see the next note for a further possibility.

See: Metaphor

Acts 3:25 (#2)

οἱ υἱοὶ

“the sons”

Although the term **sons** is masculine, Peter is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If you retain the metaphor in your translation, you could state “the sons and daughters” to indicate this.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 3:25 (#6)

τοὺς πατέρας ὑμῶν

“your fathers”

Although the term **fathers** is masculine, Peter is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If you retain the metaphor in your translation, you could state “your fathers and mothers” to indicate this.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 3:25 (#3)

καὶ τῆς διαθήκης ἧς διέθετο ὁ Θεὸς πρὸς τοὺς πατέρας ὑμῶν

“and of the covenant that God made with your fathers”

The figurative sense of **sons** as “heirs” continues in this phrase. Alternate translation: [and who are going to receive what God promised to your fathers when he made a covenant with them]

See: Metonymy

Acts 3:25 (#5)

τοὺς πατέρας ὑμῶν

“your fathers”

Here, **fathers** means “ancestors.” Alternate translation: [your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 3:25 (#4)

πρὸς τοὺς πατέρας ὑμῶν, λέγων πρὸς Ἀβραάμ, καὶ ἐν τῷ σπέρματί σου ἐνευλογηθήσονται πᾶσαι αἱ πατριαὶ τῆς γῆς

"with your fathers, saying to Abraham, 'And in your seed will all the families of the earth be blessed"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [with your fathers when he said to Abraham that in his seed all the families of the earth would be blessed]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 3:25 (#9)

ἐνευλογηθήσονται πᾶσαι αἱ πατριαὶ τῆς γῆς

"will all the families of the earth be blessed"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [I will bless all the families of the earth]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 3:26 (#4)

τῷ ἀποστρέφειν ἕκαστον ἀπὸ τῶν πονηριῶν ὑμῶν

"turning each of you from your wickedness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **wickedness**, you could express the same idea with an adjective such as "wicked." Alternate translation: [by leading every one of you to stop doing wicked things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 3:26 (#2)

τὸν παῖδα αὐτοῦ

"his Servant"

See the discussion of the term **Servant** in the introduction to this chapter, and see how you translated that term in 3:13. Alternate translation: [his Messiah]

Acts 3:26 (#3)

τῷ ἀποστρέφειν ἕκαστον ἀπὸ τῶν πονηριῶν ὑμῶν

"turning each of you from your wickedness"

Here, **turning** someone **from** something means leading that person to stop doing that thing. See how you translated the similar expression in 3:19. Alternate translation: [by leading every one of you to repent of your wickedness]

See: Metaphor

Acts 3:26 (#1)

ἀναστήσας ὁ Θεὸς τὸν παῖδα αὐτοῦ, ἀπέστειλεν αὐτὸν

"God, having raised up his Servant, sent him"

The expression **raised up** has the same meaning here as in 3:22. See how you translated it there. Alternate translation: [When God appointed Jesus as the Messiah, he sent him]

See: Idiom

Acts - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Some translations set lines of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry that is quoted from the Old Testament in 4:25–26.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Unity

The first Christians wanted very much to be united. They wanted to believe the same things and share everything they owned and help those who needed help.

"Signs and wonders"

This phrase refers to things that only God can do. The Christians wanted God to do what only he could do so that people would believe that what they said about Jesus was true.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

The "head of the corner" or cornerstone (4:11)

The cornerstone was the first piece of stone that people put down when they were building a building out of stone. Peter refers to it as the "head of the corner" in 4:11. This is a metaphor for the most important part of something, the part on which everything else depends. To say that Jesus is the cornerstone of the church is to say that nothing in the church is more important than Jesus and that everything in the church depends on Jesus. (See: Metaphor; and faith)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"no other name" (4:12)

"There is no other name under heaven given among men by which we must be saved" (Acts 4:12). As a note to this verse explains, in this expression the term "name" represents a person. So with these words, Peter was saying that no other person who has ever

been on the earth or who will ever be on earth can save people. This statement might cause some controversy in some places today, but it is an essential part of the Christian message, and it should be translated so that its meaning is clear.

Acts 4:1 (#1)

λαλούντων & αὐτῶν

"as they were speaking"

The pronoun **they** refers to Peter and John. Alternate translation: [as Peter and John were speaking]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:1 (#2)

ὁ στρατηγὸς τοῦ ἱεροῦ

"the captain of the temple"

The temple had its own guards, and this man was their commanding officer. Alternate translation: [the commander of the temple guard]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:1 (#3)

οἱ Σαδδουκαῖοι

"the Sadducees"

The Sadducees would have been particularly upset that Peter and John were saying that God raised Jesus from the dead, because they did not believe in the resurrection. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain that explicitly here. Alternate translation: [the Sadducees, who do not believe in the resurrection,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:1 (#4)

οἱ Σαδδουκαῖοι

"the Sadducees"

Luke is using the name of the whole group to mean some of its members. Alternate translation: [some of the Sadducees]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 4:2 (#1)

διαπονούμενοι διὰ τὸ διδάσκειν αὐτοὺς

"greatly troubled because they were teaching"

The pronoun **they** refers to Peter and John. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [These men were greatly troubled because Peter and John were teaching]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:2 (#3)

τὴν ἐκ νεκρῶν

"that {is} from the dead"

Peter is using the adjective **dead** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [from among those who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 4:2 (#2)

καταγγέλλειν ἐν τῷ Ἰησοῦ τὴν ἀνάστασιν, τὴν ἐκ νεκρῶν

"proclaiming in Jesus the resurrection that {is} from the dead"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **resurrection**, you could express the same idea with an equivalent phrase. Peter and John were saying that God would raise people from the dead in the same way that he had raised Jesus. Translate this in a way that allows **the resurrection** to refer to both Jesus' resurrection and the general resurrection of other people. Alternate translation: [proclaiming that God makes people alive again who have died, just as God had done for Jesus]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 4:3 (#4)

ἔθεντο εἰς τήρησιν

"put them in custody"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **custody**, you could express the same idea with a verb such as "imprison." Alternate translation: [they imprisoned them]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 4:3 (#5)

ἦν γὰρ ἑσπέρα ἤδη

"since it was already evening"

The implication is that the ruling council, which Luke describes in 4:5–6, would not meet to question anyone

at night. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [since it was already evening and the council would not meet to question them at night]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:3 (#2)

ἐπέβαλον αὐτοῖς τὰς χεῖρας

"they laid hands on them"

The pronoun **they** refers to the priests, the captain of the temple, and the Sadducees. The pronoun **them** refers to Peter and John. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the priests, the captain of the temple, and the Sadducees laid hands on Peter and John] or [the men who had come up to Peter and John laid hands on them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:3 (#1)

καὶ

"And"

Luke is using the word translated as **And** to introduce what the men who came up to Peter and John did because they were so troubled by their teaching. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 4:3 (#3)

ἐπέβαλον αὐτοῖς τὰς χεῖρας

"they laid hands on them"

The expression **laid hands on** means to arrest someone by association with the way that arresting officers might physically take hold of a person with their **hands**. Alternate translation: [they arrested them]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:4 (#4)

ἐγενήθη & ὡς χιλιάδες πέντε

"became about 5,000"

The word translated as **became** could mean: (1) the community of believers in Jesus grew to a total of 5,000 as a result of the professions of faith on this day. Alternate translation: [in the community of believers grew to about 5,000]; (2) "was," and that would indicate that 5,000 men made professions of faith on this day. Alternate translation: [who put their faith in Jesus that day was about 5,000]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:4 (#3)

ἀριθμὸς τῶν ἀνδρῶν

"the number of the men"

Luke is not using the word **men** in a generic sense here. The figure of 5,000 is the number of the men alone. It does not include women and children. So it would not be accurate to translate **men** as "people." Instead, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this distinction explicitly. Alternate translation: [the number of the men alone, not counting the women and children,]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 4:4 (#1)

δὲ

"But"

Luke uses the word **But** to introduce information about what happened after this much of the story as a result of the events within the story itself. This is not the end of the whole story, but it is the end of a significant part of it. Your language may have its own way of indicating how such information relates to a significant part of a story.

See: End of Story

Acts 4:4 (#2)

τὸν λόγον

"the word"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that Peter and John shared by using words. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:5 (#4)

συναχθῆναι

"were gathered together"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [gathered together]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:5 (#1)

ἐγένετο δὲ

“And it happened that”

Luke uses this phrase to introduce a significant development in this story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for this purpose.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 4:5 (#2)

συναχθῆναι αὐτῶν τοὺς ἄρχοντας, καὶ τοὺς πρεσβυτέρους, καὶ τοὺς γραμματεῖς

“their rulers and elders and scribes were gathered together”

Luke is implicitly describing the Sanhedrin, the Jewish ruling council, which consisted of these three groups of people. Luke describes this council explicitly as “the Sanhedrin” in 4:15. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could identify it by name here. Alternate translation: [the Sanhedrin, consisting of their rulers and elders and scribes, was gathered together]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:5 (#3)

αὐτῶν τοὺς ἄρχοντας, καὶ τοὺς πρεσβυτέρους, καὶ τοὺς γραμματεῖς

“their rulers and elders and scribes”

The pronoun **their** refers to the Jewish people. Alternate translation: [the rulers and elders and scribes of the Jewish people]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:6 (#1)

Ἅννας ὁ ἀρχιερεὺς, καὶ Καϊάφας

“Annas the high priest, and Caiaphas”

Luke describes Annas as **the high priest**, but the actual situation was complicated. At this time the Romans were appointing the high priests for Judea. One Roman official had appointed Annas some years earlier, but ten years after that, another official deposed him and named his son-in-law Caiaphas high priest instead. However, the Jews still recognized Annas’ claim to the position. If you decide to clarify this for your readers, it would probably be best to state the matter as simply as possible. Alternate translation: [Annas, whom the Jews recognized as the high priest, and Caiaphas, whom a Roman official had appointed as the high priest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:6 (#2)

Ἅννας & Καϊάφας & Ἰωάννης & Ἀλέξανδρος

“Annas & Caiaphas & John & Alexander”

These are the names of four men. The **John** mentioned here was a member of the high priest’s family. This is not the same John as the apostle.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 4:6 (#3)

ὅσοι ἦσαν ἐκ γένους ἀρχιερατικοῦ

“as many as were from the high priestly family”

Alternate translation: [all the other members of the high priestly family who were members of the council]

Acts 4:7 (#1)

στήσαντες αὐτοὺς ἐν τῷ μέσῳ, ἐπυνθάνοντο

“having set them in {their} midst, they asked them”

The pronoun **them** refers to Peter and John, and the pronouns **their** and **they** refer to the council members. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when the council members had set Peter and John in their midst, the members asked them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:7 (#2)

ἐν ποίᾳ δυνάμει ἢ ἐν ποίῳ ὀνόματι ἐποιήσατε τοῦτο ὑμεῖς

“By what power or in what name have you done this”

The words **power** and **name** (meaning authority; see next note) mean similar things. The council members may be using them together to ask a comprehensive or emphatic question. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine these terms in your translation. Alternate translation: [By whatever means were you able to do this?]

See: Doublet

Acts 4:7 (#3)

ἐν ποίῳ ὀνόματι

“in what name”

Here, **name** refers to authority. Alternate translation: [by what authority]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:7 (#4)

ὑμεῖς

“you”

Since the council members are speaking to two men, **you** would be dual if your language uses that form. (All other pronouns in this account that refer to Peter and John would also be dual, such as **them** in its two instances in this verse.)

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Dual/Plural

Acts 4:8 (#4)

τοῦ λαοῦ

“of the people”

Here, **the people** means specifically the people of Israel. Alternate translation: [of the people of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:8 (#3)

ἄρχοντες τοῦ λαοῦ καὶ πρεσβύτεροι

“Rulers of the people and elders”

Peter is addressing the entire council by referring to its two components. Some of the members had ruling responsibilities. Others, the **elders**, were added to the council to bring its total membership up to 70, since according to Exodus 24:1, that was the number of elders who accompanied Moses when God confirmed the covenant with Israel at Mount Sinai. Alternate translation: [You members of the Sanhedrin]

See: Merism

Acts 4:8 (#2)

Πέτρος πλησθεὶς Πνεύματος Ἁγίου, εἶπεν

“Peter, filled with the Holy Spirit, said”

Luke is speaking of Peter as if he were a container that the Holy Spirit **filled**. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit inspired Peter and he said]

See: Metaphor

Acts 4:8 (#1)

Πέτρος πλησθεὶς Πνεύματος Ἁγίου, εἶπεν

“Peter, filled with the Holy Spirit, said”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. See how you translated the comparable expression in 2:4. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit filled Peter and he said]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:9 (#1)

εἰ ἡμεῖς σήμερον ἀνακρινόμεθα ἐπὶ εὐεργεσίᾳ ἀνθρώπου ἀσθενοῦς, ἐν τίνι οὗτος σέσωσται

“if we are being questioned today concerning a good deed to a sick man, by what means he was made well”

Peter is not suggesting seriously that the subject of the questioning is uncertain. He knows the subject, but he is suggesting ironically that it is uncertain so that he can describe it from his own perspective. The council asked by what power or authority he and John did “this,” implying that “this” was something bad, a public disturbance that troubled the authorities. In response, Peter asserts that “this” was instead something good, **a good deed to a sick man**. If it would be helpful to your readers, in your translation you could indicate the meaning that Peter is communicating through this irony. Alternate translation: [what we actually did was a good deed for a sick man, and if you want to know by what means he was made well]

See: Irony

Acts 4:9 (#2)

ἡμεῖς & ἀνακρινόμεθα

“we are being questioned”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [you are questioning us]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:9 (#3)

οὗτος σέσωσται

“he was made well”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [he became healthy]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:10 (#8)

ἐκ νεκρῶν

“from the dead”

Peter is using the adjective **dead** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate

this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [from among those who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 4:10 (#2)

γνωστὸν ἔστω πᾶσιν ὑμῖν καὶ παντὶ τῷ λαῷ Ἰσραὴλ

"let it be known to you all and to all the people of Israel"

The word translated as **known** is an adjective, so this is not a passive verbal form. However, if your language does not use passive forms, it might be clearer for your readers if you use an expression that does not seem to be a passive verbal form. The adjective **known** expresses the result of action by a different agent, so you can use an active form with that agent as the subject. Alternate translation: [you and all the people of Israel, know]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:10 (#5)

Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ Ναζωραίου

"of Jesus Christ the Nazarene"

See how you translated this in 2:22 and 3:6. Alternate translation: [of Jesus Christ of Nazareth]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 4:10 (#1)

γνωστὸν ἔστω πᾶσιν ὑμῖν καὶ παντὶ τῷ λαῷ Ἰσραὴλ

"let it be known to you all and to all the people of Israel"

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may this be known to you and to all the people of Israel] or [this should be known to you and to all the people of Israel]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 4:10 (#3)

πᾶσιν ὑμῖν

"to you all"

The pronoun **you** refers to the council members. Alternate translation: [to all of you council members] or [to all of you who are questioning us]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:10 (#4)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι

"in the name"

Here, **name** refers to power and authority. Alternate translation: [through the power] or [by the authority]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:10 (#6)

ὃν ὑμεῖς ἐσταυρώσατε

"whom you crucified"

It was the Romans who literally crucified Jesus, but Peter says that these Jewish leaders crucified him because their demands led to his death. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:23. Alternate translation: [whom you demanded to be crucified]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 4:10 (#7)

ὃν ὁ Θεὸς ἤγειρεν ἐκ νεκρῶν

"whom God raised from the dead"

As in 2:24, the idiom **raised up** means that God made Jesus alive again after he died. Alternate translation: [whom God made alive again after he died]

See: Idiom

Acts 4:11 (#4)

εἰς κεφαλὴν γωνίας

"the head of the corner"

The phrase **the head of the corner** is an idiom that refers to a large stone with straight edges that builders would place down first and use as a reference to make sure that the walls of a stone building were straight and that the building was oriented in the right direction. Your language may have its own term for such a stone. You could also use a general expression. Alternate translation: [the cornerstone] or [the reference stone for the whole building]

See: Idiom

Acts 4:11 (#1)

οὗτός

"He"

The pronoun **He** refers to Jesus. Alternate translation: [Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:11 (#3)

ὁ ἐξουθενηθεὶς ὑφ' ὑμῶν, τῶν οἰκοδόμων

"that was rejected by you, the builders"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [that you, the builders, rejected]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:11 (#2)

ὁ λίθος ὁ ἐξουθενηθεὶς ὑφ' ὑμῶν, τῶν οἰκοδόμων, ὁ γενόμενος εἰς κεφαλὴν γωνίας

"the stone that was rejected by you, the builders, which has become the head of the corner"

Peter is quoting from Psalm 118:22, and the quotation contains a metaphor. This psalm is describing the Messiah as if he were a stone that builders chose not to use. This means that people will reject him. When the psalm says that this stone became the cornerstone, this means that God will nevertheless make the Messiah the ruler of these people. However, since this is a quotation from Scripture, we recommend that you translate the words directly rather than providing a non-figurative explanation of them, even if your language does not customarily use such figures of speech. If you want to explain the meaning of the metaphor, we recommend that you do that in a footnote rather than in the Bible text.

See: Metaphor

Acts 4:12 (#8)

ἡμᾶς

"we"

Peter is using the word **we** to refer to himself and his listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 4:12 (#7)

ἐν ᾧ δεῖ σωθῆναι ἡμᾶς

"by which we must be saved"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [that can save us] or, if you translate [name] as "person," [who can save us]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:12 (#2)

οὐκ ἔστιν ἐν ἄλλῳ οὐδενὶ ἡ σωτηρία

"there is no salvation in anyone else"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **salvation**, you could express the same idea with a verb such as "save." Alternate translation: [he is the only one who is able to save]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 4:12 (#6)

ἐν ἀνθρώποις

"among men"

Peter is using the term **men** in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [among people] or [to people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 4:12 (#4)

οὐδὲ & ὄνομά ἐστιν ἕτερον & ἐν ᾧ δεῖ σωθῆναι ἡμᾶς

"there is no other name & by which we must be saved"

Here, **name** represents a person by association with the way that each person has a name. Alternate translation: [there is no other person ... by whom we must be saved]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:12 (#5)

ὑπὸ τὸν οὐρανὸν

"under heaven"

This is an idiom. See how you translated it in 2:5. Alternate translation: [on earth]

See: Idiom

Acts 4:12 (#1)

οὐκ ἔστιν ἐν ἄλλῳ οὐδενὶ ἡ σωτηρία

"there is no salvation in anyone else"

In Greek this is a double negative for emphasis, "there is no salvation in no one else." The second negative does not cancel the first to create a positive meaning. If for emphasis your language uses double negatives that do not cancel one another, it would be appropriate to use that construction here. You could also state the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [he is the only one in whom there is salvation]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 4:12 (#3)

οὐδὲ & ὄνομά ἐστιν ἕτερον ὑπὸ τὸν οὐρανὸν τὸ δεδομένον

“there is no other name under heaven given”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [God has not given any other name under heaven]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:13 (#3)

καταλαβόμενοι

“realizing”

The implication is that the Jewish leaders realized this because of the way Peter and John spoke. Alternate translation: [realizing from the way they spoke]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:13 (#2)

τὴν τοῦ Πέτρου παρρησίαν καὶ Ἰωάννου

“the boldness of Peter and John”

Here the abstract noun **boldness** refers to the way in which Peter and John responded to the Jewish leaders. If your language does not use an abstract noun for this idea, you could express the same idea with an adverb or an adjective. Alternate translation: [how boldly Peter and John had spoken] or [how bold Peter and John were]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 4:13 (#1)

θεωροῦντες

“seeing”

Luke is using the word **seeing** to mean that the council members noticed this and found it significant. Alternate translation: [taking note of] or [impressed with]

See: Idiom

Acts 4:13 (#4)

ἐθαύμαζον; ἐπεγίνωσκόν τε αὐτοὺς, ὅτι σὺν τῷ Ἰησοῦ ἦσαν

“they marveled, and they recognized them, that they had been with Jesus”

Here the pronoun **they** refers in its first two instances to the council members, and in its third instance it refers to Peter and John, as does the pronoun **them**. It may be helpful to your readers to clarify this and to state the meaning here more concisely. Alternate translation: [the council members marveled, and they recognized that Peter and John had been with Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:13 (#5)

ἄνθρωποι ἀγράμματοί εἰσιν καὶ ἰδιῶται

“they were uneducated and ordinary men”

The words **uneducated** and **ordinary** mean similar things. Both words indicate that Peter and John had no formal education. Luke uses them together for emphasis, to express from the council members’ perspective how amazed they were. Alternate translation: [they had no formal education at all]

See: Doublet

Acts 4:14 (#3)

οὐδὲν εἶχον ἀντειπεῖν

“they had nothing to say in opposition”

The implication is that anything the council members said **in opposition** would have been in an attempt to discredit the claim that the man had been healed in the name of Jesus. But there was nothing they could say, since the evidence that the claim was true was right in front of them in the person of the formerly lame man standing on his own. Alternate translation: [they had nothing to say to discredit the account]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:14 (#1)

τόν & ἄνθρωπον & τὸν τεθεραπευμένον

“the man who had been healed”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the man whom Peter and John had healed]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:14 (#2)

σὺν αὐτοῖς ἑστῶτα, τὸν τεθεραπευμένον, οὐδὲν εἶχον

“who had been healed standing with them, they had nothing”

The pronoun **them** refers to Peter and John, and the pronoun **they** refers to the council members. It may

be helpful to your readers to clarify this. Alternate translation: [standing with Peter and John, the council members had nothing]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:15 (#2)

τοῦ Συνεδρίου

"the Sanhedrin"

Luke is using the name of the Jewish ruling council to mean the meeting place of that council. Alternate translation: [the place where the Sanhedrin met] or [the council chamber]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:15 (#1)

κελεύσαντες & αὐτοὺς ἔξω τοῦ Συνεδρίου ἀπελθεῖν, συνέβαλλον πρὸς ἀλλήλους

"having commanded them to go outside the Sanhedrin, they conferred among themselves"

The pronoun **them** refers at least to Peter and John, and probably also to the man who was healed, while the pronoun **they** refers to the council members. It may be helpful to your readers to clarify this. Alternate translation: [having commanded Peter and John and the man who was healed to go outside the Sanhedrin, the council members conferred among themselves]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:16 (#1)

τί ποιήσωμεν τοῖς ἀνθρώποις τούτοις

"What should we do to these men"

This could mean: (1) the Jewish leaders were using the question form to express their frustration because they realize that they cannot punish Peter and John. As 4:21 indicates explicitly, and as the leaders suggest here, they are afraid of how the people might respond if they do. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It is very difficult to know what we should do to these men!]; (2) the leaders were asking one another a genuine question, because ultimately they do decide to do something to Peter and John. They warn them not to speak or teach in the name of Jesus, with an implied threat of punishment if they do. In that case it would be accurate to translate this as a question.

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 4:16 (#3)

γνωστὸν σημεῖον

"a notable sign"

Here the word **sign** has the same sense that it has in the phrase "wonders and signs" in 2:22 and 2:43. It means a miracle. Alternate translation: [a remarkable miracle]

Acts 4:16 (#2)

πᾶσιν τοῖς κατοικοῦσιν Ἰερουσαλὴμ

"to everyone living in Jerusalem"

This is a generalization that the leaders are making to emphasize how widely the news of the healing has spread. Alternate translation: [people who live throughout Jerusalem]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 4:17 (#5)

μηκέτι λαλεῖν ἐπὶ τῷ ὀνόματι τούτῳ μηδενὶ ἀνθρώπων

"no longer to speak in this name to any of men"

In Greek this is a double negative for emphasis, "no longer to speak in this name to none of men." The second negative does not cancel the first to create a positive meaning. If for emphasis your language uses double negatives that do not cancel one another, it would be appropriate to use that construction here. You could also state the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [to stop speaking in this name to any of men]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 4:17 (#2)

ἵνα μὴ ἐπὶ πλεῖον διανεμηθῇ

"so that it may not be spread unto more"

By **it**, the council members do not mean the news of the man's healing, since they have already said that everyone in Jerusalem knows about it. They mean the teaching that Jesus is Messiah, since they then try to prevent this from spreading by not allowing the apostles to speak to anyone about Jesus. Alternate translation: [so that this teaching about Jesus does not spread]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:17 (#4)

λαλεῖν ἐπὶ τῷ ὀνόματι τούτῳ

“to speak in this name”

Here, **name** represents a person by association with the way that each person has a name. Alternate translation: [to speak about this person Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:17 (#6)

μηδενὶ ἀνθρώπων

“to any of men”

Here, **men** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [to any person] or [to anyone]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 4:17 (#1)

ἵνα μὴ ἐπὶ πλεῖον διανεμηθῇ

“so that it may not be spread unto more”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [so that it does not spread] or [so that they will not spread it]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:17 (#3)

ἐπὶ πλεῖον

“unto more”

Alternate translation: [any further]

Acts 4:18 (#1)

καὶ

“And”

Luke uses the word translated as **And** to introduce what the council members did as a result of their discussion. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 4:18 (#2)

καλέσαντες αὐτοὺς, παρήγγειλαν

“summoning them, they commanded them”

The pronoun **them** refers in both instances to Peter and John, and the pronoun **they** refers to the council members. It may be helpful to your readers to clarify this. Alternate translation: [summoning Peter and John, the council members commanded them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:18 (#4)

ἐπὶ τῷ ὀνόματι τοῦ Ἰησοῦ

“in the name of Jesus”

Here, **name** represents a person by association with the way that each person has a name. Alternate translation: [about this person Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:18 (#3)

μὴ φθέγγεσθαι μηδὲ διδάσκειν

“neither to speak nor to teach”

The words **speak** and **teach** mean similar things. The council members may be using them together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [not to say anything publicly]

See: Doublet

Acts 4:19 (#4)

ὑμῶν ἀκούειν μᾶλλον ἢ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“to listen to you rather than to God”

Here, **listen** is an idiom that means “obey.” Alternate translation: [to obey you rather than God]

See: Idiom

Acts 4:19 (#1)

ὁ & Πέτρος καὶ Ἰωάννης ἀποκριθέντες εἶπον

“answering, Peter and John said”

Together the words **answering** and **said** mean that Peter and John responded to the council. Alternate translation: [Peter and John responded]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 4:19 (#3)

εἰ δίκαιόν ἐστιν ἐνώπιον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“Whether it is right before God”

Here the phrase **before God** refers to God’s opinion by association with the way that God would assess anything that came to his attention in front of him. Alternate translation: [Whether God thinks it is right]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:19 (#2)

ὁ & Πέτρος καὶ Ἰωάννης ἀποκριθέντες εἶπον

“answering, Peter and John said”

This could mean: (1) Peter and John each said different parts of the quotation in 4:19–20. (2) Peter spoke these words on behalf of both of them, since the Holy Spirit had inspired him to speak to the council in 4:8–12. Alternate translation: [Peter responded on their behalf]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:20 (#1)

γὰρ

"For"

Peter and John are using the word **For** to introduce the reason why the council needs to judge whether it would be right for them to obey the council rather than God. Alternate translation: [The reason why you must judge whom we should obey is that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 4:20 (#2)

ἡμεῖς & εἴδαμεν καὶ ἠκούσαμεν

"we & we have seen and heard"

Peter and John are using the word **we** to refer to themselves but not to their listeners, so use the exclusive form of the word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 4:20 (#3)

οὐ δυνάμεθα & ἡμεῖς & μὴ λαλεῖν

"we are not able not to speak"

You could state the meaning of this double negative positively. Alternate translation: [we must speak]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 4:21 (#1)

οἱ δὲ προσαπειλησάμενοι ἀπέλυσαν αὐτούς

"So, having warned them further, they released them"

The pronoun **them** refers in both instances to Peter and John, and the pronoun **they** refers to the council members. It may be helpful to your readers to clarify this. Alternate translation: [having warned Peter and John further, the council members released them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:21 (#2)

διὰ τὸν λαόν

"on account of the people"

The implication is that the Jewish leaders were afraid that the people would riot if they punished Peter and John. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [They were afraid that if they did punish Peter and John, the people would riot]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:21 (#3)

πάντες ἐδόξαζον τὸν Θεὸν

"they were all glorifying God"

Here, **all** is a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [large numbers of them were glorifying God]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 4:22 (#3)

ὁ ἄνθρωπος, ἐφ' ὃν γεγόνει τὸ σημεῖον τοῦτο τῆς ἰάσεως

"the man to whom this sign of healing had happened"

Luke is speaking as if the **healing** had **happened** on its own. Alternate translation: [the man whom Peter and John had miraculously healed]

See: Personification

Acts 4:22 (#4)

τὸ σημεῖον τοῦτο τῆς ἰάσεως

"this sign of healing"

Luke is using the possessive form to describe a **sign** that consisted of a **healing**. The word **sign** has the same sense here that it has in the phrase "wonders and signs" in 2:22 and 2:43. It means a miracle. Alternate translation: [this miraculous healing]

See: Possession

Acts 4:22 (#1)

ἐτῶν γὰρ ἦν πλειόνων τεσσεράκοντα ὁ ἄνθρωπος, ἐφ' ὃν γεγόνει τὸ σημεῖον τοῦτο τῆς ἰάσεως

"For the man to whom this sign of healing had happened was more than 40 years old"

In this verse, Luke provides background information about the age of the man who was healed to help readers understand why the people considered his

healing such a remarkable miracle. In your translation, present this background information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 4:22 (#2)

γὰρ

“For”

Luke is using the word **For** to introduce the reason why the people were glorifying God. Alternate translation: [The people were glorifying God because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 4:23 (#2)

ἦλθον πρὸς τοὺς ἰδίους

“they came to {their} own people”

In a context such as this, your language might say “went” instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [they went to their own people]

See: Go and Come

Acts 4:23 (#4)

οἱ ἀρχιερεῖς καὶ οἱ πρεσβύτεροι

“the chief priests and the elders”

As Peter does in 4:8, here Luke is referring to the entire council by naming its two components. Alternate translation: [the members of the Sanhedrin]

See: Merism

Acts 4:23 (#1)

ἀπολυθέντες

“having been released”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who did the action. Alternate translation: [after the council members had released Peter and John]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:23 (#3)

τοὺς ἰδίους

“their} own people”

The phrase **their own people** refers to the community of believers in Jesus. Alternate translation: [the other believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:24 (#2)

ἦραν φωνὴν

“raised their voice”

Since Luke is referring to a group of people, it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **voice**. Alternate translation: [they raised their voices]

See: Collective Nouns

Acts 4:24 (#5)

σὺ

“you {are”

The word **you** is singular, and it refers to God. The same is true of the words “you” and “your” in 4:25–30. You may have decided to use a formal form of “you” in your translation in such cases.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Formal or Informal

Acts 4:24 (#1)

οἱ & ἀκούσαντες & ἦραν

“having heard, they raised”

The phrase **having heard** refers to the other believers, but the pronoun **they** seems to include Peter and John as well, since those who pray ask for boldness to keep speaking the message about Jesus (4:29). It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when the other believers heard this report, together with Peter and John they raised]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:24 (#4)

ὁμοθυμαδὸν

“unanimously”

The word **unanimously** indicates that the apostles and other believers shared a common commitment and purpose and that there was no strife among them. See how you translated the same expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [with one accord] or [harmoniously]

Acts 4:24 (#7)

τὸν οὐρανὸν

“the heaven”

The believers are using the word translated as **heaven** in one of its specific senses to mean the sky. Alternate translation: [the sky]

Acts 4:24 (#6)

ποιήσας τὸν οὐρανὸν, καὶ τὴν γῆν, καὶ τὴν θάλασσαν, καὶ πάντα τὰ ἐν αὐτοῖς

“having made the heaven and the earth and the sea and all that {is} in them”

The believers are referring to all of creation by naming its components. Alternate translation: [who created everything that exists]

See: Merism

Acts 4:24 (#3)

ἦραν φωνὴν

“raised their voice”

The expression **they raised their voice** is an idiom that means they spoke loudly. Alternate translation: [they prayed loudly] or [they prayed out loud]

See: Idiom

Acts 4:25 (#8)

ἵνα τί ἐφρύαξαν ἔθνη, καὶ λαοὶ ἐμελέτησαν κενά

“Why did the nations rage, and the peoples imagine useless things”

In this psalm, David uses the question form to emphasize the futility of opposing God. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The nations should not have raged, and the peoples should not have imagined useless things!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 4:25 (#6)

ἵνα τί ἐφρύαξαν ἔθνη, καὶ λαοὶ ἐμελέτησαν κενά

“Why did the nations rage, and the peoples imagine useless things”

Here some words have been left out that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [Why did the nations rage, and why did the peoples imagine useless things]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 4:25 (#5)

παιδός

“servant”

The believers are using the word **servant** here in its ordinary sense, not as a title for the Messiah, so it would not be appropriate to translate it as “Messiah,” as you may have done when it was a title in 3:13 and 3:26.

Acts 4:25 (#3)

ἡμῶν

“our”

The believers are using the word **our** to refer to themselves but not to God, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 4:25 (#7)

ἵνα τί ἐφρύαξαν ἔθνη, καὶ λαοὶ ἐμελέτησαν κενά

“Why did the nations rage, and the peoples imagine useless things”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if the repetition might be confusing, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Why did the nations rage, indeed, why did the peoples imagine useless things]

See: Parallelism

Acts 4:25 (#9)

κενά

“useless things”

The phrase **useless things** implicitly describes plans to oppose God, which can never succeed. Alternate translation: [ways to oppose God, which always prove useless]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:25 (#1)

ὁ τοῦ πατρὸς ἡμῶν, διὰ Πνεύματος Ἁγίου στόματος Δαυεὶδ παιδός σου εἰπών

“the one having said by the Holy Spirit from the mouth of our father David, your servant”

The word **mouth** refers to what David said by using his mouth. Alternate translation: [the one whose Holy Spirit inspired our father David, your servant, to say]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:25 (#4)

τοῦ πατρὸς

"of & father"

Here, **father** means "ancestor." Alternate translation: [ancestor]

See: Metaphor

Acts 4:25 (#2)

τοῦ πατρὸς ἡμῶν, διὰ Πνεύματος Ἁγίου στόματος Δαυεὶδ παιδός σου εἰπών, ἵνα τί ἐφρύαξαν ἔθνη, καὶ λαοὶ ἐμελέτησαν κενά

"one having said by the Holy Spirit from the mouth of our father David, your servant, 'Why did the nations rage, and the peoples imagine useless things"

As the believers pray together, they quote from one of the psalms that David composed, Psalm 2:1–2. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [whose Holy Spirit inspired our father David, your servant, to ask why the nations raged and why the peoples imagined useless things.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 4:26 (#5)

ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτὸ

"to the same"

See the discussion of this phrase in Part 3 of the Introduction to Acts. Here it could mean "by agreement" or "in the same place." You could use either phrase as an alternate translation.

Acts 4:26 (#1)

παρέστησαν οἱ βασιλεῖς τῆς γῆς καὶ οἱ ἄρχοντες συνήχθησαν ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτὸ κατὰ τοῦ Κυρίου, καὶ κατὰ τοῦ Χριστοῦ αὐτοῦ

"The kings of the earth took their stand and the rulers were gathered to the same against the Lord and against his Christ"

This is the rest of the quotation from Psalm 2 that the believers started in 4:25. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [David said that the kings of the earth had taken their stand and the rulers had gathered to the same against the Lord and against his Christ]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 4:26 (#2)

παρέστησαν οἱ βασιλεῖς τῆς γῆς καὶ οἱ ἄρχοντες συνήχθησαν ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτὸ

"The kings of the earth took their stand and the rulers were gathered to the same"

In keeping with the conventions of Hebrew poetry, these two phrases mean basically the same thing. If the repetition might be confusing for your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [The kings of the earth took their stand, yes, the rulers were gathered to the same]

See: Parallelism

Acts 4:26 (#6)

τοῦ Κυρίου & τοῦ Χριστοῦ αὐτοῦ

"the Lord & his Christ"

Here the word **Lord** refers to God and the word **Christ** refers to the Messiah. Alternate translation: [God the Lord ... his Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:26 (#3)

παρέστησαν οἱ βασιλεῖς τῆς γῆς

"The kings of the earth took their stand"

The expression **took their stand** describes an army lining up for battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The kings of the earth lined up their troops for battle] or [The kings of the earth formed their battle lines]

See: Idiom

Acts 4:26 (#4)

οἱ ἄρχοντες συνήχθησαν

"the rulers were gathered"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the rulers gathered]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:27 (#1)

συνήχθησαν

“were gathered together”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [gathered together]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:27 (#4)

ὃν ἔχρισας

“whom you anointed”

In the Old Testament, ceremonial oil was poured on a person who was being given the authority to assume an office or to do a special task. The believers are speaking of anointing to indicate that God appointed Jesus to be the Messiah. Alternate translation: [whom you appointed]

See: Metaphor

Acts 4:27 (#3)

παῖδά

“Servant”

Here the word **Servant** is a title for the Messiah. See the discussion of that term in the introduction to Chapter 3, and see how you translated it in 3:13 and 3:26. Alternate translation: [Messiah]

Acts 4:27 (#2)

ἐν τῇ πόλει ταύτῃ

“in this city”

The phrase **this city** refers to Jerusalem. Alternate translation: [here in Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:28 (#3)

ὅσα ἡ χείρ σου, καὶ ἡ βουλὴ σου προώρισεν γενέσθαι

“all that your hand and your counsel had predetermined to happen”

The believers are speaking of God’s **hand** and his **counsel** (that is, his power and his plan) as if they had **predetermined** what would happen to Jesus. They mean that God himself had done this. Alternate translation: [all that you planned in advance to make happen by your power]

See: Personification

Acts 4:28 (#1)

ὅσα ἡ χείρ σου, καὶ ἡ βουλὴ σου προώρισεν γενέσθαι

“all that your hand and your counsel had predetermined to happen”

Here, **hand** means God’s power and **counsel** means God’s plan. Alternate translation: [all that your power and your plan had predetermined to happen]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:28 (#2)

ὅσα ἡ χείρ σου, καὶ ἡ βουλὴ σου προώρισεν γενέσθαι

“all that your hand and your counsel had predetermined to happen”

The words **hand** and **counsel**, joined by **and**, are expressing a single idea. The word **hand**, meaning “power,” tells by what means God intended to carry out his **counsel**, that is, his plan. Alternate translation: [all that you planned in advance to make happen by your power]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 4:29 (#1)

καὶ τὰ νῦν, Κύριε

“And now, Lord”

The believers use the expression **And now** to direct God’s attention to the request they are making in light of what they have said to this point in their prayer. In your translation, use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for this same purpose.

Acts 4:29 (#3)

τοῖς δούλοις σου

“to your servants”

The believers are speaking of themselves in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the first person in your translation. Alternate translation: [to us, your servants]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 4:29 (#5)

μετὰ παρρησίας πάσης

“with all boldness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **boldness**, you could express the same idea with an adverb such as “boldly.” The word **all** is an intensifier. Alternate translation: [very boldly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 4:29 (#2)

ἔπιδε ἐπὶ τὰς ἀπειλὰς αὐτῶν

“look upon their threats”

The phrase **look upon** is an idiomatic way of asking God to pay attention to the threats that the Jewish leaders have made against the believers. Alternate translation: [pay attention to the threats they have made]

See: Idiom

Acts 4:29 (#4)

τὸν λόγον σου

“your word”

The believers are using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that God has told them to share by using words. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:30 (#3)

διὰ τοῦ ὀνόματος

“through the name”

Here, **name** refers to authority. Alternate translation: [by the authority]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:30 (#4)

τοῦ ὀνόματος τοῦ ἁγίου παιδός σου, Ἰησοῦ

“the name of your holy Servant Jesus”

Here the word **Servant** is a title for the Messiah. See the discussion of that term in the introduction to Chapter 3, and see how you translated it in 3:13, 3:26, and 4:27. Alternate translation: [the name of Jesus, your holy Messiah]

Acts 4:30 (#2)

σημεῖα, καὶ τέρατα

“signs and wonders”

The terms **signs** and **wonders** mean similar things. Luke is using them together for emphasis. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:43. Alternate translation: [great miracles]

See: Doublet

Acts 4:30 (#1)

ἐν τῷ τὴν χεῖρά σου, ἐκτείνειν σε εἰς ἴασιν, καὶ σημεῖα, καὶ τέρατα, γίνεσθαι

“as you stretch out your hand to heal and for signs and wonders to happen”

Here the **hand** represents God’s power. To **stretch out** the hand means to use it. So this is a prayer for God to do powerful things. Alternate translation: [as you do powerful things to heal people and to make signs and wonders happen]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:31 (#1)

καὶ

“And”

This verse is the end of the whole story of how the lame man was healed and how Peter and John were arrested as a result. Luke uses the word translated as **And** to introduce information about what happened after the story as a result of the events within the story itself. Your language may have its own way of indicating how such information relates to a story.

See: End of Story

Acts 4:31 (#7)

μετὰ παρρησίας

“with boldness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **boldness**, you could express the same idea with an adverb such as “boldly.” Alternate translation: [boldly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 4:31 (#5)

ἐπλήσθησαν ἅπαντες τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος

“they were all filled with the Holy Spirit”

Luke is speaking as if the believers were containers that the Holy Spirit **filled**. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit inspired them all]

See: Metaphor

Acts 4:31 (#4)

ἐπλήσθησαν ἅπαντες τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος

“they were all filled with the Holy Spirit”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. See how you translated the same expression in 2:4. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit filled them all]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:31 (#2)

ἐν ᾧ ἦσαν συνηγμένοι

“in which they were gathered together”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [where they had gathered together]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:31 (#6)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the word of God”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that God wanted the believers to share by using words. Alternate translation: [the message from God]

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:31 (#3)

ἐσαλεύθη

“was shaken”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [shook]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:32 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Luke uses the word **Now** to introduce background information in 4:32–37 that will help readers understand further episodes in the story. These verses introduce Barnabas, who will be an important character in the book, and they also help account for what happens to Ananias and Sapphira in the next chapter. You can translate the word **Now** with a term or phrase that serves the same purpose in your language.

See: Connect — Background Information

Acts 4:32 (#5)

ἦν αὐτοῖς πάντα κοινά

“everything was common to them”

The word **everything** may be a generalization that emphasizes the powerful spirit of generosity among the believers. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:44. Alternate translation: [they shared their belongings with one another]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 4:32 (#4)

τῶν ὑπαρχόντων αὐτῷ

“of the things that were to him”

Alternate translation: [of the things that he owned]

Acts 4:32 (#3)

ἦν καρδία καὶ ψυχὴ μία

“was one in heart and soul”

The terms **heart** and **soul** mean similar things, and Luke may be using them together for emphasis. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine the terms in your translation. Alternate translation: [was genuinely united]

See: Doublet

Acts 4:32 (#2)

ἦν καρδία καὶ ψυχὴ μία

“was one in heart and soul”

Here the word **heart** seems to represent the emotions and the word **soul** seems to represent the desires. Alternate translation: [thought the same way and desired the same things] or see the next note for a further possibility.

See: Metonymy

Acts 4:33 (#1)

τῆς ἀναστάσεως τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

“of the resurrection of the Lord Jesus”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **resurrection**, you could express the same idea with an adjective such as “alive.” Alternate translation: [of how God made the Lord Jesus alive again after he died]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 4:33 (#2)

χάρις τε μεγάλη ἦν ἐπὶ πάντας αὐτούς

“and great grace was upon them all”

The pronoun **them** refers back to "the multitude of those who believed" in 4:32. It does not refer just to the **apostles**, who are mentioned in this verse. Alternate translation: [great grace was upon all of the believers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 4:33 (#3)

χάρις τε μεγάλη ἦν ἐπὶ πάντας αὐτούς

"and great grace was upon them all"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **grace**, you could express the same idea with an equivalent expression. The word could describe: (1) how God was blessing the believers. Alternate translation: [God was blessing all of the believers in wonderful ways]; (2) how the people in Jerusalem held the believers in high esteem. Alternate translation: [the people of Jerusalem thought very highly of all the believers]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 4:34 (#5)

τὰς τιμὰς τῶν πιπρασκομένων

"the price of the things being sold"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the money that they received from the things they sold]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:34 (#2)

γὰρ

"For"

Luke uses the word **For** in its first instance in this verse to introduce the evidence or reason for his statement at the end of the previous verse that "great grace was upon them all." The meaning here depends on the meaning there. Alternate translation: (1) [The way God was blessing the believers could be seen in the fact that] or (2) [One thing that made the people think very highly of the believers was that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 4:34 (#3)

γὰρ

"for"

Luke uses the word **for** in its second instance in this verse to introduce the reason why no one in the community of believers was needy. Alternate translation: [and the reason for this was that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 4:34 (#1)

οὐδὲ γὰρ ἐνδεής τις ἦν ἐν αὐτοῖς

"For there was not anyone needy among them"

This statement expresses the result of the rest of what Luke says in this verse and what he says in the next verse. If it would be helpful in your language to put this result after the reasons for it, you could create a verse bridge by moving this statement to the end of the next verse and beginning it with the word "So" instead of **For**.

See: Verse Bridges

Acts 4:34 (#4)

ὅσοι γὰρ κτήτορες χωρίων ἢ οἰκιῶν ὑπῆρχον

"for as many as were owners of lands or houses"

The phrase **as many as** is a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [many believers who owned lands or houses]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 4:35 (#1)

ἐτίθουν παρὰ τοὺς πόδας τῶν ἀποστόλων

"they were laying it at the feet of the apostles"

The expression **laying it at the feet** indicates that believers who sold possessions were putting the money they received onto the ground in front of the apostles. In this culture, that was a symbolic way of presenting it to them as a gift to be used to help others in the community. If there is a comparable symbolic action in your culture, you could use that in your translation. You could also use a general expression. Alternate translation: [they were presenting it to the apostles]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 4:35 (#2)

διεδίδετο

"it was being distributed"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the apostles were distributing it]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:35 (#3)

ἑκάστῳ, καθότι ἄν τις χρείαν εἶχεν

“to each one, according as anyone had need”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **need**, you could express the same idea with a verb such as “need.” Alternate translation: [to every person in the amount that he needed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 4:36 (#2)

Ἰωσὴφ & Βαρναβᾶς

“Joseph & Barnabas”

Joseph and **Barnabas** are two names for the same man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 4:36 (#7)

υἱὸς παρακλήσεως

“Son of Encouragement”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **Encouragement**, you could express the same idea with a verb such as “encourage.” Alternate translation: [the One who Encourages]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 4:36 (#4)

ὅ ἐστιν μεθερμηνευόμενον, υἱὸς παρακλήσεως

“which, being translated, is Son of Encouragement”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning of the passive verbal form **being translated** with an active form. Alternate translation: [which means Son of Encouragement]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:36 (#5)

ὅ ἐστιν μεθερμηνευόμενον, υἱὸς παρακλήσεως

“which, being translated, is Son of Encouragement”

Luke assumes that his readers will know that he is saying what the name Barnabas means when **translated** from the Aramaic language. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [which means Son of Encouragement in Aramaic]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 4:36 (#3)

ὁ ἐπικληθεὶς Βαρναβᾶς, ἀπὸ τῶν ἀποστόλων

“called Barnabas by the apostles”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [whom the apostles called Barnabas]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 4:36 (#1)

Ἰωσὴφ δὲ

“Then Joseph”

Luke uses this phrase to introduce a new character into the story. If your language has its own way of doing that, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 4:36 (#6)

υἱὸς παρακλήσεως

“Son of Encouragement”

The expression **Son of** describes a person who shares the qualities of something. The apostles used this name to describe Joseph’s behavior and character, since he was a person who encouraged others. Alternate translation: [the Encourager]

See: Idiom

Acts 4:37 (#2)

ἔθηκεν παρὰ τοὺς πόδας τῶν ἀποστόλων

“laid it at the feet of the apostles”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:35. Alternate translation: [presented it to the apostles]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 4:37 (#1)

ὑπάρχοντος αὐτῷ

“that was to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:32. Alternate translation: [that he owned]

Acts - Chapter 5 Introduction

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"Why has Satan filled your heart for you to lie to the Holy Spirit?" (5:3)
No one knows for sure whether Ananias and Sapphira were truly Christians when they decided to lie about the land that they sold (5:1–10), because Luke does not say. However, Peter knew that they lied to the believers, and he knew that they had listened to and obeyed Satan. When they lied to the believers, they also lied to the Holy Spirit. This is because the Holy Spirit lives inside believers.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Long sentences
Acts 5:36 consists of a single long sentence. ULT represents all of it as a single sentence. It may be helpful to your readers to divide it into several sentences, as UST does.

There is also a long sentence that goes from the beginning of 5:38 to nearly the end of 5:39. In this case as well it may be helpful to your readers to divide it into several sentences, as UST does.

Acts 5:1 (#4)

Σαπφείρῃ

"Sapphira"

Sapphira is the name of a woman.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 5:1 (#1)

ἀνὴρ δέ τις

"Now a certain man"

Luke uses this phrase to introduce a new character into the story. If your language has its own way of doing that, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 5:1 (#2)

Ἀνανίας

"Ananias"

Ananias is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 5:1 (#3)

σὺν Σαπφείρῃ τῇ γυναικὶ αὐτοῦ

"with Sapphira his wife"

Luke uses this phrase to introduce another new character into the story. If your language has its own way of doing that, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 5:2 (#1)

ἐνοσφίσατο ἀπὸ τῆς τιμῆς

"he kept back from the price"

The implication, as the story later makes clear, is that Ananias did not tell anyone except his wife that he was keeping some of the money for himself. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly, and you could state why he did this. Alternate translation: [he kept some of the money from the sale for himself, but he did not admit that he was doing that, because he wanted everyone to think he was being completely generous]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:2 (#3)

παρὰ τοὺς πόδας τῶν ἀποστόλων ἔθηκεν

"he laid it at the feet of the apostles"

This means that he presented to money to the apostles. See how you translated the same expression in 4:37. Alternate translation: [he presented it to the apostles]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:2 (#2)

συνειδυίης καὶ τῆς γυναικός, καὶ ἐνέγκας μέρος τι & ἔθηκεν

"his} wife also knowing, and bringing a certain portion, he laid it"

It may be helpful to make two new sentences here, particularly if you add information to the previous phrase as suggested in the preceding note. Alternate translation: [His wife also knew that he was keeping back part of the sale money. He brought a certain portion of the money and laid it]

Acts 5:3 (#5)

ψεύσασθαί σε τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον

"for you to lie to the Holy Spirit"

Ananias did not lie literally to the Holy Spirit, but he did lie to the apostles and to all of the believers who would have learned about his gift, and the Holy

Spirit was present in them. So by lying to them, he was effectively also lying to the Holy Spirit. Alternate translation: [for you to lie to the Holy Spirit, who is present in us]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:3 (#6)

καὶ νοσφίσασθαι ἀπὸ τῆς τιμῆς

"and to keep back from the price"

The implication of what Peter says here is that Ananias claimed or pretended that he was giving the entire amount that he had received from selling his land. Alternate translation: [by pretending that you were giving us the entire amount when you had kept back some for yourself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:3 (#4)

ψεύσασθαί σε τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον, καὶ νοσφίσασθαι ἀπὸ τῆς τιμῆς τοῦ χωρίου

"for you to lie to the Holy Spirit and to keep back from the price of the land"

Ananias first withheld some of the money, then he lied to the Holy Spirit about this by pretending he was giving all of the money. To make this clear in your translation, it may be helpful to describe the events in that order. Alternate translation: [for you to keep back from the price of the land and lie to the Holy Spirit]

See: Order of Events

Acts 5:3 (#3)

τὴν καρδίαν σου

"your heart"

Here, the **heart** represents the thoughts and motives. Alternate translation: [your thoughts and motives]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:3 (#2)

διὰ τί ἐπλήρωσεν ὁ Σατανᾶς τὴν καρδίαν σου

"why has Satan filled your heart"

Peter is speaking of the **heart** of Ananias as if it were a container that Satan had **filled**. Alternate translation: [why have you allowed Satan to influence your heart so strongly]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:3 (#1)

διὰ τί ἐπλήρωσεν ὁ Σατανᾶς τὴν καρδίαν σου, ψεύσασθαί σε τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον, καὶ νοσφίσασθαι ἀπὸ τῆς τιμῆς τοῦ χωρίου

"why has Satan filled your heart for you to lie to the Holy Spirit and to keep back from the price of the land"

Peter is using the question form to rebuke Ananias. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [you should not have let Satan fill your heart so that you lied to the Holy Spirit and kept back from the price of the land!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 5:4 (#9)

οὐκ ἐψεύσω ἀνθρώποις, ἀλλὰ τῷ Θεῷ

"You have not lied to men, but to God"

Ananias actually has **lied to men**, but Peter is speaking of the ultimate implications of his act. As in the previous verse, where Peter says that Ananias has lied to the Holy Spirit, here he means that Ananias has lied to the apostles and other believers, and God is present in them. So by lying to them, he has effectively also lied to God. Alternate translation: [You have not lied merely to men, but also to God, who is present in us]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:4 (#5)

ἐν τῇ σῇ ἐξουσίᾳ ὑπῆρχεν

"was it & in your authority"

The implications are that Ananias was not obligated to give all of the money to the apostles. He was free to keep some if he wished or if he needed it. He could simply have acknowledged that he was doing that, and giving the rest of the money would still have been a generous act because there was no compulsion. Alternate translation, as a statement: [you could have kept some and acknowledged that and you would have still been making a generous gift]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:4 (#1)

οὐχὶ μένον σοὶ ἔμενεν, καὶ πραθὲν ἐν τῇ σῇ ἐξουσίᾳ ὑπῆρχεν

"While it remained, did it not remain yours, and being sold, was it {not} in your authority"

Peter continues to use the question form to rebuke Ananias. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [While it remained, it remained yours, and after it was sold, it was still in your authority.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 5:4 (#4)

ἐν τῇ σῇ ἐξουσίᾳ ὑπῆρχεν

“was it & in your authority”

The pronoun **it** refers to the money that Ananias received from the sale of the land. Alternate translation, as a statement: [you could still do whatever you wanted with the money you received]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:4 (#7)

τί ὅτι ἔθου ἐν τῇ καρδίᾳ σου τὸ πρᾶγμα τοῦτο

“How {is it} that you placed this thing in your heart”

Here, the **heart** represents the thoughts. Alternate translation, as an exclamation: [You should not have placed this thing in your thoughts!]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:4 (#3)

πραθὲν

“being sold”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [once you had sold it]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:4 (#10)

ἀνθρώποις

“to men”

Peter is using the term **men** in a generic sense to mean “human beings.” Alternate translation: [to human beings]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 5:4 (#8)

τί ὅτι ἔθου ἐν τῇ καρδίᾳ σου τὸ πρᾶγμα τοῦτο

“How {is it} that you placed this thing in your heart”

Peter speaks of **this thing**, that is, the plan to keep back some of the money, as if Ananias had **placed** it in his **heart**, meaning his thoughts. Alternate translation, as an exclamation: [You should not even have thought of doing such a thing!]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:4 (#2)

ἔμενεν

“While it remained”

Alternate translation: [While it remained unsold] or [Before you sold it]

Acts 5:4 (#6)

τί ὅτι ἔθου ἐν τῇ καρδίᾳ σου τὸ πρᾶγμα τοῦτο

“How {is it} that you placed this thing in your heart”

Peter continues to use the question form to rebuke Ananias. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should not have placed this thing in your heart!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 5:5 (#3)

πεσὼν ἐξέψυξεν

“falling down, expired”

Ananias fell down because he died. He did not die because he fell down. To make this clear in your translation, it may be helpful to say first that he died and then that he fell. Alternate translation: [died and fell to the ground]

See: Order of Events

Acts 5:5 (#2)

πεσὼν ἐξέψυξεν

“falling down, expired”

The word translated as **expired** means that Ananias “breathed out for the last time.” It is a mild way of saying that he died. Alternate translation: [fell down and died]

See: Euphemism

Acts 5:5 (#4)

ἐγένετο φόβος μέγας ἐπὶ πάντας τοὺς ἀκούοντας

“great fear came upon all the ones having heard”

Luke describes this **fear** as if it were a living thing that could come onto people. Here the word **fear** describes a deep respect for God. Alternate translation: [everyone who heard about it came to feel a very deep respect for God]

See: Personification

Acts 5:5 (#1)

ἀκούων δὲ & τοὺς λόγους τούτους

"And hearing these words"

Luke is using the term **words** to mean what Peter used words to say. Alternate translation: [When he heard what Peter said]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:6 (#3)

συνέστειλαν αὐτὸν

"wrapped him up"

It was the custom in this culture to wrap linen cloths around the bodies of people who had died, in order to prepare the bodies for burial. If your readers would not be familiar with such a custom, you could describe it more specifically, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [wrapped a linen burial cloth around his body] or [prepared his body for burial]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 5:6 (#1)

ἀναστάντες δὲ, οἱ νεώτεροι συνέστειλαν αὐτὸν

"So rising up, the young men wrapped him up"

Here the expression **rising up** means that the young men took an action that they recognized they needed to take. It does not mean that they stood up from a seated position. Alternate translation: [the young men took action and wrapped him up]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:6 (#2)

οἱ νεώτεροι

"the young men"

This could refer to: (1) some strong young men who were present who realized that burying Ananias was a task they could help with. Alternate translation: [some strong young men who were present]; (2) a group of young men among the believers who regularly helped the apostles with tasks that required physical strength. Alternate translation: [the young men who regularly helped the apostles with physical tasks]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:7 (#3)

τὸ γεγονὸς

"what had happened"

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state explicitly what this means. Alternate translation: [that Peter had exposed their lie and that her husband was dead]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:7 (#2)

ἡ γυνὴ αὐτοῦ

"his wife"

The pronoun **his** refers to Ananias. Alternate translation: [the wife of Ananias] or [Sapphira]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:7 (#1)

ἐγένετο δὲ ὡς ὡρῶν τριῶν διάστημα, καὶ

"And an interval of about three hours happened, and"

This is an idiomatic way of speaking about time passing. Your language may have its own way of describing that. Alternate translation: [After about three hours had gone by,]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:8 (#1)

ἀπεκρίθη & πρὸς αὐτὴν

"said to her"

The word translated as **said** means to continue or resume a conversation. Alternate translation: [asked her, based on what her husband had said]

Acts 5:8 (#2)

ἀπέδοσθε

"you sold"

Since Peter is speaking of two people, Ananias and Sapphira, **you** would be dual if your language uses that form. Otherwise, it would be plural.

See: Forms of 'You' — Dual/Plural

Acts 5:8 (#3)

τοσούτου & ναί, τοσούτου

“for so much & Yes, for so much”

This refers to the amount of money that Ananias had given to the apostles. Peter may be naming the amount or, as UST suggests, he may be showing Sapphira the money. Alternate translation: [for this amount of money ... yes, for that amount of money]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:9 (#3)

ὑμῖν & σου & σε

“by you & your & you”

The word **you** in its first instance refers to two people, Ananias and Sapphira, so it would be dual if your language uses that form. Otherwise, it would be plural. The word **your** and the word **you** in its second instance refer only to Sapphira, so those words are singular.

See: Forms of You

Acts 5:9 (#1)

τί ὅτι συνεφωνήθη ὑμῖν πειράσαι τὸ Πνεῦμα Κυρίου

“How {is it} that it was agreed together by you to test the Spirit of the Lord”

Peter is using the question form to rebuke Sapphira. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should not have agreed together to test the Spirit of the Lord!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 5:9 (#5)

πειράσαι τὸ Πνεῦμα Κυρίου

“to test the Spirit of the Lord”

Ananias and Sapphira actually tested or challenged the apostles, but Peter is speaking of the ultimate implications of their act, as he does similarly in 5:3 and 5:4. Since the Spirit of the Lord was present in the apostles, by challenging them, Ananias and Sapphira effectively lied to the Spirit. Alternate translation: [to test the Spirit of the Lord, who is present in us apostles]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:9 (#8)

οἱ πόδες τῶν θαψάντων τὸν ἄνδρα σου ἐπὶ τῇ θύρᾳ

“the feet of the ones having buried your husband {are} at the door”

Peter is telling Sapphira implicitly that her husband died as a judgment from God when Peter confronted him with the lie about the price of the land. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [your husband died as a judgment from God when I confronted him with the lie you both told about the price of the land, and the young men who buried him are just now returning]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:9 (#6)

ἰδοὺ, οἱ πόδες

“Behold, the feet”

Peter says **Behold** to get Sapphira to focus her attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here in your translation. Alternate translation: [And now the feet]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:9 (#9)

καὶ ἐξοίσουσίν σε

“and they will carry you out”

The implications are that Sapphira is also going to die and that the same young men will **carry** her **out** to bury her. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. It may be helpful to make this a separate sentence. Alternate translation: [You are also going to die as a judgment from God, and those same young men are going to carry you out and bury you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:9 (#7)

οἱ πόδες τῶν θαψάντων τὸν ἄνδρα σου ἐπὶ τῇ θύρᾳ

“the feet of the ones having buried your husband {are} at the door”

Peter is referring to the return of the young men who buried Ananias. Their **feet** represent them by association with the way they are using their feet to walk back. The **door** represents their return by association with the way they will come through the door when they return. Alternate translation: [the young men who buried your husband are just now returning]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:9 (#2)

συνεφωνήθη ὑμῖν

“it was agreed together by you”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [you agreed together]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:9 (#4)

πειράσαι τὸ Πνεῦμα Κυρίου

“to test the Spirit of the Lord”

Here the word **test** means to challenge. Ananias and Sapphira were trying to see if they could get away with lying about how much they received for the land they sold. Alternate translation: [to challenge the Spirit of the Lord]

Acts 5:10 (#3)

ἔπεσεν & πρὸς τοὺς πόδας αὐτοῦ

“she fell down at his feet”

This means that she fell to the ground in front of Peter. This expression should not be confused with the idea of “falling down at a person’s feet,” that is, bowing down to the ground in front of someone as a sign of humility. Alternate translation: [she collapsed onto the ground in front of him]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:10 (#2)

ἔπεσεν & πρὸς τοὺς πόδας αὐτοῦ, καὶ ἐξέψυξεν

“she fell down at his feet and expired”

Sapphira fell down because she died. She did not die because she fell down. To make this clear in your translation, it may be helpful to say first that she died and then that she fell. Alternate translation: [she died and fell down at his feet]

See: Order of Events

Acts 5:10 (#4)

οἱ νεανίσκοι

“the young men”

See how you translated this expression in 5:6. However, it may not be necessary to explain again here who these **young men** were in terms of their role in the community. Instead, you could identify them by their role in the story. Alternate translation: [the same young men who had buried Ananias]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:10 (#1)

ἔπεσεν & πρὸς τοὺς πόδας αὐτοῦ, καὶ ἐξέψυξεν

“she fell down at his feet and expired”

The word translated as **expired** means that Sapphira “breathed out for the last time.” It is a mild way of saying that she died. Alternate translation: [she fell down at his feet and died]

See: Euphemism

Acts 5:11 (#1)

καὶ

“And”

This verse is the end of the story about Ananias and Sapphira. Luke uses the word translated as **And** to introduce information about what happened after the story as a result of the events within the story itself. Your language may have its own way of indicating how such information relates to a story.

See: End of Story

Acts 5:11 (#2)

ἐγένετο φόβος μέγας ἐφ’ ὅλην τὴν ἐκκλησίαν, καὶ ἐπὶ πάντας τοὺς ἀκούοντας ταῦτα

“great fear came upon the whole church and upon all the ones hearing these things”

Luke describes this **fear** as if it were a living thing that could come onto people. See how you translated the similar expression in 5:5. Alternate translation: [the whole church and everyone who heard about these things came to feel a very deep respect for God]

See: Personification

Acts 5:12 (#6)

τῇ Στοᾷ Σολομῶντος

“the Porch of Solomon”

This was a covered walkway that consisted of rows of pillars that supported a roof. It was named after King Solomon. See how you translated the phrase “the porch that is called Solomon’s” in 3:11, which is a description of this same walkway. Alternate translation: [Solomon’s Porch]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 5:12 (#5)

ὁμοθυμαδὸν

“unanimously”

The word **unanimously** indicates that the apostles and other believers shared a common commitment and purpose and that there was no strife among them. See how you translated the same expression in 1:14. Alternate translation: [meeting together with one accord] or [meeting together harmoniously]

Acts 5:12 (#3)

σημεῖα καὶ τέρατα

“signs and wonders”

The terms **signs** and **wonders** mean similar things. Luke is using them together for emphasis. See how you translated this expression in 4:30. Alternate translation: [great miracles]

See: Doublet

Acts 5:12 (#2)

διὰ & τῶν χειρῶν τῶν ἀποστόλων, ἐγίνετο σημεῖα καὶ τέρατα πολλὰ

“many signs and wonders were happening through & hands of the apostles & the”

Luke is using the **hands** of the apostles to represent their actions. Alternate translation: [the apostles were doing many signs and wonders]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:12 (#1)

δὲ

“And”

Luke uses the word translated as **And** to introduce background information in 5:12–16 that will help readers understand what happens next in the story. You can translate this word with a word or phrase that serves the same purpose in your language. Alternate translation: [Now]

See: Connect — Background Information

Acts 5:12 (#4)

ἦσαν & πάντες

“they were all”

The pronoun **they** refers to the whole community of believers. Alternate translation: [the whole community of believers was]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:13 (#2)

ἐτόλμα κολλᾶσθαι αὐτοῖς

“dared to join them”

If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state explicitly why no unbelievers **dared to join them**. The reason seems to be that the Jewish leaders had commanded the apostles not to speak or teach about Jesus (4:18), but they were still doing that. Later in this chapter, in 5:28, the Sanhedrin indicates that it has arrested the apostles for violating that command. Alternate translation: [would meet with them, because the apostles were still preaching about Jesus even though the Jewish leaders had commanded them not to do so]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:13 (#1)

τῶν & λοιπῶν, οὐδεὶς

“none of the others”

The expression **the others** refers to people who were not believers in Jesus. Alternate translation: [none of the people who were not believers in Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:14 (#2)

προσετίθεντο & τῷ Κυρίῳ

“were being added to the Lord”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:41. Alternate translation: [were joining the Lord’s people]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:14 (#1)

προσετίθεντο & τῷ Κυρίῳ

“were being added to the Lord”

Luke says **the Lord** to mean the community of people who believed in the Lord. Alternate translation: [were being added to the church]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:15 (#6)

ἡ σκιὰ ἐπισκιάσῃ τινὶ αὐτῶν

“his} shadow might overshadow any one of them”

Luke is using a construction in which the subject and verb come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have its own way of describing this. Alternate translation: [his shadow might fall on]

Acts 5:15 (#2)

ἐκφέρειν

“they & carried”

The pronoun **they** refers to the people who lived in Jerusalem. Alternate translation: [people who lived in Jerusalem ... carried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:15 (#1)

ὥστε

“so that”

Luke says **so that** to introduce a result, but it is not the direct result of what he said just before, that many men and women became part of the church. It is the result of what he said in 5:12, that the apostles were doing “many signs and wonders.” All of 5:12–15 could be understood as a single sentence, and in that case what Luke says here would more clearly follow logically and grammatically from what he says in 5:12. However, ULT divides the material into several sentences, which is another way in which it can be understood. UST models a way to show how what Luke says here introduces a result of what he said in 5:12 about the “signs and wonders” that the apostles were doing.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 5:15 (#4)

κλιναρίων καὶ κραβάττων

“cots and mats”

The words **cots** and **mats** mean similar things. Luke could be using them together for emphasis, although he could also be describing two different ways that people managed to make their sick relatives and friends reasonably comfortable as they waited in the streets for Peter to walk by. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine these terms in your translation. Alternate translation: [improvised beds]

See: Doublet

Acts 5:15 (#5)

ἡ σκιὰ ἐπισκιάσῃ τινὶ αὐτῶν

“his} shadow might overshadow any one of them”

The implication is that God was healing sick people whom Peter’s shadow touched. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [his shadow might overshadow any one of them and God would heal that person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:15 (#3)

τοὺς ἀσθενεῖς

“the sick”

Luke is using the adjective **sick** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who were sick]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 5:16 (#4)

οἵτινες ἐθεραπεύοντο ἅπαντες

“who were all healed”

It does not appear that **all** is a generalization for emphasis in this case. So it would not be accurate to treat **all** as figurative and say something like “and large numbers of them were healed.” Luke is describing what remarkable things God did through the apostles at this time, and he does seem to mean that every sick person whom the people brought to Jerusalem was healed. So it would be appropriate to say in your translation just what ULT says here.

See: Hyperbole

Acts 5:16 (#1)

ἀσθενεῖς

“the sick”

See how you translated the expression **the sick** in 5:15. Alternate translation: [people who were sick]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 5:16 (#2)

ὀχλουμένους ὑπὸ πνευμάτων ἀκαθάρτων

“those afflicted by unclean spirits”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [those whom unclean spirits were afflicting]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:16 (#3)

οἵτινες ἐθεραπεύοντο ἅπαντες

"who were all healed"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who did the action. Alternate translation: [and the apostles healed them all] or [and God used the apostles to heal them all]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:17 (#4)

ἀναστὰς

"rising up"

Here the expression **rising up** means that the high priest decided to take action, not that he stood up from a seated position. Alternate translation: [taking action]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:17 (#5)

πάντες οἱ σὺν αὐτῷ, ἡ οὖσα αἵρεσις τῶν Σαδδουκαίων

"all those with him (which is the sect of the Sadducees"

The phrase **all those with him** means specifically all the other priests who joined the high priest in taking action against the apostles. Luke observes here that those other priests were from the group known as the **Sadducees**. As a note to 4:1 explains, they opposed the apostles' teaching because they did not believe in the resurrection. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and all of the priests from the group known as the Sadducees who wanted to oppose the apostles' teaching because they did not believe in the resurrection]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:17 (#2)

ἀναστὰς & ὁ ἀρχιερεὺς καὶ πάντες οἱ σὺν αὐτῷ, ἡ οὖσα αἵρεσις τῶν Σαδδουκαίων, ἐπλήσθησαν ζήλου

"rising up, the high priest and all those with him (which is the sect of the Sadducees) were filled with jealousy"

The high priest and these Sadducees were first **filled with jealousy** and then they rose up (took action) against the apostles. To make this clear in your translation, it may be helpful to describe the events in that order. Alternate translation: [the high priest and all those with him (which is the sect of the Sadducees) were filled with jealousy and they rose up]

See: Order of Events

Acts 5:17 (#6)

ἐπλήσθησαν ζήλου

"were filled with jealousy"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **jealousy**, you could express the same idea with an adjective such as "jealous." Alternate translation: [became very jealous]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 5:17 (#3)

ἀναστὰς & ὁ ἀρχιερεὺς καὶ πάντες οἱ σὺν αὐτῷ, ἡ οὖσα αἵρεσις τῶν Σαδδουκαίων, ἐπλήσθησαν ζήλου

"rising up, the high priest and all those with him (which is the sect of the Sadducees) were filled with jealousy"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an active verbal form instead of the passive form **were filled**. Alternate translation: [jealousy filled the high priest and all those with him (which is the sect of the Sadducees) and they rose up]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:17 (#1)

δὲ

"But"

Luke uses the word **But** to introduce a strong contrast into the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing a contrasting narrative. You could also refer back to the previous action in order to highlight the contrast. Alternate translation: [But even though the apostles were doing so much good,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Acts 5:17 (#7)

ἐπλήσθησαν ζήλου

“were filled with jealousy”

Luke is speaking as if the high priest and his allies were containers that jealousy **filled**. Alternate translation: [became very jealous]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:18 (#2)

ἐπέβαλον τὰς χεῖρας ἐπὶ τοὺς ἀποστόλους

“they laid hands on the apostles”

The high priest and his allies did not arrest the apostles personally. They would have ordered the temple guards to arrest them. But Luke speaks as if the high priest and his allies did this action because they had a significant part in it by ordering it. Alternate translation: [they had the temple guards arrest the apostles]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 5:18 (#1)

ἐπέβαλον τὰς χεῖρας ἐπὶ τοὺς ἀποστόλους

“they laid hands on the apostles”

The expression **laid hands on** means to arrest someone by association with the way that arresting officers might physically take hold of a person with their **hands**. Alternate translation: [they arrested the apostles]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:19 (#1)

ἐξαγαγών & αὐτοὺς

“bringing them out”

The pronoun **them** refers to the apostles. Alternate translation: [bringing the apostles out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:20 (#3)

τῆς ζωῆς ταύτης

“of this life”

Alternate translation: [about the everlasting life that God gives through Jesus] or [about the new way of living that people can have as followers of Jesus]

Acts 5:20 (#2)

πάντα τὰ ῥήματα τῆς ζωῆς ταύτης

“all the words of this life”

The angel is using the term **words** to mean the message that the apostles were to share by using words. Alternate translation: [the entire message about this life]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:20 (#1)

ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ

“in the temple”

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when the angel says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [in the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:21 (#6)

τὸ Συνέδριον καὶ πᾶσαν τὴν Γερουσίαν τῶν υἱῶν Ἰσραήλ

“the Sanhedrin, even all the elders of the sons of Israel”

The phrase **even all the elders of the sons of Israel** clarifies the name **Sanhedrin** by describing it membership. Luke is using the word **elders** here in a general sense to mean “leaders.” He is not making a distinction between “elders” and “rulers” as he does in 4:5. Alternate translation: [the Sanhedrin, which was composed of the leaders of the sons of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:21 (#1)

ἀκούσαντες

“having heard this”

Luke may be using the word “hear” in an idiomatic sense to mean “obey.” Alternate translation: [in obedience to this command from the angel]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:21 (#7)

τῶν υἱῶν Ἰσραήλ

“of the sons of Israel”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” Luke is identifying the Israelites as descendants of their ancestor Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:21 (#4)

δὲ

“And”

Luke is using the word translated as **And** to introduce other events that took place around the same time as the events he has just described. Alternate translation: [Meanwhile,]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Acts 5:21 (#5)

παραγενόμενος

“having arrived”

This does not mean that the high priest and his allies **arrived** in the temple courtyard where the apostles were. Rather, it means that they went into the chamber where the Sanhedrin met so that they could summon the rest of its members to join them there. Alternate translation: [having arrived in the council chamber]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:21 (#8)

ἀπέστειλαν εἰς τὸ δεσμωτήριον

“sent to the prison”

Luke is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. He means that the high priest and his allies sent someone to the prison to get the apostles. Alternate translation: [sent someone to the prison]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 5:21 (#3)

ὑπὸ τὸν ὄρθρον

“about daybreak”

The implication is that although the angel led the apostles out of the jail during the night, the sun was rising by the time they reached the temple courtyard. Alternate translation: [as it was beginning to get light]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:21 (#2)

εἰς τὸ ἱερὸν

“into the temple”

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when Luke says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [into the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:23 (#4)

ἔσω οὐδένα εὕρομεν

“we found no one inside”

By **no one**, the officers mean that they found none of the men they had been sent to bring, that is, none of the apostles. It is possible that other people were also being held in the prison, but the angel would not have released them, and they would still have been inside. Alternate translation: [we did not find any of those men inside]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 5:23 (#1)

τὸ δεσμωτήριον εὕρομεν κεκλεισμένον ἐν πάσῃ ἀσφαλείᾳ, καὶ τοὺς φύλακας

“We found the prison shut in all security and the guards”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an active verbal form in place of the passive form **shut**, and you can say who did the action. Alternate translation: [We found that the guards had shut the prison in all security and we found the guards]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:23 (#3)

ἀνοίξαντες

“having opened”

Your language may require you to specify the object of **opened**. Alternate translation: [once we opened the doors]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:23 (#2)

ἐν πάσῃ ἀσφαλείᾳ

“in all security”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **security**, you could express the same idea with an adverb such as “securely.” The word **all** is an intensifier. Alternate translation: [very securely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 5:24 (#3)

τί ἂν γένοιτο τοῦτο

“as to what this might become”

The expression **what this might become** refers to a possible result. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wondering what would happen as a result]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:24 (#2)

περὶ αὐτῶν

“concerning them”

The pronoun **them** does not refer to the apostles but to the **words** that the officers spoke in giving their report. Alternate translation: [about the things the officers had told them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:24 (#1)

τοὺς λόγους τούτους

“these words”

Luke is using the term **words** to mean the report that the officers gave. Alternate translation: [this report]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:25 (#2)

ἔθεσθε

“you put”

Here the word **you** refers to the captain of the temple and the chief priests and so it is plural.

See: Forms of You

Acts 5:25 (#1)

ἰδοὺ, οἱ ἄνδρες

“Behold, the men”

This person says **Behold** to get the council members to focus their attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here in your translation. Alternate translation: [Right now the men]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:25 (#3)

ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ, ἑστῶτες

“standing in the temple”

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when the messenger says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [standing in the temple courtyard]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:26 (#1)

τότε ἀπελθὼν, ὁ στρατηγὸς σὺν τοῖς ὑπηρέταις ἦγεν αὐτούς, οὐ μετὰ βίας, ἐφοβοῦντο γὰρ τὸν λαόν, μὴ λιθασθῶσιν

“Then the captain, going with the officers, brought them back, not with violence, for they feared the people, lest they stone them”

The first instance of the pronoun **them** refers to the apostles, but the second instance of the pronoun **them** refers to the captain and the officers. The captain and officers were not afraid that the people would stone the apostles. They were afraid that they would be stoned themselves if they used violence against the apostles. You could reword this to make the referents clear. It may be helpful to make this two sentences. Alternate translation: [Then the captain went with the officers and brought the apostles back. But the captain and officers did not use any violence, because they were afraid that the people would stone them if they did]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:27 (#1)

ἀγαγόντες δὲ αὐτοὺς

“And having brought them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the apostles in all three instances in this verse. It may be helpful to specify this here in the first instance. Alternate translation: [Once they had brought the apostles back]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:28 (#7)

ἡμᾶς

“us”

By **us**, the high priest means himself and his fellow Jewish leaders, but not the apostles to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 5:28 (#1)

παραγγελίᾳ παρηγγείλαμεν ὑμῖν

“We commanded you with a command”

For emphasis, the high priest is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. If your language uses the same construction for emphasis, it would be appropriate to use it here in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of conveying this emphasis. Alternate translation: [we commanded you very strictly]

Acts 5:28 (#8)

τὸ αἷμα

“the blood”

The high priest is using the term **blood** to mean death by association with the way Jesus’ blood was shed when he died. Alternate translation: [the death]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:28 (#3)

ἐπὶ τῷ ὀνόματι τούτῳ

“in this name”

The high priest is using the term **name** to mean the person of Jesus. See how you translated the similar expression in 4:17. Alternate translation: [about this person Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:28 (#5)

πεπληρώκατε τὴν Ἰερουσαλὴμ τῆς διδαχῆς ὑμῶν

“you have filled Jerusalem with your teaching”

The high priest is speaking of the city of **Jerusalem** as if it were a container that the apostles had **filled** with their teaching. Alternate translation: [you have taught people who live in every part of Jerusalem]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:28 (#2)

ὑμῖν & πεπληρώκατε & ὑμῶν & βούλεσθε

“you & you have filled & your & you desire”

In this verse the words **you** and **your** refer to the apostles, and so those words are plural.

See: Forms of You

Acts 5:28 (#6)

βούλεσθε ἐπαγαγεῖν ἐφ’ ἡμᾶς

“you desire to bring upon us”

The high priest is speaking as if the apostles wanted to put the blood of Jesus on him and his fellow Jewish leaders. Alternate translation: [you want to make us responsible for]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:28 (#9)

τοῦ ἀνθρώπου τούτου

“of this man”

The phrase **this man** refers to Jesus. Alternate translation: [this man Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:28 (#4)

ἰδοὺ, πεπληρώκατε

“behold, you have filled”

The high priest says **behold** to get the apostles to focus their attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here in your translation. Alternate translation: [nevertheless you have filled]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:29 (#2)

Πέτρος καὶ οἱ ἀπόστολοι εἶπαν

“Peter and the apostles said”

Luke seems to mean implicitly that Peter said what follows on behalf of all of the apostles. Alternate translation: [Peter said on behalf of all of the apostles]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:29 (#3)

ἀνθρώποις

“men”

Peter is using the term **men** in a generic sense to mean “human beings.” Alternate translation: [human beings]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 5:29 (#1)

ἀποκριθεὶς & Πέτρος καὶ οἱ ἀπόστολοι εἶπαν

“answering, Peter and the apostles said”

Together the words **answering** and **said** mean that Peter and the other apostles responded to the high priest. Alternate translation: [Peter and the apostles responded]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 5:30 (#4)

ὃν ὑμεῖς διεχειρίσασθε

“whom you killed”

The word **you** is plural. Even though Peter is responding to the high priest, who has been interrogating the apostles, Peter is referring here to the entire council. If your language does not use separate forms for singular and plural “you,” you could indicate that in some other way. Alternate translation: [whom you Sanhedrin members killed]

See: Forms of You

Acts 5:30 (#1)

τῶν πατέρων ἡμῶν

“of our fathers”

Peter is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” Alternate translation: [of our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:30 (#2)

τῶν πατέρων ἡμῶν

“of our fathers”

Although the term **fathers** is masculine, Peter is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If you retain the metaphor in your translation, you could state “of our fathers and mothers” to indicate this.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 5:30 (#5)

ὃν ὑμεῖς διεχειρίσασθε

“whom you killed”

It was the Romans who literally killed Jesus, but Peter says that the Sanhedrin members killed him because their demands led to his death. Alternate translation: [whom you demanded to be killed]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 5:30 (#6)

κρεμάσαντες ἐπὶ ξύλου

“having hung him on a tree”

The word translated as **tree** can mean either an actual tree or something made of wood. Peter is using the word to refer to the cross, which was made out of wood. Alternate translation: [having hung him on a wooden cross]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:30 (#7)

κρεμάσαντες ἐπὶ ξύλου

“having hung him on a tree”

In some languages the word **hung** would suggest a different method of execution. For clarity, you could use a different word that might indicate the actual meaning better. Alternate translation: [having suspended him from a wooden cross]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:30 (#3)

ἤγειρεν Ἰησοῦν

“raised up Jesus”

As in 2:24, the idiom **raised up** means that God made Jesus alive again after he died. Alternate translation: [brought Jesus back to life]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:31 (#1)

τοῦτον

“this one”

Peter is using the demonstrative adjective **this** as a noun to refer to a specific person, Jesus. (ULT shows that by adding **one**.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could specify whom Peter means. Alternate translation: [Jesus] or [this Jesus]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 5:31 (#5)

Ἰσραὴλ

“Israel”

Here, **Israel** represents the people who belong to the nation of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:31 (#4)

τοῦ δοῦναι μετάνοιαν τῷ Ἰσραὴλ καὶ ἄφεσιν ἁμαρτιῶν

"to give repentance and forgiveness of sins to Israel"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the ideas behind the words **repentance** and **forgiveness**, you could express the same ideas with verbs. Alternate translation: [to give the people of Israel an opportunity to repent and have God forgive their sins]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 5:31 (#3)

τῇ δεξιᾷ αὐτοῦ

"to his right"

God placing Jesus at his **right** side was a symbolic way of giving him great honor. Alternate translation: [to a place of great honor next to him]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 5:31 (#2)

τῇ δεξιᾷ αὐτοῦ

"to his right"

Peter is using the adjective **right** as a noun in order to indicate the right side. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:25. Alternate translation: [to his right side]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 5:32 (#1)

ἡμεῖς

"we"

Peter is addressing the Sanhedrin, but he is using the word **we** to refer only to himself and the other apostles. So if your language distinguishes between exclusive and inclusive "us," it would be accurate to use the exclusive form here. Other languages may have other ways of indicating that **we** is exclusive here. Alternate translation: [we apostles]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 5:32 (#3)

ὃ ἔδωκεν ὁ Θεὸς τοῖς πειθαρχοῦσιν αὐτῷ

"whom God has given to those obeying him"

Here at the end of his response to the high priest, Peter is echoing what he said at the beginning: "It is necessary to obey God rather than men." He is defining himself and his fellow apostles as people who are committed to obeying God and to testifying about Jesus even if the authorities forbid them to do that. Peter is saying that God has given the apostles the Holy Spirit to empower them to give that testimony in obedience to him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [whom God has given us to empower us to obey him by testifying about Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:32 (#2)

καὶ τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον, ὃ ἔδωκεν ὁ Θεὸς τοῖς πειθαρχοῦσιν αὐτῷ

"and the Holy Spirit, whom God has given to those obeying him"

Peter is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. Alternate translation: [and the Holy Spirit, whom God has given to those obeying him, is also a witness of these things]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 5:33 (#1)

οἱ δὲ ἀκούσαντες διεπρίοντο, καὶ ἐβούλοντο ἀνελεῖν αὐτούς

"having heard this, they were furious and wanted to kill them"

The pronoun **they** refers to the council members and the pronoun **them** refers to the apostles. Alternate translation: [the council members were furious when they heard this, and they wanted to kill the apostles]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:34 (#6)

ἀναστὰς

"rising up"

Here, **rising up** means that Gamaliel stood up. He did that to indicate that he had something important to say. Alternate translation: [standing up to show that he had something important to say]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 5:34 (#7)

ἐκέλευσεν ἔξω τοὺς ἀνθρώπους ποιῆσαι

“commanded to put the apostles outside”

Your language may require you to specify the object of **commanded**. Alternate translation: [commanded the officers to take the apostles outside]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:34 (#1)

τις & Φαρισαῖος ὀνόματι Γαμαλιήλ

“a certain Pharisee, Gamaliel by name”

Luke uses this phrase to introduce a new character into the story. If your language has its own way of doing that, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 5:34 (#2)

Γαμαλιήλ

“Gamaliel”

Gamaliel is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 5:34 (#8)

βραχὺ

“for a little”

Luke is using the adjective **little** as a noun in order to indicate a length of time. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could supply a word such as “while” to show this. Alternate translation: [for a little while]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 5:34 (#4)

τίμιος παντὶ τῷ λαῷ

“honored by all the people”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [whom all the people honored]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:34 (#5)

τίμιος παντὶ τῷ λαῷ

“honored by all the people”

The word **all** is a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [whom the people greatly honored]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 5:34 (#3)

νομοδιδάσκαλος τίμιος παντὶ τῷ λαῷ

“a law teacher, honored by all the people”

Luke provides this background information about Gamaliel to help readers understand what happens next in the story, when the council members follow Gamaliel’s advice to be patient rather than acting immediately against the apostles. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture. It may be helpful to do that in a separate sentence, as UST does.

See: Background Information

Acts 5:35 (#1)

τε

“And”

Luke is using the word translated as **And** to indicate that Gamaliel spoke after the officers had taken the apostles out of the council chamber. Alternate translation: [Then]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Acts 5:35 (#3)

προσέχετε ἑαυτοῖς ἐπὶ τοῖς ἀνθρώποις τούτοις τί μέλλετε πράσσειν

“pay attention to yourselves, what you are about to do to these men”

Gamaliel is warning the council members not to do something that they will later regret. He means “be very careful about what you do to these men,” and you could state that as an alternate translation. However, the implication is that the council should not kill the apostles, as 5:33 says they want to do. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [you need to be very cautious and not kill these men, because you might deeply regret that later]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:35 (#2)

ἄνδρες, Ἰσραηλεῖται

“Men, Israelites”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [My fellow Israelites]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:36 (#2)

Θευδᾶς

“Theudas”

Theudas is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 5:36 (#9)

καὶ ἐγένοντο εἰς οὐδέν

“and they came to nothing”

Alternate translation: [and their plans did not succeed]

Acts 5:36 (#1)

πρὸ & τούτων τῶν ἡμερῶν

“before these days”

Gamaliel is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time. Alternate translation: [some time ago]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:36 (#5)

ᾧ προσεκλίθη ἀνδρῶν ἀριθμὸς

“to whom was joined a number of men”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. As the introduction to this chapter suggests, it may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [whom a number of men joined] or, as a new sentence, [A number of men joined him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:36 (#3)

ἀνέστη

“rose up”

In this context, **rose up** means that Theudas rebelled against the Roman government. Alternate translation: [rebelled]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:36 (#6)

ὃς ἀνῃρέθη

“who was killed”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who did the action. It may be helpful to begin another new sentence here. Alternate translation: [whom the Romans killed] or, as a new sentence, [But the Romans killed him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:36 (#4)

λέγων εἶναί τινα ἑαυτόν

“saying himself to be somebody”

In this context, the expression **somebody** means a person of importance. Your language may use this expression in the same way. Or, if it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [saying that he was an important person]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:36 (#7)

ὅσοι ἐπείθοντο αὐτῷ

“as many as were persuaded by him”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [as many as he had persuaded]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:36 (#8)

διελύθησαν

“were dispersed”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [dispersed]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:37 (#3)

ἀνέστη

“rose up”

As in 5:36, **rose up** here means that Judas rebelled against the Roman government. Alternate translation: [rebelled]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:37 (#6)

κἀκεῖνος

“That one also”

Gamaliel is using the demonstrative adjective **that** as a noun to refer to a specific person, Judas. (ULT shows that by adding **one**.) Your language may use adjectives

in the same way. If not, you use a pronoun or this man's name. Alternate translation: [He also] or [Judas also]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 5:37 (#4)

ἐν ταῖς ἡμέραις τῆς ἀπογραφῆς

"in the days of the census"

Gamaliel is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time. Alternate translation: [at the time of the census]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:37 (#8)

διεσκορπίσθησαν

"were scattered"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [scattered]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:37 (#2)

Ἰούδας ὁ Γαλιλαῖος

"Judas the Galilean"

The word **Judas** is the name of a man. See how you translated the same name in 1:13 and 1:16. (Those verses describe two other men with this name, not the same Judas as here.) **Galilean** is the name for someone who is from the region of Galilee. See how you translated that name in 1:11.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 5:37 (#1)

μετὰ τοῦτον

"After this one"

Gamaliel is using the demonstrative adjective **this** as a noun to refer to a specific person, Theudas. (ULT shows that by adding **one**.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could use a pronoun or this man's name. Alternate translation: [After him] or [After Theudas]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 5:37 (#7)

ὅσοι ἐπείθοντο αὐτῷ

"as many as were persuaded by him"

If your language would not use the passive form **were persuaded**, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [as many as he had persuaded]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:37 (#5)

ἀπέστησε λαὸν ὀπίσω αὐτοῦ

"drew away people after him"

Here, **drew away** is an idiom that means Judas persuaded people to rebel with him against the Roman government. Alternate translation: [persuaded people to join him in rebellion]

See: Idiom

Acts 5:38 (#5)

τῶν ἀνθρώπων

"men"

Gamaliel is using the term **men** in a generic sense to mean "humans." Since he contrasts **from men** here with "from God" in the next verse, it may be appropriate to add the word "mere" to help show that contrast. Alternate translation: [mere humans]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 5:38 (#3)

ἀπόστητε ἀπὸ τῶν ἀνθρώπων τούτων καὶ ἄφετε αὐτούς

"Keep away from these men and release them"

When Gamaliel tells the council to **keep away from these men**, he implicitly means that they should not execute them, as 5:33 says they wanted to do. Alternate translation: [do not execute these men or put them back in prison]

Acts 5:38 (#4)

ἐὰν ᾖ ἐξ ἀνθρώπων, ἡ βουλὴ αὕτη ἢ τὸ ἔργον τοῦτο

"if this counsel or this work is from men"

Alternate translation: [if men have devised this plan or are doing this work]

Acts 5:38 (#2)

καὶ

"And"

Gamaliel is using the word translated as **And** to introduce what he wants the council to conclude as a result

of the two examples he has given. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 5:38 (#6)

καταλυθήσεται

"it will be destroyed"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [someone will destroy it] or [it will not last]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:38 (#1)

καὶ τὰ νῦν λέγω ὑμῖν

"And now I say these things to you"

Gamaliel uses this expression to shift the council members' attention away from the stories of Theudas and Judas so that he could give them some direct advice. In your translation, use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that would be natural for this same purpose.

Acts 5:39 (#4)

καὶ θεομάχοι εὑρεθῆτε

"you may even be found God-opposers"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. However, since this is also an idiom (See: next note), it would only be meaningful to do that in your translation if your language uses the verb "find" in the same idiomatic sense. Alternate translation: [people may even find you to be]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:39 (#2)

εἰ & ἐκ Θεοῦ ἐστιν

"if it is from God"

Here the pronoun **it** refers back to the phrase "this counsel or this work" in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [if God has devised this plan or commanded these men to do this work]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 5:39 (#1)

δὲ

"but"

Gamaliel uses this word to introduce a contrast between what would happen if the work the apostles are doing were "from men" and what would happen if it were **from God**. As the introduction to this chapter suggests, it may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation, as a new sentence: [However,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Acts 5:39 (#6)

ἐπείσθησαν & αὐτῷ

"they were persuaded by him"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [Gamaliel persuaded them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:39 (#3)

μήποτε

"lest"

It may be helpful to state the implications of the word **lest** explicitly. Alternate translation: [and if you do try to destroy them,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 5:39 (#5)

εὑρεθῆτε

"you may & be found"

The expression **be found** means to turn out to be something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [turn out to be]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:40 (#3)

λαλεῖν ἐπὶ τῷ ὀνόματι τοῦ Ἰησοῦ

"to speak in the name of Jesus"

The Sanhedrin members are using the term **name** to mean the person of Jesus. See how you translated the similar expression in 4:17. Alternate translation: [to speak about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:40 (#1)

καὶ

“And”

Luke uses the word translated as **And** to introduce what the Sanhedrin did as a result of Gamaliel’s advice. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 5:40 (#2)

προσκαλεσάμενοι τοὺς ἀποστόλους, δείραντες παρήγγειλαν

“summoning the apostles, having beaten them, they commanded them”

The Sanhedrin would have ordered their officers to bring back the apostles and beat them. They did not do those things personally. But Luke speaks as if they did do those things because they ordered them to be done. Alternate translation: [they had their officers bring back the apostles and beat them, and then they commanded them]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 5:41 (#2)

κατηξιώθησαν

“they had been considered worthy”

If your language would not use the passive form **had been considered**, you could state this with an active form, and you could state who did the action. Alternate translation: [God had considered them worthy]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 5:41 (#1)

ἀπὸ προσώπου τοῦ Συνεδρίου

“from the face of the Sanhedrin”

Luke is using the word **face** to mean “presence.” Alternate translation: [from the presence of the Sanhedrin]

See: Metaphor

Acts 5:41 (#3)

ὑπὲρ τοῦ ὀνόματος

“for the Name”

Here, **the Name** means Jesus. Alternate translation: [for Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:42 (#2)

ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ

“in the temple”

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when Luke says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [in the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 5:42 (#1)

τε

“And”

Luke uses the word translated as **And** to introduce information about what happened after this story as a result of the events within the story itself. Your language may have its own way of indicating how such information relates to a story.

See: End of Story

Acts 5:42 (#3)

οὐκ ἐπαύοντο, διδάσκοντες καὶ εὐαγγελιζόμενοι

“they did not cease teaching and proclaiming the gospel”

Luke is expressing a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. Alternate translation: [they continued to teach and to proclaim the gospel]

See: Litotes

Acts - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Acts 6:7 is a summary statement that Luke uses to mark the end of the first major part of the book.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The distribution to the widows

The believers in Jerusalem gave food every day to women whose husbands had died. All of them had been raised as Jews, but some of them spoke Hebrew and had lived mostly in Judea, while others spoke Greek and may have lived in Gentile areas. Those who gave out the food gave it to the Hebrew-speaking widows but not equally to the Greek-speaking widows. To please God, the church leaders appointed Greek-speaking men to make sure the Greek-speaking widows received their share of the food. One of these Greek-speaking men was Stephen.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“His face was like the face of an angel”
No one knows for sure what it was about Stephen’s face that was like the face of an angel, because Luke does not tell us. A note to this phrase offers one suggestion, which you may choose to follow. However, you might also decide to say only what the ULT says about this.

Acts 6:1 (#4)

παρεθεωροῦντο ἐν τῇ διακονίᾳ τῇ καθημερινῇ αἱ χῆραι αὐτῶν

“their widows were being overlooked in the daily serving”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you can say who was doing the action. Alternate translation: [those who were distributing food each day were overlooking their widows]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 6:1 (#2)

ἐν & ταῖς ἡμέραις ταύταις

“in those days”

Luke is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time. Alternate translation: [at that same time]

See: Idiom

Acts 6:1 (#1)

ἐν δὲ ταῖς ἡμέραις ταύταις

“Now in those days”

Luke uses this time reference to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 6:1 (#3)

τῶν Ἑλληνιστῶν

“by the Hellenists”

Hellenists was the name for Jews in the Roman Empire who spoke the Greek language and followed Greek customs.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 6:1 (#5)

ἐν τῇ διακονίᾳ τῇ καθημερινῇ

“in the daily serving”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **service**, you could express the same idea with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [by those who were distributing food each day]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 6:2 (#3)

οἱ δώδεκα

“the & Twelve”

Alternatively, even if your language does not ordinarily use adjectives as nouns, you may be able to do that in this case, since this is a title by which the apostles were known. Even though it is a number, if you translate it as a title, as ULT does, follow the conventions for titles in your language. For example, capitalize main words and write out numbers rather than use digits.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 6:2 (#2)

οἱ δώδεκα

“the & Twelve”

Luke is using the adjective **Twelve** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people, the apostles who led the church. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the 12 apostles] or see the next note for a further possibility.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 6:2 (#4)

καταλείψαντας τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“to leave behind the word of God”

The apostles are speaking as if they would walk away from the **word of God** and **leave** it **behind** them. Alternate translation: [to stop preaching and teaching the word of God]

See: Metaphor

Acts 6:2 (#1)

δὲ

“So”

Luke is using the word **So** to introduce the results of what the previous sentence described. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for this same purpose.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 6:2 (#5)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the word of God"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that God wanted the believers to share by using words. Alternate translation: [the message from God]

See: Metonymy

Acts 6:2 (#6)

διακονεῖν τραπέζαις

"to serve tables"

To describe the work that would be required for them personally to monitor the church's program of distributing food to people in need, the apostles speak as if they would be bringing food to people who were sitting at tables. Alternate translation: [to give our attention to food distribution]

See: Metaphor

Acts 6:3 (#2)

ἄνδρας & μαρτυρουμένους

"men of good reputation"

The expression **being attested** is a passive verbal form. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the same meaning with an active form. Alternate translation: [men to whose honesty people attest] or [men whom people say they trust]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 6:3 (#5)

ἐπὶ τῆς χρείας ταύτης

"over this task"

When the apostles say that they will appoint these men **over** the work of food distribution, they are using a spatial metaphor. Alternate translation: [to be responsible for this task]

See: Metaphor

Acts 6:3 (#4)

πλήρεις Πνεύματος καὶ σοφίας

"full of the Spirit and of wisdom"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **wisdom**, you could express the same idea with an adverb such as "wisely." Alternate translation: [in whose lives the Spirit is evidently present and who act very wisely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 6:3 (#3)

πλήρεις Πνεύματος καὶ σοφίας

"full of the Spirit and of wisdom"

The apostles are speaking of these men as if they were containers that the Holy Spirit and wisdom could fill. Alternate translation: [in whose lives the Spirit is evidently present and who possess great wisdom]

See: Metaphor

Acts 6:3 (#1)

ἀδελφοί

"brothers"

See how you translated the term **brothers** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [my fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 6:4 (#1)

τοῦ λόγου

"of the word"

The apostles are using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that God has told them to teach and preach by using words. Alternate translation: [of teaching and preaching the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 6:5 (#4)

ἄνδρα πλήρης πίστεως καὶ Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

"a man full of faith and of the Holy Spirit"

Luke is speaking of Stephen as if he was a container that faith and the Holy Spirit had filled. Alternate translation: [a man who possessed great wisdom and in whose life the Holy Spirit was evidently present]

See: Metaphor

Acts 6:5 (#2)

καὶ

"So"

Luke is using the word translated as **And** to introduce what the believers did as a result of the apostles' request. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 6:5 (#3)

Στέφανον & Φίλιππον & Πρόχορον & Νικάνορα & Τίμωνα & Παρμενᾶν & Νικόλαον

"Stephen & Philip & Prochorus & Nicanor & Timon & Parmenas & Nicolaus"

These are the names of seven men. They are all Greek names, and this suggests that all of the men selected were from the group of Greek-speaking Jews among the believers.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 6:5 (#1)

ἤρεσεν ὁ λόγος ἐνώπιον παντὸς τοῦ πλήθους

"the statement was pleasing before the whole multitude"

Luke is using the word **before** to refer to the opinion of the believers, since people assess things that come to their attention in front of them. Alternate translation: [what the apostles recommended pleased all of the other believers]

See: Metonymy

Acts 6:5 (#5)

ἄνδρα πλήρης πίστεως καὶ Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

"a man full of faith and of the Holy Spirit"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **faith**, you could express the same idea with a verb such as "trust." Alternate translation: [a man who confidently trusted in God and in whose life the Holy Spirit was evidently present]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 6:5 (#6)

Ἀντιοχέα

"from Antioch"

The name **Antiochian** describes a person who comes from the city of Antioch. Alternate translation: [who came from Antioch]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 6:6 (#1)

προσευξάμενοι, ἐπέθηκαν αὐτοῖς τὰς χεῖρας

"having prayed, they placed their hands upon them"

This could mean: (1) that the apostles first prayed and then placed their hands on these men. Alternate translation: [after they had prayed, they placed their hands upon them]; (2) that the apostles placed their hands on the men while they were praying for them. Alternate translation: [they prayed for them with their hands placed upon them] or [they placed their hands upon them and prayed for them]

See: Order of Events

Acts 6:6 (#2)

ἐπέθηκαν αὐτοῖς τὰς χεῖρας

"they placed their hands upon them"

The apostles **placed their hands** on the seven men to show publicly that they were giving them the responsibility and authority to oversee the food distribution. Alternate translation: [and placed their hands on them to show that they were giving them responsibility and authority]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 6:7 (#3)

ὁ λόγος τοῦ Θεοῦ ηὔξανεν

"the word of God kept spreading"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that God told the believers to spread by using words. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus kept becoming more widespread]

See: Metonymy

Acts 6:7 (#4)

ὑπήκουον τῇ πίστει

"became obedient to the faith"

Luke speaks generally of **the faith** (that is, belief in Jesus) to indicate that these priests **became obedient** to one part of it, Jesus' teachings about how to live. But that obedience showed that the priests genuinely embraced faith in Jesus as Messiah in its entirety. Alternate translation: [came to believe in Jesus and so started obeying his teachings]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 6:7 (#5)

ὑπήκουον τῇ πίστει

“became obedient to the faith”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **faith**, you could express the same idea with a verb such as “believe.” Alternate translation: [came to believe in Jesus and so started obeying his teachings]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 6:7 (#2)

ὁ λόγος τοῦ Θεοῦ ηὔξανεν

“the word of God kept spreading”

Luke is speaking of the way the message about Jesus kept becoming more widespread as if the word of God itself were **growing**. Alternate translation: [more and more people were hearing the word of God]

See: Metaphor

Acts 6:7 (#1)

As the outline in the General Introduction indicates, this verse is the end of the first major section of the book of Acts. That section describes how the apostles spread the good news about Jesus in Jerusalem. Luke uses this verse to summarize what happened as a result of the events within this whole section of the book. Your language may have its own way of indicating how such a summary relates to a significant part of a story.

See: End of Story

Acts 6:8 (#4)

Στέφανος & πλήρης χάριτος καὶ δυνάμεως, ἐποίει

“Stephen, full of grace and power, was doing”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the ideas behind the words **grace** and **power**, you could express the same ideas with adverbs. Alternate translation: [Stephen was supernaturally and powerfully doing]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 6:8 (#5)

τέρατα καὶ σημεῖα μεγάλα

“great wonders and signs”

The terms **wonders** and **signs** mean similar things. Luke is using them together for emphasis. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:22. Alternate translation: [many great miracles]

See: Doublet

Acts 6:8 (#3)

Στέφανος & πλήρης χάριτος καὶ δυνάμεως, ἐποίει

“Stephen, full of grace and power, was doing”

Luke may be using the two words **grace** and **power** together to express a single idea. The word **grace** would describe the character of the **power** that Stephen had. Specifically, it would be power that God was giving him. Alternate translation: [Stephen, full of gracious power, was doing] or [Stephen, full of power from God, was doing]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 6:8 (#2)

Στέφανος & πλήρης χάριτος καὶ δυνάμεως, ἐποίει

“Stephen, full of grace and power, was doing”

Luke is speaking as if Stephen were a container that **grace and power** were filling. Alternate translation: [Stephen had abundant grace and power, and so he was doing]

See: Metaphor

Acts 6:8 (#1)

Στέφανος δὲ

“Now Stephen”

Luke uses this phrase to introduce Stephen as the main character in this part of the story. Your language may have its own way of doing that. If so, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 6:9 (#4)

Κυρηναίων & Ἀλεξανδρέων & Κιλικίας & Ἀσίας

“of the Cyrenians & of the Alexandrians & Cilicia & Asia”

The word **Cyrenians** is the name for people from the city of Cyrene, and the word **Alexandrians** is the name for people from the city of Alexandria. The words **Cilicia** and **Asia** are the names of two Roman provinces.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 6:9 (#2)

τῆς συναγωγῆς, τῆς λεγομένης Λιβερτίνων

“the synagogue that is called Freedmen”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this with an active form. Alternate translation: [the synagogue whose name was Freedmen]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 6:9 (#1)

ἀνέστησαν

“there arose”

Here the expression **rose up** means that these people took action, specifically to oppose Stephen, not that they stood up from a seated position. Alternate translation: [took action to oppose Stephen]

See: Idiom

Acts 6:9 (#3)

τῆς συναγωγῆς, τῆς λεγομένης Λιβερτίνων

“the synagogue that is called Freedmen”

The word **Freedmen** probably refers to former slaves. Alternate translation: [the synagogue that former slaves attended]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 6:10 (#1)

οὐκ ἴσχυον ἀντιστῆναι

“they were not able to stand against”

In this context, the expression **stand against** means to try to defeat by argument. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they could not argue successfully against]

See: Idiom

Acts 6:10 (#3)

τῇ σοφίᾳ καὶ τῷ Πνεύματι, ᾧ ἐλάλει

“the wisdom and the Spirit by whom he spoke”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **wisdom**, you could express the same idea with an adjective such as “wise.” Alternate translation: [the wise things he said as the Spirit inspired him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 6:10 (#2)

τῇ σοφίᾳ καὶ τῷ Πνεύματι, ᾧ ἐλάλει

“the wisdom and the Spirit by whom he spoke”

Luke may be using the two words **wisdom** and **Spirit** together to express a single idea. The word **Spirit** would describe the source and character of the **wisdom** that Stephen was displaying. The word **Spirit** refers to the Holy Spirit. Alternate translation: [the Spirit-inspired wisdom by which he spoke] or [the wisdom that the Holy Spirit gave him as he spoke]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 6:11 (#3)

λαλοῦντος ῥήματα βλάσφημα

“speak blasphemous words”

The men are using the term **words** to mean the things that Stephen has been saying by using words. Alternate translation: [saying blasphemous things]

See: Metonymy

Acts 6:11 (#2)

ἀκηκόαμεν

“We have heard”

The men are using the word **We** to refer only to themselves, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 6:11 (#1)

ὑπέβαλον ἄνδρας λέγοντας

“they bribed men to say”

The word **instigated** means that Stephen’s opponents in some way persuaded these men to lie about what Stephen was saying. They may have offered them money, or they may have convinced them that Stephen was a dangerous person who needed to be stopped. Since Luke does not specify the means, it may be best not to suggest a means in your translation. But it would be appropriate to indicate that what these men were recruited to say about Stephen was a lie. Alternate translation: [recruited some men to lie about Stephen by saying]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 6:12 (#2)

συνεκίνησάν τε τὸν λαὸν, καὶ τοὺς πρεσβυτέρους, καὶ τοὺς γραμματεῖς

“They also stirred up the people and the elders and the scribes”

Luke says that Stephen's opponents **stirred up** these other groups, as if calm waters were being disturbed. He means that they said things to make them very upset with Stephen. Alternate translation: [They also said things that made the people, the elders, and the scribes very upset with Stephen]

See: Metaphor

Acts 6:12 (#1)

συνεκίνησάν

"They & stirred up"

In this verse and the next one, the word "they" continues to refer back to the opponents of Stephen who are named in 6:9.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 6:13 (#1)

οὐ παύεται λαλῶν

"does not stop speaking"

If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative verb **stop**. Alternate translation: [continually speaks]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 6:13 (#2)

λαλῶν ῥήματα

"speaking words"

The men are using the term **words** to mean things that Stephen has been saying by using words. Alternate translation: [saying things]

See: Metonymy

Acts 6:13 (#3)

τοῦ τόπου τοῦ ἁγίου

"the holy place"

The men are describing the temple in Jerusalem by referring to it by something associated with it, that it is a **holy place**. Alternate translation: [the temple]

See: Metonymy

Acts 6:14 (#1)

τὸν τόπον τοῦτον

"this place"

By **this place**, the false witnesses mean the temple, which they described as "the holy place" in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [this temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 6:14 (#2)

τὰ ἔθη ἃ παρέδωκεν ἡμῖν Μωϋσῆς

"the customs that Moses handed down to us"

The phrase **handed down** is an idiom that refers to something that is passed from generation to generation. The false witnesses are describing how the ancestors of the Jews have passed on the teachings originally received from Moses to each successive generation. Alternate translation: [the customs that our ancestors learned from Moses and have taught each successive generation]

See: Metonymy

Acts 6:15 (#1)

εἶδον τὸ πρόσωπον αὐτοῦ, ὡσεὶ πρόσωπον ἀγγέλου

"saw his face as the face of an angel"

Luke offers this comparison but he does not say specifically in what way Stephen's face was like **the face of an angel**. However, this may mean that his face was shining brightly, since descriptions of angels in the Bible often say they were shining brightly. So you might choose to say that in your translation. Alternate translation: [saw that his face was shining brightly, like the face of an angel]

See: Simile

Acts - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter presents Stephen's defense against the charges that false witnesses had made against him, as Luke describes in 6:13–14. Those witnesses had said, "This man does not stop speaking words against the holy place and the law. For we have heard him say that this Jesus the Nazarene will destroy this place and change the customs that Moses handed down to us." In response, Stephen shows that he respects the law, but he then shows how the Israelites have not kept the law. He next shows that he respects the temple, but he then explains that God does not live in temples made by people. Luke presents Stephen's speech within the narrative setting of his trial by the Sanhedrin.

- (v. 1) The high priest asks Stephen to answer the charges against him

- (vv. 2–19) Stephen tells the story of the Israelites up to the time of Moses
- (vv. 20–37) Stephen explains how Moses gave the law
- (vv. 38–43) Stephen shows that the Israelites did not keep the law that Moses gave
- (vv. 44–47) Stephen tells how the tabernacle and temple were built
- (vv. 48–50) Stephen explains that God does not live in temples that people build
- (vv. 51–54) Stephen makes his own charges against the Sanhedrin members
- (vv. 55–60) The Sanhedrin members, enraged, execute Stephen by stoning

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry that is quoted from the Old Testament in 7:42–43 and 49–50.

A note to 7:36–38 suggests making each of these verses a separate paragraph or using formatting in some other way to highlight the repeated phrases that Stephen uses to describe Moses.

It appears that 8:1 is part of the narrative of this chapter.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"Stephen said"
Stephen told the history of Israel very briefly. He paid special attention to the times that the Israelites had rejected the people God had chosen to lead them. At the end of the story, he said that the Jewish leaders he was talking to had rejected Jesus just as the evil Israelites had always rejected the leaders God had appointed for them.

"Full of the Holy Spirit"
The Holy Spirit completely controlled Stephen so that he said only and all of what God wanted him to say.

Foreshadowing
When an author speaks of something that is not important at that time but will be important later in the story, this is called foreshadowing. Luke mentions Saul in 7:58, even though he is not an important person in this part of the story. This is because Saul, also known as Paul, is an important person in the rest of the Book of Acts.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Implied information
Stephen was talking to Jews who knew the law of Moses well, so he did not explain things that his hearers already knew. But you may need to explain some of these things so that your readers will be able to understand what Stephen was saying. For example, you may need to make explicit that when Joseph's brothers "sold him into Egypt" (Acts 7:9), Joseph was going to be a slave in Egypt. (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

Metonymy
Stephen spoke of Joseph ruling "over Egypt" and over all of Pharaoh's household. By this he meant that Joseph ruled over the people of Egypt and of the people and possessions in Pharaoh's household. (See: Metonymy)

Textual Issues in This Chapter

"a dwelling for the house of Jacob" (7:46)
In 7:46, some ancient manuscripts read "a dwelling for the house of Jacob." ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read "a dwelling for the God of Jacob." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it has. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of ULT. (See: Textual Variants)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Background knowledge
The Jewish leaders to whom Stephen spoke already knew much about the events he was describing. They knew what Moses had written in the book of Genesis. If the book of Genesis has not been translated into your language, it may be difficult for your readers to follow what Stephen said. It may be helpful to provide some background information, either in the text or in notes.

Reference of "our" and "you"
Throughout this chapter, Stephen uses the word "our" to refer to himself and to his listeners. When he means only them, he says "you," and "you" is plural.

Acts 7:1 (#1)

ὁ ἀρχιερεύς

"the high priest"

Connecting Statement:

Luke assumes that his readers will know that **the high priest** was there and that he asked Stephen to testify

because he was a member of the Sanhedrin and its leader. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [the high priest, who was the leader of the Sanhedrin,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:2 (#6)

ἡμῶν

"our"

Here and throughout this chapter, Stephen is using the word **our** to refer to himself and to his listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 7:2 (#1)

ὁ δὲ ἔφη

"Then he said"

The pronoun **he** refers to Stephen, not the high priest. Alternate translation: [Then Stephen said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:2 (#2)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοὶ καὶ πατέρες

"Men, brothers and fathers"

The phrase **Men, brothers and fathers** is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [You brothers and fathers of mine]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:2 (#3)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοὶ καὶ πατέρες

"Men, brothers and fathers"

Stephen is using the word **brothers** to refer to his fellow Israelites. He is likely using the word **fathers** to refer to the leaders of Israel, the members of the Sanhedrin. In both cases he is speaking respectfully. Alternate translation: [My fellow Israelites and you leaders of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:2 (#4)

ὁ Θεὸς τῆς δόξης

"The God of glory"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **glory** with an adjective such as "glorious." Alternate translation: [The glorious God] or [God, who is glorious,] or see the next note for a further possibility.

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 7:2 (#7)

τῷ πατρὶ ἡμῶν Ἀβραὰμ

"to our father Abraham"

Stephen is using the term **father** to mean "ancestor." Alternate translation: [to Abraham our ancestor]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:2 (#5)

ὁ Θεὸς τῆς δόξης

"The God of glory"

Stephen apparently chooses to describe God in this way at the beginning of his speech in order to refute the charge made in 6:11 that he says blasphemous things about God. Calling him the **God of glory** acknowledges that people should rightfully give glory to God. You might choose to bring out this implication in your translation. Alternate translation: [God, to whom we should rightfully give glory,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:3 (#2)

εἶπεν πρὸς αὐτόν

"he said to him"

The pronoun **he** refers to God, while the pronoun **him** refers to Abraham. Alternate translation: [God said to Abraham]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:3 (#1)

εἶπεν πρὸς αὐτόν, ἔξελθε ἐκ τῆς γῆς σου καὶ ἐκ τῆς συγγενείας σου, καὶ δεῦρο εἰς τὴν γῆν ἣν & σοι δείξω

"he said to him, 'Go out from your land and from your relatives, and come into the land that I will show you"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this verse so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [God told Abraham to go out from his land and from his relatives and come into the land that he would show him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:4 (#1)

κατῴκησεν & αὐτοῦ, μετῴκισεν αὐτὸν

“he lived & his & he brought him”

The pronouns **his** and **him** and the first instance of the word **he** refer to Abraham, while the second instance of the word **he** refers to God. For clarity, in your translation you might say “Abraham lived” and “God brought him.”

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:4 (#2)

ὑμεῖς

“you”

The word **you** is plural. Stephen is using it to refer not just to the high priest, whose question he is answering, but also to all of the council members and the others who are listening to him. So you can use the plural form of the word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of You

Acts 7:5 (#3)

οὐδὲ βῆμα ποδός

“not even a footstep”

This could mean: (1) not enough ground to stand on or (2) not enough ground on which to take a step. Either way, the expression is implicitly describing a very small area. Alternate translation: [not even a tiny piece of ground]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:5 (#5)

αὐτῷ εἰς κατάσχεσιν & καὶ τῷ σπέρματι αὐτοῦ μετ’ αὐτόν

“to him for a possession, and to his seed after him”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **possession** with a verb such as “possess.” Stephen is saying that Abraham possessed the land in the sense that it was something that God had promised to him but that it was his descendants who came into actual possession of it. Alternate translation: [as something that his descendants would one day possess]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 7:5 (#2)

οὐκ ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ κληρονομίαν ἐν αὐτῇ

“he did not give him an inheritance in it”

Alternate translation: [he did not give any of it to him as an inheritance]

Acts 7:5 (#1)

οὐκ ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ & ἐπηγγείλατο & αὐτῷ & αὐτοῦ & αὐτόν, οὐκ ὄντος αὐτῷ

“he did not give him & he promised & to him & his & him—although he did not have”

The pronouns **him** and **his** and the third instance of **he** refer to Abraham, while the first two instances of **he** refer to God. For clarity, in your translation you might say “God did not give Abraham,” “God promised,” and “although Abraham did not have.”

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:5 (#4)

αὐτῷ εἰς κατάσχεσιν & καὶ τῷ σπέρματι αὐτοῦ μετ’ αὐτόν

“to him for a possession, and to his seed after him”

The term **seed** means “descendants.” Alternate translation: [to him for a possession, and to his descendants after him]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:6 (#3)

ἔσται τὸ σπέρμα αὐτοῦ, πάροικον ἐν γῇ ἀλλοτρίᾳ, καὶ δουλώσουσιν αὐτὸ καὶ κακώσουσιν

“his seed would be a stranger in a foreign land, and that they would enslave him and treat him badly”

Stephen is using the singular word **seed** to mean “descendants,” and so he uses the singular noun **stranger** and the singular pronoun **him**. For clarity in your translation, to show that he is not referring to a single individual, you could state “descendants” and “strangers” and use the plural pronoun **them**. Alternate translation: [his descendants would be strangers in a foreign land, whose people would enslave them and treat them badly]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:6 (#2)

ἐλάλησεν & οὕτως ὁ Θεὸς

“God spoke to him like this”

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that this occurred some time after the statement in the previous verse. It may be helpful to state that in your translation. Alternate translation: [Subsequently God told Abraham that]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:6 (#1)

ἐλάλησεν δὲ οὕτως ὁ Θεὸς ὅτι ἔσται τὸ σπέρμα αὐτοῦ, πάροικον ἐν γῇ ἀλλοτρίᾳ, καὶ δουλώσουσιν αὐτὸ καὶ κακώσουσιν ἔτη τετρακόσια

“But God spoke to him like this, that his seed would be a stranger in a foreign land, and that they would enslave him and treat him badly for 400 years”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [But God spoke to him like this, ‘Your seed would be a stranger in a foreign land, and they will enslave him and treat him badly for 400 years.’]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 7:7 (#1)

καὶ τὸ ἔθνος ᾧ ἐὰν δουλεύσωσιν κρινῶ ἐγώ, ὁ Θεὸς εἶπεν; καὶ μετὰ ταῦτα, ἐξελεύσονται καὶ λατρεύσουσίν μοι ἐν τῷ τόπῳ τούτῳ

“But I will judge the nation that will enslave him,’ said God, ‘and after that they will come out and serve me in this place”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [But God said that he would judge the nation that would enslave him and that after that they would come out and serve him in this place]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:7 (#3)

ἐὰν δουλεύσωσιν

“will enslave him”

As in 7:6, Stephen is using the singular pronoun **him** because he is using the singular word **seed** to mean “descendants.” For clarity, particularly if you said “descendants” in the previous verse, you could use the plural pronoun “them” instead. That would help readers recognize that Stephen also means Abraham’s descendants when he says “they” later in the verse. Alternate translation: [will enslave them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:7 (#2)

τὸ ἔθνος

“the nation”

Here, **nation** refers to the people who belong to that nation. Alternate translation: [the people of the nation]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:8 (#1)

ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ & ἐγέννησεν

“he gave him & he fathered”

The first instance of the pronoun **he** refers to God, while the word **him** and the second instance of the pronoun **he** refer to Abraham. For clarity, in your translation you might say “God gave Abraham … Abraham fathered.”

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:8 (#2)

ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ διαθήκην περιτομῆς

“he gave him the covenant of circumcision”

Stephen’s listeners would have known that this **covenant** required Abraham to circumcise the males of his family. Alternate translation: [he made a covenant that required Abraham to circumcise the males of his family]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:8 (#4)

καὶ Ἰσαὰκ τὸν Ἰακώβ, καὶ Ἰακὼβ τοὺς δώδεκα πατριάρχας

“and Isaac, Jacob; and Jacob, the 12 patriarchs”

Stephen is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. Alternate translation: [and Isaac fathered Jacob, and Jacob fathered the 12 patriarchs] or [and Isaac became the father of Jacob, and Jacob became the father of the 12 patriarchs]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 7:8 (#3)

τὸν Ἰσαὰκ & τὸν Ἰακώβ

“Isaac & Jacob”

These are the names of two men.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 7:8 (#5)

τοὺς δώδεκα πατριάρχας

"the 12 patriarchs"

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that he is using the word **patriarchs** to mean the sons of Jacob who became the ancestors of the tribes of Israel. Alternate translation: [12 sons who became the ancestors of the tribes of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:9 (#3)

ἦν & μετ' αὐτοῦ

"was with him"

When Stephen says that God **was with** Joseph, this is an idiom that means God helped him. Alternate translation: [helped him]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:9 (#2)

ἀπέδοντο εἰς Αἴγυπτον

"sold him into Egypt"

Stephen's listeners would have known that this meant that their ancestors sold Joseph into slavery and that he was taken to Egypt to be a slave there. Alternate translation: [sold him into slavery and he was taken to Egypt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:9 (#1)

οἱ πατριάρχαι

"the patriarchs"

Here the word **patriarchs** refers to the older sons of Jacob in their relationship with Joseph. If you refer to them in your translation as Joseph's brothers, use the word for an older brother if your language makes that distinction. Alternate translation: [Jacob's older sons] or [Joseph's older brothers]

See: Kinship

Acts 7:10 (#4)

ἐναντίον Φαραὼ

"before Pharaoh"

The phrase **before Pharaoh** could also refer to Pharaoh's opinion by association with the way that Pharaoh would assess anything that came to his attention in front of him. Alternate translation: [in Pharaoh's perspective]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:10 (#3)

ἐναντίον Φαραὼ

"before Pharaoh"

Here the phrase **before Pharaoh** may be an idiom that means "in the presence of." Alternate translation: [whenever he was in the presence of Pharaoh] or see next note for another possibility.

See: Idiom

Acts 7:10 (#7)

ὅλον τὸν οἶκον αὐτοῦ

"all his household"

The word **household** refers to Pharaoh's own servants and all his possessions. Alternate translation: [over all his servants and everything he owned]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:10 (#5)

κατέστησεν αὐτὸν ἡγούμενον ἐπ' Αἴγυπτον, καὶ ὅλον τὸν οἶκον αὐτοῦ

"he appointed him governor over Egypt and all his household"

In these phrases the words **he** and **his** refer to Pharaoh and the word **him** refers to Joseph. Alternate translation: [Pharaoh appointed Joseph governor over Egypt and all his household]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:10 (#1)

ἐξείλατο αὐτὸν ἐκ πασῶν τῶν θλίψεων αὐτοῦ; καὶ ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ

"he rescued him from all his afflictions, and he gave him"

In these phrases the word **he** refers to God and the words **him** and **his** refer to Joseph. Alternate translation: [God rescued Joseph from all his afflictions, and God gave Joseph]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:10 (#6)

ἐπ' Αἴγυπτον

“over Egypt”

The word **Egypt** refers to the people of Egypt. Alternate translation: [over all the people of Egypt]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:10 (#2)

ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ χάριν καὶ σοφίαν ἐναντίον Φαραὼ

“he gave him favor and wisdom before Pharaoh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract nouns **favor** and **wisdom** with adjectives. Alternate translation: [God made Pharaoh favorable towards Joseph and enabled Joseph to give Pharaoh wise advice]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 7:11 (#3)

οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν

“our fathers”

Stephen is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” He means specifically Jacob and his sons (Joseph’s older brothers), as UST indicates. Alternate translation: [our ancestors]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:11 (#1)

ἦλθεν & λιμὸς ἐφ’ ὅλην τὴν Αἴγυπτον καὶ Χανάαν, καὶ θλῖψις μεγάλη

“came a famine over all Egypt and Canaan, and great tribulation”

Here, Stephen speaks of **famine** and **tribulation** as if they **came** to Egypt and Canaan on their own. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could express this meaning in a non-figurative way. Alternate translation: [there was a famine over all Egypt and Canaan, and there was great tribulation]

See: Personification

Acts 7:11 (#2)

καὶ θλῖψις μεγάλη

“and great tribulation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **tribulation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and people suffered greatly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 7:12 (#3)

τοὺς πατέρας ἡμῶν

“our fathers”

Stephen is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” Here he means specifically Joseph’s older brothers, as UST indicates. Alternate translation: [our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:12 (#2)

ἐξαπέστειλεν τοὺς πατέρας ἡμῶν πρῶτον

“sent our fathers first”

By **first**, Stephen does not mean that Jacob sent Joseph’s older brothers to Egypt before he sent anyone else, or before he did anything else. He means that Jacob sent them for a first time and would later send them for a second time, as Stephen’s listeners would have understood. Alternate translation: [he sent our fathers on a first trip there to buy food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:12 (#1)

ὄντα σιτία εἰς Αἴγυπτον

“there was grain in Egypt”

Stephen assumes that his readers will know that with Joseph as his administrator, Pharaoh had stored up grain during prosperous years and was now selling it. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that people could buy stored grain from Pharaoh in Egypt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:13 (#3)

ἀνεγνωρίσθη Ἰωσὴφ τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς αὐτοῦ

“Joseph was made known to his brothers”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Joseph made himself known to his brothers] or [Joseph revealed to his brothers his identity as their brother]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:13 (#2)

ἐν τῷ δευτέρῳ

“during the second {time”

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [during trip number two] or [on their next trip]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Acts 7:13 (#1)

ἐν τῷ δευτέρῳ

"during the second {time"

Stephen is using the adjective **second** as a noun, to mean the second time that Joseph's brothers went to Egypt. ULT adds **time** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [when Jacob sent them to Egypt again to buy more food]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 7:13 (#4)

φανερὸν ἐγένετο τῷ Φαραὼ τὸ γένος Ἰωσήφ

"the family of Joseph became known to Pharaoh"

The phrase **became known** is not actually a passive form in Greek, but it might sound like one in other languages. If your language does not use passive forms, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Pharaoh learned that they were Joseph's family]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:14 (#1)

ἀποστείλας & Ἰωσὴφ μετεκαλέσατο Ἰακὼβ

"sending them back, Joseph summoned Jacob"

Stephen means that Joseph sent his brothers back home in order to get their father Jacob. Alternate translation: [Joseph sent his brothers back to Canaan to get Jacob]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Acts 7:14 (#2)

ἐν ψυχαῖς ἑβδομήκοντα πέντε

"in souls 75"

Stephen is using a Hebrew idiom here. Alternate translation: [who amounted to 75 people]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:15 (#1)

κατέβη Ἰακὼβ εἰς Αἴγυπτον

"Jacob went down to Egypt"

Stephen says that Jacob **went down** because he traveled from the hilly and mountainous terrain of Canaan to the lowlying land of Egypt. Alternate translation: [Jacob traveled to Egypt]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:15 (#2)

ἐτελεύτησεν αὐτὸς καὶ οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν

"he and our fathers died"

Stephen's listeners would have known that Jacob and his sons lived in Egypt for some time. Make sure that your translation does not make it sound as if they **died** as soon as they arrived in Egypt. Alternate translation: [eventually Jacob and our ancestors died]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:15 (#3)

αὐτὸς καὶ οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν

"he and our fathers"

Stephen is using the term **fathers** to mean "ancestors." Here he means specifically Jacob's sons (Joseph's older brothers), as UST indicates. Alternate translation: [Jacob and his sons who became our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:16 (#1)

μετετέθησαν εἰς Συχὲμ, καὶ ἐτέθησαν

"they were carried over to Shechem and laid"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Jacob's descendants brought his body and his son's bodies to Shechem and buried them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:16 (#2)

τιμῆς ἀργυρίου

"for a price in silver"

Stephen is referring to money by association with the way, in this culture, people used **silver** as money. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an

equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for a sum of money]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:17 (#3)

καθὼς & ἤγγιζεν ὁ χρόνος τῆς ἐπαγγελίας, ἧς ὡμολόγησεν ὁ Θεὸς τῷ Ἀβραάμ

“as the time of the promise that God had sworn to Abraham approached”

Stephen is referring to **the promise** that he described in 7:7. God promised Abraham that he would deliver his descendants from a nation that would enslave them and that he would bring them back to the land of Canaan. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [as the time approached of the promise that God had sworn to Abraham, that he would deliver his descendants from slavery and bring them back to Canaan,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:17 (#4)

ηὔξησεν ὁ λαὸς καὶ ἐπληθύνθη

“the people increased and multiplied”

Stephen is using the two words **increased** and **multiplied** together to express a single idea. The word **multiplied** tells in what way the people **increased**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use **and**. Alternate translation: [the people increased greatly]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 7:17 (#2)

καθὼς & ἤγγιζεν ὁ χρόνος τῆς ἐπαγγελίας, ἧς ὡμολόγησεν ὁ Θεὸς τῷ Ἀβραάμ

“as the time of the promise that God had sworn to Abraham approached”

Stephen is speaking of this **time** as if it were a person and could have **approached** on its own. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could express this meaning in a non-figurative way. Alternate translation: [when it was almost time for God to fulfill the promise he had sworn to Abraham]

See: Personification

Acts 7:17 (#1)

καθὼς δὲ ἤγγιζεν ὁ χρόνος τῆς ἐπαγγελίας & ηὔξησεν ὁ λαὸς καὶ ἐπληθύνθη

“And as the time of the promise & approached, the people increased and multiplied”

In your language it may be helpful to say that the people **increased and multiplied** before saying that **the time of the promise** approached. Alternate translation: [the people increased and multiplied in Egypt as the time of the promise ... approached]

See: Order of Events

Acts 7:18 (#1)

ἀνέστη βασιλεὺς ἕτερος ἐπ’ Αἴγυπτον

“another king arose over Egypt”

When Stephen says that this next king **arose**, he is using a spatial metaphor to mean that this king began his reign. Alternate translation: [another king began to rule over Egypt]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:18 (#3)

ὃς οὐκ ᾔδει τὸν Ἰωσήφ

“who did not know Joseph”

Stephen is not saying that this king **did not know Joseph** personally. Joseph had been dead for centuries by this point. Rather, **Joseph** refers to the reputation of Joseph. Alternate translation: [who did not know that Joseph had helped Egypt]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:18 (#2)

ἐπ’ Αἴγυπτον

“over Egypt”

The word **Egypt** refers to the people of Egypt. Alternate translation: [over the people of Egypt]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:19 (#3)

τοὺς πατέρας

“our} fathers”

Although the term **fathers** is masculine, when Stephen uses it to mean “ancestors,” it has a generic sense that includes both men and women. Here and throughout the speech, if you retain the metaphor in your translation, you could state “our fathers and mothers” to indicate this generic sense.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 7:19 (#2)

τοὺς πατέρας

“our} fathers”

Here and frequently throughout the rest of his speech to the Sanhedrin, Stephen is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If your readers might not understand this, you could express the meaning in a non-figurative way. Alternate translation: [our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:19 (#1)

οὗτος

“He”

He refers to the new king of Egypt, not to Joseph. Alternate translation: [This king]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:19 (#4)

τοῦ ποιεῖν τὰ βρέφη ἔκθετα αὐτῶν

“to make their babies exposed & them”

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that by **exposed** he means “left outside.” This was an unfortunate means of infanticide in the ancient world. Alternate translation: [forcing them to leave their babies outside]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:19 (#5)

εἰς τὸ μὴ ζῳογονεῖσθαι

“in order not to keep & alive”

Stephen is using a double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the verb **keep alive**, which was negative from Pharaoh’s perspective, since it was contrary to his intentions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this double negative as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [in order to kill them]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 7:20 (#3)

ἐγεννήθη Μωϋσῆς

“Moses was born”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the birth of Moses took place]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:20 (#2)

ἐγεννήθη Μωϋσῆς

“Moses was born”

Here Stephen introduces **Moses** into his story. See how you translated his name in 3:22.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 7:20 (#1)

ἐν ᾧ καιρῷ

“At that time”

Stephen uses this phrase to introduce something that happened while Pharaoh was trying to kill the Israelite babies. Alternate translation: [While this was happening,]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Acts 7:20 (#4)

ἦν ἀστεῖος τῷ Θεῷ

“he was beautiful to God”

This could mean: (1) that Moses was **beautiful** in God’s perspective. Alternate translation: [God considered him to be beautiful]; (2) in an idiom, that Moses was very **beautiful**. Alternate translation: [he was very beautiful]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:20 (#5)

ὃς ἀνετράφη & ἐν τῷ οἴκῳ τοῦ πατρός

“He was raised & in the house of {his} father”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, you could make Moses’ parents the subject. Alternate translation: [his parents cared for him ... in their home]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:21 (#1)

ἐκτεθέντος δὲ αὐτοῦ

“But when he was exposed”

Moses **was exposed** because of Pharaoh's command. If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, the context suggests that it was Moses' parents. Alternate translation: [when his parents had to place him outside]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:21 (#2)

ἀνείλατο αὐτὸν

"took him up"

This could mean: (1) that Pharaoh's daughter adopted Moses. The verb can have this figurative legal meaning. Alternate translation: [adopted him]; (2) that she lifted him up out of the basket he was in on the banks of the Nile. (This story is told in Exodus 2:1–10.) Alternate translation: [rescued him]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:22 (#2)

πάσῃ σοφίᾳ Αἰγυπτίων

"in all the wisdom of the Egyptians"

Stephen says **all** as an exaggeration for emphasis. Alternate translation: [thoroughly in the wisdom of the Egyptians]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 7:22 (#1)

ἐπαιδεύθη Μωϋσῆς πάσῃ σοφίᾳ Αἰγυπτίων

"Moses was educated in all the wisdom of the Egyptians"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Egyptians educated Moses in all of their wisdom]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:22 (#3)

δυνατὸς ἐν λόγοις καὶ ἔργοις αὐτοῦ

"mighty in his words and works"

Alternate translation: [effective in his speech and actions] or [influential in what he said and did]

Acts 7:23 (#2)

ὡς & ἐπληροῦτο αὐτῷ τεσσερακονταετὴς χρόνος

"when a 40-year time was filled to him"

Since this is an idiom, it would probably not be meaningful in most languages to retain the verb "fill" and use an active verbal form instead of the passive form. However, if your language does speak of someone or something "filling" days or times so that they arrive, and if your language does not use passive verbal forms, you could use an active form of "fill" here.

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:23 (#4)

ἀνέβη ἐπὶ τὴν καρδίαν αὐτοῦ

"it came up on his heart"

Here, **heart** is a metonym for the thoughts and emotions. Alternate translation: [he felt a desire]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:23 (#5)

τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς αὐτοῦ, τοὺς υἱοὺς Ἰσραήλ

"his brothers, the sons of Israel"

Stephen is using the word **brothers** to mean "kinsmen," and he is using the word **sons** to mean "descendants." Alternate translation: [his kinsmen, the descendants of Israel] or, if the word [Israel] might make your readers think of the nation rather than the person, [his kinsmen, the descendants of Jacob]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:23 (#1)

ὡς & ἐπληροῦτο αὐτῷ τεσσερακονταετὴς χρόνος

"when a 40-year time was filled to him"

This is an idiomatic way of speaking about time. Alternate translation: [after Moses had turned forty]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:23 (#6)

τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς αὐτοῦ, τοὺς υἱοὺς Ἰσραήλ

"his brothers, the sons of Israel"

Although the terms **brothers** and **sons** are masculine, Stephen is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If you decide to retain the metaphor in your translation, you could state

"brothers and sisters" and "sons and daughters" to indicate this.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 7:23 (#3)

ἀνέβη ἐπὶ τὴν καρδίαν αὐτοῦ

"it came up on his heart"

The expression **it came up on his heart** means that Moses felt a desire. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he felt a desire]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:24 (#3)

πατάξας τὸν Αἰγύπτιον

"striking the Egyptian"

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that Moses hit **the Egyptian** so hard that he died. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly. Alternate translation: [striking and killing the Egyptian]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:24 (#1)

ἰδών τινα ἀδικούμενον

"seeing a certain one being mistreated"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, it is clear from the context that it was **the Egyptian** who is mentioned later in the verse. Alternate translation: [seeing an Egyptian mistreating an Israelite]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:24 (#2)

ἐποίησεν ἐκδίκησιν τῷ καταπονουμένῳ, πατάξας τὸν Αἰγύπτιον

"made vengeance for the one being oppressed, striking the Egyptian"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [avenged him by striking the Egyptian who was oppressing him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:25 (#1)

τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς

"his} brothers"

Stephen is using the word **brothers** to mean "kinsmen." Alternate translation: [his kinsmen]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:25 (#3)

διὰ χειρὸς αὐτοῦ

"by his hand"

Here, **hand** refers to the actions of Moses. Alternate translation: [through his actions]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:25 (#2)

δίδωσιν σωτηρίαν αὐτοῖς

"was giving salvation to them"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in another way. In context, the word refers to God using Moses to deliver the Israelites from slavery. Alternate translation: [was delivering them from slavery]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 7:26 (#7)

ἱνα τί ἀδικεῖτε ἀλλήλους

"Why is it that you are hurting each other"

Moses is using a rhetorical question here to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You should not be hurting each other!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 7:26 (#2)

αὐτοῖς & αὐτοὺς & ἐστε & ἀδικεῖτε

"to them & them & you are & you are hurting"

Since Moses is speaking to two people, these uses of **them** and **you** would be dual if your language uses that form. Otherwise, they would be plural.

See: Forms of 'You' — Dual/Plural

Acts 7:26 (#5)

ἄνδρες

“Men”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Translate it with an expression that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Friends]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:26 (#6)

ἀδελφοί

“brothers”

Moses is using the word **brothers** to mean “kinsmen.” Alternate translation: [kinsmen]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:26 (#3)

συνήλλασσεν αὐτοὺς εἰς εἰρήνην

“he urged them to peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he urged them to stop fighting]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 7:26 (#4)

εἰπών, ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί ἐστε. ἵνα τί ἀδικεῖτε ἀλλήλους

“saying, ‘Men, you are brothers. Why is it that you are hurting each other”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [telling them that they were brothers and asking them why they were hurting each other]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:26 (#1)

αὐτοῖς

“to them”

It is clear from the context that these were two Israelite men, though Stephen does not say that specifically. Alternate translation: [to two Israelite men]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:27 (#1)

αὐτὸν

“him”

The word **him** refers to Moses, not to the neighbor. Alternate translation: [Moses]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:27 (#4)

ἄρχοντα καὶ δικαστὴν

“a ruler and a judge”

In this context, the words **ruler** and **judge** mean basically the same thing. The man is using repetition to emphasize the fact that he feels that Moses has no authority over them. If your language does not use repetition for such a purpose, you could use a single phrase and provide emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [an authority with power]

See: Doublet

Acts 7:27 (#2)

εἰπών, τίς σε κατέστησεν ἄρχοντα καὶ δικαστὴν ἐφ’ ἡμῶν

“saying, ‘Who appointed you a ruler and a judge over us”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [asking him who appointed him a ruler and a judge over them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:27 (#5)

ἡμῶν

“us”

The man is using the word **our** to refer to himself and to his neighbor, but not to Moses, so use the exclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 7:27 (#3)

τίς σε κατέστησεν ἄρχοντα καὶ δικαστὴν ἐφ’ ἡμῶν

“Who appointed you a ruler and a judge over us”

The man is using a rhetorical question to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If you would not use a

rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [No one appointed you a ruler and judge over us!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 7:28 (#1)

μὴ ἀνελεῖν με σὺ θέλεις, ὃν τρόπον ἀνεῖλες ἐχθὲς τὸν Αἰγύπτιον

"You do not want to kill me the way you killed the Egyptian yesterday, do you"

The first word of this sentence in Greek is a negative word that can be used to turn a negative statement into a question that expects a negative answer. ULT shows this by adding **do you?** Your language may have other ways of asking a question that expects a negative answer, for example, by changing the word order of a positive statement. Translate this in the way that would be clearest in your language. Alternate translation: [Do you want to kill me the way you killed the Egyptian yesterday]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 7:28 (#3)

μὴ ἀνελεῖν με σὺ θέλεις, ὃν τρόπον ἀνεῖλες ἐχθὲς τὸν Αἰγύπτιον

"You do not want to kill me the way you killed the Egyptian yesterday, do you"

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [The man asked Moses if he wanted to kill him the way he had killed the Egyptian the day before.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:28 (#4)

ὃν τρόπον

"the way"

Alternate translation: [in the same way in which]

Acts 7:28 (#2)

μὴ ἀνελεῖν με σὺ θέλεις, ὃν τρόπον ἀνεῖλες ἐχθὲς τὸν Αἰγύπτιον

"You do not want to kill me the way you killed the Egyptian yesterday, do you"

The man is using a rhetorical question implicitly to threaten Moses by indicating that he and probably others knew that Moses had killed the Egyptian. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I suppose you want to kill me the way you killed the Egyptian yesterday!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 7:29 (#2)

ἐν τῷ λόγῳ τούτῳ

"at this word"

Stephen is using the term **word** to mean what the man said by using words. Alternate translation: [at this statement]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:29 (#1)

ἔφυγεν & Μωϋσῆς ἐν τῷ λόγῳ τούτῳ

"Moses ran away at this word"

The implication is that Moses fled because he recognized that these Israelites, and probably others, knew that he had killed an Egyptian. Moses feared that he would be punished or even killed for this crime. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Moses ran away at this word to try to escape from being punished]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:29 (#3)

οὗ ἐγέννησεν υἱοὺς δύο

"where he fathered two sons"

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that Moses married a Midianite woman when he fled from Egypt. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [where he married a Midianite woman and fathered two sons]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:30 (#2)

πληρωθέντων ἐτῶν τεσσεράκοντα

"40 years having been filled"

Since this is an idiom, it would probably not be meaningful in most languages to retain the verb "fill" and use an active verbal form instead of the passive form.

However, if your language does speak of someone or something "filling" days or times so that they arrive, and if your language does not use passive verbal forms, you could use an active form of "fill" here.

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:30 (#4)

ὤφθη αὐτῷ & ἄγγελος

"an angel appeared to him"

Stephen assumes that his listeners know that God came to speak with Moses through the **angel**. The UST makes this explicit.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:30 (#3)

ὤφθη αὐτῷ & ἄγγελος

"an angel appeared to him"

The word **appeared** does not mean that Moses simply saw this angel in a vision. Rather, this expression indicates that the angel was actually present with Moses. Alternate translation: [suddenly an angel was there with Moses]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:30 (#1)

πληρωθέντων ἐτῶν τεσσεράκοντα

"40 years having been filled"

This is an idiomatic way of speaking about time. Alternate translation: [after 40 years had gone by]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:31 (#2)

ἐγένετο φωνὴ Κυρίου

"the voice of the Lord came"

Stephen is speaking of **the voice of the Lord** as if it were a person and that it **came** on its own. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could express this meaning in a non-figurative way. Alternate translation: [the Lord spoke to him]

See: Personification

Acts 7:31 (#1)

ἐθαύμασεν τὸ ὅραμα

"admired the sight"

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that Moses **admired the sight** because the bush was not burning up, even though it was on fire. Alternate translation: [marveled at what he saw, because the fire was not consuming the bush]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:32 (#1)

ἐγὼ ὁ Θεὸς τῶν πατέρων σου, ὁ Θεὸς Ἀβραὰμ, καὶ Ἰσαὰκ, καὶ Ἰακώβ

"I am the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, and of Isaac, and of Jacob"

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [The Lord told Moses that he was the God of his fathers, the God of Abraham, and of Isaac, and of Jacob]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:33 (#5)

ὁ γὰρ τόπος ἐφ' ᾧ ἕστηκας γῆ ἁγία ἐστίν

"for the place on which you are standing is holy ground"

The implication is that where God is present, the immediate area around God is considered or made **holy** by God. Alternate translation: [for the place on which you are standing has been made holy by my presence]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:33 (#3)

λῦσον τὸ ὑπόδημα τῶν ποδῶν σου

"Untie the sandal of your feet"

The implication is that God wanted Moses not only to untie his sandals but also to remove them. Alternate translation: [Untie your sandals and remove them from your feet]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:33 (#1)

εἶπεν & αὐτῷ ὁ Κύριος, λῦσον τὸ ὑπόδημα τῶν ποδῶν σου, ὁ γὰρ τόπος ἐφ' ᾧ ἕστηκας γῆ ἁγία ἐστίν

"the Lord said to him, 'Untie the sandal of your feet, for the place on which you are standing is holy ground"

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate

the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [the Lord told Moses to untie the sandals that were on his feet, because the place on which he was standing was holy ground]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:33 (#2)

λῦσον τὸ ὑπόδημα τῶν ποδῶν σου, ὁ γὰρ τόπος ἐφ' ᾧ ἕστηκας γῆ ἁγία ἐστίν

"Untie the sandal of your feet, for the place on which you are standing is holy ground"

In this culture, removing footwear was a symbolic way of acknowledging that a place was sacred. Footwear that had been worn elsewhere should not touch it. Your readers may understand the symbolic meaning of this action. If not, you could explain it in your translation. Alternate translation: [Untie your sandals and remove them to acknowledge that the place on which you are standing is holy ground]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 7:33 (#4)

τὸ ὑπόδημα τῶν ποδῶν σου

"the sandal of your feet"

Since this refers to both sandals, it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **sandals**. If your language uses the dual form, it would be appropriate to use that here. Alternate translation: [the sandals on your feet] or [the sandals you are wearing]

See: Collective Nouns

Acts 7:34 (#7)

ἀποστείλω σε εἰς Αἴγυπτον

"let me send you to Egypt"

God is not asking Moses' permission when he says **let me send you to Egypt**. This is a way of saying "I will send you to Egypt," and that statement in turn is functioning as a command. Alternate translation: [you must go to Egypt]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Acts 7:34 (#3)

τοῦ λαοῦ μου

"of my people"

God uses the possessive word **my** to emphasize that these people were in a covenant relationship with him based on his promises to their ancestors. Alternate translation: [of the descendants of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob]

See: Possession

Acts 7:34 (#5)

καὶ

"And"

God is using the word translated as **And** to introduce what he wants Moses to do as a result of what he has told him. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 7:34 (#2)

ἰδὼν, εἶδον

"I have certainly seen"

Stephen is reproducing a Hebrew idiom from the biblical account of Moses at the burning bush. The verb **seen** is repeated in Hebrew. This repetition expresses the intensity, certainty, or clarity of Yahweh's having seen how his people were being oppressed. This Hebrew practice of verb repetition for intensification cannot be directly translated into English. Use a natural form of strengthening a verb from your language.

See: Idiom

Acts 7:34 (#1)

ἰδὼν, εἶδον τὴν κάκωσιν τοῦ λαοῦ μου τοῦ ἐν Αἰγύπτῳ, καὶ τοῦ στεναγμοῦ αὐτῶν ἤκουσα, καὶ κατέβην ἐξελέσθαι αὐτούς; καὶ νῦν δεῦρο, ἀποστείλω σε εἰς Αἴγυπτον

"I have certainly seen the oppression of my people who {are} in Egypt, and I have heard their groaning, and I have come down to rescue them. And now come, let me send you to Egypt"

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [The Lord said that he had certainly seen the oppression of his people who were in Egypt and that he had heard their groaning and that he had come down to rescue them. He told Moses to get ready because he was sending him to Egypt]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:34 (#6)

νῦν δεῦρο

“now come”

God is giving an order here. Alternate translation: [get ready]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 7:34 (#4)

κατέβην ἐξελέσθαι αὐτούς

“I have come down to rescue them”

God describes himself as having **come down** from heaven to earth to help the Israelites. His presence was in the burning bush, but he also means that he is taking action to **rescue** them. Alternate translation: [I will personally bring about their release]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:35 (#5)

σὺν χειρὶ ἀγγέλου

“with the hand of the angel”

Here, **hand** is a metonym for the capability and actions of someone. Alternate translation: [accompanied by the power of the angel] or [through the actions of the angel]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:35 (#3)

ἄρχοντα καὶ δικαστήν

“a ruler and a judge”

See how you translated the combination of **ruler** and **judge** in 7:27. Alternate translation: [an authority with power]

See: Doublet

Acts 7:35 (#2)

τίς σε κατέστησεν ἄρχοντα καὶ δικαστήν

“Who appointed you a ruler and a judge”

See how you translated this rhetorical question in 7:27. Alternate translation: [No one appointed you a ruler and a judge!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 7:35 (#6)

ὀφθέντος αὐτῷ ἐν τῇ βάτῳ

“appeared to him in the bush”

See how you translated the word **appeared** in 7:30. Here as well, the word does not mean that Moses simply saw this angel in a vision. Alternate translation: [who was with him at the bush]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:35 (#4)

λυτρωτὴν

“a redeemer”

In this context, the word translated as **redeemer** refers to someone who delivers people from earthly troubles, not someone who brings eternal salvation. Alternate translation: [a rescuer]

Acts 7:35 (#1)

εἰπόντες, τίς σε κατέστησεν ἄρχοντα καὶ δικαστήν

“saying, ‘Who appointed you a ruler and a judge”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. See what you did in 7:27. Alternate translation: [asking him who appointed him a ruler and a judge]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:35–38 (#1)

τοῦτον τὸν Μωϋσῆν

“This Moses”

Verses 35, 36, 37, and 38 contains a series of similar phrases emphasizing the role of Moses. Stephen says **This Moses**, “This one,” “This is the Moses,” and “This is the one.” If possible, use similar statements in your own translation to emphasize Moses. You may also wish to make each of these verses a separate paragraph or use formatting in some other way to highlight the repeated phrases.

See: Litany

Acts 7:36 (#2)

Ἐρυθρᾷ Θαλάσσῃ

“the Red Sea”

Stephen is using the name that was common in his culture, **the Red Sea**, to refer to the body of water that the Old Testament calls “the Sea of Reeds.” Decide whether you want to use the name that Stephen uses here or the name that you are using in your translation in the Old Testament, if they are different. Alternate translation: [the Sea of Reeds]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 7:36 (#1)

τέρατα καὶ σημεῖα

“wonders and signs”

The terms **wonders** and **signs** mean similar things. Stephen is using them together for emphasis. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:22. Alternate translation: [great miracles]

See: Doublet

Acts 7:37 (#4)

τῶν ἀδελφῶν ὑμῶν

“your brothers”

Stephen is using the word **brothers** to mean “kinsmen.” Alternate translation: [your kinsmen]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:37 (#2)

τοῖς υἱοῖς Ἰσραήλ

“to the sons of Israel”

Stephen is using the word **sons** to mean “descendants.” Alternate translation: [to the descendants of Israel] or [to the descendants of Jacob]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:37 (#3)

προφήτην ὑμῖν ἀναστήσει & ὡς ἐμέ

“will raise up a prophet like me for you”

Here, the expression **raise up** describes God giving someone the mission to go as a prophet to certain people. See how you translated it in 3:22. Alternate translation: [will send you a prophet like me]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:37 (#1)

ὁ εἴπας τοῖς υἱοῖς Ἰσραήλ, προφήτην ὑμῖν ἀναστήσει ὁ Θεὸς, ἐκ τῶν ἀδελφῶν ὑμῶν, ὡς ἐμέ

“who said to the sons of Israel, ‘God will raise up a prophet like me for you from your brothers”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [who told the sons of Israel that God would raise up a prophet like him for them from their brothers]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:38 (#6)

λόγια ζῶντα

“living words”

Stephen is using the term **living** to describe God’s **words** as if they were alive. This could mean: (1) that God’s message is always effective. Alternate translation: [an enduring message]; (2) that God’s message shows how to live as God wishes. Alternate translation: [a life-giving message]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:38 (#3)

τῶν πατέρων ἡμῶν, ὃς ἐδέξατο

“with our fathers, who received”

This second instance of **who** in the verse refers to Moses, not to the **fathers**. For clarity, you could state his name and start a new sentence. Alternate translation: [with our fathers. Moses received]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:38 (#2)

μετὰ τοῦ ἀγγέλου τοῦ λαλοῦντος αὐτῷ ἐν τῷ Ὄρει Σινά, καὶ τῶν πατέρων ἡμῶν, ὃς ἐδέξατο λόγια ζῶντα

“with the angel {who was} speaking to him on Mount Sinai, and with our fathers, who received living words”

It might be more natural to put the information about **Mount Sinai** next to the information about Moses receiving **living words**. Alternate translation: [with our fathers and with the angel who was speaking to him on Mount Sinai, who received living words] or [with our fathers and with the angel who was speaking to him on Mount Sinai, where he received living words]

See: Information Structure

Acts 7:38 (#5)

λόγια ζῶντα

“living words”

Stephen is using the term **words** to mean the message that God communicated through words. Alternate translation: [a living message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:38 (#4)

ὃς ἐδέξατο λόγια ζῶντα

“who received living words”

It may be helpful in your language to specify who gave Moses the **words** that he **received**. Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that this was God. Alternate translation: [to whom God gave living words] or [to whom God spoke living words]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:38 (#1)

οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ γενόμενος

“This is the one having been”

This is the one refers to Moses. You may have decided to use similar language and special formatting in verses 35–38 to highlight the way Stephen is emphasizing Moses. However, if you think the reference would not be clear at this point, you could state his name. Alternate translation: [Moses is the one who was]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:39 (#1)

ᾧ οὐκ ἠθέλησαν ὑπήκοοι γενέσθαι οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν

“to whom our fathers were not willing to be obedient”

The word **whom** refers to Moses. It may be helpful to state his name and to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Our fathers were not willing to be obedient to Moses]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:39 (#2)

ἀπώσαντο

“they pushed him away”

Stephen is speaking to emphasize the Israelites’ rejection of Moses. Alternate translation: [they rejected him as their leader]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:39 (#3)

ἐστράφησαν ἐν ταῖς καρδίαις αὐτῶν εἰς Αἴγυπτον

“turned back in their hearts to Egypt”

Here, **hearts** is a metonym for people’s desires. Alternate translation: [made it their desire to return to Egypt]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:40 (#1)

εἰπόντες τῷ Ἀαρών, ποίησον ἡμῖν θεοὺς οἳ προπορεύσονται ἡμῶν. ὁ γὰρ Μωϋσῆς οὗτος, ὃς ἐξήγαγεν ἡμᾶς ἐκ γῆς Αἰγύπτου, οὐκ οἴδαμεν τί ἐγένετο αὐτῷ

“saying to Aaron, ‘Make for us gods who will go ahead of us. For this Moses, who brought us from the land of Egypt, we do not know what has happened to him”

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [They asked Aaron to make gods for them who would go ahead of them, because they did not know what had happened to Moses, who had brought them from the land of Egypt]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 7:40 (#3)

ὁ γὰρ Μωϋσῆς οὗτος, ὃς ἐξήγαγεν ἡμᾶς ἐκ γῆς Αἰγύπτου, οὐκ οἴδαμεν τί ἐγένετο αὐτῷ

“For this Moses, who brought us from the land of Egypt, we do not know what has happened to him”

It may be more natural to put the information about Moses at the end of the sentence. Alternate translation: [For we do not know what has happened to this Moses who brought us from the land of Egypt]

See: Information Structure

Acts 7:40 (#2)

εἰπόντες τῷ Ἀαρών

“saying to Aaron”

It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [They said to Aaron]

Acts 7:41 (#4)

τοῖς ἔργοις τῶν χειρῶν αὐτῶν

“the works of their hands”

Stephen describes what he also calls the **calf** and the **idol** as **the works of their hands** by association with the way the Israelites used their hands to make the calf. Alternate translation: [the statue they had made]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:41 (#3)

ἐμοσχοποίησαν

“they made an image of a calf”

The pronoun **they** refers back to “our fathers” in verse 39, that is, to the Israelites whom Moses led out of Egypt. Alternate translation: [the Israelites made an image of a calf]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:41 (#1)

ἐμοσχοποίησαν

“they made an image of a calf”

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that this **image of a calf** was a statue that the Israelites wanted to worship as an idol. Stephen refers to it as **the idol** later in the sentence. Alternate translation: [they made a statue that looked like a calf to worship as an idol]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:41 (#2)

ἐν ταῖς ἡμέραις ἐκείναις

“in those days”

Stephen is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time. Alternate translation: [at that time]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:42 (#5)

μὴ σφάγια καὶ θυσίας προσηνέγκατέ μοι, ἔτη τεσσεράκοντα ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ

“You did not offer slain beasts and offerings to me for 40 years in the wilderness, did you”

This is the beginning of a quotation from the prophet Amos, which continues through the end of verse 43. Even if your language does not customarily put one direct quotation inside another, it would be good to present this quotation from Amos as a direct quotation if possible, since God is addressing the Israelites directly in it. You may be able to indicate its beginning with an opening second-level quotation mark or with some other punctuation or convention that your language uses to indicate the start of a second-level quotation. You may also be able to use special formatting to set off the quotation, as ULT does.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 7:42 (#8)

μὴ & προσηνέγκατέ

“You did not offer & did you”

You is plural in these instances, even though the addressee (**house**) is singular, because God is actually speaking to all of the Israelites. If it would not be natural in your language to use the plural in such a case, you could use singular **you** in your translation.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Acts 7:42 (#9)

σφάγια καὶ θυσίας

“slain beasts and offerings”

In a figure of speech, God is using the two main categories of sacrifices, those that involve shedding blood (**slain beasts**) and those that are bloodless (**offerings**), to mean sacrifices of all kinds. If this would be misunderstood in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or non-figurative language. Alternate translation: [all kinds of sacrifices]

See: Merism

Acts 7:42 (#6)

μὴ σφάγια καὶ θυσίας προσηνέγκατέ μοι, ἔτη τεσσεράκοντα ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ, οἶκος Ἰσραήλ

“You did not offer slain beasts and offerings to me for 40 years in the wilderness, did you, O house of Israel”

The first word of this sentence in Greek is a negative word that can be used to turn a negative statement into a question that expects a negative answer. ULT shows this by adding **did you?** Your language may have other ways of asking a question that expects a negative answer, for example, by changing the word order of a positive statement. Translate this in the way that would be clearest in your language. Alternate translation: [Did you offer slain beasts and offerings to me for 40 years in the wilderness, O house of Israel?]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 7:42 (#1)

ἔστρεψεν & ὁ Θεὸς

“God turned away”

Stephen is speaking as if **God** had physically **turned away**. He speaks this way to emphasize that God was not pleased with the Israelites and no longer helped them. Alternate translation: [God stopped helping them]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:42 (#3)

γέγραπται ἐν βίβλῳ τῶν προφητῶν

"it is written in the book of the prophets"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the book of the prophets says] or [the book of the prophets records]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:42 (#10)

οἶκος Ἰσραήλ

"O house of Israel"

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So the **house of Israel** means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [nation of Israel] or [people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:42 (#7)

μὴ σφάγια καὶ θυσίας προσηνέγκατέ μοι, ἔτη τεσσεράκοντα ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ, οἶκος Ἰσραήλ

"You did not offer slain beasts and offerings to me for 40 years in the wilderness, did you, O house of Israel"

Speaking through the prophet Amos, God used the question form to emphasize to the people of **Israel** that they did not really worship Him **in the wilderness** with their sacrifices. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You did not honor me when you offered slain beasts and sacrifices for 40 years in the wilderness, O house of Israel!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 7:42 (#4)

βίβλῳ τῶν προφητῶν

"the book of the prophets"

This was apparently a collection of the writings of several of the Old Testament prophets on one scroll. Alternate translation: [the scroll that records sayings of the prophets]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:42 (#2)

τῇ στρατιᾷ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ

"the host of heaven"

Here, the word **host** means "army," and the word **heaven** means "sky." Stephen is speaking of the stars in the sky as if they were an army. Alternate translation, as in UST: [the stars in the sky]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:43 (#5)

τὴν σκηνὴν τοῦ Μολὸχ

"the tabernacle of Molech"

The **tabernacle of Molech** was a tent or shrine that housed an idol of the false god Molech. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly, as UST does.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:43 (#3)

ἀνελάβετε & μετοικιῶ ὑμᾶς

"you took up & I will remove you"

The term **took up** indicates that the Israelites carried the idols this verse describes around with them as they traveled in the wilderness. The term **remove** in this context means that God will send them into exile as a punishment, with the sense of carrying them away from their homeland. So the punishment is ironic; if possible, use similar terms in your language that will bring out this irony. Alternate translation: [you carried around ... I will carry you away]

See: Irony

Acts 7:43 (#2)

καὶ

"And"

And at the beginning of this verse introduces God's own answer to the question he asked in the previous verse, 7:42: "You did not offer slain beasts and offerings to me ..., did you?" The answer is in contrast to what the question asks. Use a natural way in your language for introducing a contrast. Alternate translation, followed by a sentence break: [No!]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Acts 7:43 (#1)

καὶ ἀνελάβετε τὴν σκηνὴν τοῦ Μολὸχ, καὶ τὸ ἄστρον τοῦ θεοῦ ὑμῶν Ῥαιφάν, τοὺς τύπους οὓς ἐποιήσατε προσκυνεῖν αὐτοῖς. καὶ μετοικιῶ ὑμᾶς ἐπέκεινα Βαβυλῶνος

“And you took up the tabernacle of Molech and the star of your god Rephan— the images that you made to worship them— and I will remove you beyond Babylon”

The quotation from the prophet Amos continues here.

Acts 7:43 (#4)

ἀνελάβετε & ὑμῶν & ἐποιήσατε & ὑμᾶς

“you took up & your & you made & you”

As in 7:42, **you** is plural here, even though the addressee (“house”) is singular, since God is speaking to all of the Israelites. In this verse **your** is also plural. If it would not be natural in your language to use the plural in these cases, you could use the singular in your translation.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Acts 7:43 (#9)

μετοικιῶ ὑμᾶς ἐπέκεινα Βαβυλῶνος

“I will remove you beyond Babylon”

This is the end of the quotation from the prophet Amos that began in verse 42. See how you marked the beginning of the quotation there. It would be appropriate to mark its ending here with a closing second-level quotation mark or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate the end of a second-level quotation. If you used special formatting to set off the quotation, you could return to regular formatting after this verse.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 7:43 (#7)

τοὺς τύπους οὓς ἐποιήσατε

“the images that you made”

The word **images** refers to the idol of Molech and the star-shaped image of Rephan. It may be helpful to make this a separate sentence. Alternate translation: [You made that idol of Molech and that star-shaped image of Rephan so that you could worship those false gods.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:43 (#8)

καὶ

“and”

Speaking through Amos, God uses the word translated as **and** to introduce what he will do as a result of the Israelites’ unfaithfulness and disobedience. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [As a result]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 7:43 (#6)

τὸ ἄστρον τοῦ θεοῦ ὑμῶν Ῥαιφάν

“the star of your god Rephan”

The Israelites were not carrying around an actual **star**, but an image designed to look like a star. This image was used in the worship of the false god Rephan. (This may have been the planet Saturn.) Alternate translation: [the star-shaped image of your god Rephan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:44 (#6)

τὸν τύπον ὃν ἑωράκει

“the pattern that he had seen”

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that he is referring to the **pattern** for the tabernacle that God showed Moses on Mount Sinai. Alternate translation: [the pattern that he showed him on Mount Sinai]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:44 (#5)

διετάξατο ὁ λαλῶν τῷ Μωϋσῇ

“the one speaking to Moses had commanded”

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that he is referring to the way God spoke to Moses on Mount Sinai. Alternate translation: [God commanded Moses when he spoke to him on Mount Sinai]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:44 (#3)

ἡ σκηνὴ τοῦ μαρτυρίου

“The tabernacle of the testimony”

Stephen calls this tent the **tabernacle of the testimony** by association with the way it housed the ark of the covenant, which was also known as the ark of the testimony. The “testimony” of the ark, as UST

indicates, was to the covenant between God and the Israelites and to his presence with them wherever they went in the wilderness. Alternate translation: [the tent that housed the ark of the covenant]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:44 (#2)

ἡ σκηνὴ τοῦ μαρτυρίου ἦν τοῖς πατράσιν ἡμῶν ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ, καθὼς διετάξατο ὁ λαλῶν τῷ Μωϋσῇ

"The tabernacle of the testimony was with our fathers in the wilderness, just as the one speaking to Moses had commanded"

Stephen is not saying that the **tabernacle** was **with** the Israelites just as God had commanded. He means that the tabernacle was built **according to the pattern** that Moses saw on Mount Sinai. To make this clear, it may be helpful to supply some of the words that Stephen is leaving out. It may also be helpful to introduce a sentence break. Alternate translation: [The tabernacle of the testimony was with our fathers in the wilderness. It was built just as the one speaking to Moses had commanded]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 7:44 (#4)

καθὼς διετάξατο ὁ λαλῶν τῷ Μωϋσῇ, ποιῆσαι αὐτὴν κατὰ τὸν τύπον ὃν ἑωράκει

"just as the one speaking to Moses had commanded, to make it according to the pattern that he had seen"

It may be more natural to put the information about the command to Moses before the information about how Moses fulfilled the command. It may also be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [The one speaking to Moses had commanded him to make the tabernacle according to the pattern that he had seen, and he made it just that way]

See: Information Structure

Acts 7:44 (#1)

Stephen continues his response to the high priest and the council which he began in Acts 7:2.

Acts 7:45 (#3)

εἰσήγαγον & μετὰ Ἰησοῦ

"brought in with Joshua"

When Stephen says that the Israelites brought in the tabernacle **with Joshua**, he does not mean that they brought in both the tabernacle and Joshua. He means that the Israelites did the things he describes in obedience to Joshua's directions. Alternate translation: [brought in as Joshua directed them]

Acts 7:45 (#4)

εἰσήγαγον

"brought in"

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that he is referring to the Israelites entering the land of Canaan. Alternate translation: [brought in to the land of Canaan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:45 (#5)

ἐν τῇ κατασχέσει τῶν ἐθνῶν

"in the possessing of the nations"

Stephen is using the term **nations** to mean the land that these people groups occupied. Alternate translation: [when they took possession of land that had been occupied by the nations]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:45 (#1)

ἣν καὶ εἰσήγαγον, διαδεξάμενοι οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν

"which also our fathers, having received it in turn, brought in"

The pronoun **which** refers to the tabernacle. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Our ancestors received the tabernacle from their ancestors, and they brought it in]

See: Pronouns

Acts 7:45 (#7)

ἕως τῶν ἡμερῶν Δαυείδ

"until the days of David"

Stephen is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages in order to be complete. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [The tabernacle remained there until the days of David]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 7:45 (#8)

τῶν ἡμερῶν Δαυείδ

"the days of David"

Stephen is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time. Alternate translation: [the time of David]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:45 (#6)

ἀπὸ προσώπου τῶν πατέρων ἡμῶν

“from the face of our fathers”

Stephen is using the word **face** to mean “presence.” Alternate translation: [from the presence of our ancestors] or [so that our ancestors alone would live there]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:45 (#2)

διαδεξάμενοι

“having received it in turn”

The phrase **having received ... in turn** translates a Greek verb that refers to receiving something in succession, in this case from one’s ancestors. Alternate translation: [having received it from their ancestors]

Acts 7:46 (#6)

τῷ οἴκῳ Ἰακώβ

“for the house of Jacob”

Some ancient manuscripts read “the house of Jacob.” ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “the God of Jacob.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it has. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 7:46 (#5)

σκήνωμα

“a dwelling”

The word **dwelling** refers to a permanent habitation, that is, a house. Stephen is using the word to mean a temple. He is speaking of this temple as if it was a house in which God lived, since God’s presence was there. Alternate translation: [a house]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:46 (#1)

εὑρεῖν

“to find”

Stephen is speaking. David did not ask God if he could go look for this **dwelling**. David asked God if he could build it. Alternate translation: [to build]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:46 (#4)

εὑρεῖν

“to find”

Stephen is speaking. David did not ask God if he could go look for this **dwelling**. David asked God if he could build it. Alternate translation: [to build]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:46 (#3)

ὃς εὗρεν χάριν ἐνώπιον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“who found favor before God”

Here the phrase **before God** refers to God’s opinion by association with the way that God would assess anything that came to his attention in front of him. Alternate translation: [God regarded David with favor]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:46 (#7)

τῷ οἴκῳ Ἰακώβ

“for the house of Jacob”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Jacob** means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:46 (#2)

ὃς εὗρεν χάριν ἐνώπιον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“who found favor before God”

The pronoun **who** refers to David. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [David found favor before God]

See: Pronouns

Acts 7:47 (#1)

αὐτῷ οἶκον

“the house for him”

Stephen is using the word **house** to mean a temple. Alternate translation: [a temple for him]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:47 (#2)

αὐτῷ οἶκον

“the house for him”

The pronoun **him** refers to God. Alternate translation: [a temple for God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:48 (#4)

χειροποιήτοις

“houses} made with hands”

The word **houses** means “temples.” Alternate translation: [temples that people build]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:48 (#3)

χειροποιήτοις

“houses} made with hands”

Stephen is using the word **hand**, one part of a person, to mean the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [houses that people build]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 7:48 (#1)

ὁ Ὕψιστος

“the Most High”

This a name for God. UST suggests one way to express its meaning.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 7:48 (#2)

χειροποιήτοις

“houses} made with hands”

Stephen is using the adjective **made with hands** (or “handmade”) as a noun, to mean structures built by humans. ULT adds **houses** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [temples that people build]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 7:48 (#5)

καθὼς ὁ προφήτης λέγει

“as the prophet says”

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that by **the prophet**, he means Isaiah. Alternate translation: [as the prophet Isaiah says]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:49 (#5)

ποῖον οἶκον οἰκοδομήσετέ μοι? λέγει Κύριος, ἢ τίς τόπος τῆς καταπαύσεώς μου

“What kind of house will you build for me?’ says the Lord, ‘or what {is} the place for my rest”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. God says the same thing twice, in slightly different ways, to emphasize the truth of what he is saying. If saying the same thing twice might be confusing for your readers, you could combine the phrases into one. Alternate translation: [You cannot build a temple that is worthy for me to live in!]

See: Parallelism

Acts 7:49 (#6)

ποῖον οἶκον

“What kind of house”

The word **house** means a “temple.” Alternate translation: [What kind of temple]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:49 (#2)

ὁ οὐρανός μοι θρόνος, ἡ δὲ γῆ ὑποπόδιον τῶν ποδῶν μου

“Heaven {is} my throne, and the earth {is} the footstool for my feet”

Speaking through Isaiah, God describes **Heaven** as his **throne** and **the earth** as his **footstool**. If your readers would not understand what these figures mean, you could use equivalent metaphors from your culture, or you could express the meaning in a non-figurative way. This could mean: (1) that God is present both in heaven and on earth. Alternate translation: [I dwell in heaven, and I am also present throughout the earth]; (2) that God rules over heaven and earth. Alternate translation: [I rule from heaven, and I have complete authority over the earth]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:49 (#4)

ποῖον οἶκον οἰκοδομήσετέ μοι? λέγει Κύριος, ἢ τίς τόπος τῆς καταπαύσεώς μου

"What kind of house will you build for me?' says the Lord, 'or what {is} the place for my rest"

God is using the question form to emphasize that human beings cannot build a temple worthy of him or adequate for him. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [You cannot build a temple that is worthy of me or a place to live that is adequate for me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 7:49 (#7)

τόπος τῆς καταπαύσεώς μου

"the place for my rest"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rest**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the place where I can live]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 7:49 (#1)

ὁ οὐρανός μοι θρόνος, ἡ δὲ γῆ ὑποπόδιον τῶν ποδῶν μου

"Heaven {is} my throne, and the earth {is} the footstool for my feet"

This is the beginning of a quotation from the prophet Isaiah, which continues through the end of verse 50. Even if your language does not customarily put one direct quotation inside another, it would be good to present this quotation from Isaiah as a direct quotation if possible, since God is addressing the Israelites directly in it. You may be able to indicate its beginning with an opening second-level quotation mark or with some other punctuation or convention that your language uses to indicate the start of a second-level quotation. You may also be able to use special formatting to set off the quotation, as ULT does.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 7:49 (#3)

ὁ οὐρανός μοι θρόνος, ἡ δὲ γῆ ὑποπόδιον τῶν ποδῶν μου

"Heaven {is} my throne, and the earth {is} the footstool for my feet"

God is using the two parts of creation, **Heaven** and **earth**, to mean all of creation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. This could mean: (1) Alternate translation: [I am present everywhere in creation]; (2) Alternate translation: [I rule over all of creation]

See: Merism

Acts 7:50 (#2)

οὐχὶ ἡ χείρ μου ἐποίησεν ταῦτα πάντα

"Did my hand not make all these things"

God is using the question form for emphasis. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [My hand made all these things!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 7:50 (#1)

οὐχὶ ἡ χείρ μου ἐποίησεν ταῦτα πάντα

"Did my hand not make all these things"

This is the end of the quotation from the prophet Isaiah that began in verse 49. See how you marked the beginning of the quotation there. It would be appropriate to mark its ending here with a closing second-level quotation mark or with whatever other punctuation or convention your language uses to indicate the end of a second-level quotation. If you used special formatting to set off the quotation, you could return to regular formatting after this verse.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 7:50 (#4)

ταῦτα πάντα

"all these things"

The phrase **all these things** refers back to "Heaven" and "earth" in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [everything in creation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:50 (#3)

οὐχὶ ἡ χείρ μου ἐποίησεν ταῦτα πάντα

"Did my hand not make all these things"

God is using one part of himself, his **hand**, to represent all of himself in the act of creating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [Did I not make all these things?] or, if you choose to represent the rhetorical question as an exclamation, [I made all these things!]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 7:51 (#4)

ἀπερίτμητοι καρδίαις καὶ τοῖς ὠσίν

"uncircumcised in heart and ears"

Stephen speaks of the Sanhedrin members' **heart and ears** as **uncircumcised** by association with the way that Gentiles, who are uncircumcised because they are not part of the covenant community, do not obey or listen to God. Alternate translation: [unwilling to obey or listen to God]

See: Metonymy

Acts 7:51 (#6)

ἀπερίτμητοι καρδίαις καὶ τοῖς ὠσίν

"uncircumcised in heart and ears"

Stephen is using one part of a person, the **ears**, to represent all of a person in the act of listening. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [unwilling to obey or listen to God]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 7:51 (#8)

ὑμεῖς & ὑμῶν & ὑμεῖς

"You & your & you"

The words **you** and **your** are plural, since Stephen is speaking to all the members of the Sanhedrin. So use plural forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Acts 7:51 (#3)

σκληροτράχηλοι

"O stiff-necked"

Stephen is speaking of the Sanhedrin members as if they were horses or mules that stiffened their necks in order not to be turned in one direction or another. He means that they are being stubborn. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent metaphor from your culture, or you could express the meaning in a non-figurative way. Alternate translation: [O stubborn]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:51 (#7)

ὑμεῖς ἀεὶ τῷ Πνεύματι τῷ Ἁγίῳ ἀντιπίπτετε

"You always resist the Holy Spirit"

The word **always** is a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [You keep resisting the Holy Spirit]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 7:51 (#1)

σκληροτράχηλοι καὶ ἀπερίτμητοι καρδίαις καὶ τοῖς ὠσίν

"O stiff-necked and uncircumcised in heart and ears"

Stephen is using the exclamatory word **O** to make a transition in his speech. Up to this point, he has been identifying with the Sanhedrin members, saying "our fathers" as he describes what earlier generations of Israelites did. Now, as he shifts to rebuking them, he addresses them with the vocative **O**. Use an exclamation that is natural in your language for this same purpose. Alternate translation: [You stiff-necked people who are uncircumcised in your heart and ears]

See: Exclamations

Acts 7:51 (#5)

ἀπερίτμητοι καρδίαις καὶ τοῖς ὠσίν

"uncircumcised in heart and ears"

Stephen is using one part of a person, the **heart**, meaning the desires and will, to represent all of a person in the act of obeying or disobeying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [unwilling to obey or listen to God]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 7:51 (#2)

σκληροτράχηλοι καὶ

"O stiff-necked and"

Stephen is using the adjective **stiff-necked** as a noun, to describe a kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate

this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [O people who are stiff-necked and]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 7:51 (#9)

ὡς οἱ πατέρες ὑμῶν, καὶ ὑμεῖς

"As your fathers, also you"

Stephen is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. Alternate translation: [As your ancestors disobeyed God and did not listen to him, so you disobey God and do not listen to him]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 7:52 (#1)

τίνα τῶν προφητῶν οὐκ ἐδίωξαν οἱ πατέρες ὑμῶν

"Which of the prophets did your fathers not persecute"

Stephen is not asking for information. He is using the question form for emphasis. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Your ancestors persecuted each of the prophets!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 7:52 (#2)

τίνα τῶν προφητῶν οὐκ ἐδίωξαν οἱ πατέρες ὑμῶν

"Which of the prophets did your fathers not persecute"

Stephen's rhetorical question has an implicit generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language that conveys emphasis. Alternate translation: [Your ancestors kept persecuting the prophets!]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 7:52 (#3)

τοῦ Δικαίου

"of the Righteous One"

Stephen is using the adjective **Righteous** as a noun in order to describe a specific person. ULT adds **One** to show this. This is a title that refers to the Christ, the Messiah. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with a noun phrase. Alternate translation: [of the Messiah, who was righteous]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 7:52 (#4)

οὗ νῦν ὑμεῖς προδόται καὶ φονεῖς ἐγένεσθε

"whose betrayers and murderers you have now become"

It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [You have now betrayed and murdered him]

Acts 7:53 (#2)

οἵτινες ἐλάβετε

"who received"

The Sanhedrin members whom Stephen is addressing did not receive **the law** themselves. Rather, Stephen is using them to represent the entire Jewish community down through the years. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [whose community received] or, if you choose to start a new sentence, [Your community received]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 7:53 (#3)

εἰς διαταγὰς ἀγγέλων

"by directions of angels"

Stephen assumes that his listeners will know that he is referring to God giving the law to the Israelites at Mount Sinai. A later Jewish tradition said that angels acted as God's intermediaries at that time. (Stephen says in 7:38 that an angel was speaking to Moses on Mount Sinai.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [as angels delivered it on Mount Sinai]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:53 (#1)

οἵτινες ἐλάβετε

"who received"

The pronoun **who** refers to the Sanhedrin members whom Stephen is addressing. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [You received]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 7:54 (#3)

ἔβρυχον τοὺς ὀδόντας ἐπ' αὐτόν

"they ground {their} teeth at him"

This action expressed their strong anger at Stephen. If there is a gesture with similar meaning in your culture, you could consider using it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [they became so angry at Stephen that they ground their teeth together] or [they moved their teeth back and forth as they looked angrily at Stephen]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 7:54 (#2)

διεπρίοντο ταῖς καρδίαις αὐτῶν

"they were cut to their hearts"

Here, the expression **they were cut to their hearts** is an idiom that means the Sanhedrin members became very angry. If your readers would not understand this, you could use an equivalent idiom or use plain language. Alternate translation: [they became furious at Stephen]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:54 (#1)

ἀκούοντες & ταῦτα διεπρίοντο ταῖς καρδίαις αὐτῶν

"hearing these things, they were cut to their hearts"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [these things cut them to their hearts when they heard them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 7:55 (#1)

πλήρης Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

"full of the Holy Spirit"

Luke is speaking of Stephen as if he were a container that the Holy Spirit could fill. Alternate translation: [inspired by the Holy Spirit]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:55 (#3)

δόξαν Θεοῦ

"the glory of God"

The implication is that Stephen saw a bright light that expressed the magnificent presence of God. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [a bright light that expressed the glorious presence of God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:55 (#6)

Ἰησοῦν ἑστῶτα ἐκ δεξιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"Jesus standing at the right of God"

Elsewhere in the New Testament, Jesus is described as "sitting" **at the right of God**. Many interpreters believe that Jesus stood on this occasion to honor Stephen for his courage and faithful testimony. If there is a gesture with similar meaning in your culture, you could consider using it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [Jesus, in a place of honor next to God, standing to honor him]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 7:55 (#2)

ἀτενίσας εἰς τὸν οὐρανὸν, εἶδεν

"looking intently into heaven, he saw"

The implication is that only Stephen saw this vision, not anyone else who was present. Alternate translation: [staring up into heaven, he saw in a vision]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:55 (#5)

Ἰησοῦν ἑστῶτα ἐκ δεξιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"Jesus standing at the right of God"

In this culture, the place at the right side of a ruler was a position of honor. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Jesus standing in a place of honor next to God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:55 (#4)

Ἰησοῦν ἑστῶτα ἐκ δεξιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"Jesus standing at the right of God"

Luke is using the adjective **right** as a noun in order to indicate the right side. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with a noun phrase. Alternate translation: [Jesus standing at the right side of God]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 7:56 (#2)

θεωρῶ τοὺς οὐρανοὺς διηνοιγμένους, καὶ

“I see the heavens opened, and”

Stephen is speaking of **the heavens** being **opened** to mean that they are open to his view. Alternate translation: [the heavens are open to my view, and I see] or [I can see into heaven, and I see]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:56 (#3)

τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ Ἀνθρώπου

“the Son of Man”

The title **Son of Man** is equivalent to “Messiah.” Jesus himself used that title to claim that role subtly and implicitly. You may want to translate the title directly into your language. Alternatively, if you think it would be helpful to your readers, you could express what it means. Alternate translation: [Jesus the Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:56 (#5)

ἐκ δεξιῶν ἑστῶτα τοῦ Θεοῦ

“standing at the right of God”

See how you expressed the implicit significance of the phrase **at the right of God** in 7:55. Alternate translation: [standing in a place of honor next to God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:56 (#1)

ἰδοὺ

“Behold”

Stephen is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Now listen]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:56 (#6)

ἐκ δεξιῶν ἑστῶτα τοῦ Θεοῦ

“standing at the right of God”

See how you expressed the significance of the symbolic action of Jesus **standing** in 7:55. Alternate translation: [the Son of Man, in a place of honor next to God, standing to honor me]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 7:56 (#4)

ἐκ δεξιῶν ἑστῶτα τοῦ Θεοῦ

“standing at the right of God”

See how you translated the nominal adjective **right** in 7:55. Alternate translation: [standing at the right side of God]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 7:57 (#4)

ὥρμησαν ὁμοθυμαδὸν ἐπ’ αὐτόν

“rushed at him unanimously”

This could mean: (1) that the Sanhedrin members all rushed at Stephen at the same time. Alternate translation: [rushed at him all at once]; (2) that every one of the Sanhedrin members rushed at Stephen. Alternate translation: [every one of them rushed at him]

Acts 7:57 (#2)

κράξαντες & φωνῇ μεγάλῃ

“shouting with a loud voice”

This is an idiom that suggests that the Sanhedrin members had another, louder voice that they could use. It means that they raised the volume of their voices. Alternate translation: [shouting loudly]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:57 (#1)

κράξαντες & φωνῇ μεγάλῃ, συνέσχον τὰ ὦτα αὐτῶν

“shouting with a loud voice, they covered their ears”

The Sanhedrin members did these things to demonstrate that they did not want to hear any more of what Stephen said. Alternate translation: [shouting loudly to drown out Stephen, they put their hands over their ears to show that they did not want to hear any more]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 7:57 (#3)

κράξαντες & φωνῇ μεγάλῃ

“shouting with a loud voice”

If you would like to reproduce this idiom but it would be unusual in your language to speak as if a whole group of people had one **voice**, you could make this plural. Alternate translation: [with loud voices] or [in loud voices]

Acts 7:58 (#5)

παρὰ τοὺς πόδας

"at the feet"

The expression **at the feet** means on the ground in front of someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on the ground in front of]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:58 (#3)

ἀπέθεντο τὰ ἱμάτια αὐτῶν, παρὰ τοὺς πόδας νεανίου καλουμένου Σαύλου

"laid aside their outer garments at the feet of a young man named Saul"

The implications are that the witnesses took off their long robes so that they could throw stones at Stephen more easily and that they left them with Saul for safekeeping. UST models one way to make these implications explicit.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:58 (#2)

οἱ μάρτυρες

"the witnesses"

These were the "false witnesses" whom the Sanhedrin brought in to accuse Stephen, as described in 6:13. According to the Law of Moses, it was their responsibility to carry out the execution of the man they had accused. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [the false witnesses, who were responsible to carry out the execution,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 7:58 (#1)

ἐκβαλόντες ἔξω τῆς πόλεως

"throwing him outside the city"

Luke is likely speaking when he speaks of the Sanhedrin members **throwing** Stephen outside the city. It is unlikely that they actually picked him up and heaved him through the air. Alternate translation: [seizing Stephen and forcefully taking him out of the city]

See: Metaphor

Acts 7:58 (#4)

τὰ ἱμάτια

"outer garments"

These **outer garments** were long cloaks or robes that people wore outside to stay warm. They were also a sign of wealth and status. If your readers would not be familiar with this kind of garment, you could use the name of another garment that they would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [coats] or [robes]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 7:59 (#1)

ἐπικαλούμενον καὶ λέγοντα

"as he was calling out and saying"

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The phrase **calling out** tells how Stephen was **saying** what he said. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use "and." Alternate translation: [as he was saying loudly]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 7:59 (#2)

δέξαι τὸ πνεῦμά μου

"receive my spirit"

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please receive my spirit]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 7:60 (#2)

ἔκραξεν φωνῇ μεγάλῃ

"he cried out with a loud voice"

This is an idiom that means that Stephen raised the volume of his voice. Alternate translation: [he cried out loudly]

See: Idiom

Acts 7:60 (#3)

μὴ στήσῃς αὐτοῖς ταύτην τὴν ἁμαρτίαν

"do not hold this sin against them"

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please do not hold this sin against them]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 7:60 (#1)

θεὶς & τὰ γόνατα

"having put down {his} knees"

Kneeling down was an act of submission to God and a reverent posture of prayer. Alternate translation: [after he had knelt down reverently]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 7:60 (#4)

μὴ στήσῃς αὐτοῖς ταύτην τὴν ἁμαρτίαν

"do not hold this sin against them"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative verb **hold ... against**. Alternate translation: [forgive them for this sin]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 7:60 (#5)

ἐκοιμήθη

"he fell asleep"

Luke is describing the death of Stephen when he says **he fell asleep**. This is a polite way of referring to something unpleasant. If this would be misunderstood in your language, use a different polite way of referring to this or use plain language. Alternate translation: [he passed away] or, as in UST, [he died]

See: Euphemism

Acts - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

The story here shifts from Stephen to Saul.

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry that is quoted from the Old Testament in 8:32–33.

The first sentence of verse 1 ends the description of the events in Chapter 7. Luke begins a new part of his history with the words "And on that day."

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Receiving the Holy Spirit

In this chapter Luke speaks for the first time of people receiving the Holy Spirit (Acts 8:15–19). The Holy Spirit had already enabled the believers to speak in tongues, to heal the sick, and to live as a community, and he had filled Stephen. But when the Jews started putting believers in prison, those believers who could leave Jerusalem did leave, and as they went, they told people about Jesus. When the people who heard about Jesus received the Holy Spirit, the church leaders knew that those people had truly become believers.

Proclaimed

This chapter, more than any other in the book of Acts, speaks of the believers proclaiming the word, proclaiming the good news, and proclaiming that Jesus is the Christ. The word "proclaim" translates a Greek word that means to tell good news about something.

Acts 8:1 (#3)

ἐν ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ

"on that day"

Here, **day** is not a figurative word for "time." Luke is referring to a specific day, the day on which Stephen was killed. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [on the day Stephen was killed,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:1 (#1)

Σαῦλος δὲ ἦν συνευδοκῶν τῇ ἀναιρέσει αὐτοῦ

"And Saul was agreeing with his execution"

Luke is providing this background information to help readers understand why Saul was persecuting the church, as he relates in 8:3 and in Chapter 9. Use a natural way in your language for introducing background information. Alternate translation: [Now Saul approved of the Sanhedrin executing Stephen]

See: Background Information

Acts 8:1 (#6)

πλὴν τῶν ἀποστόλων

“except the apostles”

The implication is that **the apostles** remained in Jerusalem, even though they too experienced this great persecution. Alternate translation: [except the apostles, who remained in Jerusalem despite the persecution]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:1 (#2)

ἐγένετο δὲ ἐν ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ, διωγμὸς μέγας ἐπὶ τὴν ἐκκλησίαν

“And on that day a great persecution began against the church”

Luke uses this phrase to introduce a new event in the story, the scattering of the church and its witness beyond Jerusalem. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [And so began that day a great persecution against the church]

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 8:1 (#4)

πάντες & διεσπάρησαν

“they all were scattered”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they all fled]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:1 (#5)

πάντες & διεσπάρησαν

“they all were scattered”

The word **all** is a generalization that emphasizes that a large number of the believers were affected. Alternate translation: [many of the believers were scattered] or [many of the believers fled]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 8:1–2 (#1)

συνεκόμισαν δὲ τὸν Στέφανον ἄνδρες εὐλαβεῖς, καὶ ἐποίησαν κοπετὸν μέγαν ἐπ’ αὐτῷ

“And devout men carried away Stephen and made great lamentation over him”

It may be helpful to your readers to move the parts of the story about Stephen together by using a verse bridge for verses 1–2 as the UST does.

See: Verse Bridges

Acts 8:2 (#1)

συνεκόμισαν & τὸν Στέφανον

“carried away Stephen”

The word translated as **carried away** means to carry away for burial. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. You could also say explicitly that it was Stephen’s body that these men carried away. Alternate translation: [carried Stephen’s body away to bury it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:3 (#1)

κατὰ τοὺς οἴκους

“by houses”

Alternate translation: [entering one house after another]

Acts 8:3 (#2)

κατὰ τοὺς οἴκους & τε ἄνδρας καὶ γυναῖκας

“by houses & both men and women”

Luke may mean **houses** where Christians met, as described in 2:46, and he means **men and women** who believed in Jesus. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [the houses where Christians met … believers in Jesus, both men and women]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:4 (#3)

εὐαγγελιζόμενοι τὸν λόγον

“proclaiming the word”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that these believers shared by using words. See how you translated the term in 4:4. Also see the introduction to this chapter for the meaning of the word translated as **proclaiming** here and many other times in this chapter. Alternate translation: [telling the good news about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:4 (#1)

οἱ & διασπαρέντες

“the ones having been scattered”

Luke is using the participle **having been scattered**, which functions as an adjective, as a noun. ULT adds the term **ones** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the believers who had been scattered]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 8:4 (#2)

οἱ & διασπαρέντες

“the ones having been scattered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. See how you translated it in 8:1. Alternate translation: [the believers who had fled from the persecution]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:5 (#2)

τὴν πόλιν τῆς Σαμαρείας

“the city of Samaria”

This is an idiom that means the principal city in the region of Samaria, probably the one known at that time as Sebaste, although some interpreters believe that Luke may have had the city of Sychar in mind instead. Alternate translation: [the main city in Samaria]

See: Idiom

Acts 8:5 (#1)

κατελθὼν

“going down”

Luke speaks of Philip **going down** from Jerusalem because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Alternate translation: [traveling]

See: Idiom

Acts 8:5 (#3)

τὸν Χριστόν

“Christ”

Luke is using the name **Christ** by association to mean the message about Christ. Alternate translation: [the good news about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:6 (#5)

τὰ σημεῖα

“the signs”

Here the word **signs** has the same sense that it has in the phrase “wonders and signs” in 2:22 and elsewhere in Acts. It means a miracle. Alternate translation: [the miracles]

Acts 8:6 (#4)

τοῖς λεγομένοις ὑπὸ τοῦ Φιλίππου

“to the things being spoken by Philip”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [the things that Philip was saying]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:6 (#3)

τοῖς λεγομένοις ὑπὸ τοῦ Φιλίππου

“to the things being spoken by Philip”

Luke is using the participle **being spoken**, which functions as an adjective, as a noun. ULT adds the term **things** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the things that Philip was saying]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 8:6 (#1)

οἱ ὄχλοι

“the crowds”

Luke implicitly means **the crowds** in the city that Philip traveled to. Alternate translation: [the people in that city of Samaria]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:6 (#2)

ὁμοθυμαδὸν

“unanimously”

Alternate translation: [all together]

Acts 8:7 (#2)

τῶν ἐχόντων

“of those having”

Luke is using the participle **having**, which functions as an adjective, as a noun. ULT adds the term **those** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the people who had]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 8:7 (#7)

πολλοὶ & παραλελυμένοι

“many & paralyzed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [many who had paralysis]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:7 (#5)

πολλοὶ & παραλελυμένοι καὶ χωλοὶ ἐθεραπεύθησαν

“many & paralyzed and lame were healed”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, it would be appropriate to say Jesus, since the book of Acts shows that the apostles healed people in the name of Jesus, for example, in 4:10. Alternate translation: [Jesus, through the power of his name, healed many who had been paralyzed and lame]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:7 (#6)

πολλοὶ & παραλελυμένοι

“many & paralyzed”

Luke is using the participle **paralyzed** as an adjective. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [many who had been paralyzed]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 8:7 (#4)

βοῶντα φωνῇ μεγάλῃ

“shouting with a loud voice”

This is an idiom that means that the unclean spirits raised the volume of their voices. Alternate translation: [shouting loudly]

See: Idiom

Acts 8:7 (#3)

ἐχόντων πνεύματα ἀκάθαρτα

“having unclean spirits”

Alternate translation: [who were controlled by unclean spirits]

Acts 8:7 (#1)

πολλοὶ γὰρ τῶν ἐχόντων πνεύματα ἀκάθαρτα, βοῶντα φωνῇ μεγάλῃ, ἐξήρχοντο

“For many of those having unclean spirits, shouting with a loud voice, they were coming out”

As Luke tells the story of this event, he changes from the people who had **unclean spirits** being the subject of the sentence to the **unclean spirits** themselves being the subject. This may be because the unclean spirits controlled people to such an extent that the spirits seemed to be the people themselves. It may be helpful to your readers to put the information about the spirits before the information about the people who had them. Alternate translation: [unclean spirits, shouting with a loud voice, were coming out of many of those who had them]

See: Information Structure

Acts 8:8 (#3)

ἐγένετο & πολλὴ χαρὰ ἐν τῇ πόλει ἐκείνῃ

“there was much joy in that city”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **joy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the people of that city rejoiced greatly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 8:8 (#2)

ἐγένετο & πολλὴ χαρὰ ἐν τῇ πόλει ἐκείνῃ

“there was much joy in that city”

The phrase **that city** refers by association to the people who lived in that city. Alternate translation: [there was much joy among the people of that city]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:8 (#1)

δὲ

“And”

Luke is using the word translated as **And** to introduce what the people in the city did as a result of the many healings that Philip performed. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 8:9 (#2)

ἀνὴρ & τις ὀνόματι Σίμων

"a certain man, Simon by name"

Luke uses this phrase to introduce Simon as a new character in the story. If your language has its own way of doing that, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 8:9 (#1)

ἀνὴρ δέ τις ὀνόματι Σίμων, προϋπῆρχεν ἐν τῇ πόλει μαγεύων

"But a certain man, Simon by name, was already practicing sorcery in the city"

Luke is providing background information to help readers understand who Simon was and why he said and did the things Luke describes in the rest of this chapter. Use a natural way in your language for introducing background information. Alternate translation: [Now there was a man named Simon who had been practicing sorcery in that city]

See: Background Information

Acts 8:9 (#3)

Σίμων

"Simon"

Simon is the name of a man. See how you translated this name, for a different man, in 1:13.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 8:10 (#7)

ἡ καλουμένη

"that is called"

If your language does not use the passive form **called**, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [that people call]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:10 (#3)

ἀπὸ μικροῦ ἕως μεγάλου

"from little to great"

Luke is using the adjectives **little** and **great** as nouns in order to indicate groups of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate these words with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [from the least important people to the most important ones]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 8:10 (#6)

ἡ Δύναμις τοῦ Θεοῦ, ἡ καλουμένη Μεγάλη

"the power of God that is called Great"

The Samaritans believed that Simon must be the embodiment of some great power, and thinking that this power was God, the highest of powers, they called it Great. Alternate translation: [an embodiment of the Great God] or [an embodiment of the supreme God]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 8:10 (#4)

ἀπὸ μικροῦ ἕως μεγάλου

"from little to great"

Luke is speaking, using these two extremes in order to include all of the people in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [no matter how important they were]

See: Merism

Acts 8:10 (#1)

ᾧ προσεῖχον πάντες ἀπὸ μικροῦ ἕως μεγάλου

"to whom they all, from little to great, were paying attention"

The phrase **to whom** refers to Simon. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [All of them, from little to great, were paying attention to Simon]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 8:10 (#5)

οὗτός

"This"

The demonstrative pronoun **This** stands for Simon. Alternate translation: [This man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 8:10 (#2)

πάντες

“all”

Luke is using the word **all** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [the Samaritans in that city]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 8:11 (#1)

προσεῖχον δὲ αὐτῷ

“And they were paying attention to him”

This verse gives additional background information about Simon and what he was doing among the Samaritans. Alternate translation: [Now they were paying attention to him]

See: Background Information

Acts 8:12 (#1)

ἐπίστευσαν

“they believed”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Samaritans. Alternate translation: [the Samaritans believed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 8:12 (#5)

ἐβαπτίζοντο

“they were & baptized”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [Philip was baptizing them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:12 (#3)

εὐαγγελιζομένῳ περὶ τῆς Βασιλείας τοῦ Θεοῦ καὶ τοῦ ὀνόματος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

“proclaiming the gospel about the kingdom of God and the name of Jesus Christ”

Here the **name** of Jesus represents his authority, specifically as the Messiah, as the title **Christ** indicates. Alternate translation: [proclaiming the good news that God had begun to rule and that Jesus the Messiah had come]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:12 (#4)

εὐαγγελιζομένῳ περὶ τῆς Βασιλείας τοῦ Θεοῦ καὶ τοῦ ὀνόματος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

“proclaiming the gospel about the kingdom of God and the name of Jesus Christ”

Since Jesus inaugurated the **kingdom of God** when he came to earth, it may be helpful to put the information about Jesus before the information about the kingdom of God. Alternate translation: [proclaiming the gospel about the name of Jesus Christ and the kingdom of God] or [proclaiming the good news that Jesus the Messiah had come and that God had begun to rule]

See: Information Structure

Acts 8:12 (#2)

εὐαγγελιζομένῳ περὶ τῆς Βασιλείας τοῦ Θεοῦ καὶ τοῦ ὀνόματος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

“proclaiming the gospel about the kingdom of God and the name of Jesus Christ”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of a **kingdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [proclaiming the good news that God had begun to rule and that Jesus the Messiah had come]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 8:13 (#1)

ὁ δὲ Σίμων καὶ αὐτὸς ἐπίστευσεν

“And Simon himself also believed”

Luke uses the word **himself** to emphasize how significant it was that Simon, who had claimed to be an embodiment of God, had believed in Jesus as the Messiah whom God sent. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this significance. Alternate translation: [Even Simon believed]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 8:13 (#5)

τε σημεῖα καὶ δυνάμεις

“And & signs and works”

The terms **signs** and **works** mean similar things. Luke is using them together for emphasis. Alternate translation, as in UST: [miracles]

See: Doublet

Acts 8:13 (#3)

βαπτισθεὶς

“having been baptized”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [after Philip baptized him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:13 (#2)

ἦν προσκαρτερῶν τῷ Φιλίππῳ

“he was continuing with Philip”

Alternate translation: [he followed Philip around everywhere]

Acts 8:13 (#4)

θεωρῶν τε σημεῖα καὶ δυνάμεις μεγάλας

“And seeing great signs and works”

The word that ULT translates as **works** here is the same word that it translates as “power” in 8:10. It can mean either power or works that demonstrate power. Luke is using the word to show what an ironic situation Simon is in. He claimed to be “the power ... that is called Great,” but now he recognizes that **works** of power that are truly **great** are done in the name of Jesus. If your language has a word for works that demonstrate power that has the same root as its word for power, it would be appropriate to use it here.

See: Irony

Acts 8:14 (#2)

ἀκούσαντες & ὅτι δέδεκται ἡ Σαμάρεια τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ, ἀπέστειλαν

“having heard that Samaria had received the word of God, sent”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [having heard, “Samaria has received the word of God,” sent]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 8:14 (#4)

ἡ Σαμάρεια

“Samaria”

Luke is using the word **Samaria** by association to mean the people of Samaria. Alternate translation: [the people of Samaria]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:14 (#3)

ἀκούσαντες & ὅτι δέδεκται ἡ Σαμάρεια τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ, ἀπέστειλαν

“having heard that Samaria had received the word of God, sent”

If you decide to have a direct quotation here, you might also decide to make it an exclamation. Alternate translation: [having heard, “Samaria has received the word of God!” sent]

See: Exclamations

Acts 8:14 (#1)

δὲ

“And”

Luke is using the word translated as **And** to introduce a new event in the story of the Samaritans becoming believers. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Now]

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 8:14 (#5)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the word of God”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that Philip shared by using words. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:15 (#2)

οἵτινες

“who”

Since the pronoun **who** stands for two men, it should be in the dual if your language uses that form.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Dual/Plural

Acts 8:15 (#4)

καταβάντες

“having come down”

Your language may say “gone” rather than **come** in contexts such as this. Use whichever is more natural. Alternate translation: [having gone down]

See: Go and Come

Acts 8:15 (#3)

καταβάντες

“having come down”

Luke speaks of Peter and John **having come down** from Jerusalem because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Alternate translation: [having traveled from Jerusalem]

See: Idiom

Acts 8:15 (#1)

οἵτινες καταβάντες, προσηύξαντο περὶ αὐτῶν

“who, having come down, prayed for them”

The pronoun **who** stands for Peter and John, and the pronoun **them** stands for the Samaritans. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [When Peter and John had come down, they prayed for the Samaritans]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 8:16 (#3)

οὐδέπω & ἦν ἐπ’ οὐδενὶ αὐτῶν ἐπιπεπτωκός

“he had not yet fallen upon any of them”

In Greek this is a double negative for emphasis, “he had not yet fallen upon none of them.” The second negative does not cancel the first to create a positive meaning. If for emphasis your language uses double negatives that do not cancel one another, it would be appropriate to use that construction here.

See: Double Negatives

Acts 8:16 (#6)

μόνον & βεβαπτισμένοι ὑπῆρχον

“they had only been baptized”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. If you must state who did the action, the context suggests it was Philip. Alternate translation: [Philip had only baptized them] or [Philip had only baptized the Samaritan believers]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:16 (#2)

γὰρ

“For”

Luke is using the word **For** to introduce the reason why Peter and John had to pray for the Samaritans to receive the Holy Spirit. Alternate translation: [They prayed for them because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 8:16 (#5)

μόνον & βεβαπτισμένοι ὑπῆρχον εἰς τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

“they had only been baptized into the name of the Lord Jesus”

Here, **the name of the Lord Jesus** represents his authority, and being baptized into his name represents being baptized in order to be under his authority. Alternate translation: [they had only been baptized to become disciples of the Lord Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:16 (#1)

οὐδέπω & ἦν ἐπ’ οὐδενὶ αὐτῶν ἐπιπεπτωκός

“he had not yet fallen upon any of them”

Luke is speaking of the Holy Spirit as if it could fall on the Samaritan believers. Alternate translation: [none of them had yet received the Holy Spirit]

See: Metaphor

Acts 8:16 (#4)

οὐδέπω & ἦν & ἐπιπεπτωκός

“he had not yet fallen”

The pronoun **he** stands for the Holy Spirit. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit had not yet fallen]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 8:17 (#2)

ἐπετίθεσαν

“they were laying”

Since this instance of the pronoun **they** stands for two men, it should be in the dual if your language uses that form. The same is true of “them” in 8:18 and “they” and “the ones” in 8:25.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Dual/Plural

Acts 8:17 (#3)

ἐπετίθεσαν τὰς χεῖρας ἐπ’ αὐτούς

“they were laying {their} hands on them”

Peter and John **laying their hands** on the Samaritans who had believed Philip's message of the gospel was a symbolic action that showed that Peter and John wanted God to give the Holy Spirit to these believers. If there is a gesture with similar meaning in your culture, you could consider using it here in your translation.

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 8:17 (#1)

ἐπετίθεσαν τὰς χεῖρας ἐπ' αὐτούς, καὶ ἐλάμβανον

"they were laying {their} hands on them, and they were receiving"

The first instance of the pronoun **they** stands for Peter and John, and the pronoun **them** and the second instance of **they** stand for the Samaritans. Alternate translation: [When Peter and John were laying their hands on the Samaritans, and the Samaritans were receiving]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 8:18 (#1)

δίδοται τὸ Πνεῦμα

"the Spirit was being given"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, it is clear from the context that this was God. Alternate translation: [God was giving the Spirit]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:19 (#1)

δότε κἀμοὶ τὴν ἐξουσίαν ταύτην, ἵνα ᾧ ἐὰν ἐπιθῶ τὰς χεῖρας, λαμβάνῃ Πνεῦμα Ἅγιον

"Give to me also this authority, so that on whomever I lay {my} hands, he may receive the Holy Spirit"

Alternate translation: [Give me the authority to give the Holy Spirit to anyone I lay my hands on]

Acts 8:20 (#1)

τὸ ἀργύριόν σου, σὺν σοὶ εἴη εἰς ἀπώλειαν

"May your silver be with you unto destruction"

Peter is using the exclamation form to emphasize how forcefully he rejects Simon's offer. You may want to use an exclamation to convey this same emphasis in your language. Alternate translation: [I refuse your offer! I can see that you are going to perdition, and you can take your money with you!]

See: Exclamations

Acts 8:20 (#2)

τὸ ἀργύριόν

"silver"

Peter is referring to money by association with the way that **silver** was used for money at this time. Alternate translation: [money]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:20 (#3)

τὴν δωρεὰν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the gift of God"

Peter is referring to the ability to confer the Holy Spirit by the laying on of hands. Since this is an ability that only God can give, by association Peter calls it **the gift of God**. Alternate translation: [the power to confer the Holy Spirit]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:21 (#1)

οὐκ ἔστιν σοι μερὶς οὐδὲ κλῆρος ἐν τῷ λόγῳ τούτῳ

"No part or share in this matter is to you"

The terms **part** and **share** mean similar things. Peter is using them together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [We will not let you have anything to do with this work]

See: Doublet

Acts 8:21 (#2)

σοι

"to you"

The phrase **to you** represents a possessive form. Alternate translation: [yours]

See: Possession

Acts 8:21 (#3)

ἡ γὰρ καρδία σου οὐκ ἔστιν εὐθεῖα

"because your heart is not right"

Here, the **heart** represents the thoughts and motives. Alternate translation: [your thoughts and motives are not right]

See: Metaphor

Acts 8:21 (#4)

ἔναντι τοῦ Θεοῦ

"before God"

This could mean: (1) that Simon's **heart** is not **right** in God's opinion by association with the way that God would assess anything that came to his attention in front of him. Alternate translation: [as far as God is concerned]; (2) that Simon does not have the right thoughts about God or intentions towards God. Alternate translation: [in its attitude towards God]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:22 (#4)

ἀφεθήσεταί σοι ἡ ἐπίνοια τῆς καρδίας σου

"the intention of your heart will be forgiven to you"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he will forgive you for the intention of your heart]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:22 (#3)

δεήθητι τοῦ Κυρίου, εἰ ἄρα ἀφεθήσεταί σοι ἡ ἐπίνοια τῆς καρδίας σου

"pray to the Lord, if therefore the intention of your heart will be forgiven to you"

Peter is using the conditional word **if** to introduce a desired result. There is actually no doubt about whether God will forgive someone who sincerely repents and prays for forgiveness. Alternate translation: [pray to the Lord so that, as a result, the intention of your heart will be forgiven to you] or [pray to the Lord and ask him to forgive you for the intention of your heart]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

Acts 8:22 (#1)

ἀπὸ τῆς κακίας σου ταύτης

"of this wickedness of yours"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wickedness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for trying to buy God's gift with money] or [for trying to bribe God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 8:22 (#2)

ἡ ἐπίνοια τῆς καρδίας σου

"the intention of your heart"

Here, the **heart** represents the thoughts and motives. Alternate translation: [what you intended to do] or [what you were thinking of doing]

See: Metaphor

Acts 8:23 (#4)

σύνδεσμον ἀδικίας

"the bond of unrighteousness"

Peter speaks of **the bond of unrighteousness** as if unrighteousness were restraining Simon and keeping him a prisoner. He means Simon is not able to stop himself from sinning. Alternate translation: [unable to stop sinning]

See: Metaphor

Acts 8:23 (#3)

εἰς & χολὴν πικρίας

"in the gall of bitterness"

Peter is describing **bitterness** as if it were made of **gall** or poison. He means that bitterness, here in the sense of envy, spiritually poisons a person, that is, it leads them towards spiritual death. Alternate translation: [dangerously envious]

See: Metaphor

Acts 8:23 (#2)

εἰς & χολὴν πικρίας

"in the gall of bitterness"

Peter is using the **gall** plant by association to mean "poison." Alternate translation: [in the poison of bitterness]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:23 (#1)

εἰς & χολὴν πικρίας

"in the gall of bitterness"

The **gall** plant has a bitter taste and is poisonous. If your readers would not be familiar with this plant, you could use the name of a similar plant in your area.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 8:24 (#5)

μηδὲν ἐπέλθῃ ἐπ' ἐμὲ ὧν εἰρήκατε

"nothing of which you have spoken may come upon me"

Simon is referring implicitly to Peter's rebuke, in which Peter spoke of Simon's silver perishing along with him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [I will not perish as you said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:24 (#4)

ὅπως μηδὲν ἐπέλθῃ ἐπ' ἐμὲ ὧν εἰρήκατε

"so that nothing of which you have spoken may come upon me"

Alternate translation: [so that the things you have said may not happen to me]

Acts 8:24 (#3)

δεήθητε ὑμεῖς ὑπὲρ ἐμοῦ πρὸς τὸν Κύριον

"You pray to the Lord for me"

Simon is stating the pronoun **You**, whose meaning is already present in the verb **pray**, for emphasis. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction here. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [Pray to the Lord for me yourselves]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 8:24 (#2)

δεήθητε ὑμεῖς ὑπὲρ ἐμοῦ πρὸς τὸν Κύριον

"You pray to the Lord for me"

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please pray to the Lord for me] or [I ask you to pray to the Lord for me]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 8:24 (#1)

ὑμεῖς & εἰρήκατε

"You & you have spoken"

Even though it was only Peter who spoke to Simon, in his response, Simon is addressing both Peter and John, since he offered money to both of them, as 8:18 describes. Since Simon is speaking to two men, **You** and **you** would be dual if your language uses that form. Otherwise it would be plural.

See: Forms of 'You' — Dual/Plural

Acts 8:25 (#2)

οἱ & διαμαρτυράμενοι καὶ λαλήσαντες τὸν λόγον τοῦ Κυρίου

"the ones having testified and having spoken the word of the Lord"

The **ones** Luke is describing are Peter and John. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Peter and John, after they had testified and spoken the word of the Lord,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:25 (#3)

οἱ & διαμαρτυράμενοι καὶ λαλήσαντες

"the ones having testified and having spoken"

Luke is using the participles **having testified** and **having spoken**, which function as adjectives, as nouns. ULT adds the term **ones** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the ones who had testified and spoken]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 8:25 (#1)

οὖν

"Then"

Luke is using the word translated as **Then** to introduce what Peter and John did after being in the city where Philip had been telling the Samaritans about Jesus. Alternate translation: [After that,]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Acts 8:25 (#5)

πολλάς & κώμας τῶν Σαμαρειτῶν

"many villages of the Samaritans"

The term **villages** refers by association to the people who lived in these villages. Alternate translation: [to the people in many Samaritan villages]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:25 (#4)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Κυρίου

"the word of the Lord"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that Peter and John shared by using words. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:26 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 8:26 (#2)

ἀνάστηθι

"Arise"

Here the word **arise** means that the angel wanted Philip to take action, not that the angel wanted him to stand up from a seated position. Alternate translation: [Pack for a journey]

See: Idiom

Acts 8:26 (#4)

ἀπὸ Ἰερουσαλὴμ εἰς Γάζαν; αὕτη ἐστὶν ἔρημος

"from Jerusalem to Gaza." (This is desert"

This sentence could be: (1) something that Luke adds to provide background information about the area through which Philip would be travelling. Alternate translation: [from Jerusalem to Gaza." (Now that road leads through a desert]; (2) part of what the angel is saying to Philip. Alternate translation: [from Jerusalem to Gaza, which is a desert road."]

See: Background Information

Acts 8:26 (#3)

τὴν ὁδὸν τὴν καταβαίνουσαν ἀπὸ Ἰερουσαλὴμ εἰς Γάζαν

"the road going down from Jerusalem to Gaza"

The angel speaks of the road **going down** from Jerusalem because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Alternate translation: [the road that leads from Jerusalem to Gaza]

See: Idiom

Acts 8:27 (#1)

ἀναστὰς, ἐπορεύθη

"arising, he went"

As in the previous verse, the word **arising** means that Philip took preparatory action, not that he stood up from a seated position. Alternate translation: [he prepared for a journey and left]

See: Idiom

Acts 8:27 (#4)

ἀνὴρ, Αἰθίοψ

"a man, an Ethiopian"

This is an idiomatic way of describing someone. Alternate translation: [a man from Ethiopia]

See: Idiom

Acts 8:27 (#6)

Κανδάκης

"of the Kandake"

Kandake was a title for the queens of Ethiopia. It is similar to the word Pharaoh, the title that was used for the kings of Egypt. So in your translation, make clear that it is a title rather than a name.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 8:27 (#5)

εὐνοῦχος, δυνάστης Κανδάκης

"a eunuch, an official of the Kandake"

While the word **eunuch** describes a man who has been castrated, as men sometimes were who served in royal courts in the ancient world, the emphasis here is on the fact that this man was a high government official, not on his physical state. Alternate translation: [an important official in the court of the Kandake]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 8:27 (#8)

ὃς ἐληλύθει προσκυνήσων εἰς Ἰερουσαλήμ

"who had come to Jerusalem to worship"

The implication is that this man was a Gentile who believed in the true God and had come to worship at the Jewish temple. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Even though he was a Gentile, he had come to worship the true God at the temple in Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:27 (#7)

ὃς ἦν ἐπὶ πάσης τῆς γάζης αὐτῆς

"who was over all her treasure"

Luke is using a spatial metaphor when says that this man was **over** the **treasure** of the Kandake. He means that the man was responsible for it. Alternate translation: [who was in charge of her treasury]

See: Metaphor

Acts 8:27 (#9)

ὃς ἐληλύθει

"who had come"

Your language may say "gone" rather than **come** in a context such as this. Use whichever is more natural. Alternate translation: [who had gone]

See: Go and Come

Acts 8:27 (#3)

ἀνὴρ, Αἰθίοψ εὐνοῦχος, δυνάστης Κανδάκης βασιλίσσης Αἰθιόπων, ὃς ἦν ἐπὶ πάσης τῆς γάζης αὐτῆς, ὃς ἐληλύθει προσκυνήσων εἰς Ἰερουσαλήμ

"a man, an Ethiopian, a eunuch, an official of the Kandake, the queen of the Ethiopians, who was over all her treasure, who had come to Jerusalem to worship"

This verse provides background information about this Ethiopian official and why he was travelling along this road. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence and to use a natural form for introducing background information. Alternate translation: [a man from Ethiopia. Now this man was a eunuch, an official of the Kandake, the queen of the Ethiopians, who was over all her treasure, and he had come to Jerusalem to worship]

See: Background Information

Acts 8:27 (#2)

ἰδοὺ

"behold"

Luke is using the word **behold** to alert his audience to a new person in the story. Use the natural form in your language for introducing a new character.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 8:28 (#3)

ἀνεγίνωσκεν

"he was reading"

Since Philip was able to hear what the man was reading, as 8:30 explains, the implication is that the man was reading aloud. Alternate translation: [he was reading aloud from]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:28 (#2)

ἀνεγίνωσκεν τὸν προφήτην Ἠσαΐαν

"he was reading the prophet Isaiah"

Luke is using the phrase **the prophet Isaiah** to mean the prophecies that Isaiah spoke and recorded. Alternate translation: [he was reading from the book of Isaiah]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:28 (#1)

τοῦ ἅρματος

"chariot"

Here and in 8:29 and 8:38, the term **chariot** probably means something like "carriage." Chariots were vehicles for war, not for long-distance travel, and people stood to ride in chariots, while this man was seated. Alternate translation, as in UST: [his carriage]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 8:29 (#1)

πρόσελθε καὶ κολλήθητι τῷ ἅρματι τούτῳ

"Approach and join this chariot"

The Spirit means that Philip is to stay close to the person riding in the **chariot**. Alternate translation: [Go over to that chariot so you can be near the man in it]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:30 (#2)

ἆρά & γινώσκεις ἃ ἀναγινώσκεις

"Do you understand what you are reading"

The Ethiopian was a literate, educated man who could read, but he lacked spiritual discernment. Philip is asking implicitly whether he understands the meaning of the passage from Isaiah. Alternate translation: [Do you understand the meaning of what you are reading?]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:30 (#1)

ἀναγινώσκοντος Ἠσαΐαν τὸν προφήτην

"reading Isaiah the prophet"

Luke is using the phrase **Isaiah the prophet** to mean the prophecies that Isaiah spoke and recorded. Alternate translation: [reading from the book of Isaiah]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:31 (#2)

παρεκάλεσέν & τὸν Φίλιππον, ἀναβάντα καθίσαι σὺν αὐτῷ

"he invited Philip to sit with him, having come up"

The implication is that when the man invited Philip to come up and sit with him, Philip agreed to travel down the road with him to explain the Scriptures. Alternate translation: [he invited Philip to come up and sit with him and explain the Scriptures, and Philip accepted the invitation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:31 (#1)

πῶς γὰρ ἂν δυναίμην ἐὰν μή τις ὁδηγήσει με

"For how would I be able, unless someone will guide me"

The man is not asking for information. He is using the question form for emphasis. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [No, I cannot understand unless someone guides me.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 8:32 (#2)

ὡς πρόβατον ἐπὶ σφαγὴν ἤχθη

"He was led like a sheep to the slaughter"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **slaughter**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [He was led like a sheep that was going to be slaughtered]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 8:32 (#1)

ὡς πρόβατον ἐπὶ σφαγὴν ἤχθη

"He was led like a sheep to the slaughter"

This a quotation from Isaiah 53:7–8. It describes the Messiah, whom Isaiah calls "the servant of the Lord." But since the Ethiopian official did not know whom Isaiah was describing and had to ask Philip, it would be better not to specify that at this point by saying, for example, "The Messiah was led like a sheep to the slaughter" or "The servant of the Lord was led like a sheep to the slaughter"

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:32 (#5)

οὐκ ἀνοίγει τὸ στόμα αὐτοῦ

"he does not open his mouth"

This means that the Messiah does not speak by association with the way a person would **open his mouth** in order to speak. Alternate translation: [he says nothing]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:32 (#3)

ἤχθη

"He was led"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [People led him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:32 (#4)

ἐναντίον τοῦ κείραντος αὐτὸν ἄφωνος

"before its shearer {is} silent"

A **shearer** is a person who cuts the wool off the sheep so that it may be used. If your readers would not be familiar with this word and you have no comparable word in your language, you could express the meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [is silent while its wool is being cut off]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 8:33 (#5)

τὴν γενεὰν αὐτοῦ τίς διηγήσεται

"Who will describe his generation"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **generation**, you could express the same idea in another way. This could mean: (1) that no one will be able to describe the Messiah's descendants because he will die without having any children. Alternate translation: [No one will be able to describe his descendants.]; (2) that no one will be able to describe the other people living at the same time as the Messiah because they will be so wicked. Alternate translation: [No one will be able to describe how wicked his contemporaries are.]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 8:33 (#1)

ἐν τῇ ταπεινώσει, ἡ κρίσις αὐτοῦ ἤρθη

"In humiliation his justice was taken away"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **humiliation** and **justice**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [Because he acted humbly and did not defend himself, his enemies were able to treat him unjustly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 8:33 (#6)

αἴρεται ἀπὸ τῆς γῆς ἡ ζωὴ αὐτοῦ

"his life is taken from the earth"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [his enemies will take his life from the earth]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:33 (#4)

τὴν γενεὰν αὐτοῦ τίς διηγήσεται

"Who will describe his generation"

Isaiah is using a future statement to describe capability. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use form that is more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Who can describe his generation?] or [No one will be able to describe his generation.]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Acts 8:33 (#2)

ἡ κρίσις αὐτοῦ ἤρθη

"his justice was taken away"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [his enemies denied him justice]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:33 (#3)

τὴν γενεὰν αὐτοῦ τίς διηγήσεται

"Who will describe his generation"

Isaiah is using the question form for emphasis. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate his words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [No one will describe his generation.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 8:34 (#3)

ἑτέρου τινός

"some other"

In this context, the pronoun **other** means "other person." Alternate translation: [some other person]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 8:34 (#1)

ἀποκριθεὶς δὲ ὁ εὐνοῦχος τῷ Φιλίππῳ εἶπεν

"And answering, the eunuch said to Philip"

Together the words **answering** and **said** mean that the Ethiopian official responded to Philip's question about whether he understood what he was reading. Alternate translation: [The eunuch responded to Philip's question by saying]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 8:34 (#2)

δέομαί σου

"I beg of you"

The Ethiopian official is using a polite, idiomatic expression. Alternate translation: [Please tell me]

See: Idiom

Acts 8:35 (#1)

ἀνοίξας & τὸ στόμα αὐτοῦ

"opening his mouth"

By association with the way a person would be **opening his mouth** in order to speak, this means that Philip spoke. The image of the open mouth suggests a certain confidence and freedom in speaking. Alternate translation: [speaking confidently]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:35 (#3)

εὐηγγελίσατο αὐτῷ τὸν Ἰησοῦν

"proclaimed Jesus to him"

Luke is using the name **Jesus** by association to mean the message about Jesus. Alternate translation: [the good news about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:35 (#2)

τῆς Γραφῆς ταύτης

"this scripture"

By **this scripture**, Luke implicitly means the passage that the official had been reading. Alternate translation: [the passage from Isaiah that the official had been reading]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:36 (#1)

τι ὕδωρ & ὕδωρ

"some water & water"

Luke and the official are using the word **water** to mean a body of water, such as a pool at a desert oasis. Alternate translation: [a pool of water ... there is a pool of water]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:36 (#2)

τί κωλύει με βαπτισθῆναι

"What is preventing my being baptized"

This question could be: (1) a rhetorical question that the eunuch is using as a polite way to ask Philip to baptize him. Alternate translation: [Please allow me to be baptized.]; (2) a genuine request for information, since Philip seems to answer this question in 8:37 by identifying something that could keep the official from being baptized. Alternate translation: [Is there a condition I must meet in order to be baptized?]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 8:36 (#3)

με βαπτισθῆναι

"my being baptized"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you from baptizing me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:37 (#4)

ἀποκριθεὶς & εἶπεν

"answering he said"

Together the words **answering** and **said** mean that the eunuch responded to what Philip told him. Alternate translation: [the eunuch responded]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 8:37 (#1)

εἶπεν δὲ αὐτῷ ὁ Φίλιππος ἐὰν πιστεύεις ἐξ ὅλης τῆς καρδίας σου σωθήσει; ἀποκριθεὶς δὲ εἶπεν Πιστεύω εἰς τὸν Χριστὸν τὸν Υἱὸν τοῦ θεοῦ

"And Philip said to him, "If you believe from your whole heart, you will be saved." And answering he said, "I believe in Christ, the Son of God"

As the General Introduction to Acts explains, this verse is found in many traditional versions of the Bible, but it is not found in the most accurate ancient manuscripts of the Bible. ULT and UST indicate this by putting the verse in brackets. If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider including this verse if that translation does. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, we recommend that you indicate in some way that this verse may not be original, such as by putting it in brackets or in a footnote.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 8:37 (#3)

σωθήσει

"you will be saved"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will save you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:37 (#2)

ἐὰν πιστεύεις ἐξ ὅλης τῆς καρδίας σου

“If you believe from your whole heart”

Here, the **heart** represents the thoughts and intentions. Alternate translation: [If you genuinely believe in Jesus and want to be his disciple]

See: Metaphor

Acts 8:38 (#1)

ἐκέλευσεν στῆναι τὸ ἅρμα

“he commanded the chariot to stop”

Luke is using the term **chariot** by association to mean the driver of the chariot. Alternate translation: [the official told the driver of the chariot to stop]

See: Metonymy

Acts 8:38 (#2)

ἐβάπτισεν αὐτόν

“he baptized him”

The pronoun **he** stands for Philip, and the pronoun **him** stands for the eunuch. Alternate translation: [Philip baptized the eunuch]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 8:39 (#1)

γὰρ

“for”

While the word translated as **for** often introduces a reason, that does not seem to be its function here. Luke is not saying that the eunuch did not see Philip anymore because he did not look for him but instead **went on his way**. Rather, the word **for** seems simply to introduce a continuation of the narrative. Alternate translation: [but] or [nevertheless]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Acts 8:40 (#2)

Φίλιππος & εὑρέθη εἰς Ἄζωτον

“Philip was found at Azotus”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Philip reappeared at Azotus]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 8:40 (#5)

Ἄζωτον & Καισάρειαν

“Azotus & Caesarea”

Azotus and **Caesarea** are the names of cities.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 8:40 (#1)

Φίλιππος & εὑρέθη εἰς Ἄζωτον

“Philip was found at Azotus”

The implication is that there was no indication of Philip traveling between where he baptized the Ethiopian and Azotus. He suddenly disappeared along the road to Gaza and reappeared at the town of Azotus. Alternate translation: [Philip suddenly reappeared at Azotus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 8:40 (#4)

τὰς πόλεις πάσας

“to all the cities”

Luke says **all** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [to the cities in that region]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 8:40 (#3)

διερχόμενος

“passing through”

Alternate translation: [as he passed through that area, he was]

Acts - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In 9:1, the story shifts back to Saul and tells about his salvation.

In 9:32, the story shifts from Saul to a new part of the story about Peter.

Acts 9:31 is a summary statement that Luke uses to mark the transition into the third major part of the book.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

“Letters for the synagogues in Damascus”

The “letters” Paul asked for in 9:2 were probably legal papers that permitted him to put Christians in prison. The synagogue leaders in Damascus would

have obeyed the letter because it was written by the high priest. If the Romans had seen the letter, they also would have allowed Saul to persecute the Christians, because they permitted the Jews to do as they desired to people who broke their religious laws.

"The Way"
No one knows for sure who first started calling the community of Jesus' followers "the Way." This may be what the believers called themselves, because the Bible often speaks of a person living his life as if that person were walking on a path or "way." If this is true, the believers were "following the way of the Lord" by living in a way that pleased God. However, in the book of Acts the term is only used by outsiders, as in 9:2, or by believers speaking to outsiders. So it could also be a term by which the community of Jesus' followers was known outside that community.

"the church"
Acts 9:31 is the first use of the word **church** in the singular to refer to more than one local congregation. In that verse it refers to all the believers in all the groups throughout Judea, Galilee, and Samaria. It shows that they recognized that they all had a common identity as followers of Jesus.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"the Lord"
Luke refers to Jesus by a respectful title, "the Lord," in verses 1, 10, 11, 15, 27, 28, 31, 35, and 42, and Ananias refers to Jesus the same way in verse 17. In your translation, you may wish to clarify that this means "the Lord Jesus." Or you could state "Jesus," as UST does. (See: Politeness)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

What Saul saw when he met Jesus
It is clear that Saul saw a light and that it was because of this light that he "fell upon the ground." Some people think that Saul knew that it was the Lord speaking to him without seeing a human form, because the Bible often speaks of God as being light and living in light. Other people think that later in his life he was able to say, "I have seen the Lord Jesus" because it was a human form that he saw here.

Acts 9:1 (#3)

ἐμπνέων

"breathing"

Luke is using the term **breathing** by association to mean "speaking," since people breathe out while they speak. Alternate translation: [speaking]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:1 (#1)

δὲ

"But"

Luke uses the word translated as **But** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 9:1 (#2)

ἐμπνέων ἀπειλῆς καὶ φόνου εἰς

"breathing threat and murder against"

Luke is using the two words **threat** and **murder** together to express a single idea. The word **murder** tells what kind of **threat** Saul was making. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use **and**. Alternate translation: [making murderous threats against]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 9:2 (#3)

εἰς Δαμασκὸν πρὸς τὰς συναγωγάς

"to Damascus, to the synagogues"

Luke is using the terms **Damascus** and **synagogues** by association to mean the people, probably the leaders, of the synagogues in Damascus. Alternate translation: [to the people in the synagogues of Damascus] or [to the leaders of the synagogues in Damascus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:2 (#5)

δεδεμένους ἀγάγῃ εἰς Ἰερουσαλήμ

"he might bring them bound to Jerusalem"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he might bind them and bring them to the chief priests]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:2 (#6)

δεδεμένους ἀγάγῃ εἰς Ἰερουσαλήμ

"he might bring them bound to Jerusalem"

Luke is using one part of the arrest process to represent the entire process. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [he might arrest them and bring them to the chief priests]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 9:2 (#1)

αὐτοῦ & εὕρῃ & ἀγάγῃ

"him & he found & he might bring them"

The pronoun **him** refers to the high priest and both instances of the pronoun **he** refer to Saul.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 9:2 (#7)

δεδεμένους ἀγάγῃ εἰς Ἰερουσαλήμ

"he might bring them bound to Jerusalem"

The implication is that Saul wanted to bring believers in Jesus to Jerusalem for trial and punishment by the Jewish leaders. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [he might take them as prisoners to Jerusalem so that the Jewish leaders there could judge and punish them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:2 (#2)

ἐπιστολὰς

"letters"

See the introduction to this chapter for an explanation of what these **letters** were. This may help you decide what word in your language to use for them.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 9:2 (#4)

τῆς ὁδοῦ, ὄντας

"being of the Way"

As the introduction to this chapter explains, **the Way** was one of the first names that people used to describe the community of believers in Jesus. If your language has a word for "way" or "path" that you can use as a name, it would be appropriate to use it here. Alternate translation: [who belonged to the Way]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 9:3 (#1)

ἐν & τῷ πορεύεσθαι

"as he was traveling"

Luke means implicitly that the high priest gave Saul the letters he asked for and that Saul then left Jerusalem to go to Damascus. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [as he was traveling to Damascus with letters that the high priest gave him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:3 (#2)

ἐγένετο

"it happened that"

Luke uses the phrase **it happened that** to introduce a significant development in this story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for this purpose.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 9:3 (#4)

ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ

"from heaven"

This could mean: (1) heaven, where God lives or (2) the sky. The first meaning is preferable. Use that meaning if your language has a separate word for it.

Acts 9:3 (#3)

αὐτὸν περιήστραψεν φῶς ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ

"a light from heaven surrounded him"

Alternate translation: [a light from heaven shone all around him]

Acts 9:4 (#2)

τί με διώκεις

"why are you persecuting me"

The voice is using the question form to rebuke Saul. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate its words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the rebuke in another way. Alternate translation: [you should not be persecuting me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 9:4 (#1)

πεσὼν ἐπὶ τὴν γῆν

“falling to the ground”

Saul did not fall down accidentally. This could mean: (1) that the light caused him to fall to the ground. Alternate translation: [falling to the ground stunned by the dazzling light]; (2) that Saul fainted when he saw the light. Alternate translation: [falling faint because of the glorious light]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:5 (#1)

τίς εἶ, κύριε

“Who are you, Lord”

Saul is not yet acknowledging that Jesus is **Lord**. He uses that title because he recognizes that he is speaking to someone of divine power. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could use a similar term of respect. Alternate translation: [Who are you, Sir]

See: Politeness

Acts 9:5 (#3)

εἶ & σὺ

“are you & you”

Both occurrences of the word **you** here are singular.

Acts 9:5 (#2)

εἶπεν & ὁ

“he said & he {said”

The first instance of **he** stands for Saul, and the second instance of **he** stands for Jesus. Alternate translation: [Saul said ... Jesus replied]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 9:6 (#1)

λαληθήσεταί σοι

“it will be told to you”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone will tell you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:8 (#1)

ἀνεῳγμένων & τῶν ὀφθαλμῶν αὐτοῦ

“his eyes being opened”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation, as in UST: [when he opened his eyes]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:8 (#2)

εἰσήγαγον

“they brought him”

The pronoun **they** stands for the men who were traveling with Saul, as described in 9:8. Alternate translation: [the men who were traveling with him brought him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 9:9 (#2)

οὐκ ἔφαγεν οὐδὲ ἔπιεν

“he neither ate nor drank”

This could mean: that Saul chose not to eat or drink as a form of worship. 9:11 says that Saul was praying at this time, and he may have been fasting along with his prayers. Alternate translation: [he fasted from food and drink]; (2) that Saul had no appetite or thirst because he was too distressed from his situation. Alternate translation: [he was too distressed to eat or drink]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:9 (#1)

ἦν ἡμέρας τρεῖς μὴ βλέπων

“he was not seeing for three days”

Alternate translation: [he remained blinded for three days]

Acts 9:10 (#3)

ὁ Κύριος

“the Lord”

Here and throughout this chapter, **the Lord** is a respectful title that Luke is using to refer to Jesus. Alternate translation: [the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 9:10 (#2)

Ἀνανίας

“Ananias”

Ananias is the name of a man. This is not the same Ananias whom Luke described in 5:1 (that man died), but you may translate the name here the same way you did there.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 9:10 (#4)

ἰδοὺ, ἐγώ, Κύριε

"Behold, I, Lord"

Behold, I is a Hebrew idiom that Ananias is using to identify himself as the Ananias to whom the Lord is calling. Alternate translation: [Yes, Lord, this is Ananias]

See: Idiom

Acts 9:10 (#1)

ἦν δέ τις μαθητὴς ἐν Δαμασκῷ ὀνόματι Ἀνανίας

"Now there was a certain disciple in Damascus named Ananias"

Luke uses this sentence to introduce a new character into the story. If your language has its own way of doing that, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 9:10 (#5)

ἰδοὺ, ἐγώ, Κύριε

"Behold, I, Lord"

Ananias is saying implicitly that he is present and available to serve **the Lord**. Alternate translation: [Yes, Lord, this is Ananias, and I am here ready to do what you ask]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:11 (#5)

ἰδοὺ γὰρ, προσεύχεται

"for behold, he is praying"

The Lord says **behold** to get Ananias to focus his attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use here in your translation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Now listen carefully: He is praying]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:11 (#4)

Ἰούδα

"of Judas"

Judas it the name of a man. This is not the disciple who betrayed Jesus (that man died); this Judas was the owner of a house in Damascus where Saul was staying. But you may translate the name here the same way you did in 1:13, 1:16, and 5:37 for the disciple and two other men with the same name.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 9:11 (#1)

ἀναστὰς, πορεύθητι ἐπὶ τὴν ῥύμην τὴν καλουμένην Εὐθεῖαν

"Arising, go to the street called Straight"

Here, the word **arising** means that God wants Ananias to take action, not that Ananias is lying down or sitting down and God wants him to stand up. You may be able to convey this with a different kind of expression. Alternate translation: [Go on over to Straight Street]

See: Idiom

Acts 9:11 (#2)

τὴν ῥύμην τὴν καλουμένην Εὐθεῖαν

"the street called Straight"

If your language does not use the passive form **called**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation, as in UST: [the street that people call Straight]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:11 (#3)

τὴν ῥύμην τὴν καλουμένην Εὐθεῖαν

"the street called Straight"

Straight is the name of a street. Alternate translation: [Straight Street]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 9:12 (#1)

ἐπιθέντα αὐτῷ χεῖρας

"laying hands on him"

In this culture, **laying hands on** people was a symbolic way of conveying a spiritual blessing to them, as the apostles did in 6:6 for the men chosen to oversee the food distribution. If there is a comparable symbolic action in your culture, you could use that in your translation. You could also use a general expression. Alternate translation: [giving him a spiritual blessing]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 9:13 (#3)

τοῖς ἁγίοις σου ἐποίησεν ἐν Ἰερουσαλήμ

“he has done to your saints in Jerusalem”

Ananias is using the term **saints** by association to mean believers in Jesus, since the term means “holy ones” or “ones who are set apart.” Alternate translation: [to the people in Jerusalem who are dedicated to you]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:13 (#1)

ἀπὸ πολλῶν

“from many”

Ananias is using the adjective **many** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [from many people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 9:13 (#2)

ὅσα κακὰ

“how many evils”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evils**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how many harmful things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 9:14 (#3)

τοὺς ἐπικαλουμένους τὸ ὄνομά σου

“the ones calling upon your name”

Ananias is using the participle **calling**, which functions as an adjective, as a noun. ULT adds the term **ones** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the people who call on your name]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 9:14 (#1)

ἔχει ἐξουσίαν παρὰ τῶν ἀρχιερέων

“he has authority from the chief priests”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **authority**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [the chief priests have authorized him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 9:14 (#5)

τοὺς ἐπικαλουμένους τὸ ὄνομά σου

“the ones calling upon your name”

Here, the expression **calling on** means to worship. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ones worshiping you]

See: Idiom

Acts 9:14 (#2)

δῆσαι

“to bind”

Ananias is using one part of the arrest process to represent the entire process. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [to arrest]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 9:14 (#4)

τοὺς ἐπικαλουμένους τὸ ὄνομά σου

“the ones calling upon your name”

Here, **name** represents a person by association with the way that each person has a name. Alternate translation: [the ones calling upon you]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:15 (#8)

υἱῶν & Ἰσραήλ

“the sons of Israel”

The Lord is using the word **sons** to mean “descendants.” He is speaking of the Israelites, who were descendants of the patriarch Jacob, also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel] or [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:15 (#6)

ἐθνῶν

“the nations”

The term **nations** refers to people groups that are not Jewish. See how you translated it in 4:25. Alternate translation: [the Gentiles]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:15 (#4)

τοῦ βαστάσαι τὸ ὄνομά μου

“to carry my name”

The Lord says that Saul will **carry** his **name**, meaning that he will go to many places and speak about it. Alternate translation: [to speak about my name]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:15 (#2)

οὗτος

“this”

The demonstrative pronoun **this** refers to Saul. Alternate translation: [this man] or [this man Saul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 9:15 (#7)

βασιλέων

“kings”

The Lord is using **kings**, one kind of ruler, to mean all kinds of rulers. Saul, later known as Paul, testified before various rulers and officials. Alternate translation: [rulers]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 9:15 (#5)

τοῦ βαστάσαι τὸ ὄνομά μου

“to carry my name”

Here, **name** represents a person by association with the way that each person has a name. Alternate translation: [to speak about me] or [to tell others about me]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:15 (#3)

σκεῦος ἐκλογῆς & μοι

“to me an instrument of choosing”

The Lord describes Saul as an **instrument** or tool to indicate that he intends to use Saul to advance his purposes. Alternate translation: [someone I have chosen to use]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:15 (#1)

σκεῦος ἐκλογῆς & μοι

“to me an instrument of choosing”

The Lord is using the possessive form to describe Saul as an **instrument** who is characterized by his **choosing**. Alternate translation: [an instrument I have chosen] or [someone I have chosen as an instrument]

See: Possession

Acts 9:16 (#1)

ὑπὲρ τοῦ ὀνόματός μου

“for my name”

Here, **name** represents a person by association with the way that each person has a name. This could mean: (1) that Saul will suffer for telling people about Jesus. Alternate translation: [to make me known]; (2) that Saul will suffer for Jesus himself. Alternate translation: [for me] or [for my sake]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:17 (#3)

σοι & ἦρχου & ἀναβλέψῃς

“to you & you were going & you might see again”

All of the occurrences of the word **you** in this verse are singular and refer to Saul.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Acts 9:17 (#1)

ἀπῆλθεν δὲ Ἁνανίας καὶ εἰσῆλθεν εἰς τὴν οἰκίαν

“And Ananias departed, and entered into the house”

It may be helpful to state that **Ananias** went to **the house** before he **entered into** it. UST models one way to express this.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:17 (#4)

Σαοὺλ, ἀδελφέ

“Saul, brother”

Brother is a figurative title that Ananias is using for **Saul**. The two men are not actual brothers. This could mean: (1) that Ananias is already addressing Saul as someone who shares the same faith. See how you

translated “brother” with this meaning in 1:15 and 6:3. Alternate translation: [Saul, my fellow believer]; (2) that Ananias is addressing Saul as a fellow Israelite, as the word is used in 3:17 and many other places in this book. Alternate translation: [Saul, my fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:17 (#7)

ὅπως ἀναβλέψῃς καὶ πλησθῇς Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

“so that you might see again and be filled with the Holy Spirit”

If your language does not use the passive form **filled**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that you might see again and that the Holy Spirit might fill you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:17 (#2)

ἐπιθεὶς ἐπ’ αὐτὸν τὰς χεῖρας

“having laid {his} hands on him”

When Ananias **laid his hands** on Saul, this was a symbolic way of giving him a blessing. See the explanation at 9:12 and see how you translated the same expression there.

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 9:17 (#5)

ὁ ὀφθείς σοι

“the one having appeared to you”

Ananias is using the participle **having appeared**, which functions as an adjective, as a noun to mean a person, Jesus. ULT adds the term **one** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [who appeared to you]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 9:17 (#8)

πλησθῇς Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

“be filled with the Holy Spirit”

Ananias is speaking as if Saul were a container that the Holy Spirit could fill. Alternate translation: [receive the Holy Spirit]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:17 (#6)

ᾗ ἤρχου

“on which you were going”

Your language may say “coming” rather than **going** in a context such as this. Use whichever word is more natural. Alternate translation: [by which you were coming]

See: Go and Come

Acts 9:18 (#1)

λεπίδες

“scales”

It may be helpful to your readers if you use something they would recognize that has scales to describe the **scales** that fell from Saul’s eyes. Alternate translation: [fish scales] or [lizard scales] or [snake scales]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 9:18 (#2)

ἐβαπτίσθη

“he was baptized”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Ananias baptized him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:19 (#1)

ἐνισχύθη

“he was strengthened”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he felt stronger]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:20 (#2)

Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

“Son of God”

Son of God is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

Acts 9:20 (#1)

ἐκήρυσσεν τὸν Ἰησοῦν, ὅτι οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ Υἱὸς τοῦ Θεοῦ

“he proclaimed Jesus, that this is the Son of God”

The personal pronoun **he** refers to Saul, and the demonstrative pronoun **this** refers to Jesus. Alternate translation: [Saul proclaimed that Jesus is the Son of God]

See: Pronouns

Acts 9:21 (#1)

πάντες οἱ ἀκούοντες

“all the ones hearing”

Luke says **all** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [those who heard him] or [many who heard him]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 9:21 (#3)

οὐχ οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ πορθήσας ἐν Ἰερουσαλὴμ τοὺς ἐπικαλουμένους τὸ ὄνομα τοῦτο, καὶ ὧδε εἰς τοῦτο ἐληλύθει, ἵνα δεδεμένους, αὐτοὺς ἀγάγῃ ἐπὶ τοὺς ἀρχιερεῖς

“Is not this the one having destroyed in Jerusalem the ones calling on this name? And he had come here for this, that he might bring them bound to the chief priests”

The people in Damascus are using the question form to emphasize that Saul was indeed the man who had persecuted the believers in Jerusalem and had come to Damascus to arrest the believers there. If you would not use rhetorical questions for this purpose in your language, you could translate these words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the emphasis in another way. It may be helpful to make this two sentences. Alternate translation: [This is the man who destroyed those in Jerusalem who call on this name! And he come here for this, that he might bring them bound to the chief priests!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 9:21 (#2)

οἱ ἀκούοντες & ὁ πορθήσας & τοὺς ἐπικαλουμένους

“the ones hearing & the one having destroyed & the ones calling on”

Luke is using the participles **hearing**, **having destroyed**, and **calling on**, which function as adjective, as nouns. ULT adds the terms **ones** and **one** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate these with equivalent expressions. Alternate translation: [those who heard ... the man who destroyed ... those who call]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 9:21 (#8)

ἵνα δεδεμένους, αὐτοὺς ἀγάγῃ ἐπὶ τοὺς ἀρχιερεῖς

“that he might bring them bound to the chief priests”

Like Ananias in 9:14, the people here are using one part of the arrest process to represent the entire process. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [that he might arrest them and bring them to the chief priests]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 9:21 (#6)

τοὺς ἐπικαλουμένους τὸ ὄνομα τοῦτο

“the ones calling on this name”

Here, **calling on** is an idiom. See how you translated it in 9:14. Alternate translation: [the ones worshiping Jesus]

See: Idiom

Acts 9:21 (#4)

τοὺς ἐπικαλουμένους τὸ ὄνομα τοῦτο

“the ones calling on this name”

By **this name** the speakers implicitly mean the name of Jesus. Alternate translation: [the ones calling on the name of Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:21 (#7)

ἵνα δεδεμένους, αὐτοὺς ἀγάγῃ ἐπὶ τοὺς ἀρχιερεῖς

“that he might bring them bound to the chief priests”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that he might bind them and bring them to the chief priests]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:21 (#5)

τοὺς ἐπικαλουμένους τὸ ὄνομα τοῦτο

“the ones calling on this name”

Here, the **name** of Jesus represents his person. Alternate translation: [the ones calling on Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:22 (#1)

καὶ συνέχυννεν τοὺς Ἰουδαίους τοὺς κατοικοῦντας ἐν Δαμασκῷ, συμβιβάζων ὅτι οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ Χριστός

“and stirring up the Jews living in Damascus, proving that Jesus is the Christ”

Saul was not intentionally **stirring up the Jews**. They became agitated because they could not find a way to refute Saul’s arguments that Jesus was the Messiah. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [As he proved that Jesus is the Christ, the Jews living in Damascus became agitated]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:23 (#2)

ὡς & ἐπληροῦντο ἡμέραι ἱκαναί

“when many days were filled”

Since this is an idiom, it would probably not be meaningful in most languages to retain the verb “fill” but use an active verbal form instead of the passive form here. However, if your language does speak of someone or something “filling” days or times so that they arrive, and if your language does not use passive verbal forms, you could use an active form of “fill” here.

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:23 (#1)

ὡς & ἐπληροῦντο ἡμέραι ἱκαναί

“when many days were filled”

As in 2:1 and 7:23, this is an idiomatic way of speaking about time. Alternate translation: [after many days]

See: Idiom

Acts 9:23 (#3)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to one part of that group, its leaders. Alternate translation: [the leaders of the Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 9:23 (#4)

αὐτόν

“him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Saul. Alternate translation: [Saul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 9:24 (#1)

ἐγνώσθη δὲ τῷ Σαύλῳ ἡ ἐπιβουλὴ αὐτῶν

“But their plot became known to Saul”

This could mean: (1) that a person realized there was a plot by recognizing that the Jewish leaders were watching the gates, and that person told Saul. In that case it may be helpful to move this information to the end of the verse, as UST does. (2) that someone told Saul about the plot, but even so, he was not able to flee for his life, because the gates were being watched. In that case you could change the second instance of **But** in the verse to “However.”

See: Information Structure

Acts 9:24 (#4)

τὰς πύλας

“the gates”

Luke is using **the gates** to mean the people going through the gates. Alternate translation: [to see who was going through the gates]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:24 (#2)

ἐγνώσθη δὲ τῷ Σαύλῳ ἡ ἐπιβουλὴ αὐτῶν

“But their plot became known to Saul”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Saul learned about their plot]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:24 (#5)

ἡμέρας τε καὶ νυκτὸς

“both day and night”

Luke is using the two parts of a full day, **day** and **night**, to mean all the time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all the time]

See: Merism

Acts 9:24 (#3)

παρετηροῦντο & τὰς πύλας & ὅπως αὐτὸν ἀνέλωσιν

"they were & watching the gates & in order to kill him"

The city of Damascus had a wall surrounding it. People could normally only enter and exit the city through **the gates** in this wall. Saul's enemies expected that he would try to leave the city eventually and they hoped to catch him and kill him when he did. Alternate translation: [they were ... watching the gates in the city wall ... in order to kill him when he tried to leave the city]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:25 (#1)

οἱ μαθηταὶ αὐτοῦ

"his disciples"

These **disciples** were people who had believed Saul's message and become committed followers of Jesus. Alternate translation: [the people who had believed Saul's message about Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:26 (#1)

πάντες ἐφοβοῦντο αὐτόν

"they were all fearing him"

Luke says **all** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [they were afraid of him]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 9:27 (#1)

Βαρναβᾶς & ἐπιλαβόμενος αὐτὸν, ἤγαγεν πρὸς τοὺς ἀποστόλους; καὶ διηγήσατο αὐτοῖς πῶς ἐν τῇ ὁδῷ εἶδεν τὸν Κύριον, καὶ ὅτι ἐλάλησεν αὐτῷ & ἐπαρρησιάσατο

"taking hold of him, Barnabas brought him to the apostles and told them how he had seen the Lord on the road and that he had spoken to him & he had spoken boldly"

The pronoun **him** refers to Saul in every instance. The pronoun **he** refers to Saul in the first and third instances and to **the Lord** in the second instance. The pronoun **them** refers to **the apostles**. Alternate translation: [taking hold of Saul, Barnabas brought him to the apostles and told the apostles how Saul had seen the Lord on the road and that the Lord had spoken to Saul ... Saul had spoken boldly]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 9:27 (#2)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι τοῦ Ἰησοῦ

"in the name of Jesus"

Here the **name** of Jesus represents his authority. Saul **had spoken boldly** with delegated authority, representing Jesus. Alternate translation: [as a representative of Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:28 (#3)

εἰσπορευόμενος καὶ ἐκπορευόμενος

"coming in and going out"

This is a Hebrew idiom that refers to freedom of movement. Saul was completely accepted by the believers in Jerusalem and could go anywhere among them. Alternate translation: [moving about freely among them]

See: Idiom

Acts 9:28 (#2)

ἦν μετ' αὐτῶν

"he was with them"

The pronoun **he** refers to Saul. The pronoun **them** refers to the apostles and probably other disciples in Jerusalem. Alternate translation: [Saul was with the apostles and other believers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 9:28 (#1)

καὶ

"And"

Luke uses the word translated as **And** to introduce what Saul was able to do after Barnabas reassured the apostles about him. Alternate translation: [So]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 9:28 (#4)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι τοῦ Κυρίου

"in the name of the Lord"

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:27. Alternate translation: [as a representative of the Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:29 (#1)

Ἑλληνιστάς

“Hellenists”

Hellenists was the name for Jews in the Roman Empire who spoke the Greek language and followed Greek customs. See how you translated this name in 6:1.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 9:29 (#2)

οἱ δὲ ἐπεχείρουν ἀνελεῖν αὐτόν

“but they were attempting to kill him”

The implication is that the Hellenists were not able to refute what Saul was saying about Jesus, and so they saw him as a threat and wanted to get rid of him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [and because they could not refute him, they were attempting to kill him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:30 (#3)

ἐξαπέστειλαν αὐτὸν

“sent him away”

Caesarea was a seaport, and the believers probably **sent** Saul **to Tarsus** by ship. Alternate translation: [sent him away by ship]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:30 (#2)

κατήγαγον αὐτὸν εἰς Καισάρειαν

“brought him down to Caesarea”

Luke uses the phrase **brought him down** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Caesarea is lower in elevation. Alternate translation: [made sure he got safely to Caesarea]

See: Idiom

Acts 9:30 (#1)

οἱ ἀδελφοὶ

“the brothers”

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. Alternate translation: [his fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:31 (#2)

οἰκοδομουμένη καὶ πορευομένη

“being built up and journeying”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, you could state “God” or “the Holy Spirit.” Alternate translation: [As God built it up and it journeyed] or [As the Holy Spirit built it up and it journeyed]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:31 (#1)

εἶχεν εἰρήνην

“was having peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [enjoyed peaceful conditions once more]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 9:31 (#3)

οἰκοδομουμένη

“being built up”

Luke is speaking of the church as if it were a building that God was constructing. Alternate translation: [growing stronger]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:31 (#6)

τῇ παρακλήσει τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος

“in the encouragement of the Holy Spirit”

Luke is using the possessive form to describe **the Holy Spirit** as the one who was giving the church **encouragement**. Alternate translation: [with the Holy Spirit encouraging them]

See: Possession

Acts 9:31 (#5)

πορευομένη τῷ φόβῳ τοῦ Κυρίου

“journeying in the fear of the Lord”

Here the word **fear** describes a deep respect for God. Alternate translation: [living with a deep respect for the Lord]

Acts 9:31 (#4)

πορευομένη τῷ φόβῳ τοῦ Κυρίου

“journeying in the fear of the Lord”

Here, **journeying** means “living.” Alternate translation: [living in the fear of the Lord]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:32 (#1)

ἐγένετο δὲ

“Now it happened that”

Luke uses this phrase to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 9:32 (#3)

κατελθεῖν

“came down”

Luke says **to come down** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, where Peter was living, since that city is up on a mountain. Lydda is lower in elevation. Alternate translation: [to travel]

See: Idiom

Acts 9:32 (#4)

τοὺς ἁγίους τοὺς κατοικοῦντας Λύδδα

“the saints inhabiting Lydda”

Luke says **to come down** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, where Peter was living, since that city is up on a mountain. Lydda is lower in elevation. Alternate translation: [to travel]

See: Idiom

Acts 9:32 (#5)

Λύδδα

“Lydda”

Lydda is the name of a city in Israel. It is located where the foothills meet the coastal plain. This city was called Lod in the Old Testament and it has that name in modern Israel as well. Decide what name would be most helpful to your readers.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 9:32 (#2)

διὰ πάντων

“throughout all”

Luke says **all** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [many places in the region of Judea, Galilee, and Samaria]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 9:33 (#1)

εὗρεν & ἐκεῖ ἄνθρωπόν τινα

“there he found a certain man”

The word **found** does not mean that Peter was intentionally searching for a certain man; he happened to meet him. Alternate translation: [there Peter happened to meet a man]

Acts 9:33 (#2)

ἄνθρωπόν τινα ὀνόματι Αἰνέαν

“a certain man, Aeneas by name”

Luke uses this sentence to introduce **Aeneas** as a new character in the story. If your language has its own way of doing that, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 9:33 (#4)

ἐξ ἐτῶν ὀκτὼ κατακείμενον ἐπὶ κραβάττου, ὃς ἦν παραλελυμένος

“lying on a mat for eight years, who was paralyzed”

In this verse, Luke provides background information about Aeneas to help readers understand what happens next in the story. This information shows how remarkable it was that Jesus could heal a man who had been bedridden for that long. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural and meaningful in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 9:33 (#3)

Αἰνέαν

“Aeneas”

Aeneas is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 9:33 (#5)

ἐξ ἐτῶν ὀκτὼ κατακείμενον ἐπὶ κραβάττου, ὃς ἦν παραλελυμένος

“lying on a mat for eight years, who was paralyzed”

The reason why Aeneas had been **lying in a bed for eight years** was that he **was paralyzed**. It may be clearer in your language to describe this result after giving the reason for it. Alternate translation: [who was paralyzed and so had lain in a bed for eight years]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 9:34 (#2)

ἀνάστηθι, καὶ στρῶσον σεαυτῷ

“Arise and make your bed for yourself”

Peter says **for yourself** to emphasize that Jesus has healed Aeneas so completely that he will now be able to do for himself what others previously had to do for him. Alternate translation: [Get up, you could make your own bed now]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 9:34 (#3)

στρῶσον σεαυτῷ

“make your bed for yourself”

Getting up and making his own bed was also a symbolic action by which Aeneas demonstrated that Jesus had healed him. Alternate translation: [Arise and make your bed to show everyone that Jesus has healed you]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 9:34 (#1)

ἀνάστηθι

“Arise”

Arise in this context is literal, not figurative. It means to get up from a position of lying down, rather than to take action or make preparations.

Acts 9:35 (#5)

οἵτινες ἐπέστρεψαν ἐπὶ τὸν Κύριον

“who turned to the Lord”

Here, **turned to the Lord** means that the people believed in Jesus and started to obey him. Alternate translation: [and they repented of their sins and started obeying Jesus]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:35 (#3)

καὶ τὸν Σαρῶνα

“and in Sharon”

Sharon is the name of a plain, on which Lydda was located. Alternate translation: [and in the surrounding area of Sharon]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 9:35 (#2)

πάντες οἱ κατοικοῦντες Λύδδα καὶ τὸν Σαρῶνα

“all the ones living in Lydda and in Sharon”

Luke says **all** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [those who lived in Lydda and in Sharon]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 9:35 (#4)

εἶδαν αὐτὸν

“saw him”

The implication is that the people knew Aeneas was bedridden and now they saw that he was healed. Alternate translation: [saw that Aeneas was healed] or [saw Aeneas up and walking around]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:35 (#1)

εἶδαν αὐτὸν πάντες οἱ κατοικοῦντες Λύδδα καὶ τὸν Σαρῶνα, οἵτινες ἐπέστρεψαν ἐπὶ τὸν Κύριον

“all the ones living in Lydda and in Sharon saw him, who turned to the Lord”

The pronoun **him** refers to Aeneas. The pronoun **who** refers to the people of Lydda and Sharon. Alternate translation: [when all the people living in Lydda and Sharon saw him, they turned to the Lord]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 9:36 (#2)

Ταβειθά, ἣ διερμηνευομένη λέγεται, Δορκάς

“Tabitha & which, being translated, is said “Dorcas”

Tabitha was this woman’s name in Aramaic, and **Dorcas** was her name Greek. (Both names mean “gazelle.”

Note how, later in the story, Luke, writing in Greek, calls her Dorcas, while Peter, speaking in Aramaic, calls her Tabitha.) It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Her name in Aramaic was Tabitha, and her name in Greek was Dorcas]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 9:36 (#1)

δέ

“Now”

Luke uses the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 9:36 (#4)

πλήρης ἔργων ἀγαθῶν

“full of good works”

Luke speaks of **Dorcas** as if she were a container that was **full** of good works and almsgivings. Alternate translation: [doing many good things and giving to others generously]

See: Metaphor

Acts 9:36 (#3)

λέγεται

“is said”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [means]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:37 (#2)

λούσαντες & αὐτὴν ἔθηκαν

“having washed her, they laid her”

This was washing to prepare for Dorcas’s body for burial. Customarily her family and friends would have done it. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. “Once her family and friends had washed her body to prepare it for burial, they laid it”

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:37 (#3)

ἔθηκαν ἐν ὑπερῴῳ

“they laid her in an upper room”

This was a temporary display of the body during the funeral process. Alternate translation: [they laid her body in an upper room so that people could come there and pay their respects]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:37 (#4)

ὑπερῴῳ

“an upper room”

In this culture, in some houses, rooms were built above other rooms. If your community does not have houses like that, you could use another expression to describe a large, sheltered space that people could use for funeral visitation.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 9:37 (#1)

ἐν ταῖς ἡμέραις ἐκείναις

“in those days”

The phrase **in those days** refers to the time when Peter was nearby in Lydda. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [while Peter was nearby]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:38 (#2)

παρακαλοῦντες

“urging him”

Since two men are speaking, if your language marks participles for number, **urging** would be dual if your language uses that form. Otherwise it would be plural.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Dual/Plural

Acts 9:38 (#1)

ἀκούσαντες ὅτι Πέτρος ἐστὶν ἐν αὐτῇ, ἀπέστειλαν

“having heard that Peter was in it, sent”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [having heard, “Peter is in Lydda,” sent]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 9:39 (#2)

αὐτοῖς

“them”

This first instance of **them** in the verse would be dual if your language uses that form, since it applies to two men. The second instance of **them** would be plural, since it refers to the group of widows.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Dual/Plural

Acts 9:39 (#4)

χιτῶνας καὶ ἱμάτια, ὅσα ἐποίει μετ᾽ αὐτῶν οὖσα ἡ Δορκάς

“coats and garments, as many as Dorcas used to make, being with them”

It may be helpful to say explicitly that Dorcas made these **coats and garments** to help these **widows** because they were poor and could not afford clothes. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [coats and garments. When she was alive, Dorcas used to make many of these to help the widows because they were poor and could not afford clothes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:39 (#3)

πᾶσαι αἱ χῆραι

“all the widows”

Luke says **all** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [a large crowd of widows]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 9:39 (#5)

μετ᾽ αὐτῶν οὖσα

“being with them”

This may be a delicate way of speaking about Dorcas’s death, rather than saying “before she died.” Alternate translation, as in UST: [while she was still alive]

See: Euphemism

Acts 9:39 (#1)

ἀναστὰς & Πέτρος συνῆλθεν αὐτοῖς

“arising, Peter went with them”

Here the word **arising** means that Peter took action in order to be able to make the trip with these men, not that he got up from a sitting or lying position. Alternate translation: [Peter quickly prepared and went with them]

See: Idiom

Acts 9:40 (#2)

Ταβειθά, ἀνάστηθι

“Tabitha, arise”

This was not a command that Tabitha was capable of obeying. Instead, it was a command that directly caused her to be restored to life. Alternate translation: [Jesus the Messiah restores you to life, so you can get up now]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 9:40 (#1)

θεὶς τὰ γόνατα

“having put down {his} knees”

Kneeling down was a reverent posture of prayer. Alternate translation: [having knelt down reverently]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 9:40 (#3)

Ταβειθά, ἀνάστηθι

“Tabitha, arise”

Getting up was a symbolic action by which Tabitha could demonstrate that Jesus had restored her to life. Alternate translation: [Get up to show everyone that Jesus has restored you to life]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 9:41 (#2)

τοὺς ἁγίους καὶ τὰς χήρας

“the saints and the widows”

These **saints** and **widows** were probably not two different groups. The widows were likely also believers, but Luke mentions them specifically because Tabitha was so important to them. To show this, it may be helpful to put the information about the widows before the information about the believers. Alternate translation: [the widows and the other believers]

See: Information Structure

Acts 9:41 (#3)

τοὺς ἁγίους

“the saints”

Luke is using the term **saints** by association to mean believers in Jesus. See how you translated the term in 9:13. Alternate translation: [the other believers]

See: Metonymy

Acts 9:41 (#1)

δοὺς & αὐτῇ χεῖρα, ἀνέστησεν αὐτήν

"giving her {his} hand, he raised her up"

The implication is that Peter extended his **hand** to Tabitha to help her stand up. Alternate translation: [he let her hold onto his hand for support as he helped her stand]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 9:42 (#1)

γνωστὸν δὲ ἐγένετο καθ' ὅλης τῆς Ἰόππης

"And it became known throughout all Joppa"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [People throughout all Joppa heard about this matter]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 9:43 (#1)

ἐγένετο δὲ

"Now it happened that"

Luke uses this phrase to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 9:43 (#2)

βυρσεῖ

"a tanner"

A **tanner** is someone who makes leather from animal skins. If this is not an occupation that your readers would recognize or understand, you could use the name of a similar occupation in your culture that they would recognize.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts - Chapter 10 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

- Verses 1–2 give background information about Cornelius. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence at the start of v. 2. (See: Background Information)
- In verse 9, the story shifts away from Cornelius and tells how God prepared Peter to preach the gospel to the Gentiles.
- In verse 24, the story brings Peter and Cornelius together.
- The long sentence in verses 36–38 can be broken up into several sentences, as in the UST.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Jews visiting with Gentiles
The Jews believed that they would become unclean in God's sight if they visited or ate food with a Gentile. This was because the Pharisees had made a law against this, wanting to keep Jews from eating foods that the law of Moses said were unclean. The law of Moses did say that some foods were unclean, but it did not say that Jewish people could not visit or eat with Gentiles. (See: law, law of Moses, law of Yahweh, law of God)

Baptism and the Holy Spirit
Those who were listening to Peter received the Holy Spirit even as he was speaking to them. This showed the Jewish believers that Gentiles could believe the word of God and receive the Holy Spirit just as the Jewish believers had. After that, the Gentiles were baptized.

Acts 10:1 (#6)

Ἰταλικῆς

"Italian"

Italian is the name of a military unit. The name indicates that although the soldiers in it were stationed in Syria, they came from Italy and thus were native Romans. This made them more reliable protection for the high-ranking Roman officials whose residence was in Caesarea.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 10:1 (#3)

ἑκατοντάρχης

"a centurion"

A **centurion** was an officer in the Roman army who was in charge of a group of 100 soldiers. Such a group

was called a "century." Alternate translation: [an army officer in charge of 100 soldiers]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 10:1 (#5)

Σπείρης

"the regiment"

A **regiment** was a military unit consisting of six centuries or 600 soldiers. You may have a term in your language that you can use for a unit of about this size.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 10:1 (#1)

ἀνὴρ δέ τις

"Now a certain man"

Luke uses this phrase to introduce a new character into the story. If your language has its own way of doing that, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 10:1 (#2)

Κορνήλιος

"Cornelius"

Cornelius is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 10:1 (#4)

Σπείρης τῆς καλουμένης Ἰταλικῆς

"the regiment called Italian"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the regiment people called Italian] or [the regiment whose name was Italian] or [the Italian Regiment]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:2 (#3)

τῷ λαῷ

"to the people"

Luke assumes that his readers will know that **the people** refers to Jewish people who were in need. Alternate translation: [to Jewish people in need]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:2 (#2)

εὐσεβὴς καὶ φοβούμενος τὸν Θεὸν

"devout and fearing God"

Jews in the time of the New Testament used the expression **fearing God** to describe Gentiles (non-Jews) who worshiped the God of Israel, attended the synagogue, prayed at regular times, and supported the needs of the Jewish community. Luke may be using the expression in this way and assuming that his readers will recognize it. Alternate translation: [a Gentile who sincerely worshiped the God of Israel]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:2 (#1)

εὐσεβὴς καὶ φοβούμενος τὸν Θεὸν

"devout and fearing God"

The word **devout** and the phrase **fearing God** mean similar things. (In this context, the word **fearing** has the sense of deep respect and awe.) Luke may be using them together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [sincerely devoted to God] or see next note for another possibility.

See: Doublet

Acts 10:2 (#4)

διὰ παντός

"through all"

The phrase **through all** is an ellipsis for "through all times." See how you translated it in 2:25. Alternate translation: [always] or [at all times]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 10:2 (#5)

δεόμενος τοῦ Θεοῦ διὰ παντός

"praying to God through all"

The phrase **through all**, meaning "at all times," is a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [often]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 10:3 (#1)

ὥραν ἐνάτην

"the ninth hour"

This was the normal afternoon prayer time for Jews. Cornelius, as a Gentile who worshiped the God of

Israel, would have praying at this time. Alternate translation: [during his afternoon prayer time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:3 (#2)

ὥραν ἐνάτην

"the ninth hour"

In this culture, people began counting the hours each day beginning around daybreak at six o'clock in the morning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this in the way the people of your culture reckon time.

See: Idiom

Acts 10:3 (#3)

ὥραν ἐνάτην

"the ninth hour"

If you decide to translate this in the way that the biblical culture reckoned time, but your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here. Alternate translation: [around hour nine]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Acts 10:4 (#2)

τί ἐστιν, κύριε

"What is it, lord"

Cornelius uses the respectful title **lord** because he recognizes that he is speaking to a messenger from God. See how you translated the similar term in 9:5.

See: Politeness

Acts 10:4 (#4)

αἱ προσευχαί σου, καὶ αἱ ἐλεημοσύναι σου, ἀνέβησαν εἰς μνημόσυνον ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"Your prayers and your alms have gone up for a memorial offering before God"

A **memorial offering** was the portion of an offering brought to the priests for their support that was burned on the altar as a pleasing aroma for God, to give God an occasion to remember the worshiper. The angel is using this offering to tell Cornelius that God is aware of his devotion and generosity and that God is pleased with those things. You could translate this metaphor as a simile, or you could explain its meaning. Alternate translation: [Your prayers and your alms have gone up like a memorial offering before God] or [God is aware of your prayers and your alms, and he is pleased with them]

See: Metaphor

Acts 10:4 (#3)

εἶπεν δὲ αὐτῷ

"And he said to him"

The pronoun **he** stands for the angel, and the pronoun **him** stands for Cornelius. Alternate translation: [And the angel said to Cornelius]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 10:4 (#5)

ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"before God"

Here, **before** means "in the presence of." Alternate translation: [into the presence of God]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:4 (#1)

ὁ δὲ, ἀτενίσας αὐτῷ

"But he, staring at him"

The pronoun **he** stands for Cornelius, and the pronoun **him** stands for the angel. Alternate translation: [But Cornelius, staring at the angel]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 10:5 (#1)

ὃς ἐπικαλεῖται Πέτρος

"who is called Peter"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom people call Peter]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:6 (#2)

βυρσεῖ

"a tanner"

See how you translated the term **tanner** in 9:43.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 10:6 (#1)

ξενίζεται παρά

“is being hosted by”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is the guest of]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:7 (#1)

ὡς δὲ ἀπῆλθεν ὁ ἄγγελος ὁ λαλῶν αὐτῷ

“And when the angel speaking to him left”

Alternate translation: [And when Cornelius’ vision of the angel had ended]

Acts 10:7 (#2)

εὐσεβῆ

“devout”

The adjective **devout** describes a person who worships God and serves him. Alternate translation: [sincerely religious]

Acts 10:8 (#1)

ἅπαντα

“everything”

By **everything**, Luke means the details of the vision that Cornelius had. Alternate translation: [how an angel had spoken to him in a vision and what the angel had said]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 10:9 (#1)

ὁδοιπορούντων ἐκείνων

“as those were traveling”

The demonstrative pronoun **those** refers to Cornelius’ two servants and the soldier under Cornelius’ command. Alternate translation: [as the men whom Cornelius had sent were traveling]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 10:9 (#3)

περὶ ὥραν ἕκτην

“at about the sixth hour”

If you decide to translate this in the way that the biblical culture reckoned time, but your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here. Alternate translation: [at around hour six]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Acts 10:9 (#2)

περὶ ὥραν ἕκτην

“at about the sixth hour”

In this culture, people began counting the hours each day beginning around daybreak at six o’clock in the morning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this in the way the people of your culture reckon time. Alternate translation: [at around noon]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 10:10 (#1)

ἐγένετο ἐπ’ αὐτὸν ἔκστασις

“a vision came upon him”

Luke speaks of this **vision** as if it were a living thing that could come onto someone. Alternate translation: [he had a vision]

See: Personification

Acts 10:11 (#1)

θεωρεῖ τὸν οὐρανὸν ἀνεῳγμένον

“he sees the sky opened”

To call attention to a development in the story, here Luke uses the present tense in past narration. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense in your translation. It may be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [And he saw] or [And Peter saw]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Acts 10:11 (#3)

καθιέμενον

“being let down”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [It appeared as if someone was letting it down]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:11 (#2)

τὸν οὐρανὸν ἀνεῳγμένον

“the sky opened”

If your language does not use the passive form **opened**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the sky break open]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:12 (#2)

καὶ πετεινὰ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ

"and birds of the sky"

From Peter's response in 10:14, the implication is that the law of Moses commanded the Jews not to eat some of the creatures in the container. Alternate translation: [and birds of the sky, including some that the law of Moses commanded Jews not to eat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:12 (#1)

πάντα τὰ

"all the"

The word **all** is likely a generalization for emphasis, although since this was a vision, it is possible that the container Peter saw did contain every kind of these creatures. Alternate translation: [various]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 10:13 (#2)

ἀναστάς

"arising"

Here the term **arising** means that the voice wanted Peter to take action, not that the voice wanted him to stand up from a seated position. Alternate translation, as in UST: [Go ahead]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:13 (#1)

ἐγένετο φωνὴ πρὸς αὐτόν

"a voice came to him"

Luke speaks of this **voice** as if it were a living thing that could come to someone. Alternate translation: [he heard a voice]

See: Personification

Acts 10:14 (#3)

κοινὸν καὶ ἀκάθαρτον

"common and unclean"

The words **common** and **unclean** mean similar things. Peter may be using them together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [that our Jewish laws forbid us to eat]

See: Doublet

Acts 10:14 (#2)

οὐδέποτε ἔφαγον πᾶν κοινὸν καὶ ἀκάθαρτον

"I have never eaten anything common and unclean"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of word **never** and the negative terms **common** and **unclean**. Alternate translation: [I have only ever eaten things that are holy and clean]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 10:14 (#1)

μηδαμῶς

"Not at all"

Not at all is an exclamation that communicates a strong refusal to do or even to consider something. Use an exclamation that is natural in your language for communicating this. Alternate translation: [No, never]

See: Exclamations

Acts 10:14 (#4)

οὐδέποτε ἔφαγον πᾶν κοινὸν καὶ ἀκάθαρτον

"I have never eaten anything common and unclean"

The implication is that some the animals in the container were forbidden for Jews to eat. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [common and unclean, like some of those animals]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:15 (#1)

φωνὴ πάλιν & πρὸς αὐτόν

"the voice {came} to him again"

The implied verb here is **came**, and so Luke is speaking once again of this **voice** as if it were a living thing that could come to someone. Alternate translation: [he heard the voice speaking to him again]

See: Personification

Acts 10:15 (#3)

σὺ μὴ κοίνου

“you, do not make common”

The voice is adding the pronoun **you** for emphasis. If your language does not ordinarily use a pronoun with the imperative but can do so for emphasis, it would be appropriate to do that here. You could also express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you must not make common]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 10:15 (#2)

ἃ ὁ Θεὸς ἐκαθάρισεν

“What God has cleansed”

If God is the speaker, he is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the first person in your translation. Alternate translation: [What I, God, have cleansed]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 10:16 (#1)

τοῦτο & ἐγένετο ἐπὶ τρίς

“this happened three times”

This could mean: (1) that the voice told Peter three times to kill and eat, Peter refused three times, and each time the voice told him not to call unclean what God had cleansed. Alternate translation: [Peter had this exchange with the voice three times]; (2) that after Peter first refused, the voice said to him three times, “What God has cleansed, you must not make common.” Alternate translation: [the voice said this three times] You may find it simplest to say, [This happened three times] as UST does.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:16 (#2)

ἀνελήμφθη τὸ σκεῦος

“the container was & taken back up”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [it appeared as if someone was pulling the container back up]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:17 (#4)

ἐπέστησαν ἐπὶ τὸν πυλῶνα

“the & stood before & gate”

The implication is that the house of Simon the tanner had a wall around it and that there was a **gate** in the wall that people could use to enter the property. Alternate translation: [stood before the gate to the house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:17 (#1)

ἐν ἑαυτῷ διηπόρει ὁ Πέτρος, τί ἂν εἴη τὸ ὅραμα ὃ εἶδεν

“Peter was doubting within himself what the vision that he had seen might mean”

Alternate translation: [Peter was wondering how God could have given him a vision like that]

Acts 10:17 (#2)

ἰδοὺ, οἱ ἄνδρες

“behold, the men”

Luke is using the term **behold** to focus readers’ attention on how suddenly these **men** appeared. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [just then the men]

See: Metaphor

Acts 10:17 (#3)

οἱ ἀπεσταλμένοι ὑπὸ τοῦ Κορνηλίου

“sent by Cornelius”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom Cornelius had sent]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:18 (#2)

ξενίζεται

“was being hosted”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [was a guest]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:18 (#1)

ὁ ἐπικαλούμενος Πέτρος

“called Peter”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom people called Peter]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:19 (#1)

ἰδοὺ, ἄνδρες τρεῖς

“Behold, three men”

The Spirit is using the term **behold** to focus Peter’s attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention, this is important: Three men]

See: Metaphor

Acts 10:19 (#2)

ἄνδρες τρεῖς

“three men”

Cornelius sent two of his servants and one soldier. Some ancient texts say “two men” or “some men.” If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider using the reading in that translation. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, you may wish to follow the readings of ULT and UST.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 10:20 (#2)

κατάβηθι

“go down”

The implication is that Peter is to **go down** from the roof of the house and greet the men. Alternate translation: [go down from the roof of the house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:20 (#3)

πορεύου σὺν αὐτοῖς

“go with them”

It would be natural for Peter not to want to go with the men, because they were Gentiles. Alternate translation: [go with them, even though they are Gentiles]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:20 (#4)

μηδὲν διακρινόμενος

“not hesitating”

This could mean: (1) that the Spirit did not want Peter to have any doubts or worries about going with the men, even though they were Gentiles. Alternate translation: [without worrying about it]; (2) that the Spirit did not want Peter to feel that he should not be in the company of these men, because they were Gentiles. Alternate translation: [not making a distinction between these men and others you would associate with]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:20 (#1)

ἀναστὰς

“arising”

Here the term **arising** means that the voice wanted Peter to take action, not that the voice wanted him to stand up from a seated position. Alternate translation: [Go ahead]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:22 (#2)

οἱ & εἶπαν

“they said”

The pronoun **they** refers to the two servants and the soldier whom Cornelius sent. Alternate translation: [The messengers from Cornelius replied]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 10:22 (#4)

φοβούμενος τὸν Θεὸν

“fearing God”

The word **righteous** and the phrase **fearing God** mean similar things. (In this context, the word **fearing** has the sense of deep respect and awe.) Luke may be using them together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [a man sincerely devoted to God] or see next note for another possibility.

See: Doublet

Acts 10:22 (#1)

οἱ & εἶπαν, Κορνήλιος, ἑκατοντάρχης ἀνὴρ δίκαιος, καὶ φοβούμενος τὸν Θεὸν, μαρτυρούμενός τε ὑπὸ ὅλου τοῦ ἔθνους τῶν Ἰουδαίων, ἐχρηματίσθη ὑπὸ ἀγγέλου

ἁγίου, μεταπέμψασθαί σε εἰς τὸν οἶκον αὐτοῦ, καὶ ἀκοῦσαι ῥήματα παρὰ σοῦ

"they said, "Cornelius, a centurion, a man righteous and fearing God and attested by the whole nation of the Jews, was directed by a holy angel to summon you to his house and to hear words from you"

If the direct quotation inside a direct quotation would be confusing in your language, you could translate the second direct quotation as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [they told Peter that Cornelius, a centurion, a man righteous and fearing God and attested by the whole nation of the Jews, was directed by a holy angel to summon him to his house and to hear words from him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 10:22 (#6)

μαρτυρούμενός τε ὑπὸ ὅλου τοῦ ἔθνους τῶν Ἰουδαίων, ἐχρηματίσθη ὑπὸ ἀγγέλου ἁγίου

"and attested by the whole nation of the Jews, was directed by a holy angel"

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [about whom the whole nation of the Jews testifies, received instructions from a holy angel]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:22 (#3)

οἱ & εἶπαν

"they said"

One of the messengers probably spoke these words on behalf of all three of them. Alternate translation: [one of them said]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 10:22 (#8)

ῥήματα

"words"

The messengers are using the term **words** to mean what Peter would say to Cornelius by using words. Alternate translation: [a message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 10:22 (#7)

ὅλου τοῦ ἔθνους τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"the whole nation of the Jews"

Luke says **whole** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [the Jewish people]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 10:22 (#5)

ἀνὴρ δίκαιος, καὶ φοβούμενος τὸν Θεὸν

"a man righteous and fearing God"

Jews in the time of the New Testament used the expression **fearing God** to describe Gentiles (non-Jews) who worshiped the God of Israel. Luke may be using the expression in this way. See how you translated it in 10:2. Alternate translation: [a Gentile who sincerely worships the God of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:23 (#1)

εἰσκαλεσάμενος οὖν αὐτοὺς ἐξένισεν

"Therefore, having invited them, he hosted them"

The implication is that the journey to Caesarea was too long for them to begin that afternoon. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [But since the journey to Caesarea was too long for them to make that day, Peter invited the men into Simon's house and hosted them there overnight]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:23 (#2)

ἀναστὰς

"arising"

Here the word **arising** means that Peter took action to prepare, not that he stood up from a seated or lying position. Alternate translation: [after packing for a journey]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:23 (#3)

τινες τῶν ἀδελφῶν

"some of the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. Alternate translation: [some fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 10:24 (#1)

τῇ & ἐπαύριον

“on the next day”

The **next day** means the day after they left Joppa. The journey to Caesarea took longer than one day. Alternate translation: [on the following day]

Acts 10:25 (#1)

πεσὼν ἐπὶ τοὺς πόδας

“and} falling down at {his} feet”

Be sure that it is clear in your translation that Cornelius did not fall down accidentally. He knelt down at Peter’s feet as a gesture to honor him. Alternate translation: [kneeling down and putting his face close to Peter’s feet to honor him]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 10:26 (#1)

ἀνάστηθι, καὶ ἐγὼ αὐτὸς ἄνθρωπός εἰμι

“Arise! I too am a man myself”

Peter is using the statement form to give a mild rebuke or correction to Cornelius. It may be clearer for your readers if you translate this as an imperative. Alternate translation: [Stop doing that! I am only a man, as you are]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Acts 10:27 (#1)

συνομιλῶν αὐτῷ, εἰσῆλθεν

“talking with him, he went in”

The pronoun **him** refers to Cornelius, and the pronoun **he** refers to Peter. Alternate translation: [talking with Cornelius, Peter went in]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 10:27 (#3)

συνεληλυθότας πολλούς

“many gathered together”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [many people whom Cornelius had gathered together]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:27 (#2)

εὑρίσκει

“finds”

To call attention to a development in the story, here Luke uses the present tense in past narration. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense in your translation. Alternate translation: [found]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Acts 10:28 (#1)

ὡς ἀθέμιτόν ἐστιν ἀνδρὶ Ἰουδαίῳ

“how unlawful it is for a Jewish man”

This phrase refers to the requirements of the Jewish religious law. Alternate translation: [that the Jewish law forbids a Jewish man]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:28 (#3)

ἄνθρωπον

“man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, Peter is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 10:28 (#2)

ἀλλοφύλῳ

“with a foreigner”

Here, the term **foreigner** refers to people who are not Jews. It is not a reference to where they live. Alternate translation: [a Gentile]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:28 (#4)

κοινὸν ἢ ἀκάθαρτον

“common or unclean”

The words **common** and **unclean** mean similar things. Peter may be using them together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [unacceptable to God]

See: Doublet

Acts 10:29 (#2)

μετεπέμψασθέ

“did you summon”

The word **you** is plural. Peter is speaking to everyone who has gathered in the home of Cornelius. Use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Acts 10:29 (#1)

μεταπεμφθείς

“having been summoned”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when you summoned me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:30 (#1)

ἀπὸ τετάρτης ἡμέρας μέχρι ταύτης τῆς ὥρας, ἤμην τὴν ἐνάτην προσευχόμενος ἐν τῷ οἴκῳ μου

“Four days ago, at this hour, I was praying at the ninth {hour} in my house”

Some ancient texts say, “From the fourth day until this hour, I was fasting, and at the ninth hour I was praying in my house.” If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider using the reading in that translation. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, you may wish to follow the reading of ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 10:30 (#8)

ἰδοὺ, ἀνὴρ

“behold, a man”

Cornelius is using the term **behold** to focus Peter’s attention on how suddenly this **man** appeared. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [just then a man]

See: Metaphor

Acts 10:30 (#6)

τὴν ἐνάτην

“at the ninth {hour”

If you decide to translate this in the way that the biblical culture reckoned time, but your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here. Alternate translation: [hour nine]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Acts 10:30 (#5)

τὴν ἐνάτην

“at the ninth {hour”

In this culture, people began counting the hours each day beginning around daybreak at six o’clock in the morning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this in the way the people of your culture reckon time. See how you translated this expression in 10:3.

See: Idiom

Acts 10:30 (#9)

ἀνὴρ

“a man”

Luke says in 10:3 that Cornelius saw an angel. Cornelius calls him **a man** here because the angel appeared to him in human form. you could state that explicitly in your translation if your readers might be confused otherwise. Alternate translation: [an angel in human form]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:30 (#2)

ἀπὸ τετάρτης ἡμέρας

“Four days ago”

In the idiom of this culture, today was the “first day,” yesterday was the “second day,” the day before yesterday was the “third day,” and the day before that was the “fourth day” or **Four days ago**. You may wish to express this in your translation in the way your own culture reckons time. Alternate translation, as in UST: [Three days ago]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:30 (#7)

τὴν ἐνάτην

“at the ninth {hour”

This was the normal afternoon prayer time for Jews. Cornelius, as a Gentile who worshiped the God of Israel, would have praying at this time. Alternate translation: [during my usual afternoon prayer time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:30 (#3)

ταύτης τῆς ὥρας

“this hour”

Cornelius is using the term **hour** to mean a particular time. Alternate translation: [this time]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:30 (#4)

τὴν ἐνάτην

“at the ninth {hour”

Cornelius is using the adjective **ninth** as a noun. ULT adds **hour** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. See how you translated this expression in 10:3.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 10:31 (#1)

φησί, Κορνήλιε, εἰσηκούσθη σου ἡ προσευχὴ καὶ αἱ ἐλεημοσύναι σου ἐμνήσθησαν ἐνώπιον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“he says, ‘Cornelius, your prayer has been heard, and your alms have been remembered before God”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [he told me that my prayer had been heard and that my alms had been remembered before God]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 10:31 (#4)

ἐμνήσθησαν ἐνώπιον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“have been remembered before God”

The word **remembered** does not imply that God had forgotten about these **alms**. Rather, it means that God is aware of Cornelius’s devotion and generosity and is pleased with them. See how you translated the similar expression in 10:4. Alternate translation: [God is aware of your alms and is pleased with them]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:31 (#3)

εἰσηκούσθη σου ἡ προσευχὴ καὶ αἱ ἐλεημοσύναι σου ἐμνήσθησαν ἐνώπιον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“your prayer has been heard, and your alms have been remembered before God”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God has heard your prayer and has remembered your alms]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:31 (#2)

φησί

“he says”

To call attention to a development in the story, here Cornelius uses the present tense in past narration. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense in your translation. Alternate translation: [he said]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Acts 10:31 (#5)

ἐνώπιον

“before”

Here the word **before** is being used. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:32 (#2)

ὃς ἐπικαλεῖται Πέτρος

“who is called Peter”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom people call Peter]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:32 (#1)

πέμψον οὖν εἰς Ἰόππην καὶ μετακάλεσαι Σίμωνα, ὃς ἐπικαλεῖται Πέτρος; οὗτος ξενίζεται ἐν οἰκίᾳ Σίμωνος, βυρσέως παρὰ θάλασσαν

“Therefore, send to Joppa and summon Simon who is called Peter. He is being hosted in the house of Simon, a tanner, by the sea”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [He said I should therefore send to Joppa and summon Simon who is called Peter, who was being hosted in the house of Simon, a tanner, by the sea]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 10:32 (#3)

οὗτος ξενίζεται

“He is being hosted”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [He is a guest]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:32 (#4)

μετακάλεσαι Σίμωνα & παρὰ θάλασσαν

“summon Simon & by the sea”

Some ancient manuscripts add at the end of this verse, “When he comes, he will speak to you.” If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider using the reading in that translation. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, you may wish to follow the reading of ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 10:33 (#3)

ἡμεῖς

“we”

Cornelius is using the word **we** to refer to himself and to his guests, but not to Peter and the believers who came with him, so use the exclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 10:33 (#5)

τὰ προστεταγμένα σοι ὑπὸ τοῦ Κυρίου

“the things you have been instructed by the Lord {to say”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the things that the Lord has told you to say]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:33 (#2)

σύ τε καλῶς ἐποίησας παραγενόμενος

“and you did well {in} coming”

This expression is a polite way of thanking Peter for coming. Alternate translation: [and we are grateful to you for coming]

See: Politeness

Acts 10:33 (#1)

σέ, σύ & σοι

“you & you & you”

The word **you** is singular in each of these instances. Even though Peter came with other believers, Cornelius is addressing Peter directly. So use the singular form of “you” in your translation if your language makes that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Acts 10:33 (#6)

τὰ προστεταγμένα σοι ὑπὸ τοῦ Κυρίου

“the things you have been instructed by the Lord {to say”

Some ancient manuscripts read “instructed by the Lord.” ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “instructed by God to say.” If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider using the reading in that translation. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, you may wish to follow the reading of ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 10:33 (#4)

ἐνώπιον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“before God”

Cornelius is using the word **before**. Alternate translation: [in the presence of God]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:34 (#2)

προσωπολήμπτης

“a favoritism-shower”

Alternate translation: [one who shows favoritism]

Acts 10:34 (#3)

οὐκ ἔστιν προσωπολήμπτης ὁ Θεός

“God is not a favoritism-shower”

As the next verse shows, Peter means implicitly that God does not favor Jewish people above people of

other nations. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [God does not favor Jewish people above people of other nations]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:34 (#1)

ἀνοίξας & Πέτρος τὸ στόμα εἶπεν

“opening {his} mouth, Peter said”

It might seem that the expression **opening his mouth ... said** contains redundant information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could abbreviate it. Alternate translation: [Peter replied]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 10:35 (#1)

ὁ φοβούμενος αὐτὸν καὶ ἐργαζόμενος δικαιοσύνην

“the one fearing him and working righteousness”

Here, **fearing** has the sense of deep respect and awe. Alternate translation: [anyone who sincerely worships him and works righteousness]

Acts 10:35 (#2)

ὁ φοβούμενος αὐτὸν καὶ ἐργαζόμενος δικαιοσύνην

“the one fearing him and working righteousness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [anyone who worships him and does righteous deeds] or [anyone who worships him and does what is right]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 10:36 (#5)

πάντων

“of all”

The word **all** could mean: (1) all people groups, both Jewish and non-Jewish. Alternate translation: [of all people, whether or not they are Jews]; (2) all created things. Alternate translation: [of everything in God’s creation]

Acts 10:36 (#4)

εὐαγγελιζόμενος εἰρήνην διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

“proclaiming peace through Jesus Christ”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [proclaiming that Jesus Christ reconciles us to God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 10:36 (#1)

τὸν λόγον

“The word”

Here Peter is implicitly saying to Cornelius and his guests that they know about this **word**; he says that explicitly in the next verse. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state “You know the word” in this verse as well.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:36 (#2)

τὸν λόγον

“The word”

Peter is using the term **word** to mean what God said to the Israelites by using words. Alternate translation: [The message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 10:36 (#3)

τοῖς υἱοῖς Ἰσραὴλ

“to the sons of Israel”

Peter is using the word **sons** to mean “descendants.” He is speaking of the Israelites, who were descendants of the patriarch Jacob, also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [to the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Acts 10:37 (#2)

καθ’ ὅλης τῆς Ἰουδαίας

“throughout all Judea”

Peter says **all** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [in many places in Judea]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 10:37 (#1)

ὑμεῖς οἴδατε τὸ & ῥῆμα

“you know the word”

Peter is using the term **word** to mean the things that happened through the life and ministry of Jesus. It

may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [You know the things]

See: Metonymy

Acts 10:37 (#3)

μετὰ τὸ βάπτισμα ὃ ἐκήρυξεν Ἰωάννης

“after the baptism that John announced”

Alternate translation: [after John preached to the people that they should repent and then baptized them]

Acts 10:38 (#5)

πάντας τοὺς καταδυναστευομένους ὑπὸ τοῦ διαβόλου

“all the ones being oppressed by the devil”

Peter says **all** as a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [those who were oppressed by the devil] or [many people who were oppressed by the devil]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 10:38 (#1)

Ἰησοῦν τὸν ἀπὸ Ναζαρέθ, ὡς ἔχρισεν αὐτὸν ὁ Θεὸς

“Jesus, the one from Nazareth, how God anointed him”

It may be helpful to put the information about God anointing before the information that it was Jesus whom God anointed. Alternate translation: [how God anointed Jesus, the one from Nazareth,]

See: Information Structure

Acts 10:38 (#3)

ἔχρισεν αὐτὸν ὁ Θεὸς Πνεύματι Ἁγίῳ καὶ δυνάμει

“God anointed him with the Holy Spirit and with power”

Peter speaks of the Holy Spirit and of God’s power as if they could be poured over someone like oil. Alternate translation: [God enabled him to do powerful works through the Holy Spirit]

See: Metaphor

Acts 10:38 (#6)

ὁ Θεὸς ἦν μετ’ αὐτοῦ

“God was with him”

The expression **was with him** is an idiom. See how you translated it in 7:9. Alternate translation: [God was helping him]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:38 (#4)

εὐεργετῶν

“doing good”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **good**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [doing good things] or [helping people]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 10:38 (#2)

Ἰησοῦν τὸν ἀπὸ Ναζαρέθ, ὡς ἔχρισεν αὐτὸν ὁ Θεὸς

“Jesus, the one from Nazareth, how God anointed him”

Peter is once again saying implicitly that Cornelius and his guests know about the things he is describing. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that explicitly. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [You know how God anointed Jesus, the one from Nazareth,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:39 (#3)

κρεμάσαντες ἐπὶ ξύλου

“hanging him on a tree”

This expression refers to crucifixion. Peter says **tree** to mean a wooden cross. Alternate translation: [crucifying him]

See: Metonymy

Acts 10:39 (#2)

ὃν καὶ ἀνεῖλαν

“whom they also killed”

The pronoun **whom** refers to Jesus, and the pronoun **they** refers to the enemies of Jesus, the Jewish leaders who conspired against him and the Romans who ordered and carried out his execution. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Also, the enemies of Jesus killed him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 10:39 (#1)

ἡμεῖς μάρτυρες

“we {are} witnesses”

Here, **we** refers to Peter and the apostles and believers who were with Jesus when he was on earth, not to Cornelius and his guests. So use the exclusive form of "we" if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 10:40 (#3)

τῇ τρίτῃ ἡμέρᾳ

"on the third day"

In the idiom of this culture, today was the "first day," tomorrow was the "second day," and the day after tomorrow was the "third day." You may wish to express this in your translation in the way your own culture reckons time. Alternate translation: [two days after he died]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:40 (#2)

τοῦτον ὁ Θεὸς ἤγειρεν

"God raised this one up"

Here, **raised ... up** is an idiom that refers to causing someone who has died to become alive again. Alternate translation: [God caused Jesus to become alive again]

See: Idiom

Acts 10:40 (#4)

ἔδωκεν αὐτὸν ἐμφανῆ γενέσθαι

"caused him to be seen"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [permitted many people to see him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:40 (#1)

τοῦτον

"this one"

The demonstrative pronoun **this** refers to Jesus. Alternate translation: [Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 10:41 (#2)

παντὶ τῷ λαῷ

"by all the people"

By **the people**, Peter means the Jewish people. Alternate translation: [by all the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:41 (#1)

οὐ παντὶ τῷ λαῷ, ἀλλὰ μάρτυσι τοῖς προκεχειροτονημένοις ὑπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ, ἡμῖν, οἵτινες συνεφάγομεν καὶ συνεπίομεν αὐτῷ μετὰ τὸ ἀναστῆναι αὐτὸν ἐκ νεκρῶν

"not by all the people, but by witnesses chosen beforehand by God—by us who ate and drank with him after he rose from the dead"

If you used an active form instead of "caused him to be seen" in the previous verse, you could adjust the language here to fit. It may be helpful to make this two new sentences. Alternate translation: [All the people did not see him, but witnesses chosen beforehand by God saw him. We who ate and drank with him after he rose from the dead saw him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:41 (#5)

ἐκ νεκρῶν

"from the dead"

Peter is using the adjective **dead** as a noun. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 10:41 (#4)

οἵτινες συνεφάγομεν καὶ συνεπίομεν αὐτῷ

"who ate and drank with him"

Peter is using one activity that he and the other apostles did with Jesus after he rose from the dead, eating and drinking (that is, sharing meals), to mean spending time with him personally. Alternate translation: [who spend time with him personally]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 10:41 (#3)

τοῖς προκεχειροτονημένοις ὑπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ

"chosen beforehand by God"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom God chose beforehand]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:42 (#3)

ὁ ὡρισμένος ὑπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the one chosen by God"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the one whom God has chosen]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:42 (#1)

ἡμῖν

"us"

Here, **us** refers to Peter and the other apostles whom Jesus chose, not to Cornelius and his guests. So use the exclusive form of "us" if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 10:42 (#4)

ζώντων καὶ νεκρῶν

"of the living and the dead"

Peter is using the adjectives **living** and **dead** as nouns. (The word **living** is actually a participle, but it functions here as an adjective.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate these words with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [of those who are alive and of those who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 10:42 (#2)

τῷ λαῷ

"to the people"

Connecting Statement:

By **the people**, Peter means the Jewish people. Alternate translation: [to the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:43 (#2)

διὰ τοῦ ὀνόματος αὐτοῦ

"through his name"

Peter is speaking of the **name** of Jesus. It could mean: (1) his actions. Alternate translation: [through what Jesus has done for them]; (2) his authority. Alternate translation: [by his authority]

See: Metonymy

Acts 10:43 (#1)

τούτῳ

"To this one"

The demonstrative pronoun **this** refers to Jesus. Alternate translation: [To Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 10:44 (#3)

τὸν λόγον

"his} word"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean what Peter was saying by using words. Alternate translation: [his message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 10:44 (#1)

ἐπέπεσε τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον ἐπὶ πάντας τοὺς ἀκούοντας τὸν λόγον

"the Holy Spirit fell on all the ones listening to {his} word"

Luke is speaking of the Holy Spirit as if it could fall on Cornelius and his guests. See how you translated the similar expression in 8:16. Alternate translation: [all the ones listening to his word received the Holy Spirit]

See: Metaphor

Acts 10:44 (#2)

πάντας τοὺς ἀκούοντας

"all the ones listening to"

While the believers who came with Peter from Joppa were also **listening** to his message, the word **all** refers to the Gentiles who were present. Alternate translation: [Cornelius and his guests, who were listening]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 10:45 (#4)

ἐκκέχυται

"was poured out"

Luke is speaking of the Holy Spirit as if he were a liquid that could be poured on people. This image implies a

generous amount. Alternate translation: [was generously given]

See: Metaphor

Acts 10:45 (#2)

ἐκ περιτομῆς

“from the circumcision”

Luke is using the term **circumcision** by association to identify these **faithful** people as Jewish. Alternate translation: [who were Jewish]

See: Metonymy

Acts 10:45 (#1)

οἱ & πιστοὶ

“the faithful”

Luke is using the adjective **faithful** as a noun, to mean people who have faith in Jesus. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the faithful men]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 10:45 (#3)

ἡ δωρεὰ τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος ἐκκέχυται

“the gift of the Holy Spirit was poured out”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God was pouring out the gift of the Holy Spirit]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:45 (#6)

καὶ ἐπὶ τὰ ἔθνη

“also on the Gentiles”

Here, **also** refers to the fact that the Holy Spirit had already been given to the Jewish believers. Alternate translation: [on the Gentiles, as it had been on Jewish believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:45 (#5)

ἡ δωρεὰ τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος

“the gift of the Holy Spirit”

Luke is using a possessive form to identify **the Holy Spirit** as a **gift** from God. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit as a gift]

See: Possession

Acts 10:46 (#1)

λαλούντων γλώσσαις

“speaking in languages”

The implication is that at least some of these **languages** were ones that the Jews recognized and could understand, but which Cornelius and his guests had not learned. This caused the Jews to acknowledge that the Holy Spirit was giving them the ability to speak these languages. Alternate translation: [speaking in languages they had not learned]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:47 (#4)

τὸ ὕδωρ

“water”

Peter is using **water**, one thing necessary for baptism, to signify all the means and permission necessary for baptism. Alternate translation: [the means and permission]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 10:47 (#1)

μήτι τὸ ὕδωρ δύναται κωλῦσαί τις τοῦ μὴ βαπτισθῆναι τούτους, οἵτινες τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον ἔλαβον, ὡς καὶ ἡμεῖς

“No one is able to withhold water, is he, so that these are not baptized who have received the Holy Spirit as we also {did”

The first word of this sentence in Greek is a negative word that can be used to turn a negative statement into a question that expects a negative answer. ULT shows this by adding **is he**. Your language may have other ways of asking a question that expects a negative answer, for example, by changing the word order of a positive statement. Translate this in the way that would be clearest in your language. Alternate translation: [Is anyone able to withhold water so that these are not baptized who have received the Holy Spirit as we also did]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 10:47 (#2)

μήτι τὸ ὕδωρ δύναται κωλῦσαί τις τοῦ μὴ βαπτισθῆναι τούτους, οἵτινες τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον ἔλαβον, ὡς καὶ ἡμεῖς

"No one is able to withhold water, is he, so that these are not baptized who have received the Holy Spirit as we also {did"

Peter is using the question form to convince the Jewish Christians that the Gentile believers should be baptized. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [No one should withhold water so that these are not baptized who have received the Holy Spirit as we also did!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 10:47 (#5)

τοῦ μὴ βαπτισθῆναι τούτους

"so that these are not baptized"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that these do not receive baptism]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:47 (#3)

μήτι τὸ ὕδωρ δύναται κωλῦσαί τις τοῦ μὴ βαπτισθῆναι τούτους, οἵτινες τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον ἔλαβον, ὡς καὶ ἡμεῖς

"No one is able to withhold water, is he, so that these are not baptized who have received the Holy Spirit as we also {did"

Even if the negative question is turned into a positive statement, a double negative still remains, the negative verb **withhold** and the negative particle **not**. This double negative can also be stated in positive form. Alternate translation: [We should make water available so that these can be baptized who have received the Holy Spirit as we also did!]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 10:48 (#1)

προσέταξεν & αὐτοὺς & βαπτισθῆναι

"he commanded them to be baptized"

The implication is that Peter and the believers who accompanied him from Joppa would be the ones to baptize the Gentile believers. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [Peter told the Gentile believers to allow the Jewish Christians to baptize them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 10:48 (#2)

προσέταξεν & αὐτοὺς & βαπτισθῆναι

"he commanded them to be baptized"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he commanded them to receive baptism]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 10:48 (#3)

ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ βαπτισθῆναι

"to be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ"

Here, **in the name** is an idiomatic way of saying "on the basis of naming." Peter commanded Cornelius and his guests to acknowledge Jesus as the Messiah as the basis of their baptism for the forgiveness of their sins, as described in 10:43. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:38. Alternate translation: [on the basis of naming Jesus as the Christ] or [upon acknowledging that Jesus is the Messiah]

See: Idiom

Acts - Chapter 11 Introduction

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"The Gentiles also had received the word of God"
Almost all of the first believers were Jewish. Luke writes in this chapter that many Gentiles started to believe in Jesus. They believed that the message about Jesus was true and so began to "receive the word of God." Some of the believers in Jerusalem did not believe that Gentiles could truly follow Jesus, so Peter went to them and told them what had happened to him and how he had seen the Gentiles receive the Word of God and receive the Holy Spirit.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"the Lord"
In verse 16, Peter refers to Jesus by a respectful title, "the Lord." Luke refers to Jesus the same way in the second instance of the phrase in verse 21 and in verses 23 and 24. In your translation, you may wish to clarify

that this means "the Lord Jesus." Or you could state "Jesus," as UST does. (See: Politeness)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Peter's summary of his visit to Cornelius
In Acts 11:5–17, Peter summarizes the events that are described in greater detail in 10:9–47. Very similar language is used throughout both passages. As you translate 11:5–17, in order to ensure that your translation is consistent, compare how you translated specific terms and phrases in 10:9–47.

Acts 11:1 (#2)

οἱ ἀδελφοὶ

"the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. Alternate translation, as in UST: [the other believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 11:1 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke uses the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 11:1 (#3)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the word of God"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that Peter, by using words, shared with Cornelius and his guests. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:2 (#2)

οἱ ἐκ περιτομῆς

"those from the circumcision"

As in 10:45, Luke is using the term **circumcision** by association to identify as Jewish these believers who disputed with Peter. They were likely to have been strictly observant Jews who followed the teaching of the Pharisees about Jews visiting with Gentiles. See the discussion of this in the introduction to Chapter 10. Alternate translation: [some believers who were strictly observant Jews]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:2 (#1)

ἀνέβη & εἰς Ἰερουσαλήμ

"came up to Jerusalem"

Luke says that Peter **came up** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling to Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Alternate translation: [returned to Jerusalem]

See: Idiom

Acts 11:3 (#2)

εἰσῆλθεν πρὸς

"he went in to"

This expression implicitly means that Peter went in to the home of these **men**. Alternate translation: [he went into the home of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:3 (#1)

λέγοντες, ὅτι εἰσῆλθεν πρὸς ἄνδρας, ἀκροβυστίαν ἔχοντας, καὶ συνέφαγεν αὐτοῖς

"saying that he went in to men having foreskins and ate with them"

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [saying, "You went in to men having foreskins and ate with them!"]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 11:3 (#3)

ἄνδρας, ἀκροβυστίαν ἔχοντας

"men having foreskins"

The phrase **men having foreskins** refers to men who are not Jewish. It is a crude and dismissive expression, and it shows that these Jewish believers still regarded Gentiles with disdain. Alternate translation: [uncircumcised men] or [Gentiles]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:4 (#1)

ἀρξάμενος & Πέτρος ἐξετίθετο αὐτοῖς

"Peter, beginning, was explaining to them"

Luke is using the word **beginning** to indicate that Peter had been doing something else (listening to the complaints against him) but then began to do something new when he had the opportunity to speak. It might not be necessary to translate the word **began**, since it may seem to convey redundant information that would be not be natural to express in your language. Alternate translation: [Peter explained to them]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 11:5 (#1)

καθιεμένην

"being let down"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [It appeared as if someone was letting it down]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:6 (#1)

καὶ τὰ πετεινὰ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ

"and the birds of the sky"

From Peter's response in 11:8, the implication is that the law of Moses commanded the Jews not to eat some of the creatures in the container. See how you translated this in 10:12. Alternate translation: [... and the birds of the sky, including some that the law of Moses commanded Jews not to eat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:7 (#1)

φωνῆς λεγούσης μοι

"a voice saying to me"

Peter speaks of this **voice** as if it were a living thing that could speak on its own. Alternate translation: [someone saying to me]

See: Personification

Acts 11:7 (#2)

ἀναστάς

"arising"

Here the term **arising** means that the voice wanted Peter to take action, not that the voice wanted him to stand up from a seated position. Alternate translation, as in UST: [Go ahead]

See: Idiom

Acts 11:7 (#3)

λεγούσης μοι, ἀναστάς, Πέτρε, θῦσον καὶ φάγε

"saying to me, 'Peter, arising, kill and eat"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [telling me to arise and kill and eat]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 11:8 (#3)

κοινὸν ἢ ἀκάθαρτον

"the common or unclean"

The words **common** and **unclean** mean similar things. Peter may be using them together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [food that our Jewish laws forbid us to eat]

See: Doublet

Acts 11:8 (#4)

κοινὸν ἢ ἀκάθαρτον οὐδέποτε εἰσῆλθεν εἰς τὸ στόμα μου

"the common or unclean has never entered into my mouth"

The implication is that some the animals in the container were forbidden for Jews to eat. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [the common or unclean, like some of those animals, has never entered into my mouth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:8 (#6)

κοινὸν ἢ ἀκάθαρτον οὐδέποτε εἰσῆλθεν εἰς τὸ στόμα μου

"the common or unclean has never entered into my mouth"

Peter is using one part of the eating process to represent the entire process. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [I have never eaten anything that is common or unclean]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 11:8 (#1)

εἶπον δέ, μηδαμῶς, Κύριε, ὅτι κοινὸν ἢ ἀκάθαρτον οὐδέποτε εἰσῆλθεν εἰς τὸ στόμα μου

"But I said, 'By no means, Lord; for the common or unclean has never entered into my mouth"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [But I told the Lord that I would certainly not do that, since the common or unclean had never entered my mouth]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 11:8 (#5)

κοινὸν ἢ ἀκάθαρτον οὐδέποτε εἰσῆλθεν εἰς τὸ στόμα μου

"the common or unclean has never entered into my mouth"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the word **never** and the negative terms **common** and **unclean**. Alternate translation: [only what is holy and clean has ever entered into my mouth]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 11:8 (#2)

μηδαμῶς

"By no means"

By no means is an exclamation that communicates a strong refusal to do or even to consider something. Use an exclamation that is natural in your language for communicating this. See how you translated this in 10:14. Alternate translation: [No, never]

See: Exclamations

Acts 11:9 (#1)

ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ, ἃ ὁ Θεὸς ἐκαθάρισεν, σὺ μὴ κοίνου

"from heaven, 'What God has cleansed, you, do not make common"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [from heaven and told me that I must not make common what God had cleansed]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 11:9 (#3)

σὺ μὴ κοίνου

"you, do not make common"

The voice is adding the pronoun **you** for emphasis. If your language does not ordinarily use a pronoun with the imperative but can do so for emphasis, it would be appropriate to do that here. You could also express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you must not make common]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 11:9 (#2)

ἃ ὁ Θεὸς ἐκαθάρισεν

"What God has cleansed"

If God is the speaker, he is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the first person in your translation. Alternate translation: [What I, God, have cleansed]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 11:10 (#2)

ἀνεσπάσθη & ἅπαντα

"everything was pulled up"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [it appeared as if someone was pulling everything up]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:10 (#1)

τοῦτο & ἐγένετο ἐπὶ τρίς

"this happened three times"

This could mean: (1) that the voice told Peter three times to kill and eat, Peter refused three times, and each time the voice told him not to call unclean what God had cleansed. Alternate translation: [Peter had this exchange with the voice three times]; (2) that after Peter first refused, the voice said to him three times, "What God has cleansed, you must not make common." Alternate translation: [the voice said this three times] See how you translated this in 10:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:11 (#2)

ἰδοὺ, ἐξαυτῆς

"behold, immediately"

Peter is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners' attention on how soon after his vision ended these **three men** arrived. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [right then]

See: Metaphor

Acts 11:11 (#4)

ἀπεσταλμένοι

"having been sent"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Someone had sent them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:11 (#3)

ἐξαυτῆς

"immediately"

Alternate translation: [immediately] or [at that exact moment]

Acts 11:11 (#1)

ἦμεν

"we were"

The term **we** refers to Peter and the others in the house in Joppa. It does not include his current audience in Jerusalem. So use the exclusive form of "we" if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 11:12 (#1)

μηδὲν διακρίναντα

"not hesitating"

This could mean: (1) that the Spirit did not want Peter to have any doubts or worries about going with the men, even though they were Gentiles. Alternate translation: [not worrying about it]; (2) that the Spirit did not want Peter to feel that he should not be in the company of these men, because they were Gentiles. Alternate translation: [not making a distinction between these men and others you would associate with] See how you translated this in 10:20.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:12 (#2)

οἱ ἓξ ἀδελφοὶ οὗτοι

"these six brothers"

Peter is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. Alternate translation: [these six fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 11:12 (#3)

τὸν οἶκον τοῦ ἀνδρός

"the house of the man"

Peter implicitly means the **house** of Cornelius. Alternate translation: [the house of the man who had sent the messengers to me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:13 (#1)

ἡμῖν

"to us"

The term **us** refers to Peter and the believers who came with him to Caesarea. It does not include his current audience in Jerusalem. So use the exclusive form of "us" if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 11:13 (#2)

Σίμωνα, τὸν ἐπικαλούμενον Πέτρον

"Simon, called Peter"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. See how you translated the same phrase in 10:32. Alternate translation: [whom people call Peter]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:14 (#1)

ῥήματα

"words"

The angel is using the term **words** to mean what Peter would say to Cornelius by using words. Alternate translation: [a message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:14 (#3)

σωθήσῃ

“you will be saved”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. It is clear from the context that God will do the action. Alternate translation, as in UST: [God will save you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:14 (#2)

σὲ & σωθήσῃ σὺ & σου

“you & you will be saved—you & your”

All the instances of the words **you** and **your** in this verse are singular, since they refer to Cornelius. So use the singular forms of those word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Acts 11:14 (#4)

πᾶς ὁ οἶκός σου

“all your house”

Here, **house** refers to an entire household living together. Alternate translation: [all the people living in your house]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:15 (#4)

ὥσπερ καὶ ἐφ’ ἡμᾶς

“just as also on us”

Here the word **us** refers to Peter himself and to the believers to whom he is speaking in Jerusalem, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 11:15 (#1)

ἐν & τῷ ἄρξασθαί με λαλεῖν

“as I began to speak”

Peter is using the word **began** to indicate that he had been doing something else (listening to Cornelius tell why he had summoned him) but then began to do something new when Cornelius finished speaking. It might not be necessary to translate the word **began**, since it may seem to convey redundant information that would be not be natural to express in your language. Alternate translation: [as I was speaking]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 11:15 (#2)

ἐπέπεσεν τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον ἐπ’ αὐτοὺς, ὥσπερ καὶ ἐφ’ ἡμᾶς ἐν ἀρχῇ

“the Holy Spirit fell on them, just as also on us in the beginning”

Peter is speaking of the Holy Spirit as if it **fell** on Cornelius and his guests. See how you translated the similar expressions in 8:16 and 10:44. Alternate translation: [they received the Holy Spirit, just as we did in the beginning]

See: Metaphor

Acts 11:15 (#3)

αὐτοὺς

“them”

The pronoun **them** refers to Cornelius and his guests. Alternate translation: [the man who had sent for me and the others in his house]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 11:15 (#5)

ἐν ἀρχῇ

“in the beginning”

By **in the beginning**, Peter means the day of Pentecost. Alternate translation: [on the day of Pentecost]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:16 (#3)

ὑμεῖς & βαπτισθήσεσθε ἐν Πνεύματι Ἁγίῳ

“you will be baptized in the Holy Spirit”

After first describing how John baptized people literally, Jesus uses baptism in this second instance as a metaphor. See the discussion in the introduction to Chapter 1, and see how you translated this in 1:5. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit will come and empower you]

See: Metaphor

Acts 11:16 (#2)

τοῦ Κυρίου

“of the Lord”

As the introduction to this chapter discusses, Peter is referring to Jesus here by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [of the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 11:16 (#4)

ὑμεῖς & βαπτισθήσεσθε

“you will be baptized”

You may wish to retain the metaphor of baptism in your translation. If you do, if it would be clearer in your language, you could state this with an active form, and you can say who will do the action. Alternate translation, as in UST: [God will baptize you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:16 (#1)

τοῦ ῥήματος

“the word”

Peter is using the term **word** to mean what Jesus said by using words. Alternate translation: [the statement]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:17 (#1)

ἡμῖν

“to us”

Here the word **us** refers to Peter himself and to the believers to whom he is speaking in Jerusalem, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 11:17 (#5)

κωλῦσαι τὸν Θεόν

“to hinder God”

It may be helpful to indicate in what way Peter thought he might be able to **hinder** God. Alternate translation: [to hinder God by refusing to welcome and baptize people to whom he had given his own Spirit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:17 (#2)

τὴν ἴσην δωρεὰν ἔδωκεν αὐτοῖς ὁ Θεὸς, ὡς καὶ ἡμῖν πιστεύσασιν

“God gave to them the same gift as also to us having believed”

Peter is referring to the **gift** of the Holy Spirit. Alternate translation: [the gift of the Holy Spirit, just as he did to us when we believed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:17 (#4)

ἐγὼ τίς ἤμην δυνατὸς κωλῦσαι τὸν Θεόν

“I, who was I {to be} able to hinder God”

For emphasis, Peter is adding the pronoun **I**, which is not required with the verb. If your language does not ordinarily use a pronoun with verbs but can do so for emphasis, it would be appropriate to do that here. You could also express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I certainly could not hinder God!]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 11:17 (#3)

ἐγὼ τίς ἤμην δυνατὸς κωλῦσαι τὸν Θεόν

“I, who was I {to be} able to hinder God”

Peter is using the question form to convince his listeners that God wanted him to accept the Gentile believers. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I could not hinder God!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 11:18 (#1)

ἡσύχασαν

“they became quiet”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Jewish believers to whom Peter was speaking. Alternate translation: [the Jewish believers became quiet]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 11:18 (#2)

ἡσύχασαν

“they became quiet”

This is an idiom that means they no longer argued. Alternate translation: [they no longer argued with Peter]

See: Idiom

Acts 11:18 (#3)

καὶ τοῖς ἔθνεσιν ὁ Θεὸς τὴν μετάνοιαν εἰς ζωὴν ἔδωκεν

"to the Gentiles also God has given repentance unto life"

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **repentance** and **life**, you could express the same idea in other ways. Here the term **life** refers to everlasting life. Alternate translation: [God has allowed the Gentiles as well to repent and live forever]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 11:19 (#3)

Φοινίκης

"Phoenicia"

The word **Phoenicia** is the name of a region.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 11:19 (#6)

μηδενὶ λαλοῦντες τὸν λόγον εἰ μὴ μόνον Ἰουδαίοις

"speaking the word to no one except only to Jews"

Since Luke says here that the scattered believers spoke about Jesus **only to Jews**, but he says in the next verse that some of them spoke to "Greeks" (that is, Gentiles), it might appear in your language that Luke was contradicting himself. If so, you could reword this to avoid using an exception clause. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Most of them believed they should speak the message about Jesus only to Jews, so that is what they did]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

Acts 11:19 (#2)

οἱ & διασπαρέντες ἀπὸ

"the ones having been scattered from"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. This is a reference to the **persecution** that Luke describes in 8:1, which began after the trial and death of Stephen. See how you translated the similar expression in that verse. Alternate translation: [those who had scattered because of]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:19 (#4)

Κύπρου

"Cyprus"

The word **Cyprus** is the name of an island. See how you translated it in 4:36.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 11:19 (#1)

οὖν

"Then"

Luke uses the word translated as **Then** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 11:19 (#5)

τὸν λόγον

"the word"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that these scattered believers proclaimed by using words. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:20 (#4)

τοὺς Ἑλληνιστάς

"the Greeks"

Luke assumes that his readers will know that these people he calls **Greeks** were not necessarily from Greece; rather, they were Greek-speaking people who were also Gentiles, not Jews. Alternate translation: [Gentiles who spoke Greek]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:20 (#3)

Κυρηναῖοι

"Cyrenians"

The word **Cyrenians** is the name for people who come from the city of Cyrene.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 11:20 (#1)

ἄνδρες, Κύπριοι καὶ Κυρηναῖοι

“men, Cypriots and Cyrenians”

Luke is describing these **men** in an idiomatic way. Alternate translation: [Cypriot and Cyrenian men]

See: Idiom

Acts 11:20 (#2)

Κύπριοι

“Cypriots”

The word **Cypriots** is the name for people who come from the island of Cyprus.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 11:21 (#3)

ἦν & μετ’ αὐτῶν

“was with them”

When Luke says that God **was with** the men from Cyprus and Cyrene who were proclaiming the gospel, this is an idiom that means God was working through them. Alternate translation: [was working through them]

See: Idiom

Acts 11:21 (#5)

ἐπὶ τὸν Κύριον

“to the Lord”

In this instance, Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title, as the introduction to this chapter discusses. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [to the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 11:21 (#4)

ἐπέστρεψεν ἐπὶ τὸν Κύριον

“turned to the Lord”

Luke speaks of these Gentiles in Antioch as if they physically **turned to the Lord**. He means that they stopped living in one way and began to live in another way. They believed in Jesus and started to obey him. Alternate translation: [became disciples of Jesus]

See: Metaphor

Acts 11:21 (#2)

χεὶρ

“the hand”

Here, the **hand** represents power, since hands give people the capability to do things. Alternate translation: [the power]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:21 (#1)

χεὶρ Κυρίου

“the hand of the Lord”

In this instance, Luke seems to mean God the Father when he says **the Lord**. In 4:29–30, the believers pray, “Lord ... stretch out your hand to heal and for signs and wonders to happen through the name of your holy Servant Jesus.” Luke seems to be describing these events as part of the answer to that prayer. Alternate translation: [the hand of God the Lord]

See: Politeness

Acts 11:22 (#3)

ὁ λόγος

“the report”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean a report about the Gentile believers in Antioch. Alternate translation: [a report]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:22 (#1)

ἠκούσθη & ὁ λόγος εἰς τὰ ὦτα τῆς ἐκκλησίας τῆς οὔσης ἐν Ἰερουσαλὴμ περὶ αὐτῶν

“the report about them came to the ears of the church that was in Jerusalem”

In your language, the expression **was heard in the ears** might seem to convey redundant information that would be not be natural to express. If so, you could abbreviate it. Alternate translation: [the word about them was heard by the church being in Jerusalem]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 11:22 (#4)

αὐτῶν & ἐξαπέστειλαν

“them & they sent out”

The pronoun **them** refers to the Gentile believers in Antioch, and the pronoun **they** refers to the leaders of the church in Jerusalem. It may be helpful to your readers to clarify this. Alternate translation: [these Gentile believers ... its leaders sent]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 11:22 (#2)

ἠκούσθη δὲ ὁ λόγος εἰς τὰ ὦτα τῆς ἐκκλησίας τῆς οὔσης ἐν Ἰερουσαλὴμ περὶ αὐτῶν

"And the report about them came to the ears of the church that was in Jerusalem"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. It is clear from the context that God will do the action. Alternate translation: [The church being in Jerusalem heard the word about them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:23 (#1)

τὴν χάριν τὴν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the grace of God"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how gracious God had been to them]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 11:23 (#2)

τῇ προθέσει τῆς καρδίας

"with purpose of heart"

Here the **heart** represents the will and desires of a person. Alternate translation: [with firm determination]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:24 (#5)

τῷ Κυρίῳ

"to the Lord"

Luke says **the Lord** (a title for Jesus) to mean the community of believers in Jesus. Alternate translation: [to the community of believers in Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 11:24 (#1)

ὅτι

"For"

Luke is using the word **For** to introduce the reason why Barnabas encouraged the new believers in Antioch so well. Alternate translation: [He was able to do this because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 11:24 (#4)

προσετέθη ὄχλος ἱκανὸς

"a considerable crowd was added"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. It is clear from the context that God did the action. Alternate translation: [God added a considerable crowd]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:24 (#3)

καὶ πλήρης Πνεύματος Ἁγίου καὶ πίστεως

"and full of the Holy Spirit and of faith"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faith**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [who was inspired by the Holy Spirit and who believed firmly in Jesus]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 11:24 (#2)

πλήρης Πνεύματος Ἁγίου καὶ πίστεως

"full of the Holy Spirit and of faith"

Luke speaks of Barnabas as if he were a container that was **full** of the **Holy Spirit** and of **faith**. Alternate translation: [who was inspired by the Holy Spirit and who had strong faith]

See: Metaphor

Acts 11:25 (#1)

ἐξῆλθεν

"he went out"

The pronoun **he** refers to Barnabas. Alternate translation: [Barnabas went out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 11:26 (#4)

χρηματίσαι & πρώτως & τοὺς μαθητὰς

"the disciples were first called"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people first called the disciples]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:26 (#3)

αὐτοῖς & συναχθῆναι ἐν τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ

“to them & they were gathered together with the church”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they gathered together with the church]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 11:26 (#5)

Χριστιανούς

“Christians”

The word **Christians** is a name for people who believe that Jesus is the Christ, that is, the Messiah.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 11:26 (#1)

εὑρὼν ἤγαγεν

“having found him, he brought him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Barnabas, and the pronoun **him** refers to Saul. Alternate translation: [and having found Saul, Barnabas brought him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 11:26 (#6)

πρώτως ἐν Ἀντιοχείᾳ

“first & in Antioch”

Alternate translation: [for the first time in Antioch]

Acts 11:26 (#2)

ἐγένετο δὲ αὐτοῖς καὶ ἐνιαυτὸν ὅλον συναχθῆναι ἐν τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ

“And it happened to them that for even a whole year they were gathered together with the church”

This wording suggests that Barnabas and Saul did not know initially how long they would be meeting with the church in Antioch, but in the end it amounted to a whole year. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express it that way. Alternate translation: [in the end they were gathered together with the church for an entire year]

Acts 11:27 (#2)

ἐν ταύταις & ταῖς ἡμέραις

“in these days”

Luke is using the word **days** to describe a specific time. Alternate translation: [at this time]

See: Idiom

Acts 11:27 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 11:27 (#3)

κατῆλθον

“came down”

Luke says that these prophets **came down** from Jerusalem because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Alternate translation: [traveled]

See: Idiom

Acts 11:28 (#4)

ἐπὶ Κλαυδίου

“upon Claudius”

The expression **upon Claudius** refers to the time during the reign of Claudius. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [during the reign of Claudius]

See: Idiom

Acts 11:28 (#1)

ἀναστὰς

“having arisen”

Here, **having arisen** means that Agabus stood up as a symbolic action to indicate that he had something important to say. Alternate translation: [having stood up to show that he had something important to say]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 11:28 (#2)

ἐφ᾽ ὅλην τὴν οἰκουμένην

“over the whole world”

The term **whole** is a generalization for emphasis. Alternate translation: [throughout the world]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 11:28 (#5)

Κλαυδίου

“Claudius”

The word **Claudius** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 11:28 (#3)

τὴν οἰκουμένην

“the & world”

Luke assumes that his readers will know that by **world**, he means the part of the world that they were familiar with. Alternate translation: [the ... Roman Empire]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:29 (#2)

τοῖς & ἀδελφοῖς

“to the brothers”

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. Alternate translation: [to their fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 11:29 (#1)

τῶν & μαθητῶν καθὼς εὐπορεῖτό τις, ὥρισαν ἕκαστος αὐτῶν & πέμψαι

“they determined, just as any of the disciples was prospering, each of them to send {something”

The implication is that while some of the disciples were **prospering** greatly but others were struggling financially, every one of them resolved to send something according to his own means. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [while some of the believers in Antioch were rich and others were poor, every one of them resolved to send what they could afford]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:30 (#1)

πρὸς τοὺς πρεσβυτέρους

“to the elders”

Luke assumes that his readers will know that he is referring to the **elders** who were the leaders of the church in Jerusalem. Alternate translation: [to the elders in Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 11:30 (#2)

διὰ χειρὸς Βαρναβᾶ καὶ Σαύλου

“by the hand of Barnabas and Saul”

Here, the **hand**, one part of a person, represents the action of the whole person. Alternate translation: [by having Barnabas and Saul take it to them]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 11:30 (#3)

διὰ χειρὸς Βαρναβᾶ καὶ Σαύλου

“by the hand of Barnabas and Saul”

If you retain the figurative word **hand** in your translation, it may be more natural in your language to use the plural form of that word, if you would not ordinarily speak of two people having one hand. Alternate translation: [by the hands of Barnabas and Saul]

See: Collective Nouns

Acts - Chapter 12 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Chapter 12 tells what happened to King Herod while Barnabas and Saul were delivering money from Antioch to Jerusalem, as described in 11:25–30. Herod killed one of the apostles, James, and he put Peter in prison. God helped Peter escape from the prison, so Herod executed the prison guards, but God then killed Herod.

Acts 12:1 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 12:1 (#4)

ἐπέβαλεν & τὰς χεῖρας κακῶσαί τινας τῶν ἀπὸ τῆς ἐκκλησίας

“laid on hands to harm some from the church”

Herod most likely did not do this himself, Rather, as a ruler, he ordered his soldiers to arrest **some from the church**. Luke is speaking of Herod, one person who was involved in this action, to mean everyone who was involved. Alternate translation: [had his soldiers arrest some from the church, intending to harm them]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 12:1 (#2)

κατ’ ἐκεῖνον & τὸν καιρὸν

“at that time”

The phrase **that time** implicitly refers to the time that Luke has just described, when the church in Antioch sent Barnabas and Saul to Jerusalem with money to help the believers there. Alternate translation: [at the time when the church in Antioch sent assistance to the believers in Jerusalem,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 12:1 (#3)

ἐπέβαλεν & τὰς χεῖρας κακῶσαί τινας τῶν ἀπὸ τῆς ἐκκλησίας

“laid on hands to harm some from the church”

The expression **laid on hands** means to arrest someone by association with the way that arresting officers might physically take hold of a person with their **hands**. See how you translated it in 5:18. Alternate translation: [arrested some from the church, intending to harm them]

See: Metonymy

Acts 12:2 (#1)

ἀνεῖλεν & Ἰάκωβον

“he killed James”

It was probably not Herod himself who **killed James**. Rather, he most likely ordered his soldiers to do this. Alternate translation: [he ordered his soldiers to execute James]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 12:3 (#1)

τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

“to the Jews”

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to one part of that group, its leaders. Alternate translation: [to the leaders of the Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 12:3 (#2)

ἡμέραι τῶν Ἀζύμων

“the days of Unleavened Bread”

The phrase **Unleavened Bread** is the name of a Jewish religious observance that took place over several **days**. If your readers would not be familiar with the food known as “bread” or the substance known as “leaven,” you could translate this with a general expression. Alternate translation: [the days of Special Food]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 12:4 (#2)

τέσσαρσιν τετραδίοις στρατιωτῶν

“to four quaternions of soldiers”

These **quaternions** were groups of four **soldiers** each. They would have taken turns guarding Peter in six-hour shifts throughout the day and night. Two soldiers would have been at Peter’s side and the other two soldiers by the entrance. Your language and culture may have a term for a group of four soldiers that you can use in your translation. You could also explain the meaning of the term “quaternion,” as UST does. Alternate translation: [to four teams of soldiers]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 12:4 (#3)

βουλόμενος & ἀναγαγεῖν αὐτὸν τῷ λαῷ

“intending to bring him out to the people”

The phrase **to bring him out** means to put Peter on trial publicly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Herod planned to judge Peter in a public trial in the presence of the Jewish people]

See: Idiom

Acts 12:4 (#1)

ὃν καὶ πιάσας, ἔθετο εἰς φυλακήν

“and whom, having arrested, he put in prison”

The pronouns **whom** refers to Peter, and the pronoun **he** refers to Herod. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [After Herod had arrested Peter, he put him in prison]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 12:5 (#1)

ὁ & Πέτρος ἐτηρεῖτο

"Peter was being kept"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to specify who did the action, it is clear from the context that it was the soldiers. Alternate translation: [the soldiers were guarding Peter]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 12:5 (#2)

προσευχὴ & ἦν ἐκτενῶς γινομένη ὑπὸ τῆς ἐκκλησίας πρὸς τὸν Θεὸν περὶ αὐτοῦ

"prayer was being made earnestly to God for him by the church"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the church was earnestly praying to God for him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 12:6 (#1)

προαγαγεῖν αὐτὸν

"to bring him out"

Here, the word translated as **to bring him out** is slightly different from the word translated that same way in 12:4. It means to put someone on trial, and the implications, based on the fact that Herod saw that it pleased the Jewish leaders when he executed James, are that Herod planned to execute Peter after this trial. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [to put Peter on trial and then execute him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 12:6 (#2)

δεδεμένος ἁλύσεσιν δυσίν

"bound with two chains"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [with two chains binding him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 12:7 (#1)

ἰδοὺ, ἄγγελος

"behold, an angel"

Luke is using the term **behold** to focus readers' attention on how suddenly this **angel** appeared. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [suddenly an angel]

See: Metaphor

Acts 12:9 (#3)

ἐδόκει & ὅραμα βλέπειν

"he was thinking he was seeing a vision"

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [he was thinking, "I am seeing a vision"]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 12:9 (#1)

οὐκ ᾔδει ὅτι ἀληθές ἐστιν τὸ γινόμενον διὰ τοῦ ἀγγέλου; ἐδόκει δὲ

"he did not know that what was being done by the angel was real, but he was thinking"

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here and to add a sentence break. Alternate translation: [he did not realize, "What is being done by the angel is real!" He was thinking]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 12:9 (#2)

τὸ γινόμενον διὰ τοῦ ἀγγέλου

"what was being done by the angel"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [what the angel was doing]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 12:10 (#1)

διελθόντες & πρώτην φυλακὴν καὶ δευτέραν

"having passed by the first guard and the second"

The implication is that the guards were not able to see Peter and the angel as they walked by. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [having passed by the first guard and the second without being noticed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 12:10 (#2)

καὶ δευτέραν

“and the second”

The word **guard** can be supplied from the previous phrase. Alternate translation: [and the second guard]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 12:11 (#2)

χειρὸς

“the hand”

Here, **hand** represents the capability of a person. Alternate translation: [the power]

See: Metonymy

Acts 12:11 (#4)

τοῦ λαοῦ τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“of the Jewish people”

Luke is likely using the phrase **the Jewish people** to refer to one part of that group, its leaders. Alternate translation: [of the leaders of the Jewish people]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 12:11 (#3)

πάσης τῆς προσδοκίας τοῦ λαοῦ τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“all the expectation of the Jewish people”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **expectation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [all that the Jewish people expected that Herod would do to me]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 12:11 (#1)

ὁ Πέτρος ἐν ἑαυτῷ γενόμενος εἶπεν

“Peter, having come to himself, said”

The phrase **having come to himself** means that Peter became fully awake and realized he was not just seeing a vision. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when Peter became fully awake and alert, he said]

See: Idiom

Acts 12:12 (#2)

ἱκανοὶ

“many”

Luke is using the adjective **many** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [many people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 12:12 (#1)

τοῦ ἐπικαλουμένου Μάρκου

“called Mark”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom people called Mark]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 12:13 (#2)

τὴν θύραν τοῦ πυλῶνος

“the door of the gate”

Here, the word **gate** probably describes an entrance from the street to a courtyard in front of the house. If houses in your culture have a similar entrance, in your translation you could use the name for it in your language. If not, you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [the door of the entrance from the street to the courtyard]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 12:13 (#3)

Ῥόδη

“Rhoda”

The word **Rhoda** is the name of a woman.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 12:13 (#1)

κρούσαντος & αὐτοῦ

“when he knocked at”

To "knock" at a door means to tap or hit it a few times to let a person inside the house know you are standing outside. You could translate this expression with the way people in your culture show that they have arrived at a house, such as "call out" or "cough" or "clap."

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 12:14 (#1)

ἀπὸ τῆς χαρᾶς

"from joy"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **joy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because she was so joyful,]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 12:15 (#1)

οἱ & εἶπαν

"they said"

The pronoun **they** refers to the people who were inside the house praying. Alternate translation: [the people who were inside the house praying said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 12:15 (#2)

ὁ ἄγγελός ἐστιν αὐτοῦ

"It is his angel"

Some Jews believed in guardian angels, and the people inside the house may have thought that Peter's **angel** had come to them. Alternate translation: [What you saw was Peter's guardian angel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 12:16 (#1)

ἀνοίξαντες δὲ εἶδαν αὐτὸν

"and opening, they saw him"

While the word **they** refers to the people in the house as in the previous verse, it is likely that only some of them came to the door. Alternate translation: [so some of the people in the house came and opened the door, and they saw him]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 12:17 (#1)

Ἰακώβῳ

"to James"

Peter assumes that his listeners will know that by **James**, he means the brother of Jesus who was the leader of the church in Jerusalem. UST models one way to express this implicit information. However, since this is something that Peter assumes his listeners will know, you may find it preferable to explain this in a footnote rather than add information to the text.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 12:17 (#2)

τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς

"the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. Alternate translation: [the other believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 12:18 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a significant development in this story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 12:18 (#4)

τί ἄρα ὁ Πέτρος ἐγένετο

"what then had Peter become"

The word translated as **become** can be used to indicate that a person has entered a new condition, and in this context it indicates that Peter has changed his location. Alternate translation: [where then Peter had gone]

Acts 12:18 (#3)

ἐν τοῖς στρατιώταις, τί ἄρα ὁ Πέτρος ἐγένετο

"among the soldiers, what then had Peter become"

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [among the soldiers: "What then had Peter become?"]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 12:18 (#2)

τάραχος οὐκ ὀλίγος

“no small disturbance”

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. Alternate translation: [a great disturbance]

See: Litotes

Acts 12:19 (#3)

κατελθὼν

“having gone down”

Luke speaks of Herod **having gone down** to Caesarea because that city is lower in elevation than Judea. Alternate translation: [traveled]

See: Idiom

Acts 12:19 (#2)

ἐπιζητήσας αὐτὸν

“having searched for him”

It was probably not Herod himself who **searched for** Peter. Rather, he most likely ordered his soldiers to do this. Alternate translation: [having ordered a search for him]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 12:19 (#1)

αὐτὸν

“for him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Peter. Alternate translation: [Peter]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 12:20 (#7)

Βλάστον

“Blastus”

The word **Blastus** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 12:20 (#4)

ὁμοθυμαδὸν & παρῆσαν πρὸς αὐτόν

“they came to him unanimously”

Your language may say “went” rather than **came** in contexts such as this. Use whichever is more natural. Alternate translation: [they went to him unanimously]

See: Go and Come

Acts 12:20 (#5)

ὁμοθυμαδὸν & παρῆσαν πρὸς αὐτόν

“they came to him unanimously”

It is unlikely that all the people of Tyre and Sidon came to Herod. Instead, they sent representatives. Luke is using the names of their groups to refer to one part of those groups, these representatives. Alternate translation: [they sent representatives to him unanimously]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 12:20 (#8)

τὸν ἐπὶ τοῦ κοιτῶνος τοῦ βασιλέως

“the one over the bedchamber of the king”

This phrase indicates that **Blastus** was an official whom the king trusted with important responsibilities for his personal affairs. In your translation, use the word or phrase for the most comparable role in your culture. Alternate translation: [the king’s chamberlain]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 12:20 (#9)

ᾐτοῦντο εἰρήνην

“they were requesting peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [they were asking the king to restore peaceful relations]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 12:20 (#2)

ἦν & θυμομαχῶν

“he was quarreling”

The pronoun **he** refers to Herod. Alternate translation: [Herod was quarreling]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 12:20 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 12:20 (#6)

ὁμοθυμαδὸν & παρῆσαν πρὸς αὐτόν

“they came to him unanimously”

The word **unanimously** indicates that the Tyrians and Sidonians recognized that they had a common interest and that they agreed to act together to pursue that interest. See how you translated the same word in 1:14. Alternate translation: [they agreed together to send representatives to him]

Acts 12:20 (#3)

Τυρίοις & Σιδωνίοις

“with the Tyrians & Sidonians”

Tyrians is the name for people from the city of Tyre, and **Sidonians** is the name for people from the city of Sidon.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 12:20 (#10)

τὸ τρέφεσθαι αὐτῶν τὴν χώραν ἀπὸ τῆς βασιλικῆς

“their country was nourished from the king’s country”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [their country depended on the king’s country for its food supply]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 12:20 (#11)

τὸ τρέφεσθαι αὐτῶν τὴν χώραν ἀπὸ τῆς βασιλικῆς

“their country was nourished from the king’s country”

The implication is that Herod had stopped supplying food to the people of Tyre and Sidon because he was angry with them. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [their country depended on the king’s country for its food supply, and Herod had cut off that supply because he was angry with them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 12:21 (#3)

καθίσας ἐπὶ τοῦ βήματος

“having sat on the throne”

The **throne** was where Herod formally addressed people who came to see him.

Acts 12:21 (#2)

ἐνδυσάμενος ἐσθῆτα βασιλικὴν, καὶ καθίσας ἐπὶ τοῦ βήματος

“having put on royal clothing and having sat on the throne”

Putting on this **royal clothing**, which was visibly expensive, and sitting on the **throne** were symbolic actions by which Herod demonstrated that he was a wealthy and powerful king. He did these things to impress and intimidate the Tyrians and Sidonians as they negotiated. Alternate translation: [having put on royal clothing and having sat on the throne to show what a wealthy and powerful king he was]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 12:21 (#1)

τακτῇ & ἡμέρᾳ

“on the appointed day”

The implication is that this was the **day** on which Herod had agreed to meet with the representatives of the Tyrians and Sidonians. Alternate translation: [on the day when Herod had agreed to meet with them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 12:22 (#1)

Θεοῦ φωνὴ, καὶ οὐκ ἀνθρώπου

“The voice of a god and not of a man”

The people are using one part of Herod, his **voice**, to represent all of him in the act of speaking. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [This person who is speaking to us is a god, not a man]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 12:23 (#2)

γενόμενος σκωληκόβρωτος, ἐξέψυξεν

“having become worm-eaten, he died”

The word translated as **worm-eaten** is an adjective, so this is not a passive verbal form. However, if your language does not use passive forms, it might be clearer for your readers if you use an expression that does not seem to be a passive verbal form. The word **worm-eaten** expresses the result of action by a dif-

ferent agent, so you can use an active form with that agent as the subject. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. UST models one way to do this.

See: Active or Passive

Acts 12:23 (#3)

γενόμενος σκωληκόβρωτος, ἐξέψυξεν

"having become worm-eaten, he died"

It is not clear exactly what this means, and you might choose to say nothing further in your translation. However, this could mean: (1) that when the angel **struck** Herod, this caused a deep wound, and by the time Herod died of this wound, it was already infested with maggots. Alternate translation: [he died after his wound became so infected that it was infested with maggots]; (2) that the word **struck** is figurative and it refers to an illness, a severe case of intestinal worms. Alternate translation: [he got such a severe case of intestinal worms that he died]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 12:23 (#1)

ἀνθ' ὧν οὐκ ἔδωκεν τὴν δόξαν τῷ Θεῷ

"because he did not give the glory to God"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could put this reason before the result it led to (the angel striking Herod), as UST does.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 12:24 (#4)

ἐπληθύνετο

"was being multiplied"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God was multiplying it]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 12:24 (#2)

ὁ δὲ λόγος τοῦ Θεοῦ ηὔξανεν καὶ ἐπληθύνετο

"the word of God was increasing and was being multiplied"

Luke is speaking of the way the message about Jesus was becoming more widespread as if the word of God itself were **increasing** and **being multiplied**. Alternate translation: [more and more people were hearing and believing the word of God]

See: Personification

Acts 12:24 (#1)

ὁ δὲ λόγος τοῦ Θεοῦ ηὔξανεν καὶ ἐπληθύνετο

"the word of God was increasing and was being multiplied"

Luke is expressing a single idea by using two verbs connected with **and**. The verb **being multiplied** tells in what way the word of God was **increasing**, that is, very rapidly. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this same idea with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the word of God was increasing very rapidly]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 12:24 (#3)

ὁ δὲ λόγος τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the word of God"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that God told the believers to spread by using words. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 12:25 (#5)

Ἰωάννην, τὸν ἐπικληθέντα Μᾶρκον

"John, called Mark"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. See how you translated it in 12:12. Alternate translation: [John, whom people called Mark]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 12:25 (#3)

Βαρναβᾶς δὲ καὶ Σαῦλος ὑπέστρεψαν εἰς Ἰερουσαλὴμ

"Then Barnabas and Saul returned to Jerusalem"

Some ancient copies say that Barnabas and Saul returned "from" Jerusalem, which makes sense, since in the next verse, Barnabas and Saul are back in Antioch. If the reading **to** is correct, this verse may be indicating that they went somewhere else in Judea and then returned to Jerusalem before going back to Antioch. If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider using the reading in that translation. If there is not already a Bible translation

in your area, you may wish to follow the readings of ULT and UST.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 12:25 (#2)

Βαρναβᾶς δὲ καὶ Σαῦλος ὑπέστρεψαν εἰς Ἰερουσαλὴμ, πληρώσαντες τὴν διακονίαν

"Then Barnabas and Saul returned to Jerusalem, having completed their service"

This can also be translated, "Then Barnabas and Saul returned, having completed their service in Jerusalem." If that is the correct translation, then Luke is saying implicitly that they **returned** to Antioch. Alternate translation: [Then Barnabas and Saul returned to Antioch, having completed their service in Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 12:25 (#1)

δὲ

"Then"

Luke uses the word translated as **Then** to introduce information about what happened after Herod died. This is the end of the part of the story about him. Your language may have its own way of indicating how such information relates to a significant part of a larger story.

See: End of Story

Acts 12:25 (#4)

πληρώσαντες τὴν διακονίαν

"having completed their service"

This refers implicitly to the trip that Barnabas and Saul made to Jerusalem to deliver money from the believers in Antioch, which Luke describes in 11:29–30. Alternate translation: [having delivered to the church leaders in Jerusalem the money that the believers in Antioch had collected]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts - Chapter 13 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Verses 1–4 describe how the Holy Spirit called Barnabas and Paul to go on a special mission to share the gospel of Jesus. Verses 5–12 describe how they shared the gospel on the island of Cyprus. Verses 13–52 describe how they shared the gospel in the city of Antioch in the province of Pamphylia.

Some translations set quotations from the Old Testament farther to the right on the page than the rest of the text. The ULT does this with the three quotations from Psalms in 13:33–35.

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry that is quoted from the Old Testament in 13:41.

The chapter is where the second half of the Book of Acts begins. Luke writes more about Paul than about Peter, and he describes how the believers told the message about Jesus to Gentiles. Luke begins to tell about the mission trips on which the church at Antioch sent Barnabas and Saul.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

A light for the Gentiles

The Bible often speaks of unrighteous people, people who do not do what pleases God, as if they were walking around in darkness. It speaks of light as if light were what enables sinful people to understand that what they are doing is wrong and begin to obey God. The Jews considered all Gentiles to be walking in darkness, but Paul and Barnabas spoke of telling the Gentiles about Jesus as if they were going to bring them physical light. (See: Metaphor; and righteous, righteousness, unrighteous, unrighteousness, upright, uprightness)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"the Lord"

In verses 2, 12, 48, and 49, Luke refers to Jesus by a respectful title, "the Lord." Paul refers to Jesus the same way in verses 10 and 11. In your translation, you may wish to clarify that this means "the Lord Jesus." Or you could state "Jesus," as UST does. (See: Politeness)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"our" in Paul's sermon in Antioch of Pisidia

In verses 17, 32, and 33, Paul uses the term **our** to refer to himself and the other Jews who are present in the synagogue; the term does not include the Gentiles who are also present. If your language marks the distinction between inclusive and exclusive "our," use the form that would be natural in such a situation. (See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We')

Acts 13:1 (#7)

Ἡρῴδου τοῦ τετράρχου

“of Herod the tetrarch”

In the Roman Empire, a **tetrarch** was the governor of one of four divisions of a country or province. **Herod the tetrarch** ruled over Galilee, one of four areas that the kingdom of his father, Herod the Great, was divided into after his death. (The Herod described in Chapter 12 was a different man, the grandson of Herod the Great and the nephew of Herod the tetrarch.) If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a general term instead of “tetrarch.” Alternate translation: [the ruler Herod]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 13:1 (#3)

Συμεὼν ὁ καλούμενος Νίγερ

“Simeon called Niger”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Simeon, whom people called Niger]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:1 (#5)

Λούκιος ὁ Κυρηναῖος

“Lucius the Cyrenian”

The word **Lucius** is the name of a man. The word **Cyrenian** is the name for someone who comes from the city of Cyrene. See how you translated it in 11:20.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 13:1 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 13:1 (#2)

Συμεὼν ὁ καλούμενος Νίγερ

“Simeon called Niger”

The word **Simeon** is the name of a man. The word **Niger** is another name by which he was known. This is not a racial epithet; it is the Latin word for “black,” and it probably indicates that he was African. Alternate translation: [Simeon the African]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 13:1 (#6)

σύντροφος

“the foster brother”

In this culture, rulers would sometimes bring the children of other parents into their homes to be raised and educated with their own children. This gave their children playmates and friends, and it was also a way of honoring or thanking the parents of the other children. A boy who was raised with the son of a ruler would be considered the **foster brother** of that son. There may be a similar role in your culture, and your language may have a term for it that you can use in your translation. You could also explain the meaning of the term “foster brother,” as UST does. Alternate translation: [the childhood playmate] or [the boyhood friend]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 13:1 (#4)

Μαναήν

“Manaen”

The word **Manaen** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 13:2 (#4)

εἰς τὸ ἔργον ὃ προσκέκλημαι αὐτούς

“for the work to which I have called them”

The Holy Spirit is referring implicitly to the **work** of proclaiming the gospel of Jesus in new areas, Cyprus and Asia Minor. Since Luke describes Barnabas and Paul doing this work in the rest of this chapter and in Chapter 14, you do not need to explain its meaning further here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Acts 13:2 (#2)

τῷ Κυρίῳ

“to the Lord”

As the introduction to this chapter discusses, Peter is referring to Jesus here by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [of the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 13:2 (#3)

ἀφορίσατε

“Separate”

Alternate translation: [Set apart]

Acts 13:2 (#1)

λειτουργούντων & αὐτῶν τῷ Κυρίῳ

“while they were ministering to the Lord”

The expression **ministering to** means that the believers in Antioch were worshiping God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [while they were worshiping the Lord]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:3 (#3)

ἀπέλυσαν

“they released them”

While in this context the term **released** basically means “sent off,” the implication is that the believers in Antioch were freeing Barnabas and Saul of all of their responsibilities in the church so that they could go on the mission on which the Holy Spirit was sending them. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [they gave them the freedom to go on their new mission]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:3 (#1)

νηστεύσαντες, καὶ προσευξάμενοι, καὶ ἐπιθέντες τὰς χεῖρας αὐτοῖς, ἀπέλυσαν

“having fasted and prayed, and having laid {their} hands on them, they released them”

The pronouns **their** and **they** refer to the believers in Antioch, and the pronoun **them** refers to Barnabas and Saul. The phrase **having fasted and prayed** refers to all of them. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [after they had all fasted and prayed together, the believers in Antioch laid their hands on Barnabas and Saul, and then the believers released them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:3 (#2)

ἐπιθέντες τὰς χεῖρας αὐτοῖς

“having laid {their} hands on them”

The believers in Antioch **laid their hands** on Barnabas and Saul as a symbolic action to show that they were sending them on their mission with the blessing and support of the whole church and that they were entrusting them to God’s care. Alternate translation: [placed their hands on them as a sign of blessing and support and as a way of entrusting them to God’s care]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 13:4 (#4)

Σελεύκιαν

“Seleucia”

The word **Seleucia** is the name of a city that is on the seacoast.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 13:4 (#2)

ἐκπεμφθέντες ὑπὸ τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος

“having been sent out by the Holy Spirit”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [because the Holy Spirit had sent them out]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:4 (#3)

κατῆλθον

“went down”

Luke says that Barnabas and Saul **went down** to Seleucia because that city is lower in elevation than Antioch. Alternate translation: [traveled]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:4 (#1)

αὐτοὶ & ἐκπεμφθέντες

“they, having been sent out”

The pronoun **they** refers to Barnabas and Saul. Alternate translation: [Barnabas and Saul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:5 (#1)

Σαλαμῖνι

“Salamis”

The word **Salamis** is the name of a city on the island of Cyprus.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 13:5 (#2)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the word of God"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that the Holy Spirit wanted Barnabas and Saul to share by using words. Alternate translation: [the message from God]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:6 (#4)

ᾧ ὄνομα Βαριησοῦς

"whose name {was} Bar Jesus"

The words **Bar Jesus** are a name that means "Son of Jesus." However, there was no relation between this man and Jesus Christ. **Jesus** was a common name at that time.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 13:6 (#1)

Πάφου

"Paphos"

The word **Paphos** is the name of a major city on the island of Cyprus. It was where the Roman proconsul lived.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 13:6 (#3)

ἄνδρα, τινὰ μάγον

"a certain man, a magician"

The word **magician** here does not mean someone who entertains others with tricks based on slight of hand and optical illusions. It means someone who practices witchcraft or supernatural magic arts. Your language and culture may have a term for such a person that you can use in your translation.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 13:6 (#2)

εὗρον

"they found"

The word **found** does not mean that Barnabas, Saul, and Mark were intentionally searching for a certain man. They happened to meet him. Alternate translation: [they happened to meet]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:7 (#2)

Σεργίῳ Παύλῳ

"Sergius Paulus"

The words **Sergius** and **Paulus** are the names of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 13:7 (#1)

τῷ ἀνθυπάτῳ

"the proconsul"

A **proconsul** was a governor in charge of a Roman province. Alternate translation, as in UST: [the governor]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 13:7 (#3)

ἀνδρὶ συνετῷ

"an intelligent man"

Luke provides this background information about Sergius Paulus to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 13:8 (#3)

ζητῶν διαστρέψαι τὸν ἀνθύπατον ἀπὸ τῆς πίστεως

"seeking to turn the proconsul away from the faith"

Here, **to turn** someone **away from** something is a metaphor for convincing someone to not do something. Alternate translation: [he attempted to persuade the governor not to believe the gospel message]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:8 (#1)

Ἐλύμας ὁ μάγος

"Elymas, "the Magician"

The word **Elymas** is an Arabic word that Bar-Jesus was using as another name. Luke spells it out using Greek letters so his readers will know how it sounds, and then he says what it means, **the Magician**. In your translation you can spell it the way it sounds in your language and then explain its meaning.

See: Copy or Borrow Words

Acts 13:8 (#2)

οὕτως γὰρ μεθερμηνεύεται τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ

"for thus is his name translated"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [for that is how one translates his name]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:9 (#1)

πλησθεὶς Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

"being filled with the Holy Spirit"

Luke is speaking of Paul as if he were a container that the Holy Spirit **filled**. Alternate translation: [inspired by the Holy Spirit]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:9 (#2)

πλησθεὶς Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

"being filled with the Holy Spirit"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom the Holy Spirit was inspiring]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:10 (#7)

υἱὲ διαβόλου

"son of the devil"

Paul is drawing an implicit contrast between Elymas' claim to be the "son of Jesus" (Bar Jesus) and his actual character as a **son of the devil**. If you retain the "son of" idiom in your translation, you could bring out this contrast explicitly. If you do, it may be helpful to make this a separate sentence. Alternate translation: [You are not the son of Jesus—you are the son of the devil!]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:10 (#4)

παντὸς δόλου καὶ πάσης ῥᾳδιουργίας

"of all deceit and all trickery"

The terms **deceit** and **wickedness** mean similar things. Paul may be using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [of all evil treachery]

See: Doublet

Acts 13:10 (#10)

οὐ παύσῃ διαστρέφων τὰς ὁδοὺς τοῦ Κυρίου τὰς εὐθείας

"will you not stop turning aside the straight paths of the Lord"

Paul is using the question form to rebuke Elymas for opposing God. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [you must stop turning aside the straight paths of the Lord!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 13:10 (#8)

ἐχθρὲ πάσης δικαιοσύνης

"enemy of all righteousness"

Paul is speaking of **righteousness** as if it were a person who could have an **enemy**. If your language would not use this figure of speech, you could express the meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [opposed to all righteousness]

See: Personification

Acts 13:10 (#9)

ἐχθρὲ πάσης δικαιοσύνης

"enemy of all righteousness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [enemy of everything that is right] or [opposed to everything that is right]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 13:10 (#11)

διαστρέφων τὰς ὁδοὺς τοῦ Κυρίου τὰς εὐθείας

"turning aside the straight paths of the Lord"

Paul is speaking of Elymas as if he were physically redirecting **paths** that God wanted people to follow so that these paths no longer went **straight**. He means that if people believe in God and obey him, they live in the right way, and that Elymas is trying to keep people, especially Sergius Paulus, from doing that. Alternate translation: [preventing people from believing in God, obeying him, and living right]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:10 (#5)

παντὸς δόλου καὶ πάσης ῥᾳδιουργίας

"of all deceit and all trickery"

Paul says **all** in these two instances as a generalization for emphasis. (But when he calls Elymas the **enemy of all righteousness**, that may be understood more literally.) Alternate translation: [of great deceit and great trickery]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 13:10 (#6)

υἱὲ διαβόλου

"son of the devil"

The expression **son of** describes a person who shares the qualities of something or someone else. Paul is saying that Elymas is acting like the devil in trying to keep Sergius Paulus from believing in Jesus. Alternate translation: [you who are acting like the devil]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:10 (#3)

ὦ πλήρης παντὸς δόλου καὶ πάσης ῥᾳδιουργίας

"O full of all deceit and all trickery"

Paul is speaking of Elymas as if he were a container that was **full** of negative qualities. Alternate translation: [O you who practice all deceit and all trickery]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:10 (#2)

ὦ πλήρης παντὸς δόλου καὶ πάσης ῥᾳδιουργίας

"O full of all deceit and all trickery"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the ideas of **deceit** and **trickery**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [O you who are always deceiving and tricking other people]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 13:10 (#1)

ὦ πλήρης παντὸς δόλου καὶ πάσης ῥᾳδιουργίας

"O full of all deceit and all trickery"

Paul is using the adjective **full** as a noun to identify Elymas as a person who is full of the negative qualities he describes. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [O you who are full of all deceit and all trickery]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 13:11 (#5)

ἔπεσεν ἐπ' αὐτὸν ἀχλὺς καὶ σκότος

"a mist and darkness fell upon him"

Luke may be using the two words **mist** and **darkness** together to express a single idea. The word **mist** may tell what kind of **darkness** was all that Elymas could see. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use **and**. Alternate translation: [a misty darkness was all that Elymas could see]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 13:11 (#3)

τυφλὸς, μὴ βλέπων τὸν ἥλιον

"blind, not seeing the sun"

Paul is using a word and a phrase together to express a single idea. The phrase **not seeing the sun** tells to what degree Elymas will be **blind**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [so blind that you will not be able to tell whether it is day or night]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 13:11 (#2)

χεὶρ Κυρίου ἐπὶ σέ

"the hand of the Lord {is} upon you"

Here the word **hand** represents the power of God, and the phrase **upon you** indicates punishment. Alternate translation: [the Lord is going to punish you]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:11 (#4)

ἔπεσεν ἐπ' αὐτὸν ἀχλὺς καὶ σκότος

"a mist and darkness fell upon him"

Paul is speaking of this **mist** and **darkness** as if they were going to **fall** on Elymas. Alternate translation: [what Elymas could see became blurry and then dark] or see the next note for another possibility.

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:11 (#1)

ἰδοὺ

"behold"

Paul is using the term **behold** to focus Elymas' attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation.

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:12 (#4)

τῇ διδαχῇ τοῦ Κυρίου

"the teaching of the Lord"

In this possessive form, **the Lord** is the object rather than the subject of **teaching**. That is, this does not mean "what the Lord taught," it means "what Barnabas and Paul taught about the Lord." you could state that as an alternate translation.

See: Possession

Acts 13:12 (#3)

τῇ διδαχῇ τοῦ Κυρίου

"the teaching of the Lord"

Luke is using the word **teaching** to mean the truth and power associated with the teaching about Jesus. Alternate translation: [the truth and power that accompanied the teaching of the Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:12 (#2)

ἐκπλησσόμενος ἐπὶ τῇ διδαχῇ τοῦ Κυρίου

"being astonished at the teaching of the Lord"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [The teaching of the Lord astonished him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:12 (#1)

ὁ ἀνθύπατος

"the proconsul"

A **proconsul** was a governor in charge of a Roman province. Alternate translation: [the governor]

Acts 13:13 (#4)

Πέργην τῆς Παμφυλίας

"Perga of Pamphylia"

The word **Perga** is the name of a city, and the word **Pamphylia** is the name of the province in which that city was located.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 13:13 (#3)

οἱ περὶ, Παῦλον

"the ones around Paul"

Alternate translation: [Paul and his traveling companions]

Acts 13:13 (#2)

οἱ περὶ, Παῦλον

"the ones around Paul"

The phrase **those around Paul** refers to Barnabas and John (who is also called John Mark). This phrase provides some background to the rest of the story by indicating that Paul had become the leader of the group. It is important to communicate this by keeping Paul's name first when he is mentioned with others, for example, in 13:46, 13:50, etc. The order of names is important.

See: Background Information

Acts 13:13 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 13:14 (#2)

ἐκάθισαν

“they sat down”

Paul and Barnabas may have **sat down** in the place where rabbis would sit, or in the way that rabbis would sit, as a way of asking permission to speak to the congregation. The fact that they were invited to speak (13:15) suggests that this is the case. Alternate translation: [sat down as rabbis would, to ask permission to speak to the congregation]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 13:14 (#1)

αὐτοὶ

“they”

The pronoun **they** refers to Paul and Barnabas. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul and Barnabas]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:15 (#3)

ἀδελφοί

“brothers”

The synagogue leaders are using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. Alternate translation: [Our fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:15 (#1)

τοῦ νόμου καὶ τῶν προφητῶν

“of the Law and the Prophets”

The word **Law** is the name for one part of the Hebrew Scriptures, and the word **Prophets** is the name for another part of the Hebrew Scriptures. Even though these are common nouns, Luke is using them to mean specific things. Show this in your translation in the way that is natural in your language.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 13:15 (#2)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

“Men, brothers”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [Our brothers] or [You brothers of ours]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:15 (#4)

εἴ τίς ἐστιν ἐν ὑμῖν λόγος παρακλήσεως πρὸς τὸν λαόν

“if any word of exhortation for the people is in you”

The synagogue leaders are using the term **word** to mean what Barnabas or Paul would want to say using words. Alternate translation: [if you want to say anything to encourage our people]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:15 (#5)

λέγετε

“speak”

This is an imperative, but it communicates an invitation rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates an invitation. Alternate translation: [we invite you to speak it now]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 13:16 (#4)

οἱ φοβούμενοι τὸν Θεόν

“ones fearing God”

Jews in the time of the New Testament used the expression **fearing God** to describe Gentiles (non-Jews) who worshiped the God of Israel and attended the synagogue. That is what Paul means here. See how you translated the similar expression in 10:2. Alternate translation: [you Gentiles who sincerely worship the God of Israel]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:16 (#2)

κατασείσας τῇ χειρὶ

“motioning with {his} hand”

This likely means that Paul waved his hand to get the attention of the audience and signal that he was about to speak. He wanted everyone in the synagogue to hear what he had to say from the very first word, so he did this to quiet them. Alternate translation: [waving his hand to signal that he was about to speak]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 13:16 (#5)

ἀκούσατε

“listen”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please listen to what I am about to say]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 13:16 (#3)

ἄνδρες, Ἰσραηλεῖται, καὶ οἱ φοβούμενοι τὸν Θεόν

"Men, Israelites and ones fearing God"

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [You Israelites and you who fear God]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:16 (#1)

ἀναστὰς

"arising"

Here the term **arising** means that Paul stood up to show that he indeed wanted to speak, as he had been invited to do. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:14. Alternate translation: [standing up to show that he wanted to speak]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 13:17 (#5)

μετὰ βραχίονος ὑψηλοῦ

"with an uplifted arm"

Here, **an uplifted arm** describes God's mighty power. Alternate translation: [with great power]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:17 (#4)

τὸν λαὸν ὕψωσεν

"exalted the people"

When Paul says that God **exalted the people** of Israel when they were in Egypt, he is referring to the way God made them great in number and strength even while they were still slaves. Alternate translation: [greatly enlarged their population]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:17 (#3)

τοὺς πατέρας

"fathers"

Paul is using the term **fathers** to mean "ancestors." Alternate translation: [ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:17 (#1)

ὁ Θεὸς τοῦ λαοῦ τούτου Ἰσραὴλ

"The God of this people Israel"

Alternate translation: [The God whom the people of Israel worship]

Acts 13:17 (#2)

ἡμῶν

"our"

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter to decide whether to use an inclusive or exclusive form of the word **our** here and in verses 32 and 33.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 13:18 (#1)

ἐτροποφόρησεν αὐτοὺς

"he endured them"

This means "he put up with their disobedience." Some ancient copies have a different word that means "he took care of them," which makes sense, since in this part of his speech, Paul is listing all of the good things that God did for the Israelites. Paul would be quoting Deuteronomy 1:13 from a well-known Greek translation. If the reading **put up with them** is correct, Paul may be foreshadowing the warning he gives at the end of his speech in 13:40–41. If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider using the reading in that translation. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, you may wish to follow the readings of ULT and UST. Alternate translation: [he took care of them]

See: Textual Variants

Acts 13:19 (#1)

κατεκληρονόμησεν τὴν γῆν αὐτῶν

"he gave them their land for an inheritance"

The pronoun **he** refers to God, the pronoun **them** refers to the Israelites, and the pronoun **their** refers to the seven nations that God destroyed. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [God gave the Israelites for an inheritance the land that these seven nations had previously occupied]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:20 (#1)

ὡς ἔτεσι τετρακοσίοις καὶ πεντήκοντα

“in about 450 years”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context. It may be helpful to make this a separate sentence. Alternate translation: [All these events took place over a period of about 450 years]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 13:20 (#2)

ἔδωκεν κριτὰς ἕως Σαμουὴλ προφήτου

“he gave them judges until Samuel the prophet”

This could mean: (1) that God gave the Israelites a series of judges and Samuel was the last of them. Alternate translation: [he gave them a series of judges ending with Samuel, who was also a prophet]; (2) that the phrase **Samuel the prophet** represents the time period associated with Samuel. Alternate translation: [until the time of Samuel the prophet]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:21 (#1)

ἔτη τεσσεράκοντα

“for 40 years”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence. Alternate translation: [to be their king for 40 years]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 13:22 (#3)

εὗρον

“I have found”

While God was indeed searching for someone to replace Saul, here the word **found** does not refer to the results of that search, but rather to God’s estimation of David. Alternate translation: [I have recognized that David, son of Jesse, is a man according to my heart]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:22 (#4)

ἄνδρα κατὰ τὴν καρδίαν μου

“a man according to my heart”

This is an idiomatic expression. Alternate translation: [the kind of person who does what pleases me]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:22 (#2)

εἶπεν μαρτυρήσας, εὗρον Δαυεὶδ τὸν τοῦ Ἰεσσαί, ἄνδρα κατὰ τὴν καρδίαν μου, ὃς ποιήσει πάντα τὰ θελήματά μου

“he said, testifying, ‘I have found David, {son} of Jesse, a man according to my heart, who will do all my will”

In order to avoid having a second-level quotation, you could turn Paul’s quotation into an indirect quotation. (Paul is quoting from 1 Samuel 13:14 and Psalm 89:20.) Alternate translation: [he said, testifying, that he had found David, son of Jesse, a man according to his heart, who would do all his will]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 13:22 (#1)

ἤγειρεν τὸν Δαυεὶδ αὐτοῖς εἰς βασιλέα

“he raised up David for them for {their} king”

Here, the expression **raised up** describes God giving someone an important position. See how you translated it in 3:22. Alternate translation: [made David their king]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:23 (#3)

τούτου

“of this one”

The demonstrative pronoun **this one** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [of David]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:23 (#4)

τῷ Ἰσραὴλ

“to Israel”

Here, **Israel** refers to the people of Israel. Alternate translation: [to the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:23 (#1)

τούτου & ἀπὸ τοῦ σπέρματος

"From the seed of this one"

This information is placed at the beginning of the sentence to emphasize that the Savior had to be one of David's descendants. It would be appropriate to retain this order in your translation rather than say, for example, "According to promise, God brought to Israel a Savior, Jesus, from the seed of this one."

See: Information Structure

Acts 13:23 (#2)

τοῦ σπέρματος

"the seed"

The term **seed** means "descendants." Alternate translation: [the descendants]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:24 (#5)

τῆς εἰσόδου αὐτοῦ

"of his entrance"

The pronoun **his** refers to Jesus. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [of Jesus' entrance]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:24 (#2)

πρὸ προσώπου τῆς εἰσόδου αὐτοῦ

"before the face of his entrance"

In your language, the expression **before the face of his entrance**, meaning "before the appearance of his entry into ministry" (See: next two notes), might seem to convey redundant information that would be not be natural to express. If so, you could abbreviate it. Alternate translation: [before he appeared] or [before he entered into his ministry]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 13:24 (#1)

Ἰωάννου

"John"

By **John**, Paul is referring implicitly to John the Baptist. Alternate translation: [John the Baptist]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:24 (#4)

τῆς εἰσόδου αὐτοῦ

"of his entrance"

By **entrance**, Paul is referring to Jesus beginning his ministry. Alternate translation: [of the start of his ministry]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:24 (#6)

βάπτισμα μετανοίας παντὶ τῷ λαῷ Ἰσραήλ

"a baptism of repentance to all the people of Israel"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **repentance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to all the people of Israel a baptism that people received to show that they were repenting]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 13:24 (#3)

πρὸ προσώπου τῆς εἰσόδου αὐτοῦ

"before the face of his entrance"

Here the term **face** means "appearance." Alternate translation: [appearance]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:25 (#7)

τὸ ὑπόδημα τῶν ποδῶν

"the sandals of {his} feet"

In your language, the expression **the sandals of his feet** might seem to convey redundant information that would be not be natural to express. If so, you could abbreviate it. Alternate translation: [his sandals]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 13:25 (#6)

οὗ οὐκ εἰμὶ ἄξιος τὸ ὑπόδημα τῶν ποδῶν λῦσαι

"of whom the sandals of {his} feet I am not worthy to untie"

John is using the action of untying sandals symbolically to signify humble service. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could translate this with a general expression. Alternate translation: [to whom I am not even worthy to offer humble service]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 13:25 (#2)

ἔλεγεν, τί ἐμὲ ὑπονοεῖτε εἶναι? οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐγώ, ἀλλ' ἰδοὺ, ἔρχεται μετ' ἐμὲ, οὗ οὐκ εἰμὶ ἄξιος τὸ ὑπόδημα τῶν ποδῶν λῦσαι

"he was saying, 'Who do you think me to be? I am not he. But behold, one is coming after me, of whom the sandals of {his} feet I am not worthy to untie"

Even if your language does not customarily put one direct quotation inside another, it might be good to present this quotation from John the Baptist as a direct quotation if possible, since it uses several figures of speech that might not sound natural in an indirect quotation. (As an indirect quotation, this would read something like this: "he asked the people who they thought him to be, and he told them he was not he and that behold, one was coming after him, the sandals of whose feet he was not worthy to untie.") You may be able to indicate the beginning of Paul's quotation from John with some punctuation or convention that your language uses.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 13:25 (#5)

ἰδοὺ

"behold"

John is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners' attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation.

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:25 (#3)

τί ἐμὲ ὑπονοεῖτε εἶναι

"Who do you think me to be"

John is using the question form to challenge his listeners' idea of who he is. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I am not who you think I am!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 13:25 (#1)

τὸν δρόμον

"his} course"

Paul is speaking of John as if he had been running a race or **course**. Alternate translation: [his work]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:25 (#4)

οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐγώ

"I am not he"

The pronoun **he** refers to the Messiah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [I am not the Messiah]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:26 (#3)

υἱοὶ

"sons"

Paul is using the term **sons** to mean "descendants." Alternate translation: [descendants]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:26 (#2)

ἀδελφοί, υἱοὶ γένους Ἀβραὰμ, καὶ οἱ ἐν ὑμῖν φοβούμενοι τὸν Θεόν

"brothers, sons of the family of Abraham, and the ones among you fearing God"

Paul is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. Alternate translation: [My fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:26 (#7)

τῆς σωτηρίας ταύτης

"of this salvation"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how God is saving people]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 13:26 (#5)

ὁ λόγος τῆς σωτηρίας ταύτης ἐξαπεστάλη

"the word of this salvation has been sent"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who did the action, it is clear from the context that this

was God. Alternate translation: [God has sent the word about this salvation]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:26 (#6)

ὁ λόγος

“the word”

Paul is using the term **word** to mean the message that God sent about Jesus by using words. Alternate translation: [the message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:26 (#4)

ἡμῖν

“to us”

Here the word **us** includes Paul and his entire audience in the synagogue, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks this distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 13:26 (#1)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί, υἱοὶ γένους Ἀβραὰμ, καὶ οἱ ἐν ὑμῖν φοβούμενοι τὸν Θεόν

“Men, brothers, sons of the family of Abraham, and the ones among you fearing God”

Paul is using an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [My brothers—my fellow sons of the family of Abraham—and you others who fear God]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:27 (#3)

τὰς φωνὰς τῶν προφητῶν

“the voices of the prophets”

Paul is using the word **voices** to mean the prophecies that the prophets spoke with their voices. Alternate translation: [the prophecies of the prophets]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:27 (#1)

τοῦτον ἀγνοήσαντες

“not recognizing this one”

The demonstrative pronoun **this one** refers to Jesus. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [not recognizing Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:27 (#4)

τὰς & ἀναγινωσκομένας

“being read”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that someone reads]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:27 (#5)

τὰς & ἀναγινωσκομένας

“being read”

Paul is referring implicitly to the way that someone reads from the writings of **the prophets** on each **Sabbath** in the synagogues. Alternate translation: [that someone reads aloud in each synagogue]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:27 (#2)

τοῦτον ἀγνοήσαντες

“not recognizing this one”

Paul means implicitly that the people of Jerusalem and their leaders did not recognize that God had sent Jesus to be the Messiah. Alternate translation: [not recognizing that God had sent Jesus to be the Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:28 (#1)

ᾐτήσαντο Πειλᾶτον ἀναιρεθῆναι αὐτόν

“they asked Pilate for him to be killed”

Here the word **they** refers to the Jewish people and their religious leaders in Jerusalem, and the pronoun **him** refers to Jesus. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Jewish leaders asked Pilate for Jesus to be killed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:28 (#2)

ἀναιρεθῆναι αὐτόν

“for him to be killed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to execute him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:29 (#3)

τοῦ ξύλου

“the tree”

The word translated as **tree** can mean either an actual tree or something made of wood. Paul is using the word to refer to the cross, which was made out of wood. Alternate translation: [from the cross]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:29 (#1)

πάντα τὰ περὶ αὐτοῦ γεγραμμένα

“all the things having been written about him”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [all that the prophets had written about him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:29 (#2)

καθελόντες ἀπὸ τοῦ ξύλου

“taking him down from the tree”

It may be helpful to say explicitly that Jesus had died before this happened. Alternate translation: [taking him down from the tree after he died]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:30 (#2)

ἤγειρεν αὐτὸν

“raised him”

Here, **raised** is an idiom for causing someone who has died to become alive again. Alternate translation: [caused him to live again after he had died]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:30 (#3)

ἤγειρεν αὐτὸν ἐκ νεκρῶν

“raised him from the dead”

Paul is using the adjective **dead** as a noun to mean people who have died. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [from among those who were dead]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 13:30 (#1)

ὁ δὲ Θεὸς ἤγειρεν αὐτὸν

“But God raised him”

Paul uses the word **But** to indicate a strong contrast between what the people did and what God did. Alternate translation: [Nevertheless]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Acts 13:31 (#2)

ὃς ὤφθη ἐπὶ ἡμέρας πλείους τοῖς συναναβᾶσιν αὐτῷ ἀπὸ τῆς Γαλιλαίας εἰς Ἰερουσαλήμ

“who was seen for many days by the ones having come up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The ones having come up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem saw him for many days]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:31 (#1)

ὃς ὤφθη ἐπὶ ἡμέρας πλείους τοῖς συναναβᾶσιν αὐτῷ ἀπὸ τῆς Γαλιλαίας εἰς Ἰερουσαλήμ

“who was seen for many days by the ones having come up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem”

The pronoun **who** refers to Jesus. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers, and it may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Jesus was seen for many days by the ones having come up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:31 (#4)

τοῖς συναναβᾶσιν

“by the ones having come up”

Paul says **having come up** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling to Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Alternate translation: [by the ones who traveled]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:31 (#3)

ἡμέρας πλείους

“many days”

We know from the Gospels that this period was 40 days. Translate **many days** with a term that would be appropriate for that length of time.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:32 (#1)

τὴν πρὸς τοὺς πατέρας ἐπαγγελίαν γενομένην

"the promise having been to {our} fathers"

Paul assumes that his listeners will know that he is referring to a **promise** that God made. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [the promise that God made to our fathers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:32 (#2)

τοὺς πατέρας

"our} fathers"

Paul is using the term **fathers** to mean "ancestors." Alternate translation: [our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:33 (#8)

Υἱός μου εἶ σύ, ἐγὼ σήμερον γεγέννηκά σε

"You are my Son; today I have fathered you"

Even if your language does not customarily put one direct quotation inside another, it would be good to present this quotation from Psalm 2 as a direct quotation if possible, since God is addressing the Messiah directly in it. You may be able to indicate its beginning with an opening second-level quotation mark or with some other punctuation or convention that your language could use to indicate the start of a second-level quotation. You may also be able to use special formatting to set off the quotation, as ULT does.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 13:33 (#7)

τῷ ψαλμῷ & τῷ δευτέρῳ

"the second Psalm"

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [Psalm 2]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Acts 13:33 (#6)

ὡς καὶ ἐν τῷ ψαλμῷ γέγραπται τῷ δευτέρῳ

"As it is also written in the second Psalm"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [As we can also read in the second Psalm]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:33 (#9)

Υἱός μου εἶ σύ, ἐγὼ σήμερον γεγέννηκά σε

"You are my Son; today I have fathered you"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if the repetition might be confusing, you could connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [You are my Son, yes, today I have fathered you]

See: Parallelism

Acts 13:33 (#2)

ταύτην

"this"

Paul assumes that his listeners will know that by **this** he means the promise he described in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [this promise]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:33 (#3)

τοῖς τέκνοις ἡμῶν

"for our children"

Some ancient copies read, "for us, their children" which makes sense, since Paul is saying that this promise was fulfilled in his own generation, not in the next generation. If the reading **for our children** is correct, Paul may mean "for the children of us Israelites." If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider using the reading in that translation. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, you may wish to follow the readings of ULT and UST.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 13:33 (#10)

Υἱός & γεγέννηκά σε

“Son & have fathered you”

Son is an important title that describes the relationship between Jesus and God. Be sure to retain this title in your translation.

See: Translating Son and Father

Acts 13:33 (#5)

ἀναστήσας Ἰησοῦν

“raising up Jesus”

Here, **raising up** is an idiom for causing someone who has died to become alive again. Alternate translation: [causing Jesus to live again after he had died]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:33 (#4)

τοῖς τέκνοις ἡμῶν

“for our children”

If this is the correct reading, then Paul may be using the term **children** to mean “descendants.” Alternate translation: [for our descendants]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:33 (#1)

ὅτι ταύτην ὁ Θεὸς ἐκπεπλήρωκεν τοῖς τέκνοις ἡμῶν

“that God has completely fulfilled this for our children”

It may be helpful to create a verse bridge that combines verse 32 with the first part of verse 33. you could state something like this: “And we are proclaiming to you that by raising Jesus, God has completely fulfilled for our children the promise he made to our fathers.”

See: Verse Bridges

Acts 13:34 (#4)

δώσω ὑμῖν τὰ ὅσια Δαυεὶδ τὰ πιστά

“I will give you the holy, trustworthy things of David”

This quotation is from the prophet Isaiah. Even if your language does not customarily put one direct quotation inside another, it would be good to present this quotation from Isaiah as a direct quotation if possible, since God is addressing the Israelites and ultimately the Messiah directly in it. You may be able to indicate its beginning with an opening second-level quotation mark or with some other punctuation or convention that your language uses to indicate the start of a second-level quotation. You may also be able to use special formatting to set off the quotation, as ULT does.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 13:34 (#2)

ἀνέστησεν αὐτὸν

“he raised him up”

As in 2:24, the idiom **raised up** means that God made Jesus alive again after he died. Alternate translation: [he brought him back to life]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:34 (#5)

τὰ ὅσια Δαυεὶδ τὰ πιστά

“the holy, trustworthy things of David”

Paul is using the adjectives **holy** and **trustworthy** as nouns. ULT adds the word **things** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the trustworthy promises that God made to David as the ancestor of the Holy One]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 13:34 (#1)

ἀνέστησεν αὐτὸν & εἴρηκεν

“he raised him up & he has spoken”

The pronoun **he** refers to God, and the pronoun **him** refers to Jesus. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [God raised Jesus … God has spoken]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:34 (#3)

ἐκ νεκρῶν

“from the dead”

Paul is using the adjective **dead** as a noun to mean people who have died. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [from among those who were dead]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 13:35 (#4)

τὸν Ὅσιόν σου

“your Holy One”

This is a Messianic prophecy, and the Messiah is referring to himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the first person in your translation. Alternate translation: [me, your Holy One] or [me, the Messiah]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 13:35 (#6)

ἰδεῖν διαφθοράν

“to see decay”

The term **decay** refers in this context to the decomposition of the body after death. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [to experience the decomposition of his body]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:35 (#2)

καὶ & λέγει

“he also says”

Even though David is the author of Psalm 16, from which this quotation is taken, the pronoun **he** refers to God, as in 13:34. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [God also says]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:35 (#3)

τὸν Ὅσιόν σου

“your Holy One”

The expression **Holy One** is a title for the Messiah. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that explicitly. Alternate translation: [your Messiah] or [your holy Messiah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:35 (#1)

ἐν ἑτέρῳ

“in another {place”

Paul assumes that his listeners will know that by **another place**, he means another place in the Scriptures. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [in another place in the Scriptures]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:35 (#5)

ἰδεῖν διαφθοράν

“to see decay”

Paul is using the word **see** to mean “experience.” Alternate translation: [to experience decay] or [to undergo decay]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:36 (#1)

ἐκοιμήθη

“fell asleep”

Paul is referring to death in a polite way by using the phrase **fell asleep**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [passed away] or [died]

See: Euphemism

Acts 13:36 (#3)

πρὸς τοὺς πατέρας αὐτοῦ

“with his fathers”

Paul is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with his ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:36 (#4)

εἶδεν διαφθοράν

“saw decay”

Paul is using the word **saw** to mean “experienced.” Alternate translation: [experienced decay] or [underwent decay]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:36 (#2)

προσετέθη πρὸς τοὺς πατέρας αὐτοῦ, καὶ εἶδεν

“was laid with his fathers and saw”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people buried him with his fathers and he saw]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:36 (#5)

διαφθοράν

“decay”

Here, the term **decay** refers to the decomposition of the body after death. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [the decomposition of his body]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:37 (#3)

οὐκ εἶδεν διαφθοράν

“did not see decay”

Paul is using the word **see** to mean “experience.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [experience decay] or [undergo decay]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:37 (#2)

ὁ Θεὸς ἤγειρεν

“God raised up”

The idiom **raised up** means that God made Jesus alive again after he died. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God brought back to life]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:37 (#1)

ὃν & ὁ Θεὸς ἤγειρεν

“he whom God raised up”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jesus. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Jesus, whom God raised up,]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:37 (#4)

διαφθοράν

“decay”

The term **decay** refers in this context to the decomposition of the body after death. Alternate translation: [the decomposition of his body]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:38 (#6)

ὑμῖν ἄφεσις ἁμαρτιῶν καταγγέλλεται, καὶ ἀπὸ πάντων

“release of sins is proclaimed to you and from everything”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [release of sins is proclaimed to you, and release is also proclaimed to you from the guilt of everything]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 13:38 (#5)

ὑμῖν ἄφεσις ἁμαρτιῶν καταγγέλλεται, καὶ

“release of sins is proclaimed to you and”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we are proclaiming forgiveness of sins to you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:38 (#1)

γνωστὸν & ἔστω ὑμῖν

“let it be known to you”

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may it be known to you] or [you should know]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 13:38 (#2)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

“men, brothers”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular group of people. Alternate translation: [my brothers]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:38 (#3)

ἀδελφοί

“brothers”

Paul is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. He is addressing the people in the synagogue who are his fellow-Jews and followers of Judaism. They are not Christian believers at this point. He may also be using the word **brothers** as a term of friendship for the Gentiles who are present. Alternate translation, as in UST: [my fellow Israelites and other friends]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:38 (#4)

τούτου

"this one"

The demonstrative pronoun **this one** refers to Jesus. Alternate translation: [Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:38 (#7)

πάντων ὧν οὐκ ἠδυνήθητε ἐν νόμῳ Μωϋσέως δικαιωθῆναι

"everything of which you were not able to be justified in the law of Moses"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [everything that you were not able to do in obedience to the law of Moses]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:39 (#1)

ἐν τούτῳ πᾶς ὁ πιστεύων δικαιοῦται

"In this one, everyone believing is justified"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God justifies everyone who believes in this one]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:39 (#2)

τούτῳ

"this one"

The demonstrative pronoun **this one** refers to Jesus. Alternate translation: [Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:40 (#1)

βλέπετε

"Look"

Paul is using the term **Look** to mean "Be careful," since looking around alertly is associated with being careful. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Be careful]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:40 (#3)

μὴ ἐπέλθῃ

"that & may not come upon you"

Paul is speaking of what the prophets spoke as if it were a living thing that could **come upon** his listeners. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that ... may not happen to you]

See: Personification

Acts 13:40 (#2)

τὸ εἰρημένον ἐν τοῖς προφήταις

"the thing spoken about in the prophets"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the thing that the prophets spoke about]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:41 (#2)

ἴδετε

"Look"

In this quotation, Habakkuk is using the term **Look** to mean "Pay attention," since God is describing doing a new thing that many people will not understand. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Pay attention]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:41 (#1)

ἴδετε, οἱ καταφρονηταί, καὶ θαυμάσατε καὶ ἀφανίσθητε, ὅτι ἔργον ἐργάζομαι ἐγὼ ἐν ταῖς ἡμέραις ὑμῶν, ἔργον ὃ οὐ μὴ πιστεύσητε, ἐάν τις ἐκδιηγῆται ὑμῖν

"Look, you despisers, and marvel and be destroyed! For I am doing a work in your days, a work that you would not believe at all, even if someone announced it to you"

This quotation is from the prophet Habakkuk. Even if your language does not customarily put one direct quotation inside another, it would be good to present this quotation from Habakkuk as a direct quotation if possible, since God is addressing the Israelites directly in it. You may be able to indicate its beginning with an opening second-level quotation mark or with some other punctuation or convention that your language could use to indicate the start of a second-level quotation. You may also be able to use special formatting to set off the quotation, as ULT does.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 13:41 (#5)

ἐν ταῖς ἡμέραις ὑμῶν

“in your days”

God is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [during your lifetime]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:41 (#4)

ἔργον ἐργάζομαι & ἔργον

“am doing a work & a work”

God is using the word **work** to mean a judgment that he will work to bring about. Alternate translation: [I am carrying out a judgment ... a judgment]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:41 (#3)

ἀφανίσθητε

“be destroyed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [perish]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:42 (#1)

ἐξιόντων δὲ, αὐτῶν

“And as they were leaving”

Here the pronoun **they** refers to Paul and Barnabas. Alternate translation: [as Paul and Barnabas were leaving]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:42 (#2)

παρεκάλουν

“they were begging”

Here the pronoun **they** refers to the people who were in the synagogue. Alternate translation: [the people in the synagogue begged them for]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:42 (#4)

τὰ ῥήματα ταῦτα

“these words”

Here, **words** refers to the message that Paul had spoken using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:42 (#3)

λαληθῆναι αὐτοῖς τὰ ῥήματα ταῦτα

“these words to be spoken to them”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [them to speak these words to them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:43 (#3)

ἠκολούθησαν & τῷ Παύλῳ καὶ τῷ Βαρναβᾷ

“followed Paul and Barnabas”

In this context, to **follow** someone means to become that person’s disciple or accept that person as a teacher. Alternate translation: [accepted Paul and Barnabas as their teachers]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:43 (#1)

λυθείσης & τῆς συναγωγῆς

“when the synagogue meeting was ended”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when the synagogue meeting ended]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:43 (#2)

προσηλύτων

"proselytes"

These **proselytes** were non-Jewish people who had converted to Judaism. Alternate translation: [converts to Judaism]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 13:43 (#4)

προσμένειν τῇ χάριτι τοῦ Θεοῦ

"to continue in the grace of God"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to remain faithful to God, who had graciously saved them]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 13:44 (#1)

σχεδὸν πᾶσα ἡ πόλις

"almost the whole city"

The **city** represents the people in the city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [almost all the people of the city]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:44 (#3)

ἀκοῦσαι τὸν λόγον τοῦ Κυρίου

"to hear the word of the Lord"

The implication is that Paul and Barnabas were going to speak **the word of the Lord**. Alternate translation: [to hear Paul and Barnabas speak the word of the Lord]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:44 (#4)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Κυρίου

"the word of the Lord"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that Paul and Barnabas were going to share by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message of the Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:44 (#2)

συνήχθη

"was gathered together"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [gathered together]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:45 (#3)

τοῖς ὑπὸ Παύλου λαλουμένοις

"the things being said by Paul"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the things that Paul was saying]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:45 (#2)

ἐπλήσθησαν ζήλου

"were filled with jealousy"

For emphasis, Luke is speaking of the Jewish leaders as if they were a container that jealousy **filled**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the emphasis another way. Alternate translation: [became very jealous]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:45 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"the & Jews"

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to one part of that group, its leaders. Alternate translation: [the leaders of the Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 13:46 (#6)

ἰδοὺ

"behold"

Paul and Barnabas are using the term **behold** to focus the attention of the Jewish leaders on what they are about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation.

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:46 (#3)

ὑμῖν & πρῶτον

“to you first”

Paul means implicitly that it was necessary to speak to the Jews first because they were God’s chosen people, and God had sent the Messiah initially to them. Alternate translation: [to you Jews first because you are God’s chosen people, and God sent the Messiah initially to you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:46 (#5)

οὐκ ἀξίους κρίνετε ἑαυτοὺς τῆς αἰωνίου ζωῆς

“judge yourselves not worthy of eternal life”

Paul does not seriously believe that the Jewish leaders do not consider themselves worthy of eternal life. Paul actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of his words. Alternate translation: [are acting as if you judge yourselves not worthy of eternal life]

See: Irony

Acts 13:46 (#1)

λαληθῆναι τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the word of God to be spoken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [for us to speak the word of God]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:46 (#8)

στρεφόμεθα

“we are turning”

By **we**, Paul and Barnabas mean themselves, but not the Jewish leaders to whom they are speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 13:46 (#7)

στρεφόμεθα εἰς τὰ ἔθνη

“we are turning to the Gentiles”

Paul and Barnabas are speaking as if they are going to be physically **turning** toward **the Gentiles**. They mean that they are going to stop preaching in the Jewish synagogue and begin preaching to gatherings of Gentiles. Alternate translation: [we will leave you and start preaching to the Gentiles]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 13:46 (#2)

ὑμῖν & ἀναγκαῖον πρῶτον λαληθῆναι τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“necessary for the word of God to be spoken to you first”

Paul and Barnabas are using the term **word** to mean the message that God commanded them to share by using words. Alternate translation: [the message from God]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:46 (#4)

ἐπειδὴ ἀπωθεῖσθε αὐτὸν

“Since you reject it”

Their rejection of the word of God is spoken of as if it were something they pushed away. Alternate translation: [Since you reject the word of God]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:47 (#6)

ἕως ἐσχάτου τῆς γῆς

“as far as the end of the earth”

This phrase is an idiom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everywhere on earth]

See: Idiom

Acts 13:47 (#4)

σε

“you”

The word **you** is singular here because it refers to the Messiah.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Acts 13:47 (#3)

τέθεικά σε εἰς φῶς

“I have placed you as a light”

Through this quotation from Isaiah, Paul and Barnabas are saying that the truth they are preaching about

Jesus is like a **light** that allows people to see. You could use the same simile in your translation, or you could use a different comparison, to something else your readers would recognize that helps people to understand.

See: Simile

Acts 13:47 (#5)

τοῦ εἶναί & εἰς σωτηρίαν ἕως ἐσχάτου τῆς γῆς

"for & to be for salvation as far as the end of the earth"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [should go and help people to be saved]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 13:47 (#1)

ἡμῖν

"us"

By **us**, Paul and Barnabas mean themselves, but not the Jewish leaders to whom they are speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 13:47 (#2)

τέθεικά σε εἰς φῶς ἐθνῶν, τοῦ εἶναί σε εἰς σωτηρίαν ἕως ἐσχάτου τῆς γῆς

"I have placed you as a light for the Gentiles, for you to be for salvation as far as the end of the earth"

This quotation is from the prophet Isaiah. Even if your language does not customarily put one direct quotation inside another, it would be good to present this quotation from Isaiah as a direct quotation if possible, since God is addressing the Messiah directly in it. (Paul and Barnabas are saying that since they are disciples of the Messiah, the quotation also refers to their ministry.) You may be able to indicate its beginning with an opening second-level quotation mark or with some other punctuation or convention that your language could use to indicate the start of a second-level quotation. You may also be able to use special formatting to set off the quotation, as ULT does.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 13:48 (#2)

τεταγμένοι

"appointed"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, it is clear from the context that it was God. Alternate translation: [God had appointed]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:48 (#1)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Κυρίου

"the word of the Lord"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that Paul and Barnabas had shared by using words. Alternate translation: [the message about the Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:49 (#2)

διεφέρετο & ὁ λόγος τοῦ Κυρίου

"the word of the Lord was being spread"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, the context suggests that it was those who believed in Jesus. Alternate translation: [those who believed in Jesus spread the word of the Lord]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 13:49 (#1)

ὁ λόγος τοῦ Κυρίου

"the word of the Lord"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that Paul and Barnabas had shared by using words. Alternate translation: [the message about the Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:50 (#7)

τῶν ὁρίων αὐτῶν

"their boundaries"

Luke is describing the city of Antioch in Pisidia by association with the way that it had **boundaries** and its leading citizens could determine who could be within those boundaries. Alternate translation: [their city] or [the territory they controlled]

See: Metonymy

Acts 13:50 (#5)

ἐξέβαλον αὐτοὺς

“they threw them out”

The pronoun **they** refers to the influential women and important men, not to the Jewish leaders. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the influential women and important men threw them out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:50 (#3)

τὰς σεβομένας γυναῖκας τὰς εὐσχήμονας

“the influential worshiping women”

Alternate translation: [the influential women among the Gentile women who worshiped in the synagogue]

Acts 13:50 (#2)

παρώτρυναν

“stirred up”

Luke says that the Jewish leaders **stirred up** these women and men, as if calm waters were being disturbed. This figurative expression means that the leaders said things to make them very upset with Paul and Barnabas. Alternate translation: [agitated]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:50 (#1)

οἱ & Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to one part of that group, its leaders. Alternate translation: [the leaders of the Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 13:50 (#6)

ἐξέβαλον αὐτοὺς ἀπὸ τῶν ὁρίων αὐτῶν

“they threw them out from their boundaries”

Luke is probably not speaking literally when he says that they **threw** them out. It is unlikely that they actually picked up Paul and Barnabas and heaved them through the air. Alternate translation: [they forced Paul and Barnabas to leave their boundaries]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:50 (#4)

τοὺς πρώτους

“the principal ones”

Luke is using the adjective **principal** as a noun, to mean people who are important. (ULT adds the word **ones** to show this.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the most important men]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 13:51 (#1)

οἱ

“they”

The pronoun **they** refers to Paul and Barnabas. Alternate translation: [Paul and Barnabas]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 13:51 (#2)

ἐκτιναξάμενοι τὸν κονιορτὸν τῶν ποδῶν ἐπ’ αὐτοὺς

“having shaken off the dust of {their} feet against them”

This symbolic action was an expression of strong rejection in this culture. It showed that someone did not want even the dust of a town to remain on them. If there is a similar gesture in your culture, you could consider using it here in your translation.

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 13:52 (#2)

ἐπληροῦντο χαρᾶς καὶ Πνεύματος Ἁγίου

“were filled with joy and the Holy Spirit”

Luke is speaking of these disciples as if they were a container that **joy** and **the Holy Spirit** had **filled**. Alternate translation: [experienced great joy and a strong sense of the Holy Spirit’s presence]

See: Metaphor

Acts 13:52 (#1)

οἳ & μαθηταὶ

“the disciples”

Here, **the disciples** implicitly means the new believers that Paul and Barnabas were leaving behind in Antioch of Pisidia. Alternate translation: [the new believers in Antioch of Pisidia]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts - Chapter 14 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

- Verses 1–4 describe how Paul and Barnabas proclaimed the gospel in Iconium.
- Verses 5–19 describe how Paul and Barnabas proclaimed the gospel in Lystra.
- Verses 20–28 describe how Paul and Barnabas proclaimed the gospel and strengthened the believers in several cities on their way back to Antioch.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"the word of his grace"
The expression "the word of his grace" refers to the message that God will graciously forgive and accept those who believe in Jesus. (See: grace, gracious; and believe, believer, belief, unbeliever, unbelief)

Zeus and Hermes
In this chapter, Barnabas and Paul are mistaken for the pagan gods Zeus and Hermes. The Gentiles in the Roman Empire worshiped many different false gods that did not really exist. Paul and Barnabas told them to believe in the "living God," that is, the one and only true God. (See: god, false god, goddess, idol, idolater, idolatrous, idolatry)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"We must enter into the kingdom of God through many sufferings."
Jesus told his followers before he died that everyone who followed him would suffer persecution. Paul and Barnabas were saying the same thing using different words as they encouraged the new believers in the cities that they had visited.

Acts 14:1 (#1)

ἐγένετο δὲ

"And it happened that"

Luke is using this phrase to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 14:1 (#2)

λαλῆσαι

"spoke"

It may be helpful to say explicitly that they spoke about Jesus. Alternate translation: [spoke about Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 14:2 (#2)

ἐπήγειραν

"stirred up"

Luke says that these Jews **stirred up** the Gentiles, as if calm waters were being disturbed. This expression means that the Jews said things to make the Gentiles very upset with Paul and Barnabas. Alternate translation: [agitated]

See: Metaphor

Acts 14:2 (#3)

τὰς ψυχὰς τῶν ἐθνῶν

"the souls of the Gentiles"

Luke is using one part of the Gentiles, their **souls**, to mean all of them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Gentiles]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 14:2 (#1)

οἱ & ἀπειθήσαντες Ἰουδαῖοι

"the disobeying Jews"

Alternate translation: [those Jews who did not believe the message about Jesus]

Acts 14:2 (#4)

τῶν ἀδελφῶν

"the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 14:3 (#2)

ἐπὶ τῷ Κυρίῳ

"for the Lord"

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [about the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 14:3 (#5)

σημεῖα καὶ τέρατα

“signs and wonders”

The terms **signs** and **wonders** mean similar things. Luke is using them together for emphasis. See how you translated this expression in 4:30. Alternate translation: [great miracles]

See: Doublet

Acts 14:3 (#1)

οὖν

“But”

Luke uses the word **But** here to indicate a contrast between what the unfaithful Jews did and what Paul and Barnabas did in response. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Nevertheless]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Acts 14:3 (#3)

τῷ λόγῳ

“to the word”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that the Holy Spirit wanted Paul and Barnabas to share by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in support of the message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 14:3 (#6)

διὰ τῶν χειρῶν αὐτῶν

“by their hands”

Here, **hands** represents the capability of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [through them]

See: Metonymy

Acts 14:3 (#4)

τῆς χάριτος αὐτοῦ

“of his grace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [about how God graciously saves us]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 14:4 (#2)

σὺν τοῖς ἀπoστόλοις

“with the apostles”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [were with the apostles]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 14:4 (#1)

ἐσχίσθη & τὸ πλῆθος τῆς πόλεως

“the multitude of the city was divided”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the people of the city disagreed with each other]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 14:5 (#1)

ὑβρίσαι καὶ λιθοβολῆσαι αὐτούς

“to mistreat and stone them”

Luke is expressing a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **stone** tells how their opponents in Iconium wanted to **mistreat** Paul and Barnabas. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use “and.” Alternate translation: [to put them to death by stoning them]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 14:6 (#1)

τῆς Λυκαονίας

“of Lycaonia”

The word **Lycaonia** is the name of a district in Asia Minor

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 14:6 (#2)

Δέρβην

“Derbe”

The word **Derbe** is the name of a city in Asia Minor. It is south of Iconium and Lystra.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 14:8 (#2)

ἀδύνατος & τοῖς ποσὶν

“powerless in {his} feet”

Luke is referring to the strength of this man’s legs by association with the way people are able to stand on their **feet** when their legs are strong. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [whose legs could not support him]

See: Metonymy

Acts 14:8 (#1)

τις ἀνὴρ & ἐκάθητο

“a certain man was sitting”

Luke uses this phrase to introduce a new character into the story. If your language has its own way of doing that, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 14:8 (#3)

χωλὸς ἐκ κοιλίας μητρὸς αὐτοῦ

“lame from the womb of his mother”

Luke is referring to the time of this man’s birth by association with the way he came out of the **womb of his mother** when he was born. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [lame from the time he was born]

See: Metonymy

Acts 14:9 (#1)

οὗτος ἤκουσεν τοῦ Παύλου λαλοῦντος, ὃς ἀτενίσας αὐτῷ καὶ ἰδὼν ὅτι ἔχει πίστιν

“He heard Paul speaking, who looked intently at him and saw that he had faith”

The pronouns **he** and **him** refer to the lame man, and the pronoun **who** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers, and it may be helpful to make this two sentences. Alternate translation: [This man heard Paul speaking. Paul looked intently at the man and saw that he had faith]

See: Pronouns

Acts 14:9 (#2)

ἔχει πίστιν τοῦ σωθῆναι

“he had faith to be healed”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faith**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he could trust in Jesus to heal him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 14:9 (#3)

ἔχει πίστιν τοῦ σωθῆναι

“he had faith to be healed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who would do the action, it is clear from the context that it would be Jesus. (Here Luke is using the word that is often translated as “saved” in one of its specific senses to mean **healed**.) Alternate translation: [he could trust Jesus to heal him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 14:10 (#4)

ἥλατο

“he jumped up”

The implication is that the man’s legs were completely healed. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [the man was completely healed and he jumped up]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 14:10 (#3)

ἀνάστηθι ἐπὶ τοὺς πόδας σου ὀρθός

“Stand upright on your feet”

It might seem that the expression **Arise upon your feet** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [Get up!]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 14:10 (#1)

εἶπεν & ἥλατο

“He said & he jumped up”

The first instance of the pronoun **He** refers to Paul, and the second instance refers to the man who was lame. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul said ... the man jumped up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 14:10 (#2)

ἀνάστηθι ἐπὶ τοὺς πόδας σου ὀρθός

"Stand upright on your feet"

This was not a command that the man was capable of obeying. Instead, it was a command that directly caused the man to be healed. Alternate translation: [Jesus the Messiah gives you the ability to walk]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 14:11 (#1)

ἐπῆραν τὴν φωνὴν αὐτῶν

"raised their voice"

Since Luke is referring to a group of people, it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **voice**. Alternate translation: [they raised their voices]

See: Collective Nouns

Acts 14:11 (#2)

ἐπῆραν τὴν φωνὴν αὐτῶν

"raised their voice"

The phrase **raised up their voice** is an idiom that means that the crowds spoke loudly. Alternate translation: [they said loudly]

See: Idiom

Acts 14:11 (#4)

Λυκαονιστὶ

"in Lycaonian"

The word **Lycaonian** is the name of the language that was spoken in the district of Lycaonia.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 14:11 (#5)

ὁμοιωθέντες ἀνθρώποις

"having been made like men"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [having become like men]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 14:11 (#3)

Λυκαονιστὶ λέγοντες, οἱ θεοὶ ὁμοιωθέντες ἀνθρώποις, κατέβησαν πρὸς ἡμᾶς

"saying in Lycaonian, "The gods, having been made like men, have come down to us"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [saying in Lycaonian that the gods, having been made like men, had come down to them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 14:12 (#1)

Δία

"Zeus"

The word **Zeus** is the name of a pagan god who was considered to be the ruler of all the other pagan gods.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 14:12 (#2)

Ἑρμῆν

"Hermes"

The word **Hermes** is the name of the pagan god who was thought to bring messages to people from Zeus and the other gods.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 14:12 (#3)

τὸν δὲ Παῦλον, Ἑρμῆν

"and Paul "Hermes"

Luke is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they were calling Paul "Hermes,"]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 14:12 (#4)

ὁ ἡγούμενος τοῦ λόγου

"the leader of the word"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that Paul and Barnabas were sharing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the leader of the message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 14:12 (#5)

ὁ ἡγούμενος τοῦ λόγου

"the leader of the word"

Luke is speaking of the message about Jesus as if it were a living thing that Paul could lead. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the main speaker]

See: Personification

Acts 14:13 (#2)

τοῦ Διὸς, τοῦ ὄντος πρὸ τῆς πόλεως

"of Zeus, being before the city"

Here, **before** means "in front of". Luke is referring to the temple of Zeus that was located right outside the entrance to the city of Iconium. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [of the Temple of Zeus that was located right outside the entrance to the city]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 14:13 (#1)

τοῦ Διὸς, τοῦ ὄντος πρὸ τῆς πόλεως

"of Zeus, being before the city"

Luke is using the name **Zeus** to mean the temple that was associated with the worship of Zeus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the temple of Zeus, which was before the city]

See: Metonymy

Acts 14:13 (#4)

σὺν τοῖς ὄχλοις ἤθελεν θύειν

"was wanting to sacrifice with the crowds"

Luke means implicitly that the priest of Zeus wanted to offer the oxen as sacrifices to Paul and Barnabas, whom the people thought were the gods Zeus and Hermes. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [was wanting to offer sacrifice with the crowds to Paul and Barnabas as the gods Zeus and Hermes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 14:13 (#3)

ταύρους καὶ στέμματα

"oxen and wreaths"

The implication is that the priest had put these **wreaths** on the **oxen** because they were going to be offered as a sacrifice. That was the custom in this culture. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [oxen that were wearing wreaths as sacrificial animals]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 14:14 (#2)

κράζοντες

"crying out"

Together with the word "saying" in the next verse, the phrase "crying out" expresses a single idea. The phrase **crying out** tells how Barnabas and Paul were **saying** what they said. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use "and." Alternate translation: [saying loudly]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 14:14 (#1)

διαρρήξαντες τὰ ἱμάτια ἑαυτῶν

"tearing their clothing"

Barnabas and Paul tore their clothes as a symbolic action to show that they were deeply distressed and upset that the crowd wanted to sacrifice to them. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [tearing their clothing to show how distressed they were that the crowd wanted to sacrifice to them]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 14:15 (#7)

ὃς ἐποίησεν τὸν οὐρανὸν, καὶ τὴν γῆν, καὶ τὴν θάλασσαν, καὶ πάντα τὰ ἐν αὐτοῖς

"who made the heaven and the earth and the sea and everything in them"

Paul and Barnabas are referring to all of creation by naming its components. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of creation]

See: Merism

Acts 14:15 (#3)

καὶ ἡμεῖς ὁμοιοπαθεῖς ἐσμεν ὑμῖν ἄνθρωποι

"We also are men, like-passioned to you"

People in this culture believed that the gods did not have passions as humans do. So the implication of this statement is that Paul and Barnabas are human beings and not gods. You can include this information in your translation if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [We are human beings just like you. We are not gods!]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 14:15 (#2)

ἄνδρες, τί ταῦτα ποιεῖτε

"Men, why are you doing these things"

Barnabas and Paul are rebuking the people for trying to sacrifice to them. If it would be helpful in your language, you would express this question as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [People, you must not do these things!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 14:15 (#5)

τούτων τῶν ματαίων

"these useless things"

Paul and Barnabas are using the adjective **useless** as a noun to mean the false gods that the people of Lystra had been worshiping. ULT adds the word **things** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this expression with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [these false gods]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 14:15 (#6)

Θεὸν ζῶντα

"the living God"

This expression is an idiom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one God who truly exists]

See: Idiom

Acts 14:15 (#4)

ἀπὸ τούτων τῶν ματαίων ἐπιστρέφειν ἐπὶ Θεὸν ζῶντα

"to turn you from these useless things to the living God"

Paul and Barnabas are speaking as if they want the people in Lystra physically to **turn** from idol worship and believe in the one true God. They mean that the people should stop living in one way and should start living in another way. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to get you to stop worshiping these false gods and lead you to worship the living God instead]

See: Metaphor

Acts 14:15 (#1)

ἄνδρες

"Men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, Paul and Barnabas are likely using the term in a generic sense that includes both men and women, since both men and women of Lystra were probably in the crowd that wanted to sacrifice to them. To make this clear to your readers, you could use a term in your language that includes both men and women. Alternate translation: [You people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 14:16 (#1)

πορεύεσθαι ταῖς ὁδοῖς αὐτῶν

"to go their own ways"

This is a metaphor that refers to how people live their lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to live their lives the way they wanted to] or [to do what they wanted to do]

See: Metaphor

Acts 14:17 (#2)

οὐρανόθεν ὑμῖν ὑετοὺς διδοὺς

"giving you rains from the sky"

It might seem that the expression **rains from the sky** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [providing rain]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 14:17 (#4)

τροφῆς καὶ εὐφροσύνης

“with food and gladness”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **gladness** tells how the food that God provided made these people feel. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use “and.” Alternate translation: [enjoyable food]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 14:17 (#3)

ἐμπιπλῶν & τὰς καρδίας ὑμῶν

“filling your hearts”

Paul and Barnabas are using one part of these people, their **hearts**, meaning their desires, to mean their entire beings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [satisfying you]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 14:17 (#1)

οὐκ ἀμάρτυρον αὐτὸν ἀφῆκεν

“he did not leave himself without witness”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative preposition **without**. Alternate translation: [he left himself a witness] or [he showed you what he was like]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 14:19 (#1)

πείσαντες τοὺς ὄχλους

“having persuaded the crowds”

It may be helpful to state explicitly what they **persuaded the crowds** to do. Alternate translation: [persuaded the crowds not to believe Paul and Barnabas and to turn violently against them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 14:20 (#1)

αὐτὸν & εἰσῆλθεν & ἐξῆλθεν

“him & he entered & he went”

The pronouns **him** and **he** refer to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul ... he entered ... Paul went]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 14:21 (#1)

μαθητεύσαντες ἱκανοὺς

“having made many disciples”

Luke is using the adjective **many** as a noun to mean the people who became disciples. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [having helped many people to become disciples]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 14:22 (#1)

ἐπιστηρίζοντες τὰς ψυχὰς τῶν μαθητῶν

“strengthening the souls of the disciples”

Luke is using one part of the disciples, their **souls**, to represent their entire beings as believers in Jesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [They were strengthening the disciples]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 14:22 (#4)

δεῖ ἡμᾶς εἰσελθεῖν εἰς τὴν Βασιλείαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“It is necessary for us to enter into the kingdom of God”

See the discussion of the concept of the **kingdom of God** in Part 2 of the General Introduction to Acts. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the idea behind the abstract noun **kingdom** with a noun such as “king.” Alternate translation: [It is necessary for us to endure many afflictions in order to live in allegiance to God as our true king]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 14:22 (#2)

παρακαλοῦντες ἐμμένειν τῇ πίστει

“encouraging them to continue in the faith”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faith**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [encouraging them to keep believing in Jesus]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 14:22 (#5)

δεῖ ἡμᾶς εἰσελθεῖν

“It is necessary for us to enter”

By **us**, Paul and Barnabas mean both themselves and the believers to whom they were speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 14:22 (#3)

καὶ ὅτι διὰ πολλῶν θλίψεων, δεῖ ἡμᾶς εἰσελθεῖν εἰς τὴν Βασιλείαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“and {saying}, “It is necessary for us to enter into the kingdom of God through many afflictions”

You may want to have an indirect quotation here, if that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and saying that it was necessary for all of them to enter into the kingdom of God through many afflictions]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 14:23 (#1)

χειροτονήσαντες & παρέθεντο & πεπιστεύκεισαν

“having appointed & they entrusted & they had believed”

The pronoun **them** refers to the new believers in the cities of Lystra, Iconium, and Antioch, and the pronoun **they** refer to Paul and Barnabas. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [for the new believers in these cities ... Paul and Barnabas entrusted these believers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 14:23 (#3)

τῷ Κυρίῳ

“to the Lord”

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [to the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 14:23 (#2)

κατ’ ἐκκλησίαν

“by church”

Alternate translation: [in each new group of believers]

Acts 14:25 (#2)

κατέβησαν εἰς Ἀττάλιαν

“they went down to Attalia”

Luke says that Paul and Barnabas **went down** to Attalia because that city is lower in elevation than Perga. Alternate translation: [traveled to Attalia]

See: Idiom

Acts 14:25 (#1)

τὸν λόγον

“the word”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that the Holy Spirit wanted Paul and Barnabas to share by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 14:26 (#1)

ὅθεν ἦσαν παραδεδομένοι τῇ χάριτι τοῦ Θεοῦ

“where they had been commended to the grace of God”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [where the believers had commended them to the grace of God]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 14:26 (#2)

ὅθεν ἦσαν παραδεδομένοι τῇ χάριτι τοῦ Θεοῦ

“where they had been commended to the grace of God”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [where the believers had asked God to care for them graciously]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 14:27 (#4)

ἤνοιξεν τοῖς ἔθνεσιν θύραν πίστεως

“he had opened a door of faith for the Gentiles”

Here the expression **opened a door** means that God created an opportunity, as if a door that gave access to this opportunity had previously been closed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he had given the Gentiles an opportunity for faith]

See: Metaphor

Acts 14:27 (#1)

ἀνήγγελλον & αὐτῶν & ἤνοιξεν

"they were reporting & them & he had opened"

The pronouns **they** and **them** refer to Paul and Barnabas, and the pronoun **he** refers to God. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul and Barnabas were reporting ... them ... God had opened]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 14:27 (#5)

ἤνοιξεν τοῖς ἔθνεσιν θύραν πίστεως

"he had opened a door of faith for the Gentiles"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faith**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he had given the Gentiles the opportunity to believe in Jesus]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 14:27 (#2)

ὅσα ἐποίησεν ὁ Θεὸς μετ' αὐτῶν

"how much God had done with them"

In many languages it would be an idiom to say that God **had done** something with Paul and Barnabas. It would mean that they had been the objects of God's action. But the expression is not an idiom here. It means that Paul and Barnabas had been able to work in partnership **with** God. Alternate translation: [how much they had been able to do by working together with God]

See: Idiom

Acts 14:27 (#3)

ἤνοιξεν τοῖς ἔθνεσιν θύραν πίστεως

"he had opened a door of faith for the Gentiles"

Here, the possessive form describes not a **door** consisting of **faith** but a door that leads to faith. Alternate translation: [a door leading to faith]

See: Possession

Acts 14:28 (#1)

χρόνον οὐκ ὀλίγον

"for not a little time"

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could take the meaning plainly. Alternate translation, as in UST: [for a long time]

See: Litotes

Acts - Chapter 15 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Verses 1–35 tell how the church resolved the question of whether Gentiles who believed in Jesus needed to keep the whole law of Moses. Verses 36–41 tell how Paul began a new journey to proclaim the gospel, bringing Silas with him.

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry that is quoted from the Old Testament in 15:16–18.

Even if your language does not customarily put one direct quotation inside another, it would be good to present the quotation from the prophet Amos in verses 16–18 as a direct quotation if possible, since in it God is speaking directly the people of Israel. Since Amos acknowledges in verse 17 that God is speaking by saying "says the Lord," a third-level quotation actually starts in verse 16. ULT uses second-level and third-level quotation marks within the first-level quotation from James to identify the various speakers. But it may not be necessary to do this in your translation. You could just use second-level quotation marks or some other punctuation or convention available in your language to indicate the beginning and ending of the second-level quotation from Amos. (See: Quote Markings)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Did Gentiles have to obey the law of Moses?

Some believers wanted the Gentiles to be circumcised because God had told Abraham and Moses that everyone who wanted to belong to him had to be circumcised, so this was a law that would always exist. But Paul and Barnabas had seen God give uncircumcised Gentiles the gift of the Holy Spirit, so they did not believe that the Gentiles needed to be circumcised. Both groups went to Jerusalem to have the church

leaders decide what they should do. The meeting that the apostles and elders held to decide about this issue is commonly called the "Jerusalem Council."

Acts 15:1 (#3)

ἐδίδασκον τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς

"were teaching the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [were teaching the believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:1 (#1)

τινες

"certain ones"

Luke assumes that his readers will recognize that these were Jews who believed in Jesus. You can include this information if your readers will need it to understand this sentence. Alternate translation: [certain Jews who believed in Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:1 (#5)

οὐ δύνασθε σωθῆναι

"you are not able to be saved"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who would do the action, it is clear from the context that it would be God. Alternate translation, as in UST: [God will not save you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:1 (#2)

κατελθόντες ἀπὸ τῆς Ἰουδαίας

"coming down from Judea"

Luke speaks of these Jews **coming down** to Antioch because that city is lower in elevation than Judea. Alternate translation: [who had traveled]

See: Idiom

Acts 15:1 (#4)

ἐὰν μὴ περιτμηθῆτε

"Unless you are circumcised"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [Unless someone circumcises you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:2 (#3)

πρὸς αὐτοὺς, ἔταξαν & ἐξ αὐτῶν

"with them & they appointed & from among them"

The first instance of the pronoun **them** refers to the Jewish believers from Judea, and the pronoun **they** and the second instance of the pronoun **them** refers to the believers in the church in Antioch. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [with the Jewish believers from Judea ... the believers in Antioch appointed ... from the church there]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 15:2 (#4)

ἀναβαίνειν & εἰς Ἰερουσαλὴμ

"to go up & in Jerusalem"

Luke says **to go up** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling to Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Use a natural way in your language of referring to traveling to a higher elevation.

See: Idiom

Acts 15:2 (#1)

στάσεως καὶ ζητήσεως οὐκ ὀλίγης

"no little dispute and debate"

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with a word, **little**, that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could states the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a great dispute and debate]

See: Litotes

Acts 15:2 (#2)

στάσεως καὶ ζητήσεως

"dispute and debate"

The terms **dispute** and **debate** mean similar things. Luke may be using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single word or phrase. Alternate translation: [controversy]

See: Doublet

Acts 15:3 (#5)

πᾶσι τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς

“in all the brothers”

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in all the believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:3 (#2)

τῆς ἐκκλησίας

“the church”

Luke is using the phrase **the church** to mean the people who were associated with the church. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of the church]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:3 (#3)

ἐκδιηγούμενοι τὴν ἐπιστροφὴν τῶν ἐθνῶν

“describing the conversion of the Gentiles”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **conversion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [describing how some of the Gentiles had stopped worshiping false gods and were now worshiping the true God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 15:3 (#6)

πᾶσι τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς

“in all the brothers”

The word **all** here may be a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, use a different way to convey this general statement. Alternate translation: [in the believers in those places]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 15:3 (#4)

ἐποίουν χαρὰν μεγάλην πᾶσι τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς

“producing great joy in all the brothers”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **joy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [making all the brothers very happy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 15:3 (#1)

οἱ & προπεμφθέντες ὑπὸ τῆς ἐκκλησίας

“the ones having been sent out by the church”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the ones the church had sent out]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:4 (#1)

παρεδέχθησαν ὑπὸ τῆς ἐκκλησίας, καὶ τῶν ἀποστόλων, καὶ τῶν πρεσβυτέρων

“they were welcomed by the church and the apostles and the elders”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the church the apostles and the elders welcome them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:4 (#2)

τῆς ἐκκλησίας, καὶ τῶν ἀποστόλων, καὶ τῶν πρεσβυτέρων

“the church and the apostles and the elders”

Luke is using the phrase **the church** to mean the people who were associated with the church. Since he mentions the **apostles** and **elders** separately, here means the ordinary members of the church. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the members of the church]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:4 (#3)

ὅσα ὁ Θεὸς ἐποίησεν μετ’ αὐτῶν

“how much God had done with them”

See how you translated this same expression in 14:27. Alternate translation: [how much they had been able to do working together with God]

See: Idiom

Acts 15:5 (#2)

ἐξανέστησαν

“stood up”

These believers **stood up** to indicate that they had something important to say. Alternate translation: [stood up to show that they had something important to say]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 15:5 (#3)

αὐτοὺς, παραγγέλλειν

“them & command them”

Both instances of the pronoun **them** refer to the Gentiles who had converted to belief in the true God, as described in 15:3. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [these Gentiles who have converted ... command them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 15:5 (#1)

πεπιστευκότες

“having believed”

Alternate translation: [who had believed in Jesus]

Acts 15:6 (#2)

ἰδεῖν περὶ

“to see about”

Here the phrase **to see about** is an idiom that means “to consider.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to consider]

See: Idiom

Acts 15:6 (#1)

συνήχθησάν

“were gathered together”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [gathered together]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:6 (#3)

τοῦ λόγου τούτου

“this word”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the claim that the Jewish believers who were Pharisees had made by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the claim that the Jewish believers who were Pharisees had made]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:7 (#6)

ὑμεῖς ἐπίστασθε

“you know”

For emphasis, Peter is stating the pronoun **you**, whose meaning is already present in the verb **know**. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction here. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [you know very well]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 15:7 (#4)

ἀδελφοί

“brothers”

Peter is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation, as in UST: [fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:7 (#2)

αὐτούς

“them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the apostles and elders. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the apostles and elders]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 15:7 (#9)

τὸν λόγον

“the word”

Peter is using the term **word** to mean the message that he shared by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:7 (#3)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

“Men, brothers”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular group of people. Alternate translation: [My brothers]

See: Idiom

Acts 15:7 (#7)

ἀφ’ ἡμερῶν ἀρχαίων

“from original days”

Peter is using an idiom that refers to the time when something began or had its origin. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the time when the Gentiles would first begin to believe in Jesus,]

See: Idiom

Acts 15:7 (#1)

ἀναστὰς Πέτρος

“Peter, arising”

Peter stood up to indicate that he had something important to say. If your readers might not understand the significance of this action, you could explain it in your translation. Alternate translation: [Peter, standing up to show that he had something important to say]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 15:7 (#8)

διὰ τοῦ στόματός μου

“By my mouth”

Peter is using one part of himself, his **mouth**, to represent all of himself in the act of speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or plain language. Alternate translation: [From me]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 15:7 (#5)

ὑμεῖς & ὑμῖν

“you & you”

Both occurrences of **you** are plural since they refer to the apostles and elders. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Acts 15:8 (#2)

ἐμαρτύρησεν αὐτοῖς

“testified to them”

The implication is not that God testified to the Gentiles about Jesus, but that by giving the Gentiles the Holy Spirit, God testified to Peter and his companions that they could have genuine faith. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [testified to their genuine faith]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:8 (#3)

καθὼς καὶ ἡμῖν

“just as also to us”

Peter is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [just as he also gave the Holy Spirit to us]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 15:8 (#1)

καρδιογνώστης

“the heart-knower”

Here, the word **heart** refers to a person’s character and intentions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who understands each person’s character and intentions]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:8 (#4)

ἡμῖν

“to us”

Peter is using the word **us** to refer to himself and his listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 15:9 (#1)

οὐδὲν διέκρινεν μεταξὺ ἡμῶν τε καὶ αὐτῶν

“he did not distinguish between us and them”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative verb **distinguish**, which in this context means "discriminate." Alternate translation: [he regarded them in the same way he regarded us]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 15:9 (#4)

τῇ πίστει καθαρίσας τὰς καρδίας αὐτῶν

"having cleansed their hearts by faith"

Here, the word **hearts** represents the inner beings of the Gentiles. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [having forgiven them because they believed in Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:9 (#2)

ἡμῶν

"us"

Peter is using the word **us** to refer to himself and his listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 15:9 (#3)

τῇ πίστει καθαρίσας τὰς καρδίας αὐτῶν

"having cleansed their hearts by faith"

Peter speaks of God forgiving the Gentile believers' sins as though God literally **cleansed** their hearts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [having made them innocent because they believed in Jesus]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:10 (#7)

οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν

"our fathers"

Peter is using the term **fathers** to mean "ancestors." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:10 (#6)

τὸν τράχηλον

"the neck"

Since Peter is referring to a group of people, it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **neck**. Alternate translation: [the necks]

See: Collective Nouns

Acts 15:10 (#5)

ἐπιθεῖναι ζυγὸν ἐπὶ τὸν τράχηλον τῶν μαθητῶν, ὃν οὔτε οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν οὔτε ἡμεῖς ἰσχύσαμεν βαστάσαι

"putting a yoke upon the neck of the disciples that neither our fathers nor we have been able to bear"

Peter is speaking as if the believers who are Pharisees literally want to put a **yoke** on the necks of the Gentile believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [requiring the disciples to meet an onerous obligation that neither our fathers nor we have been able to fulfill]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:10 (#3)

ἡμῶν & ἡμεῖς

"our & we"

Peter is using the words **our** and **we** to refer to himself and his listeners, so use the inclusive form of those words if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 15:10 (#2)

τί πειράζετε τὸν Θεόν, ἐπιθεῖναι ζυγὸν ἐπὶ τὸν τράχηλον τῶν μαθητῶν, ὃν οὔτε οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν οὔτε ἡμεῖς ἰσχύσαμεν βαστάσαι

"why are you testing God, putting a yoke upon the neck of the disciples that neither our fathers nor we have been able to bear"

Peter is using the question form to challenge the believers who are Pharisees about what they want the Gentiles to do. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement, ending the verse with a period or exclamation point. Alternate translation: [you must not test God to put a yoke upon the neck of the disciples which neither our fathers nor we were able to bear!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 15:10 (#1)

νῦν οὖν τί

“Now, therefore, why”

Now in this context does not mean “at this moment.” Peter is using the word to draw attention to the important point that follows. Alternate translation: [So tell me, therefore: Why]

Acts 15:10 (#4)

τί πειράζετε τὸν Θεόν

“why are you testing God”

Here the word **testing** means **challenging**. Peter is saying that God has accepted the Gentiles without requiring them to be circumcised or keep the law, but the believers who are Pharisees are challenging God’s judgment that the Gentiles should be accepted on that basis. See how you translated the similar expression in 5:9. Alternate translation: [why are you challenging God]

Acts 15:11 (#5)

διὰ τῆς χάριτος τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

“through the grace of the Lord Jesus”

Peter means implicitly that we are saved through the grace of the Lord Jesus and not by obeying the law of Moses. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [through the grace of the Lord Jesus and not by obeying the law of Moses]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:11 (#7)

κἀκεῖνοι

“they also”

Peter assumes that his listeners will know that he is using the pronoun **they** to refer to the Gentiles. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand this sentence. Alternate translation: [the Gentiles also will be saved]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:11 (#3)

πιστεύομεν σωθῆναι

“we believe ourselves to be saved”

Peter is using the pronoun **we** and the implied pronoun **ourselves** to refer to himself and his listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 15:11 (#2)

πιστεύομεν σωθῆναι

“we believe ourselves to be saved”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who will do the action, it is clear from the context that it will be God. Alternate translation: [we believe that God will save us]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:11 (#1)

πιστεύομεν σωθῆναι

“we believe ourselves to be saved”

Peter is using a construction in which the object is implied. Since the object is the same as the subject of the verb, the construction calls for the relative pronoun **ourselves**. Your language may have its own way of expressing the same meaning. Alternate translation: [we believe that we will be saved]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 15:11 (#4)

διὰ τῆς χάριτος τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

“through the grace of the Lord Jesus”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [through what God has graciously done for us through the Lord Jesus]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 15:11 (#6)

καθ’ ὃν τρόπον κἀκεῖνοι

“according to the way they also”

Peter is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [according to the way they also will be saved]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 15:12 (#1)

σημεῖα καὶ τέρατα

“signs and wonders”

The terms **signs** and **wonders** mean similar things. Luke is using them together for emphasis. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:43. Alternate translation, as in UST: [great miracles]

See: Doublet

Acts 15:13 (#1)

ἀπεκρίθη Ἰάκωβος λέγων

“James answered, saying”

Together the words **answered** and **saying** mean that James responded to what everyone in the meeting had said to that point. Alternate translation: [James responded]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 15:13 (#2)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

“Men, brothers”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular group of people. Alternate translation: [My fellow believers]

See: Idiom

Acts 15:14 (#1)

Συμεὼν

“Simeon”

The word **Simeon** is the name of a man. It is the Hebrew form of the name whose Greek form is Simon. James is referring to Peter by his Hebrew name. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could use either the name Simon or the name Peter here in your translation.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 15:14 (#2)

ὁ Θεὸς ἐπεσκέψατο

“God & looked”

James is speaking of the way God showed concern for the Gentiles by association with the way someone would look carefully at a situation he was concerned about. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God concerned himself]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:14 (#3)

λαὸν τῷ ὀνόματι αὐτοῦ

“a people for his name”

This could mean: (1) that God chose the Gentiles for himself. James would be using the term **name** to refer to a person, God, by association with the way that each person has a name. Alternate translation: [a people who would belong to him]; (2) that God chose the Gentiles to worship him. James would be using the term **name** to refer to worship by association with the way that worshipers call upon the name of God. Alternate translation: [a people who would worship him]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:15 (#1)

οἱ λόγοι τῶν προφητῶν

“the words of the prophets”

James is using the term **words** to mean the message that God spoke through the prophets. (This is a quotation from the prophet Amos.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message of the prophets]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:15 (#2)

καθὼς γέγραπται

“as it is written”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [as one of the prophets wrote] or [as the prophet Amos wrote]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:16 (#5)

ἀνοικοδομήσω τὴν σκηνὴν Δαυεὶδ τὴν πεπτωκυῖαν, καὶ τὰ κατεστραμμένα αὐτῆς, ἀνοικοδομήσω καὶ ἀνορθώσω αὐτήν

“I will rebuild the fallen tent of David, and I will rebuild its ruins and restore it”

God is speaking of the royal dynasty of David as if it were a **tent** that had **fallen** down. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly.

Alternate translation: [I will restore the dynasty of David, which is no longer ruling over the people of Israel, yes, I will make one of David's descendants king again and restore his dynasty]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:16 (#6)

τὴν σκηνὴν Δαυεὶδ τὴν πεπτωκυῖαν

"the fallen tent of David"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the tent of David that has fallen]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:16 (#1)

μετὰ ταῦτα ἀναστρέψω

"After these things I will return"

See the discussion in the introduction to this chapter about whether to represent this as the beginning of a third-level quotation or a second-level quotation, or whether to use some other punctuation or convention that is available in your language to indicate who the various speakers are in verses 16–18.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 15:16 (#4)

ἀνοικοδομήσω τὴν σκηνὴν Δαυεὶδ τὴν πεπτωκυῖαν, καὶ τὰ κατεστραμμένα αὐτῆς, ἀνοικοδομήσω καὶ ἀνορθώσω αὐτήν

"I will rebuild the fallen tent of David, and I will rebuild its ruins and restore it"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. However, if the repetition might be confusing, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I will rebuild the fallen tent of David, yes, I will rebuild its ruins and restore it]

See: Parallelism

Acts 15:16 (#3)

ἀναστρέψω

"I will return"

God is speaking of showing favor to the Israelites once again as if he had gone somewhere else but will now **return**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will show favor to the Israelites once again]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:16 (#2)

ἀναστρέψω & ἀνοικοδομήσω & ἀνοικοδομήσω

"I will return & I will rebuild & I will rebuild"

The pronoun **I** refers to God, who is speaking through the prophet Amos. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [I, God, will return]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 15:17 (#4)

ἐφ' οὓς ἐπικέκληται τὸ ὄνομά μου ἐπ' αὐτούς

"upon whom my name has been called upon them"

It might seem that this phrase contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [upon whom my name has been called]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 15:17 (#3)

ἂν ἐκζητήσωσιν & τὸν Κύριον

"may seek the Lord"

God is speaking as if the Gentiles would literally **seek** or look for him. The expression means that the Gentiles will begin to worship God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [may begin to worship the Lord]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:17 (#1)

κατάλοιποι τῶν ἀνθρώπων

"remnant of men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, God is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. You may wish to indicate this in your translation. Alternate translation: [the remnant of humanity]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 15:17 (#6)

ἐφ᾽ οὓς ἐπικέκληται τὸ ὄνομά μου ἐπ᾽ αὐτούς

“upon whom my name has been called upon them”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:14. (1) Alternate translation: [who will belong to me]; (2) Alternate translation: [who will worship me]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:17 (#2)

ἂν ἐκζητήσωσιν & τὸν Κύριον

“may seek the Lord”

God is speaking about himself in the third person. Alternate translation: [may seek me, the Lord]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 15:17 (#5)

ἐφ᾽ οὓς ἐπικέκληται τὸ ὄνομά μου ἐπ᾽ αὐτούς

“upon whom my name has been called upon them”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom I have called by my name]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:18 (#1)

γνωστὰ

“known”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that people have known]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:19 (#2)

ἐπιστρέφουσιν ἐπὶ τὸν Θεόν

“turning to God”

James is speaking of these Gentiles as if they are physically **turning** to God. He means that they are believing in the true God and starting to live in a way that pleases him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning of this expression plainly. Alternate translation: [believing in God and obeying him]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:19 (#1)

μὴ παρενοχλεῖν τοῖς ἀπὸ τῶν ἐθνῶν, ἐπιστρέφουσιν ἐπὶ τὸν Θεόν

“not to trouble the ones from the Gentiles turning to God”

In your translation, you could make explicit in what way James does not want to **trouble** these **Gentiles**. Alternate translation: [that we should not require the Gentiles who are believing in God to be circumcised and obey the laws of Moses]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:20 (#5)

τοῦ πνικτοῦ, καὶ τοῦ αἵματος

“the strangled and blood”

God did not allow the Jews to consume blood in any form. Therefore, for one thing, they could not eat the meat from an animal that had been **strangled**, because the blood would not have been properly drained from the body of the animal. For another thing, while James is not saying that the Gentiles should have no contact at all with blood, he is saying implicitly that they should not consume blood. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [from eating the meat of animals that have been killed by strangulation, because this meat still contains blood, and from consuming blood]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:20 (#2)

τῶν ἀλισγημάτων τῶν εἰδώλων

“from the pollution of idols”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **pollution**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [from things that idols have polluted]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 15:20 (#1)

James lists four regulations in this verse and he gives the reason for them in the next verse. To put the reason before the result, you could create a verse bridge for verses 19–21. It might say something like this: “Therefore, I judge that we should not trouble the Gentiles who are turning to God. However, since Moses has had those proclaiming him in every city from ancient generations—he is read in the synagogues on

every Sabbath—we should write to the Gentiles to abstain from the pollution of idols and sexual immorality and strangled things and blood."

See: Verse Bridges

Acts 15:20 (#6)

καὶ τοῦ πνικτοῦ

"and the strangled"

James is using the adjective **strangled** as a noun to mean animals that have been killed by strangulation. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [animals that have been killed by strangulation]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 15:20 (#7)

τοῦ πνικτοῦ

"the strangled"

James is referring by association to meat from animals that have been killed by strangulation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from eating the meat of animals that have been killed by strangulation]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:20 (#3)

τῶν ἀλισγημάτων τῶν εἰδώλων

"from the pollution of idols"

If your language would not use a possessive form here, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [from things that idols have polluted]

See: Possession

Acts 15:20 (#4)

τῶν ἀλισγημάτων τῶν εἰδώλων

"from the pollution of idols"

James is likely talking about food that has been offered to **idols**, and he is speaking as if being offered to idols has polluted this food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from eating food that has been offered to idols]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:21 (#1)

Μωϋσῆς γὰρ ἐκ γενεῶν ἀρχαίων κατὰ πόλιν τοὺς κηρύσσοντας αὐτὸν, ἔχει ἐν ταῖς συναγωγαῖς κατὰ πᾶν Σάββατον ἀναγινωσκόμενος

"For Moses has by city, from ancient generations, ones proclaiming him, being read in the synagogues on every Sabbath"

James is saying implicitly that Gentile believers should observe at least the four regulations he has listed because they embody essential aspects of the law of Moses (not worshiping idols, not practicing sexual immorality, and respecting the blood of sacrifices), and the law of Moses is well known because it is read aloud regularly in the Jewish synagogues. If the Gentiles did not observe even these regulations, that would upset Jewish believers and make Jews who were not yet believers more hostile to Christianity. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand what James is saying. UST models one way to do this.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:21 (#2)

Μωϋσῆς & ἐκ γενεῶν ἀρχαίων κατὰ πόλιν τοὺς κηρύσσοντας αὐτὸν, ἔχει & ἀναγινωσκόμενος

"Moses has by city, from ancient generations, ones proclaiming him, being read"

James is using the name **Moses** to mean the law associated with Moses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people have been proclaiming the law of Moses by city from ancient generations; it is read]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:21 (#3)

ἀναγινωσκόμενος

"being read"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [People read him] or [People read from the law of Moses]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:21 (#4)

κατὰ πόλιν

"by city"

The expression **by city** means "in every city," and James implicitly means every city in which there are Jews. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [in every city in which there are Jews]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:22 (#4)

Ἰούδαν τὸν καλούμενον Βαρσαββᾶν

"Judas called Barsabbas"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Judas, whom people called Barsabbas]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:22 (#1)

ὅλῃ τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ

"the whole church"

Here the word **church** describes the people who were part of the church. Alternate translation: [all the people of the church]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:22 (#5)

τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς

"the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the members of the church]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:22 (#2)

ὅλῃ τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ

"the whole church"

Luke assumes that his readers will know that he is referring to the **church** in Jerusalem. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand this sentence. Alternate translation: [the church in Jerusalem] or [all the people of the church in Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:22 (#3)

Ἰούδαν τὸν καλούμενον Βαρσαββᾶν

"Judas called Barsabbas"

The words **Judas** and **Barsabbas** are the names of men. **Barsabbas** was another name by which **Judas** was known. **Barsabbas** is probably a patronymic, that is, an indication of who his father was. If your language and culture identify people by patronymics, it may be helpful to translate this name as "the son of Sabbas," as UST does. See how you translated this same name for another man in 1:23.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 15:23 (#4)

ἀδελφοὶ, τοῖς & ἀδελφοῖς

"brothers, to the brothers"

The apostles and elders are using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. By doing this, they are assuring the Gentile believers that they accept them as fellow believers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to our fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:23 (#1)

γράψαντες διὰ χειρὸς αὐτῶν

"writing by their hand"

Luke does not mean that the apostles and elders ask Judas and Silas to write out this letter for them. Rather, Luke is using the word **hand** to mean that Judas and Silas carried the letter and delivered it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [sending the following letter with them]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:23 (#3)

οἱ ἀπόστολοι καὶ οἱ πρεσβύτεροι, ἀδελφοὶ, τοῖς κατὰ τὴν Ἀντιόχειαν, καὶ Συρίαν, καὶ Κιλικίαν, ἀδελφοῖς τοῖς ἐξ ἐθνῶν, χαίρειν

"The apostles and the elders, brothers, to the brothers among the Gentiles throughout Antioch and Syria and Cilicia: Greetings"

This is the introduction of the letter. In the culture of this time, letter writers would give their own names first. Your language and culture may have its own way of introducing the author of a letter and saying to

whom it is written. Alternate translation: [This letter is from your brothers, the apostles and elders. We are writing to you Gentile believers in Antioch, Syria, and Cilicia. Greetings to you] or [To our Gentile brothers in Antioch, Syria, and Cilicia. Greetings from the apostles and elders, your brothers]

Acts 15:23 (#2)

χειρὸς αὐτῶν

"their hand"

Since Luke is referring to two people, it might be more natural in your language to use the dual or plural form here, as your language may require. Alternate translation: [their hands]

See: Forms of 'You' — Dual/Plural

Acts 15:24 (#2)

ἐξ ἡμῶν

"from us"

The apostles and elders seem to mean implicitly that these people have gone out from their community, but not from among themselves. That is, the word **some** refers to people who were part of the church in Jerusalem, but who were not apostles or elders. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [from our community] or [from here in Judea]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:24 (#4)

ἀνασκευάζοντες τὰς ψυχὰς ὑμῶν

"upsetting your souls"

The apostles and elders are using one part of the people to whom they are writing, their **souls**, to mean the people themselves. Alternate translation: [upsetting you]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 15:24 (#3)

λόγοις

"with words"

The apostles and elders are using the term **words** to mean what the people who have gone out from them have been teaching by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by what they have been teaching]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:24 (#1)

ἠκούσαμεν & ἡμῶν & οὐ διεστειλάμεθα

"we have heard & us & we did not commission"

Here and in the rest of the letter, by **we** and **us** (and "our"), the apostles and elders mean themselves and probably the rest of the church in Jerusalem, but not the Gentiles to whom they are writing, so use the exclusive forms of those words in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 15:26 (#3)

παραδεδωκόσι τὰς ψυχὰς αὐτῶν

"having handed over their souls"

The letter is speaking as if Paul and Barnabas have literally **handed over** their lives. This means that they have been willing to risk their lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [having put their lives at risk]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:26 (#4)

ὑπὲρ τοῦ ὀνόματος τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"for the name of our Lord Jesus Christ"

This is a figurative expression. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. This could mean: (1) that the **name** of Jesus represents his person. Alternate translation: [out of loyalty to our Lord Jesus Christ]; (2) that the **name** of Jesus represents his cause in the world. Alternate translation: [for the cause of our Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:26 (#2)

παραδεδωκόσι τὰς ψυχὰς αὐτῶν

"having handed over their souls"

The letter is using the term **souls** to mean the lives of Paul and Barnabas, by association with the way a living person has a soul. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [having handed over their lives]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:26 (#1)

ἀνθρώποις παραδεδωκόσι

“men having handed over”

By **men**, the letter implicitly means Paul and Barnabas. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Those two men have handed over]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:27 (#2)

διὰ λόγου

“by word”

The letter is using the term **word** to mean “by word of mouth,” that is, “in person.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:27 (#1)

ἀπαγγέλλοντας τὰ αὐτά

“reporting the same thing”

The letter is using the adjective **same** as a noun to mean the details of the decision that the apostles and elders have reached. ULT adds **thing** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [confirming that this is our decision]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 15:28 (#2)

μηδὲν πλέον ἐπιτίθεσθαι ὑμῖν βάρος

“for no greater burden to be laid upon you”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to lay no greater burden upon you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:28 (#1)

μηδὲν πλέον & βάρος

“no greater burden”

The letter is speaking of the restrictions it describes as if they were a physical **burden** that the Gentiles would need to carry. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [no greater obligation]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:29 (#2)

αἵματος

“blood”

See how you translated as **blood** in 15:20. Alternate translation: [consuming blood]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:29 (#4)

ἔρρωσθε

“Farewell”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a friendly wish rather than a command. This was the customary way of ending a letter in this culture. Your language may have its own way of ending a letter that you can use in your translation.

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 15:29 (#3)

πνικτῶν

“the strangled”

See how you translated as **the strangled** in 15:20. Alternate translation: [the meat of animals that have been killed by strangulation]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 15:29 (#1)

εἰδωλοθύτων

“from things sacrificed to idols”

The letter is using the adjective **sacrificed**, with the qualifier **to idols**, as a noun to mean the meat of animals that have been sacrificed to idols. (ULT adds **things** to show this.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the meat of animals that have been sacrificed to idols]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 15:30 (#1)

οἱ & ἀπολυθέντες, κατῆλθον

“they, having been dismissed & came down”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [once the apostles and elders had dismissed them, they came down]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:30 (#3)

κατῆλθον

“came down”

Luke says that these four men **came down** to Antioch because that city is lower in elevation than Judea. Alternate translation: [traveled]

See: Idiom

Acts 15:30 (#2)

οἱ

“they”

The pronoun **they** refers to Paul, Barnabas, Judas, and Silas. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul, Barnabas, Judas, and Silas]

See: Pronouns

Acts 15:30 (#4)

κατῆλθον

“came down”

You may wish to retain the idiom for travel to a lower elevation, and if so, your language might say “went” instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [went down]

See: Go and Come

Acts 15:30 (#5)

τὸ πλῆθος

“the crowd”

Luke assumes that his readers will know that by **the crowd**, he means the people of the church in Antioch. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand this sentence. Alternate translation: [the people of the church in Antioch]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:31 (#2)

ἐπὶ τῇ παρακλήσει

“at the encouragement”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **encouragement**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because they were so encouraged]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 15:31 (#1)

ἐχάρησαν

“they rejoiced”

The pronoun **they** refers to the believers in Antioch. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the believers in Antioch rejoiced]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 15:32 (#1)

καὶ αὐτοὶ προφῆται ὄντες

“also being prophets themselves”

When Luke says **also**, he means implicitly that Judas and Silas were prophets as Paul and Barnabas were 13:1. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [who were prophets as Paul and Barnabas were prophets]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:32 (#4)

ἐπεστήριξαν

“strengthened them”

Luke does not mean that Judas and Silas strengthened the believers physically but that they strengthened them spiritually. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [strengthened them in their faith]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:32 (#3)

διὰ λόγου πολλοῦ & καὶ ἐπεστήριξαν

“with many a word and strengthened them”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean a message of encouragement that Judas and Silas spoke to the believers in Antioch by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by speaking to them at length to strengthen them]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:32 (#2)

τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς

"the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:33 (#1)

ἀπελύθησαν μετ' εἰρήνης ἀπὸ τῶν ἀδελφῶν

"they were sent away with peace from the brothers"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the brothers sent them away with peace]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:33 (#3)

πρὸς τοὺς ἀποστείλαντας αὐτούς

"to the ones having sent them"

Luke is referring implicitly to the apostles and elders in Jerusalem, who had sent Judas and Silas to Antioch. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [back to the apostles and elders in Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 15:33 (#2)

τῶν ἀδελφῶν

"the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:34 (#1)

As the General Introduction to Acts explains, this verse is found in many traditional versions of the Bible, but it is not found in the most accurate ancient manuscripts of the Bible. ULT and UST indicate this by putting the verse in brackets. If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider including this verse if that translation does. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, we recommend that you indicate in some way that this verse may not be original, such as by putting it in brackets or in a footnote.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 15:35 (#3)

τοῦ Κυρίου

"of the Lord"

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [about the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 15:35 (#2)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Κυρίου

"the word of the Lord"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that God wanted the believers to share by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message of the Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:35 (#1)

δὲ

"But"

Luke uses the word **But** to introduce information about what happened once the church resolved the question about whether the Gentiles needed to obey all the laws of Moses. Your language may have its own way of indicating how such information relates to a story.

See: End of Story

Acts 15:36 (#2)

τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς

"the brothers"

Paul is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people who believed in Jesus]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:36 (#5)

πῶς ἔχουσιν

“how they are”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation, with no comma preceding: [to see how they are doing]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 15:36 (#4)

τοῦ Κυρίου

“of the Lord”

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [about the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 15:36 (#1)

ἡμέρας

“days”

Luke is using the term **days** to mean “time.” Alternate translation: [time]

See: Idiom

Acts 15:36 (#3)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Κυρίου

“the word of the Lord”

Paul is using the term **word** to mean the message that he and Barnabas shared by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message of the Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:38 (#1)

Παῦλος & ἠξίου & μὴ συνπαραλαμβάνειν τοῦτον

“Paul was thinking it wise not to take with them this”

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. Alternate translation: [Paul was thinking it would be foolish to take him with them]

See: Litotes

Acts 15:39 (#1)

ὥστε ἀποχωρισθῆναι αὐτοὺς ἀπ’ ἀλλήλων; τόν τε Βαρναβᾶν παραλαβόντα τὸν Μᾶρκον, ἐκπλεῦσαι εἰς Κύπρον

“so as for them to be separated from each other and for Barnabas, taking Mark with him, to sail away to Cyprus”

If your language does not use the passive form **to be separated**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that they separated from each other and Barnabas, taking Mark with him, sailed away to Cyprus]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:40 (#3)

τοῦ Κυρίου

“of the Lord”

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [of the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 15:40 (#1)

παραδοθεὶς & ὑπὸ τῶν ἀδελφῶν

“having been commended by the brothers”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [after the brothers had commended him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 15:40 (#2)

τῇ χάριτι

“to the grace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to the gracious care]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 15:41 (#4)

ἐπιστηρίζων τὰς ἐκκλησίας

“strengthening the churches”

Luke does not mean that Paul and Silas strengthened the people of the churches physically but that they strengthened them spiritually. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [strengthening the people of the churches in their faith]

See: Metaphor

Acts 15:41 (#2)

διήρχετο

"he was going through"

Luke says **he**, meaning Paul, to refer both to Paul and to Silas, who was traveling with him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they went through] or [Paul and Silas went through]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 15:41 (#3)

ἐπιστηρίζων τὰς ἐκκλησίας

"strengthening the churches"

Luke is using the term **churches** to refer to the people associated with the churches. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [strengthening the people of the churches]

See: Metonymy

Acts 15:41 (#1)

διήρχετο

"he was going through"

The pronoun **he** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul was going through]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts - Chapter 16 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

- Verses 1–5 describe how Paul began his second missionary journey and met Timothy and brought him along with him.
- Verses 6–12 describe how the Holy Spirit led Paul and his companions to share the gospel in the city of Philippi
- Verses 13–40 describe how Paul and Silas made disciples in Philippi, delivered a young woman from an evil spirit, and were imprisoned but miraculously released. Acts 16:5 is a summary statement that Luke uses to mark the transition into the fourth major part of the book.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Timothy's circumcision
Paul circumcised Timothy because he and Silas were telling the message of Jesus to Jews as well as to Gentiles. Many Jews would have been so offended that Timothy was not circumcised, even though his mother was Jewish, that they would not have listened to the message. Paul felt that he could have Timothy circumcised as a discretionary matter to remove an offense to hearing the gospel, even though the church leaders in Jerusalem had decided that Gentile believers did not have to be circumcised.

Acts 16:1 (#1)

κατήντησεν & καὶ

"he also came down"

Luke says **he**, meaning Paul, to refer both to Paul and to Silas, who was traveling with him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Paul and Silas also came down]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 16:1 (#6)

ἐκεῖ

"there"

By **there**, Luke means the city of Lystra. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [in Lystra]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:1 (#4)

ἰδοὺ

"behold"

Luke is using the term **behold** to focus readers' attention on the new character he is about to introduce. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation.

See: Metaphor

Acts 16:1 (#5)

μαθητής τις ἦν ἐκεῖ ὀνόματι Τιμόθεος, υἱὸς γυναικὸς Ἰουδαίας πιστῆς, πατρὸς δὲ Ἕλληνος

"a certain disciple was there, Timothy by name, the son of a believing Jewish woman but of a father, a Greek"

Luke is using the phrase **a certain disciple** to introduce **Timothy** as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [there was a disciple there named Timothy]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 16:1 (#3)

κατήντησεν & καὶ

"he also came down"

If you retain the idiom, it may be more natural in your language to say "went" rather than **came**. Alternate translation: [he also went down]

See: Go and Come

Acts 16:1 (#8)

πατρὸς δὲ Ἕλληνος

"but of a father, a Greek"

Luke is describing Timothy's father in an idiomatic way. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular kind of person. Alternate translation: [but whose father was Greek]

See: Idiom

Acts 16:1 (#2)

κατήντησεν & καὶ

"he also came down"

Luke says that Paul **came down** to Derbe and Lystra because that was the customary way in this culture of describing a person arriving somewhere after traveling by sea. Paul likely travel by sea from Syria to Cilicia, and Luke is saying that he then also went to Derbe and to Lystra. Alternate translation: [he also traveled]

See: Idiom

Acts 16:1 (#7)

γυναικὸς Ἰουδαίας πιστῆς

"of a believing Jewish woman"

By **believing**, Luke means believing in Jesus. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [a Jewish woman who believed in Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:2 (#1)

ὃς ἐμαρτυρεῖτο ὑπὸ τῶν ἐν Λύστροις καὶ Ἰκονίῳ ἀδελφῶν

"who was being well attested by the brothers in Lystra and Iconium"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [The brothers in Lystra and Iconium spoke well of him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:2 (#2)

ὑπὸ τῶν & ἀδελφῶν

"by the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 16:3 (#1)

περιέτεμεν αὐτὸν

"he circumcised him"

It is possible that Paul himself **circumcised** Timothy, but it is more likely that he had someone else circumcise him. You can include that information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [he had him circumcised]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:3 (#5)

ᾔδεισαν & ἅπαντες

"they all knew"

Luke says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [they knew very well]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 16:3 (#3)

διὰ τοὺς Ἰουδαίους τοὺς ὄντας ἐν τοῖς τόποις ἐκείνοις

“because of the Jews being in those places”

By **those places**, Luke means the areas where Paul and Timothy would be traveling. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [in the areas where Paul and Timothy would be traveling]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:3 (#4)

ᾔδεισαν γὰρ ἅπαντες, ὅτι Ἕλλην ὁ πατὴρ αὐτοῦ ὑπῆρχεν

“for they all knew that his father was a Greek”

Luke assumes that his readers will know that **Greek** men did not have their sons circumcised, and so the Jews would have known that Timothy had not been circumcised. As a result, they would have rejected Paul and Timothy before hearing their message about Christ. See the discussion of this in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [for they all knew that his father was a Greek and that he therefore had not been circumcised]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:3 (#2)

τοῦτον

“this one”

The demonstrative pronoun **this one** refers to Timothy. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Timothy]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 16:4 (#3)

τὰ κεκριμένα ὑπὸ τῶν ἀποστόλων καὶ πρεσβυτέρων τῶν ἐν Ἰεροσολύμοις

“that had been decided by the apostles and elders in Jerusalem”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that the apostles and elders in Jerusalem had decided]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:4 (#1)

διεπορεύοντο & παρεδίδοσαν αὐτοῖς

“they were going through & they were delivering to them”

The pronoun **they** refers to Paul, Silas, and Timothy, and the pronoun **them** refers to the believers in the cities they were visiting. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul, Silas, and Timothy were going ... they were delivering to the believers in those cities]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 16:4 (#2)

αὐτοῖς φυλάσσειν

“to them to keep”

Luke is writing in a compact way. You can explain his meaning more fully if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the believers the decrees that had been decided by the apostles and elders in Jerusalem, and they were instructing the believers to keep]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 16:5 (#1)

αἱ & ἐκκλησίαι ἐστερεοῦντο τῇ πίστει

“the churches were being strengthened in the faith”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, it is clear from the context that it was Paul, Silas, and Timothy. Alternate translation: [Paul, Silas, and Timothy were strengthening the churches in the faith]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:6 (#6)

τὸν λόγον

“the word”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that God wanted the believers to share by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:6 (#1)

διῆλθον & τὴν Φρυγίαν καὶ Γαλατικὴν χώραν, κωλυθέντες ὑπὸ τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος λαλῆσαι τὸν λόγον ἐν τῇ Ἀσίᾳ

"they went through Phrygia and the Galatian region, having been forbidden by the Holy Spirit to speak the word in Asia"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [having been forbidden by the Holy Spirit to speak the word in Asia, they went through Phrygia and the Galatian region]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 16:6 (#2)

τὴν Φρυγίαν & Γαλατικὴν χώραν & τῇ Ἀσίᾳ

"Phrygia & the Galatian region & Asia"

The word **Phrygia** is the name of a region in northwestern Asia Minor. See how you translated this name in 2:10. The word **Galatian** describes the region of Galatia in central Asia Minor. The word **Asia** is the name of a Roman province in western Asia Minor.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 16:6 (#4)

κωλυθέντες ὑπὸ τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος

"having been forbidden by the Holy Spirit"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [because the Holy Spirit had forbidden them] or [because the Holy Spirit did not permit them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:6 (#5)

κωλυθέντες ὑπὸ τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος

"having been forbidden by the Holy Spirit"

Since Luke explains shortly after this that the Holy Spirit actually wanted Paul, Silas, and Timothy to share the good news about Jesus in two other regions, you do not need to explain here why the Holy Spirit forbade them to share the good news at this time in the province of Asia.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Acts 16:6 (#3)

τὴν Φρυγίαν καὶ Γαλατικὴν χώραν

"Phrygia and the Galatian region"

Paul, Silas, and Timothy actually had to go through Galatia in order to reach Phrygia, so it might be more natural to put the information about Galatia first. Alternate translation: [the Galatian region and Phrygia]

See: Order of Events

Acts 16:7 (#2)

τὸ Πνεῦμα Ἰησοῦ

"the Spirit of Jesus"

Luke assumes that his readers will know that by **the Spirit of Jesus**, he means the Holy Spirit. You can use that name instead if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the Holy Spirit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:7 (#1)

τὴν Μυσίαν & τὴν Βιθυνίαν

"Mysia & Bithynia"

The words **Mysia** and **Bithynia** are the names of two more regions in Asia Minor.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 16:8 (#1)

κατέβησαν

"they came down"

Luke says that Paul, Silas, and Timothy **came down** to Troas because that city is lower in elevation than Mysia. Alternate translation: [they traveled]

See: Idiom

Acts 16:8 (#2)

κατέβησαν

"they came down"

In a context such as this, if you retain the idiom, your language might say "went" instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [they went down]

See: Go and Come

Acts 16:9 (#1)

διαβὰς

"Coming over"

The man in the vision uses the phrase **coming over** because **Macedonia** is across the sea from Troas. Alternate translation: [across the sea]

See: Idiom

Acts 16:9 (#2)

ἀνὴρ Μακεδών τις

“A man, a certain Macedonian”

Luke is describing this man in an idiomatic way. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular kind of person. Alternate translation: [A certain man of Macedonia]

See: Idiom

Acts 16:10 (#2)

ἐζητήσαμεν & προσκέκληται ἡμᾶς ὁ Θεὸς

“we sought & God had summoned us”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that he says **we** and **us** because he joined Paul and his other companions at this point in the story. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand what is happening. UST models a way to do this.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:10 (#4)

αὐτούς

“to them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the people of Macedonia. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to the people of Macedonia]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 16:10 (#3)

ἐζητήσαμεν & προσκέκληται ἡμᾶς ὁ Θεὸς

“we sought & God had summoned us”

Luke is using the pronouns **we** and **us** to refer to himself and his traveling companions, but not to his readers, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 16:10 (#1)

εἶδεν

“he had seen”

The pronoun **he** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul had seen]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 16:11 (#2)

τῇ δὲ ἐπιούσῃ εἰς Νέαν Πόλιν

“and the next day to Neapolis”

Luke is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the next day we sailed to Neapolis]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 16:11 (#1)

Σαμοθρᾴκην & Νέαν Πόλιν

“Samothrace & Neapolis”

The word **Samothrace** is the name of an island, and the word **Neapolis** is the name of a city.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 16:12 (#1)

κἀκεῖθεν εἰς Φιλίππους

“and from there to Philippi”

Luke is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and from there we traveled overland to Philippi]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 16:12 (#3)

κολωνία

“a colony”

In the Roman empire, a **colony** was a city outside of Italy where many people who came from Rome lived. The people there had the same rights and freedoms as people who lived in cities in Italy. They could govern themselves and they did not have to pay taxes. This information will become important later in the story. Alternate translation: [a Roman colony, where Roman citizens had special rights]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:12 (#2)

κολωνία

“a colony”

Luke assumes that his readers will know that by **colony** he means a Roman colony. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand this sentence. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Philippi is a Roman colony]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:14 (#2)

Λυδία

“Lydia”

The word **Lydia** is the name of a woman.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 16:14 (#1)

τις γυνὴ ὀνόματι Λυδία & ἤκουεν

“a certain woman, Lydia by name & was listening”

Luke is using the phrase **a certain woman** to introduce **Lydia** as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [there was a woman named Lydia ... who was listening]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 16:14 (#8)

τοῖς λαλουμένοις ὑπὸ τοῦ Παύλου

“to the things being said by Paul”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the things that Paul was saying]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:14 (#4)

Θυατείρων

“of Thyatira”

The word **Thyatira** is the name of a city.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 16:14 (#5)

σεβομένη τὸν Θεόν

“worshiping God”

Here the expression **worshiping God** means the same thing as the expression “fearing God,” which Jews in the time of the New Testament used to describe Gentiles (non-Jews) who worshiped the God of Israel and attended the synagogue. See how you translated “fearing God” in 10:2. Alternate translation: [a Gentile who sincerely worshiped the God of Israel]

See: Idiom

Acts 16:14 (#3)

πορφυρόπωλις

“a seller of purple”

Luke is using the color of **purple** cloth to mean the cloth itself by association. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a seller of purple cloth]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:14 (#7)

ἧς ὁ Κύριος διήνοιξεν τὴν καρδίαν

“whose heart the Lord opened”

Here, the **heart** represents a person’s will and disposition. Alternate translation: [whom the Lord made disposed]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:14 (#6)

ἧς ὁ Κύριος διήνοιξεν τὴν καρδίαν

“whose heart the Lord opened”

Luke is speaking as if the Lord physically **opened** Lydia’s heart to receive the message that Paul was sharing. Alternate translation: [whom the Lord made disposed]

See: Metaphor

Acts 16:15 (#6)

τῷ Κυρίῳ

“to the Lord”

Lydia is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [to the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 16:15 (#2)

ὡς δὲ ἐβαπτίσθη

“And when she was baptized”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, it is likely from the context that it was Paul. Alternate translation: [when Paul baptized her]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:15 (#5)

κεκρίκατέ

“you have judged”

The word **you** is plural here. Lydia is addressing Paul and his companions. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Acts 16:15 (#8)

ἡμᾶς

“us”

Luke is using the pronoun **us** to refer to himself and his traveling companions, but not to his readers, so use the exclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 16:15 (#4)

ὁ οἶκος αὐτῆς

“her household”

Here, **her household** refers to all the people who lived in Lydia’s house. Alternate translation: [the members of her household] or [her family and household servants]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:15 (#7)

εἰσελθόντες εἰς τὸν οἶκόν μου, μένετε

“entering into my house, stay”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please come to my house and stay with me as my guests]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 16:15 (#3)

καὶ ὁ οἶκος αὐτῆς

“and her household”

Luke is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and her household was also baptized]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 16:15 (#1)

ὡς & ἐβαπτίσθη

“when she was baptized”

The implication is that Lydia believed in Jesus and then was baptized. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [when she believed in Jesus and was baptized]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:16 (#1)

ἐγένετο δὲ

“And it happened that”

Luke is using this phrase to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 16:16 (#4)

Πύθωνα

“Python”

The word **Python** is the name of a pagan god. However, Luke is using the name here by association to mean a demonic spirit of divination.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 16:16 (#3)

πνεῦμα Πύθωνα

“a Python spirit”

Luke is describing the **spirit** that enabled this woman to tell fortunes by association with the Pythian serpent that the ancient Greeks believed to have guarded the oracle at Delphi. This was not an actual god named

Python; it was a demonic spirit. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a spirit of divination] or [a demonic spirit that enabled her to tell fortunes]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:16 (#2)

παιδίσκην τινὰ ἔχουσαν πνεῦμα Πύθωνα, ὑπαντῆσαι ἡμῖν

"a certain young female slave having a Python spirit met us"

Luke is using the phrase **a certain young female slave** to introduce this woman as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [there was a certain young female slave who had a Python spirit and who met us]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 16:17 (#1)

ὁδὸν σωτηρίας

"the way of salvation"

This woman is speaking as if **salvation** were a **way** or path that people walked on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [how you can receive salvation]

See: Metaphor

Acts 16:17 (#2)

ὁδὸν σωτηρίας

"the way of salvation"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation, as in UST: [how God can save you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 16:18 (#2)

ἐν ὀνόματι Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"in the name of Jesus Christ"

Here the **name** of Jesus represents his authority. Alternate translation: [by the authority of Jesus Christ]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:18 (#1)

διαπονηθεὶς δὲ Παῦλος, καὶ ἐπιστρέψας & εἶπεν

"But Paul, having become annoyed and having turned, said"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [she greatly annoyed Paul, so he turned and said]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:18 (#3)

ἐξῆλθεν αὐτῇ τῇ ὥρᾳ

"it came out in the same hour"

In the ancient world, an **hour** was the shortest time span that people envisioned. In this context, the term does not mean a literal hour of 60 minutes; it means the shortest time imaginable. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it came out that instant]

See: Idiom

Acts 16:19 (#3)

ἐπὶ τοὺς ἄρχοντας

"to the rulers"

The implication is that the masters of the young female slave brought Paul and Silas **to the rulers** in order to charge them with a crime and have them punished. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the rulers so that they would judge and punish them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:19 (#1)

ἐξῆλθεν ἡ ἐλπὶς τῆς ἐργασίας αὐτῶν

"their hope of profit had gone"

The implication is that the **masters** could no longer **profit** from the woman because she could no longer tell fortunes. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [their hope of profit had gone because their young female slave could no longer tell fortunes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:19 (#2)

εἰς τὴν ἀγορὰν

"into the marketplace"

The **marketplace** was a public area for business where the buying and selling of goods and services took place. If you have a term in your language for such an area, you could use it in your translation. Alternate translation: [into the public square]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 16:20 (#1)

ἡμῶν τὴν πόλιν

“our city”

The masters of the slave girl are referring to the people of the city by association with the city itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of our city]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:20 (#2)

οὗτοι οἱ ἄνθρωποι ἐκταράσσουσιν ἡμῶν τὴν πόλιν

“These men are greatly troubling our city”

The masters of the slave girl are using the pronoun **our** to refer to themselves and to their listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 16:21 (#1)

παραδέχεσθαι οὐδὲ ποιεῖν

“to accept nor to practice”

The terms **accept** and **practice** mean similar things. The crowd in Philippi is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [practice at all]

See: Doublet

Acts 16:22 (#1)

συνεπέστη ὁ ὄχλος

“the crowd rose up together”

Luke is speaking as if the crowd in Philippi literally **rose up** against Paul and Silas. He means that the people in the crowd became hostile to them and began shouting their own accusations against them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the crowd became hostile and shouted further accusations]

See: Metaphor

Acts 16:22 (#2)

αὐτῶν & αὐτῶν & ἐκέλευον

“them & their & commanded them”

The pronouns **them** and **their** refer to Paul and Silas. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul and Silas ... their ... commanded Paul and Silas]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 16:22 (#3)

ἐκέλευον ῥαβδίζειν

“commanded them to be beaten with rods”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [commanded soldiers to beat them with rods]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:23 (#2)

ἔβαλον εἰς φυλακήν

“they threw them into prison”

Luke is speaking when he says that the rulers **threw them into prison**. They did not pick up Paul and Silas and heave them through the air. Alternate translation: [they confined Paul and Silas in prison]

See: Metaphor

Acts 16:23 (#1)

πολλάς & ἐπιθέντες αὐτοῖς πληγὰς

“having laid many blows upon them”

This is an idiomatic expression. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [having hit them many times with the rods]

See: Idiom

Acts 16:24 (#1)

ξύλον

“stocks”

The word **stocks** describes a wooden frame with holes to hold a person’s feet and prevent them from moving. UST models a good way of describing **stocks** for readers who are not familiar with them.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 16:24 (#2)

ἔβαλεν αὐτοὺς εἰς τὴν ἐσωτέραν φυλακὴν

“threw them into the inner prison”

Luke is speaking when he says that the jailer **threw them into the inner prison**. He did not pick up Paul and Silas and heave them through the air. Alternate translation: [confined Paul and Silas to the inner prison]

See: Metaphor

Acts 16:26 (#1)

σεισμὸς ἐγένετο μέγας, ὥστε σαλευθῆναι τὰ θεμέλια τοῦ δεσμωτηρίου

“a great earthquake happened, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a severe earthquake shook the foundations of the prison]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:26 (#5)

πάντων

“of all”

Luke assumes that his readers will know that by **all** he means all the prisoners. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand this sentence. Alternate translation: [all the prisoners]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:26 (#2)

σαλευθῆναι τὰ θεμέλια τοῦ δεσμωτηρίου

“the foundations of the prison were shaken”

Luke is using one part of the prison, its **foundations**, to refer to the entire prison in the state of being **shaken**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a shaking that began in the prison’s foundations shook the entire prison]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 16:26 (#4)

πάντων τὰ δεσμὰ ἀνέθη

“the chains of all were unfastened”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the chains of all came loose]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:26 (#3)

ἠνεῴχθησαν & αἱ θύραι πᾶσαι

“all the doors were opened”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [all the doors opened]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:27 (#1)

ἤμελλεν ἑαυτὸν ἀναιρεῖν, νομίζων ἐκπεφευγέναι τοὺς δεσμίους

“he was about to kill himself, thinking the prisoners to have escaped”

Luke assumes that his readers will know that death was the punishment in the Roman Empire for allowing prisoners to escape. The jailer thought his prisoners had escaped, and he preferred to commit suicide rather than face trial and execution. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand this sentence. Alternate translation: [he was about to kill himself, because he thought that his prisoners had escaped and he knew that he would be tried and executed for allowing them to escape]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:27 (#2)

ἀνεῳγμένας τὰς θύρας τῆς φυλακῆς

“the prison doors having been opened”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that the prison doors were open]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:28 (#2)

μηδὲν πράξῃς σεαυτῷ κακόν

“Do not do harm to yourself”

This is an imperative, but it communicates an urgent request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates such a request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please do not hurt yourself]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 16:28 (#1)

ἐσμεν

"we are"

By **we**, Paul means himself and the other prisoners but not the jailer, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 16:29 (#1)

αἰτήσας & φῶτα

"having called for lights"

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that the jailer **called for lights** because it was midnight and dark, and he wanted to be sure that his prisoners were still in the prison. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand this sentence. UST models a way to do this.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:29 (#2)

προσέπεσεν τῷ Παύλῳ καὶ Σιλᾷ

"he fell down to Paul and Silas"

Be sure that it is clear in your translation that the jailer did not fall down accidentally. He knelt down at the feet of Paul and Silas as a gesture to honor them. Alternate translation: [he knelt down respectfully in front of Paul and Silas]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 16:30 (#1)

ἵνα σωθῶ

"in order to be saved"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in order for God to save me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:31 (#3)

σωθήσῃ

"you will be saved"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God will save you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:31 (#1)

οἱ

"they"

The pronoun **they** refers to Paul and Silas. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul and Silas]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 16:31 (#4)

ὁ οἶκός σου

"your household"

Here, **your household** refers to all the people who lived in the jailer's house. Alternate translation: [all the members of your household] or [your family]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:31 (#2)

πίστευσον ἐπὶ τὸν Κύριον Ἰησοῦν καὶ σωθήσῃ

"Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved"

This is an imperative, but it communicates an encouraging invitation rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates such an invitation. Alternate translation: [If you believe in the Lord Jesus, you will be saved]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 16:32 (#2)

τοῦ Κυρίου

"of the Lord"

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [about the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 16:32 (#1)

τὸν λόγον

“the word”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that Paul and Silas had come to Philippi to share by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:33 (#2)

ἐβαπτίσθη

“he was baptized”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, the context suggests that it was Paul and Silas who baptized the jailer and his family. Alternate translation: [Paul and Silas baptized him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 16:33 (#1)

ἐν ἐκείνῃ τῇ ὥρᾳ τῆς νυκτὸς

“at that hour of the night”

Luke is using the term **hour** to mean a particular time. Alternate translation: [at that time in the night]

See: Idiom

Acts 16:34 (#1)

παρέθηκεν τράπεζαν

“he set a table before them”

Luke is referring to a meal by association with the way, in this culture, a meal was served at a **table**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he set a meal before them] or [he served them a meal]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:35 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a significant development in this story. Here Luke tells the last part of the story that started in 16:16. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development in a story.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 16:36 (#1)

τοὺς λόγους

“the words”

Luke is using the term **words** to mean the message that the officers whom the magistrates sent communicated by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:36 (#2)

ἐξελθόντες, πορεύεσθε ἐν εἰρήνῃ

“coming out, go in peace”

The word **go** is an imperative, but it communicates permission rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates permission. Alternate translation: [you may come out of the jail and go in peace]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 16:36 (#3)

πορεύεσθε ἐν εἰρήνῃ

“go in peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [go peacefully] or [go without being concerned that the authorities will trouble you any further]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 16:37 (#1)

πρὸς αὐτούς

“to them”

The implication is that the officers whom the magistrates sent had come into the prison with the jailer. That is why Luke says **them** and not just **him**, meaning the jailer. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the officers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:37 (#2)

αὐτούς & ἔβαλαν & ἡμᾶς ἐκβάλλουσιν & ἡμᾶς ἐξαγαγέτωσαν

“them & they threw us & they cast us out & let them lead us out”

The first instance of the pronoun **them** refers to the officers whom the magistrates sent to the prison, and the pronoun **they** and the second instance of the pronoun **them** refer to the magistrates. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the officers ... the magistrates threw us ... they cast us out ... let the magistrates lead us out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 16:37 (#5)

δείραντες ἡμᾶς δημοσίᾳ

"Having beaten us in public"

The magistrates did not do this themselves. They ordered soldiers to do it. Paul is speaking of the magistrates, some of the people who were involved in this action, to mean everyone who was involved. Alternate translation: [having ordered their soldiers to beat us in public]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:37 (#6)

οὔ γάρ

"For not"

Paul is using an expression that leaves out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [No, for they will not do that]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 16:37 (#3)

ἡμᾶς & ἔβαλαν & ἡμᾶς & ἡμᾶς

"us & they threw us & us & us"

By **us**, Paul means himself and Silas but not the officers to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 16:37 (#9)

ἡμᾶς ἐξαγαγέτωσαν

"let them lead us out"

It is likely that Paul wanted the magistrates to bring him and Silas out of prison, which would effectively be an apology for mistreatment, so that the believers in Philippi would have the protection of the law even after Paul and his companions left the city. However, this is more a matter of interpretation than of implied information, so it would probably be best not to put an explanation of it in your translation. You can leave it to teachers and preachers of the Bible to explain.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Acts 16:37 (#4)

δείραντες ἡμᾶς δημοσίᾳ, ἀκατακρίτους ἀνθρώπους Ῥωμαίους ὑπάρχοντας, ἔβαλαν εἰς φυλακήν καὶ νῦν λάθρᾳ ἡμᾶς ἐκβάλλουσιν

"Having beaten us in public without trial, men being Romans, they threw us into prison, and now they cast us out secretly"

Paul is using the question form to protest that what the magistrates want to do is not just or fair. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The magistrates beat us in public without trial, men being Romans, and then they threw us into prison; I will not allow them, after doing that, to cast us out secretly!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 16:37 (#7)

ἐλθόντες αὐτοὶ, ἡμᾶς ἐξαγαγέτωσαν

"coming themselves, let them lead us out"

Paul is using the reflexive pronoun **themselves** for emphasis. It may be more natural in your language to express this emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [let them come in person and lead us out]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 16:37 (#8)

ἡμᾶς ἐξαγαγέτωσαν

"let them lead us out"

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may they lead us out] or [they should lead us out]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 16:38 (#1)

τὰ ῥήματα ταῦτα

"these words"

Luke is using the term **words** to mean what Paul said to the officers by using words. If it would be helpful

in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what Paul had said]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:38 (#3)

ἐφοβήθησαν & ἀκούσαντες ὅτι Ῥωμαῖοί εἰσιν

"they were terrified, hearing that they were Romans"

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [they were terrified when they heard, "They are Romans!"]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 16:38 (#2)

ἐφοβήθησαν & ἀκούσαντες ὅτι Ῥωμαῖοί εἰσιν

"they were terrified, hearing that they were Romans"

Roman citizenship provided freedom from torture and the right to a fair trial. So the implication is that the magistrates were **terrified** that more important Roman authorities might learn how they had mistreated Paul and Silas. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [they were terrified when they heard that they were Roman citizens, because as magistrates they were supposed to make sure that citizens were not tortured and received fair trials, and they were concerned that more important authorities would punish them for the way they had treated Paul and Silas]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:39 (#1)

παρεκάλεσαν αὐτούς & ἐξαγαγόντες, ἠρώτων

"they entreated them & bringing them out, they were asking them"

The pronoun **they** refers to the magistrates, and the pronoun **them** refers to Paul and Silas. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the magistrates entreated Paul and Silas ... bringing them out, the magistrates were asking Paul and Silas]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 16:39 (#2)

παρεκάλεσαν αὐτούς

"they entreated them"

Luke means implicitly that the magistrates **entreated** or begged Paul and Silas not to make any protest about how they had been treated. In effect, they apologized to them and asked them to overlook the offense. Alternate translation: [they apologized to them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:40 (#6)

καὶ ἐξῆλθαν

"and went out"

Since Luke says **they ... went out**, not "we went out," the implication is that Luke remained in Philippi for a time, likely to strengthen and encourage the new believers there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. UST models one way to do this.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 16:40 (#3)

εἰσῆλθον

"they came"

In a context such as this, your language might say "went" instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [they went]

See: Go and Come

Acts 16:40 (#1)

δὲ

"So"

Luke uses the word **So** to introduce information about what happened at the end of the story of the imprisonment of Paul and Silas. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

Acts 16:40 (#5)

καὶ ἐξῆλθαν

"and went out"

Luke says that **they ... went out**, meaning Paul and Silas, to refer to those two men and to Timothy, who was still traveling with them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and then Paul and Silas and Timothy left Philippi]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 16:40 (#2)

τὴν Λυδίαν

"Lydia"

Luke is referring to the house of **Lydia** by association with the name of the woman who lived there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they came to the house of Lydia]

See: Metonymy

Acts 16:40 (#4)

τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς

"the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts - Chapter 17 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

- Verses 1–9 describe how Paul, Silas, and Timothy proclaimed the gospel in the city of Thessalonica.
- Verses 10–14 describe how Paul, Silas, and Timothy proclaimed the gospel in the city of Berea.

Verses 15–34 describe how Paul proclaimed the gospel in the city of Athens.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The religion of Athens
Paul said that the people in the city of Athens were "religious," but this did not mean that they worshiped the true God. They worshiped many different false gods. In the past they had conquered other peoples, and they had begun to worship the gods of the peoples they had conquered. (See: god, false god, goddess, idol, idolater, idolatrous, idolatry)

As Paul spoke to the philosophers in Athens, he told the message of Christ for the first time to people who knew nothing of the Old Testament.

Acts 17:1 (#2)

τὴν Ἀμφίπολιν καὶ τὴν Ἀπολλωνίαν

"Amphipolis and Apollonia"

The words **Amphipolis** and **Apollonia** are the names of coastal cities in the Roman province of Macedonia.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 17:1 (#3)

συναγωγὴ τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"a synagogue of the Jews"

It might seem that the expression **a synagogue of the Jews** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [a synagogue]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 17:1 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 17:2 (#1)

αὐτοὺς & αὐτοῖς

"them & with them"

The pronoun **them** refers the Jews who attended the synagogue in Thessalonica. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Jews in the synagogue]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 17:3 (#2)

διανοίγων

"fully opening them"

Luke is speaking as if Paul had been literally **opening** the Scriptures **fully**, as by unrolling a scroll, so that the Jews in the synagogue could understand them. Luke means that Paul was explaining the Scriptures thoroughly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [explaining them thoroughly]

See: Metaphor

Acts 17:3 (#1)

διανοίγων καὶ παρατιθέμενος

"fully opening them and demonstrating"

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two expressions connected with **and**. The phrase **fully opening them** tells how Paul was **demonstrating** from the Scriptures that Jesus is the Messiah. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use "and." Alternate translation: [by opening the Scriptures fully, demonstrating]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 17:3 (#4)

ἐκ νεκρῶν

"from the dead"

Luke is using the adjective **dead** as a noun. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [from among those who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 17:3 (#3)

ἀναστῆναι

"to rise"

Luke is using the word **rise** to mean that Jesus came back to life again after he died. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to come back to life]

See: Idiom

Acts 17:4 (#1)

τινες ἐξ αὐτῶν ἐπείσθησαν

"some from them were persuaded"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [some of the Jews believed] or [some of the Jews understood]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 17:4 (#3)

οὐκ ὀλίγαι

"not a few"

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. Alternate translation: [many]

See: Litotes

Acts 17:4 (#2)

τῶν & σεβομένων Ἑλλήνων

"of worshiping Greeks"

Here the expression **worshiping Greeks** describes Gentiles (non-Jews) who worshiped the God of Israel and attended the synagogue. See how you translated the expression in 16:14. Alternate translation: [Greeks who sincerely worshiped the God of Israel]

See: Idiom

Acts 17:5 (#6)

αὐτοὺς

"them"

The pronoun **them** refers to Paul and Silas. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul and Silas]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 17:5 (#2)

τῶν ἀγοραίων

"from the marketplace"

The **marketplace** was a public area for business where the buying and selling of goods and services took place. See how you translated this term in 16:20.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 17:5 (#4)

Ἰάσονος

"of Jason"

Luke does not tell us anything further about this **Jason**, but the implication is that the Jewish leaders believed that Paul and Silas were staying in his home. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [of Jason, where they believed Paul and Silas were staying,]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 17:5 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"the Jews"

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to one part of that group, its leaders. Alternate translation: [the leaders of the Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 17:5 (#3)

τὴν πόλιν

“the city”

The word **city** represents the people of the city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of the city]

See: Metonymy

Acts 17:5 (#5)

Ἰάσονος

“of Jason”

The word **Jason** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 17:6 (#1)

τινας ἀδελφοὺς

“certain brothers”

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [some other believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 17:6 (#2)

οἱ τὴν οἰκουμένην ἀναστατώσαντες

“The ones having turned the world upside down”

The Jewish leaders are exaggerating the influence of Paul and Silas and their teaching. Alternate translation: [These men who have caused trouble wherever they have gone]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 17:8 (#1)

ἐτάραξαν

“they agitated”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Jewish leaders in Thessalonica. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Jewish leaders]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 17:9 (#2)

ἀπέλυσαν αὐτούς

“they released them”

The pronoun **they** refers to the city officials, and the pronoun **them** refers to Jason and the other believers. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the city officials released them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 17:9 (#1)

τὸ ἱκανὸν

“a bond”

A **bond** was an amount of money that the city officials required Jason and the rest of the believers to pay as a guarantee of good behavior. The city officials would return the money if those men did not cause any further trouble. Your language and culture may have a term that you can use in your translation for this kind of monetary guarantee.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 17:10 (#1)

οἱ & ἀδελφοὶ

“the brothers”

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 17:10 (#2)

τὴν συναγωγὴν τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“the synagogue of the Jews”

It might seem that the expression **the synagogue of the Jews** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [the synagogue]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 17:11 (#6)

ταῦτα

“these things”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that Paul was showing the Bereans from the Scriptures that Jesus was the Messiah, just as Paul did for the Thessalonians. You can include this information if that

would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the things that Paul was teaching about Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 17:11 (#3)

εὐγενέστεροι

"more noble than"

Luke is using the word **noble**, which literally describes a person of a certain lineage, to mean the gracious behavior that should characterize people of that lineage. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [more gracious] or [more considerate]

See: Metonymy

Acts 17:11 (#4)

τὸν λόγον

"the word"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message about Jesus that Paul was sharing by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 17:11 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke uses the word **Now** to introduce background information about the Jews in Berea to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 17:11 (#7)

εἰ ἔχοι ταῦτα οὕτως

"whether these things might be so"

Luke is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to find out whether these things might be so]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 17:11 (#5)

μετὰ πάσης προθυμίας

"with all readiness"

Luke says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [with great readiness]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 17:11 (#2)

οὗτοι & τῶν ἐν Θεσσαλονίκῃ

"these & those} in Thessalonica"

Luke is using the demonstrative pronoun **these** to refer to the Jews in Berea and the demonstrative pronoun **those** to refer to the Jews in Thessalonica. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Jews in Berea ... the Jews in Thessalonica]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 17:12 (#1)

ἀνδρῶν οὐκ ὀλίγοι

"not a few men"

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. Alternate translation: [many men]

See: Litotes

Acts 17:13 (#3)

σαλεύοντες καὶ ταράσσοντες τοὺς ὄχλους

"exciting and troubling the crowds"

The terms **exciting** and **troubling** mean similar things. Luke may be using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [greatly upsetting]

See: Doublet

Acts 17:13 (#1)

καὶ & κατηγγέλη ὑπὸ τοῦ Παύλου ὁ λόγος τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the word of God was also being proclaimed by Paul"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Paul was also proclaiming the word of God]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 17:13 (#2)

ὁ λόγος τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the word of God"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that Paul was sharing by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message from God]

See: Metonymy

Acts 17:14 (#1)

οἱ ἀδελφοὶ

"the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 17:14 (#2)

ἕως ἐπὶ τὴν θάλασσαν

"as far as to the sea"

It might seem that the expression **as far as to the sea** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [to the seacoast]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 17:15 (#1)

πρὸς τὸν Σιλᾶν καὶ τὸν Τιμόθεον, ἵνα ὡς τάχιστα ἔλθωσιν πρὸς αὐτὸν, ἐξῆεσαν

"to Silas and Timothy that they should come to him as quickly as possible, they departed"

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [to Silas and Timothy, "Come to me as quickly as possible!" they departed]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 17:16 (#5)

παρωξύνετο τὸ πνεῦμα αὐτοῦ ἐν αὐτῷ

"his spirit was being provoked within him"

Here the **spirit** represents a person's feelings and sensitivities, particularly of a spiritual nature. Alternate translation: [this offended his spiritual sensitivities]

See: Metonymy

Acts 17:16 (#4)

παρωξύνετο τὸ πνεῦμα αὐτοῦ ἐν αὐτῷ

"his spirit was being provoked within him"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [this provoked his spirit within him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 17:16 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 17:16 (#2)

αὐτοὺς

"them"

The pronoun **them** refers to Silas and Timothy. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Silas and Timothy]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 17:16 (#3)

παρωξύνετο τὸ πνεῦμα αὐτοῦ ἐν αὐτῷ, θεωροῦντος κατείδωλον οὖσαν τὴν πόλιν

"his spirit was being provoked within him, seeing the city being full of idols"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [when he saw that the city was full of idols, his spirit was provoked within him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 17:17 (#2)

ἐν τῇ ἀγορᾷ

“in the marketplace”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:19. Alternate translation: [in the public square]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 17:17 (#1)

τοῖς σεβομένοις

“the ones worshiping”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:14. Alternate translation: [the Greeks who sincerely worshiped the God of Israel]

See: Idiom

Acts 17:18 (#3)

Στοϊκῶν

“Stoic”

The word **Stoic** is the name of another kind of philosopher. Stoics believed that freedom comes from resigning oneself to fate. They rejected a personal, loving God and the resurrection.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 17:18 (#2)

τῶν Ἐπικουρίων & φιλοσόφων

“of the Epicurean & philosophers”

The word **Epicurean** is the name of a certain kind of philosopher. Epicureans believed that all things were formed by chance and that the gods were too busy being happy to be bothered with governing the universe. They rejected the resurrection and wanted only simple pleasures.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 17:18 (#4)

ὁ σπερμολόγος

“word-picker”

These Athenian philosophers are using a common expression in their culture that refers negatively to a person who only knows little bits of information. The expression depicts a person picking up words or ideas the way a bird picks up seeds. The philosophers are saying that Paul has only a few bits of information that are not worth listening to. Alternate translation: [uneducated person]

See: Idiom

Acts 17:18 (#5)

ξένων δαιμονίων

“of foreign gods”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that the Athenian philosophers misunderstood Paul and thought that he was introducing two new **gods**, Jesus and Anastasis (the Greek word for resurrection), about which the Greeks and Romans had not known before. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [of two new gods, Jesus and Anastasis]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 17:18 (#1)

αὐτῷ & δοκεῖ & εὐηγγελίζετο

“with him & He seems & he was proclaiming”

The pronouns **him**, **He**, and **he** all refer to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [with Paul ... He seems ... Paul was proclaiming]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 17:19 (#4)

δυνάμεθα

“Are we able”

By **we**, the philosophers mean themselves but not Paul, to whom they are speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 17:19 (#1)

Ἄρειον Πάγον

“Areopagus”

The word **Areopagus** means “Hill of Ares” in Greek. It was named after the pagan god whose name was Ares in Greek and Mars in Latin. Luke does not explain the meaning of this word, since his readers already understand Greek. ULT spells this name the way it sounds in English. In your translation, you could spell it the way it sounds in your language. You could also translate the meaning of the word and use the name “Mars Hill,” as UST does. Or you could spell the word

the way it sounds and then explain its meaning. Alternate translation: [Mars Hill] or [the Areopagus, that is, Mars Hill]

See: Copy or Borrow Words

Acts 17:19 (#2)

ἐπὶ τὸν Ἄρειον Πάγον

"to the Areopagus"

Luke most likely means that the philosophers from the marketplace brought Paul to meet the main group of philosophers on the Areopagus, not that they just brought Paul to the hill itself. Luke would be using the word **Areopagus** by association to mean the philosophers who gathered there. Alternate translation: [to the philosophers who met on the Areopagus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 17:19 (#3)

δυνάμεθα γνῶναι τίς ἡ καινὴ αὕτη, ἡ ὑπὸ σοῦ λαλουμένη, διδαχή

"Are we able to know what this new teaching {is} that is being spoken by you"

This is not actually a rhetorical question, since the philosophers really do want to know whether Paul is willing to explain himself more fully to the group at the Areopagus. However, if in your language it might seem to be a rhetorical question, you could translate it as a statement instead. Alternate translation: [We would like to know what this new teaching is that is being spoken by you]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 17:19 (#5)

ἡ ὑπὸ σοῦ λαλουμένη

"that is being spoken by you"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that you are speaking]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 17:20 (#4)

τίνα θέλει ταῦτα εἶναι

"what these things want to be"

The philosophers are using an idiom. Your language may have a similar idiom that you could use in your translation. Or, if it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what these things mean]

See: Idiom

Acts 17:20 (#3)

ἡμῶν. βουλόμεθα

"our & we wish"

By **our** and **we**, the philosophers mean themselves but not Paul, to whom they are speaking, so use the exclusive form of those words in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 17:20 (#1)

ξενίζοντα & τινα εἰσφέρεις εἰς τὰς ἀκοὰς ἡμῶν

"you are bringing some startling things into our ears"

The philosophers are speaking of Paul's teachings about Jesus and the resurrection as if they were objects that one person could bring to another person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are saying some startling things]

See: Metaphor

Acts 17:20 (#2)

ξενίζοντα γάρ τινα εἰσφέρεις εἰς τὰς ἀκοὰς ἡμῶν

"For you are bringing some startling things into our ears"

The philosophers are referring to hearing by association with the **ears**, which people use to hear. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [we are hearing you say some startling things]

See: Metonymy

Acts 17:21 (#5)

τι καινότερον

"something newer"

This could mean: (1) that the implication is that the Athenians were looking for something **newer** than the last new thing they had said or heard. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [something newer than the last new thing they had said or heard]; (2)

that Luke may be using the comparative form **newer** with simple positive meaning. Alternate translation: [something new]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 17:21 (#2)

Ἀθηναῖοι & πάντες καὶ οἱ ἐπιδημοῦντες ξένοι & ηὐκαίρουν

"all the Athenians and the sojourning foreigners were devoting their leisure"

Luke says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [the Athenians and the sojourning foreigners loved to devote their leisure]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 17:21 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce background information about the people of Athens that will help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 17:21 (#4)

εἰς οὐδὲν ἕτερον ηὐκαίρουν

"were devoting their leisure to nothing other than"

Here, Luke says **nothing other** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [made it their favorite leisure activity]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 17:21 (#3)

Ἀθηναῖοι

"the Athenians"

The word **Athenians** is the name for people who live in or come from the city of Athens.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 17:22 (#5)

κατὰ πάντα

"in everything"

Paul says **everything** here as a generalization for emphasis. He is referring to the Athenians' public display of honoring the gods through prayers, building altars, and offering sacrifices. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [in many different ways]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 17:22 (#2)

ἐν μέσῳ τοῦ Ἀρείου Πάγου

"in the middle of the Areopagus"

As in 17:19, Luke uses the word **Areopagus** by association to mean the philosophers who gathered there. He does not mean that the philosophers placed Paul in the middle of the hill known as the Areopagus. Alternate translation: [in the middle of the group of philosophers who met on the Areopagus] or [in the middle of the group of philosophers who met on Mars Hill]

See: Metonymy

Acts 17:22 (#4)

δεισιδαιμονεστέρους

"more religious"

Paul is using the comparative form **more religious** for emphasis. Your language may use comparative forms in the same way. If not, you could convey the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [very religious]

Acts 17:22 (#1)

σταθεὶς δὲ Παῦλος ἐν μέσῳ τοῦ Ἀρείου Πάγου ἔφη

"And Paul, having been stood in the middle of the Areopagus, was saying"

If your language does not use the passive form **having been stood**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Once the philosophers had stood Paul in the middle of the Areopagus, he was saying]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 17:22 (#3)

ἄνδρες, Ἀθηναῖοι

“Men, Athenians”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular group of people. Alternate translation: [You Athenians]

See: Idiom

Acts 17:23 (#2)

βωμὸν ἐν ᾧ ἐπεγέγραπτο, ἀγνώστῳ Θεῷ

“an altar on which had been inscribed, ‘To an Unknown God”

Even if your language does not customarily put one direct quotation inside another, it would be good to present this as a direct quotation if possible, since it is the inscription on the altar that Paul is describing. You may be able to enclose this quotation in second-level quotation marks or use some other punctuation or convention that is available in your language to indicate a second-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 17:23 (#3)

ἐν ᾧ ἐπεγέγραπτο

“on which had been inscribed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [on which someone had inscribed]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 17:23 (#1)

βωμὸν ἐν ᾧ ἐπεγέγραπτο, ἀγνώστῳ Θεῷ

“an altar on which had been inscribed, ‘To an Unknown God”

While it would be preferable to present this as a direct quotation (See: next note), you could translate this as an indirect quotation so that there is not one direct quotation within another. Alternate translation: [an altar whose inscription dedicated it to an unknown god]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 17:24 (#2)

χειροποιήτοις ναοῖς

“hand-built temples”

Paul is using one part of a person, the **hand**, to represent all of a person in the act of building. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [temples that humans have made]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 17:24 (#1)

οὐρανοῦ καὶ γῆς

“of heaven and earth”

Paul is referring to all of creation by naming its two major components. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of everything that exists]

See: Merism

Acts 17:25 (#4)

αὐτὸς διδοὺς

“himself giving”

Paul is using the word **himself** for emphasis. Alternate translation: [because he himself gives]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 17:25 (#6)

πᾶσι

“to all”

By **all**, Paul implicitly means “all people.” You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to all people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 17:25 (#3)

ὑπὸ χειρῶν ἀνθρωπίνων

“by hands of men”

Paul is using one part of a person, the **hands**, to represent all of a person in the act of supposedly caring for God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by people]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 17:25 (#5)

ζωὴν, καὶ πνοὴν

“life and breath”

The terms **life** and **breath** mean similar things. Paul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [existence itself]

See: Doublet

Acts 17:25 (#2)

προσδεόμενός τινος

"needing anything"

Alternate translation: [as if he needed anything]

Acts 17:25 (#1)

ὑπὸ χειρῶν ἀνθρωπίνων θεραπεύεται

"is he cared for by hands of men"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [do hands of men care for him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 17:26 (#2)

πᾶν ἔθνος ἀνθρώπων

"every nation of men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a term in your language that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [every nation of humanity]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 17:26 (#1)

ἑνὸς

"one"

By **one**, Paul implicitly means "one man." He means Adam, the first person God created. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [one man] or [Adam]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 17:27 (#2)

ψηλαφήσειαν αὐτὸν καὶ εὕροιεν

"they might feel around for him and find him"

Paul is speaking as if people could **feel around for** God and **find him** that way. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they might sincerely try to know God and come to know him]

See: Metaphor

Acts 17:27 (#3)

οὐ μακρὰν ἀπὸ

"not & far from"

Paul is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [close to]

See: Litotes

Acts 17:27 (#1)

ζητεῖν τὸν Θεὸν

"to seek God"

Paul means implicitly that God did the things he described in the previous verse, giving the nations of humanity particular times to live in particular places, so that they would **seek** him. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [God did this so that people would seek him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 17:27 (#4)

ἡμῶν

"of us"

Paul is using the pronoun **us** to refer to himself and his listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 17:28 (#3)

ἐν αὐτῷ γὰρ ζῶμεν καὶ κινούμεθα καὶ ἐσμέν; ὡς καί τινες τῶν καθ' ὑμᾶς ποιητῶν εἰρήκασιν, τοῦ γὰρ καὶ γένος ἐσμέν

"For 'in him we live and are moved and are,' and as some of your own poets have said, 'For we too are {his} offspring"

Here Paul is quoting from the Greek philosopher-poet Epimenides and from the Greek poets Aratus and

Cleanthes. While it would be preferable to present these two quotations as direct quotations (See: next note), you could translate them as indirect quotations so that there are not direct quotations within a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [For some of your own poets have said that in him we live and are moved and are and that we too are his offspring]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 17:28 (#5)

ἐν αὐτῷ γὰρ ζῶμεν καὶ κινούμεθα καὶ ἐσμέν

"For 'in him we live and are moved and are"

The expressions **live** and **are moved** and **are** mean similar things. Epimenides is using the three terms together for poetic effect. It would be good to preserve that effect if possible, but it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the same idea with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [For he is the source of our entire existence]

See: Doublet

Acts 17:28 (#7)

τοῦ γὰρ καὶ γένος ἐσμέν

"For we too are {his} offspring"

Aratus and Cleanthes do not mean that people are literally God's **offspring** or children. They are speaking and poetically. It would be good to preserve the poetic effect if possible, but it would be clearer for your readers, you could express this metaphor as a simile. Alternate translation: [For it is as if we too are his offspring]

See: Metaphor

Acts 17:28 (#4)

ἐν αὐτῷ γὰρ ζῶμεν καὶ κινούμεθα καὶ ἐσμέν; ὡς καί τινες τῶν καθ' ὑμᾶς ποιητῶν εἰρήκασιν, τοῦ γὰρ καὶ γένος ἐσμέν

"For 'in him we live and are moved and are,' and as some of your own poets have said, 'For we too are {his} offspring"

Even if your language does not customarily put one direct quotation inside another, it would be good to present these two quotations as direct quotations if possible, since that would show that Paul is quoting Greek poets as he speaks to the philosophers in Athens. You may be able to enclose these quotations within second-level quotation marks or use some other punctuation or convention that is available in your language to indicate second-level quotations.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 17:28 (#1)

αὐτῷ & γένος

"him & offspring"

The pronouns **him** and **his** refer to God. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [in God ... God's offspring]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 17:28 (#6)

ἐν αὐτῷ γὰρ ζῶμεν καὶ κινούμεθα καὶ ἐσμέν

"For 'in him we live and are moved and are"

If your language does not use the passive form **are moved**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [For 'he is the one in whom we live and who moves us and in whom we exist]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 17:28 (#2)

ζῶμεν & κινούμεθα

"we live & are moved"

Paul is using the pronoun **we** to refer to himself and his listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 17:29 (#3)

χρυσῷ, ἢ ἀργύρῳ, ἢ λίθῳ

"to gold or silver or stone"

Paul is referring to idols by association with the materials out of which people made idols. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to idols made of gold or silver or stone]

See: Metonymy

Acts 17:29 (#5)

ἀνθρώπου

"of man"

Although the term **man** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a term in your language that is clearly inclu-

sive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [of humans]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 17:29 (#1)

γένος & ὑπάρχοντες τοῦ Θεοῦ

"being offspring of God"

Paul is speaking as if people were literally God's **offspring** or children. He means that God created people, and they are his creatures. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this metaphor as a simile. Alternate translation: [being like God's children]

See: Metaphor

Acts 17:29 (#2)

τὸ θεῖον

"the Divine"

Paul is using the adjective **Divine** as a noun to mean God, who is divine. ULT capitalizes the word to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [God]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 17:29 (#4)

χαράγματι τέχνης καὶ ἐνθυμήσεως ἀνθρώπου

"images of the skill and imagination of man"

Paul is using the possessive form not to mean images that resemble human **skill** and **imagination** but to describe the qualities that people use to create **images** or idols. Alternate translation: [images that people create by using their skill and imagination]

See: Possession

Acts 17:30 (#1)

χρόνους τῆς ἀγνοίας

"times of ignorance"

Paul is using the possessive form here not to describe **times** that were themselves ignorant but **times** when people were characterized by spiritual **ignorance**. Paul is referring to the times before God fully revealed himself through Jesus Christ and before people truly knew how to obey God. Alternate translation: [the times when people were ignorant of the true God]

See: Possession

Acts 17:30 (#2)

τοῖς ἀνθρώποις

"to men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a term in your language that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 17:31 (#4)

πίστιν παρασχὼν πᾶσιν

"having provided assurance to all"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **assurance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [having given everyone reason to believe surely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 17:31 (#2)

ἐν δικαιοσύνῃ

"in righteousness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [by his own righteous standards]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 17:31 (#3)

ἐν ἀνδρὶ ᾧ ὥρισεν

"by the man whom he has appointed"

By **the man**, Paul implicitly means Jesus. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [by Jesus, the man whom he has appointed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 17:31 (#1)

τὴν οἰκουμένην

"the world"

Here the term **world** refers to the people who live in the world. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of the world]

See: Metonymy

Acts 17:31 (#5)

ἐκ νεκρῶν

“from the dead”

Paul is using the adjective **dead** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [from among those who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 17:32 (#2)

ἀκουσόμεθά

“We will hear”

By **We**, these philosophers mean themselves but not Paul, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 17:32 (#4)

This is the end of the part of the story about Paul in Athens.

See: End of Story

Acts 17:32 (#5)

ἀκούσαντες

“hearing of”

These are the people who were present at the Areopagus, listening to Paul.

Acts 17:32 (#6)

οἱ μὲν ἐχλεύαζον

“some indeed mocked”

These did not believe it was possible for someone to die and then return to life. Alternate translation: [some ridiculed Paul] or [some laughed at Paul]

Acts 17:32 (#1)

νεκρῶν

“of the dead”

Luke is using the adjective **dead** as a noun in order to indicate a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [of those who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 17:32 (#3)

καὶ πάλιν

“also again”

It might seem that the expression **also again** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [again] or [another time]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 17:34 (#6)

Δάμαρις

“Damaris”

The word **Damaris** is the name of a woman.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 17:34 (#5)

Διονύσιος ὁ Ἀρεοπαγίτης

“Dionysius the Areopagite”

The word **Dionysius** is the name of a man. The word **Areopagite** is the name for someone who was a member of a council of rulers and judges that met on the Areopagus.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 17:34 (#1)

δὲ

“But”

Luke uses the word **But** to introduce information about what happened at the end of the story of what Paul did in Athens. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

Acts 17:34 (#2)

τινὲς & ἄνδρες

“certain men”

Although the term **men** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women, as the mention of **Damaris** shows. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a term in your language that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [certain people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 17:34 (#3)

κολληθέντες αὐτῷ, ἐπίστευσαν

"being joined to him, believed"

The people Luke describes here **believed** before they were **joined** to Paul, so it might be more natural to put the information about them believing first. Alternate translation: [believed and were joined to him]

See: Order of Events

Acts 17:34 (#4)

κολληθέντες αὐτῷ

"being joined to him"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [joining him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts - Chapter 18 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

- Verses 1–17 describe how Paul proclaimed the gospel in the city of Corinth.
- Verses 18–23 describe how Paul returned to Antioch and then started out on another missionary journey.
- Verses 24–28 describe how a man named Apollos became an effective preacher of the gospel.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The baptism of John
Some Jews who lived far away from Jerusalem and Judea had heard of John the Baptist and followed his teachings. They had not yet heard about Jesus. One of these Jews was Apollos. He followed John the Baptist, but he did not know that the Messiah had come. John had baptized people to show that they were sorry for their sins, but that kind of baptism was different from Christian baptism. (See: faithful, faithfulness, trustworthy; and Christ, Messiah; and repent, repentance)

Acts 18:1 (#1)

μετὰ ταῦτα

"After these things"

Luke is using the phrase **After these things** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 18:1 (#2)

ἦλθεν

"he went"

The pronoun **he** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul went]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 18:2 (#2)

τινα Ἰουδαῖον

"a certain Jew"

Luke is using the phrase **a certain Jew** to introduce **Aquila** as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [that there was a certain Jew there]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 18:2 (#1)

καὶ εὑρών

"And having found"

The word **found** does not mean that Paul was intentionally searching for a certain man; he happened to meet him. Alternate translation: [And when Paul happened to meet]

See: Idiom

Acts 18:2 (#4)

προσφάτως ἐληλυθότα ἀπὸ τῆς Ἰταλίας, καὶ Πρίσκιλλαν γυναῖκα αὐτοῦ, διὰ τὸ διατεταχέναι Κλαύδιον χωρίζεσθαι πάντας τοὺς Ἰουδαίους ἀπὸ τῆς Ῥώμης

"having recently come from Italy, also Priscilla, his wife, because Claudius had ordered all the Jews to depart from Rome"

It might be more natural to keep all of the information about Aquila leaving Italy together and mention afterwards that Paul also met his wife Priscilla. Alternate translation: [having recently come from Italy because Claudius had ordered all the Jews to depart from Rome, and Priscilla, his wife]

See: Information Structure

Acts 18:2 (#5)

Κλαύδιον

"Claudius"

The word **Claudius** is the name of the man who was the Roman emperor at this time. See how you translated his name in 11:28.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 18:2 (#3)

Ποντικὸν

"a Pontian"

The word **Pontian** was the name for someone who came from the province of Pontus on the southern coast of the Black Sea. See how you translated the name "Pontus" in 2:9.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 18:5 (#1)

Silas and Timothy rejoin Paul.

Acts 18:5 (#4)

συνείχετο τῷ λόγῳ ὁ Παῦλος

"Paul was constrained by the word"

Luke speaks of **the word** as if it were a living thing that could constrain Paul. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Paul felt urgently that he needed to devote himself to the word]

See: Personification

Acts 18:5 (#2)

κατῆλθον

"came down"

Luke says that Silas and Timothy **came down** to Corinth because that city is lower in elevation than Macedonia. Alternate translation: [traveled]

See: Idiom

Acts 18:5 (#5)

συνείχετο τῷ λόγῳ ὁ Παῦλος

"Paul was constrained by the word"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean preaching the message about Jesus by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Paul felt urgently that he needed to devote himself to preaching the message about Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 18:5 (#3)

συνείχετο τῷ λόγῳ ὁ Παῦλος

"Paul was constrained by the word"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Paul felt urgently that he needed to devote himself to the word]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 18:6 (#3)

τὸ αἷμα ὑμῶν ἐπὶ τὴν κεφαλὴν ὑμῶν

"Your blood {be} upon your head"

Paul is using one part of a person, the **head**, to represent all of a person in the act of deciding. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Your punishment is your responsibility]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 18:6 (#6)

καθαρὸς ἐγώ

"I am clean"

Paul is speaking as if he were physically **clean**. He means that he is satisfied in his conscience that he has fulfilled his duty to proclaim the gospel to these Jews. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have fulfilled my duty in proclaiming the gospel to you]

See: Metaphor

Acts 18:6 (#1)

ἐκτιναξάμενος τὰ ἱμάτια

"shaking out {his} garments"

This symbolic action was an expression of strong rejection in this culture. It showed that someone did not want even the dust of a place, in this case the synagogue, to remain on them. If there is a similar gesture in your culture, you could consider using it

here in your translation. See what you did with the similar gesture in 13:51.

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 18:6 (#4)

τὸ αἷμα ὑμῶν ἐπὶ τὴν κεφαλὴν ὑμῶν

"Your blood {be} upon your head"

The word **your** is plural. Paul is speaking to all the Jews in the synagogue, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Acts 18:6 (#2)

τὸ αἷμα ὑμῶν ἐπὶ τὴν κεφαλὴν ὑμῶν

"Your blood {be} upon your head"

Here, **blood** represents punishment, specifically for rejecting Jesus. Paul is telling the Jews that they are solely responsible for the divine judgment they will face for their stubbornness if they refuse to repent. Alternate translation: [You alone must bear the responsibility when God punishes you for rejecting Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 18:6 (#5)

τὴν κεφαλὴν ὑμῶν

"your head"

Since Paul is speaking to a group of people, it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **head**. Alternate translation: [your heads]

See: Collective Nouns

Acts 18:7 (#2)

Τιτίου Ἰούστου

"Titius Justus"

The words **Titius Justus** are the names of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 18:7 (#1)

τινὸς & σεβομένου τὸν Θεόν

"of a certain one worshiping God"

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:14. Alternate translation: [a Gentile man who sincerely worshiped the God of Israel]

See: Idiom

Acts 18:8 (#1)

Κρίσπος

"Crispus"

The word **Crispus** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 18:8 (#3)

ὅλῳ τῷ οἴκῳ αὐτοῦ

"his whole house"

Here, **house** refers to an entire household living together. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his entire household]

See: Metonymy

Acts 18:8 (#4)

ἐβαπτίζοντο

"were being baptized"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [were receiving baptism]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 18:8 (#2)

τῷ Κυρίῳ

"in the Lord"

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [in the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 18:9 (#3)

λάλει καὶ μὴ σιωπήσῃς

"speak and do not be silent"

The expressions **speak** and **do not be silent** mean similar things. Jesus is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [you must certainly continue speaking]

See: Doublet

Acts 18:9 (#4)

μὴ σιωπήσῃς

“do not be silent”

Jesus means implicitly that Paul should not **be silent** about the gospel. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [do not be silent about the gospel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 18:9 (#1)

μὴ φοβοῦ

“Do not fear”

Jesus means implicitly that Paul should not **fear** what people might do to him if he continues proclaiming the gospel. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Do not fear what people might do to you if you continue proclaiming the gospel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 18:9 (#2)

ὁ Κύριος

“Lord & the”

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 18:10 (#2)

λαός ἐστί μοι πολὺς ἐν τῇ πόλει ταύτῃ

“much people is to me in this city”

This means “many people in this city are mine.” Jesus is using the possessive form to indicate that these people are loyal to him. Alternate translation: [there are many people in this city who are loyal to me]

See: Possession

Acts 18:10 (#1)

ἐγώ εἰμι μετὰ σοῦ

“I am with you”

Jesus is stating the pronoun **I**, whose meaning is already present in the verb **am**, for emphasis. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction here. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [I am certainly with you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 18:11 (#1)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the word of God”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that God wanted Paul to teach by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message from God]

See: Metonymy

Acts 18:12 (#4)

κατεπέστησαν

“rose up”

Here the expression **rose up** means that the Jewish leaders took action, specifically to oppose Paul. It does not mean that they stood up from a seated position. Alternate translation: [took action against]

See: Idiom

Acts 18:12 (#2)

τῆς Ἀχαΐας

“of Achaia”

The word **Achaia** was the name of the Roman province in which Corinth was located. Corinth was the largest city in southern Greece and the capital of the province.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 18:12 (#6)

ἤγαγον αὐτὸν ἐπὶ τὸ βῆμα

“brought him to the judgment seat”

The term **judgment seat** refers to the place where Gallio the governor sat when he made legal decisions in court. The implication is that the Jewish leaders wanted Gallio to judge and punish Paul. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [brought him before the judgment seat so that the governor would judge and punish him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 18:12 (#3)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to one part of that group, its leaders. If it

would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the leaders of the Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 18:12 (#5)

ὁμοθυμαδὸν

“unanimously”

The word **unanimously** indicates that the Jews in Corinth recognized that they had a common interest and that they agreed to act together to pursue that interest. See how you translated the same word in 1:14. Alternate translation: [all together]

Acts 18:12 (#1)

Γαλλίωνος

“Gallio”

The word **Gallio** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 18:13 (#3)

παρὰ τὸν νόμον

“contrary to the law”

By **the law**, the Jewish leaders implicitly mean “Roman law.” You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [contrary to Roman law]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 18:13 (#2)

τοὺς ἀνθρώπους

“men”

Although the term **men** is masculine, the Jewish leaders is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a term in your language that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 18:13 (#1)

οὗτος

“This one”

The demonstrative pronoun **this** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [This man Paul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 18:14 (#2)

τοὺς Ἰουδαίους

“the Jews”

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to one part of that group, its leaders. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the leaders of the Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 18:14 (#3)

εἰ μὲν ἦν ἀδίκημά τι ἢ ῥᾳδιούργημα πονηρόν

“if indeed it was some crime or evil wrongdoing”

Gallio is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if it would be helpful in your language. Alternate translation: [if indeed it was some crime or evil wrongdoing on Paul’s part that brought you here today]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 18:14 (#1)

ἀνοίγειν τὸ στόμα

“to open {his} mouth”

Luke is referring to “speaking” by association with a person would **open his mouth** in order to speak. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to speak]

See: Metonymy

Acts 18:14 (#4)

ἀδίκημά τι ἢ ῥᾳδιούργημα πονηρόν

“some crime or evil wrongdoing”

The terms **crime** and **wrongdoing** mean similar things. Gallio using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [some serious crime]

See: Doublet

Acts 18:15 (#3)

ὀνομάτων

“names”

By **names**, Gallio likely means the question of whether Jesus can be called the Messiah. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 18:15 (#2)

λόγου

“word”

By **word**, Gallio likely means speech, expressed in words, as opposed to action. He is saying that what Paul has been saying is not a matter of great importance if he has not actually committed any crime. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [teaching]

See: Metonymy

Acts 18:15 (#5)

ὄψεσθε αὐτοί

“you will see yourselves”

By **see**, Gallio means investigate the matter and resolve it. Your language may have a similar idiom that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [you must see to it yourselves] or [you must look into it yourselves]

See: Idiom

Acts 18:15 (#1)

εἰ

“if”

Gallio is speaking as if what follows was a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if the speaker knows that it is certain or true, then you can translate his words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

Acts 18:15 (#4)

ὄψεσθε αὐτοί

“you will see yourselves”

Gallio is using a future statement to give an command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural form for giving a command. Alternate translation: [you must see yourselves]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Acts 18:16 (#1)

ἀπήλασεν αὐτοὺς ἀπὸ τοῦ βήματος

“he sent them away from the judgment seat”

Here, **judgment seat** refers to the place where Gallio sits to make legal decisions in court. Alternate translation: [Gallio made them leave his presence in the court] or [Gallio made them leave the court]

See: Metonymy

Acts 18:17 (#2)

τὸν ἀρχισυνάγωγον

“the synagogue leader”

Since Luke says in 18:8 that Crispus was the synagogue leader in Corinth, the implication is that during the year and a half that had passed since then, another man, Sosthenes, had become the leader. Since the Jewish leaders who were hostile to Paul were also hostile to him, a further implication is that, like Crispus, Sosthenes had become a believer in Jesus. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. (However, see next note for another possibility that some interpreters favor.) Alternate translation: [the new synagogue leader, who believed in Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 18:17 (#3)

ἐπιλαβόμενοι δὲ πάντες Σωσθένην τὸν ἀρχισυνάγωγον, ἔτυπτον ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ βήματος

“But having seized Sosthenes, the synagogue leader, they were all beating him before the judgment seat”

This could mean: (1) that the Jewish leaders were beating Sosthenes because he was a believer in Jesus. Alternate translation: [the Jewish leaders were all beating him]; (2) that the Gentiles who were present in the court beat Sosthenes because the Jews had caused trouble by bothering Gallio with an insignificant matter and Sosthenes was the synagogue leader. Alternate translation: [the Gentiles who were in the court were all beating him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 18:17 (#1)

Σωσθένην

“Sosthenes”

The word **Sosthenes** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 18:17 (#4)

πάντες & ἔτυπτον

“they were all beating him”

Luke likely says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [they were angrily beating him]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 18:18 (#1)

ὁ δὲ Παῦλος ἔτι προσμείνας ἡμέρας ἱκανὰς

“But Paul, having stayed yet many days”

Luke is using the word **But** here to introduce a contrast between what Paul might have been expected to do—leave the city because he was in danger and to protect the believers from danger themselves, as he did in Thessalonica and Berea—and what Paul actually did—remain in the city. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Nevertheless, Paul stayed yet many days, then]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Acts 18:18 (#4)

κειράμενος ἐν Κενχρεαῖς τὴν κεφαλήν, εἶχεν γὰρ εὐχήν

“having shorn {his} head in Cenchrea, for he had a vow”

Paul cut the hair off **his head** to show that he had fulfilled a vow that he had made to God. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Paul cut off his hair in Cenchrea to show that he had fulfilled a vow that he had made to God]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 18:18 (#3)

Κενχρεαῖς

“Cenchrea”

The word **Cenchreae** is the name of a city. This city was the seaport for the larger inland city of Corinth.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 18:18 (#5)

εἶχεν γὰρ εὐχήν

“for he had a vow”

Luke seems to offer the information that Paul had made a **vow** as the explanation for why he **stayed yet many days** in Corinth despite the danger he was in. It may be more natural in your translation to put this information right after the phrase it seems to explain, **having stayed many days**.

See: Information Structure

Acts 18:18 (#6)

εἶχεν γὰρ εὐχήν

“for he had a vow”

Luke tells us nothing further about why Paul made this vow or what he did to carry it out, so it would not be appropriate to add any information in your translation about why Paul made it.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Acts 18:18 (#7)

εὐχήν

“a vow”

This **vow** was a promise that a person in this culture made to God that he would not drink alcohol or cut his hair until the end of a set period of time. A person might do this to express his sincerity about something he was praying for, to acknowledge something that God had done for him, or to consecrate himself to deeper devotion to God for a time. In your translation, you may be able to use the word for a comparable practice in your culture. Alternate translation: [made a special promise to God not to cut his hair for a time in order to be more devoted]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 18:18 (#2)

τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς

“the brothers”

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 18:19 (#2)

κατήντησαν & εἰς Ἔφεσον

“they came down to Ephesus”

Luke says that Paul, Priscilla, and Aquila **came down** to Ephesus because that was the customary way in this culture of describing a person arriving somewhere after traveling by sea. Alternate translation: [they sailed to Ephesus]

See: Idiom

Acts 18:19 (#1)

κατήντησαν δὲ εἰς Ἔφεσον, κἀκείνους κατέλιπεν αὐτοῦ

“And they came down to Ephesus and them he left there”

The pronoun **they** refers to Paul, Priscilla, and Aquila, the pronoun **them** refers to Priscilla and Aquila, and the pronoun **he** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the three of them came down to Ephesus and Paul left Priscilla and Aquila there]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 18:20 (#1)

ἐρωτώντων & αὐτῶν

“when they asked him”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Jews in the synagogue in Ephesus. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when the Jews in the synagogue asked him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 18:22 (#4)

τὴν ἐκκλησίαν

“the church”

Luke is saying **the church** to mean the people who were associated with the church. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the members of the church]

See: Metonymy

Acts 18:22 (#1)

κατελθὼν εἰς Καισάρειαν

“having come down to Caesarea”

Luke says that Paul had **come down** to Caesarea because that was the customary way in this culture of describing a person arriving somewhere after traveling by sea. Your language may have its own way of describing that. Alternate translation: [having landed in Caesarea]

See: Idiom

Acts 18:22 (#2)

ἀναβὰς

“having gone up”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that by **having gone up**. he means that Paul traveled to Jerusalem. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [having gone up to Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 18:22 (#3)

ἀναβὰς

“having gone up”

Luke says that Paul had **gone up** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Use a natural way in your language of referring to traveling to a higher elevation. Alternate translation: [having traveled to Jerusalem]

See: Idiom

Acts 18:22 (#5)

κατέβη

“he went down”

Luke says that Paul **went down** to Antioch because that city is lower in elevation than Jerusalem. Use a natural way in your language of referring to traveling to a lower elevation.

See: Idiom

Acts 18:23 (#1)

διερχόμενος καθεξῆς τὴν Γαλατικὴν χώραν καὶ Φρυγίαν

“going through the region of Galatia and Phrygia in succession”

Luke means that Paul visited **in succession** the churches in **the region of Galatia and Phrygia**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [going

through the region of Galatia and Phrygia and visiting the churches there in succession]

See: Metonymy

Acts 18:23 (#2)

στηρίζων πάντας τοὺς μαθητάς

"strengthening all the disciples"

Luke says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [greatly strengthening the disciples]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 18:24 (#5)

κατήντησεν εἰς Ἔφεσον

"came down to Ephesus"

Luke does not say where Apollos traveled from when he came to Ephesus. However, he probably says that Apollos **came down** to Ephesus because that was the customary way in this culture of describing a person arriving somewhere after traveling by sea. Your language may have its own way of describing that. Alternate translation: [arrived in the port of Ephesus]

See: Idiom

Acts 18:24 (#4)

Ἀλεξανδρεὺς

"an Alexandrian"

The word **Alexandrian** is the name for people who live in or come from the city of Alexandria in Egypt. See how you translated this name in 6:9.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 18:24 (#6)

δυνατὸς ὢν ἐν ταῖς Γραφαῖς

"being mighty in the Scriptures"

Luke is speaking of **Apollos** as if he had physical strength with regard to the Scriptures. Luke means that he knew the Scriptures very well. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [having great knowledge about the Scriptures]

See: Metaphor

Acts 18:24 (#2)

Ἰουδαῖος & τις

"a certain Jewish man"

Luke is using the phrase **a certain Jewish man** to introduce **Apollos** as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [there was a Jewish man]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 18:24 (#1)

δέ

"Now"

Luke uses the word **Now** to introduce background information about **Apollos** that will help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 18:24 (#3)

Ἰουδαῖος

"a & Jewish man"

Luke is using the adjective **Jewish** as a noun to mean a person who is a Jew. ULT adds **man** to show this. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this expression with an equivalent word or phrase. Alternate translation: [Jew]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 18:25 (#5)

ζέων τῷ πνεύματι

"being fervent in spirit"

Here the **spirit** represents a person's feelings and motivation. Alternate translation: [being very enthusiastic]

See: Metonymy

Acts 18:25 (#3)

τὴν ὁδὸν τοῦ Κυρίου

"the way of the Lord"

Luke is speaking as if the salvation that God has provided through Jesus is a way or path that people walk on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [about the salvation that God has provided through Jesus]

See: Metaphor

Acts 18:25 (#6)

τὸ βάπτισμα Ἰωάννου

“the baptism of John”

Luke is using the possessive form here not to describe a **baptism** that **John** received but the baptism that John performed. Alternate translation: [the baptism that John performed]

See: Possession

Acts 18:25 (#4)

τοῦ Κυρίου

“of the Lord”

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [of the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 18:25 (#2)

οὗτος ἦν κατηχημένος

“He had been taught”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Other believers had taught him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 18:25 (#1)

ἐλάλει καὶ ἐδίδασκεν

“he was speaking and teaching”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **speaking** tells how Apollos was **teaching** about Jesus. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use “and.” Alternate translation: [as he spoke, he taught]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 18:26 (#1)

τὴν ὁδὸν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the way of God”

Luke is speaking as if the salvation that God has provided through Jesus is a way or path that people walk on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [about the salvation that God has provided through Jesus]

See: Metaphor

Acts 18:27 (#4)

τοῖς πεπιστευκόσιν διὰ τῆς χάριτος

“the ones having believed by grace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [those whom God had graciously led to believe]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 18:27 (#1)

βουλομένου & αὐτοῦ

“when he desired”

The pronoun **he** refers to Apollos. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when Apollos desired]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 18:27 (#2)

διελθεῖν εἰς τὴν Ἀχαΐαν

“to pass over into Achaia”

Luke uses the expression **pass over** here because Apollos had to cross the Aegean Sea to get to Achaia from Ephesus. Your language may have its own way of describing travel across a body of water. Alternate translation: [to go across the sea to Achaia]

See: Idiom

Acts 18:27 (#3)

οἱ ἀδελφοὶ

“the brothers”

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 18:28 (#1)

δημοσίᾳ

“in public”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **public**, you could express

the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [publicly] or [where anyone could listen]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts - Chapter 19 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

- Verses 1–10 tell how Paul came to the city of Ephesus and proclaimed the gospel there.
- Verses 11–20 describe remarkable things that God did in Ephesus as a result of the gospel proclamation there.
- Verses 21–41 describe how the artisans in Ephesus created an uproar because people were no longer buying the idols they made.

Acts 19:20 is a summary statement that Luke uses to mark the transition into the sixth major part of the book.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Temple of Artemis
The temple of Artemis was an important place in the city of Ephesus. Many people came to Ephesus to see this temple, and they bought statues of the goddess Artemis while they were there. The people who sold statues of Artemis were afraid that if people did not believe Artemis was a real goddess, they would stop giving the sellers money for statues.

Acts 19:1 (#1)

ἐγένετο δὲ

“And it happened that”

Luke is using the phrase **And it happened that** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 19:1 (#3)

κατελθεῖν εἰς

“came down to”

Luke says that Paul **came down** to Ephesus because he was coming down to the coast from a route that traveled over high ground. Alternate translation: [arrived in]

See: Idiom

Acts 19:1 (#2)

διελθόντα τὰ ἀνωτερικὰ μέρη

“passing through the upper parts”

Luke says that Paul traveled through **the upper parts** of the province of Asia to indicate that he followed a more direct route to Ephesus that went over higher ground than did the main route. The implication is that Paul wanted to go directly to Ephesus after visiting the churches in Galatia and Phrygia (18:23), as he had promised he would do if that was God’s will (18:21). You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [taking the most direct route]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:1 (#4)

τινας μαθητάς

“certain disciples”

Luke is using the phrase **certain disciples** to introduce these believers as new participants in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [that there were already some believers in the city]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 19:2 (#1)

εἶπέν τε πρὸς αὐτούς, εἰ Πνεῦμα Ἅγιον ἐλάβετε, πιστεύσαντες

“And he said to them, “If you received the Holy Spirit, having believed”

Luke is recording how Paul used the typical form in his language for asking questions. It may be more natural in your language to have an indirect quotation here. Alternate translation: [And he asked them if they had received the Holy Spirit when they believed.]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 19:3 (#3)

Ἰωάννου

“of John”

By **John**, the believers implicitly mean John the Baptist. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [of John the Baptist]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:3 (#1)

εἰς τί οὖν ἐβαπτίσθητε

“Into what then were you baptized”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Then what kind of baptism did you receive?]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:3 (#2)

εἰς τὸ Ἰωάννου βάπτισμα

“Into the baptism of John”

The believers in Ephesus are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [We received the kind of baptism that John performed]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 19:4 (#2)

βάπτισμα μετανοίας

“a baptism of repentance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **repentance**, you could express the same idea with the verb “repent.” Alternate translation: [a baptism that people requested when they wanted to repent]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 19:4 (#1)

Ἰωάννης ἐβάπτισεν βάπτισμα

“John baptized a baptism”

Paul is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. Your language may be able to do the same. But if that would sound unnatural in your language, you could express the meaning another way. Alternate translation: [John performed a baptism]

Acts 19:5 (#2)

ἐβαπτίσθησαν

“they were baptized”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they received baptism]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:5 (#3)

εἰς τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

“in the name of the Lord Jesus”

Here the **name** of Jesus represents his authority. By being baptized, these believers were acknowledging Jesus’ authority over their lives as their Lord and Savior. Alternate translation: [to express their allegiance to Jesus as their Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 19:5 (#1)

ἐβαπτίσθησαν

“they were baptized”

The pronoun **they** refers to the believers in Ephesus who were speaking with Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [those believers were baptized]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 19:6 (#1)

ἐπιθέντος αὐτοῖς τοῦ Παύλου χεῖρας

“Paul having laid hands on them”

Paul **laid** his **hands** on these believers as a symbolic action to show that he wanted God to give the Holy Spirit to them. If there is a gesture with similar meaning in your culture, you could consider using it here in your translation. See how you translated the similar expression in 8:17.

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 19:6 (#2)

ἦλθε τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον ἐπ’ αὐτούς

“the Holy Spirit came upon them”

Luke is speaking as if the Holy Spirit physically **came upon** these believers. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they received the Holy Spirit]

See: Metaphor

Acts 19:6 (#3)

ἐλάλουν & γλώσσαις

“they were speaking in languages”

The implication is that these believers were speaking languages that they did not know. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [they were speaking in languages that they did not know]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:7 (#1)

δὲ

“And”

Luke uses the word translated as **And** to introduce information to conclude this part of the story of what Paul did in Ephesus. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

Acts 19:8 (#3)

περὶ τῆς Βασιλείας τοῦ Θεοῦ

“about the kingdom of God”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of a **kingdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [about how God had begun to rule as king]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 19:8 (#2)

διαλεγόμενος καὶ πείθων

“reasoning and persuading”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The phrase **reasoning** tells how Paul was **persuading** people in the synagogue in Ephesus. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use “and.” Alternate translation: [reasonably persuading]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 19:8 (#4)

περὶ τῆς Βασιλείας τοῦ Θεοῦ

“about the kingdom of God”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that Paul was teaching that the **kingdom of God** had begun on earth when Jesus came as the Messiah. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [about how, when Jesus came as the Messiah, God had begun to rule as king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:8 (#1)

ἐπαρρησιάζετο

“he was speaking boldly”

The pronoun **he** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul was speaking boldly]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 19:9 (#3)

τὴν ὁδὸν

“of the Way”

As the introduction to Chapter 9 explain, **the Way** was one of the first names that people used to describe the community of believers in Jesus. If your language has a word for “way” or “path” that you can use as a name, it would be appropriate to use it here. See what you did in 9:2. Alternate translation: [who belonged to the Way]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 19:9 (#2)

ἐσκληρύνοντο

“were being hardened”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [were hardening themselves]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:9 (#1)

ἐσκληρύνοντο καὶ ἠπείθουν

“were being hardened and disobeying”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The phrase **being hardened** tells how **some** in the Ephesus synagogue were **disobeying** what God wanted them to do, according to Paul’s teaching. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use “and.” Alternate translation: [stubbornly disobeying]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 19:9 (#4)

Τυράννου

"of Tyrannus"

The word **Tyrannus** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 19:10 (#4)

τὸν λόγον τοῦ Κυρίου

"the word of the Lord"

Here, **word** stands for a message. Alternate translation: [the message about the Lord]

See: Metonymy

Acts 19:10 (#3)

τοῦ Κυρίου

"of the Lord"

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [about the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 19:10 (#2)

τὸν λόγον

"the word"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that Paul was proclaiming by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 19:10 (#1)

πάντας τοὺς κατοικοῦντας τὴν Ἀσίαν ἀκοῦσαι

"all living in Asia heard"

Luke says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [people living throughout the province of Asia heard]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 19:11 (#2)

τῶν χειρῶν Παύλου

"the hands of Paul"

Luke is using one part of Paul, his **hands**, to represent all of Paul in the act of doing miracles. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [through Paul]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 19:11 (#1)

οὐ τὰς τυχούσας

"not ordinary"

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [extraordinary]

See: Litotes

Acts 19:12 (#1)

καὶ ἐπὶ τοὺς ἀσθενοῦντας ἀποφέρεσθαι ἀπὸ τοῦ χρωτὸς αὐτοῦ σουδάρια ἢ σιμικίνθια

"even handkerchiefs or aprons from his skin were taken to the sick"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people even took handkerchiefs or aprons from Paul's skin to the sick]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:12 (#3)

σουδάρια

"handkerchiefs"

These **handkerchiefs** were small pieces of cloth used to wipe one's face. Your language and culture may have a term for a similar item that you can use in your translation.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 19:12 (#4)

σιμικίνθια

"aprons"

These **aprons** were clothing worn on the front of the body to protect the clothes of those who wore the aprons. Your language and culture may have a term for a similar item that you can use in your translation.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 19:12 (#6)

ἀπαλλάσσεσθαι ἀπ' αὐτῶν τὰς νόσους

"their} illnesses departed from them"

Luke is speaking of these **illnesses** as if they were living thing that could depart from a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God cured them of their illnesses]

See: Personification

Acts 19:12 (#2)

ἀπὸ τοῦ χρωτὸς αὐτοῦ σουδάρια ἢ σιμικίνθια

"handkerchiefs or aprons from his skin"

This could mean implicitly: (1) that these were cloth items that others had placed on Paul's **skin**. Alternate translation: [handkerchiefs or aprons that had touched Paul's skin]; (2) that these were cloth items that Paul had worn or used. Alternate translation: [handkerchiefs or aprons that Paul had worn or used]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:12 (#5)

τοὺς ἀσθενοῦντας

"the sick"

Luke is using the adjective **sick** as a noun to describe a group of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who were sick]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 19:13 (#1)

δέ

"Now"

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. This is the beginning of another event that happened while Paul was in Ephesus. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 19:13 (#4)

τὸν Ἰησοῦν

"by the Jesus"

The exorcists are referring to Jesus himself to mean his authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by the authority of the Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 19:13 (#2)

τῶν & ἐξορκιστῶν

"of the & exorcists"

These **exorcists** were people who sent evil spirits away from people or places. Your language and culture may have a term for this kind of person that you can use in your translation. You could also explain the meaning of the term "exorcists," as UST does.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 19:13 (#3)

τὸ ὄνομα

"the name"

Here, **name** refers to Jesus' power and authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the authority]

See: Metonymy

Acts 19:14 (#1)

δέ

"Now"

Luke uses the word **Now** to introduce background information about these **seven sons of Sceva** that will help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 19:14 (#3)

Σκευᾶ

"of Sceva"

The word **Sceva** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 19:14 (#2)

ἦσαν & τινος Σκευᾶ Ἰουδαίου ἀρχιερέως, ἑπτὰ υἱοὶ τοῦτο ποιοῦντες

“seven sons of Sceva, a certain Jewish chief priest, were doing this”

Luke is using the phrase **a certain Jewish high priest** to introduce his **seven sons** as new participants in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [there was a Jewish chief priest whose seven sons were doing this]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 19:15 (#2)

τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ πονηρὸν

“the evil spirit”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that he is continuing the story he began in verse 13 after providing background material in verse 14. By **the evil spirit**, he means one to which some of the sons of Sceva were saying on a specific occasion, “I adjure you by the Jesus whom Paul proclaims.” Luke indicates in verse 16 that two of the sons were involved on this occasion. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:15 (#1)

ἀποκριθὲν & τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ πονηρὸν εἶπεν

“answering, the evil spirit said”

Together the words **answering** and **said** mean that the evil spirit responded to the sons of Sceva. Alternate translation: [the evil spirit responded]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 19:15 (#4)

ὑμεῖς & τίνες ἐστέ

“you, who are you”

The evil spirit is stating the pronoun **you**, whose meaning is already present in the verb **are**, for emphasis. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction here. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [I certainly do not know you!]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 19:15 (#3)

ὑμεῖς δὲ τίνες ἐστέ

“but you, who are you”

The evil spirit is using the question form to emphasize that it does not know or respect these sons of Sceva the way he knows and respects Jesus and Paul, the representative of Jesus. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [but I do not know or respect you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 19:16 (#1)

ἀμφοτέρων

“them both”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that only two of the seven sons of Sceva were involved on this particular occasion. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the two sons of Sceva who were trying to cast out the evil spirit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:17 (#6)

ἐμεγαλύνετο τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

“the name of the Lord Jesus was being magnified”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they magnified the name of the Lord Jesus]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:17 (#4)

ἐπέπεσεν φόβος ἐπὶ πάντας αὐτούς

“fear fell upon them all”

Luke is speaking of **fear** as if it could physically fall on the people of Ephesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they all became very afraid]

See: Metaphor

Acts 19:17 (#3)

τοῦτο & ἐγένετο γνωστὸν πᾶσιν & τοῖς κατοικοῦσιν τὴν Ἔφεσον

“this became known to all living in Ephesus”

Luke says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use

a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [this became widely known among those who lived in Ephesus]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 19:17 (#5)

ἐπέπεσεν φόβος ἐπὶ πάντας αὐτούς

"fear fell upon them all"

Luke says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [all who heard about it became very afraid]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 19:17 (#2)

τοῦτο & ἐγένετο γνωστὸν πᾶσιν & τοῖς κατοικοῦσιν τὴν Ἔφεσον

"this became known to all living in Ephesus"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [all living in Ephesus came to know about this]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:17 (#7)

ἐμεγαλύνετο τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

"the name of the Lord Jesus was being magnified"

Here the word **name** stands for the reputation of Jesus. Alternate translation: [the Lord Jesus received a great reputation]

See: Metonymy

Acts 19:17 (#1)

δὲ

"And"

Luke uses the word translated as **And** to introduce information about what happened at the end of the story of the seven sons of Sceva. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

Acts 19:18 (#1)

ἐξομολογούμενοι καὶ ἀναγγέλλοντες

"confessing and declaring"

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The phrase **declaring** tells how these believers were **confessing** the wrong things that they had done. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use "and." Alternate translation: [publicly confessing]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 19:19 (#4)

ἀργυρίου

"pieces of silver"

Each of the **pieces of silver** was the approximate daily wage of a common laborer.

See: Biblical Money

Acts 19:19 (#3)

ἀργυρίου μυριάδας πέντε

"five myriad pieces of silver"

Each of these **pieces of silver** was the approximate daily wage of a common laborer. You could try to express this amount in terms of current monetary values, but that might cause your Bible translation to become outdated and inaccurate, since those values can change over time. So instead, you might say something more general or give the equivalent in wages. Alternate translation: [an amount equivalent to well over a hundred years' wages]

See: Biblical Money

Acts 19:19 (#2)

τὰς βίβλους

"their} books"

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that the word **books** refers to scrolls on which magical incantations and formulas were recorded. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [their scrolls of magical incantations]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:19 (#1)

τὰ περίεργα

"the magical arts"

Luke is using the adjective **magical** as a noun to describe certain practices. ULT adds the word **arts** to show that. Your language may use adjectives in the

same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [practices that involved magic]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 19:20 (#3)

τοῦ Κυρίου

"of the Lord"

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [about the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 19:20 (#2)

ὁ λόγος

"the word"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that Paul was proclaiming by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 19:20 (#1)

τοῦ Κυρίου ὁ λόγος ηὔξανεν καὶ ἴσχυεν

"the word of the Lord was increasing and prevailing"

Luke is speaking of the way that the **word of the Lord** was becoming more widely known and accepted as if it were a living thing that was **increasing** and **prevailing**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [more and more people were hearing and believing the word of God]

See: Personification

Acts 19:21 (#2)

ὡς & ἐπληρώθη ταῦτα, ἔθετο ὁ Παῦλος ἐν τῷ Πνεύματι & πορεύεσθαι

"when these things were fulfilled, Paul determined in the Spirit to travel"

The word **fulfilled** conveys the sense that Paul had completed the work that God had for him to do in Ephesus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [once all these things had happened, the Spirit showed Paul that he had completed his work in Ephesus and that he should travel]

See: Idiom

Acts 19:21 (#3)

δεῖ με καὶ Ῥώμην ἰδεῖν

"it is necessary for me also to see Rome"

In this context, the word **see** means to visit a place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I must also visit Rome]

See: Idiom

Acts 19:21 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 19:22 (#1)

Ἔραστον

"Erastus"

The word **Erastus** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 19:23 (#2)

τῆς ὁδοῦ

"the Way"

As the introduction to Chapter 9 explains, **the Way** was one of the first names that people used to describe the community of believers in Jesus. If your language has a word for "way" or "path" that you can use as a name, it would be appropriate to use it here. See what you did in 19:9.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 19:23 (#1)

τάραχος οὐκ ὀλίγος

"no small disturbance"

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a great disturbance]

See: Litotes

Acts 19:24 (#6)

οὐκ ὀλίγην ἐργασίαν

“not a little business”

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a great deal of business]

See: Litotes

Acts 19:24 (#3)

τις & ἀργυροκόπος, ποιῶν ναοὺς ἀργυροῦς Ἀρτέμιδος

“a certain silversmith making silver shrines of Artemis”

Luke provides this background information about **Demetrius** to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, present this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 19:24 (#4)

ναοὺς ἀργυροῦς Ἀρτέμιδος

“silver shrines of Artemis”

Luke assumes that his readers will know that Ephesus had a large temple dedicated to the goddess **Artemis**. (She was known as Diana in Latin; she was a false goddess of fertility.) Since Demetrius describes this temple in verse 27, you do not need to provide information about it here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Acts 19:24 (#1)

τις & ἀργυροκόπος & παρείχετο

“a certain silversmith & was bringing”

Luke is using the phrase **a certain silversmith** to introduce **Demetrius** as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [there was a silversmith ... who was bringing]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 19:24 (#2)

Δημήτριος

“Demetrius”

The word **Demetrius** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 19:24 (#5)

ἀργυροκόπος

“a & silversmith”

A **silversmith** is a craftsman who works with silver metal to make statues and jewelry. Your language and culture may have a term for this kind of worker that you can use in your translation.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 19:25 (#2)

περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα

“about such things”

Luke is using the adjective **such** as a noun to mean a certain kind of work. ULT adds the word **things** to show that. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this expression with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [in similar occupations] or [who did similar crafts]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 19:25 (#1)

οὓς συναθροίσας καὶ τοὺς περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα ἐργάτας, εἶπεν

“whom, having gathered together, and the workers about such things, said”

It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [He gathered together the craftsmen, along with workers in similar occupations, and said]

Acts 19:26 (#3)

οἱ διὰ χειρῶν γινόμενοι

“the things coming into being through hands”

Demetrius is using one part of the artisans, their **hands**, to represent all of them in the act of making idols. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [things which people make]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 19:26 (#2)

μετέστησεν ἱκανὸν ὄχλον

“has removed a considerable crowd”

Demetrius is speaking as if Paul had physically **removed** a crowd that had been patronizing the artisans in Ephesus. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has caused a considerable crowd to stop buying our shrines]

See: Metaphor

Acts 19:26 (#1)

θεωρεῖτε καὶ ἀκούετε

“you see and hear”

Demetrius is referring to perception by naming the two major means of perception. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you perceive clearly]

See: Merism

Acts 19:27 (#2)

ἣν ὅλη ἡ Ἀσία καὶ ἡ οἰκουμένη σέβεται

“whom all Asia, indeed the world, worships”

This was an exaggeration to show how popular the goddess Artemis was. Alternate translation: [whom people from all over the province of Asia and the world worship]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 19:27 (#3)

ἣν ὅλη ἡ Ἀσία καὶ ἡ οἰκουμένη σέβεται

“whom all Asia, indeed the world, worships”

Here the words **Asia** and **the world** refer to the people in Asia and in the known world. Alternate translation: [whom many people in Asia and in other parts of the world worship]

See: Metonymy

Acts 19:27 (#1)

τὸ τῆς μεγάλης θεᾶς Ἀρτέμιδος ἱερὸν, εἰς οὐθὲν λογισθῆναι

“the temple of the great goddess Artemis to be considered as nothing”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that people will consider the temple of the great goddess Artemis to be nothing]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:28 (#1)

ἔκραζον

“they were shouting”

The pronoun **they** refers to the craftsmen who were making the idols. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the craftsmen were shouting]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 19:28 (#2)

γενόμενοι πλήρεις θυμοῦ

“becoming full of anger”

Luke is speaking of the craftsmen as if they were containers that **anger** filled. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [becoming very angry]

See: Metaphor

Acts 19:29 (#4)

τὸ θέατρον

“the theater”

The **theater** in Ephesus was an outdoor semi-circular area with bench seats that could hold thousands of people. It was used for public meetings and for entertainment such as plays and music. If the word “theater” would communicate the wrong idea in your language, you could use a term that would be clearer for your readers. Alternate translation, as in UST: [the stadium]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 19:29 (#2)

ἐπλήσθη ἡ πόλις τῆς συγχύσεως

“the city was filled with confusion”

Luke is speaking of **the city** as if they were a container that **confusion** filled. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [there was confusion throughout the city]

See: Metaphor

Acts 19:29 (#3)

ἐπλήσθη ἡ πόλις τῆς συγχύσεως

“the city was filled with confusion”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **confusion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [people throughout the city were confused]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 19:29 (#1)

ἐπλήσθη ἡ πόλις τῆς συγχύσεως

“the city was filled with confusion”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [confusion filled the city]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:29 (#5)

Γάϊον & Ἀρίσταρχον

“Gaius & Aristarchus”

The words **Gaius** and **Aristarchus** are names of men.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 19:31 (#1)

τῶν Ἀσιαρχῶν

“of the Asiarchs”

The word **Asiarchs** is the name for the provincial officers who governed the Roman province of Asia.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 19:31 (#3)

δοῦναι ἑαυτὸν εἰς τὸ θέατρον

“to give himself into the theater”

The expression **to give himself** means “to go,” but it suggests risk and danger. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to risk going into the theater]

See: Idiom

Acts 19:31 (#2)

αὐτῷ & αὐτὸν, παρεκάλουν & ἑαυτὸν

“to him & him, were urging him & himself”

The pronouns **him** and **himself** refer to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [of Paul’s … him … were urging Paul … himself]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 19:33 (#2)

Ἀλέξανδρον

“Alexander”

The word **Alexander** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 19:33 (#4)

ἀπολογεῖσθαι τῷ δήμῳ

“to give a defense to the people”

The implication is that Alexander wanted to explain that although he and his fellow Jews did not worship idols themselves, they were not opposing the business of making silver shrines of Artemis. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to explain to the people that he and his fellow Jews were not responsible for the artisans losing business]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:33 (#1)

συνεβίβασαν Ἀλέξανδρον

“instructed Alexander”

The implication is that some people **instructed Alexander** about how he could speak to everyone in the theater. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [instructed Alexander about how he could speak to everyone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:33 (#3)

κατασείσας τὴν χεῖρα

“waving {his} hand”

This likely means that Alexander was **waving his hand** to get the attention of the audience and signal that he was about to speak. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this specifically in your translation. Alternate translation: [waving his hand to signal that he was about to speak]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 19:34 (#1)

ἐπιγνόντες & ὅτι Ἰουδαῖός ἐστιν

“recognizing that he was a Jew”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [recognizing, “He is a Jew!”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 19:34 (#2)

φωνὴ ἐγένετο μία ἐκ πάντων, ὡς & κραζόντων

“one voice happened from {them} all, while shouting”

Luke is speaking as if the people in the theater collectively had only **one voice**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they all shouted together]

See: Metaphor

Acts 19:35 (#9)

τὴν Ἐφεσίων πόλιν νεωκόρον οὖσαν τῆς μεγάλης Ἀρτέμιδος

“the Ephesian city to be the temple keeper of the great Artemis”

The term **temple keeper** was an honorary title that cities assumed when they built and maintained temples to the gods that the Greeks and Romans worshiped or to the emperor. In your translation, use an expression that shows that the city clerk is using honorific language. Alternate translation: [the city of Ephesus has the honor of hosting the temple of the great Artemis]

See: Politeness

Acts 19:35 (#7)

τίς & ἐστιν ἀνθρώπων, ὃς οὐ γινώσκει

“who is there of men who does not know”

A generalization for emphasis is implicit in the city clerk’s question, and this generalization becomes explicit when the question takes the form of a statement or exclamation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [men know very well]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 19:35 (#6)

τίς & ἐστιν ἀνθρώπων, ὃς οὐ γινώσκει

“who is there of men who does not know”

The city clerk’s question becomes a double negative when it takes the form of a statement or exclamation. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression instead. Alternate translation: [all men know]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 19:35 (#3)

ἄνδρες, Ἐφέσιοι

“Men, Ephesians”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular group of people. Alternate translation: [Citizens of Ephesus]

See: Idiom

Acts 19:35 (#10)

τοῦ διοπετοῦς

“of the Zeus-fallen image”

The city clerk is using the adjective **Zeus-fallen** as a noun to mean a specific kind of object. ULT adds the word **image** to show that. (Within the temple of Artemis was an image of the goddess. It had been fashioned from a meteorite that had fallen from the sky. The people of Ephesus thought that this rock had come directly from Zeus, whom they considered the ruler of their pagan gods.) Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the image that fell from the sky from Zeus]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 19:35 (#1)

ὁ γραμματεὺς

“the city clerk”

This **city clerk** was a high official in the government of Ephesus. He was not merely someone who kept records. In your translation, you could use a term for someone in a comparable role in your culture. Alternate translation: [an alderman]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 19:35 (#5)

τίς & ἐστιν ἀνθρώπων, ὃς οὐ γινώσκει τὴν Ἐφεσίων πόλιν νεωκόρον οὖσαν τῆς μεγάλης Ἀρτέμιδος καὶ τοῦ διοπετοῦς

"who is there of men who does not know the Ephesian city to be the temple keeper of the great Artemis and of the Zeus-fallen image"

The city clerk is using the question form to emphasize that the people of Ephesus do not need to be concerned that the worship of Artemis is in peril. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [there is no one of men who does not know that the city of Ephesus is the temple warden of the great Artemis and of the Zeus-fallen image!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 19:35 (#8)

τίς & ἐστιν ἀνθρώπων

"who is there of men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, the city clerk is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a term in your language that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [what person is there] or, as a statement or exclamation, [all people know] or [people know very well]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 19:35 (#11)

τοῦ διοπετοῦς

"of the Zeus-fallen image"

The word **Zeus** is the name of a pagan god.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 19:35 (#4)

τίς γάρ ἐστιν

"for who is there"

The city clerk is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [you should stop this uproar because, after all, who is there]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 19:35 (#2)

φησίν

"says"

To call attention to a development in the story, here Luke uses the present tense in past narration. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense in your translation. Alternate translation: [said]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Acts 19:36 (#3)

μηδὲν προπετὲς πράσσειν

"to do nothing rash"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative word **nothing** and the negative adjective **rash**. Alternate translation: [to be careful about what you do]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 19:36 (#2)

μηδὲν προπετὲς πράσσειν

"to do nothing rash"

The city clerk means implicitly that it would be **rash** for the people to do anything to harm Gaius and Aristarchus, as he says in the next verse. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [not to act impulsively and hurt the two men you have brought here]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 19:36 (#1)

κατεσταλμένους ὑπάρχειν

"to be calmed"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to calm down]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:37 (#1)

In this verse, the city clerk is giving the reason why the people of Ephesus should not harm Gaius and Aristarchus impulsively. To put the reason before the result, you could create a verse bridge for verses 36–37. It might say something like this: "You brought these

two men here even though they are neither temple-robbers nor blasphemers of our goddess. Therefore it is necessary for you to be calmed and to do nothing rash, since it is undeniable that people from throughout the world come to Ephesus to worship Artemis."

See: Verse Bridges

Acts 19:37 (#2)

τοὺς ἄνδρας τούτους

"these men {who are"

The pronoun **these** refers to refers to Gaius and Aristarchus, Paul's traveling companions (Acts 19:29). While the city clerk does not refer to them by name, you could find a way to identify them for your readers. UST models one way to do this.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 19:38 (#5)

ἐγκαλείτωσαν ἀλλήλοις

"let them accuse one another"

The pronoun **them** refers both to Demetrius and his colleagues and to Gaius and Aristarchus. The city clerk does not mean that Demetrius and his colleagues will accuse each other. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [let Demetrius and the craftsmen bring a charge against these men, and let these men respond] or [Demetrius and the craftsmen may bring a charge against these men, and these men may respond]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 19:38 (#2)

ἀγοραῖοι ἄγονται καὶ ἀνθύπατοί εἰσιν

"the courts are being conducted and there are proconsuls"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the proconsuls are holding court sessions]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:38 (#4)

ἐγκαλείτωσαν ἀλλήλοις

"let them accuse one another"

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they may accuse one another]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 19:38 (#1)

ἔχουσιν πρός τινα λόγον

"have a word against anyone"

The city clerk is using the term **word** to mean an accusation that Demetrius might make against Gaius and Aristarchus by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wish to make an accusation against anyone] or [wish to bring a charge against anyone]

See: Metonymy

Acts 19:38 (#3)

ἀνθύπατοί

"proconsuls"

The **proconsuls** were the Roman governor's representatives who made legal decisions in court. In your translation, you could use a term for someone in a comparable role in your culture. Alternate translation: [judges]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 19:39 (#2)

ἐν τῇ ἐννόμῳ ἐκκλησίᾳ ἐπιλυθήσεται

"it will be settled in the regular assembly"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the regular assembly will settle it]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:39 (#4)

τῇ ἐννόμῳ ἐκκλησίᾳ

"the regular assembly"

This **regular assembly** refers to a public gathering of citizens over which the county clerk presided. In your translation, you could use a term for a comparable deliberative body in your culture. Alternate translation: [the town meeting]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 19:39 (#3)

ἐν τῇ ἐννόμῳ ἐκκλησίᾳ ἐπιλυθήσεται

"it will be settled in the regular assembly"

The city clerk may be using a future statement to give an command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural form for giving a command. Alternate translation: [you must settle it in the regular assembly]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Acts 19:39 (#1)

εἰ δέ τι περὶ ἑτέρων ἐπιζητεῖτε

"But if you seek anything about other matters"

The word **seek** does not mean that Demetrius and his colleagues would be searching for something. The city clerk is speaking. Alternate translation: [But if you have other matters to discuss]

See: Idiom

Acts 19:40 (#2)

τῆς σήμερον

"the today"

The city clerk is leaving out a word that a sentence would ordinarily need in Greek in order to be complete. The clerk is abbreviating the expression "the today day," which means "this day." You can say that in your translation if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [this day]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 19:40 (#4)

μηδενὸς αἰτίου ὑπάρχοντος, περὶ οὗ & δυνησόμεθα ἀποδοῦναι λόγον

"there being no cause about which we will be able to give an account"

In Greek this is a double negative for emphasis, "there being no cause about which we will not be able to give an account." The second negative does not cancel the first to create a positive meaning. If for emphasis your language uses double negatives that do not cancel one another, it would be appropriate to use that construction here. You could also state the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [because we would have to have a reason in order to give an account]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 19:40 (#1)

κινδυνεύομεν ἐγκαλεῖσθαι

"we are in danger of being accused"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who would do the action, the context suggests that it would be the Roman authorities. Alternate translation: [we are in danger of the Roman authorities accusing us]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 19:40 (#3)

τῆς σήμερον

"the today"

The city clerk is referring to the events that were nearly a riot, by association with the day on which they took place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the events of this day]

See: Metonymy

Acts - Chapter 20 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

In this chapter Luke describes Paul's last visits to believers in the provinces of Macedonia and Asia before he went to Jerusalem.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Race

Paul spoke of living for Jesus as if he were running in a race. By this he meant that he needed to keep working hard even when things were difficult and he wanted to quit. (See: Metaphor)

"Compelled by the Spirit"

Paul thought that the Holy Spirit wanted him to go to Jerusalem even if Paul did not want to go there. The same Holy Spirit told other people that when Paul arrived in Jerusalem, people would try to harm him.

Acts 20:2 (#1)

αὐτοὺς

"them"

The pronoun **them** refers to the believers in the **regions** of Macedonia. It may be helpful to clarify this

for your readers. Alternate translation, as in UST: [the believers there]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 20:3 (#2)

γνώμης τοῦ ὑποστρέφειν διὰ Μακεδονίας

"he returned of a resolution through Macedonia"

The expression **of a resolution** means that Paul resolved to do something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he resolved to return through Macedonia]

See: Idiom

Acts 20:3 (#3)

αὐτῷ & μέλλοντι ἀνάγεσθαι εἰς τὴν Συρίαν

"against him being about to sail to Syria"

Alternate translation: [as he was ready to sail to Syria]

Acts 20:3 (#1)

ὑπὸ τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"by the Jews"

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by certain Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 20:4 (#1)

Σώπατρος Πύρρου & Σεκοῦνδος & Τυχικὸς & Τρόφιμος

"Sopater of Pyrrhus & Secundus & Tychicus & Trophimus"

These words are the names of five men.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 20:4 (#2)

Σώπατρος Πύρρου

"Sopater of Pyrrhus"

Here, the possessive form indicates that **Sopater** is the son of **Pyrrhus**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that specifically. Alternate translation: [Sopater, whose father was named Pyrrhus]

See: Possession

Acts 20:4 (#4)

Ἀρίσταρχος & Γάϊος

"Aristarchus & Gaius"

The words **Aristarchus** and **Gaius** are the names of men. See how you translated these names in 19:29.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 20:4 (#3)

Βεροιαῖος, Θεσσαλονικέων & Δερβαῖος & Ἀσιανοὶ

"a Berean & of the Thessalonians & a Derbean & Asians"

The word **Berean** is the name for someone from the city of Berea. The word **Thessalonians** describes people from the city of Thessalonica. The word **Derbean** is the name for someone from the city of Derbe. The word **Asians** describes people from the province of Asia.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 20:5 (#1)

ἡμᾶς

"for us"

As the introduction to this chapter discusses, here Luke begins to use the pronouns **us** and **we** to refer to himself and his traveling companions, but not to his readers. So use the exclusive form of those words throughout this chapter if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 20:5 (#3)

ἡμᾶς

"for us"

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that he says **us** because he joined Paul and his other companions at this point in the story. You can include this information if it will help your readers understand what is happening. UST models a way to do this.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:5 (#2)

οὗτοι

"they"

The pronoun **they** refers to the seven men who were traveling with Paul, whom Luke lists in the previous

verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [those seven men]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 20:6 (#1)

τὰς ἡμέρας τῶν Ἀζύμων

“the days of Unleavened Bread”

The words **Unleavened Bread** are the name of a Jewish religious observance that took place over several **days**. See how you translated this in 12:3.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 20:7 (#5)

κλάσαι ἄρτον

“to break bread”

Luke could be using the word **break** to mean “eat,” and he could be using the word **bread** to mean “food.” In each case he would be using one part of something to mean the whole thing. Breaking bread is one thing people do when they eat it, and bread is one kind of food. So this could be a reference to the believers sharing a meal together. Alternate translation: [to share a meal] or see the next note for a further possibility.

See: Synecdoche

Acts 20:7 (#7)

τὸν λόγον

“the word”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the message that Paul was sharing by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his message]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:7 (#4)

αὐτοῖς

“with them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the believers in Troas with whom Paul and his traveling companions were meeting. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the believers in Troas]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 20:7 (#6)

κλάσαι ἄρτον

“to break bread”

By **to break bread**, Luke could also mean remembering the death of Jesus in the way that Jesus commanded, by literally breaking a loaf of bread and sharing it (and also sharing a cup of wine). If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [to observe the Lord’s Supper]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:7 (#2)

τῇ μιᾷ τῶν σαββάτων

“the first of the week”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that the believers met on **the first of the week** because that was the day Jesus rose from the dead. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the first day of the week, when Jesus rose from the dead]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:7 (#1)

τῇ μιᾷ τῶν σαββάτων

“the first of the week”

Luke is using the adjective **first** as a noun to mean a particular day of the **week**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the first day of the week]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 20:7 (#3)

συνηγμένων ἡμῶν

“we having been gathered together”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we having gathered together]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 20:8 (#1)

ἦσαν & λαμπάδες ἱκαναὶ ἐν τῷ ὑπερῴῳ, οὗ ἦμεν συνηγμένοι

“many lamps were in the upper room where we were gathered together”

The implication seems to be that it became warm in this **upper room** because there were **many lamps** lit in it, and this helps account for why Eutychus fell asleep, as Luke describes in the next verse. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [it was warm in the upper room where we were gathered together because many lamps were in it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:8 (#2)

ὑπερῴῳ

"upper room"

In this culture, in some houses, rooms were built above other rooms. According to the next verse, this room was actually built above a room that was built above another room. If your community does not have houses like that, you could use another expression to describe a large indoor space where people could meet. See how you translated this in 9:37.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 20:8 (#3)

ἦμεν συνηγμένοι

"we were gathered together"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we had gathered together]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 20:9 (#1)

Εὔτυχος

"Eutychus"

The word **Eutychus** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 20:9 (#7)

ἤρθη νεκρός

"was picked up dead"

The implication is that some of the believers rushed down to help Eutychus but discovered that he had died from the fall. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [they lifted him from the ground, but he had died]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:9 (#3)

καταφερόμενος ὕπνῳ βαθεῖ & κατενεχθεὶς ἀπὸ τοῦ ὕπνου

"being overcome by a deep sleep & having been overcome by sleep"

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express this idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a deep sleep overcoming him ... sleep having overcome him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 20:9 (#5)

τριστέγου

"third story"

In this culture, the **third story** meant a level two floors above the ground floor. Some languages and cultures consider the "first story" to be one level above the ground floor, and so they would consider this level, two stories above the ground floor, to be the "second story." You can say that in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers.

Acts 20:9 (#4)

καταφερόμενος ὕπνῳ βαθεῖ & κατενεχθεὶς ἀπὸ τοῦ ὕπνου

"being overcome by a deep sleep & having been overcome by sleep"

Luke is speaking of **sleep** as if it were a living thing that could **overcome** Eutychus. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [starting to sleep deeply ... becoming completely asleep]

See: Personification

Acts 20:9 (#2)

ἐπὶ τῆς θυρίδος

"on the window"

This **window** was an opening in the wall with a ledge that was wide enough for a person to sit on. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe this more fully. Alternate translation: [on the ledge of a window opening in the wall]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 20:9 (#6)

ἤρθη νεκρός

“was picked up dead”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, the context suggests that it was the believers who were meeting with Paul. Alternate translation: [the believers picked him up dead]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 20:10 (#1)

μὴ θορυβεῖσθε

“Do not be troubled”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Do not let this trouble you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 20:10 (#2)

ἡ & ψυχὴ αὐτοῦ ἐν αὐτῷ ἐστιν

“his life is in him”

Paul is speaking as if the life of Eutychus were contained within him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he is alive]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:11 (#1)

κλάσας τὸν ἄρτον καὶ γευσάμενος

“having broken bread and having tasted”

Luke could be using the words **broken** and **tasted** to mean “eaten,” and he could be using the word **bread** to mean “food.” In each case he would be using one part of something to mean the whole thing. Breaking and tasting bread are things people do when they eat bread, and bread is one kind of food. So this could be a reference to the believers sharing a meal together. Alternate translation: [having shared a meal with the believers] or see the next note for a further possibility.

See: Synecdoche

Acts 20:11 (#3)

ἐξῆλθεν

“he left”

The pronoun **he** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul left]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 20:11 (#2)

κλάσας τὸν ἄρτον καὶ γευσάμενος

“having broken bread and having tasted”

By **having broken bread and having tasted**, Luke could also mean remembering the death of Jesus in the way that Jesus commanded, by literally breaking a loaf of bread and sharing it (and also sharing a cup of wine). If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [having observe the Lord’s Supper with the believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:12 (#1)

δὲ

“But”

Luke uses the word **But** to introduce information about what happened at the end of the story of Eutychus. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

Acts 20:12 (#2)

τὸν παῖδα

“the boy”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that by **the boy**, he means Eutychus. You can use his name if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Eutychus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:12 (#4)

οὐ μετρίως

“not moderately”

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [greatly]

See: Litotes

Acts 20:12 (#3)

παρεκλήθησαν

“were comforted”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [this comforted them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 20:13 (#2)

τὴν Ἄσσον

“Assos”

The word **Assos** is the name of a town on the coast of the Aegean sea.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 20:13 (#3)

μέλλων αὐτὸς πεζεύειν

“intending to go on foot himself”

In light of what Paul says in 20:23, that the Holy Spirit was showing him that he would soon suffer and be imprisoned, the implication seems to be that Paul wanted to **go on foot himself** so that he could be alone for a while and reflect and pray. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [intending to go on foot himself because he wanted to have some time alone to reflect and pray]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:13 (#1)

ἡμεῖς δὲ, προελθόντες ἐπὶ τὸ πλοῖον, ἀνήχθημεν ἐπὶ τὴν Ἄσσον, ἐκεῖθεν μέλλοντες ἀναλαμβάνειν τὸν Παῦλον; οὕτως γὰρ διατεταγμένος, ἦν μέλλων αὐτὸς πεζεύειν

“Then we, having gone ahead to the ship, sailed away to Assos, intending to take Paul on board there, for thus he had arranged, intending to go on foot himself”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Paul intended to go on foot to Assos and he arranged for us to take him on board there, so we went ahead to the ship and sailed away to Assos]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Acts 20:14 (#1)

Μιτυλήνην

“Mitylene”

The word **Mitylene** is the name of a town on the coast of the Aegean sea.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 20:15 (#4)

Μίλητον

“Miletus”

The word **Miletus** is the name of a port city that was located in western Asia Minor.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 20:15 (#3)

Σάμον

“Samos”

The word **Samos** is the name of an island south of Chios in the Aegean Sea.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 20:15 (#2)

Χίου

“Chios”

The word **Chios** is the name of an island in the Aegean Sea.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 20:15 (#1)

κατηντήσαμεν

“we came down”

Luke says that he and his traveling companions **came down** to a point on the mainland **opposite Chios** because that was the customary way in this culture of describing a person arriving somewhere after traveling by sea. Your language may have its own way of describing that. Alternate translation: [we landed]

See: Idiom

Acts 20:16 (#1)

ὅπως μὴ γένηται αὐτῷ χρονοτριβῆσαι

“so that it would not happen to him to lose time”

Luke is speaking about **time** as if it were a commodity that a person could **lose**. Alternate translation: [so that he would not have to remain for a time]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:17 (#1)

μετεκαλέσατο

"he summoned"

The pronoun **he** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul sent]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 20:18 (#2)

ὑμεῖς ἐπίστασθε

"You know"

Paul is stating the pronoun **you**, whose meaning is already present in the verb **know**, for emphasis. If your language can state implied pronouns explicitly for emphasis, you may want to use that construction here. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [You certainly know]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 20:18 (#3)

ἐπέβην εἰς τὴν Ἀσίαν

"I set foot in Asia"

Paul is using one part of himself, his **foot**, to represent all of himself in the act of arriving in Asia. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I entered Asia]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 20:18 (#1)

ὑμεῖς ἐπίστασθε ἀπὸ πρώτης ἡμέρας ἀφ' ἧς ἐπέβην εἰς τὴν Ἀσίαν, πῶς μεθ' ὑμῶν τὸν πάντα χρόνον ἐγενόμην

"You know, from the first day from which I set foot in Asia, how I was with you the whole time"

It may be more natural in your language to reverse the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [You yourselves know how I was with you the whole time from the first day from which I set foot in Asia]

See: Information Structure

Acts 20:19 (#4)

δακρύων

"tears"

Paul is referring to strong emotion by association with the way a person who feels things deeply sheds **tears** of sadness or joy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [deep emotion] or [genuine feeling]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:19 (#2)

μετὰ πάσης ταπεινοφροσύνης

"with all humility"

Paul says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [with great humility]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 20:19 (#3)

μετὰ πάσης ταπεινοφροσύνης

"with all humility"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **humility**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [very humbly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 20:19 (#6)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"of the Jews"

Paul is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of certain Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 20:19 (#5)

καὶ πειρασμῶν, τῶν συμβάντων μοι

"and trials happening to me"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate

translation: [and how I endured the trials that happened to me]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 20:19 (#1)

τῷ Κυρίῳ

"the Lord"

Paul is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 20:20 (#2)

ὡς οὐδὲν ὑπεστειλάμην τῶν συμφερόντων τοῦ μὴ ἀναγγεῖλαι ὑμῖν

"how I withheld nothing being useful in order not to declare it to you"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative word **nothing** and the negative particle **not**. Alternate translation: [how I eagerly brought forth everything that would be useful so that I could declare it to you]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 20:20 (#1)

ὡς οὐδὲν ὑπεστειλάμην τῶν συμφερόντων τοῦ μὴ ἀναγγεῖλαι ὑμῖν

"how I withheld nothing being useful in order not to declare it to you"

Paul says **nothing** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [how I did not withhold things that would be useful and not declare them to you]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 20:21 (#2)

τὴν εἰς Θεὸν μετάνοιαν καὶ πίστιν εἰς τὸν Κύριον ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦν

"repentance toward God and faith in our Lord Jesus"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the ideas of **repentance** and **faith**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [about the need to repent towards God and believe in our Lord Jesus]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 20:21 (#3)

ἡμῶν

"our"

Paul is using the pronoun **our** to refer to himself and his listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 20:21 (#1)

διαμαρτυρόμενος & τὴν εἰς Θεὸν μετάνοιαν καὶ πίστιν εἰς τὸν Κύριον ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦν

"testifying & repentance toward God and faith in our Lord Jesus"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [testifying about the need for ... repentance toward God and faith in our Lord Jesus]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 20:22 (#5)

ἐν αὐτῇ

"in her"

The pronoun **her** refers to the city of Jerusalem. Conventionally, Greek referred to cities with feminine pronouns. Your language may use a different gender. You could also use a noun. Alternate translation: [in it] or [in that city]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 20:22 (#1)

ἰδοὺ

"behold"

Paul is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners' attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation.

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:22 (#4)

τὰ ἐν αὐτῇ συναντήσοντά μοι, μὴ εἰδώς

"not knowing the things that will happen to me in her"

Since Paul says in the next verse that he does know one thing that will happen to him in Jerusalem, it might appear in your language he is contradicting himself. If so, you could reword this to avoid using an exception clause. You could begin a new sentence here that continues into the next verse, leaving out the word "except" at the start of the next verse. Alternate translation: [The one thing I do know that will happen to me in her is]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

Acts 20:22 (#2)

δεδεμένος & τῷ Πνεύματι

"having been bound by the Spirit"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [with the Spirit binding me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 20:22 (#3)

δεδεμένος & τῷ Πνεύματι

"having been bound by the Spirit"

Paul is speaking as if **the Spirit** had **bound** him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with the Spirit constraining me] or [with the Spirit leading me in a way that I cannot refuse]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:23 (#1)

δεσμὰ καὶ θλίψεις με μένουσιν

"chains and afflictions await me"

Luke is speaking as if these **chains** and **sufferings** were living things that were waiting for Paul in Jerusalem. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will experience chains and afflictions when I get there]

See: Personification

Acts 20:23 (#2)

δεσμὰ

"chains"

Paul is using one aspect of imprisonment, the **chains** that bound prisoners at this time, to mean the entire experience of being imprisoned. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [imprisonment]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 20:24 (#2)

τελειῶσαι τὸν δρόμον μου, καὶ τὴν διακονίαν ἣν ἔλαβον παρὰ τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

"to finish my race and the ministry that I received from the Lord Jesus"

The terms **race** and **ministry** mean the same thing; **race** is figurative and **ministry** is literal. Paul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could show how the second term is the literal equivalent of the first. Alternate translation: [to finish my race, that is, the ministry that I received from the Lord Jesus]

See: Doublet

Acts 20:24 (#3)

τελειῶσαι τὸν δρόμον μου, καὶ τὴν διακονίαν ἣν ἔλαβον παρὰ τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

"to finish my race and the ministry that I received from the Lord Jesus"

Paul is speaking as if the **ministry** that Jesus gave him were a **race** he was running. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to complete my assignment, that is, the ministry that I received from the Lord Jesus]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:24 (#6)

τὸ εὐαγγέλιον τῆς χάριτος τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the gospel of the grace of God"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the good news that God graciously saves those who believe in Jesus]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 20:24 (#5)

τελειῶσαι τὸν δρόμον μου, καὶ τὴν διακονίαν ἣν ἔλαβον παρὰ τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

"to finish my race and the ministry that I received from the Lord Jesus"

Paul is speaking about this **race** and **ministry** as if they were objects that Jesus gave him and he **received**. He means that Jesus commanded him to do this ministry. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that plainly. Alternate translation: [to complete the entire ministry that the Lord Jesus commanded me to do]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:24 (#4)

τελειῶσαι τὸν δρόμον μου, καὶ τὴν διακονίαν ἣν ἔλαβον παρὰ τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

"to finish my race and the ministry that I received from the Lord Jesus"

If you decide to use a plain expression rather than the figurative expression **race**, you could also use another way to express the emphasis that Paul is conveying by using two similar terms together. Alternate translation: [to complete the entire ministry that I received from the Lord Jesus]

See: Doublet

Acts 20:24 (#1)

οὐδενὸς λόγου ποιοῦμαι τὴν ψυχὴν τιμίαν ἐμαυτῷ

"of no word do I consider my life valuable to myself"

Paul is using the term **word** to mean what he might say by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I do not consider my life to have any value for myself worth speaking of]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:25 (#1)

ἰδοὺ

"behold"

Paul is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners' attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation.

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:25 (#3)

τὴν βασιλείαν

"the kingdom"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of a **kingdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how God has begun to rule as king]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 20:25 (#2)

τὴν βασιλείαν

"the kingdom"

Paul assumes that his listeners will understand that by **kingdom** he means the kingdom of God. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the kingdom of God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:25 (#4)

οὐκέτι ὄψεσθε τὸ πρόσωπόν μου

"will see my face no more"

Paul is using one part of himself, his **face**, to represent all of himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will see me no more]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 20:26 (#1)

ἐν τῇ σήμερον ἡμέρᾳ

"in the today day"

This is an idiomatic expression. Your language may have its own way of expressing the same meaning. Alternate translation: [this very day]

See: Idiom

Acts 20:26 (#3)

καθαρός εἰμι ἀπὸ τοῦ αἵματος πάντων

"I am innocent from the blood of all"

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that they would receive a punishment of spiritual death for rejecting Jesus as their Savior from the guilt of sin. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I am not responsible for the punishment of spiritual death that any of you might receive for rejecting Jesus as your Savior from the guilt of sin]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:26 (#2)

καθαρός εἰμι ἀπὸ τοῦ αἵματος πάντων

“I am innocent from the blood of all”

Paul is referring to death as a punishment by association with the way a person’s blood is often shed when they are executed. In this case the death is not physical but spiritual. It is the punishment of spiritual death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am not responsible for the punishment of spiritual death that any of you might receive]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:27 (#1)

In this verse, Paul is giving the reason why he is not responsible for any spiritual punishment the people in Ephesus might receive. To put the reason before the result, you could create a verse bridge for verses 26–27. It might say something like this: “I did not hold back from declaring all the counsel of God to you. Therefore I testify to you this very day that I am innocent of the blood of all of you.”

See: Verse Bridges

Acts 20:27 (#3)

πᾶσαν τὴν βουλὴν τοῦ Θεοῦ ὑμῖν

“to you all the counsel of God”

Paul says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everything that you needed to know in order to be saved]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 20:27 (#2)

οὐ γὰρ ὑπεστειλάμην τοῦ μὴ ἀναγγεῖλαι & ὑμῖν

“For I did not hold back in order not to declare to you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative verb **hold back**. Alternate translation: [For I forthrightly declared to you]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 20:28 (#2)

τὴν ἐκκλησίαν τοῦ Θεοῦ, ἣν περιεποιήσατο διὰ τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ ἰδίου

“the church of God, which he obtained through his own blood”

Paul is referring to death by association with the way people may shed their **blood** when they die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the church of God, which he obtained through his own death]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:28 (#5)

τὴν ἐκκλησίαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the church of God”

Here the term **church** refers to the people who belong to the church. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of the church of God]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:28 (#3)

τὴν ἐκκλησίαν τοῦ Θεοῦ, ἣν περιεποιήσατο διὰ τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ ἰδίου

“the church of God, which he obtained through his own blood”

The word translated as **obtained** means to make something one’s own. The pronoun **he** may refer to Jesus, and this would mean that Jesus made the people of the church his own by dying for them. Alternate translation: [the people of the church of God, whom Jesus made his own by dying for them] or see next note for another possibility.

See: Pronouns

Acts 20:28 (#4)

τὴν ἐκκλησίαν τοῦ Θεοῦ, ἣν περιεποιήσατο διὰ τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ ἰδίου

“the church of God, which he obtained through his own blood”

This could also mean that God made the people of the church his own by sending his Son to die for them. In that case the translation would be “through the blood of his Own” and Paul would be using the adjective **own** as a noun to mean God’s own Son. Alternate transla-

tion: [the people of the church, whom God made his own through the death of his own Son]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 20:28 (#1)

τῷ ποιμνίῳ, ἐν ᾧ ὑμᾶς τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον ἔθετο ἐπισκόπους, ποιμαίνειν τὴν ἐκκλησίαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the flock among which the Holy Spirit has made you overseers to shepherd the church of God"

Paul is speaking as if the believers were a **flock** of sheep and the elders to whom he is speaking were their shepherds. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers whose leaders the Holy Spirit has made you, to care for the church of God]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:29 (#1)

εἰσελεύσονται & λύκοι βαρεῖς εἰς ὑμᾶς, μὴ φειδόμενοι τοῦ ποιμνίου

"vicious wolves will come in among you, not sparing the flock"

Paul is continuing to speak as if the believers were a **flock** of sheep and as if the false teachers he describes in the next verse are **vicious wolves**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [false teachers will come to your group of believers and they will harm many of you]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:30 (#1)

καὶ ἐξ ὑμῶν αὐτῶν

"Even from you yourselves"

Paul is adding the word **yourselves** for emphasis. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [From within your very own group]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 20:30 (#4)

τοῦ ἀποσπᾶν τοὺς μαθητὰς ὀπίσω ἑαυτῶν

"in order to draw away the disciples after them"

Paul is speaking as if these false teachers would physically **draw away** people **after them** as they themselves left the fellowship of true believers in Jesus. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in order to influence disciples to follow their teaching instead of Jesus' teaching]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:30 (#2)

ἀναστήσονται ἄνδρες λαλοῦντες διεστραμμένα

"men will arise speaking perverted things"

In this context, **arise** means to take action to get an enterprise under way, not to get up from a sitting or lying position. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [men will begin to speak perverted things]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:30 (#3)

διεστραμμένα

"perverted things"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [distortions of the truth]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 20:31 (#1)

οὐκ ἐπαυσάμην & νουθετῶν

"I did not stop admonishing"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **stop**. Alternate translation: [I continued to warn]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 20:31 (#2)

μετὰ δακρύων

"with tears"

Paul is referring to strong emotion by association with the way a person who feels things deeply sheds **tears** of sadness or joy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with deep emotion] or [with genuine feeling]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:31 (#4)

νύκτα καὶ ἡμέραν

“night and day”

Paul says **night and day** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [without ever giving up]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 20:31 (#3)

νύκτα καὶ ἡμέραν

“night and day”

Paul is using the two parts of a full day, **night** and **day**, to mean all the time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all the time]

See: Merism

Acts 20:32 (#1)

τῷ Θεῷ, καὶ τῷ λόγῳ τῆς χάριτος αὐτοῦ, τῷ δυναμένῳ

“to God and to the word of his grace being able”

Paul is speaking of the **word** of God’s **grace** as if it were a living thing that was **able** to do the things he describes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to God who, through the word of his grace, is able]

See: Personification

Acts 20:32 (#2)

τῷ λόγῳ τῆς χάριτος αὐτοῦ

“to the word of his grace”

Paul is using the term **word** to mean the message about God’s **grace** that Jesus and his apostles shared by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the message about his grace]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:32 (#5)

τὴν κληρονομίαν

“the inheritance”

Paul is speaking as if the blessings that God gives believers were money or property that a child inherits from a father. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God’s blessings]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:32 (#6)

τοῖς ἡγιασμένοις

“the ones having been sanctified”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, it is clear from the context that it was God. Alternate translation: [the ones whom God has sanctified]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 20:32 (#4)

τῷ δυναμένῳ οἰκοδομῆσαι

“being able to build you up”

Paul is speaking as if these believers were a wall or building or other structure and the **word** of God’s **grace** was making them higher and stronger. Alternate translation: [which is able to make you more confident and mature in your faith]

See: Metaphor

Acts 20:32 (#3)

τῷ λόγῳ τῆς χάριτος αὐτοῦ

“to the word of his grace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **grace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to the message about how God has graciously saved us]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 20:33 (#2)

ἀργυρίου, ἢ χρυσίου, ἢ ἱματισμοῦ, οὐδενὸς ἐπεθύμησα

“I coveted the silver or gold or clothing of no one”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative phrase **no one** and the negative word **coveted**. Alternate translation: [I served you freely]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 20:33 (#4)

ἀργυρίου, ἢ χρυσίου, ἢ ἱματισμοῦ

“the silver or gold or clothing”

In this culture, owning expensive **clothing** was a way of storing and displaying wealth. Paul is referring to wealth by naming two of its major components. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the wealth]

See: Merism

Acts 20:33 (#3)

ἀργυρίου, ἢ χρυσίου

“the silver or gold”

Paul is referring to money by association with the way, in this culture, people used **silver** and **gold** as money. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the money]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:33 (#1)

ἀργυρίου, ἢ χρυσίου, ἢ ἱματισμοῦ, οὐδενὸς ἐπεθύμησα

“I coveted the silver or gold or clothing of no one”

The implication is that Paul did not desire any of these things and did not try to get them by charging for his ministry to the Ephesians. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I did not insist on being paid for my work] or [I did not try to become wealthy by teaching you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 20:34 (#3)

καὶ τοῖς οὖσι μετ᾽ ἐμοῦ

“and to the ones being with me”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and to the needs of those who were with me]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 20:34 (#2)

ταῖς χρείαις μου & ὑπηρέτησαν αἱ χεῖρες αὗται

“these hands ministered to my needs”

Paul is speaking of his **hands** as if they were a living thing that **ministered** to his **needs**, that is, worked to pay his expenses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I worked with my hands to pay my own expenses]

See: Personification

Acts 20:34 (#1)

αὐτοὶ γινώσκετε

“You yourselves know”

Paul is adding the word **yourselves** for emphasis. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [You know very well]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 20:35 (#6)

τῶν λόγων τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

“the words of the Lord Jesus”

Paul is using the term **words** to mean a statement that Jesus made by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the statement of the Lord Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:35 (#3)

πάντα

“all things”

Paul is using the adjective **all** as a noun. ULT adds the word **things** to show that. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [all kinds of things]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 20:35 (#7)

εἶπεν, μακάριόν ἐστιν μᾶλλον, διδόναι ἢ λαμβάνειν

“he & said, ‘It is more blessed to give than to receive”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [said that it is more blessed to give than to receive]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 20:35 (#4)

ἀντιλαμβάνεσθαι τῶν ἀσθενούντων

“to take hold of the ones being weak”

Paul is referring to helping people by association with the way that someone might **take hold** of a person who was **weak** to keep him from falling. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to help those who are weak]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:35 (#2)

πάντα & ὅτι & δεῖ

“all things, that it is necessary”

Paul says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [consistently, that it is necessary]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 20:35 (#1)

πάντα ὑπέδειξα ὑμῖν, ὅτι & δεῖ

“I showed you all things, that it is necessary”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I showed you all things in order to demonstrate that it is necessary]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 20:35 (#5)

τῶν λόγων τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ, ὅτι αὐτὸς εἶπεν

“the words of the Lord Jesus, that he himself said”

Paul is adding the word **himself** for emphasis. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [the words that none other than our Lord Jesus spoke]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 20:36 (#1)

θεὶς τὰ γόνατα αὐτοῦ

“bowing his knees”

Paul knelt down as a symbolic action to show that he was approaching God humbly in prayer. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [humbly kneeling down]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 20:37 (#2)

κατεφίλουν αὐτόν

“they were kissing him”

To kiss someone on the cheek was an expression of brotherly or friendly love in this culture. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [they were kissing him on the cheek to express their brotherly love for him]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 20:37 (#1)

ἐπιπεσόντες ἐπὶ τὸν τράχηλον τοῦ Παύλου

“falling upon the neck of Paul”

The expression **falling upon** means that the Ephesian elders put their arms around Paul. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [embracing Paul] or [putting their arms around Paul]

See: Idiom

Acts 20:38 (#2)

οὐκέτι μέλλουσιν τὸ πρόσωπον αὐτοῦ θεωρεῖν

“they were going to see his face no more”

In his statement, Paul was using one part of himself, his **face**, to represent all of himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that they were never going to see him again]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 20:38 (#1)

τῷ λόγῳ ᾧ εἰρήκει

“the word that he had spoken”

Luke is using the term **word** to mean the statement that Paul made by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the statement that he had made]

See: Metonymy

Acts 20:38 (#3)

εἰρήκει, ὅτι οὐκέτι μέλλουσιν τὸ πρόσωπον αὐτοῦ θεωρεῖν

"he had spoken, that they were going to see his face no more"

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [he had spoken, "You are going to see my face no more]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts - Chapter 21 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Acts 21:1–19 describes Paul's journey to Jerusalem. After he arrived in Jerusalem, the believers there told him that the Jews wanted to harm him and advised what he should do so they would not harm him (verses 20–26). Even though Paul did what the believers told him to do, the Jews tried to kill him. The Romans rescued him and gave him a chance to speak to the Jews.

The last verse of the chapter ends with an incomplete sentence. Most translations leave the sentence incomplete, as the ULT does.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

"They are all determined to keep the law"
The Jews in Jerusalem were following the law of Moses. Even those who were following Jesus still kept the law. Both groups thought that Paul had been telling Jews in Greece not to keep the law. But it was only the Gentiles to whom Paul was saying that.

Nazarite vow
The vow that Paul and his three friends made was probably a Nazarite vow, because they shaved their heads (Acts 21:23).

Gentiles in the temple
The Jews accused Paul of bringing a Gentile man into a part of the temple into which God only allowed Jews to go. They thought that God wanted them to punish Paul by killing him. (See: holy, holiness, unholy, sacred)

Roman citizenship
The Romans thought that they needed to treat only Roman citizens justly. They could do as they desired with people who were not Roman citizens, but they had to obey the law with other Romans. Some people were born Roman citizens, and others gave money to the Roman government so they could become Roman citizens.

Acts 21:1 (#3)

τὴν Κῶ

"Cos"

The word **Cos** is the name of an island in the South Aegean Sea.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 21:1 (#5)

Πάταρα

"Patara"

The word **Patara** is the name of a city on the southwest coast of Asia Minor.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 21:1 (#1)

ἡμᾶς & ἤλθομεν

"we & we came"

As the introduction to this chapter discusses, throughout this chapter Luke uses the pronoun **we** (as well as the pronouns "us" and "our") to refer to himself and his traveling companions, but not to his readers. So use the exclusive form of those words if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 21:1 (#2)

ἀποσπασθέντας ἀπ' αὐτῶν

"having been parted from them"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [having parted from them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:1 (#4)

τὴν Ῥόδον

"Rhodes"

The word **Rhodes** is the name of an island in the South Aegean Sea south of Cos.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 21:2 (#1)

πλοῖον διαπερῶν εἰς Φοινίκην

"a ship crossing over to Phoenicia"

Luke is speaking of this **ship** as if it were a living thing that was **crossing over** the Mediterranean Sea to Phoenicia on its own. Luke means that the crew of this ship was sailing it to Phoenicia. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a ship whose crew would be sailing it over to Phoenicia]

See: Personification

Acts 21:3 (#4)

τὸ πλοῖον ἦν ἀποφορτιζόμενον τὸν γόμον

"the ship was unloading {its} cargo"

Luke is speaking of this **ship** as if it were a living thing that was **unloading** its own **cargo**. Luke means that the crew of this ship was doing the unloading. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ship's crew was to unload its cargo]

See: Personification

Acts 21:3 (#1)

καταλιπόντες αὐτὴν εὐώνυμον

"having left it behind on the port side"

The expression **leaving it behind on the port side** means on the left side of the ship. Since the ship was sailing east, this means that it sailed to the south of the island of Cyprus. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express that meaning plainly. However, if the people of your culture are familiar with sea travel, you could use the corresponding expression that is most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [having sailed to the south of it]

See: Idiom

Acts 21:3 (#2)

κατήλθομεν εἰς Τύρον

"came down to Tyre"

Luke says that he and his companions **came down** to Tyre because that was the customary way in this culture of describing a person arriving somewhere after traveling by sea. Your language may have its own way of describing that. Alternate translation: [landed at Tyre]

See: Idiom

Acts 21:3 (#3)

ἐκεῖσε & τὸ πλοῖον ἦν ἀποφορτιζόμενον τὸν γόμον

"there the ship was unloading {its} cargo"

Luke is using the last part of a process to represent the entire process. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the ship was going there to unload its cargo]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 21:4 (#2)

ἐπιβαίνειν εἰς Ἰεροσόλυμα

"to set foot in Jerusalem"

The disciples were using one part of Paul, his **foot**, to represent all of him in the potential act of going to Jerusalem. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to go to Jerusalem]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 21:4 (#1)

οἵτινες τῷ Παύλῳ ἔλεγον

"who were saying to Paul"

The pronoun **who** refers to the **disciples** in Tyre. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers, and you may want to begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [Those disciples kept saying to Paul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 21:5 (#2)

πάντων

"everyone"

Luke says **everyone** here as a generalization. He means all of the believers with whom he and his companions were meeting in Tyre. Alternate translation: [the believers from Tyre]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 21:5 (#1)

ὅτε & ἐγένετο ἡμᾶς ἐξαρτίσαι τὰς ἡμέρας

"when it happened that we had finished the days"

Luke is speaking of the seven days when he and his traveling companions were in Tyre as if those days were something they **finished**. Alternate translation: [at the end of those seven days]

See: Idiom

Acts 21:5 (#3)

θέντες τὰ γόνατα ἐπὶ τὸν αἰγιαλὸν προσευξάμενοι

"having put down {our} knees on the shore {and} having prayed"

The travelers and their hosts knelt down as a symbolic action to show that they were approaching God humbly in prayer. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [having humbly knelt down on the shore to pray]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 21:6 (#1)

ἐκεῖνοι

"those"

The pronoun **those** refers to the believers from Tyre. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the believers from Tyre]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 21:7 (#1)

ἡμεῖς & ἐμείναμεν

"we & we stayed"

Here the word **we** refers to Luke, Paul, and those traveling with them, but not to the reader.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 21:7 (#2)

Πτολεμαΐδα

"Ptolemais"

The word **Ptolemais** is the name of a city that was south of Tyre.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 21:7 (#3)

τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς

"the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers there]

See: Metaphor

Acts 21:8 (#1)

ἐκ τῶν ἑπτὰ

"from the Seven"

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that by **the Seven**, he means the seven men who were chosen in 6:5 to distribute food and other assistance to the widows among the believers. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [one of the seven men who had been chosen to oversee the assistance that the believers were providing to widows]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:8 (#2)

τοῦ εὐαγγελιστοῦ

"the Evangelist"

Luke is using the title **evangelist** to acknowledge the special work that Philip did in proclaiming the gospel. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a descriptive phrase preceded by a comma in your translation rather than a title. Alternate translation: [, a man known for proclaiming the gospel]

See: Politeness

Acts 21:9 (#1)

δὲ

"Now"

Luke uses the word **Now** to introduce background information about the **daughters** of Philip that will help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 21:9 (#2)

τούτῳ & ἦσαν θυγατέρες τέσσαρες

"to this one were four daughters"

The pronoun **this** refers to Philip. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Philip had four daughters]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 21:10 (#2)

Ἄγαβος

"Agabus"

The word **Agabus** is the name of a man. See how you translated it in 11:28.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 21:10 (#3)

κατῆλθέν τις ἀπὸ τῆς Ἰουδαίας

“certain & came down from Judea”

Luke says that Agabus **came down** from Judea because that province is higher in elevation than Caesarea. Use a natural way in your language of referring to traveling to a lower elevation. Alternate translation: [arrived from up in Judea]

See: Idiom

Acts 21:10 (#1)

κατῆλθέν τις & προφήτης ὀνόματι Ἄγαβος

“a certain prophet, Agabus by name, came down”

Luke is using the phrase **a certain prophet** to introduce **Agabus** as a returning participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing returning participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [there was a prophet named Agabus who came down]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 21:11 (#4)

εἰς χεῖρας ἐθνῶν

“into the hands of the Gentiles”

Here, **hands** represents the power of someone, in this case the power of an authority to hold an accused person in custody. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into the custody of the Gentiles]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:11 (#5)

ἐθνῶν

“of the Gentiles”

Agabus is using the name of a whole group, **the Gentiles**, to refer to one part of that group, its members who are in authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that plainly. Alternate translation: [of the Gentile authorities]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 21:11 (#1)

ἄρας τὴν ζώνην τοῦ Παύλου, δήσας ἑαυτοῦ τοὺς πόδας καὶ τὰς χεῖρας

“having taken the belt of Paul, having bound his own feet and hands”

Agabus bound his own feet and hands with Paul’s belt as a symbolic action to illustrate the prophecy he was delivering. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [having taken the belt of Paul and bound his own feet and hands to illustrate the prophecy he was delivering]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 21:11 (#2)

τάδε λέγει τὸ Πνεῦμα τὸ Ἅγιον, τὸν ἄνδρα οὗ ἐστιν ἡ ζώνη αὕτη, οὕτως δήσουσιν ἐν Ἰερουσαλὴμ οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι, καὶ παραδώσουσιν εἰς χεῖρας ἐθνῶν

“The Holy Spirit says these things: ‘Thus will the Jews in Jerusalem bind the man of whom is this belt, and they will deliver him into the hands of the Gentiles”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [The Holy Spirit says that in this way the Jews in Jerusalem will bind the man who owns this belt and that they will deliver him into the hands of the Gentiles]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 21:11 (#3)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Agabus is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to one part of that group, its leaders. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that plainly. Alternate translation: [the leaders of the Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 21:12 (#2)

παρεκαλοῦμεν ἡμεῖς

“we & were urging”

Luke means implicitly that this **urging** included weeping over what would happen to Paul if he went to Jerusalem, as the next verse indicates. You can include this information here if that would be helpful to

your readers. Alternate translation: [were weeping and urging]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:12 (#1)

οἱ ἐντόπιοι

"the locals"

Luke is using the adjective **locals** as a noun to mean the believers who lived in that local area, that is, Caesarea. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the believers who lived in Caesarea]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 21:12 (#3)

τοῦ μὴ ἀναβαίνειν & εἰς Ἰερουσαλήμ

"not to go up to Jerusalem"

Luke says **to go up** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling to Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Caesarea is lower in elevation. Use a natural way in your language of referring to traveling to a higher elevation.

See: Idiom

Acts 21:13 (#5)

ὑπὲρ τοῦ ὀνόματος τοῦ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ

"for the name of the Lord Jesus"

This could mean: (1) that the **name** of Jesus represents his person. Alternate translation: [out of loyalty to the Lord Jesus]; (2) that the **name** of Jesus represents his cause in the world. Alternate translation: [for the cause of the Lord Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:13 (#3)

συνθρύπτοντές μου τὴν καρδίαν

"breaking my heart"

In this context, the **heart** represents the emotions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [making me so sad]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:13 (#4)

οὐ μόνον δεθῆναι

"not only to be bound"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [not only for them to bind me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:13 (#1)

τί ποιεῖτε, κλαίοντες καὶ συνθρύπτοντές μου τὴν καρδίαν

"What are you doing, weeping and breaking my heart"

Paul is using the question form to insist that the believers in Caesarea do not need to weep over what will happen to him if he goes to Jerusalem. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Please do not weep like that, breaking my heart]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 21:13 (#2)

συνθρύπτοντές μου τὴν καρδίαν

"breaking my heart"

Paul is speaking as if the believers in Caesarea were literally **breaking** his **heart**. He means that they are making him very sad. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [making me so sad]

See: Metaphor

Acts 21:14 (#2)

μὴ πειθομένου

"as & was not being persuaded"

Luke assumes that his readers will understand what he and the others were not persuading Paul about. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he was not being persuaded not to go to Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:14 (#1)

μὴ πειθομένου & αὐτοῦ

"as he was not being persuaded"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we were not persuading him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:14 (#3)

τοῦ Κυρίου τὸ θέλημα γινέσθω

"Let the will of the Lord happen"

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [May the will of the Lord happen]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 21:15 (#1)

ἀνεβαίνομεν εἰς Ἰεροσόλυμα

"we went up to Jerusalem"

Luke says that he and his traveling companions **went up** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling to Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Use a natural way of referring in your language to traveling to a higher elevation.

See: Idiom

Acts 21:16 (#1)

τινι Κυπρίῳ ἀρχαίῳ μαθητῇ

"a certain Cypriot, an early disciple"

Luke is using the phrase **a certain early disciple** to introduce **Mnason** as a new participant in the story. The phrase **early disciple** introduces him as one of the first people to believe in Jesus. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [a Cypriot who was one of the first believers]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 21:16 (#3)

παρ' ᾧ ξενισθῶμεν

"with whom we would be hosted"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [who would be hosting us]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:16 (#2)

Μνάσωνί & Κυπρίῳ

"to Mnason & Cypriot"

The word **Mnason** is the name of a man. The word **Cypriot** is the name for someone who lives on or comes from the island of Cyprus. See how you translated it in 11:20.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 21:17 (#1)

οἱ ἀδελφοί

"the brothers"

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the believers there]

See: Metaphor

Acts 21:20 (#3)

ἀδελφέ

"brother"

James and the elders using the term **brother** to mean someone who shares the same faith. Since this expression occurs in direct discourse, you may want to preserve it in your translation to show how these believers addressed one another.

See: Metaphor

Acts 21:20 (#5)

πάντες ζηλωταὶ τοῦ νόμου ὑπάρχουσιν

"they are all zealous for the law"

James and the elders say **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [they are very zealous for the law]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 21:20 (#4)

ὑπάρχουσιν

"they are"

In this instance the pronoun **they** refers to the believing Jews whom James and the elders are describing. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [these believing Jews are]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 21:20 (#1)

οἱ & ἐδόξαζον & εἶπόν & αὐτῷ

“they were glorifying & they said to him”

The pronoun **they** refers in these instances to James and the elders, and the pronoun **him** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [James and the elders were glorifying … they said to Paul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 21:20 (#2)

θεωρεῖς

“You see”

Paul does not physically **see** these tens of thousands of Jewish believers. James and the elders mean that he knows about them. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You know]

See: Metaphor

Acts 21:21 (#6)

μηδὲ τοῖς ἔθεσιν περιπατεῖν

“nor to walk in the customs”

By **the customs**, James and the elders implicitly mean the customs that Jews ordinarily observe. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [nor to observe our Jewish customs]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:21 (#3)

ἀποστασίαν & ἀπὸ Μωϋσέως

“apostasy from Moses”

James and the elders are referring to the Jewish law by association with **Moses**, through whom God gave the law. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [apostasy from the law of Moses]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:21 (#5)

μηδὲ τοῖς ἔθεσιν περιπατεῖν

“nor to walk in the customs”

James and the elders are speaking as if the Jewish **customs** were a path that people walked on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [nor to observe the customs]

See: Metaphor

Acts 21:21 (#4)

ἀποστασίαν & ἀπὸ Μωϋσέως

“apostasy from Moses”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **apostasy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [not to obey the law of Moses]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 21:21 (#1)

κατηχήθησαν & περὶ σοῦ

“they have been told about you”

James and the elders mean implicitly that people **have been told** this about Paul even though it is not true. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [even though it is not true, they have been told about you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:21 (#2)

κατηχήθησαν

“they have been told”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [people have told them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:22 (#2)

τί οὖν ἐστιν

“What therefore is it”

James and the elders are using the question form to introduce what they think Paul should do in response to the situation they have described. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You need to do something about this!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 21:22 (#1)

τί οὖν ἐστιν

“What therefore is it”

James and the elders are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [What therefore is it that you should do] or [So what should you do about this]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 21:23 (#3)

ἀφ’ ἑαυτῶν

“from themselves”

Some ancient manuscripts read **from themselves**. That would be indicating that these men made the vow on their own initiative. ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “upon themselves.” That would be indicating that the men still needed to fulfill the commitment implicit in the vow to make an offering in the temple at the end of the time during which the conditions of the vow were in effect. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 21:23 (#1)

λέγομεν

“we say”

As the introduction to this chapter indicates, by **we**, James and the elders mean themselves but Paul, to whom they are speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 21:23 (#2)

εὐχὴν ἔχοντες

“having a vow”

See how you translated the term **vow** in 18:18.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 21:24 (#5)

ἵνα ξυρήσονται τὴν κεφαλήν

“so that they will shear {their} heads”

Even though James and the elders are using the future tense, they are actually stating the purpose for which Paul would be purified with these four men and pay their expenses. Use a natural way in your language for expressing a purpose. Alternate translation: [so that they may shear their heads] or [so that they will be able to shear their heads to show that they have fulfilled their vows]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Acts 21:24 (#8)

καὶ αὐτὸς, φυλάσσων τὸν νόμον

“also keeping the law yourself”

James and the elders are using the word **yourself** for emphasis. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [You too observe the law very carefully]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 21:24 (#3)

δαπάνησον ἐπ’ αὐτοῖς

“pay the expenses for them”

James and the elders assume that Paul will know that the **expenses** at the end of a vow included buying a male and female lamb, a ram, grain, and wine for offerings. They also assume that Paul will know that the Jews considered paying such expenses for those who could not afford them to be an act of great piety. Alternate translation: [piously help them buy the animals and foods they will need for offerings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:24 (#1)

ἁγνίσθητι σὺν αὐτοῖς

“be purified with them”

James and the elders assume that Paul will know that in order to make an offering at the end of the time of their vows, these men will need to be made ceremonially clean so that they can go into the temple area. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [be purified with them so that you can all go to the temple area together]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:24 (#2)

ἁγνίσθητι

“be purified”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [participate in a purification ceremony]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:24 (#4)

ἵνα ξυρήσονται τὴν κεφαλήν

“so that they will shear {their} heads”

The men would cut the hair off **their heads** to show that he had fulfilled the vows that they had made to God. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. See how you translated it in 18:18.

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 21:24 (#7)

κατήχηνται περὶ σοῦ

“they have been told about you”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people have told them about you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:24 (#6)

ὧν κατήχηνται περὶ σοῦ οὐδέν ἐστιν

“there is nothing in the things they have been told about you”

The expression **there is nothing in** these things means that they are not true. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the things they have been told about you are not true]

See: Idiom

Acts 21:25 (#2)

τό & εἰδωλόθυτον & πνικτὸν

“the idol-sacrificed & the strangled”

James and the elders are using the adjectives **idol-sacrificed** and **strangled** as nouns to mean specific kinds of animals. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate these words with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [animals that have been offered to idols ... animals that have been killed by strangulation]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 21:25 (#3)

τό & εἰδωλόθυτον & πνικτὸν

“the idol-sacrificed & the strangled”

James and the elders are referring by association to meat from animals that have been offered to idols or killed by strangulation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from eating the meat of animals that have been offered to idols ... from what is killed by strangulation]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:25 (#4)

πνικτὸν

“the strangled”

God did not allow the Jews to consume blood in any form. Therefore, they could not eat the meat from an animal that had been strangled, because the blood would not have been properly drained from the body of the animal. James and the elders wanted Gentiles who believed in Jesus not to consume blood either. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand the sentence. Alternate translation: [the meat of animals that have been killed by strangulation, because this meat still contains blood]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:25 (#1)

ἡμεῖς ἀπεστείλαμεν & φυλάσσεσθαι αὐτοὺς

“we sent that they should guard”

James and the elders are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [we sent them a letter telling them that they should guard themselves from]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 21:26 (#4)

τὸ ἱερόν

“the temple”

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when Luke says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:26 (#7)

τῶν ἡμερῶν τοῦ ἁγνισμοῦ

"of the days of purification"

In this case Luke is referring implicitly to a separate **purification** process from the one the men fulfilled in order to enter the temple area. He means the purification process that came at the end of a vow. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [of the days of purification at the end of their vows]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:26 (#1)

τοὺς ἄνδρας

"the men"

Luke implicitly means the four **men** who had made a vow. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the men who had each made a vow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:26 (#3)

ἁγνισθεὶς

"having been purified"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [having participated in a purification ceremony]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:26 (#6)

διαγγέλλων τὴν ἐκπλήρωσιν τῶν ἡμερῶν τοῦ ἁγνισμοῦ

"declaring the fulfillment of the days of purification"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **purification**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [declaring that the men had kept their vows for the number of days that they had promised and that they could now be purified]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 21:26 (#5)

διαγγέλλων τὴν ἐκπλήρωσιν τῶν ἡμερῶν τοῦ ἁγνισμοῦ

"declaring the fulfillment of the days of purification"

Luke is using the possessive form **the days of purification** to mean the days during which the men's vows were in effect, at the end of which there needed to be a **purification** ceremony. Alternate translation: [declaring that the men had kept their vows for the number of days that they had promised and that they could now be purified]

See: Possession

Acts 21:26 (#8)

ἕως οὗ προσηνέχθη ὑπὲρ ἑνὸς ἑκάστου αὐτῶν ἡ προσφορά

"until the offering was offered for each one of them"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [until each one of them offered an offering for himself]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:26 (#2)

ἁγνισθεὶς

"having been purified"

Luke is referring implicitly to the purification ceremony that allowed Paul and these men to enter the temple area. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [having been purified in order to enter the temple area]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:27 (#3)

ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ

"in the temple"

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when Luke says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:27 (#5)

τὸν ὄχλον

“the & crowd”

By the **crowd**, Luke implicitly means the crowd of people who had come to Jerusalem from all over the Roman Empire for the Pentecost festival. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the whole crowd of people who had come to Jerusalem for the Pentecost festival]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:27 (#2)

οἱ ἀπὸ τῆς Ἀσίας Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews from Asia”

Luke implicitly means some **Jews from Asia** who had come to Jerusalem for the Pentecost festival, as described in 20:16. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [some Jews from Asia who had come to Jerusalem for the Pentecost festival]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:27 (#4)

συνέχεον πάντα τὸν ὄχλον

“were agitating the whole crowd”

Luke says **whole** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [were making many people in the crowd very agitated]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 21:27 (#1)

αἱ ἑπτὰ ἡμέραι

“the seven days”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that he means the **seven days** that were customarily required for the offerings and purification ceremony at the end of a vow. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the seven days that it took to purify these men]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:27 (#6)

ἐπέβαλον ἐπ’ αὐτὸν τὰς χεῖρας

“they laid {their} hands on him”

The expression **laid hands on** means to arrest or detain someone, by association with the way that arresting officers or concerned citizens might physically take hold of a person with their **hands**. Alternate translation: [they held onto him] or [they detained him]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:28 (#5)

τὸ ἱερὸν

“the temple”

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when Luke says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:28 (#4)

εἰς τὸ ἱερὸν

“into the temple”

The Jews from Asia assume that their listeners will understand that only Jewish males were allowed in certain areas of the courtyard of the Jerusalem **temple** and that they are accusing Paul of bringing **Greeks** into those areas. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [into areas of the temple courtyard where they are not allowed to go]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:28 (#2)

πάντας πανταχῇ

“all everywhere”

The Jews from Asia are saying **all** and **everywhere** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [people throughout the empire]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 21:28 (#1)

ἄνδρες, Ἰσραηλεῖται

“Men, Israelites”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular group of people. Alternate translation: [You Israelites]

See: Idiom

Acts 21:28 (#3)

τοῦ λαοῦ, καὶ τοῦ νόμου, καὶ τοῦ τόπου τούτου

"the people and the law and this place"

The Jews from Asia assume that their listeners will understand that they are referring to the special status of the people of Israel as God's chosen people, the law of Moses, and the temple in Jerusalem. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel and the law of Moses and this temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:29 (#1)

In this verse, Luke is giving the reason why the Jews from the province of Asia thought that Paul had "defiled" the temple area by bringing "Greeks" into it. To put the reason before the result, you could create a verse bridge for verses 28–29. It might say something like this: "Now some Jews from Asia had seen Trophimus the Ephesian with Paul in the city. When they saw Paul in the temple when the seven days were about to be finished, they were thinking that Paul had brought Trophimus into the temple. So they were agitating the whole crowd, and they laid their hands on him, shouting, 'Men, Israelites, help! This is the man teaching all everywhere against the people and the law and this place. And he has even both brought Greeks into the temple and has defiled this holy place.'"

See: Verse Bridges

Acts 21:29 (#2)

Τρόφιμον

"Trophimus"

The word **Trophimus** is the name of a man. See how you translated this name in 20:4.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 21:30 (#4)

ἔξω τοῦ ἱεροῦ

"outside of the temple"

Only priests were allowed inside the temple building, so when Luke says **the temple** here, he means the courtyard associated with the temple. Alternate translation: [of the temple courtyard]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:30 (#5)

ἐκλείσθησαν αἱ θύραι

"the doors were shut"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, the context suggests that it would have been the temple gatekeepers. Alternate translation: [the gatekeepers shut the doors]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:30 (#3)

ἐκινήθη & ἡ πόλις ὅλη

"the whole city was excited"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the people of the city were very angry]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:30 (#2)

ἐκινήθη & ἡ πόλις ὅλη

"the whole city was excited"

Luke says **the whole** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [the people of the city were very excited]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 21:30 (#1)

ἐκινήθη & ἡ πόλις ὅλη

"the whole city was excited"

Here, the word **city** means the people who lived in the city of Jerusalem. Alternate translation: [all the people of the city became excited]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:30 (#6)

ἐκλείσθησαν αἱ θύραι

"the doors were shut"

The implication is that the gatekeepers **shut** the **doors** to the temple courtyard once the mob dragged Paul outside so that the mob would not defile the temple precincts by killing Paul within them. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the gatekeepers shut the doors so that the mob would not defile the temple courtyard by killing Paul there]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:31 (#7)

ὅλη συνχύννεται Ἰερουσαλήμ

"all Jerusalem was agitated"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [something was greatly agitating the people who lived in Jerusalem]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:31 (#6)

ὅλη συνχύννεται Ἰερουσαλήμ

"all Jerusalem was agitated"

Luke says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [the people who lived in the city of Jerusalem were very agitated] or [the people who lived in the city of Jerusalem were rioting]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 21:31 (#1)

ζητούντων τε αὐτὸν ἀποκτεῖναι

"And as they were seeking to kill him"

The pronoun **they** refers to the mob, and the pronoun **him** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And as the mob was seeking to kill Paul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 21:31 (#3)

ἀνέβη φάσις τῷ χιλιάρχῳ τῆς σπείρης

"a report came up to the chiliarch of the cohort"

Luke uses the phrase **came up** because the commander was in a fortress connected to the temple that was higher in elevation than the temple courtyard. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a messenger brought a report to the commander of the guard up in the temple fortress]

See: Idiom

Acts 21:31 (#2)

ἀνέβη φάσις τῷ χιλιάρχῳ τῆς σπείρης

"a report came up to the chiliarch of the cohort"

Luke is speaking of this **report** as if they were a living thing that **came up to the commander** on its own. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a messenger brought a report to the commander of the guard]

See: Personification

Acts 21:31 (#4)

τῷ χιλιάρχῳ τῆς σπείρης

"to the chiliarch of the cohort"

A **chiliarch** was an officer in the Roman army who was in charge of a group of 1,000 soldiers. A **cohort** was a large military guard unit. Alternate translation: [to the commander of the military guard]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 21:31 (#5)

ὅλη συνχύννεται Ἰερουσαλήμ

"all Jerusalem was agitated"

Here, the word **Jerusalem** means the people who lived in the city of Jerusalem. Alternate translation: [all the people who lived in the city of Jerusalem were agitated]

See: Metonymy

Acts 21:32 (#2)

ἑκατοντάρχας

"centurions"

A **centurion** was an officer in the Roman army who was in charge of a group of 100 soldiers. See how you translated it in 10:1. Alternate translation: [their commanding officers]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 21:32 (#1)

ὃς ἐξαυτῆς παραλαβὼν στρατιώτας καὶ ἑκατοντάρχας, κατέδραμεν ἐπ' αὐτούς

“who, immediately taking soldiers and centurions, ran down to them”

The pronoun **who** refers to the chiliarch (the Roman commander), and the pronoun **them** refer to the people who were rioting. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [The commander immediately took soldiers and centurions and ran down to them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 21:33 (#2)

ἐκέλευσε δεθῆναι

“commanded him to be bound”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [commanded his soldiers to bind him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:33 (#1)

ἐκέλευσε δεθῆναι ἁλύσεσι δυσί

“commanded him to be bound with two chains”

These means implicitly that the commander ordered his soldiers to chain Paul to one soldier on each side of him. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [commanded him to be chained to one soldier on each side of him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:33 (#3)

ἐπυνθάνετο τίς εἴη καὶ τί ἐστιν πεποιηκώς

“he was asking who he might be and what he had done”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [he was asking, “Who is this? What has he done?”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 21:33 (#4)

ἐπυνθάνετο

“he was asking”

Luke means implicitly that the commander **was asking** the people in the crowd these questions, not that he was asking them of Paul. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he was asking the people in the crowd]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 21:34 (#3)

ἐκέλευσεν ἄγεσθαι αὐτὸν

“ordered him to be brought”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [ordered his soldiers to bring Paul]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:34 (#2)

τὸ ἀσφαλὲς

“the certain”

Luke is using the adjective **certain** as a noun to mean what was reliable or true about Paul. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the truth about Paul]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 21:34 (#1)

αὐτοῦ & αὐτὸν

“he & him”

The pronoun **he** refers to the commander, and the pronoun **him** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the commander ... Paul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 21:35 (#1)

βαστάζεσθαι αὐτὸν ὑπὸ τῶν στρατιωτῶν

“he was carried by the soldiers”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the soldiers carried him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:35 (#2)

διὰ τὴν βίαν τοῦ ὄχλου

“because of the violence of the crowd”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **violence**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because the crowd was so violent]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 21:36 (#1)

αἶρε αὐτόν

"Take him away"

The crowd is using somewhat milder and less exact language to ask for Paul's death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a mild way of referring to this in your language or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Put him to death]

See: Euphemism

Acts 21:37 (#1)

μέλλων & εἰσάγεσθαι εἰς τὴν παρεμβολὴν, ὁ Παῦλος

"being about to be brought into the fortress, Paul"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [as the soldiers were about to bring Paul inside the fortress, Paul]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 21:37 (#2)

ὁ Παῦλος λέγει

"Paul says"

To call attention to a development in the story, here Luke uses the present tense in past narration. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense in your translation. Alternate translation: [Paul said]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Acts 21:37 (#3)

ὁ Παῦλος λέγει τῷ χιλιάρχῳ, εἰ ἔξεστίν μοι εἰπεῖν τι πρὸς σέ

"Paul says to the chiliarch, "If it is permitted for me to say something to you"

Luke is recording how Paul used the typical form in his language for asking questions. It may be more natural in your language to have an indirect quotation here. Alternate translation: [Paul asked the chiliarch if it was permitted for him to say something to him]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 21:37 (#4)

Ἑλληνιστὶ γινώσκεις

"Do you know Greek"

The commander is using the question form to express surprise that Paul is not who he thought he was. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You know Greek!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 21:38 (#2)

τῶν σικαρίων

"of the Sicarii"

The term **Sicarii** is a Latin word. Luke spells it out using Greek letters so his readers will know how it sounds. The term means an assassin and it comes from the Latin word for a dagger. In this context, it refers to a group of Jewish rebels who carried daggers under their robes and killed Romans and people who supported the Romans. In your translation, you could spell this the way it sounds in your language, or you could use a term with the same meaning. Alternate translation: [of the Assassins]

See: Copy or Borrow Words

Acts 21:38 (#1)

οὐκ ἄρα σὺ εἶ ὁ Αἰγύπτιος, ὁ πρὸ τούτων τῶν ἡμερῶν, ἀναστατώσας καὶ ἐξαγαγὼν εἰς τὴν ἔρημον τοὺς τετρακισχιλίους ἄνδρας τῶν σικαρίων

"Then are you not the Egyptian having revolted before these days and having led 4,000 men of the Sicarii into the wilderness"

The commander is using the question form to emphasize the conclusion he has drawn about Paul. Jews who spoke Greek typically came from somewhere outside of Palestine, and since Paul seems to be someone whom the Jews in Jerusalem consider to be very dangerous, the commander concludes that he must be **the Egyptian** he knows about. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Then you must not be the Egyptian who before these days revolted and led the 4,000 men of the Assassins into the wilderness!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 21:39 (#3)

ἐπίτρεψόν μοι

“allow me”

This is an imperative, but as Paul’s phrase **I ask of you** shows, it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please allow me]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 21:39 (#2)

οὐκ ἀσήμου πόλεως πολίτης

“a citizen of a not undistinguished city”

Paul is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a very distinguished city]

See: Litotes

Acts 21:39 (#1)

Ταρσεὺς

“a Tarsian”

The word **Tarsian** is the name for someone who comes from the city of Tarsus.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 21:40 (#2)

κατέσεισε τῇ χειρὶ τῷ λαῷ

“motioned with {his} hand to the people”

This likely means that Paul waved his hand to get the attention of the audience and signal that he was about to speak. He did this to quiet them. Alternate translation: [waved his hand to the people to signal that he was about to speak]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 21:40 (#1)

ἐπιτρέψαντος & αὐτοῦ

“when he allowed”

The pronoun **he** refers to the Roman commander. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when the commander allowed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts - Chapter 22 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This is the second account of Paul’s conversion in the book of Acts. Because this is such an important event in the early church, there are three accounts of Paul’s conversion. (See: Acts 9 and Acts 26)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

“In the Hebrew language”

Most Jews at this time spoke Aramaic and Greek. Most of the people who spoke Hebrew were educated Jewish scholars. This is why the people paid attention when Paul started speaking in Hebrew.

“The Way”

No one knows for sure who first started calling believers “followers of the Way.” This is probably what the believers called themselves, because the Bible often speaks of a person living his life as if that person were walking on a path or “way.” If this is true, the believers were “following the way of the Lord” by living in a way that pleased God.

Roman citizenship

The Romans thought that they needed to treat only Roman citizens justly. They could do as they desired with people who were not Roman citizens, but they had to obey the law with other Romans. Some people were born Roman citizens, and others gave money to the Roman government so they could become Roman citizens. The “chief captain” could have been punished for treating a Roman citizen the same way he would treat a noncitizen.

Acts 22:1 (#2)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοὶ καὶ πατέρες

“Men, brothers and fathers”

Paul is using the word **brothers** to refer to his fellow Israelites. He is using the word **fathers** to refer either to Jewish leaders who may be present or to Jewish men who are older than he is. In both cases he is speaking respectfully. Alternate translation: [My fellow Israelites and you leaders of Israel] or [My fellow Israelites young and old]

See: Metaphor

Acts 22:1 (#3)

ἀκούσατέ μου τῆς πρὸς ὑμᾶς νυνὶ ἀπολογίας

“hear my defense to you now”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as "please" to make this clear. Alternate translation: [please listen as I explain myself]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 22:1 (#1)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοὶ καὶ πατέρες

"Men, brothers and fathers"

This is an idiomatic form of address. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular group of people. Alternate translation: [You brothers and fathers of mine]

See: Idiom

Acts 22:2 (#1)

μᾶλλον παρέσχον ἡσυχίαν

"they granted more quietness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **quietness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [they became even more quiet]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 22:3 (#7)

καθὼς πάντες ὑμεῖς ἐστε σήμερον

"as you all are today"

Paul compares himself with the crowd. Alternate translation: [in the same way that all of you are today]

Acts 22:3 (#3)

ἀνατεθραμμένος δὲ ἐν τῇ πόλει ταύτῃ, παρὰ τοὺς πόδας Γαμαλιήλ, πεπαιδευμένος

"but educated in this city at the feet of Gamaliel, instructed"

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could state this using active forms. It may be helpful to begin new sentences here. Alternate translation: [However, Gamaliel educated me in this city. He instructed me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:3 (#1)

γεγεννημένος ἐν Ταρσῷ τῆς Κιλικίας

"born in Tarsus of Cilicia"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a native of Tarsus of Cilicia]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:3 (#4)

Γαμαλιήλ

"of Gamaliel"

The word **Gamaliel** is the name of the man who was one of the most prominent teachers of the Jewish law at this time. See how you translated his name in 5:34.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 22:3 (#6)

πατρῴου

"of our fathers"

Peter is using the term **fathers** to mean "ancestors." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 22:3 (#2)

ἀνατεθραμμένος δὲ ἐν τῇ πόλει ταύτῃ, παρὰ τοὺς πόδας Γαμαλιήλ, πεπαιδευμένος

"but educated in this city at the feet of Gamaliel, instructed"

Paul is using the phrase **at the feet** to refer to Gamaliel himself by association with the way a student in this culture would sit at the feet of a teacher (that is, on the ground in front of a teacher) while learning from him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but educated in this city by Gamaliel, instructed]

See: Metonymy

Acts 22:3 (#5)

κατὰ ἀκρίβειαν

"according to the strictness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **strictness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [according to the most strict interpretation]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 22:4 (#2)

ὃς & ἐδίωξα

“who persecuted”

Paul is using the pronoun **who** to refer to himself. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [I persecuted]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 22:4 (#3)

ταύτην τὴν Ὁδὸν

“this Way”

Here, **this Way** represents the people who belonged to the group called the Way. Alternate translation: [I persecuted the people who belonged to the group called the Way]

See: Metonymy

Acts 22:4 (#1)

ὃς ταύτην τὴν Ὁδὸν ἐδίωξα ἄχρι θανάτου

“who persecuted this Way unto death”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **death**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [who persecuted this Way to the point of killing those who belonged to it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 22:4 (#4)

ταύτην τὴν Ὁδὸν

“this Way”

As the introduction to chapter 9 explains, **the Way** was one of the first names that people used to describe the community of believers in Jesus. If your language has a word for “way” or “path” that you can use as a name, it would be appropriate to use it in your translation. See what you did in 9:2.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 22:5 (#3)

τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς

“the brothers”

Paul is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [our fellow Jews]

See: Metaphor

Acts 22:5 (#5)

ἵνα τιμωρηθῶσιν

“so that they might be punished”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in order that they might receive punishment]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:5 (#2)

τὸ πρεσβυτέριον

“the elderhood”

Paul is referring to the Sanhedrin by association with the way it was composed of the elders of the Jewish people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Sanhedrin]

See: Metonymy

Acts 22:5 (#1)

μαρτυρεῖ μοι

“testifies for me”

Paul is speaking politely of the high priest as if it may be assumed that he will willingly testify to what he knows to be true. Use a form in your language that implicitly suggests good will on the part of someone. Alternate translation: [will tell you about me]

See: Politeness

Acts 22:5 (#4)

ἄξων & τοὺς ἐκεῖσε ὄντας, δεδεμένους εἰς Ἰερουσαλὴμ

“going to bring back bound to Jerusalem & those being there”

If your language does not use the passive form **bound**, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to bind those who were there and bring them back to Jerusalem]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:6 (#1)

ἐγένετο δέ μοι

"And it happened to me that"

Paul is using this phrase to introduce a significant development in his story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for this purpose.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 22:7 (#3)

τί με διώκεις

"why are you persecuting me"

The voice is using the question form to rebuke Saul. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate its words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the rebuke in another way. Alternate translation: [you should not be persecuting me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 22:7 (#2)

φωνῆς λεγούσης μοι

"a voice saying to me"

Paul is using one part of this speaker, his **voice**, to represent all of him in the act of speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [someone saying to me]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 22:7 (#1)

φωνῆς λεγούσης μοι, Σαοὺλ, Σαούλ, τί με διώκεις

"a voice saying to me, 'Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting me"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [someone addressing me by name and asking me why I was persecuting him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:8 (#2)

τίς εἶ, κύριε

"Who are you, Lord"

Paul was not yet acknowledging that Jesus was **Lord**. He used that respectful title because he recognized that he was speaking to someone of divine power. If this might be confusing for your readers, you could use a similar term of respect. Alternate translation: [Who are you, Sir]

See: Politeness

Acts 22:8 (#1)

ἐγὼ δὲ ἀπεκρίθην, τίς εἶ, κύριε? εἶπέν τε πρὸς ἐμέ, ἐγώ εἰμι Ἰησοῦς ὁ Ναζωραῖος, ὃν σὺ διώκεις

"And I answered, 'Who are you, Lord?' And he said to me, 'I am Jesus the Nazarene, whom you are persecuting"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And in response I asked this divine figure who he was, and he told me that he was Jesus the Nazarene, whom I was persecuting]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:9 (#1)

τὴν & φωνὴν οὐκ ἤκουσαν

"they did not hear the voice"

In this context the word **hear** likely means "understand," since Luke says in 9:7 that the men traveling with Paul did actually hear the voice. You may wish to make this clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [they did not understand the voice]

See: Idiom

Acts 22:10 (#3)

πάντων ὧν τέτακταί

"all that has been appointed"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, it is clear from the context that it was God. Alternate translation: [all that God has appointed]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:10 (#2)

σοι λαληθήσεται

"it will be told to you"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way

that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone will tell you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:10 (#1)

εἶπον δέ, τί ποιήσω, Κύριε? ὁ δὲ Κύριος εἶπεν πρός με, ἀναστὰς πορεύου εἰς Δαμασκόν, κἀκεῖ σοι λαληθήσεται περὶ πάντων ὧν τέτακταί σοι ποιῆσαι

"But I said, 'What should I do, Lord?' And the Lord said to me, 'Arising, go into Damascus, and there it will be told to you about all that has been appointed to you to do"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [But I asked the Lord what I should do, and the Lord told me to get up and go into Damascus, because there it would be told to me about all that had been appointed to me to do.] (There should no quotation mark at the end.)

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:11 (#2)

χειραγωγούμενος ὑπὸ τῶν συνόντων μοι

"being led by the hand by the ones being with me"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [with the ones being with me leading me by the hand]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:11 (#1)

ἀπὸ τῆς δόξης τοῦ φωτὸς ἐκείνου

"because of the glory of that light"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because that light was so bright]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 22:11 (#3)

ἦλθον

"I came"

In a context such as this, your language might say "went" instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [I went]

See: Go and Come

Acts 22:12 (#2)

μαρτυρούμενος ὑπὸ πάντων τῶν κατοικούντων Ἰουδαίων

"being attested by all the Jews living there"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom all the Jews there attested] or [of whom all the Jews there spoke well]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:12 (#1)

τις ἀνὴρ εὐλαβὴς

"a certain devout man"

Paul is using the phrase **a certain devout man** to introduce **Ananias** as a new participant in his story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 22:13 (#2)

Σαοὺλ, ἀδελφέ

"Saul, brother"

Ananias was using the word **brother** as a title for **Saul**. The two men were not actual brothers. This could mean: (1) that Ananias was already addressing Saul as someone who shared the same faith. Alternate translation: [Saul, my fellow believer]; (2) that Ananias is addressing Saul as a fellow Israelite, as the word "brother" is used in 3:17 and many other places in this book. Alternate translation: [Saul, my fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Acts 22:13 (#1)

εἶπέν μοι, Σαοὺλ, ἀδελφέ, ἀνάβλεψον

"said to me, 'Saul, brother, look up"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [addressed me as a brother and told me to look up]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:13 (#5)

αὐτῇ τῇ ὥρᾳ

"in the same hour"

In the ancient world, an **hour** was the shortest time span that people envisioned. In this context, the term does not mean a literal hour of 60 minutes, but it means the shortest time imaginable. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [right at that instant]

See: Idiom

Acts 22:13 (#6)

κἀγὼ & ἀνέβλεψα εἰς αὐτόν

“And & I looked up to him”

Paul means implicitly that when he **looked up** at Ananias, he was able to see him clearly. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And … when I looked up at him, I could see him] or see next note for another possibility.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 22:13 (#3)

ἀνάβλεψον

“look up”

In one sense, this was not a command that Paul was capable of obeying, since he could not see. Instead, it was a command that directly caused him to be healed, if he would **look up** as if he could see. Alternate translation: [if you look up, you will be able to see] or see next note for another possibility.

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 22:13 (#4)

ἀνάβλεψον

“look up”

The expression **look up** can also mean “see again,” that is, to have one’s sight restored. If this is the meaning, then Ananias was telling Paul what Jesus was going to do for him. Alternate translation: [Jesus is restoring your sight]

See: Idiom

Acts 22:14 (#2)

τῶν πατέρων

“of & fathers”

Paul is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 22:14 (#4)

τὸν Δίκαιον

“the Righteous One”

Ananias is referring to the Messiah by association with the way the Messiah was **Righteous**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Messiah]

See: Metonymy

Acts 22:14 (#3)

τὸν Δίκαιον

“the Righteous One”

Ananias is using the adjective **Righteous** as a noun to mean a particular person who is righteous. ULT adds the word **one** to show that. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the One who is righteous]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 22:14 (#5)

φωνὴν ἐκ τοῦ στόματος αὐτοῦ

“the voice from his mouth”

It might seem that the expression **the voice from his own mouth** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [his own voice]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 22:14 (#1)

ὁ δὲ εἶπεν, ὁ Θεὸς τῶν πατέρων ἡμῶν προεχειρίσατό σε γνῶναι τὸ θέλημα αὐτοῦ καὶ ἰδεῖν τὸν Δίκαιον, καὶ ἀκοῦσαι φωνὴν ἐκ τοῦ στόματος αὐτοῦ

“And he said, ‘The God of our fathers appointed you to know his will and to see the Righteous One and to hear the voice from his mouth”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And he told me that the God of our fathers had appointed me to know his will and to see the Righteous One and to hear the voice from his mouth]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:15 (#1)

ὅτι ἔσῃ μάρτυς αὐτῷ πρὸς πάντας ἀνθρώπους, ὧν ἑώρακας καὶ ἤκουσας

"for you will be a witness for him to all men of what you have seen and heard"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation, continuing from the previous verse: [because I would be a witness for him to all men of what I had seen and heard]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:15 (#2)

πρὸς πάντας ἀνθρώπους

"to all men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, Ananias was using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a term in your language that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [to all people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 22:16 (#1)

καὶ νῦν τί μέλλεις? ἀναστὰς, βάπτισαι καὶ ἀπόλουσαι τὰς ἁμαρτίας σου, ἐπικαλεσάμενος τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ

"And now, why are you delaying? Arising, be baptized and wash away your sins, calling on his name"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [He asked me why I was delaying, and he told me to arise and be baptized and wash away my sins, calling on the name of Jesus]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:16 (#7)

τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ

"his name"

By **his name**, Ananias implicitly means the name of Jesus. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the name of Jesus]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 22:16 (#4)

βάπτισαι

"be baptized"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [receive baptism]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:16 (#3)

ἀναστὰς

"Arising"

Here the term **arising** means that Ananias wanted Paul to take action, not that he wanted him to stand up from a sitting or lying position. Alternate translation: [Come on]

See: Idiom

Acts 22:16 (#6)

ἐπικαλεσάμενος τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ

"calling on his name"

Here, **name** represents a person by association with the way that each person has a name. Alternate translation: [calling on him]

See: Metonymy

Acts 22:16 (#5)

καὶ ἀπόλουσαι τὰς ἁμαρτίας σου

"and wash away your sins"

Ananias is speaking as if Paul could literally **wash away** his **sins**. He is using a word picture to convey his meaning. He means that just as washing one's body removes dirt, if Paul repents and asks Jesus for forgiveness, Jesus releases him from the guilt and power sin. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to show that you are asking Jesus to free you from sin]

See: Metaphor

Acts 22:16 (#2)

καὶ νῦν

"And now"

Here, **now** does not mean "at this moment"; Ananias is using the term to draw attention to the important point that follows. Alternate translation: [So listen]

Acts 22:17 (#1)

ἐγένετο δέ μοι

"And it happened to me that"

Paul is using this phrase to introduce a significant development in his story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 22:18 (#3)

σπεῦσον καὶ ἔξελθε ἐν τάχει

"Hurry and go away in haste"

The expressions **Hurry** and **in haste** mean similar things. Jesus was using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Go away as fast as you can]

See: Doublet

Acts 22:18 (#1)

καὶ ἰδεῖν αὐτὸν λέγοντά μοι, σπεῦσον καὶ ἔξελθε ἐν τάχει ἐξ Ἰερουσαλήμ, διότι οὐ παραδέξονταί σου μαρτυρίαν περὶ ἐμοῦ

"And I saw him saying to me, 'Hurry and go away in haste from Jerusalem, because they will not accept your testimony about me"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And I saw him telling me to hurry and go away in haste from Jerusalem because they would not accept my testimony about him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:18 (#2)

αὐτὸν

"him"

The pronoun **him** refers to Jesus. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Lord Jesus]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 22:19 (#2)

αὐτοὶ ἐπίστανται

"they themselves know"

The pronouns **they themselves** refers to the non-believing Jews in Jerusalem. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Jews here in Jerusalem who do not believe in you know]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 22:19 (#3)

αὐτοὶ ἐπίστανται

"they themselves know"

Paul is adding the word **themselves** for emphasis. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [they know very well]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 22:19 (#1)

κἀγὼ εἶπον, Κύριε, αὐτοὶ ἐπίστανται ὅτι ἐγὼ ἤμην φυλακίζων καὶ δέρων κατὰ τὰς συναγωγὰς, τοὺς πιστεύοντας ἐπὶ σέ

"And I said, 'Lord, they themselves know that I was imprisoning and beating by synagogues the ones believing in you"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And I told the Lord that they themselves knew that I was imprisoning and beating by synagogues those who believed in him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:20 (#1)

καὶ ὅτε ἐξεχύννετο τὸ αἷμα Στεφάνου τοῦ μάρτυρός σου, καὶ αὐτὸς ἤμην ἐφεστὼς, καὶ συνευδοκῶν, καὶ φυλάσσων τὰ ἱμάτια τῶν ἀναιρούντων αὐτόν

"And when the blood of Stephen your witness was spilled, I myself was also standing by and agreeing and guarding the outer garments of the ones killing him"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [I told him that when the blood of Stephen his witness was spilled, I myself was also standing by and agreeing and guarding the outer garments of the ones killing him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:20 (#2)

ἐξεχύννετο τὸ αἷμα Στεφάνου τοῦ μάρτυρός σου

“the blood of Stephen your witness was spilled”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, recall from chapter 7 that it was the enemies of Stephen. Alternate translation: [the enemies of Stephen your witness spilled his blood]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:20 (#3)

ἐξεχύννετο τὸ αἷμα Στεφάνου τοῦ μάρτυρός σου

“the blood of Stephen your witness was spilled”

Paul is referring to Stephen’s death by association with the way his **blood** was **spilled** when his enemies killed him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the enemies of Stephen your witness killed him]

See: Metonymy

Acts 22:21 (#1)

καὶ εἶπεν πρός με, πορεύου, ὅτι ἐγὼ εἰς ἔθνη μακρὰν ἐξαποστελῶ σε

“But he said to me, ‘Go, because I will send you far away to the Gentiles”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [But he told me to go because he would send me far away to the Gentiles]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 22:22 (#4)

αἶρε ἀπὸ τῆς γῆς τὸν τοιοῦτον

“Remove such a one from the earth”

The crowd is referring to Paul’s death by association with the way they would **remove** him **from the earth** if they killed him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Kill such a one]

See: Metonymy

Acts 22:22 (#5)

οὐ & καθῆκεν αὐτὸν ζῆν

“it was not right for him to live”

The crowd meant implicitly that it was **not right** for Paul to **live** even long enough to offer the explanation he was giving. You can indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [we should have killed him even before he spoke to us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 22:22 (#2)

ἐπῆραν τὴν φωνὴν αὐτῶν λέγοντες

“they lifted up their voice, saying”

Luke is speaking as if the crowd in Jerusalem literally **lifted up** its **voice**. He means that they spoke loudly. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they shouted]

See: Metaphor

Acts 22:22 (#3)

τὴν φωνὴν αὐτῶν

“their voice”

If you would like to retain the metaphor in your translation of “lifting up a voice” but it would be unusual in your language to speak as if a whole group of people had one **voice**, you could make this plural. Alternate translation: [their voices]

Acts 22:22 (#1)

τούτου τοῦ λόγου

“this word”

This could mean: (1) that the crowd became upset when they heard the specific **word** “Gentiles.” Alternate translation: [they heard the word “Gentiles,”]; (2) that the term **word** means what Paul said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Paul says this]

See: Metonymy

Acts 22:23 (#1)

ῥιπτούντων τὰ ἱμάτια

“casting off {their} outer garments”

When the people in the crowd removed their outer garments, this was at least a symbolic action indicating that they felt they should stone Paul to death. They took off their long robes as they would have done in

order to throw stones at Paul more easily. But some of the people may actually have intended to try to stone Paul even though he was in the custody of the Roman soldiers. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this in your translation. Alternate translation: [casting off their outer garments as if they were going to throw stones at Paul to kill him]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 22:23 (#2)

κονιορτὸν βαλλόντων εἰς τὸν ἀέρα

"throwing dust into the air"

This could mean: (1) that the people in the crowd were **throwing dust into the air** to symbolize how they wanted to throw stones at Paul, who was on the steps above them. Alternate translation: [throwing dust into the air as if they were throwing stones at Paul]; (2) that the people in the crowd were doing this to demonstrate how angry they were. Alternate translation: [angrily throwing dust into the air]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 22:24 (#3)

εἴπας μάστιξιν ἀνετάζεσθαι αὐτὸν

"commanding him to be examined by scourges"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [commanding his soldiers to examine him by scourges]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:24 (#5)

μάστιξιν

"by scourges"

The term **scourges** describes leathern thongs that had small pieces of metal attached to them to inflict more damage. Your language may have a term for a similar item that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [by whips]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 22:24 (#2)

τὴν παρεμβολήν

"the fortress"

This **fortress** was connected to the outer temple court. See how you translated this in 21:34.

Acts 22:24 (#4)

εἴπας μάστιξιν ἀνετάζεσθαι αὐτὸν

"commanding him to be examined by scourges"

The commander did not want **scourges** to conduct this examination. Luke is referring to the act of whipping someone by association with the instruments, **scourges**, that the commander ordered his soldiers to use for whipping. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [commanding his soldiers to examine him by scourging him]

See: Metonymy

Acts 22:24 (#1)

ἐκέλευσεν & εἰσάγεσθαι αὐτὸν

"ordered him to be brought"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [ordered his soldiers to bring him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:25 (#2)

εἶπεν πρὸς τὸν ἑστῶτα ἑκατόνταρχον ὁ Παῦλος, εἰ ἄνθρωπον Ῥωμαῖον καὶ ἀκατάκριτον, ἔξεστιν ὑμῖν μαστίζειν

"Paul said to the centurion standing by, "If it is lawful for you to scourge a man Roman and uncondemned"

Luke is recording how Paul used the typical form in his language for asking questions. It may be more natural in your language to have an indirect quotation here. Alternate translation: [Paul asked the centurion who was standing by whether it was lawful for him and his soldiers to scourge a man who was a Roman and had not been condemned.]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 22:25 (#3)

εἰ ἄνθρωπον Ῥωμαῖον καὶ ἀκατάκριτον, ἔξεστιν ὑμῖν μαστίζειν

"If it is lawful for you to scourge a man Roman and uncondemned"

Paul is using the question form to challenge the right of the centurion and his soldiers to whip him. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in

your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It is not lawful for you to whip a man who is a Roman citizen and who is uncondemned!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 22:25 (#1)

προέτειναν

"they stretched & out"

The pronoun **they** refers to the soldiers who were going to whip Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the soldiers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 22:25 (#4)

ἄνθρωπον Ῥωμαῖον καὶ ἀκατάκριτον

"a man Roman and uncondemned"

In this context, the term **Roman** implicitly indicates Roman citizenship. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a man who is a Roman citizen and who has not been condemned]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 22:26 (#2)

τί μέλλεις ποιεῖν

"What are you about to do"

The centurion is speaking of the commander, one person who was involved in having Paul whipped, to mean everyone who was involved. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [We should not be doing this!]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 22:26 (#3)

Ῥωμαῖός

"a Roman"

As in the previous verse, here the term **Roman** implicitly indicates Roman citizenship. Alternate translation: [a Roman citizen]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 22:26 (#1)

τί μέλλεις ποιεῖν

"What are you about to do"

The centurion is using the question form to warn the commander that he should not have Paul whipped. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should not be doing this!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 22:27 (#1)

αὐτῷ & ὁ

"to him & he"

The pronouns **them**, **him**, and **he** refer to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul ... he]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 22:28 (#1)

ἐγὼ πολλοῦ κεφαλαίου τὴν πολιτείαν ταύτην ἐκτησάμην

"I bought this citizenship with a large sum of money"

The commander is saying implicitly that he does not believe that Paul is a Roman citizen, because Paul does not appear to be wealthy enough to have purchased citizenship. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [It requires a large sum of money to purchase citizenship, and you do not seem to be wealthy, so I do not believe that you are a citizen]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 22:28 (#3)

ἐγὼ & καὶ γεγέννημαι

"I & indeed was born"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I indeed was born a citizen]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 22:28 (#4)

ἐγὼ & καὶ γεγέννημαι

"I & indeed was born"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation:

[I indeed have been a citizen since birth] or [I indeed inherited citizenship from my father]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 22:28 (#2)

ἐγὼ πολλοῦ κεφαλαίου τὴν πολιτείαν ταύτην ἐκτησάμην

"I bought this citizenship with a large sum of money"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **citizenship**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [I became a citizen by paying a large sum of money]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 22:29 (#1)

ἐφοβήθη

"was afraid"

The implication is that the commander **was afraid** that the higher Roman authorities would punish him. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [was afraid that the higher Roman authorities would punish him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 22:30 (#2)

ἔλυσεν αὐτόν

"he released him"

This means implicitly not that the commander **released** Paul from custody but that he freed Paul from the chains that were binding him to one solider on each side of him. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he ordered his soldiers to unchain Paul]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 22:30 (#1)

τὸ ἀσφαλὲς

"the certain"

Luke is using the adjective **certain** as a noun to mean what was reliable or true about Paul. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the truth]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts - Chapter 23 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Some translations set quotations from the Old Testament farther to the right on the page than the rest of the text. The ULT does this with the quoted material in 23:5.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Resurrection of the dead

The Pharisees believed that after people died, they would become alive again and God would either reward them or punish them. The Sadducees believed that once people died, they stayed dead and would never become alive again. (See: reward, prize, deserve)

"Called a curse"

Some Jews promised God that they would not eat or drink until they killed Paul, and they asked God to punish them if they did not do what they had promised to do.

Roman citizenship

The Romans thought that they needed to treat only Roman citizens justly. They could do as they desired with people who were not Roman citizens, but they had to obey the law with other Romans. Some people were born Roman citizens, and others gave money to the Roman government so they could become Roman citizens. The "chief captain" could have been punished for treating a Roman citizen the same way he would treat a non-citizen.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Whitewash

This is a common metaphor in Scripture for appearing to be good or clean or righteous when one is evil or unclean or unrighteous. (See: Metaphor)

Acts 23:1 (#2)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

"Men, brothers"

Paul is using the word **brothers** to refer respectfully to his fellow Israelites. Alternate translation: [My fellow Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Acts 23:1 (#1)

ἀδελφοί

"brothers"

This is an idiomatic form of address. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular group of people. Alternate translation: [brothers of mine]

See: Idiom

Acts 23:1 (#3)

πάσῃ συνειδήσει ἀγαθῇ

"in all good conscience"

Paul says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [in careful obedience to the law]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 23:2 (#1)

Ἀνανίας

"Ananias"

Ananias is the name of a man. See how you translated the same name for two other men in 5:1 and 9:10.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 23:2 (#2)

τύπτειν αὐτοῦ τὸ στόμα

"to strike his mouth"

Ananias ordered this as a symbolic action to show that he believed Paul had said something with his **mouth** that he should not have said. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [to strike his mouth because he believed Paul had said something he should not have said]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 23:3 (#1)

τοῖχε κεκονιαμένε

"you whitewashed wall"

Paul is referring to the way a **wall** can be painted white to make it look clean. Paul was suggesting that, in the same way, Ananias appeared to look morally innocent, but he was really full of evil intent. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you who pretend to be good]

See: Metaphor

Acts 23:3 (#2)

καὶ σὺ κάθῃ κρίνων με κατὰ τὸν νόμον, καὶ παρανομῶν κελεύεις με τύπτεσθαι

"And do you sit judging me by the law and, acting contrary to the law, command me to be struck"

Paul is using the question form to challenge Ananias for what he has done. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should certainly not sit judging me by the law while acting contrary to the law by commanding me to be struck!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 23:3 (#3)

κελεύεις με τύπτεσθαι

"command me to be struck"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [command someone to strike me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 23:4 (#1)

τὸν ἀρχιερέα τοῦ Θεοῦ λοιδορεῖς

"Are you insulting the high priest of God"

The men standing by Paul are using the question form to rebuke him for saying what he said. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should not insult the high priest of God!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 23:5 (#4)

ἄρχοντα τοῦ λαοῦ σου, οὐκ ἐρεῖς κακῶς

"You shall not speak evil of a ruler of your people"

Moses is using a future statement to give a command. Alternate translation: [You must not speak evil of a ruler of your people]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Acts 23:5 (#3)

γέγραπται γὰρ

"For it is written"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [For Moses wrote in the law]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 23:5 (#2)

γέγραπται γὰρ & ἄρχοντα τοῦ λαοῦ σου, οὐκ ἐρεῖς κακῶς

"For it is written, 'You shall not speak evil of a ruler of your people"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [For it is written that we should not speak evil of a ruler of our people]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 23:5 (#1)

ἀδελφοί

"brothers"

Paul is using the term **brothers** to mean his fellow Jews. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my kinsmen]

See: Metaphor

Acts 23:6 (#5)

ἐλπίδος καὶ ἀναστάσεως

"the hope and resurrection"

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **resurrection** describes what the Pharisees had **hope** for. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use "and." Alternate translation: [the hope of the resurrection]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 23:6 (#4)

υἱὸς Φαρισαίων

"a son of Pharisees"

By **son**, Paul means both that he is the literal son of a Pharisee and that he is the descendant of a line of Pharisees. Alternate translation: [and my father and forefathers were Pharisees]

See: Metaphor

Acts 23:6 (#3)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

"Men, brothers"

Paul is using the term **brothers** to mean his fellow Jews. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [My kinsmen]

See: Metaphor

Acts 23:6 (#6)

ἐλπίδος καὶ ἀναστάσεως νεκρῶν

"the hope and resurrection of the dead"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **resurrection**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the hope that God will make the dead alive again]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 23:6 (#8)

ἐγὼ κρίνομαι

"I am being judged"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you are judging me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 23:6 (#7)

νεκρῶν

"of the dead"

Paul is using the adjective **dead** as a noun to mean people who have died. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 23:6 (#1)

τὸ ἓν μέρος

"one part"

Luke is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [one part of the council]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 23:6 (#2)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

“Men, brothers”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Alternate translation: [My brothers]

See: Idiom

Acts 23:8 (#2)

μὴ εἶναι ἀνάστασιν, μήτε ἄγγελον, μήτε πνεῦμα

“there is no resurrection, nor angels or spirits”

Luke is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [there is no resurrection and that there are no angels and no spirits]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 23:8 (#1)

γὰρ

“For”

Luke uses the word **For** to introduce background information about the **Sadducees** and **Pharisees** that will help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 23:8 (#3)

τὰ ἀμφότερα

“both”

By **both**, Luke means implicitly that Pharisees believe in (1) the resurrection and (2) angels and spirits. You could indicate this explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [both that there is a resurrection and that there are angels and spirits]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 23:9 (#1)

ἀναστάντες

“arising”

By **arising** (that is, standing up), these Pharisees were indicating that they had something important to say. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [standing up to show that they had something important to say]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 23:9 (#2)

εἰ δὲ πνεῦμα ἐλάλησεν αὐτῷ, ἢ ἄγγελος

“And if a spirit spoke to him, or an angel”

These Pharisees are speaking as if what they are saying is a hypothetical possibility, but they believe that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if the speaker believes that it is true, then you can translate these words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [And since a spirit must have spoken to him, or an angel]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

Acts 23:9 (#3)

εἰ δὲ πνεῦμα ἐλάλησεν αὐτῷ, ἢ ἄγγελος

“And if a spirit spoke to him, or an angel”

These Pharisees assume that the Sadducees will understand that they mean this spirit or angel **spoke** to Paul when he had the vision in the Jerusalem temple that he described in 22:17–21. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And since a spirit must have spoken to him, or an angel, when he had his vision in Jerusalem]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 23:9 (#4)

εἰ δὲ πνεῦμα ἐλάλησεν αὐτῷ, ἢ ἄγγελος

“And if a spirit spoke to him, or an angel”

These Pharisees are making the first part of a conditional statement and leaving the second part for the Sadducees to realize on their own. If this would be unclear to your readers, you could supply the second part of this conditional statement in your translation. Alternate translation: [And if a spirit spoke to him, or an angel, then you should find no evil in this man either.]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 23:10 (#1)

διασπασθῇ ὁ Παῦλος ὑπ’ αὐτῶν

“Paul be torn apart by them”

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they tear Paul apart]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 23:10 (#2)

μὴ διασπασθῇ ὁ Παῦλος ὑπ’ αὐτῶν

“lest Paul be torn apart by them”

Luke is making an overstatement here to emphasize the danger that Paul was in. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [lest they cause Paul great physical harm]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 23:11 (#2)

ὁ Κύριος

“the Lord”

Luke is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [the Lord Jesus]

See: Politeness

Acts 23:11 (#1)

τῇ & ἐπιούσῃ νυκτὶ

“on the following night”

This expression indicates the **night** after the day Paul went before the council. In your translation, express this in the way your culture reckons time. Alternate translation: [during the night that followed]

See: Idiom

Acts 23:11 (#3)

εἰς Ῥώμην μαρτυρῆσαι

“to testify in Rome”

Jesus assumes that Paul will know that he means Paul will **testify** about him in Rome. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to testify about me in Rome]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 23:12 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [certain Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 23:12 (#3)

λέγοντες μήτε φαγεῖν μήτε πιεῖν, ἕως οὗ ἀποκτείνωσιν τὸν Παῦλον

“saying neither to eat nor to drink until they had killed Paul”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [saying, “We will neither eat or drink until we have killed Paul”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 23:12 (#2)

ἀνεθεμάτισαν ἑαυτοὺς

“cursed themselves”

The implication is that the curse was, “May God do so to us if we eat or drink until we have killed Paul,” that is, “May God kill us.” You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [asked God to kill them if they did not do what they swore to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 23:14 (#2)

μηδενὸς γεύσασθαι

“to eat nothing”

Since the men actually swore that they would **eat** or drink nothing, they are using one part of their oath to represent all of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to eat and drink nothing]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 23:14 (#1)

ἀναθέματι ἀνεθεματίσαμεν ἑαυτοὺς

“We have cursed ourselves with a curse”

It might seem that the expression **cursed ourselves with a curse** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [cursed ourselves]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 23:15 (#1)

ἡμεῖς

“we”

By **we**, the conspirators mean themselves but not chief priests and leaders to whom they are speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 23:15 (#2)

ἐμφανίσατε

“appear”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a request. Alternate translation: [we would like you to make it appear]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 23:16 (#1)

ἀκούσας & τὴν ἐνέδραν

“hearing the ambush”

Luke means that the son of Paul’s sister heard some of the conspirators talking about the **ambush**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [hearing people talk about the ambush]

See: Metonymy

Acts 23:16 (#2)

ὁ υἱὸς τῆς ἀδελφῆς Παύλου

“the son of the sister of Paul”

Luke does not tell us whether this **sister** was older or younger than Paul, but describe this relationship in the way that would be most natural for your language and culture. Alternate translation: [Paul’s nephew] or [the nephew of Paul]

See: Kinship

Acts 23:17 (#1)

ἄπαγε

“Take”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please take]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Acts 23:18 (#1)

ὁ & παραλαβὼν αὐτὸν, ἤγαγεν

“taking him, he brought him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Paul’s nephew, and the pronoun **he** refers to the centurion. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [taking Paul’s nephew, the centurion brought him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 23:18 (#2)

φησίν

“says”

To call attention to a development in the story, here Luke uses the present tense in past narration. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense in your translation. Alternate translation: [said]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Acts 23:19 (#1)

ἐπιλαβόμενος δὲ τῆς χειρὸς αὐτοῦ

“So & taking hold of his hand”

The chiliarch **taking hold** of the **hand** of Paul’s nephew was more than was needed simply to lead the nephew to a **private** location. This was a symbolic action that assured the nephew that the chiliarch would protect him and that he could therefore speak safely and confidentially. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [taking hold of his hand to reassure him]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 23:20 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

“The Jews”

Paul’s nephew is using the name of a whole group, **The Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Certain Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 23:21 (#1)

σὺ & μὴ πεισθῇς αὐτοῖς

“may you not be persuaded by them”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may they not persuade you] or [do not let them persuade you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 23:21 (#2)

τὴν ἀπὸ σοῦ ἐπαγγελίαν

“the promise from you”

By the word **promise**, Paul’s nephew is referring to the commander agreeing to bring Paul to the Sanhedrin the next day and actually bringing him. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you to bring Paul to the Sanhedrin]

See: Metonymy

Acts 23:22 (#1)

παραγγείλας, μηδενὶ ἐκλαλῆσαι ὅτι ταῦτα ἐνεφάνισας πρὸς ἐμέ

“commanding him to tell no one that “you have reported these things to me”

Luke begins an indirect quotation but finishes it as a direct quotation. It may be more natural in your language for the entire quotation to be either indirect or direct. Alternate translation: [commanding him to tell no one that he had reported these things to him] or [commanding him, “Tell no one that you have reported these things to me]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 23:23 (#2)

τρίτης ὥρας τῆς νυκτός

“the third hour of the night”

In your translation, you may wish to express this in the way your own culture reckons time. Alternate translation: [nine o’clock this evening]

See: Idiom

Acts 23:23 (#1)

δεξιολάβους διακοσίους

“200 spearmen”

Alternate translation: [200 soldiers who are armed with spears]

See: Numbers

Acts 23:24 (#3)

Φήλικα

“Felix”

The word **Felix** is the name of the man who was the Roman **governor** of Judea at this time.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 23:24 (#1)

κτήνη τε παραστῆσαι, ἵνα ἐπιβιβάσαντες τὸν Παῦλον, διασώσωσι πρὸς Φήλικα τὸν ἡγεμόνα

“and to provide animals so that, having set Paul on them, they may bring him safely to Felix the governor”

Here Luke finishes as an indirect quotation the direct quotation that began in the previous verse. It may be more natural in your language to continue and finish the quotation as a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [and provide animals so that, having set Paul on them, they may bring him safely to Felix the governor]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 23:24 (#2)

διασώσωσι

“they may bring him safely”

The pronoun **they** refers to the soldiers, horsemen, and spearmen described in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [these troops may bring him safely]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 23:25 (#1)

γράψας ἐπιστολὴν

“writing a letter”

Luke means implicitly that the commander gave the instructions described in the previous two verses by “summoning” two centurions and **writing** the letter quoted in verses 26–30. It may be helpful to begin

a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [He also wrote a letter]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 23:26 (#1)

Κλαύδιος Λυσίας, τῷ κρατίστῳ ἡγεμόνι Φήλικι

"Claudius Lysias to the most excellent Governor Felix"

The commander begins this letter by speaking about himself and about the person to whom he is writing in the third person. That was the convention in this culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the first and second persons to translate this. Alternate translation: [I, Claudius Lysias, to you, the most excellent Governor Felix]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Acts 23:26 (#4)

τῷ κρατίστῳ ἡγεμόνι Φήλικι

"to the most excellent Governor Felix"

The expression **most excellent** was a formal title by which people addressed Roman officials. Your language and culture may have a comparable title that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [to the Honorable Governor Felix]

See: Politeness

Acts 23:26 (#3)

Κλαύδιος Λυσίας

"Claudius Lysias"

The words **Claudius Lysias** are the name of the commander.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 23:26 (#2)

Κλαύδιος Λυσίας, τῷ κρατίστῳ ἡγεμόνι Φήλικι, χαίρειν

"Claudius Lysias to the most excellent Governor Felix: Greetings"

As was also the convention in this culture, the letter-writer leaves it unstated but understood that he is writing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply those words. Alternate translation: [I, Claudius Lysias, am writing to you, the most excellent Governor Felix]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 23:27 (#2)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

"the Jews"

The commander is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [certain Jews]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 23:27 (#1)

τὸν ἄνδρα τοῦτον συνλημφθέντα ὑπὸ τῶν Ἰουδαίων, καὶ μέλλοντα ἀναιρεῖσθαι ὑπ' αὐτῶν & ἐξειλάμην

"This man, having been seized by the Jews and about to be killed by them & I rescued"

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express these ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Learning that the Jews had seized this man and that they were about to kill him ... I rescued him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 23:27 (#3)

Ῥωμαῖός

"a Roman"

Here the term **Roman** implicitly indicates Roman citizenship. Alternate translation: [a Roman citizen]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 23:28 (#1)

κατήγαγον

"I took him down"

The commander says that he took Paul **down** to the Sanhedrin because he brought him down the steps from the Roman fortress to the temple courtyard. It may not be necessary to reproduce this detail in your translation. Alternate translation: [I brought him]

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Acts 23:29 (#2)

θανάτου ἢ δεσμῶν

"of death or chains"

The commander is using the word **death** to mean a penalty of death. He is referring to imprisonment by association with the way that the Romans used **chains** to secure prisoners. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [execution or imprisonment] or [of being put to death or being put in prison]

See: Metonymy

Acts 23:29 (#1)

ὃν εὗρον ἐνκαλούμενον περὶ ζητημάτων τοῦ νόμου αὐτῶν; μηδὲν δὲ ἄξιον θανάτου ἢ δεσμῶν ἔχοντα ἔγκλημα

"whom I found being accused about questions of their law but having no accusation worthy of death or chains"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [I found that the Jews were accusing him about questions of their law, but they were not accusing him of anything worthy of death or chains]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 23:30 (#1)

μηνυθείσης & μοι ἐπιβουλῆς εἰς τὸν ἄνδρα ἔσεσθαι

"when a plot that was to be against the man was revealed to me"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when someone revealed to me that there was going to be a plot against the man]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 23:31 (#1)

κατὰ τὸ διατεταγμένον αὐτοῖς

"according to the thing having been commanded to them"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [according to what the chiliarch had commanded them to do]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 23:31 (#2)

τὴν Ἀντιπατρίδα

"Antipatris"

The word **Antipatris** is the name of a city. It was located about halfway between Jerusalem and Caesarea.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 23:32 (#1)

αὐτῷ, ὑπέστρεψαν

"they returned & him"

The pronoun **they** refers to the soldiers, and the pronoun **him** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul, the soldiers returned]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 23:33 (#1)

οἵτινες εἰσελθόντες εἰς τὴν Καισάρειαν, καὶ ἀναδόντες τὴν ἐπιστολὴν τῷ ἡγεμόνι, παρέστησαν καὶ τὸν Παῦλον αὐτῷ

"who, entering into Caesarea and delivering the letter to the governor, also presented Paul to him"

The pronoun **who** refers to the horsemen who accompanied Paul all the way to Caesarea. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers, and it may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [When the horsemen reached Caesarea, they delivered the letter to the governor and also presented Paul to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 23:34 (#1)

ἐπερωτήσας ἐκ ποίας ἐπαρχείας ἐστὶν

"having asked what province he was from"

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [having asked Paul, "What province are you from?"]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 23:35 (#1)

κελεύσας & φυλάσσεσθαι αὐτόν

"commanding him to be guarded"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [commanding his soldiers to guard him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts - Chapter 24 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Paul told the governor that he had not done what the Jews were accusing him of doing and that the governor should not punish him for what he did do.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Respect

Both the Jewish leaders (Acts 24:2–4) and Paul (Acts 24:10) began their speeches with words that show respect to the governor.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Governmental leaders

The words "governor," "commander," and "centurion" may be difficult to translate into some languages. (See: Translate Unknowns)

Acts 24:1 (#3)

Τερτύλλου τινός

"certain & Tertullus"

The word **Tertullus** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 24:1 (#1)

ῥήτορος Τερτύλλου τινός

"a certain orator, Tertullus"

Luke is using the phrase **a certain orator** to introduce **Tertullus** as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 24:1 (#2)

ῥήτορος

"a & orator"

In this context, the term **orator** means a person who spoke well and who was well acquainted with Roman law. Either an accuser or a defendant might employ such a person to argue a case for them in court. In your translation, you could use a term for someone in a comparable role in your culture. Alternate translation: [a courtroom lawyer]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 24:1 (#4)

κατέβη

"came down"

Luke says that these men **came down** to Caesarea because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Use a natural way of referring to traveling downward in your language.

See: Idiom

Acts 24:2 (#5)

τῷ ἔθνει τούτῳ

"for this people"

Tertullus assumes that Governor Felix will understand that by **this people** he means the Jewish people. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 24:2 (#3)

τυγχάνοντες

"As we are obtaining"

By **we**, Tertullus means himself and his fellow Jews but not Governor Felix, to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 24:2 (#1)

κληθέντος & αὐτοῦ

"when he had been summoned"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when the governor summoned Paul]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 24:2 (#4)

σοῦ & σῆς

"you & your"

Here the words **you** and **your** refer to Felix, the governor. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [you, Governor Felix ... your]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 24:2 (#2)

κατηγορεῖν

“to accuse him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to accuse Paul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 24:3 (#1)

πάντῃ & πανταχοῦ & πάσης

“in every way & everywhere & all”

Tertullus says these things as overstatements for emphasis. Since Luke is quoting directly from his speech, it would be appropriate to retain these overstatements in your translation.

See: Hyperbole

Acts 24:3 (#2)

κράτιστε Φῆλιξ

“most excellent Felix”

The expression **most excellent** was a formal title by which people addressed Roman officials. Your language and culture may have a comparable title that you can use in your translation. See how you translated the similar expression in Acts 23:26. Alternate translation: [Your Excellency, Governor Felix]

See: Politeness

Acts 24:3 (#3)

μετὰ πάσης εὐχαριστίας

“with all thankfulness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **thankfulness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [very gratefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 24:4 (#1)

ἡμῶν

“to us”

By **us**, Tertullus means himself and the Jewish leaders on whose behalf he is speaking. He does not mean Governor Felix, to whom he is speaking. So use the exclusive form of “us” in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 24:4 (#2)

συντόμως, τῇ σῇ ἐπιεικείᾳ

“briefly in your fairness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **fairness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [briefly, knowing that you will judge our case fairly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 24:5 (#1)

λοιμὸν

“a pest”

Tertullus is speaking as if Paul was literally spreading disease. He means that Paul is causing trouble. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a trouble-maker]

See: Metaphor

Acts 24:5 (#2)

πᾶσι τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις τοῖς κατὰ τὴν οἰκουμένην

“among all the Jews throughout the world”

Tertullus says this as overstatements for emphasis. Since Luke is quoting directly from his speech, it would be appropriate to retain this overstatement in your translation.

See: Hyperbole

Acts 24:5 (#3)

τῶν Ναζωραίων

“of the Nazarenes”

In this context, the word **Nazarenes** is a name that people used at this time to describe believers in Jesus. Jesus himself was known as a Nazarene because he came from the town of Nazareth. See how you translated the same word in 2:22, where it has that meaning.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 24:6 (#2)

As the General Introduction to Acts explains, this second half of this verse, all of verse 7, and the first part of verse 8 are found in many traditional versions of the Bible, but they are not found in the most accu-

rate ancient manuscripts of the Bible. ULT and UST indicate this by putting this material in brackets. If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider including this material if that translation does. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, we recommend that you indicate in some way that this material may not be original, such as by putting it in brackets or in a footnote.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 24:6 (#1)

ὃν καὶ ἐκρατήσαμεν

"whom also we arrested"

Tertullus is making the case that Paul is a criminal, but he is leaving it up to Felix to decide what Paul's punishment should be, so he is deliberately breaking off this sentence here. If this might be unclear to your readers, you could indicate his meaning in your translation. Alternate translation: [whom we also arrested, and who deserves to be punished, but we will leave it to you to decide his punishment.]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 24:8 (#1)

παρ' οὗ

"from whom"

The pronoun **whom** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers, and it may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [From him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 24:9 (#1)

οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"the Jews"

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish leaders who had come to Caesarea to accuse Paul]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 24:11 (#1)

οὐ πλείους εἰσίν μοι ἡμέραι δώδεκα, ἀφ' ἧς

"it is not more than 12 days for me from when"

Paul is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [it was only 12 days ago that]

See: Litotes

Acts 24:12 (#1)

εὗρόν

"they found"

The pronoun **they** refers to the Jews who are accusing Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [these Jews who are accusing me found]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 24:14 (#3)

τοῖς προφήταις

"the Prophets"

The word **Prophets** is the name of a section of the Bible that contains the books in which the prophets recorded the messages that God gave them. Alternate translation: [the books that the prophets wrote]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 24:14 (#2)

τοῖς ἐν τοῖς προφήταις γεγραμμένοις

"the things written in the Prophets"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the things that the prophets wrote]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 24:14 (#1)

τὴν Ὁδὸν

"the Way"

As the introduction to chapter 9 explains, **the Way** was one of the first names that people used to describe the community of believers in Jesus. If your language has a word for "way" or "path" that you can use as a name, it would be appropriate to use it in your translation. See what you did in 9:2.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 24:15 (#2)

ἀνάστασιν μέλλειν ἔσεσθαι, δικαίων τε καὶ ἀδίκων

“that there is going to be a resurrection of both the righteous and the unrighteous”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **resurrection**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [that God will make both the righteous and the unrighteous alive again after they have died]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 24:15 (#3)

δικαίων τε καὶ ἀδίκων

“of both the righteous and the unrighteous”

Paul is using the adjectives **righteous** and **unrighteous** as nouns to mean different groups of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate these words with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [of both people who have done what is right and people who have not done what is right]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 24:15 (#1)

οὗτοι

“these”

The pronoun **these** refers to the Jewish leaders who are accusing Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [my accusers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 24:16 (#3)

τοὺς ἀνθρώπους

“men”

Although the term **men** is masculine, Paul is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a term in your language that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 24:16 (#1)

ἐν τούτῳ

“In this”

The pronoun **this** refers to what Paul has just said in verses 14 and 15 about what he believes. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Because I believe these things,]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 24:16 (#2)

πρὸς τὸν Θεὸν

“before God”

Paul is using this phrase to refer to the opinion or judgment of God and men by association with the way that they would assess anything that came to their attention in front of them. Alternate translation: [in the perspective of God]

See: Metonymy

Acts 24:17 (#3)

εἰς τὸ ἔθνος μου

“to my nation”

Paul is actually referring to the place where the people of the Jewish **nation** live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the place where my Jewish people live]

See: Metonymy

Acts 24:17 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Paul is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new phase of his defense. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that would be natural for this purpose.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 24:17 (#4)

ἐλεημοσύνας ποιήσων & καὶ προσφοράς

“bringing alms and offerings”

By **alms** Paul means gifts for the poor that the Gentile churches had collected and that he was delivering. By **offerings** he means the sacrifices that he and four other men offered at the end of a period of vows. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to bring gifts for the poor and to offer sacrifices at the end of a vow period]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 24:17 (#2)

παρεγενόμην

"I came"

In a context such as this, your language might say "went" instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [went]

See: Go and Come

Acts 24:18 (#1)

ἐν αἷς

"in which"

The pronoun **which** refers to the offerings that Paul described in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers, and it may be helpful to begin a new sentence here, ending verse 17 with a period. Alternate translation: [While I was making those offerings,]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 24:19 (#1)

τινὲς & ἀπὸ τῆς Ἀσίας Ἰουδαῖοι, οὓς ἔδει & παρεῖναι

"certain Jews from Asia—who ought to be present"

As Paul defends himself by telling what happened in Jerusalem, he suddenly realizes that his actual accusers are not present. So he breaks off his sentence to bring this fact to the attention of Governor Felix. If this might be unclear to your readers, in your translation you could finish this part of the story and begin a new sentence. Alternate translation: [certain Jews from Asia saw me in Jerusalem with a Gentile and they thought that I had brought him into the temple. Now they ought to be present]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 24:20 (#1)

αὐτοὶ οὗτοι εἰπάτωσαν

"let these themselves say"

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may these themselves say] or [these themselves should say]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 24:20 (#2)

αὐτοὶ οὗτοι

"these themselves"

These pronouns refer to the Jewish leaders who have come to Caesarea to accuse Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [these Jewish leaders who have come here]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 24:20 (#3)

στάντος μου ἐπὶ τοῦ Συνεδρίου

"when I stood before the Sanhedrin"

Paul is referring to what he said to the Sanhedrin to defend himself by association with the way he **stood** in front of the council as he said it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when I defended myself at a meeting of the Sanhedrin]

See: Metonymy

Acts 24:21 (#3)

ἐγὼ κρίνομαι & ἐφ' ὑμῶν

"I am being judged by you"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you are judging me today]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 24:21 (#1)

ἢ περὶ μιᾶς ταύτης φωνῆς, ἧς ἐκέκραξα ἐν αὐτοῖς ἑστὼς & περὶ ἀναστάσεως νεκρῶν ἐγὼ κρίνομαι σήμερον ἐφ' ὑμῶν

"other} than regarding this one utterance that I shouted out standing among them, 'Concerning the resurrection of the dead I am being judged by you today"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [other than that when I was standing among them, I shouted that I was being judged by them that day concerning the resurrection of the dead]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 24:21 (#2)

περὶ ἀναστάσεως νεκρῶν

"Concerning the resurrection of the dead"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **resurrection**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Because I believe that God will make those who have died alive again,]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 24:22 (#1)

καταβῇ

"may come down"

Felix says **may come down** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Use a natural way in your language of referring to traveling to a lower elevation.

See: Idiom

Acts 24:23 (#2)

τῶν ἰδίων αὐτοῦ

"of his own"

By **his own**, Luke implicitly means Paul's **own** friends. You can indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [of his friends]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 24:23 (#1)

μηδένα κωλύειν

"to forbid none"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **none** and the negative verb **forbid**. Alternate translation: [to allow all]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 24:24 (#2)

οὔσῃ Ἰουδαίᾳ

"being a Jewess"

The word **Jewess** is the name for a woman who is Jewish. Alternate translation: [who was a Jewish woman]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 24:24 (#1)

Δρουσίλλῃ

"Drusilla"

The word **Drusilla** is the name of a woman.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 24:25 (#1)

αὐτοῦ

"he"

The pronoun **he** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 24:26 (#1)

χρήματα δοθήσεται αὐτῷ ὑπὸ τοῦ Παύλου

"money would be given to him by Paul"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Paul would give him money]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 24:27 (#3)

τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις

"with the Jews"

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Jews who were hostile to Paul]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 24:27 (#1)

διετίας & πληρωθείσης

"two years being fulfilled"

Luke is describing this time period in the way in which his culture and language spoke about time. The expression can refer to any period of time between one year and two years in length. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [after a couple of years]

See: Idiom

Acts 24:27 (#4)

δεδεμένον

“bound”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [in bonds]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 24:27 (#2)

Πόρκιον Φῆστον

“Porcius Festus”

The words **Porcius Festus** are the names of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 24:27 (#5)

δεδεμένον

“bound”

Luke is using one thing that the Romans did to keep Paul prisoner to represent all of what they did. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as a prisoner]

See: Synecdoche

Acts - Chapter 25 Introduction

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Favor
This word is used in two different ways in this chapter. When the Jewish leaders asked Festus for a favor, they were asking him to do something special for them on that day. They wanted him to do for them something that he would not usually do. When Festus “wanted to gain the favor of the Jews,” he wanted them to like him and be willing to obey him in the months and years to come. (See: favor, favorable, favoritism)

Roman citizenship
The Romans thought that they needed to treat only Roman citizens justly. They could do as they desired with people who were not Roman citizens, but they had to obey the law with other Romans. Some people were born Roman citizens; others gave money to the Roman government so they could become Roman citizens. Roman officials could have been punished for treating a Roman citizen the same way they would treat a non-citizen.

Acts 25:1 (#4)

ἀνέβη εἰς Ἰεροσόλυμα ἀπὸ Καισαρείας

“went up from Caesarea to Jerusalem”

Luke says that Festus **went up** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling to Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Use a natural way in your language of referring to traveling to a higher elevation.

See: Idiom

Acts 25:1 (#2)

ἐπιβὰς

“having set foot”

Luke is using one part of Festus, his **foot**, to represent all of himself in the act of arriving in Judea. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [having arrived]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 25:1 (#1)

οὖν

“Now”

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 25:1 (#3)

τῇ ἐπαρχείᾳ

“in the province”

By **the province**, Luke implicitly means the province of Judea. You can provide this information in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in Judea]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 25:2 (#1)

οἱ πρῶτοι τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“the first of the Jews”

Luke is using the adjective **first** as a noun to mean a particular group of people. Here, **first** has the sense of most prominent. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the most prominent of the Jews]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 25:3 (#1)

αὐτοῦ & αὐτὸν & αὐτὸν

“him & him & him”

The pronoun **him** refers to Paul in each of these instances. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul ... him ... Paul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 25:3 (#2)

ἐνέδραν ποιοῦντες ἀνελεῖν αὐτὸν κατὰ τὴν ὁδόν

“making an ambush to kill him along the way”

It was the Jewish leaders who were secretly **making an ambush**. This was not part of what they were **requesting** Festus to do. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers, and it may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [But the Jewish leaders were secretly preparing an ambush to kill Paul along the way]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 25:4 (#3)

ἐκπορεύεσθαι

“to depart”

Festus means implicitly that he is **about to depart** from Jerusalem and travel to Caesarea. You can provide this information in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to depart Jerusalem for Caesarea]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 25:4 (#1)

ὁ & Φῆστος ἀπεκρίθη, τηρεῖσθαι τὸν Παῦλον εἰς Καισάρειαν, ἑαυτὸν δὲ μέλλειν ἐν τάχει ἐκπορεύεσθαι

“Festus answered that Paul was being held at Caesarea but that he himself was about to depart soon”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [Festus answered, “Paul is being held at Caesarea, but I myself am about to depart soon.”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 25:4 (#2)

τηρεῖσθαι τὸν Παῦλον

“Paul was being held”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he was holding Paul]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:5 (#2)

συνκαταβάντες

“having come down together”

As the introduction to this chapter discusses, here Festus says **come down** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling from Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Use a natural way in your language of referring to traveling to a lower elevation.

See: Idiom

Acts 25:5 (#3)

κατηγορείτωσαν αὐτοῦ

“let them accuse him”

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may they accuse him] or [they should accuse him]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 25:5 (#1)

οἱ & ἐν ὑμῖν & δυνατοὶ

“the powerful among you”

Festus is using the adjective **powerful** as a noun to mean a certain group of people. In this context, **powerful** means having the legal power to represent the Jewish nation. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those of you who have legal standing in this matter]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 25:6 (#1)

ἡμέρας, οὐ πλείους ὀκτὼ ἢ δέκα

“not more than eight or ten days”

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [less than eight or ten days]

See: Litotes

Acts 25:6 (#2)

καθίσας ἐπὶ τοῦ βήματος

“having sat in the judgment seat”

Festus **sat in the judgment seat** as a symbolic action to show that he was ready to act as the judge in the case against Paul. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [having sat in the judgment seat to show that he was ready to act as the judge in the case against Paul]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 25:6 (#3)

τὸν Παῦλον ἀχθῆναι

“Paul to be brought”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [his soldiers to bring Paul to him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:7 (#1)

αὐτοῦ & αὐτὸν

“he & him”

The pronouns **he** and **him** refer to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul ... him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 25:7 (#2)

πολλὰ καὶ βαρέα αἰτιώματα

“many and serious charges”

It may be more natural in your language not to use the word **and** between these adjectives. Alternate translation: [many serious charges] or [many charges that were all serious]

Acts 25:8 (#1)

εἰς Καίσαρά

“against Caesar”

Paul is using the leader of the Roman government to represent that entire government. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [against the Roman government]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 25:9 (#3)

ἀποκριθεὶς τῷ Παύλῳ εἶπεν

“answering Paul, said”

Together the words **answering** and **said** mean that Festus responded to Paul. Alternate translation: [Festus responded to Paul]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 25:9 (#4)

εἰς Ἰεροσόλυμα ἀναβὰς

“having gone up to Jerusalem”

Festus says **gone up** because that was the customary way of speaking about traveling to Jerusalem, since that city is up on a mountain. Use a natural way in your language of referring to traveling to a higher elevation.

See: Idiom

Acts 25:9 (#2)

τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις χάριν καταθέσθαι

“to lay down a favor for the Jews”

Luke is speaking as if the Festus wanted to **lay down** a favor physically for the Jewish leaders, as if they would pick it up and leave something else for him in its place. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to do a favor for the Jewish leaders that they would later return]

See: Metaphor

Acts 25:9 (#1)

θέλων τοῖς Ἰουδαίοις χάριν καταθέσθαι

“wanting to lay down a favor for the Jews”

Luke is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish leaders who were opposing Paul]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 25:9 (#5)

εἰς Ἰεροσόλυμα & ἐκεῖ περὶ τούτων κριθῆναι ἐπ’ ἐμοῦ

"to Jerusalem, to be judged before me there about these things"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to Jerusalem and have me judge you there about these things]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:10 (#2)

ἐπὶ τοῦ βήματος Καίσαρος ἑστώς εἰμι

"I am standing before the judgment seat of Caesar"

Paul is using **Caesar**, the leader of the Roman government, to represent that entire government. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am being judged by the Roman government]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 25:10 (#1)

ἐπὶ τοῦ βήματος Καίσαρος ἑστώς εἰμι

"I am standing before the judgment seat of Caesar"

Paul is referring to Caesar's authority to judge him by association with the **judgment seat** where Caesar sat when he judged cases. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am being judged by Caesar]

See: Metonymy

Acts 25:10 (#3)

οὗ με δεῖ κρίνεσθαι

"where it is necessary for me to be judged"

If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [where it is necessary for someone to judge me] or, if you translated the previous phrase as "I am being judged by the Roman government," then use [which is the authority that ought to judge me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:11 (#1)

οὐ παραιτοῦμαι τὸ ἀποθανεῖν

"I do not refuse to die"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative verb **refuse**. Alternate translation: [I am willing to die]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 25:12 (#1)

τοῦ συμβουλίου

"the council"

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that by **council** here, he does not mean the Jewish Sanhedrin. He means the group of officials who advised Festus. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with his own government advisors]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 25:12 (#2)

ἐπὶ Καίσαρα πορεύσῃ

"to Caesar you will go"

Festus is using a future statement to give a ruling in Paul's case. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural form for giving a ruling. Alternate translation: [so I grant your appeal and I am going to send you to Caesar for judgment]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Acts 25:13 (#2)

Ἀγρίππας ὁ βασιλεὺς καὶ Βερνίκη

"King Agrippa and Bernice"

The word **Agrippa** is the name of a man. He ruled a few territories in the area where Festus was the Roman governor. The word **Bernice** is the name a woman. She was the sister of King Agrippa.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 25:13 (#3)

κατήντησαν εἰς Καισάρειαν

"having come down to Caesarea"

Luke speaks of Agrippa and Bernice **having come down** to Caesarea because that city is lower in elevation than Jerusalem, where they lived. Use a natural way in your language of referring to traveling to a lower elevation.

See: Idiom

Acts 25:13 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Luke is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 25:14 (#2)

ἀνήρ τὶς ἐστιν καταλελειμμένος ὑπὸ Φήλικος δέσμιος

“A certain man has been left a prisoner by Felix”

Festus is using the phrase **A certain man** to introduce **Paul** to Agrippa and Bernice. If your language has its own way of introducing people and their stories, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [There is a man named Paul whom Felix left as a prisoner]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 25:14 (#1)

ἀνήρ τὶς ἐστιν καταλελειμμένος ὑπὸ Φήλικος δέσμιος

“A certain man has been left a prisoner by Felix”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Felix has left a certain man a prisoner]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:15 (#1)

αἰτούμενοι κατ᾽ αὐτοῦ καταδίκην

“requesting a judgment against him”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of a **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [requesting that I judge him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 25:16 (#1)

ὁ κατηγορούμενος

“the one being accused”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the one against whom people are making accusations]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:16 (#2)

κατὰ πρόσωπον ἔχοι τοὺς κατηγόρους

“may have the accusers by face”

Here, the word **face** represents the presence of a person by association with the way people can see the face of someone who is present. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [may meet face to face with the accusers]

See: Metonymy

Acts 25:17 (#2)

καθίσας ἐπὶ τοῦ βήματος

“having sat in the judgment seat”

Festus **sat in the judgment seat** as a symbolic action to show that he was ready to act as the judge in the case against Paul. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [having sat in the judgment seat to show that I was ready to act as the judge in this case]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 25:17 (#1)

συνελθόντων

“when they had come together”

The pronoun **they** refers to the chief priests and the elders of the Jews, whom Festus mentioned in verse 15. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when the chief priests and the elders of the Jews had come together]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 25:17 (#3)

ἐκέλευσα ἀχθῆναι τὸν ἄνδρα

“I commanded the man to be brought”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I commanded soldiers to bring the man]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:19 (#1)

τῆς ἰδίας δεισιδαιμονίας

“their own religion”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **religion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [their religious beliefs] or [their beliefs about God and spiritual things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 25:20 (#2)

κρίνεσθαι

“be judged”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and have me judge him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:20 (#1)

ἔλεγον εἰ βούλοιτο πορεύεσθαι εἰς Ἰεροσόλυμα, κἀκεῖ κρίνεσθαι περὶ τούτων

“asked if he might be willing to go to Jerusalem and be judged there about these things”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [asked, ‘Might you be willing to go to Jerusalem and be judged there about these things?’]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 25:21 (#2)

τοῦ Σεβαστοῦ

“of the August one”

Festus is referring to the Roman emperor by a respectful title. Your language and culture may have a similar title that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [of His Majesty the Emperor]

See: Politeness

Acts 25:21 (#3)

ἐκέλευσα τηρεῖσθαι αὐτὸν

“I commanded him to be kept”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [I commanded the guards to keep him in custody]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:21 (#1)

τοῦ & Παύλου ἐπικαλεσαμένου τηρηθῆναι αὐτὸν

“when Paul appealed that he be kept”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could state this in active form. Alternate translation: [when Paul asked that I keep him]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:22 (#2)

φησίν

“he says”

To call attention to a development in the story, here Luke uses the present tense in past narration. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense in your translation. It may be helpful to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [he said]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Acts 25:22 (#1)

ἐβουλόμην καὶ αὐτὸς τοῦ ἀνθρώπου ἀκοῦσαι

“I myself was also wanting to hear this man”

Agrippa is using the reflexive pronoun **myself** for emphasis. It may be more natural in your language to express this emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I too would certainly want to hear this man]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Acts 25:23 (#1)

ἤχθη ὁ Παῦλος

“Paul was brought”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the soldiers brought Paul]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 25:24 (#2)

ἡμῖν

“with us”

By **us**, Festus means himself and King Agrippa but not the rest of the crowd to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 25:24 (#5)

μὴ δεῖν αὐτὸν ζῆν μηκέτι

"he ought not to live any longer"

In Greek this is a double negative for emphasis, "he ought not to live no longer." In Greek, the second negative creates a positive meaning by canceling the first negative. If for emphasis your language uses double negatives that do not cancel one another, it would be appropriate to use that construction here. You could also state the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [he should die immediately]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 25:24 (#3)

ἅπαν τὸ πλῆθος τῶν Ἰουδαίων ἐνέτυχόν μοι

"the whole multitude of the Jews petitioned me"

Festus says **the whole** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [the multitude of the Jews petitioned me urgently]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 25:24 (#4)

βοῶντες μὴ δεῖν αὐτὸν ζῆν μηκέτι

"shouting that he ought not to live any longer"

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [shouting, 'He ought not to live any longer!']

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 25:24 (#1)

πάντες οἱ & ἄνδρες

"all the men"

Although the term **men** is masculine, Festus is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. (It is clear that women as well as men are **present**, since Luke notes in verse 23 that Bernice entered with Agrippa.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a term in your language that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [all of you]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Acts 25:25 (#1)

τὸν Σεβαστὸν

"the August one"

Festus is referring to the Roman emperor by a respectful title. Your language and culture may have a similar title that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [to His Majesty the Emperor]

See: Politeness

Acts 25:26 (#1)

τῷ κυρίῳ

"to the lord"

Festus is referring to the emperor by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [to our lord the emperor]

See: Politeness

Acts 25:26 (#2)

ὑμῶν & σοῦ

"you & you"

Here the first instance of **you** is plural and refers to everyone assembled in the hall. The second **you** is singular and is directed only to Agrippa. Use the plural and singular forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Acts 25:27 (#1)

ἄλογον & μοι δοκεῖ πέμποντα δέσμιον, μὴ καὶ & σημᾶναι

"it seems unreasonable to me, sending a prisoner and not to signify"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative adjective **unreasonable**. Alternate translation: [it seems reasonable to me, sending a prisoner, that I should state]

See: Double Negatives

Acts - Chapter 26 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This is the third account of Paul's conversion in the book of Acts. Because this is such an important event

in the early church, there are three accounts of Paul's conversion. (See: Acts 9 and Acts 22)

Paul told King Agrippa why he had done what he had done and said that the governor should not punish him for that.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Light and darkness
The Bible often speaks of unrighteous people, people who do not do what pleases God, as if they were walking around in darkness. It speaks of light as if it were what enables those sinful people to become righteous, to understand what they are doing wrong and begin to obey God. (See: righteous, righteousness, unrighteous, unrighteousness, upright, uprightness)

Acts 26:1 (#2)

ἐκτείνας τὴν χεῖρα

"stretching out {his} hand"

This could mean: (1) that Paul waved his hand to get the attention of the audience and signal that he was about to speak. Alternate translation: [waving his hand to signal that he was about to speak]; (2) that as Paul spoke, he used hand gestures to emphasize the points he was making. Alternate translation: [gesturing with his hand as he spoke]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 26:1 (#1)

ἐπιτρέπεταί σοι

"It is permitted to you"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I permit you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 26:2 (#2)

Ἰουδαίων

"the Jews"

Paul is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [many of the Jewish leaders]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 26:2 (#1)

ὧν ἐγκαλοῦμαι ὑπὸ Ἰουδαίων

"of which I am accused by the Jews"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that the Jews accuse me of doing]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 26:3 (#1)

πάντων τῶν κατὰ Ἰουδαίους, ἐθῶν τε καὶ ζητημάτων

"in all the customs and controversies among the Jews"

Paul says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [in a wide range of customs and controversies among the Jews]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 26:4 (#2)

ἐν τῷ ἔθνει μου ἔν τε Ἱεροσολύμοις

"in my nation and in Jerusalem"

By **nation**, Paul most likely means by association the people of his nation, that is, the Jews. Alternate translation: [among the Jews, especially in the city of Jerusalem]

See: Metonymy

Acts 26:4 (#1)

ἴσασι πάντες οἱ Ἰουδαῖοι

"all the Jews know"

Paul says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [the Jews know very well]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 26:5 (#1)

τῆς ἡμετέρας θρησκείας

"of our religion"

By **our**, Paul means himself and his fellow Jews but not Agrippa to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 26:6 (#4)

τῆς εἰς τοὺς πατέρας ἡμῶν ἐπαγγελίας, γενομένης ὑπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“of the promise made to our fathers by God”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [of the promise that God made to our fathers]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 26:6 (#2)

ἕστηκα κρινόμενος

“I stand here being judged”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you are judging me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 26:6 (#7)

τοὺς πατέρας ἡμῶν

“our fathers”

By **our**, Paul means himself and his fellow Jews but not Agrippa to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 26:6 (#1)

νῦν

“now”

Paul is using the word translated as **Now** to introduce a new phase of his defense. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that would be natural for this purpose.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 26:6 (#6)

τοὺς πατέρας ἡμῶν

“our fathers”

Paul is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 26:6 (#5)

τῆς εἰς τοὺς πατέρας ἡμῶν ἐπαγγελίας, γενομένης ὑπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“of the promise made to our fathers by God”

Since Paul explains in verse 8 that the **promise** for which he has **hope** is the resurrection from the dead, here you do not need to explain further what Paul means.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

Acts 26:6 (#3)

ἐπ’ ἐλπίδι τῆς εἰς τοὺς πατέρας ἡμῶν ἐπαγγελίας, γενομένης ὑπὸ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“because of hope of the promise made to our fathers by God”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **hope**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because I hope in the promise made to our fathers by God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 26:7 (#6)

ὑπὸ Ἰουδαίων

“by the Jews”

Paul is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by these Jewish leaders]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 26:7 (#4)

νύκτα καὶ ἡμέραν

“night and day”

Paul is using the two parts of a full day, **night** and **day**, to refer to continuous activity throughout a full day. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [continually] or, if you translated **serving in earnestness** as **serving earnestly**: [and continually]

See: Merism

Acts 26:7 (#5)

ἐνκαλοῦμαι ὑπὸ Ἰουδαίων

“I am being accused by the Jews”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Jews are accusing me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 26:7 (#1)

τὸ δωδεκάφυλον ἡμῶν

“our 12 tribes”

Paul is referring to the people of Israel by association with the way that nation was historically composed of 12 tribes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [our Jewish people]

See: Metonymy

Acts 26:7 (#2)

τὸ δωδεκάφυλον ἡμῶν

“our 12 tribes”

By **our**, Paul means himself and his fellow Jews but not Agrippa to whom he is speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 26:7 (#3)

ἐν ἐκτενείᾳ & λατρεῦον

“serving in earnestness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **earnestness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [serving earnestly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 26:8 (#1)

τί ἄπιστον κρίνεται παρ’ ὑμῖν, εἰ ὁ Θεὸς νεκροὺς ἐγείρει

“Why is it judged unbelievable among you if God raises the dead”

Paul is using the question form to challenge the Jewish leaders who are accusing him. Many of them are Pharisees who believe that God does raise the dead, and yet they do not believe that God raised Jesus from the dead. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [By accusing me, you are acting as if you do not believe that God raises the dead!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 26:8 (#3)

εἰ ὁ Θεὸς νεκροὺς ἐγείρει

“if God raises the dead”

Paul is speaking as if what he is saying is a hypothetical possibility, but he believes that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if the speaker believes that it is true, then you can translate these words as an affirmative statement. Alternate translation: [that God raises the dead]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

Acts 26:8 (#5)

νεκροὺς

“the dead”

Paul is using the adjective **dead** as a noun to mean people who have died. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 26:8 (#4)

νεκροὺς ἐγείρει

“raises the dead”

Here, **raises the dead** is an idiom that refers to making someone who has died alive again. Alternate translation: [God makes the dead alive again]

See: Idiom

Acts 26:8 (#2)

παρ’ ὑμῖν

“among you”

While to this point Paul has used the word **you** in the singular to refer to Agrippa, here he uses it in the plural to refer to the Jewish leaders who are present. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Acts 26:9 (#1)

τὸ ὄνομα Ἰησοῦ

"the name of Jesus"

While in such contexts the word **name** often represents the person who has that name, Paul is describing a time when he did not believe that Jesus was still alive. So here the word **name** seems to represent the reputation and influence of Jesus. Alternate translation: [the reputation and influence of Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 26:10 (#2)

ἀναιρουμένων & αὐτῶν

"when they were being executed"

Paul is using one part of the process of putting someone on trial for a capital offense and punishing that person if he is found guilty to represent the entire process. Since he speaks of casting his **vote** in favor of execution, here he means specifically the trial part of the process. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when they were being put on trial for crimes with a penalty of death]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 26:10 (#4)

κατήνεγκα ψῆφον

"I cast my vote against them"

The implication is that Paul **cast his vote** as a member of the Sanhedrin. You can provide this information in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as a member of the Sanhedrin, I cast my vote against them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 26:10 (#1)

τῶν ἁγίων

"of the saints"

Paul is using the term **saints** by association to mean believers in Jesus. See how you translated the term in 9:32. Alternate translation: [of the believers in Jesus]

See: Metonymy

Acts 26:10 (#3)

ἀναιρουμένων & αὐτῶν

"when they were being executed"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when the Sanhedrin was considering whether to execute them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 26:11 (#1)

κατὰ πάσας τὰς συναγωγὰς & τιμωρῶν αὐτοὺς

"punishing them in all the synagogues"

Paul says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [going from one synagogue to another to punish them]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 26:12 (#1)

μετ' ἐξουσίας καὶ ἐπιτροπῆς

"with authority and a commission"

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **authority** tells what kind of **commission** the **chief priests** gave Paul. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use "and." Alternate translation: [with an authoritative commission]

See: Hendiadys

Acts 26:14 (#3)

τί με διώκεις

"why are you persecuting me"

The voice is using the question form to rebuke Saul. If you would not use a rhetorical question for this purpose in your language, you could translate its words as a statement or an exclamation and communicate the rebuke in another way. Alternate translation: [you should not be persecuting me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 26:14 (#4)

σκληρόν σοι πρὸς κέντρα λακτίζειν

"It is hard for you to kick against a goad"

The voice is speaking as if Paul were literally kicking against a **goad**, that is, a sharp object that people use to prod an animal. The voice means that by opposing Jesus and persecuting believers, Paul is hurting himself. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You are hurting yourself by what you are doing]

See: Metaphor

Acts 26:14 (#1)

ἤκουσα φωνὴν, λέγουσαν πρός με τῇ Ἑβραΐδι διαλέκτῳ, Σαοὺλ, Σαούλ, τί με διώκεις? σκληρόν σοι πρὸς κέντρα λακτίζειν

“I heard a voice speaking to me in the Hebrew language, ‘Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting me? It is hard for you to kick against a goad”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [I heard a voice speaking to me in the Hebrew language, calling me twice by name, asking me why I was persecuting him, and telling me it was hard for me to kick against a goad.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 26:14 (#2)

ἤκουσα φωνὴν, λέγουσαν πρός με

“I heard a voice speaking to me”

Paul is speaking of this **voice** as if it were a living thing that could speak on its own. Alternate translation: [I heard someone saying to me]

See: Personification

Acts 26:15 (#2)

τίς εἶ, κύριε

“Who are you, Lord”

When Paul replied to the voice, he was not yet acknowledging that Jesus was **Lord**. He used that respectful title because he recognized that he was speaking to someone of divine power. If this might be confusing for your readers, in your translation you could use a similar term of respect. Alternate translation: [Who are you, Sir]

See: Politeness

Acts 26:15 (#3)

ὁ & Κύριος εἶπεν

“the Lord said”

In this case Paul is referring to Jesus by a respectful title. Use a form for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [the Lord Jesus said]

See: Politeness

Acts 26:15 (#1)

ἐγὼ δὲ εἶπα, τίς εἶ, κύριε? ὁ δὲ Κύριος εἶπεν, ἐγώ εἰμι Ἰησοῦς, ὃν σὺ διώκεις

“And I said, ‘Who are you, Lord?’ And the Lord said, ‘I am Jesus, whom you are persecuting”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And I asked the Lord who he was, and the Lord said that he was Jesus, whom I was persecuting]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 26:16 (#2)

ἀνάστηθι, καὶ στῆθι ἐπὶ τοὺς πόδας σου

“get up and stand on your feet”

It might seem that the expression **get up and stand on your feet** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [stand up]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 26:16 (#3)

ὀφθήσομαί σοι

“I will be shown to you”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I will show myself to you]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 26:16 (#1)

ἀλλὰ ἀνάστηθι, καὶ στῆθι ἐπὶ τοὺς πόδας σου; εἰς τοῦτο γὰρ ὤφθην σοι, προχειρίσασθαί σε ὑπηρέτην καὶ μάρτυρα, ὧν τε εἶδές με ὧν τε ὀφθήσομαί σοι

“But get up and stand on your feet, because for this I have appeared to you, to appoint you a servant and a witness both of the things in which you have seen me and of the things in which I will be shown to you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [He told me to get up and stand on my feet, because for this he had appeared to me, to appoint me a servant and a witness both of the things in which I had seen him and of the things in which he would be shown to me]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 26:17 (#1)

ἐξαιρούμενός σε ἐκ τοῦ λαοῦ καὶ ἐκ τῶν ἐθνῶν, εἰς οὓς ἐγὼ ἀποστέλλω σε

"rescuing you from the people and from the Gentiles, to whom I am sending you"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [He told me that he would rescue me from the peoples and from the Gentiles, to whom he was sending me]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 26:17 (#2)

τοῦ λαοῦ

"the people"

By **the people**, Jesus means specifically the Jewish people. Alternate translation: [the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 26:18 (#5)

τοῦ λαβεῖν αὐτοὺς ἄφεσιν ἁμαρτιῶν καὶ

"for them to receive forgiveness of sins and"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **forgiveness**, you could express the same idea with the verb "forgive." Alternate translation: [so that God may forgive their sins and give them]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 26:18 (#7)

τοῖς ἡγιασμένοις πίστει τῇ εἰς ἐμέ

"the ones having been sanctified by faith in me"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the ones whom I sanctify because they have faith in me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 26:18 (#6)

κλῆρον ἐν

"an inheritance among"

Jesus is speaking of the blessings that he gives to those who believe in him as if they were an **inheritance** such as children receive from their parents. Alternate translation: [the blessings that I give to]

See: Metaphor

Acts 26:18 (#2)

ἀνοῖξαι ὀφθαλμοὺς αὐτῶν, τοῦ ἐπιστρέψαι

"to open their eyes to turn"

Jesus is speaking of Paul helping people to understand the truth about him as if Paul would literally **open** the **eyes** of these people. Alternate translation: [to help them understand the truth about me so that they will turn]

See: Metaphor

Acts 26:18 (#3)

τοῦ ἐπιστρέψαι ἀπὸ σκότους εἰς φῶς

"to turn from darkness to light"

Jesus is speaking of Paul helping people to stop doing what is wrong and to start obeying God as if the Paul would be literally helping these people stop directing their attention to **darkness** and start directing it to **light**. Alternate translation: [so that they will stop doing what is wrong and start obeying God]

See: Metaphor

Acts 26:18 (#1)

ἀνοῖξαι ὀφθαλμοὺς αὐτῶν, τοῦ ἐπιστρέψαι ἀπὸ σκότους εἰς φῶς, καὶ τῆς ἐξουσίας τοῦ Σατανᾶ ἐπὶ τὸν Θεόν, τοῦ λαβεῖν αὐτοὺς ἄφεσιν ἁμαρτιῶν καὶ κλῆρον ἐν τοῖς ἡγιασμένοις πίστει τῇ εἰς ἐμέ

"to open their eyes to turn from darkness to light and from the authority of Satan to God, for them to receive forgiveness of sins and an inheritance among the ones having been sanctified by faith in me"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [to open their eyes to turn from darkness to light and from the authority of Satan to God, for them to receive forgiveness of

sins and an inheritance among the ones having been sanctified by faith in him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 26:18 (#4)

καὶ τῆς ἐξουσίας τοῦ Σατανᾶ ἐπὶ τὸν Θεόν

“and from the authority of Satan to God”

By **authority**, Jesus implicitly means the control that **Satan** has over people who are under his authority. You can provide this information in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and no longer have Satan control them but have God control them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 26:19 (#2)

τῇ οὐρανίῳ ὀπτασίᾳ

“to the heavenly vision”

Paul is referring to Jesus by association with the way Jesus spoke to him in this **vision**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to Jesus, who spoke to me from heaven in this vision]

See: Metonymy

Acts 26:19 (#1)

οὐκ ἐγενόμην ἀπειθὴς

“I was not disobedient”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative adjective **disobedient**. Alternate translation: [I was obedient]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 26:20 (#1)

ἐπιστρέφειν ἐπὶ τὸν Θεόν

“turn to God”

Paul is speaking as if he declared that people should physically **turn** to God. He means that he proclaimed they should stop living in one way and begin to live in another way. Alternate translation: [start obeying God]

See: Metaphor

Acts 26:20 (#2)

ἄξια τῆς μετανοίας ἔργα πράσσοντας

“doing deeds worthy of repentance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **repentance**, you could express the same idea with the verb “repent.” Alternate translation: [doing deeds that showed that they had truly repented]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 26:21 (#1)

Ἰουδαῖοι

“the Jews”

Paul is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Jews who opposed me]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 26:22 (#1)

μικρῷ τε καὶ μεγάλῳ

“to both small and great”

Paul is referring to people of every kind by naming two extremes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to people of every kind]

See: Merism

Acts 26:22 (#2)

οὐδὲν ἐκτὸς & ὧν

“nothing except the things that”

If it would appear in your language that Paul was contradicting himself by saying that he spoke **nothing** and then describing what he spoke, you could reword this to avoid using an exception clause. Alternate translation: [the same things that]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

Acts 26:23 (#6)

τῷ & λαῷ

“to the people”

By **the people**, Paul means specifically the Jewish people. Alternate translation: [to the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 26:23 (#4)

νεκρῶν

“of the dead”

Paul is using the adjective **dead** as a noun to mean people who have died. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [of people who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 26:23 (#3)

πρῶτος ἐξ ἀναστάσεως νεκρῶν

“the first from the resurrection of the dead”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **resurrection**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the first person whom God made alive again after he died]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 26:23 (#5)

φῶς μέλλει καταγγέλλειν

“he & was going to proclaim light”

Paul is saying that the truth that Jesus proclaimed about God was like a **light** that allowed people to see. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [was going to proclaim the truth about God]

See: Metaphor

Acts 26:23 (#1)

εἰ παθητὸς ὁ Χριστός; εἰ πρῶτος ἐξ ἀναστάσεως νεκρῶν, φῶς μέλλει καταγγέλλειν

“if the Christ would be a sufferer, if he, the first from the resurrection of the dead, was going to proclaim light”

Paul could be saying that this is what Moses and the prophets said about the Messiah. You can provide this information in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [They addressed the question as to whether the Christ would be a sufferer, as to whether he, the first from the resurrection of the dead, was going to proclaim] or see next note for another possibility.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 26:23 (#2)

εἰ παθητὸς ὁ Χριστός; εἰ πρῶτος ἐξ ἀναστάσεως νεκρῶν, φῶς μέλλει καταγγέλλειν

“if the Christ would be a sufferer, if he, the first from the resurrection of the dead, was going to proclaim light”

Paul could be speaking as if what he is saying is a hypothetical possibility even though he believes that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if the speaker believes that it is true, then you can translate these words as an affirmative statement. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Now since the Christ was a sufferer, since he was the first from the resurrection of the dead, then he was going to proclaim light]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

Acts 26:24 (#1)

ὁ Φῆστος & φησιν

“Festus says”

To call attention to a development in the story, here Luke uses the present tense in past narration. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the past tense in your translation. Alternate translation: [Festus said]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Acts 26:24 (#2)

τὰ πολλά σε γράμματα εἰς μανίαν περιτρέπει

“Great learning is turning you to insanity”

Festus is speaking of **learning** as if it were a living thing that was **turning** Paul from sanity to insanity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You have become insane from learning so much]

See: Personification

Acts 26:25 (#2)

κράτιστε Φῆστε

“most excellent Festus”

The expression **most excellent** was a formal title by which people addressed Roman officials. Your language and culture may have a comparable title that you can use in your translation. See how you translated the similar expression in Acts 23:26. Alternate translation: [Honorable Governor Festus]

See: Politeness

Acts 26:25 (#1)

οὐ μαίνομαι

“I am not insane”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative adjective **insane**. Alternate translation: [I am completely sane]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 26:25 (#3)

ἀληθείας καὶ σωφροσύνης ῥήματα

“words of truth and of sanity”

Paul is using the possessive form to describe the character of the **words** he is **speaking**. Alternate translation: [words that are true and sane]

See: Possession

Acts 26:26 (#3)

οὐ & ἐστιν ἐν γωνίᾳ πεπραγμένον τοῦτο

“not & this has & been done in a corner”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [this did not happen in a corner]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 26:26 (#2)

λανθάνειν & αὐτὸν τι τούτων οὐ πείθομαι οὐθέν

“I am not persuaded at all that any of these things eludes him”

In Greek this is a double negative for emphasis, “I am not persuaded that not any of these things eludes him.” In Greek, the second negative creates a positive meaning by canceling the first negative. If for emphasis your language uses double negatives that do not cancel one another, it would be appropriate to use that construction here. You could also state the meaning positively. Alternate translation: [I am persuaded that not one of these things at all eludes him]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 26:26 (#5)

ἐν γωνίᾳ

“in a corner”

Paul is speaking as if Jesus might have done things secretly, as if he had done them **in a corner** of a room where no one could see him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [secretly]

See: Metaphor

Acts 26:26 (#1)

πρὸς ὃν καὶ παρρησιαζόμενος λαλῶ

“to whom indeed, speaking boldly, I am talking”

Paul recognizes that he is being very outspoken in response to King Agrippa’s invitation to speak for himself, so he implicitly apologizes. In your translation, you could use a comparable expression from your language and culture. Alternate translation: [and I hope that he will pardon me for speaking so boldly as I talk to him]

See: Politeness

Acts 26:26 (#4)

οὐ & ἐστιν ἐν γωνίᾳ πεπραγμένον τοῦτο

“not & this has & been done in a corner”

Paul is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this has been done openly]

See: Litotes

Acts 26:27 (#1)

πιστεύεις, Βασιλεῦ Ἀγρίππα, τοῖς προφήταις

“Do you believe the prophets, King Agrippa”

Paul asks this question to challenge **King Agrippa** to recognize that if he believes what the prophets wrote, then he should believe that Jesus rose from the dead. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this question as a statement. Alternate translation: [You should believe what I am saying about Jesus since you believe the prophets, King Agrippa.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 26:28 (#1)

ἐν ὀλίγῳ με πείθεις Χριστιανὸν ποιῆσαι

“In little are you persuading me to make me a Christian”

Agrippa is using the question form to challenge Paul. He is asserting that what Paul has said so far is not sufficiently persuasive. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. The term **little** could mean: (1) little proof. Alternate translation: [You cannot persuade me to become a Christian with so little proof.]; (2) little time. Alternate translation: [You cannot persuade me to become a Christian in such a short time.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Acts 26:29 (#1)

καὶ ἐν ὀλίγῳ καὶ ἐν μεγάλῳ

"either in little or in much"

The term **little** could mean: (1) little proof. Alternate translation: [whether what I have said is enough or whether you need more proof]; (2) little time. Alternate translation: [whether it takes a short time or a long time]

Acts 26:29 (#2)

παρεκτὸς τῶν δεσμῶν τούτων

"without these chains"

Paul is using one aspect of imprisonment, the **chains** that bound prisoners at this time, to mean the entire state of being imprisoned. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [without being imprisoned]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 26:31 (#1)

οὐδὲν θανάτου ἢ δεσμῶν ἄξιον τι πράσσει ὁ ἄνθρωπος οὗτος

"This man is not doing anything worthy of death or of chains"

The king and governor are referring to a penalty of death by association with **death** itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [This man does not deserve to receive the death penalty or to be kept in chains]

See: Metonymy

Acts 26:31 (#2)

δεσμῶν

"of chains"

These people who heard Paul speak are using one aspect of imprisonment, the **chains** that bound prisoners at this time, to mean the entire state of being imprisoned. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of being imprisoned]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 26:32 (#1)

ἀπολελύσθαι ἐδύνατο ὁ ἄνθρωπος οὗτος

"This man was able to have been released"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [You could have released this man]

See: Active or Passive

Acts - Chapter 27 Introduction

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Sailing
People who lived near the sea traveled by boats powered by the wind. During some months of the year, the wind would blow in the wrong direction or so hard that sailing was impossible.

Trust
Paul trusted God to bring him safely to land. He told the sailors and soldiers to trust that God would also keep them alive. (See: trust, trusted, trustworthy, trustworthiness)

Paul breaks bread
Luke uses almost the same words here to describe Paul taking bread, thanking God, breaking it, and eating it that he used to describe the last supper Jesus ate with his disciples. However, your translation should not make your reader think that Paul was leading a religious celebration here.

Acts 27:1 (#6)

σπείρης Σεβαστῆς

"of the Augustan regiment"

The **Augustan regiment** was the name of the military unit from which this centurion came. Some versions translate this as the "Imperial regiment."

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:1 (#2)

ἐκρίθη τοῦ ἀποπλεῖν ἡμᾶς

“it was decided for us to sail”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that he says **us** because he joined Paul at this point in the story. You can include this information if your readers need it to understand what is happening. UST models a way to do this.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 27:1 (#4)

ἑκατοντάρχῃ ὀνόματι Ἰουλίῳ

“to a centurion, Julius by name”

Luke is using the phrase **a centurion** to introduce **Julius** as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Acts 27:1 (#1)

ἐκρίθη τοῦ ἀποπλεῖν ἡμᾶς

“it was decided for us to sail”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Roman authorities decided that we should sail]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:1 (#5)

Ἰουλίῳ

“Julius”

The word **Julius** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:1 (#3)

ἡμᾶς

“for us”

As the introduction to this chapter explains, here and in several other places Luke says “we,” **us**, and “our” to mean himself and others who were traveling with him, but not his readers. So use the exclusive form of those words if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Acts 27:2 (#1)

Ἀδραμυντηνῷ

“from Adramyttium”

The word **Adramyttium** is the name of a city.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:2 (#3)

Ἀριστάρχου

“Aristarchus”

The word **Aristarchus** is the name of a man who came from Macedonia but who had been working with Paul in Ephesus. See how you translated his name in 19:29.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:2 (#2)

πλοίῳ & μέλλοντι πλεῖν

“a ship & being about to sail”

Luke is referring to what the crew of this ship was about to do by association with the ship itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a ship whose crew was about to sail it]

See: Metonymy

Acts 27:3 (#1)

κατήχθημεν εἰς Σιδῶνα

“we came down to Sidon”

As the introduction to this chapter explains, Luke says that he and the other travelers **came down** to Sidon because that was the customary way in this culture of describing people arriving somewhere after traveling by sea. Your language may have its own way of describing that. Alternate translation: [we landed at Sidon]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:3 (#2)

ἐπιμελείας τυχεῖν

“to receive {their} care”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **care**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [so that they could care for him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 27:4 (#1)

ὑπεπλεύσαμεν τὴν Κύπρον

“we sailed under Cyprus”

The expression **sailed under** does not mean that the travelers sailed south of the island of Cyprus, such as Luke describes in 21:3, even though that would have been the shortest route. Rather, **sailed under** means that the ship kept close to the northern shore of the island, which loomed above the ship and blocked the wind. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express that meaning plainly. However, if the people of your culture are familiar with sea travel, you could use the corresponding expression that is most natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we stayed close to the northern shore of Cyprus]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:5 (#2)

Μύρρα τῆς Λυκίας

“Myra of Lycia”

The word **Myra** is the name of a city, and the word **Lycia** is the name of the province in which that city was located.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:5 (#1)

κατήλθαμεν εἰς Μύρρα τῆς Λυκίας

“we came down to Myra of Lycia”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that the travelers got off the ship at **Myra**. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [we came down to Myra of Lycia, where we got off the ship]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 27:6 (#2)

Ἀλεξανδρῖνον

“Alexandrian”

The word **Alexandrian** is the name for someone or something that comes from the city of Alexandria. See how you translated it in 18:24.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:6 (#1)

πλοῖον Ἀλεξανδρῖνον, πλέον εἰς τὴν Ἰταλίαν

“an Alexandrian ship sailing to Italy”

Luke is referring to what the crew of this ship was doing by association with the ship itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a ship whose crew was sailing it to Italy]

See: Metonymy

Acts 27:7 (#2)

τὴν Κνίδον

“Cnidus”

The word **Cnidus** is the name of a city.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:7 (#3)

τὴν Κρήτην & Σαλμώνην

“Crete & Salmone”

The word **Crete** is the name of an island. See how you translated the word “Cretans” in 2:11. The word **Salmone** is the name of a cape on the east end of the island of Crete.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:7 (#1)

ἐν ἱκαναῖς δὲ ἡμέραις, βραδυπλοοῦντες καὶ μόλις, γενόμενοι κατὰ τὴν Κνίδον

“And sailing slowly for many days and having arrived with difficulty near Cnidus”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that the ship was **sailing slowly** and **with difficulty** because it was sailing into the wind. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [sailing slowly for many days and having arrived with difficulty near Cnidus because we were sailing into the wind]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 27:8 (#3)

Καλοὺς Λιμένας

“Fair Havens”

The word **Fair Havens** is the name of a port on the south coast of the island of Crete.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:8 (#4)

πόλις ᾗ ν Λασαία

“was & the city of Lasea”

The word **Lasea** is the name of a city on the coast of the island of Crete.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:8 (#2)

μόλις

“with difficulty”

The implication is that even under the shelter of the island of Crete, the winds were still so strong as to make sailing to the west difficult. You can provide this information in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with difficulty because the winds from the west were strong even there]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 27:8 (#1)

παραλεγόμενοι αὐτὴν

“sailing along it”

The pronoun **it** refers the island of Crete. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [sailing along the island of Crete]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 27:9 (#1)

τὸ καὶ τὴν νηστείαν ἤδη παρεληλυθέναι

“even the fast had already passed”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that after this **fast**, which came in the last part of September or the first part of October according to Western calendars, there was a higher risk of seasonal storms. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [even the fast had already passed and so there was a higher risk of seasonal storms]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 27:9 (#2)

τὴν νηστείαν

“the fast”

Luke is referring to the Day of Atonement by association with the way that Jews observed a **fast** in connection with that sacred day. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Day of Atonement]

See: Metonymy

Acts 27:9 (#3)

παρήνει ὁ Παῦλος

“Paul was warning them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the centurion and to the pilot and owner of the ship, as verse 11 makes clear. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul was warning Julius and the pilot and the owner of the ship]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 27:10 (#1)

θεωρῶ

“I see”

Paul is speaking as if he could literally **see** the things he describes. He means that God has revealed them to him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God has revealed to me]

See: Metaphor

Acts 27:10 (#2)

μετὰ ὕβρεως καὶ πολλῆς ζημίας, οὐ μόνον τοῦ φορτίου καὶ τοῦ πλοίου, ἀλλὰ καὶ τῶν ψυχῶν ἡμῶν, μέλλειν ἔσεσθαι τὸν πλοῦν

“the voyage is about to be with injury and much loss, not only of the cargo and the ship, but also of our lives”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **injury** and **loss**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. It may be helpful to make this two sentences. Alternate translation: [on this voyage, many of us will be injured and we will lose many valuable things. We will not only lose the cargo and the ship, we will lose our lives]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 27:11 (#1)

ὁ & ἑκατοντάρχης τῷ κυβερνήτῃ καὶ τῷ ναυκλήρῳ μᾶλλον ἐπείθετο, ἢ τοῖς ὑπὸ Παύλου λεγομένοις

“the centurion was being persuaded more by the pilot and by the captain than by the things being spoken by Paul”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in other ways that are natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the pilot and the captain were persuading the centurion more by what they were saying than Paul was persuading him by what he was saying]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:11 (#2)

τῷ ναυκλήρῳ

"by the captain"

Here the word **captain** could mean: (1) someone who was in command of the ship. Alternate translation: [the ship's commander]; (2) someone who owned the ship and was in command of it. However, while this is a common meaning of the word, it is unlikely in this context. We learn from the story that this ship was carrying grain from Egypt to Italy and so it would have belonged to the emperor's own fleet. Alternate translation: [the shipowner]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 27:12 (#3)

Φοίνικα

"Phoenix"

The word **Phoenix** is the name of a port city on the south coast of Crete.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:12 (#6)

λίβα & χῶρον

"the southwest wind & the northwest wind"

These directions are based on the rising and setting of the sun. The **southwest** is somewhat to the left of the setting sun, and the **northwest** is somewhat to the right of the setting sun. If you decide to use the terms "northeast" and "southeast" instead, based on the two previous notes, the northeast is somewhat to the left of the rising sun and the southeast is somewhat to the right of the rising sun. Your language and culture may have their own terms for these directions.

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 27:12 (#1)

λιμένος

"harbor"

A **harbor** is a place on the coast whose location and shape allow ships to come safely close to the land. If your language does not have a term for such a place, you could use a general description in your translation. Alternate translation: [place of access to the shore]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 27:12 (#4)

βλέποντα κατὰ λίβα καὶ κατὰ χῶρον

"looking according to the southwest wind and according to the northwest wind"

This expression means that the Phoenix harbor provided access for ships to sail out in the directions that the winds coming from the **southwest** and the **northwest** blew. That is, ships would sail out to the northeast and southeast from the harbor, and they would enter the harbor from the northeast or southeast. Your language and culture may have a comparable expression of its own that you can use in your translation. Otherwise, you could describe this in general terms. Alternate translation: [looking down the northwest wind and down the southwest wind]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:12 (#5)

βλέποντα κατὰ λίβα καὶ κατὰ χῶρον

"looking according to the southwest wind and according to the northwest wind"

Luke is speaking as if the harbor of Phoenix was literally **looking** in these directions. He means that it gave access for ships to sail in those directions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [giving access for sailing to the northeast or to the southeast]

See: Metaphor

Acts 27:12 (#2)

παραχειμασίαν & παραχειμάσαι

"wintering & to winter there"

The terms **wintering** and **to winter** mean to stay in a place that is safe during the winter, which is a cold and stormy season in this location. If the seasons do not vary much in your location or if there is not a cold and stormy season, you could explain this with a general expression. Alternate translation: [staying during a cold and stormy season ... to stay there during the cold and stormy season]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 27:13 (#2)

παρελέγοντο

“they were sailing along”

The pronoun **they** refers to the crew of the ship. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the crew was sailing the ship]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 27:13 (#1)

ἄραντες

“having raised {the anchor”

An **anchor** is a heavy object that is attached to a rope that is tied to a ship. The ship’s crew tosses the anchor into the water and it sinks to the bottom of the sea, keeping the ship from drifting about. The crew raises the anchor out of the water when it is time for the ship to travel. Your language may have a specific expression for this action. Alternate translation: [having weighed anchor]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 27:14 (#4)

αὐτῆς

“it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the island of Crete. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the island of Crete]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 27:14 (#2)

ὁ καλούμενος Εὐρακύλων

“called Eurakylon”

The term **Euraklyon** is a combination of the Greek word for the east wind and the Latin word for the north wind. Luke spells out the term using Greek letters so that his readers will know how it sounds. This seems to be the name that Luke heard the sailors give to this wind. In your translation, you could spell it the way it sounds in your language. You could also say what it means. Alternate translation: [called the Northeaster]

See: Copy or Borrow Words

Acts 27:14 (#1)

μετ᾽ οὐ πολὺ

“after not long”

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [after a short time]

See: Litotes

Acts 27:14 (#3)

ὁ καλούμενος

“called”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that the sailors called]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:15 (#2)

συναρπασθέντος & τοῦ πλοίου, καὶ μὴ δυναμένου ἀντοφθαλμεῖν τῷ ἀνέμῳ

“the ship having been seized and not being able to face into the wind”

Luke is speaking of the **wind** as if it were a living thing that **seized** the **ship**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with the wind blowing with such force that it kept the ship from sailing in the direction from which it was coming]

See: Personification

Acts 27:15 (#4)

ἐφερόμεθα

“we were driven along”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the wind drove us along]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:15 (#1)

συναρπασθέντος δὲ τοῦ πλοίου, καὶ μὴ δυναμένου ἀντοφθαλμεῖν τῷ ἀνέμῳ

“And the ship having been seized and not being able to face into the wind”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [when the wind seized the ship, so that we were not able to face into the wind]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:15 (#3)

ἀντοφθαλμεῖν τῷ ἀνέμῳ

"to face into the wind"

Luke is speaking as if the ship literally had a **face** that it could turn towards the wind. Your language may have an expression that suits this context and that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [to bear up against the wind]

See: Metaphor

Acts 27:16 (#4)

τῆς σκάφης

"of the lifeboat"

A **lifeboat** is a smaller boat that crews sometimes tow behind their larger ship and sometimes bring up onto the ship and tie down. They use the smaller boat for various reasons, including escaping from the larger ship if it is sinking. If your language does not have a term for a smaller boat like this, you could use a general expression in your translation. Alternate translation: [of the smaller utility boat that the ship was towing]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 27:16 (#3)

Καῦδα

"Cauda"

The word **Cauda** is the name of a small island located off the south coast of Crete.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:16 (#1)

νησίον & τι ὑποδραμόντες, καλούμενον Καῦδα

"running under a certain island called Cauda"

The expression **running under** is a sailing term that means to go along a specific side of some land in order to block the wind. Your language may have a specific expression for this action. If not, you could explain the meaning generally. Alternate translation: [sailing under the lee of a certain island called Cauda] or [sailing on the side of an island called Cauda where the wind was not so strong]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:16 (#2)

νησίον & τι & καλούμενον Καῦδα

"a certain island called Cauda"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a certain island that people called Cauda]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:17 (#6)

χαλάσαντες τὸ σκεῦος

"lowering the gear"

The term **gear** could mean: (1) the sails of the ship and the rigging that the sailors uses to raise and lower the sails. If this is the meaning, then Luke is saying that without sails, the sailors could not steer the ship and it had to go wherever the wind drove it. Alternate translation: [taking down the sails]; (2) a sea anchor, that is, some object that the sailors would drag along in the water behind the ship in order to slow the ship down. If this is the meaning, then the sailors lowered this sea anchor in the hopes that the storm would end before they reached the quicksand. Alternate translation: [putting a sea anchor into the water]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 27:17 (#3)

μὴ εἰς τὴν Σύρτιν ἐκπέσωσιν

"lest they might fall into the Syrtis"

The expression **fall into** is a nautical term that in this context describes a ship becoming stuck in quicksand. If your language does not have a comparable nautical term, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [they might run aground on the Syrtis]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:17 (#5)

τὴν Σύρτιν

"the Syrtis"

Quicksand, which the word **Syrtis** describes, is sand that is saturated with water. It does not support the weight of a person, so sailors cannot get out of a

ship to free it if the ship gets stuck in quicksand. If your readers would not be familiar with quicksand, you could describe it generally in your translation. Alternate translation: [the large mass of waterlogged sand off the north coast of Africa]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 27:17 (#4)

τὴν Σύρτιν

"the Syrtis"

The word **Syrtis** is the name of a large mass of quicksand near the north coast of Africa.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:17 (#1)

βοηθείαις ἐχρῶντο, ὑποζωννύντες τὸ πλοῖον

"they were using helps, undergirding the ship"

The word **helps** is a nautical term that means ropes or cables. The word **undergirding** describes the process of running ropes or cables around the bottom of a ship so that the ship will not come apart during a storm. If your language does not have comparable nautical terms, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [they were tying ropes around the bottom of the ship so that it would not come apart during the storm]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:17 (#7)

ἐφέροντο

"they were being driven along"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the wind was driving them along]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:17 (#2)

ἐχρῶντο

"they were using"

Here and in the next two verses, the pronoun **they** refers to the sailors of the ship. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the sailors were using]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 27:18 (#2)

ἐκβολὴν ἐποιοῦντο

"they were doing a jettison"

The word **jettison** is a nautical term that describes sailors throwing the cargo of a ship (the goods that the ship is transporting) into the sea to lighten the weight of the ship in an effort to prevent it from sinking. If your language does not have a comparable nautical term, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [they were throwing the cargo of the ship into the sea to make the ship lighter to try to keep it from sinking]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:18 (#1)

σφοδρῶς & χειμαζομένων ἡμῶν

"we being exceedingly storm-tossed"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [as the storm was tossing us exceedingly]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:19 (#2)

τῇ τρίτῃ

"on the third day"

If you retain this idiom but your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [on day three]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Acts 27:19 (#3)

τὴν σκευὴν τοῦ πλοίου ἔριψαν

"they threw the equipment of the ship {overboard"

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that the sailors **threw the equipment ... overboard** in a desperate effort to make the ship even lighter. In this context, **equipment** refers to everything the sailors needed to sail the ship: tackle, hoists, beams of wood, block and tackle, ropes, lines, sails, and the like. This indicates that they had given up on sailing the ship and were hoping just to survive. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [they became so desperate that they threw overboard everything they needed to sail the ship, hoping just to survive]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 27:19 (#1)

τῇ τρίτῃ

“on the third day”

In the idiom of this culture, today was the “first day,” tomorrow was the “second day,” and the day after tomorrow was the “third day.” So here, **the third day** means two days after the sailors tied ropes around the ship and one day after the sailors threw the cargo overboard. You may wish to express this in your translation in the way your own culture reckons time. Alternate translation: [on the day after that]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:19 (#4)

αὐτόχειρες

“with their own hands”

Luke is using one part of the sailors, their **hands**, to represent all of them in the act of throwing the cargo overboard. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [themselves]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 27:20 (#2)

χειμῶνός & οὐκ ὀλίγου

“no small storm”

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a great storm]

See: Litotes

Acts 27:20 (#3)

ἐπικειμένου

“lying upon us”

Luke is speaking of the storm as if they were a living thing that was **lying upon** the ship. He means that the storm continued to buffet the ship without ever letting up. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [continually buffeting the ship]

See: Personification

Acts 27:20 (#1)

μήτε & ἡλίου μήτε ἄστρων ἐπιφαινόντων ἐπὶ πλείονας ἡμέρας

“neither sun nor stars appearing for many days”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that the **sun** and **stars** did not appear because the dark storm clouds obscured them. Luke also assumes that his readers will understand that sailors needed to see the sun and stars in order to know where they were and in what direction they were headed. So this is a further indication of how desperate the situation was. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [since the sailors could not determine their position or navigate the ship because the dark storm clouds prevented the sun and stars from appearing for many days]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 27:20 (#6)

λοιπὸν περιῃρεῖτο ἐλπὶς πᾶσα, τοῦ σῴζεσθαι ἡμᾶς

“all hope for us to be saved was finally being taken away”

Luke says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [it finally became very difficult to hope that we could save ourselves]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 27:20 (#4)

λοιπὸν περιῃρεῖτο ἐλπὶς πᾶσα, τοῦ σῴζεσθαι ἡμᾶς

“all hope for us to be saved was finally being taken away”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the same ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we finally lost all hope that we could save ourselves]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:20 (#5)

λοιπὸν περιῃρεῖτο ἐλπὶς πᾶσα, τοῦ σῴζεσθαι ἡμᾶς

“all hope for us to be saved was finally being taken away”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **hope**, you could express the same idea in

another way. Alternate translation: [we finally stopped hoping that we could save ourselves]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 27:21 (#1)

πολλῆς & ἀσιτίας ὑπαρχούσης

“as there had been much abstinence”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abstinence**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [as we had gone a long time without eating food]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 27:21 (#3)

τὴν ὕβριν ταύτην, καὶ τὴν ζημίαν

“this damage and loss”

The terms **injury** and **loss** mean similar things. Paul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [such a great loss]

See: Doublet

Acts 27:21 (#2)

σταθεὶς & ἐν μέσῳ αὐτῶν

“having stood up in the midst of them”

Paul **stood up** to indicate that he had something important to say. Alternate translation: [having stood up in the midst of them to show that he had something important to say]

See: Symbolic Action

Acts 27:22 (#1)

ἀποβολὴ & ψυχῆς οὐδεμία ἔσται ἐξ ὑμῶν, πλὴν τοῦ πλοίου

“there will be no loss of life among you, only of the ship”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [there will be no loss of life among you, there will only be loss of the ship]

See: Ellipsis

Acts 27:23 (#1)

τοῦ Θεοῦ, οὗ εἰμι, ᾧ καὶ λατρεύω

“of the God whose I am and whom I serve”

The phrases **whose I am** and **whom I serve** mean similar things. Paul is using repetition for emphasis. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine these phrases in your translation. Alternate translation: [of the God I worship]

See: Parallelism

Acts 27:24 (#2)

ἰδοὺ

“behold”

The angel is using the term **behold** to focus Paul’s attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation.

See: Metaphor

Acts 27:24 (#3)

Καίσαρί σε δεῖ παραστῆναι

“It is necessary for you to stand before Caesar”

The angel is using one aspect of the trial process, the fact that an accused person would **stand before** a judge, to represent the entire process. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You must appear in Caesar’s court so that he can judge you]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 27:24 (#1)

λέγων, μὴ φοβοῦ, Παῦλε; Καίσαρί σε δεῖ παραστῆναι, καὶ ἰδοὺ, κεχάρισταί σοι ὁ Θεὸς πάντας τοὺς πλέοντας μετὰ σοῦ

“saying, ‘Do not be afraid, Paul. It is necessary for you to stand before Caesar, and behold, God has graciously granted to you all the ones sailing with you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [The angel told me that I should not be afraid, because it was necessary for me to stand before Caesar, and behold, God had graciously granted to me all the ones sailing with me]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 27:25 (#1)

καθ᾽ ὃν τρόπον λελάληταί μοι

“according to the way it was told to me”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [according to the way the angel told me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:26 (#1)

εἰς νῆσον & τινα & ἐκπεσεῖν

“to fall upon some island”

The expression **fall upon** is a nautical term that in this context describes a ship running aground on the shore of an island. If your language does not have a comparable nautical term, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [to run aground on some island]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:27 (#3)

τῷ Ἀδρίᾳ

“the Hadria”

The word **Hadria** is the term that people of this culture used to describe the open Mediterranean Sea between Italy and Malta on the west and Greece and Crete on the east.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 27:27 (#4)

προσάγειν τινὰ αὐτοῖς χώραν

“some land to be approaching them”

Luke is speaking of this **land** as if it were a living thing that was **approaching** the sailors on the ship. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that they were approaching some land]

See: Personification

Acts 27:27 (#2)

διαφερομένων ἡμῶν

“as we were being driven about”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [as the storm was driving us about]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:27 (#1)

τεσσαρεσκαιδεκάτη νὺξ

“the fourteenth night”

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [night 14]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Acts 27:28 (#1)

βολίσαντες

“taking soundings”

The expression **taking soundings** is a nautical term that describes sailors determining the depth of the water. Sailors measure this by dropping a marked line with a weight tied to the end of it into the water. If your language does not have a comparable nautical term, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [measuring the depth of the sea water]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:28 (#2)

ὀργυιὰς εἴκοσι & ὀργυιὰς δεκαπέντε

“20 fathoms & 15 fathoms”

A **fathom** is a unit of measurement of the depth of water. One fathom is equal to about two meters or about six feet. Alternate translation: [40 meters ... 30 meters] or [120 feet ... 90 feet]

See: Numbers

Acts 27:29 (#2)

πρύμνης

“the stern”

The word **stern** is a nautical term that means the back of a ship. If your language does not have a comparable nautical term, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [the back of the ship]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:29 (#1)

κατὰ & ἐκπέσωμεν

“we might fall upon”

The expression **fall upon** is a nautical term that in this context describes a ship running aground on **some rugged place**. If your language does not have a comparable nautical term, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [we might run aground on]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:30 (#1)

πρῴρης

“the bow”

The word **bow** is a nautical term that means the front of a ship. If your language does not have a comparable nautical term, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [the front of the ship]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:31 (#1)

ὑμεῖς σωθῆναι οὐ δύνασθε

“you are not able to be saved”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you will not be able to save yourselves]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:32 (#1)

ἐκπεσεῖν

“fall away”

The expression **fall away** is a nautical term that in this context could mean: (1) that the soldiers let the lifeboat fall into the water where none of the sailors could get into it, because it was no longer tied to the ship. Alternate translation: [fall into the water]; (2) that the soldiers let the lifeboat, which was already in the water, drift away where none of the sailors could get into it. Alternate translation: [drift away]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:33 (#2)

ἄσιτοι & μηθὲν προσλαβόμενοι

“fasting, having eaten nothing”

The expressions **fasting** and **having eaten nothing** mean similar things. Paul is using the two expressions together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express this emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to eat nothing at all]

See: Doublet

Acts 27:33 (#1)

τεσσαρεσκαιδεκάτην σήμερον ἡμέραν, προσδοκῶντες & διατελεῖτε

“Anxiously waiting for a fourteenth day today, you are continuing”

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you could use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [This is now day 14 that you have been anxiously waiting, and you are continuing]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Acts 27:34 (#2)

οὐδενὸς & ὑμῶν θρὶξ ἀπὸ τῆς κεφαλῆς ἀπολεῖται

“a hair from the head of none of you will perish”

Paul is using one part of each of his listeners, a **hair** from his **head**, to represent all of that listener. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [each of you will survive without suffering harm]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 27:34 (#1)

τοῦτο & πρὸς τῆς ὑμετέρας σωτηρίας ὑπάρχει

“this is for your salvation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [this will save you] or [this will keep you alive]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 27:36 (#1)

εὔθυμοι & γενόμενοι πάντες

“they were all encouraged”

The phrase **were ... encouraged** is not actually a passive form in Greek. The word translated as **encouraged** is an adjective. However, this phrase might sound like a passive verbal form in other languages. If your language does not use passive forms, you could state this in active form or in another way that is natural in

your language. Alternate translation: [this encouraged them all]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:37 (#1)

ἤμεθα & αἱ πᾶσαι ψυχαὶ ἐν τῷ πλοίῳ, διακόσιαι ἑβδομήκοντα ἕξ

"we, all the souls in the ship, were 276"

This is background information about the number of people on the ship. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 27:37 (#2)

αἱ & ψυχαὶ

"the souls"

Luke is using one part of the people on the ship, their **souls**, to represent their entire selves. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 27:38 (#1)

κορεσθέντες & τροφῆς

"having been satisfied with food"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [having eaten enough food to satisfy them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:39 (#1)

οὐκ ἐπεγίνωσκον

"they were not recognizing"

Here and in the rest of this verse and in the next verse, the pronoun **they** refers to the sailors. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the sailors were not recognizing]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 27:39 (#2)

κόλπον & τινα

"a certain bay"

A **bay** is a large area of water that partly surrounded by land but open to a larger body of water. Your language may have a specific expression for this kind of area. If not, you could explain the meaning generally. Alternate translation: [a certain area of water sheltered by the land]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 27:40 (#1)

τὰς ζευκτηρίας τῶν πηδαλίων

"the bands of the rudders"

The words **bands** and **rudders** are nautical terms. The **rudders** were large pieces of wood at the back of the ship that the sailors used for steering the ship. The **bands** were ropes or cords that held the rudders out of the water while anchors were holding the ship in one place. If your language does not have comparable nautical terms, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [the ropes that held out of the water the pieces of wood that the sailors used to steer the ship]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:40 (#2)

τὸν ἀρτέμωνα

"the topsail"

A sail is a large piece of cloth that catches the wind in order to propel a ship through the water. A **topsail** is a sail that sailors place at the top of a mast on a ship. A mast is a vertical pole with cross-poles that hold sails. Alternate translation: [the sail that sailors put at the top of a pole, high above the ship]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 27:40 (#3)

κατεῖχον εἰς τὸν αἰγιαλόν

"they were heading to the beach"

In this context, the expression **they were heading** is a nautical term that describes a ship moving in a specific direction. If your language does not have a comparable nautical term, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [they were steering the ship toward the beach]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:41 (#2)

τόπον διθάλασσον

“a place between two seas”

The expression **a place between two seas** is a nautical term that describes a sandbar that extends out from the land. A sandbar forms when a sea current coming from one direction flows across a sea current coming from another direction. This causes the sand under the water to pile up, making the water shallow and dangerous for ships. If your language does not have a comparable nautical term, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [a sandbar extending out from the land]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:41 (#1)

περιπεσόντες & εἰς

“having fallen into”

The expression **having fallen into** is a nautical term that in this context describes a ship striking land. If your language does not have a comparable nautical term, you could state the meaning plainly in your translation. Alternate translation: [striking]

See: Idiom

Acts 27:41 (#3)

ἡ δὲ πρύμνα ἐλύετο ὑπὸ τῆς βίας

“but the stern was being loosed by the violence”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but the violence was breaking up the stern]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 27:41 (#5)

ὑπὸ τῆς βίας

“by the violence”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **violence**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because the waves that were hitting it were so strong]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 27:41 (#4)

ὑπὸ τῆς βίας

“by the violence”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that he is referring to the **violence** of the waves that were hitting the **stern** of the ship. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [by the violence of the waves]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 27:44 (#1)

καὶ τοὺς λοιποὺς

“and the rest”

Luke is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the previous verse if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the rest to depart]

See: Ellipsis

Acts - Chapter 28 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

No one knows for sure why Luke ends his history without telling what happened to Paul after he had been in Rome for two years.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

“Letters” and “brothers”

The Jewish leaders were surprised that Paul wanted to speak with them, because they had received no letters from the high priest in Jerusalem telling them that Paul was coming.

When the Jewish leaders spoke of “brothers,” they were referring to fellow Jews, not to Christians.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“He was a god”

The native people believed that Paul was a god, but they did not believe that he was the one true God. We do not know why Paul did not tell the native people that he was not a god.

Acts 28:1 (#3)

Μελίτη

“Malta”

The word **Malta** is the name of an island located south of the island of Sicily.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 28:1 (#2)

Μελίτη ἡ νῆσος καλεῖται

“the island was called Malta”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people called the island Malta]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:1 (#1)

διασωθέντες

“having been brought safely through”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who did the action, it seems that Luke means to say that it was God. Alternate translation: [after God had brought us safely through]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:2 (#1)

οἵ & βάρβαροι

“the barbarians”

Luke is using the word **barbarians** in the specific sense that it had in his culture. He means people who did not speak Greek or Latin. From his perspective and the perspective of the others with him, they were “foreigners,” but from their own perspectives, they were “natives” of the island. It may be appropriate to describe them that way in your translation. Alternate translation: [the natives]

See: Idiom

Acts 28:2 (#2)

οὐ τὴν τυχοῦσαν φιλανθρωπίαν

“no ordinary benevolence”

Luke is using a figure of speech that expresses a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a word that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [extraordinary benevolence]

See: Litotes

Acts 28:3 (#1)

ἔχιδνα

“a viper”

A **viper** is a dangerous poisonous snake. If your readers would not recognize this name, you could use the name of another poisonous snake they might recognize or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [a snake whose venom was poisonous]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 28:4 (#1)

ἡ δίκη

“Justice”

The word **Justice** is the name of a false god who the people of this time believed would avenge crimes.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 28:6 (#3)

μεταβαλόμενοι

“turning themselves around”

Luke is speaking as if the natives of Malta were literally **turning themselves around**. He means that they came to a different opinion about who Paul was. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use an expression from your own language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [changing their minds]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:6 (#1)

αὐτὸν μέλλειν πίμπρασθαι, ἢ καταπίπτειν ἄφνω νεκρόν

“him to begin to be inflamed or suddenly to fall down dead”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that the effects of the venom would begin to inflame him or that he would suddenly fall down dead] or [that the effects of the venom would make his body start to swell or that he would suddenly fall down dead]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:6 (#4)

ἔλεγον αὐτὸν εἶναι θεόν

“they said he was a god”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [they said, “He is a god!”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Acts 28:6 (#2)

μηδὲν ἄτοπον εἰς αὐτὸν γινόμενον

“nothing unusual happening to him”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **nothing** and the negative adjective **unusual**. Alternate translation: [everything happening to him as usual]

See: Double Negatives

Acts 28:7 (#2)

τῷ πρώτῳ

“of the first”

Luke is using the adjective **first** as a noun to mean a particular kind of person. In this context, **first** has the sense of most prominent. Since **Publius** is a Roman name, this man was probably the Roman governor of the island. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [of the most prominent man] or [of the Roman governor]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 28:7 (#3)

Ποπλίῳ

“Publius”

The word **Publius** is the name of a man.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 28:7 (#1)

δὲ

“Now”

Luke is using the word **Now** to introduce background information about **Publius** that will help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

Acts 28:8 (#2)

δυσεντερίῳ

“dysentery”

The word **dysentery** describes an infectious intestinal disease. In your translation, you could use a term a similar disease, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [intestinal disease]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 28:8 (#1)

πυρετοῖς καὶ δυσεντερίῳ συνεχόμενον

“being afflicted with fevers and dysentery”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom fevers and dysentery were afflicting]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:9 (#1)

ἐθεραπεύοντο

“being healed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Paul was healing them]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:10 (#1)

πολλαῖς τιμαῖς ἐτίμησαν ἡμᾶς

“honored us with many honors”

Luke assumes that his readers will understand that these **honors** probably included gifts. You can include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [gave us many gifts]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 28:11 (#2)

παρασήμῳ Διοσκούροις

“with a Dioscouri figurehead”

A **figurehead** was an image of a god, human being, animal, or object that was painted or sculpted on the prow (front) of a ship as a good luck token. If your readers would not be familiar with this, you could use a general expression in your translation. Alternate translation: [with images of Castor and Pollux sculpted on the prow]

See: Translate Unknowns

Acts 28:11 (#1)

παρασήμῳ Διοσκούροις

“with a Dioscouri figurehead”

The word **Dioscouri** is the name of two false gods, Castor and Pollux, whom some sailors considered to be their patron gods. The name means “Sons of Zeus” in Greek. Alternate translation: [with Castor and Pollux as their figurehead]

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 28:12 (#1)

καταχθέντες εἰς Συρακούσας

“having come down to Syracuse”

Luke says that he and the others traveling with him had **come down** to Syracuse because that was the customary way in this culture of describing a person arriving somewhere after traveling by sea. Your language may have its own way of describing that. Alternate translation: [having landed at Syracuse]

See: Idiom

Acts 28:12 (#2)

Συρακούσας

“Syracuse”

The word **Syracuse** is the name of a city on the southeast coast of the island of Sicily, just southwest of Italy.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 28:13 (#1)

κατηντήσαμεν εἰς Ῥήγιον

“we came down to Rhegium”

Luke says that he and those traveling with him **came down to Rhegium** because that was the customary way in this culture of describing a person arriving somewhere after traveling by sea. Your language may have its own way of describing that. Alternate translation: [we landed at Rhegium]

See: Idiom

Acts 28:13 (#3)

Ποτιόλους

“Puteoli”

The word **Puteoli** is the name of a city that was located on the west coast of Italy.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 28:13 (#2)

Ῥήγιον

“Rhegium”

The word **Rhegium** is the name of a port city that was located at the southwestern tip of Italy.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 28:14 (#3)

οὕτως εἰς τὴν Ῥώμην ἤλθαμεν

“thus we went towards Rome”

Since Luke describes in the next verse how believers from Rome came some distance to meet Paul and his companions on their way to Rome, by **thus** he means that after staying with the believers in Puteoli for seven days, they continued on their way to Rome. In a context such as this, your language might say “came” instead of **went**. Alternate translation: [we came near Rome]

See: Go and Come

Acts 28:14 (#2)

παρεκλήθημεν

“we were begged”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they begged us]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:14 (#1)

ἀδελφοὺς

“brothers”

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [some believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:15 (#4)

ἔλαβε θάρσος

“took courage”

Here, **courage** is spoken of as if it were an object that a person could **take**. Alternate translation: [became encouraged]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:15 (#5)

Ἀππίου Φόρου & Τριῶν Ταβερνῶν

“the Forum of Appius & Three Taverns”

The phrase **the Forum of Appius** is the name of a popular market on the main highway to Rome that was called the Appian Way. The Forum of Appius was about 40 miles or about 60 kilometers south of Rome. The phrase **Three Taverns** is the name of an inn on that same highway about 30 miles or about 45 kilometers south of Rome.

See: How to Translate Names

Acts 28:15 (#1)

κἀκεῖθεν

“From there”

By **there**, Luke implicitly means Rome. You can provide this information in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [From Rome]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 28:15 (#2)

οἱ ἀδελφοὶ

“the brothers”

Luke is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [some believers]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:15 (#3)

ἀκούσαντες, τὰ περὶ ἡμῶν

“having heard the things about us”

The implication is that these believers had heard from the believers in Puteoli while Paul and his companions were staying with them that they were on their way to Rome. You can provide this information in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [having learned from the believers in Puteoli that we were coming]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 28:16 (#1)

ἐπετράπη τῷ Παύλῳ

“Paul was allowed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Roman officials allowed Paul]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:16 (#2)

καθ’ ἑαυτὸν

“by himself”

Since there was a **soldier** with Paul who was **guarding him**, Luke does not mean that Paul stayed all **by himself**. Rather, he means that the Roman authorities allowed Paul to live in a rented house (as verse 30 indicates) rather than putting him in prison. You can provide this information in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in a rented house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 28:17 (#4)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

“Men, brothers”

Paul is using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [My fellow Jews]

See: Idiom

Acts 28:17 (#2)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων πρώτους

“first among the Jews”

Luke is using the adjective **first** as a noun to mean a particular group of people. Here, **first** has the sense of most prominent. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [most prominent among the Jews]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 28:17 (#6)

τῷ λαῷ

“to the people”

By **the people**, Paul means specifically the Jewish people. Alternate translation: [to the Jewish people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Acts 28:17 (#7)

ἐγώ & δέσμιος ἐξ Ἰεροσολύμων παρεδόθην

“I was delivered as a prisoner from Jerusalem”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Jewish leaders in Jerusalem delivered me as a prisoner]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:17 (#3)

ἄνδρες, ἀδελφοί

“Men, brothers”

This is an idiomatic form of address. Use a way that is natural in your language to refer to a particular group of people. Alternate translation: [My brothers]

See: Idiom

Acts 28:17 (#1)

ἐγένετο δὲ

“And it happened that”

Luke is using this phrase to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Acts 28:17 (#8)

τὰς χεῖρας

“the hands”

Here, **hands** represents the power of someone, in this case the power of an authority to hold an accused person in custody. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the custody]

See: Metonymy

Acts 28:17 (#5)

τοῖς ἔθεσι τοῖς πατρῴοις

“to the fathers’ customs”

Paul is using the term **fathers** to describe customs that have been passed down among the Jews through the generations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the ancestral customs]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:18 (#1)

τὸ μηδεμίαν αἰτίαν θανάτου ὑπάρχειν ἐν ἐμοί

“there was no reason in me for death”

Paul is referring to a penalty of death by association with **death** itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I had done nothing to deserve the death penalty]

See: Metonymy

Acts 28:19 (#3)

τοῦ ἔθνους μου

“my nation”

Paul is referring by association to the people of the Jewish **nation**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish people]

See: Metonymy

Acts 28:19 (#1)

τῶν Ἰουδαίων

“the Jews”

Paul is using the name of a whole group, **the Jews**, to refer to some members of that group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Jewish leaders in Jerusalem]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 28:19 (#2)

ἠναγκάσθην

“I was forced”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [my concern for my safety forced me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:20 (#2)

εἵνεκεν & τῆς ἐλπίδος τοῦ Ἰσραὴλ

“on account of the hope of Israel”

Paul is referring by association to something that the people of Israel had **hope** for. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or express the meaning plainly. This could mean: (1) the hope that God would send the Messiah. Alternate translation: [because I believe God has sent the Messiah]; (2) the hope that God would make people who had died alive again. Alternate translation: [because I believe that God will make people who have died alive again]

See: Metonymy

Acts 28:20 (#5)

τὴν ἅλυσιν ταύτην περίκειμαι

"I am bound with this chain"

Paul is using one aspect of imprisonment, the **chain** with which he is bound, to mean the entire state of being imprisoned. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Romans are keeping me as a prisoner]

See: Synecdoche

Acts 28:20 (#3)

τοῦ Ἰσραὴλ

"of Israel"

Paul is referring to all of the people of Israel as if they were a single person, their ancestor, **Israel**. Alternate translation: [of the people of Israel]

See: Personification

Acts 28:20 (#1)

τῆς ἐλπίδος τοῦ Ἰσραὴλ

"the hope of Israel"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **hope**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what Israel is hoping for]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 28:20 (#4)

τὴν ἅλυσιν ταύτην περίκειμαι

"I am bound with this chain"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [this chain is binding me]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:21 (#3)

οὔτε παραγενόμενός τις τῶν ἀδελφῶν ἀπήγγειλεν ἢ ἐλάλησέν τι

"nor have any of the brothers, coming, reported or said anything"

The terms **reported** and **said** mean similar things. The Jewish leaders are using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [nor have any of the brothers, coming, told us anything at all]

See: Doublet

Acts 28:21 (#1)

ἡμεῖς

"We"

By **We**, these Jewish leaders mean themselves but not Paul, to whom they are speaking, so use the exclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Acts 28:21 (#2)

τῶν ἀδελφῶν

"of the brothers"

These Jewish leaders are using the term **brothers** to mean people who share the same faith. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of our fellow Jews]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:22 (#1)

γνωστὸν ἡμῖν ἐστιν

"it is known to us"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we know]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:22 (#3)

πανταχοῦ

"everywhere"

The Jewish leaders say **everywhere** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [in places throughout the empire]

See: Hyperbole

Acts 28:22 (#2)

ἀντιλέγεται

"it is spoken against"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people speak against it]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:23 (#3)

ἀπό τε τοῦ νόμου Μωϋσέως, καὶ τῶν προφητῶν

"both from the Law of Moses and the Prophets"

Luke is referring to all of the Hebrew Scriptures by naming two of their major parts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from passages throughout the Scriptures]

See: Merism

Acts 28:23 (#1)

πλείονες

"more"

Luke is using the adjective **more** as a noun to mean the larger number of people who came to hear Paul speak. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [more people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Acts 28:23 (#2)

διαμαρτυρόμενος τὴν Βασιλείαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"testifying about the kingdom of God"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of a **kingdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [testifying about how God had begun to rule as king]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 28:24 (#1)

οἱ & ἐπείθοντο τοῖς λεγομένοις

"some were convinced by the things being said"

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the things that Paul was saying convinced some]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:25 (#1)

εἰπόντος & ῥῆμα ἓν

"having spoken one word"

Luke is using the term **word** to mean a statement that Paul made by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [having made this last statement]

See: Metonymy

Acts 28:25 (#2)

τοὺς πατέρας ὑμῶν

"your fathers"

Paul is using the term **fathers** to mean "ancestors." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:26 (#2)

λέγων, πορεύθητι

"saying, 'Go"

This is the beginning of a quotation within a quotation. You may be able to indicate that with an opening second-level quotation mark or with some other punctuation or convention that your language could use to indicate the start of a second-level quotation. You may also be able to use special formatting to set off the quotation, as ULT does.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 28:26 (#3)

εἰπόν, ἀκοῇ

"say, "By hearing"

This is the beginning of a quotation within a quotation within a quotation. You may be able to indicate that

with an opening third-level quotation mark or with some other punctuation or convention that your language could use to indicate the start of a third-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 28:26 (#4)

ἀκοῇ ἀκούσετε & βλέποντες βλέψετε

“By hearing you will hear & seeing you will see”

Isaiah is using a Hebrew idiom, the repetition of a verb to express the intensity of an action. It may not be possible to translate this Hebrew practice of verb repetition directly into many languages. Use a natural form of strengthening a verb in your language. Alternate translation: [You will try very hard to hear ... you will try very hard to see]

See: Idiom

Acts 28:26 (#6)

καὶ οὐ μὴ συνῆτε & καὶ οὐ μὴ ἴδητε

“but you will not understand at all & but you will not perceive at all”

Both of these phrases mean basically the same thing. They emphasize that the Jewish people will not understand God’s plan.

See: Parallelism

Acts 28:26 (#7)

οὐ μὴ ἴδητε

“you will not perceive at all”

This is the end of a quotation within a quotation within a quotation. You may be able to indicate that with a closing third-level quotation mark or with some other punctuation or convention that your language could use to indicate the end of a third-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 28:26 (#5)

ἀκοῇ ἀκούσετε, καὶ οὐ μὴ συνῆτε; καὶ βλέποντες βλέψετε, καὶ οὐ μὴ ἴδητε

“By hearing you will hear but you will not understand at all, and seeing you will see but you will not perceive at all”

These two phrases mean similar things. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [You will become aware of what is happening around you but you will not understand the significance of what is happening]

See: Parallelism

Acts 28:26 (#1)

λέγων, πορεύθητι πρὸς τὸν λαὸν τοῦτον, καὶ εἰπόν, ἀκοῇ ἀκούσετε, καὶ οὐ μὴ συνῆτε; καὶ βλέποντες βλέψετε, καὶ οὐ μὴ ἴδητε

“saying, ‘Go to this people and say, “By hearing you will hear but you will not understand at all, and seeing you will see but you will not perceive at all”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation and then another quotation inside the first one. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [The Holy Spirit told Isaiah to go to the people of Israel and tell them that by hearing they would hear but they would not understand at all and that seeing they would see but they would not perceive at all]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 28:27 (#3)

ἐπαχύνθη & ἡ καρδία τοῦ λαοῦ τούτου

“the heart of this people has been thickened”

Isaiah is speaking as if the **heart** of the people of Israel has literally been **thickened**. He means that they are resisting God stubbornly. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this people has become stubborn]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:27 (#4)

ἡ καρδία

“the heart”

Isaiah is speaking as if the **heart** of the people of Israel has literally been **thickened**. He means that they are resisting God stubbornly. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this people has become stubborn]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:27 (#1)

ἐπαχύνθη γὰρ ἡ καρδία τοῦ λαοῦ τούτου, καὶ τοῖς ὠσὶν βαρέως ἤκουσαν, καὶ τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς αὐτῶν ἐκάμμυσαν, μήποτε ἴδωσιν τοῖς ὀφθαλμοῖς, καὶ

τοῖς ὠσὶν ἀκούσωσιν, καὶ τῇ καρδίᾳ συνῶσιν, καὶ ἐπιστρέψωσιν, καὶ ἰάσομαι αὐτούς

"For the heart of this people has been thickened, and with {their} ears they have hardly heard, and they have shut their eyes, lest they might see with {their} eyes, and they might hear with {their} ears, and they might understand with {their} heart and turn back, and I would heal them"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. It may be helpful to make this two sentences. Alternate translation: [The Holy Spirit told Isaiah to say that because the heart of that people had been thickened, and with their ears they had hardly heard, and they had shut their eyes. Otherwise they might have seen with their eyes, and they might have heard with their ears, and they might have understood with their heart and turned back, and God would have healed them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Acts 28:27 (#5)

ἡ καρδία τοῦ λαοῦ τούτου

"the heart of this people"

If it would not be natural in your language to speak as if a group of people had only one **heart**, you could use the plural form of that word in your translation. Alternate translation: [the hearts of these people]

See: Collective Nouns

Acts 28:27 (#13)

ἰάσομαι αὐτούς

"I would heal them"

This is the end of a quotation within a quotation. You may be able to indicate that with closing second-level quotation marks or with some other punctuation or convention that your language could use to indicate the end of a second-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Acts 28:27 (#11)

ἐπιστρέψωσιν

"turn back"

Isaiah is speaking of the people of Israel as if they had been traveling somewhere and had taken the wrong way and needed to **turn back** onto the right way. Alternate translation: [start obeying the Lord again]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:27 (#10)

ἴδωσιν τοῖς ὀφθαλμοῖς, καὶ τοῖς ὠσὶν ἀκούσωσιν

"they might see with {their} eyes, and they might hear with {their} ears"

These two phrases mean similar things. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [they might use their senses]

See: Parallelism

Acts 28:27 (#8)

καὶ τοῖς ὠσὶν βαρέως ἤκουσαν, καὶ τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς αὐτῶν ἐκάμμυσαν

"and with {their} ears they have hardly heard, and they have shut their eyes"

Isaiah is speaking as if the people of Israel have become unable to hear and have **shut their eyes** so that they will not see. He means that they are refusing to consider what God wants to tell them. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they are refusing to consider what God wants to tell them]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:27 (#12)

ἰάσομαι αὐτούς

"I would heal them"

This does not mean God would only **heal** the people physically. He would also heal them spiritually by forgiving their sins. Alternate translation: [I would heal them and forgive them]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:27 (#9)

τοῖς ὠσὶν βαρέως ἤκουσαν & ἴδωσιν τοῖς ὀφθαλμοῖς & τοῖς ὠσὶν ἀκούσωσιν

"with {their} ears they have hardly heard & they might see with {their} eyes & they might hear with {their} ears"

It might seem that these expressions contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten them. Alternate translation: [they have hardly heard anything ... they might see clearly ... they might hear clearly]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Acts 28:27 (#2)

ἐπαχύνθη γὰρ ἡ καρδία τοῦ λαοῦ τούτου, καὶ τοῖς ὠσὶν βαρέως ἤκουσαν, καὶ τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς αὐτῶν ἐκάμμυσαν

"For the heart of this people has been thickened, and with {their} ears they have hardly heard, and they have shut their eyes"

These three phrases mean similar things. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [For this people is stubbornly refusing to use its senses]

See: Parallelism

Acts 28:27 (#6)

ἡ καρδία & τῇ καρδίᾳ

"the heart & with {their} heart"

Here, the **heart** represents the thoughts of people. Alternate translation: [the thinking ... with their thinking]

See: Metaphor

Acts 28:27 (#7)

ἐπαχύνθη

"has been thickened"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [has become thick]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:28 (#2)

τοῖς ἔθνεσιν ἀπεστάλη τοῦτο τὸ σωτήριον τοῦ Θεοῦ

"this salvation of God has been sent to the Gentiles"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who has done the action, it is clear from the context that it was God. Alternate translation: [God has sent me to proclaim this salvation of his to the Gentiles]

See: Active or Passive

Acts 28:28 (#4)

αὐτοὶ & ἀκούσονται

"they will hear"

In this context the word **hear** likely means "understand and obey," since Paul is drawing a contrast with the stubborn response of many of the Jews. You may wish to make this clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [they will understand the message and obey it]

See: Idiom

Acts 28:28 (#3)

τοῦτο τὸ σωτήριον τοῦ Θεοῦ

"this salvation of God"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [this message about how God saves people]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 28:28 (#1)

γνωστὸν & ἔστω

"let it be known"

If your language does not use the third-person imperative in this way, you could state this in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may it be known to you]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Acts 28:29 (#1)

As the General Introduction to Acts explains, this verse is found in many traditional versions of the Bible, but it is not found in the most accurate ancient manuscripts of the Bible. ULT and UST indicate this by putting the verse in brackets. If a translation of the Bible already exists in your area, you could consider including this verse if that translation does. If there is not already a Bible translation in your area, we recommend that you indicate in some way that this verse may not be original, such as by putting it in brackets or in a footnote.

See: Textual Variants

Acts 28:30 (#2)

ἐνέμεινεν

"he stayed"

The pronoun **he** refers to Paul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Paul stayed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Acts 28:30 (#1)

ἐνέμεινεν δὲ διετίαν ὅλην ἐν ἰδίῳ μισθώματι

“And he stayed for two whole years in his own rented house”

This is the beginning of information that Luke presents to bring the story of the book of Acts to a close. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

Acts 28:31 (#3)

μετὰ πάσης παρρησίας

“with all boldness”

Luke says **all** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis.

See: Hyperbole

Acts 28:31 (#2)

μετὰ πάσης παρρησίας ἀκωλύτως

“with all boldness, without hindrance”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **boldness** and **hindrance**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [very boldly, with no one hindering him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Acts 28:31 (#1)

τὴν Βασιλείαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the kingdom of God”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of a **kingdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how God had begun to rule as king]

See: Abstract Nouns